POETRY

The Oxford Book of English Verse, 1250-1900

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The Oxford Book Of English Verse

1250-1900

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The Oxford Book Of English Verse 1250-1900

Chosen & Edited by Arthur Quiller-Couch

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TO

THE PRESIDENT

FELLOWS AND SCHOLARS

OF

TRINITY COLLEGE OXFORD

A HOUSE OF LEARNING

ANCIENT LIBERAL HUMANE

AND MY MOST KINDLY NURSE

PREFACE

For this Anthology I have tried to range over the whole field of English Verse from the beginning, or from the Thirteenth Century to this closing year of the Nineteenth, and to choose the best. Nor have I sought in these Islands only, but wheresoever the Muse has followed the tongue which among living tongues she most delights to honour. To bring home and render so great a spoil compendiously has been my capital difficulty. It is for the reader to judge if I have so managed it as to serve those who already love poetry and to implant that love in some young minds not yet initiated.

My scheme is simple. I have arranged the poets as nearly as possible in order of birth, with such groupings of anonymous pieces as seemed convenient. For convenience, too, as well as to avoid a dispute-royal, I have gathered the most of the Ballads into the middle of the Seventeenth Century; where they fill a languid interval between two winds of inspiration--the Italian dying down with Milton and the French following at the heels of the restored Royalists. For convenience, again, I have set

myself certain rules of spelling. In the very earliest poems inflection and spelling are structural, and to modernize is to destroy. But as old inflections fade into modern the old spelling becomes less and less vital, and has been brought (not, I hope, too abruptly) into line with that sanctioned by use and familiar. To do this seemed wiser than to discourage many readers for the sake of diverting others by a scent of antiquity which--to be essential--should breathe of something rarer than an odd arrangement of type. But there are scholars whom I cannot expect to agree with me; and to conciliate them I have excepted Spenser and Milton from the rule.

Glosses of archaic and otherwise difficult words are given at the foot of the page: but the text has not been disfigured with reference-marks. And rather than make the book unwieldy I have eschewed notes--reluctantly when some obscure passage or allusion seemed to ask for a timely word; with more equanimity when the temptation was to criticize or ‘appreciate.’ For the function of the anthologist includes criticizing in silence.

Care has been taken with the texts. But I have sometimes thought it consistent with the aim of the book to prefer the more beautiful to the better attested reading. I have often excised weak or superfluous stanzas when sure that excision would improve; and have not hesitated to extract a few stanzas from a long poem when persuaded that they could stand alone as a lyric. The apology for such experiments can only lie in their success: but the risk is one which, in my judgement, the anthologist ought to take. A few small corrections have been made, but only when they were quite obvious.

The numbers chosen are either lyrical or epigrammatic. Indeed I am mistaken if a single epigram included fails to preserve at least some faint thrill of the emotion through which it had to pass before the Muse’s lips let it fall, with however exquisite deliberation. But the lyrical spirit is volatile and notoriously hard to bind with definitions; and seems to grow wilder with the years. With the anthologist--as with the fisherman who knows the fish at the end of his sea-line--the gift, if he have it, comes by sense, improved by practice. The definition, if he be clever enough to frame one, comes by after-thought. I don’t know that it helps, and am sure that it may easily mislead.

Having set my heart on choosing the best, I resolved not to be dissuaded by common objections against anthologies--that they repeat one another until the proverb δὶς ἢ τρὶς τὰ καλά loses all application--or perturbed if my judgement should often agree with that of good critics. The best is the best, though a hundred judges have declared it so; nor had it been any feat to search out and insert the second-rate merely because it happened to be recondite. To be sure, a man must come to such a task as mine haunted by his youth and the favourites he loved in days when he had much enthusiasm but little reading.

A deeper import Lurks in the legend told my infant years Than lies upon that truth we live to learn.

Few of my contemporaries can erase--or would wish to erase--the dye their minds took from the late Mr. Palgrave’s _Golden Treasury_: and he who has returned to it

again and again with an affection born of companionship on many journeys must remember not only what the _Golden Treasury_ includes, but the moment when this or that poem appealed to him, and even how it lies on the page. To Mr. Bullen's _Lyrics from the Elizabethan Song Books_ and his other treasuries I own a more advised debt. Nor am I free of obligation to anthologies even more recent--to Archbishop Trench's _Household Book of Poetry_, Mr. Locker-Lampson's _Lyra Elegantiarum_, Mr. Miles' _Poets and Poetry of the Century_, Mr. Beeching's _Paradise of English Poetry_, Mr. Henley's _English Lyrics_, Mrs. Sharp's _Lyra Celtica_, Mr. Yeats' _Book of Irish Verse_, and Mr. Churton Collins' _Treasury of Minor British Poetry_: though my rule has been to consult these after making my own choice. Yet I can claim that the help derived from them--though gratefully owned--bears but a trifling proportion to the labour, special and desultory, which has gone to the making of my book.

For the anthologist's is not quite the _dilettante_ business for which it is too often and ignorantly derided. I say this, and immediately repent; since my wish is that the reader should in his own pleasure quite forget the editor's labour, which too has been pleasant: that, standing aside, I may believe this book has made the Muses' access easier when, in the right hour, they come to him to uplift or to console--

ἄκλητος μὲν ἔγωγε μένοιμί κεν ἐς δὲ καλεύντων θαρσήσας Μοίσαισι σὺν ἀμετέραισιν ἰκοίμαν

My thanks are here tendered to those who have helped me with permission to include recent poems: to Mr. A. C. Benson, Mr. Laurence Binyon, Mr. Wilfrid Blunt, Mr. Robert Bridges, Mr. John Davidson, Mr. Austin Dobson, Mr. Aubrey de Vere, Mr. Edmund Gosse, Mr. Bret Harte, Mr. W. E. Henley, Mrs. Katharine Tynan Hinkson, Mr. W. D. Howells, Dr. Douglas Hyde, Mr. Rudyard Kipling, Mr. Andrew Lang, Mr. Richard Le Gallienne, Mr. George Meredith, Mrs. Meynell, Mr. T. Sturge Moore, Mr. Henry Newbolt, Mr. Gilbert Parker, Mr. T. W. Rolleston, Mr. George Russell ('A. E.'), Mrs. Clement Shorter (Dora Sigerson), Mr. Swinburne, Mr. Francis Thompson, Dr. Todhunter, Mr. William Watson, Mr. Watts-Dunton, Mrs. Woods, and Mr. W. B. Yeats; to the Earl of Crewe for a poem by the late Lord Houghton; to Lady Ferguson, Mrs. Allingham, Mrs. A. H. Clough, Mrs. Locker-Lampson, Mrs. Coventry Patmore; to the Lady Betty Balfour and the Lady Victoria Buxton for poems by the late Earl of Lytton and the Hon. Roden Noel; to the executors of Messrs. Frederic Tennyson (Captain Tennyson and Mr. W. C. A. Ker), Charles Tennyson Turner (Sir Franklin Lushington), Edward FitzGerald (Mr. Aldis Wright), William Bell Scott (Mrs. Sydney Morse and Miss Boyd of Penkill Castle, who has added to her kindness by allowing me to include an unpublished 'Sonet' by her sixteenth-century ancestor, Mark Alexander Boyd), William Philpot (Mr. Hamlet S. Philpot), William Morris (Mr. S. C. Cockerell), William Barnes, and R. L. Stevenson; to the Rev. H. C. Beeching for two poems from his own works, and leave to use his redaction of _Quia Amore Langueo_; to Messrs. Macmillan for confirming permission for the extracts from FitzGerald, Christina Rossetti, and T. E. Brown, and particularly for allowing me to insert the latest emendations in Lord Tennyson's non-copyright poems; to the proprietors of Mr. and Mrs. Browning's copyrights and to Messrs. Smith, Elder & Co. for a similar favour, also for a copyright

poem by Mrs. Browning; to Mr. George Allen for extracts from Ruskin and the author of _Ionica_; to Messrs. G. Bell & Sons for poems by Thomas Ashe; to Messrs. Chatto & Windus for poems by Arthur O'Shaughnessy and Dr. George MacDonald, and for confirming Mr. Bret Harte's permission; to Mr. Elkin Mathews for a poem by Mr. Bliss Carman; to Mr. John Lane for two poems by William Brighty Rands; to the Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge for two extracts from Christina Rossetti's _Verses_; and to Mr. Bertram Dobell, who allows me not only to select from James Thomson but to use a poem of Traherne's, a seventeenth-century singer rediscovered by him. To mention all who in other ways have furthered me is not possible in this short Preface; which, however, must not conclude without a word of special thanks to Dr. W. Robertson Nicoll for many suggestions and some pains kindly bestowed, and to Professor F. York Powell, whose help and wise counsel have been as generously given as they were eagerly sought, adding me to the number of those many who have found his learning to be his friends' good fortune.

A.T.Q.C.

October 1900

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859. Arthur Christopher Benson. b. 1862.....1035-1036

860. Henry Newbolt. b. 1862.....1036-1037

861. Gilbert Parker. b. 1862.....1038

862-864. William Butler Yeats. b. 1865.....1038-1039

865-867. Rudyard Kipling. b. 1865.....1040-1045

868-869. Richard Le Gallienne. b. 1866.....1045-1047

870-871. Laurence Binyon. b. 1869.....1047

872-873. 'A. E.' (George William Russell).....1048-1049

874. T. Sturge Moore. b. 1870.....1049

875. Francis Thompson, b. 1859, d. 1907.....1050-1052

876. Henry Cust. b. 1861, d. 1917.....1053

877. Katharine Tynan Hinkson. b. 1861.....1053-1054

878. Frances Bannerman.....1054-1055

879-880. Alice Meynell. b. 1850.....1055-1056

881. Dora Sigerson. d. 1918.....1056-1057

882. Margaret L. Woods. b. 1856.....1057

883. Anonymous.....1058

[Illustration]

_1._ _Cuckoo Song_

c. 1250

Sumer is icumen in, Lhude sing cuccu! Groweth sed, and bloweth med, And springth the wude nu-- Sing cuccu!

Awe bleteth after lomb, Lhouth after calve cu; Bulluc sterteth, bucke verteth, Murie sing cuccu!

Cuccu, cuccu, well singes thu, cuccu: Ne swike thu naver nu; Sing cuccu, nu, sing cuccu, Sing cuccu, sing cuccu, nu!

lhude] loud. awe] ewe. lhouth] loweth. sterteth] leaps. swike] cease.

ANONYMOUS

_2._ _Alison_

c. 1300

Bytuene Mershe ant Averil When spray biginneth to spring, The lutel foul hath hire wyl On hyre kid to synge: Ich libbe in love-longinge For semlokest of alle thynge, He may me blisse bringe, Icham in hire bandoun. An hendy hap ichabbe y-hent, Ichot from hevene it is me sent, From alle wymmen my love is lent Ant lyht on Alisoun.

On heu hire her is fayr ynoh, Hire browe broune, hire eye blake; With lossum chere he on me loh; With middel smal ant wel y-make; Bote he me wolle to hire take For to buen hire owen make, Long to lyven ichulle forsake Ant feye fallen adoun. An hendy hap, etc.

Nihtes when I wende and wake, For-thi myn wonges waxeth won;

on hyre lud] in her language. ich libbe] I live. semlokest] seemliest. he] she. bandoun] thraldom. hendy] gracious. y hent] seized, enjoyed. ichot] I wot. lyht] alighted. hire her] her hair. lossum] lovesome. loh] laughed. bote he] unless she. buen] be. make] mate. feye] like to die. nihtes] at night. wende] turn. for-thi] on that account. wonges waxeth won] cheeks grow wan.

Levedi, al for thine sake Longinge is y-lent me on. In world his non so wyter mon That al hire bountè telle con; Hire swyre is whittore than the swon, Ant feyrest may in toune. An hendy hap, etc.

Icham for wowyng al for-wake, Wery so water in wore; Lest eny reve me my make Ichabbe y-yerned yore. Betere is tholien whyle sore Then mournen evermore. Geynest under gore, Herkne to my roun-- An hendy hap, etc.

_2._ levedi] lady. y-lent me on] arrived to me. so wyter mon] so wise a man. swyre] neck. may] maid. for-wake] worn out with vigils. so water in wore] as water in a weir. reve] rob. y-yerned yore] long been distressed. tholien] to endure. geynest under gore] comeliest under woman's apparel. roun] tale, lay.

_3._ _Spring-tide_

c. 1300

Lenten ys come with love to toune, With blosmen ant with briddes roune, That al this blisse bryngeth; Dayes-eyes in this dales, Notes suete of nyhtegales, Vch foul song singeth;

_3._ to toune] in its turn.

The threstlecoc him threteth oo, Away is huere wynter wo, When woderove springeth; This foules singeth ferly fele, Ant wlyteth on huere winter wele, That al the wode ryngeth.

The rose rayleth hire rode, The leves on the lyhte wode Waxen al with wille; The mone mandeth hire bleo, The lilie is lossom to seo, The fenyl ant the fille; Wowes this wilde drakes, Miles murgeth huere makes; Ase strem that striketh stille, Mody meneth; so doth mo (Ichot ycham on of tho) For loue that likes ille.

The mone mandeth hire lyht, So doth the semly sonne bryht. When briddes singeth breme; Deowes donketh the dounes, Deores with huere derne rounes Domes forte deme;

him threteth oo] is aye chiding them. huere] their. woderove] woodruff. ferly fele] marvellous many. wlyteth] whistle, or look. rayleth hire rode] clothes herself in red. mandeth hire bleo] sends forth her light. lossom to seo] lovesome to see. fille] thyme. wowes] woo. miles] males. murgeth] make merry. makes] mates. striketh] flows, trickles. mody meneth] the moody man makes moan. so doth mo] so do many. on of tho] one of them. breme] lustily. deowes] dews. donketh] make dank. deores] dears, lovers. huere derne rounes] their secret tales. domes forte deme] for to give (decide) their decisions.

Wormes woweth under cloude, Wymmen waxeth wounder proude, So wel hit wol hem seme, Yef me shal wonte wille of on, This wunne weole y wole forgon Ant wyht in wode be fleme.

_3._ cloude] clod. wunne weole] wealth of joy. y wole forgon] I will forgo. wyht] wight. fleme] banished.

_4._ _Blow, Northern Wind_

c. 1300

Ichot a burde in boure bryht, That fully semly is on syht, Menskful maiden of myht; Feir ant fre to fonde; In al this wurhliche won A burde of blod ant of bon Never yete y nuste non Lussomore in londe. Blou northerne wynd! Send thou me my suetyng! Blou northerne wynd! blou, blou, blou!

With lokkes lefliche ant longe, With frount ant face feir to fonge, With murthes monie mote heo monge, That brid so breme in boure.

_4._ Ichot] I know. burde] maiden. menskful] worshipful. feir] fair. fonde] take, prove. wurhliche] noble. won] multitude. y nuste] I knew not. lussomore in londe] lovelier on earth. suetyng] sweetheart. lefliche] lovely. fonge] take between hands. murthes] mirths, joys. mote heo monge] may she mingle. brid] bird. breme] full of life.

With lossom eye grete ant gode, With browen blysfol under hode, He that reste him on the Rode, That leflych lyf honoure. Blou northerne wynd, etc.

Hire lure lumes liht, Ase a launterne a nyht, Hire bleo blykyeth so bryht, So feyr heo is ant fyn. A suetly swyre heo hath to holde. With armes shuldre ase mon wolde, Ant fingres feyre forte folde, God wolde hue were myn! Blou northerne wynd, etc.

Heo is coral of godnesse, Heo is rubie of ryhtfulnesse, Heo is cristal of clannesse, Ant baner of bealtè. Heo is lilie of largesse, Heo is parvenke of prouesse, Heo is solsecle of suetnesse, Ant lady of lealtè.

For hire love y carke ant care, For hire love y droupne ant dare, For hire love my blisse is bare Ant al ich waxe won,

Rode] the Cross. lure] face. lumes] beams. bleo] colour. suetly swyre] darling neck. forte] for to. hue, heo] she. clannesse] cleanness, purity. parvenke] periwinkle. solsecle] sunflower. won] wan.

For hire love in slep y slake, For hire love al nyht ich wake, For hire love mournynge y make More then eny mon. Blou northerne wynd! Send thou me my suetyng! Blou northerne wynd! blou, blou, blou!

_5._ _This World’s Joy_

c. 1300

Wynter wakeneth al my care, Nou this leves waxeth bare; Ofte I sike ant mourne sare When hit cometh in my thoht Of this worldes joie, hou hit goth al to noht.

Nou hit is, and nou hit nys, Al so hit ner nere, ywys; That moni mon seith, soth hit ys: Al goth bote Godes wille: Alle we shule deye, thah us like ylle.

Al that gren me graueth grene, Nou hit faleweth albydene: Jesu, help that hit be sene Ant shild us from helle! For y not whider y shal, ne hou longe her duelle.

_5._ this leves] these leaves. sike] sigh. nys] is not. also hit ner nere] as though it had never been. soth] sooth. bote] but, except. thah] though. faleweth] fadeth. albydene] altogether. y not whider] I know not whither. her duelle] here dwell.

_6._ _A Hymn to the Virgin_

c. 1300

Of on that is so fayr and bright _Velut maris stella_, Brighter than the day is light, _Parens et puella_: Ic crie to the, thou see to me, Levedy, preye thi Sone for me, _Tam pia_, That ic mote come to thee _Maria_.

Al this world was for-lore _Eva peccatrice_, Tyl our Lord was y-bore _De te genetrice_. With _ave_ it went away Thuster nyth and comz the day _Salutis_; The welle springeth ut of the, _Virtutis_.

Levedy, flour of alle thing, _Rosa sine spina_, Thu bere Jhesu, hevene king, _Gratia divina_: Of alle thu ber'st the pris, Levedy, quene of paradys _Electa_: Mayde milde, moder es _Effecta_.

on] one. levedy] lady. thuster] dark. pris] prize.

_7._ _Of a rose, a lovely rose,_ _Of a rose is al myn song._

c. 1350

Lestenyt, lordynges, both elde and yinge, How this rose began to sprynge; Swych a rose to myn lykynge In al this word ne knowe I non.

The Aungil came fro hevene tour, To grete Marye with gret honour, And seyde sche xuld bere the flour That xulde breke the fyndes bond.

The flour sprong in heye Bedlem, That is bothe bryht and schen: The rose is Mary hevene qwyn, Out of here bosum the blosme sprong.

The ferste braunche is ful of myht, That sprang on Cyrstemesse nyht, The sterre schon over Bedlem bryht That is bothe brod and long.

The secunde braunche sprong to helle, The fendys power doun to felle: Therein myht non sowle dwelle; Blyssid be the time the rose sprong!

The thredde braunche is good and swote, It sprang to hevene crop and rote, Therein to dwellyn and ben our bote; Every day it schewit in prystes hond.

lestenyt] listen. word] world. xuld] should. schen] beautiful. hevene qwyn] heaven's queen. bote] salvation.

Prey we to here with gret honour, Che that bar the blyssid flowr, Che be our helpe and our socour And schyd us fro the fyndes bond.

ROBERT MANNYNG OF BRUNNE

1260-1340

_8._ _Praise of Women_

No thyng ys to man so dere As wommanys love in gode manere. A gode womman is mannys blys, There her love right and stedfast ys. There ys no solas under hevene Of alle that a man may nevene That shulde a man so moche glew As a gode womman that loveth true. Ne derer is none in Goddis hurde Than a chaste womman with lovely worde.

_8._ nevene] name. glew] gladden. hurde] flock.

JOHN BARBOUR

d. 1395

_9._ _Freedom_

A! Fredome is a noble thing! Fredome mays man to haiff liking; Fredome all solace to man giffis, He levys at ese that frely levys! A noble hart may haiff nane ese, Na ellys nocht that may him plese,

_9._ liking] liberty. na ellys nocht] nor aught else.

Gyff fredome fail; for fre liking Is yarnyt our all othir thing. Na he that ay has levyt fre May nocht knaw weill the propyrtè, The angyr, na the wretchyt dome That is couplyt to foule thyrldome. Bot gyff he had assayit it, Than all perquer he suld it wyt; And suld think fredome mar to prise Than all the gold in warld that is. Thus contrar thingis evirmar Discoweryngis off the tothir ar.

_9._ yarnyt] yearned for. perquer] thoroughly, by heart.

GEOFFREY CHAUCER

1340?-1400

_10._ _The Love Unfeigned_

O YONGE fresshe folkes, he or she, In which that love up groweth with your age, Repeyreth hoom from worldly vanitee, And of your herte up-casteth the visage To thilke god that after his image Yow made, and thinketh al nis but a fayre This world, that passeth sone as floures fayre.

And loveth him, the which that right for love Upon a cros, our soules for to beye, First starf, and roos, and sit in hevene a-bove; For he nil falsen no wight, dar I seye, That wol his herte al hoolly on him leye. And sin he best to love is, and most meke, What nedeth feyned loves for to seke?

_10._ repeyreth] repair ye. starf] died.

_11._ _Balade_

Hyd, Absolon, thy gilte tresses clere; Ester, ley thou thy meknesse al a-doun; Hyd, Jonathas, al thy frendly manere; Penalopee, and Marcia Catoun, Mak of your wyfhod no comparisoun; Hyde ye your beautes, Isoude and Eleyne; My lady cometh, that al this may disteyne.

Thy faire body, lat hit nat appere, Lavyne; and thou, Lucresse of Rome toun, And Polixene, that boghten love so dere, And Cleopatre, with al thy passioun, Hyde ye your trouthe of love and your renoun; And thou, Tisbe, that hast of love swich peyne; My lady cometh, that al this may disteyne.

Herro, Dido, Laudomia, alle y-fere, And Phyllis, hanging for thy Demophoun, And Canace, espyed by thy chere, Ysiphile, betraysed with Jasoun, Maketh of your trouthe neyther boost ne soun; Nor Ypermistre or Adriane, ye tweyne; My lady cometh, that al this may distevne.

_11._ disteyne] bedim. y-fere] together.

_12._ _Merciles Beaute_

A TRIPLE ROUNDEL

1. CAPTIVITY

Your eyen two wol slee me sodenly, I may the beautè of hem not sustene, So woundeth hit through-out my herte kene.

And but your word wol helen hastily My hertes wounde, whyl that hit is grene, Your eyen two wol slee me sodenly, I may the beautè of hem not sustene.

Upon my trouthe I sey yow feithfully, That ye ben of my lyf and deeth the quene; For with my deeth the trouthe shal be sene. Your eyen two wol slee me sodenly, I may the beautè of hem not sustene, So woundeth hit through-out my herte kene.

2. REJECTION

So hath your beautè fro your herte chaced Pitee, that me ne availeth not to pleyne; For Daunger halt your mercy in his cheyne.

Giltles my deeth thus han ye me purchaced; I sey yow sooth, me nedeth not to feyne; So hath your beautè fro your herte chaced Pitee, that me ne availeth not to pleyne.

Allas! that nature hath in yow compassed So greet beautè, that no man may atteyne To mercy, though he sterve for the peyne. So hath your beautè fro your herte chaced Pitee, that me ne availeth not to pleyne; For Daunger halt your mercy in his cheyne.

3. ESCAPE

Sin I fro Love escaped am so fat, I never thenk to ben in his prison lene; Sin I am free, I counte him not a bene.

halt] holdeth.

He may answere, and seye this or that; I do no fors, I speke right as I mene. Sin I fro Love escaped am so fat, I never thenk to ben in his prison lene.

Love hath my name y-strike out of his sclat, And he is strike out of my bokes clene For ever-mo; ther is non other mene. Sin I fro Love escaped am so fat, I never thenk to ben in his prison lene; Sin I am free, I counte him not a bene.

_12._ sclat] slate

THOMAS HOCCLEVE

1368-9?-1450?

_13._ _Lament for Chaucer_

Allas! my worthi maister honorable, This landes verray tresor and richesse! Deth by thy deth hath harme irreparable Unto us doon: hir vengeable duresse Despoiled hath this land of the swetnesse Of rethorik; for unto Tullius Was never man so lyk amonges us.

Also who was hier in philosophie To Aristotle in our tonge but thou? The steppes of Virgile in poesie Thou folwedist eeke, men wot wel ynow. That combre-worlde that the my maister slow-- Wolde I slayn were!--Deth, was to hastyf To renne on thee and reve the thi lyf ...

_13._ hier] heir. combre-worlde] encumberer of earth. slow] slew.

She myghte han taried hir vengeance a while Til that sum man had egal to the be; Nay, lat be that! sche knew wel that this yle May never man forth brynge lyk to the, And hir office needes do mot she: God bad hir so, I truste as for the beste; O maister, maister, God thi soule reste!

JOHN LYDGATE

1370?-1450?

_14._ _Vox ultima Crucis_

Tarye no lenger; toward thyn heritage Hast on thy weye, and be of ryght good chere. Go eche day onward on thy pylgrymage; Thynke howe short tyme thou hast abyden here. Thy place is bygged above the sterres clere, Noon erthly palys wrought in so statly wyse. Come on, my frend, my brother most entere! For the I offered my blood in sacryfice.

_14._ bygged] built. palys] palace.

KING JAMES I OF SCOTLAND

1394-1437

_15._ _Spring Song of the Birds_

Worschippe ye that loveris bene this May, For of your blisse the Kalendis are begonne, And sing with us, Away, Winter, away! Cum, Somer, cum, the suete sesoùn and sonne! Awake for schame! that have your hevynnis wonne, And amorously lift up your hedis all, Thank Lufe that list you to his merci call!

_15._ suete] sweet. Lufe] Love.

ROBERT HENRYSON

1425-1500

_16._ _Robin and Makyne_

Robin sat on gude green hill, Kepand a flock of fe: Mirry Makyne said him till ‘Robin, thou rew on me: I haif thee luvit, loud and still, Thir yeiris twa or thre; My dule in dern bot gif thou dill, Doutless but dreid I de.’

Robin answerit ‘By the Rude Na thing of luve I knaw, But keipis my scheip undir yon wud: Lo, quhair they raik on raw. Quhat has marrit thee in thy mude, Makyne, to me thou shaw; Or quhat is luve, or to be lude? Fain wad I leir that law.’

‘At luvis lair gif thou will leir Tak thair ane A B C; Be heynd, courtass, and fair of feir, Wyse, hardy, and free: So that no danger do thee deir Quhat dule in dern thou dre; Preiss thee with pain at all poweir Be patient and previe.’

kepand] keeping. fe] sheep, cattle. him till] to him. dule in dern] sorrow in secret. dill] soothe. but dreid] without dread, i. e. there is no fear or doubt. raik on raw] range in row. lude] loved. leir] learn. lair] lore. heynd] gentle. feir] demeanour. deir] daunt. dre] endure. preiss] endeavour.

Robin answerit hir agane, ‘I wat nocht quhat is lufe; But I haif mervel in certaine Quhat makis thee this wanrufe: The weddir is fair, and I am fain; My scheip gois haill aboif; And we wald pley us in this plane, They wald us baith reproif.’

‘Robin, tak tent unto my tale, And wirk all as I reid, And thou sall haif my heart all haill, Eik and my maiden-heid: Sen God sendis bute for baill, And for murnyng remeid, In dern with thee bot gif I daill Dowtles I am bot deid.’

‘Makyne, to-morn this ilka tyde And ye will meit me heir, Peraventure my scheip may gang besyde, Quhyle we haif liggit full neir; But mawgre haif I, and I byde, Fra they begin to steir; Quhat lyis on heart I will nocht hyd; Makyn, then mak gude cheir.’

‘Robin, thou reivis me roiff and rest; I luve bot thee allane.’ ‘Makyne, adieu! the sone gois west, The day is neir-hand gane.’

wanrufe] unrest. haill] healthy, whole. aboif] above, up yonder. and] if. tak tent] give heed. reid] advise. bute for baill] remedy for hurt. bot gif] but if, unless. daill] deal. mawgre haif I] I am uneasy. reivis] robbest. roiff] quiet.

‘Robin, in dule I am so drest That luve will be my bane.’ ‘Ga luve, Makyne, quhair-evir thow list, For lemman I luve nane.’

‘Robin, I stand in sic a styll, I sicht and that full sair.’ ‘Makyne, I haif been here this quhyle; At hame God gif I wair.’ ‘My huny, Robin, talk ane quhyll, Gif thow will do na mair.’ ‘Makyn, sum uthir man begyle, For hamewart I will fair.’

Robin on his wayis went As light as leif of tre; Makyne murnit in hir intent, And trowd him nevir to se. Robin brayd attour the bent: Then Makyne cryit on hie, ‘Now may thow sing, for I am schent! Quhat alis lufe at me?’

Makyne went hame withowttin fail, Full wery eftir cowth weip; Then Robin in a ful fair daill Assemblit all his scheip. Be that sum part of Makynis aill Out-throw his hairt cowd creip; He fallowit hir fast thair till assaill, And till her tuke gude keip.

drest] beset. lemman] mistress. sicht] sigh. in hir intent] in her inward thought. brayd] strode. bent] coarse grass. schent] destroyed. alis] ails. be that] by the time that. till] to. tuke keip] paid attention.

‘Abyd, abyd, thow fair Makyne, A word for ony thing; For all my luve, it sall be thyne, Withowttin departing. All haill thy hairt for till haif myne Is all my cuvating; My scheip to-morn, quhyle houris nyne, Will neid of no keping.’

‘Robin, thow hes hard soung and say, In gestis and storeis auld, The man that will nocht quhen he may Sall haif nocht quhen he wald. I pray to Jesu every day, Mot eik thair cairis cauld That first preissis with thee to play Be firth, forrest, or fauld.’

‘Makyne, the nicht is soft and dry, The weddir is warme and fair, And the grene woid rycht neir us by To walk attour all quhair: Thair ma na janglour us espy, That is to lufe contrair; Thairin, Makyne, baith ye and I, Unsene we ma repair.’

‘Robin, that warld is all away, And quyt brocht till ane end: And nevir agane thereto, perfay, Sall it be as thow wend;

hard] heard. gestis] romances. mot eik] may add to. be] by. janglour] talebearer. wend] weened.

For of my pane thow maid it play; And all in vane I spend: As thow hes done, sa sall I say, “Murne on, I think to mend.”’

‘Makyne, the howp of all my heill, My hairt on thee is sett; And evirmair to thee be leill Quhill I may leif but lett; Never to faill as utheris feill, Quhat grace that evir I gett.’ ‘Robin, with thee I will nocht deill; Adieu! for thus we mett.’

Makyne went hame blyth anneuche Attour the holttis hair; Robin murnit, and Makyne leuche; Scho sang, he sichit sair: And so left him baith wo and wreuch, In dolour and in cair, Kepand his hird under a huche Amangis the holttis hair.

_16._ howp] hope. but lett] without hindrance. anneuche] enough. holttis hair] grey woodlands. leuche] laughed. wreuch] peevish. huche] heuch, cliff.

_17._ _The Bludy Serk_

This hinder yeir I hard be tald Thair was a worthy King; Dukis, Erlis, and Barronis bald, He had at his bidding.

_17._ hinder yeir] last year.

The Lord was ancean and ald, And sexty yeiris cowth ring; He had a dochter fair to fald, A lusty Lady ying.

Off all fairheid scho bur the flour, And eik hir faderis air; Off lusty laitis and he honour, Meik bot and debonair: Scho wynnit in a bigly bour, On fold wes nane so fair, Princis luvit hir paramour In cuntreis our allquhair.

Thair dwelt a lyt besyde the King A foull Gyand of ane; Stollin he has the Lady ying, Away with hir is gane, And kest her in his dungering Quhair licht scho micht se nane; Hungir and cauld and grit thristing Scho fand into hir waine.

He wes the laithliest on to luk That on the grund mycht gang: His nailis wes lyk ane hellis cruk, Thairwith fyve quarteris lang;

ring] reign. fald] enfold. ying] young. fairheid] beauty. air] heir. laitis] manners. bot and] and also. scho wynnit] she dwelt. bigly] well-built. fold] earth. paramour] lovingly. our allquhair] all the world over. a lyt besyde] a little, (i. e. close) beside. of ane] as any. kest] cast. dungering] dungeon. into hir waine] in her lodging. hellis cruk] hell-claw.

Thair wes nane that he ourtuk, In rycht or yit in wrang, Bot all in schondir he thame schuk, The Gyand wes so strang.

He held the Lady day and nycht Within his deip dungeoun, He wald nocht gif of hir a sicht For gold nor yit ransoun-- Bot gif the King mycht get a knycht, To fecht with his persoun, To fecht with him beth day and nycht, Quhill ane wer dungin doun.

The King gart seik baith fer and neir, Beth be se and land, Off ony knycht gif he mycht heir Wald fecht with that Gyand: A worthy Prince, that had no peir, Hes tane the deid on hand For the luve of the Lady cleir, And held full trew cunnand.

That Prince come prowdly to the toun Of that Gyand to heir, And fawcht with him, his awin persoun, And tuke him presoneir, And kest him in his awin dungeoun Allane withouten feir, With hungir, cauld, and confusioun, As full weill worthy weir.

quhill] until. dungin doun] beaten down. his awin persoun] himself. withouten feir] without companion.

Syne brak the bour, had hame the bricht Unto her fadir fre. Sa evill wondit wes the Knycht That he behuvit to de; Unlusum was his likame dicht, His sark was all bludy; In all the world was thair a wicht So peteouss for to se?

The Lady murnyt and maid grit mane, With all her mekill mycht-- 'I luvit nevir lufe bot ane, That dulfully now is dicht; God sen my lyfe were fra me tane Or I had seen yone sicht, Or ellis in begging evir to gane Furth with yone curtass knycht.'

He said 'Fair lady, now mone I De, trestly ye me trow; Take ye my serk that is bludy, And hing it forrow yow; First think on it, and syne on me, Quhen men cumis yow to wow.' The Lady said 'Be Mary fre, Thairto I mak a vow.'

Quhen that scho lukit to the sark Scho thocht on the persoun, And prayit for him with all hir hart That lowsit hir of bandoun,

the bricht] the fair one. likame] body. lowsit hir of. bandoun] loosed her from thraldom.

Quhair scho was wont to sit full merk Into that deip dungeoun; And evir quhill scho wes in quert, That was hir a lessoun.

Sa weill the Lady luvit the Knycht That no man wald scho tak: Sa suld we do our God of micht That did all for us mak; Quhilk fullily to deid was dicht, For sinfull manis sak, Sa suld we do beth day and nycht, With prayaris to him mak.

This King is lyk the Trinitie, Baith in hevin and heir; The manis saule to the Lady, The Gyand to Lucefeir, The Knycht to Chryst, that deit on tre And coft our synnis deir; The pit to Hele with panis fell, The Syn to the woweir.

The Lady was wowd, but scho said nay With men that wald hir wed; Sa suld we wryth all sin away That in our breist is bred. I pray to Jesu Chryst verray, For ws his blud that bled, To be our help on domisday Quhair lawis ar straitly led.

quert] prison. coft] bought. straitly led] strictly carried out.

The saule is Godis dochtir deir, And eik his handewerk, That was betrayit with Lucefeir, Quha sittis in hell full merk: Borrowit with Chrystis angell cleir, Hend men, will ye nocht herk? And for his lufe that bocht us deir Think on the BLUDY SERK!

_17._ hend] gentle.

WILLIAM DUNBAR

1465-1520?

_18._ _To a Lady_

Sweet rois of vertew and of gentilness, Delytsum lily of everie lustynes, Richest in bontie and in bewtie clear, And everie vertew that is wenit dear, Except onlie that ye are mercyless.

Into your garth this day I did persew; There saw I flowris that fresche were of hew; Baith quhyte and reid most lusty were to seyne, And halesome herbis upon stalkis greene; Yet leaf nor flowr find could I nane of rew.

I doubt that Merche, with his cauld blastis keyne, Has slain this gentil herb, that I of mene; Quhois piteous death dois to my heart sic paine That I would make to plant his root againe,-- So confortand his levis unto me bene.

_18._ rois] rose. wenit] weened, esteemed. garth] garden-close. to seyne] to see. that I of mene] that I complain of, mourn for.

_19._ _In Honour of the City of London_

London, thou art of townes _A per se_. Soveraign of cities, seemliest in sight, Of high renoun, riches and royaltie; Of lordis, barons, and many a goodly knyght; Of most delectable lusty ladies bright; Of famous prelatis, in habitis clericall; Of merchauntis full of substaunce and of myght: London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Gladdith anon, thou lusty Troynovaunt, Citie that some tyme cleped was New Troy; In all the erth, imperiall as thou stant, Pryncesse of townes, of pleasure and of joy, A richer restith under no Christen roy; For manly power, with craftis naturall, Fourmeth none fairer sith the flode of Noy: London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Gemme of all joy, jasper of jocunditie, Most myghty carbuncle of vertue and valour; Strong Troy in vigour and in strenuytie; Of royall cities rose and geraflour; Empress of townes, exalt in honour; In beawtie beryng the crone imperiall; Swete paradise precelling in pleasure; London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Above all ryvers thy Ryver hath renowne, Whose beryall stremys, pleasaunt and preclare, Under thy lusty wallys renneth down, Where many a swan doth swymme with wyngis fair;

gladdith] rejoice. Troynovaunt] Troja nova or Trinovantum. fourmeth] appeareth. geraflour] gillyflower.

Where many a barge doth saile and row with are; Where many a ship doth rest with top-royall. O, towne of townes! patrone and not compare, London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Upon thy lusty Brigge of pylers white Been merchauntis full royall to behold; Upon thy stretis goeth many a semely knyght In velvet gownes and in cheynes of gold. By Julyus Cesar thy Tour founded of old May be the hous of Mars victoryall, Whose artillary with tonge may not be told: London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Strong be thy wallis that about thee standis; Wise be the people that within thee dwellis; Fresh is thy ryver with his lusty strandis; Blith be thy chirches, wele sownyng be thy bellis; Rich be thy merchauntis in substaunce that excellis; Fair be their wives, right lovesom, white and small; Clere be thy virgyns, lusty under kellis: London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

Thy famous Maire, by pryncely governaunce, With sword of justice thee ruleth prudently. No Lord of Parys, Venyce, or Floraunce In dignitye or honour goeth to hym nigh. He is exampler, loode-ster, and guye; Principall patrone and rose orygynalle, Above all Maires as maister most worthy: London, thou art the flour of Cities all.

are] oar. small] slender. kellis] hoods, head-dresses. guye] guide.

_20._ _On the Nativity of Christ_

Rorate coeli desuper! Hevins, distil your balmy schouris! For now is risen the bricht day-ster, Fro the rose Mary, flour of flouris: The cleir Sone, quhom no cloud devouris, Surmounting Phebus in the Est, Is cumin of his hevinly touris: _Et nobis Puer natus est_.

Archangellis, angellis, and dompnationis, Tronis, potestatis, and marteiris seir, And all ye hevinly operationis, Ster, planeit, firmament, and spheir, Fire, erd, air, and water cleir, To Him gife loving, most and lest, That come in to so meik maneir; _Et nobis Puer natus est_.

Synnaris be glad, and penance do, And thank your Maker hairtfully; For he that ye micht nocht come to To you is cumin full humbly Your soulis with his blood to buy And loose you of the fiendis arrest-- And only of his own mercy; _Pro nobis Puer natus est_.

All clergy do to him inclyne, And bow unto that bairn benyng, And do your observance divyne To him that is of kingis King:

schouris] showers. cumin] come, entered. seir] various. erd] earth. lest] least. synnaris] sinners. benyng] benign.

Encense his altar, read and sing In holy kirk, with mind degest, Him honouring attour all thing _Qui nobis Puer natus est_.

Celestial foulis in the air, Sing with your nottis upon hicht, In firthis and in forrestis fair Be myrthful now at all your mycht; For passit is your dully nicht, Aurora has the cloudis perst, The Sone is risen with glaidsum licht, _Et nobis Puer natus est_.

Now spring up flouris fra the rute, Revert you upward naturaly, In honour of the blissit frute That raiss up fro the rose Mary; Lay out your levis lustily, Fro deid take life now at the lest In wirschip of that Prince worthy _Qui nobis Puer natus est_.

Sing, hevin imperial, most of hicht! Regions of air mak armony! All fish in flud and fowl of flicht Be mirthful and mak melody! All Gloria in excelsis cry! Heaven, erd, se, man, bird, and best,-- He that is crownit abone the sky _Pro nobis Puer natus est_!

attour] over, above. perst] pierced. raiss] rose. best] beast.

_21._ _Lament for the Makers_

I that in heill was and gladnèss Am trublit now with great sickness And feblit with infirmitie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Our plesance here is all vain glory, This fals world is but transitory, The flesh is bruckle, the Feynd is slee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

The state of man does change and vary, Now sound, now sick, now blyth, now sary, Now dansand mirry, now like to die:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

No state in Erd here standis sicker; As with the wynd wavis the wicker So wannis this world’s vanitie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Unto the Death gois all Estatis, Princis, Prelatis, and Potestatis, Baith rich and poor of all degree:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He takis the knichtis in to the field Enarmit under helm and scheild; Victor he is at all mellie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

heill] health. bruckle] brittle, feeble. slee] sly. dansand] dancing. sicker] sure. wicker] willow. wannis] wanes. mellie] mellay.

That strong unmerciful tyrand Takis, on the motheris breast sowkand, The babe full of benignitie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He takis the campion in the stour, The captain closit in the tour, The lady in bour full of bewtie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He spairis no lord for his piscence, Na clerk for his intelligence; His awful straik may no man flee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Art-magicianis and astrologgis, Rethoris, logicianis, and theologgis, Them helpis no conclusionis slee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

In medecine the most practicianis, Leechis, surrigianis, and physicianis, Themself from Death may not supplee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

I see that makaris amang the lave Playis here their padyanis, syne gois to grave; Sparit is nocht their facultie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He has done petuously devour The noble Chaucer, of makaris flour, The Monk of Bury, and Gower, all three:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me._

sowkand] sucking. campion] champion. stour] fight. piscence] puissance. straik] stroke. supplee] save. makaris] poets. the lave] the leave, the rest. padyanis] pageants.

The good Sir Hew of Eglintoun, Ettrick, Heriot, and Wintoun, He has tane out of this cuntrie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

That scorpion fell has done infeck Maister John Clerk, and James Afflek, Fra ballat-making and tragedie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Holland and Barbour he has berevit; Alas! that he not with us levit Sir Mungo Lockart of the Lee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Clerk of Tranent eke he has tane, That made the anteris of Gawaine; Sir Gilbert Hay endit has he:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He has Blind Harry and Sandy Traill Slain with his schour of mortal hail, Quhilk Patrick Johnstoun might nought flee:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He has reft Merseir his endite, That did in luve so lively write, So short, so quick, of sentence hie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

He has tane Rowll of Aberdene, And gentill Rowll of Corstorphine; Two better fallowis did no man see:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

anteris] adventures. schour] shower. endite] inditing. fallowis] fellows.

In Dunfermline he has tane Broun With Maister Robert Henrysoun; Sir John the Ross enbrast has he:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

And he has now tane, last of a, Good gentil Stobo and Quintin Shaw, Of quhom all wichtis hes pitie:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Good Maister Walter Kennedy In point of Death lies verily; Great ruth it were that so suld be:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Sen he has all my brether tane, He will naught let me live alane; Of force I man his next prey be:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

Since for the Death remeid is none, Best is that we for Death dispone, After our death that live may we:-- _Timor Mortis conturbat me_.

_21._ wichtis] wights, persons. man] must. dispone] make disposition.

ANONYMOUS

15th Cent.

_22._ _May in the Green-Wood_

In somer when the shawes be sheyne, And leves be large and long, Hit is full merry in feyre foreste To here the foulys song.

_22._ sheyne] bright.

To se the dere draw to the dale And leve the hilles hee, And shadow him in the leves grene Under the green-wode tree.

Hit befell on Whitsontide Early in a May mornyng, The Sonne up faire can shyne, And the briddis mery can syng.

‘This is a mery mornyng,’ said Litulle Johne, ‘Be Hym that dyed on tre; A more mery man than I am one Lyves not in Christiantè.

‘Pluk up thi hert, my dere mayster,’ Litulle Johne can say, ‘And thynk hit is a fulle fayre tyme In a mornynge of May.’

_23._ _Carol_

15th Cent.

I sing of a maiden That is makeles; King of all kings To her son she ches.

He came al so still There his mother was, As dew in April That falleth on the grass.

_23._ makeles] matchless. ches] chose.

He came al so still To his mother’s bour, As dew in April That falleth on the flour.

He came al so still There his mother lay, As dew in April That falleth on the spray.

Mother and maiden Was never none but she; Well may such a lady Goddes mother be.

_24._ _Quia Amore Langueo_

15th Cent. (?)

In a valley of this restles mind I sought in mountain and in mead, Trusting a true love for to find. Upon an hill then took I heed; A voice I heard (and near I yede) In great dolour complaining tho: See, dear soul, how my sides bleed _Quia amore langueo_.

Upon this hill I found a tree, Under a tree a man sitting; From head to foot wounded was he; His hearte blood I saw bleeding: A seemly man to be a king, A gracious face to look unto. I askèd why he had paining; [He said,] _Quia amore langueo_.

_24._ yede] went.

I am true love that false was never; My sister, man’s soul, I loved her thus. Because we would in no wise dissever I left my kingdom glorious. I purveyed her a palace full precious; She fled, I followed, I loved her so That I suffered this pain piteous _Quia amore langueo_.

My fair love and my spouse bright! I saved her from beating, and she hath me bet; I clothed her in grace and heavenly light; This bloody shirt she hath on me set; For longing of love yet would I not let; Sweete strokes are these: lo! I have loved her ever as I her het _Quia amore langueo_.

I crowned her with bliss and she me with thorn; I led her to chamber and she me to die; I brought her to worship and she me to scorn; I did her reverence and she me villany. To love that loveth is no maistry; Her hate made never my love her foe: Ask me then no question why-- _Quia amore langueo_.

Look unto mine handes, man! These gloves were given me when I her sought; They be not white, but red and wan; Embroidered with blood my spouse them brought. They will not off; I loose hem nought:

het] promised.

I woo her with hem wherever she go. These hands for her so friendly fought _Quia amore langueo_.

Marvel not, man, though I sit still. See, love hath shod me wonder strait: Buckled my feet, as was her will, With sharpe nails (well thou may’st wait!) In my love was never desait; All my membres I have opened her to; My body I made her herte’s bait _Quia amore langueo_.

In my side I have made her nest; Look in, how weet a wound is here! This is her chamber, here shall she rest, That she and I may sleep in fere. Here may she wash, if any filth were; Here is seat for all her woe; Come when she will, she shall have cheer _Quia amore langueo_.

I will abide till she be ready, I will her sue if she say nay; If she be retchless I will be greedy, If she be dangerous I will her pray; If she weep, then bide I ne may: Mine arms ben spread to clip her me to. Cry once, I come: now, soul, assay _Quia amore langueo_.

Fair love, let us go play: Apples ben ripe in my gardayne.

bait] resting-place. weet] wet. in fere] together.

I shall thee clothe in a new array, Thy meat shall be milk, honey and wine. Fair love, let us go dine: Thy sustenance is in my crippe, lo! Tarry thou not, my fair spouse mine, _Quia amore langueo_.

If thou be foul, I shall thee make clean; If thou be sick, I shall thee heal; If thou mourn ought, I shall thee mene; Why wilt thou not, fair love, with me deal? Foundest thou ever love so leal? What wilt thou, soul, that I shall do? I may not unkindly thee appeal _Quia amore langueo_.

What shall I do now with my spouse But abide her of my gentleness, Till that she look out of her house Of fleshly affection? love mine she is; Her bed is made, her bolster is bliss, Her chamber is chosen; is there none mo. Look out on me at the window of kindeness _Quia amore langueo_.

My love is in her chamber: hold your peace! Make ye no noise, but let her sleep. My babe I would not were in disease, I may not hear my dear child weep. With my pap I shall her keep; Ne marvel ye not though I tend her to: This wound in my side had ne’er be so deep But _Quia amore langueo_.

crippe] scrip. mene] care for.

Long thou for love never so high, My love is more than thine may be. Thou weepest, thou gladdest, I sit thee by: Yet wouldst thou once, love, look unto me! Should I always feede thee With children meat? Nay, love, not so! I will prove thy love with adversitè _Quia amore langueo_.

Wax not weary, mine own wife! What mede is aye to live in comfort? In tribulation I reign more rife Ofter times than in disport. In weal and in woe I am aye to support: Mine own wife, go not me fro! Thy mede is marked, when thou art mort: _Quia amore langueo_.

_25._ _The Nut-Brown Maid_

15th Cent.

_He._ _Be it right or wrong, these men among_ _On women do complain;_ _Affirming this, how that it is_ _A labour spent in vain_ _To love them wele; for never a dele_ _They love a man again:_ _For let a man do what he can_ _Their favour to attain,_ _Yet if a new to them pursue,_ _Their first true lover than_ _Laboureth for naught; for from her thought_ _He is a banished man._

_25._ never a dele] never a bit. than] then.

She. _I say not nay, but that all day_ _It is both written and said_ _That woman's faith is, as who saith,_ _All utterly decayd:_ _But nevertheless, right good witnèss_ _In this case might be laid_ _That they love true and continue:_ _Record the Nut-brown Maid,_ _Which, when her love came her to prove,_ _To her to make his moan,_ _Would not depart; for in her heart_ _She loved but him alone._

_He._ _Then between us let us discuss_ _What was all the manere_ _Between them two: we will also_ _Tell all the pain in fere_ _That she was in. Now I begin,_ _So that ye me answere:_ _Wherefore all ye that present be,_ _I pray you, give an ear._ _I am the Knight. I come by night,_ _As secret as I can,_ _Saying_, Alas! thus standeth the case, I am a banished man.

She. _And I your will for to fulfil_ _In this will not refuse;_ _Trusting to show, in wordes few,_ _That men have an ill use--_ _To their own shame--women to blame,_ _And causeless them accuse._

in fere] in company together.

Therefore to you I answer now, _All women to excuse--_ Mine own heart dear, with you what cheer? I pray you, tell anone; For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ It standeth so: a deed is do Whereof great harm shall grow: My destiny is for to die A shameful death, I trow; Or else to flee. The t' one must be. None other way I know But to withdraw as an outlàw, And take me to my bow. Wherefore adieu, mine own heart true! None other rede I can: For I must to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. O Lord, what is this worldis bliss, That changeth as the moon! My summer's day in lusty May Is darked before the noon. I hear you say, farewell: Nay, nay, We

dèpart not so soon. Why say ye so? whither will ye go? Alas! what have ye done? All my welfàre to sorrow and care Should change, if ye were gone: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

rede I can] counsel I know.

_He._ I can believe it shall you grieve, And somewhat you distrain; But afterward, your paines hard Within a day or twain Shall soon aslake; and ye shall take Comfort to you again. Why should ye ought? for, to make thought, Your labour were in vain. And thus I do; and pray you to, As hartely as I can: For I must to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Now, sith that ye have showed to me The secret of your mind, I shall be plain to you again, Like as ye shall me find. Sith it is so that ye will go, I will not live behind. Shall never be said the Nut-brown Maid Was to her love unkind. Make you readý, for so am I, Although it were anone: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Yet I you rede to take good heed What men will think and say: Of young, of old, it shall be told That ye be gone away Your wanton will for to fulfil, In green-wood you to play; And that ye might for your delight No longer make delay Rather than ye should thus for me Be called an ill womàn Yet would I to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Though it be sung of old and young That I should be to blame, Theirs be the charge that speak so large In hurting of my name: For I will prove that faithful love It is devoid of shame; In your distress and heaviness To part with you the same: And sure all tho that do not so True lovers are they none: For in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ I counsel you, Remember how It is no maiden’s law Nothing to doubt, but to run out To wood with an outlàw. For ye must there in your hand bear A bow readý to draw; And as a thief thus must you live Ever in dread and awe; Whereby to you great harm might grow: Yet had I liever than That I had to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

part with] share with. tho] those.

She. I think not nay but as ye say; It is no maiden’s lore; But love may make me for your sake, As I have said before, To come on foot, to hunt and shoot, To get us meat and store; For so that I your company May have, I ask no more. From which to part it maketh my heart As cold as any stone; For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ For an outlàw this is the law, That men him take and bind: Without pitie, hangèd to be, And waver with the wind. If I had need (as God forbede!) What socours could ye find? Forsooth I trow, you and your bow For fear would draw behind. And no mervail; for little avail Were in your counsel than: Wherefore I’ll to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Right well know ye that women be But feeble for to fight; No womanhede it is, indeed, To be bold as a knight: Yet in such fear if that ye were With enemies day and night, I would withstand, with bow in hand, To grieve them as I might, And you to save; as women have From death men many one: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Yet take good hede; for ever I drede That ye could not sustain The thorny ways, the deep vallèys, The snow, the frost, the rain, The cold, the heat; for dry or wete, We must lodge on the plain; And, us above, no other roof But a brake bush or twain: Which soon should grieve you, I believe; And ye would gladly than That I had to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Sith I have here been partynere With you of joy and bliss, I must alsò part of your woe Endure, as reason is: Yet I am sure of one pleasùre, And shortly it is this-- That where ye be, me seemeth, pardé, I could not fare amiss. Without more speech I you beseech That we were shortly gone; For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ If ye go thyder, ye must consider, When ye have lust to dine, There shall no meat be for to gete, Nether bere, ale, ne wine, Ne shetès clean, to lie between, Made of thread and twine; None other house, but leaves and boughs, To cover your head and mine. Lo, mine heart sweet, this ill diète Should make you pale and wan: Wherefore I'll to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Among the wild deer such an archère, As men say that ye be, Ne may not fail of good vitayle Where is so great plentè: And water clear of the rivere Shall be full sweet to me; With which in hele I shall right wele Endure, as ye shall see; And, or we go, a bed or two I can provide anone; For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Lo yet, before, ye must do more, If ye will go with me: As, cut your hair up by your ear, Your kirtle by the knee; With bow in hand for to withstand Your enemies, if need be:

hele] health.

And this same night, before daylight, To woodward will I flee. If that ye will all this fulfil, Do it shortly as ye can: Else will I to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. I shall as now do more for you Than 'longeth to womanhede; To short my hair, a bow to bear, To shoot in time of need. O my sweet mother! before all other For you I have most drede! But now, adieu! I must ensue Where fortune doth me lead. All this make ye: Now let us flee; The day cometh fast upon: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Nay, nay, not so; ye shall not go, And I shall tell you why-- Your appetite is to be light Of love, I well espy: For, right as ye have said to me, In likewise hardily Ye would answere whosoever it were, In way of companý: It is said of old, Soon hot, soon cold; And so is a womàn: Wherefore I to the wood will go, Alone, a banished man.

She. If ye take heed, it is no need Such words to say to me; For oft ye prayed, and long assayed, Or I loved you, pardè: And though that I of ancestry A baron's daughter be, Yet have you proved how I you loved, A squire of low degree; And ever shall, whatso befall To die therefore anone; For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ A baron's child to be beguiled, It were a cursèd deed! To be felàw with an outlaw-- Almighty God forbede! Yet better were the poor squyere Alone to forest yede Than ye shall say another day That by my cursèd rede Ye were betrayed. Wherefore, good maid, The best rede that I can, Is, that I to the green-wood go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Whatever befall, I never shall Of this thing be upbraid: But if ye go, and leave me so, Then have ye me betrayed. Remember you wele, how that ye dele; For if ye, as ye said,

yede] went.

Be so unkind to leave behind Your love, the Nut-brown Maid, Trust me trulý that I shall die Soon after ye be gone: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ If that ye went, ye should repent; For in the forest now I have purveyed me of a maid Whom I love more than you: Another more fair than ever ye were I dare it well avow; And of you both each should be wroth With other, as I trow: It were mine ease to live in peace; So will I, if I can: Wherefore I to the wood will go, Alone, a banished man.

She. Though in the wood I understood Ye had a paramour, All this may nought remove my thought, But that I will be your': And she shall find me soft and kind And courteis every hour; Glad to fulfil all that she will Command me, to my power: For had ye, lo, an hundred mo, Yet would I be that one: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Mine own dear love, I see the prove That ye be kind and true; Of maid, of wife, in all my life, The best that ever I knew. Be merry and glad; be no more sad; The case is changèd new; For it were ruth that for your truth Ye should have cause to rue. Be not dismayed, whatsoever I said To you when I began: I will not to the green-wood go; I am no banished man.

She. These tidings be more glad to me Than to be made a queen, If I were sure they should endure; But it is often seen When men will break promise they speak The wordis on the splene. Ye shape some wile me to beguile, And steal from me, I ween: Then were the case worse than it was, And I more wo-begone: For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

_He._ Ye shall not nede further to drede: I will not disparàge You (God defend), sith you descend Of so great a linàge. Now understand: to Westmoreland, Which is my heritage,

on the splene] that is, in haste.

I will you bring; and with a ring, By way of marriàge I will you take, and lady make, As shortly as I can: Thus have you won an Earles son, And not a banished man.

Here may ye see that women be _In love meek, kind, and stable;_ _Let never man reprove them than,_ _Or call them variable;_ _But rather pray God that we may_ _To them be comfortable;_ _Which sometime proveth such as He loveth,_ _If they be charitable._ _For sith men would that women should_ _Be meek to them each one;_ _Much more ought they to God obey,_ _And serve but Him alone._

_26._ _As ye came from the Holy Land_

16th Cent.

As ye came from the holy land Of Walsinghame, Met you not with my true love By the way as you came?

How should I know your true love, That have met many a one As I came from the holy land, That have come, that have gone?

She is neither white nor brown, But as the heavens fair; There is none hath her form divine In the earth or the air.

Such a one did I meet, good sir, Such an angelic face, Who like a nymph, like a queen, did appear In her gait, in her grace.

She hath left me here alone All alone, as unknown, Who sometime did me lead with herself, And me loved as her own.

What’s the cause that she leaves you alone And a new way doth take, That sometime did love you as her own, And her joy did you make?

I have loved her all my youth, But now am old, as you see: Love likes not the falling fruit, Nor the withered tree.

Know that Love is a careless child, And forgets promise past: He is blind, he is deaf when he list, And in faith never fast.

His desire is a dureless content, And a trustless joy; He is won with a world of despair, And is lost with a toy.

Of womenkind such indeed is the love, Or the word love abusèd, Under which many childish desires And conceits are excusèd.

But true love is a durable fire, In the mind ever burning, Never sick, never dead, never cold, From itself never turning.

_27._ _The Lover in Winter Plaineth for the Spring_

16th Cent.(?)

O western wind, when wilt thou blow That the small rain down can rain? Christ, that my love were in my arms And I in my bed again!

_28._ _Balow_

16th Cent.

Balow, my babe, lie still and sleep! It grieves me sore to see thee weep. Wouldst thou be quiet I'se be glad, Thy mourning makes my sorrow sad: Balow my boy, thy mother's joy, Thy father breeds me great annoy-- Balow, la-low!

When he began to court my love, And with his sugred words me move, His faynings false and flattering cheer To me that time did not appear: But now I see most cruellye He cares ne for my babe nor me-- Balow, la-low!

Lie still, my darling, sleep awhile, And when thou wak'st thou'le sweetly smile: But smile not as thy father did, To cozen maids: nay, God forbid! But yet I fear thou wilt go near Thy father's heart and face to bear-- Balow, la-low!

I cannot choose but ever will Be loving to thy father still; Where'er he go, where'er he ride, My love with him doth still abide; In weal or woe, where'er he go, My heart shall ne'er depart him fro-- Balow, la-low!

But do not, do not, pretty mine, To faynings false thy heart incline! Be loyal to thy lover true, And never change her for a new: If good or fair, of her have care For women's banning's wondrous sare-- Balow, la-low!

Bairn, by thy face I will beware; Like Sirens' words, I'll come not near; My babe and I together will live; He'll comfort me when cares do grieve. My babe and I right soft will lie, And ne'er respect man's crueltye-- Balow, la-low!

Farewell, farewell, the falsest youth That ever kist a woman's mouth! I wish all maids be warn'd by me Never to trust man's curtesye; For if we do but chance to bow, They'll use us then they care not how-- Balow, la-low!

_29._ _The Old Cloak_

16th Cent.(?)

This winter's weather it waxeth cold, And frost it freezeth on every hill, And Boreas blows his blast so bold That all our cattle are like to spill. Bell, my wife, she loves no strife; She said unto me quietlye, Rise up, and save cow Crumbock's life! Man, put thine old cloak about thee!

_He._ O Bell my wife, why dost thou flyte? Thou kens my cloak is very thin: It is so bare and over worn, A crickè thereon cannot renn. Then I'll no longer borrow nor lend; For once I'll new apparell'd be; To-morrow I'll to town and spend; For I'll have a new cloak about me.

She. Cow Crumbock is a very good cow: She has been always true to the pail; She has helped us to butter and cheese, I trow, And other things she will not fail.

_29._ flyte] scold.

I would be loth to see her pine. Good husband, counsel take of me: It is not for us to go so fine-- Man, take thine old cloak about thee!

_He._ My cloak it was a very good cloak, It hath been always true to the wear; But now it is not worth a groat: I have had it four and forty year'. Sometime it was of cloth in grain: 'Tis now but a sigh clout, as you may see: It will neither hold out wind nor

rain; And I’ll have a new cloak about me.

She. It is four and forty years ago Sine the one of us the other did ken; And we have had, betwixt us two, Of children either nine or ten: We have brought them up to women and men: In the fear of God I trow they be. And why wilt thou thyself misken? Man, take thine old cloak about thee!

_He._ O Bell my wife, why dost thou flyte? Now is now, and then was then: Seek now all the world throughout, Thou kens not clowns from gentlemen: They are clad in black, green, yellow and blue, So far above their own degree. Once in my life I’ll take a view; For I’ll have a new cloak about me.

cloth in grain] scarlet cloth. sigh clout] a rag for straining.

She. King Stephen was a worthy peer; His breeches cost him but a crown; He held them sixpence all too dear, Therefore he called the tailor ‘lown.’ He was a king and wore the crown, And thou’se but of a low degree: It’s pride that puts this country down: Man, take thy old cloak about thee!

_He._ Bell my wife, she loves not strife, Yet she will lead me, if she can; And to maintain an easy life I oft must yield, though I’m good-man. It’s not for a man with a woman to threap, Unless he first give o’er the plea: As we began, so will we keep, And I’ll take my old cloak about me.

_29._ threap] argue.

JOHN SKELTON

1460?-1529

_30._ _To Mistress Margery Wentworth_

With margerain gentle, The flower of goodlihead, Embroidered the mantle Is of your maidenhead. Plainly I cannot glose; Ye be, as I divine, The pretty primrose, The goodly columbine.

_30._ margerain] marjoram.

Benign, courteous, and meek, With wordes well devised; In you, who list to seek, Be virtues well comprised. With margerain gentle, The flower of goodlihead, Embroidered the mantle Is of your maidenhead.

_31._ _To Mistress Margaret Hussey_

Merry Margaret As midsummer flower, Gentle as falcon Or hawk of the tower: With solace and gladness, Much mirth and no madness, All good and no badness; So joyously, So maidenly, So womanly Her demeaning In every thing, Far, far passing That I can indite, Or suffice to write Of Merry Margaret As midsummer flower, Gentle as falcon Or hawk of the tower. As patient and still And as full of good will As fair Isaphill, Coliander, Sweet pomander, Good Cassander; Steadfast of thought, Well made, well wrought, Far may be sought, Ere that ye can find So courteous, so kind As merry Margaret, This midsummer flower, Gentle as falcon Or hawk of the tower.

_31._ Isaphill] Hypsipyle. coliander] coriander seed, an aromatic. pomander] a ball of perfume. Cassander] Cassandra.

STEPHEN HAWES

d. 1523

_32._ _The True Knight_

For knighthood is not in the feats of warre, As for to fight in quarrel right or wrong, But in a cause which truth can not defarre: He ought himself for to make sure and strong, Justice to keep mixt with mercý among: And no quarrell a knight ought to take But for a truth, or for the common’s sake.

_32._ defarre] undo.

_33._ _An Epitaph_

O mortal folk, you may behold and see How I lie here, sometime a mighty knight; The end of joy and all prosperitee Is death at last, thorough his course and might: After the day there cometh the dark night, For though the daye be never so long, At last the bells ringeth to evensong.

SIR THOMAS WYATT

1503-1542

_34._ _Forget not yet_

The Lover Beseecheth his Mistress not to Forget his Steadfast Faith and True Intent

Forget not yet the tried intent Of such a truth as I have meant; My great travail so gladly spent, Forget not yet!

Forget not yet when first began The weary life ye know, since whan The suit, the service, none tell can; Forget not yet!

Forget not yet the great assays, The cruel wrong, the scornful ways, The painful patience in delays, Forget not yet!

Forget not! O, forget not this!-- How long ago hath been, and is, The mind that never meant amiss-- Forget not yet!

Forget not then thine own approved, The which so long hath thee so loved, Whose steadfast faith yet never moved: Forget not this!

_35._ _The Appeal_

An Earnest Suit to his Unkind Mistress, not to Forsake him

And wilt thou leave me thus! Say nay, say nay, for shame! --To save thee from the blame Of all my grief and grame. And wilt thou leave me thus? Say nay! say nay!

And wilt thou leave me thus, That hath loved thee so long In wealth and woe among: And is thy heart so strong As for to leave me thus? Say nay! say nay!

And wilt thou leave me thus, That hath given thee my heart Never for to depart Neither for pain nor smart: And wilt thou leave me thus? Say nay! say nay!

_35._ grame] sorrow.

And wilt thou leave me thus, And have no more pitye Of him that loveth thee? Alas, thy cruelty! And wilt thou leave me thus? Say nay! say nay!

_36._ _A Revocation_

What should I say? --Since Faith is dead. And Truth away From you is fled? Should I be led With doubleness? Nay! nay! mistress.

I promised you, And you promised me, To be as true As I would be. But since I see Your double heart, Farewell my part!

Thought for to take 'Tis not my mind; But to forsake One so unkind; And as I find So will I trust. Farewell, unjust!

Can ye say nay But that you said That I alway Should be obeyed? And--thus betrayed Or that I wist! Farewell, unkist!

_37._ _Vixi Puellis Nuper Idoneus ..._

They flee from me that sometime did me seek, With naked foot stalking within my chamber: Once have I seen them gentle, tame, and meek, That now are wild, and do not once remember That sometime they have put themselves in danger To take bread at my hand; and now they range, Busily seeking in continual change.

Thanked be fortune, it hath been otherwise Twenty times better; but once especial-- In thin array: after a pleasant guise, When her loose gown did from her shoulders fall, And she me caught in her arms long and small, And therewithal so sweetly did me kiss, And softly said, '_Dear heart, how like you this?_'

It was no dream; for I lay broad awaking: But all is turn'd now, through my gentleness, Into a bitter fashion of forsaking; And I have leave to go of her goodness; And she also to use new-fangleness. But since that I unkindly so am servèd, '_How like you this?_'--what hath she now deservèd?

_38._ _To His Lute_

My lute, awake! perform the last Labour that thou and I shall waste, And end that I have now begun; For when this song is said and past, My lute, be still, for I have done.

As to be heard where ear is none, As lead to grave in marble stone, My song may pierce her heart as soon: Should we then sing, or sigh, or moan? No, no, my lute! for I have done.

The rocks do not so cruelly Repulse the waves continually, As she my suit and affectiòn; So that I am past remedy: Whereby my lute and I have done.

Proud of the spoil that thou hast got Of simple hearts thorough Love’s shot, By whom, unkind, thou hast them won; Think not he hath his bow forgot, Although my lute and I have done.

Vengeance shall fall on thy disdain, That makest but game of earnest pain: Trow not alone under the sun Unquit to cause thy lover’s plain, Although my lute and I have done.

May chance thee lie wither’d and old The winter nights that are so cold, Plaining in vain unto the moon: Thy wishes then dare not be told: Care then who list! for I have done.

And then may chance thee to repent The time that thou has lost and spent To cause thy lover’s sigh and swoon: Then shalt thou know beauty but lent, And wish and want as I have done.

Now cease, my lute! this is the last Labour that thou and I shall waste, And ended is that we begun: Now is this song both sung and past-- My lute, be still, for I have done.

HENRY HOWARD, EARL OF SURREY

1516-47

_39._ _Description of Spring_

Wherein each thing renews, save only the Lover

The soote season, that bud and bloom forth brings, With green hath clad the hill and eke the vale: The nightingale with feathers new she sings; The turtle to her make hath told her tale. Summer is come, for every spray now springs: The hart hath hung his old head on the pale; The buck in brake his winter coat he flings; The fishes flete with new repairèd scale.

_39._ make] mate.

The adder all her slough away she slings; The swift swallow pursueth the flies smale; The busy bee her honey now she mings; Winter is worn that was the flowers’ bale.

And thus I see among these pleasant things Each care decays, and yet my sorrow springs.

_39._ mings] mingles, mixes.

_40._ _Complaint of the Absence of Her Lover being upon the Sea_

O happy dames! that may embrace The fruit of your delight, Help to bewail the woful case And eke the heavy plight Of me, that wonted to rejoice The fortune of my pleasant choice: Good ladies, help to fill my mourning voice.

In ship, freight with rememberance Of thoughts and pleasures past, He sails that hath in governance My life while it will last: With scalding sighs, for lack of gale,

Furthering his hope, that is his sail, Toward me, the swete port of his avail,

Alas! how oft in dreams I see Those eyes that were my food; Which sometime so delighted me, That yet they do me good: Wherewith I wake with his return Whose absent flame did make me burn: But when I find the lack, Lord! how I mourn!

When other lovers in arms across Rejoice their chief delight, Drownèd in tears, to mourn my loss I stand the bitter night In my window where I may see Before the winds how the clouds flee: Lo! what a mariner love hath made me!

And in green waves when the salt flood Doth rise by rage of wind, A thousand fancies in that mood Assail my restless mind. Alas! now drencheth my sweet foe, That with the spoil of my heart did go, And left me; but alas! why did he so?

And when the seas wax calm again To chase fro me annoy, My doubtful hope doth cause me plain; So dread cuts off my joy. Thus is my wealth mingled with woe And of each thought a doubt doth grow; --Now he comes! Will he come? Alas! no, no.

_40._ drencheth] i.e. is drenched or drowned.

_41._ _The Means to attain Happy Life_

Martial, the things that do attain The happy life be these, I find:-- The richesse left, not got with pain; The fruitful ground, the quiet mind; The equal friend; no grudge, no strife; No charge of rule, nor governance; Without disease, the healthful life; The household of continuance;

The mean diet, no delicate fare; True wisdom join’d with simpleness; The night dischargèd of all care, Where wine the wit may not oppress.

The faithful wife, without debate; Such sleeps as may beguile the night: Contented with thine own estate Ne wish for death, ne fear his might.

NICHOLAS GRIMALD

1519-62

_42._ _A True Love_

What sweet relief the showers to thirsty plants we see, What dear delight the blooms to bees, my true love is to me! As fresh and lusty Ver foul Winter doth exceed-- As morning bright, with scarlet sky, doth pass the evening’s weed-- As mellow pears above the crabs esteemèd be-- So doth my love surmount them all, whom yet I hap to see! The oak shall olives bear, the lamb the lion fray, The owl shall match the nightingale in tuning of her lay,

_42._ fray] affright.

Or I my love let slip out of mine entire heart, So deep reposèd in my breast is she for her desart! For many blessèd gifts, O happy, happy land! Where Mars and Pallas strive to make their glory most to stand! Yet, land, more is thy bliss that, in this cruel age, A Venus’ imp thou hast brought forth, so steadfast and so sage. Among the Muses Nine a tenth if Jove would make, And to the Graces Three a fourth, her would

Apollo take. Let some for honour hunt, and hoard the massy gold: With her so I may live and die, my weal cannot be told.

ALEXANDER SCOTT

1520?-158-

_43._ _A Bequest of His Heart_

Hence, heart, with her that must depart, And hald thee with thy soverane! For I had liever want ane heart. Nor have the heart that dois me pain. Therefore, go, with thy luve remain, And let me leif thus unmolest; And see that thou come not again, But bide with her thou luvis best.

Sen she that I have servit lang Is to depart so suddenly, Address thee now, for thou sall gang And bear thy lady company.

_43._ hald] keep. sen] since.

Fra she be gone, heartless am I, For quhy? thou art with her possest. Therefore, my heart, go hence in high, And bide with her thou luvis best.

Though this belappit body here Be bound to servitude and thrall, My faithful heart is free entier And mind to serve my lady at all. Would God that I were perigall Under that redolent rose to rest! Yet at the least, my heart, thou sall Abide with her thou luvis best.

Sen in your garth the lily quhyte May not remain amang the laif, Adieu the flower of whole delite! Adieu the succour that may me saif! Adieu the fragrant balme suaif, And lamp of ladies lustiest! My faithful heart she shall it haif To bide with her it luvis best.

Deploir, ye ladies cleir of hue, Her absence, sen she must depart! And, specially, ye luveris true That wounded bene with Luvis dart. For some of you sall want ane heart As well as I; therefore at last Do go with mine, with mind inwart, And bide with her thou luvis best!

belappit] downtrodden. perigall] made equal to, privileged. garth] garden-close. laif] rest. with mind inwart] with inner mind, i.e. in spirit.

_44._ _A Rondel of Love_

Lo, quhat it is to love Learn ye that list to prove, By me, I say, that no ways may The ground of grief remove, But still decay both nicht and day: Lo, quhat it is to love!

Love is ane fervent fire Kindlit without desire, Short pleasure, long displeasure, Repentance is the hire; Ane pure tressour without measour; Love is ane fervent fire.

To love and to be wise, To rage with good advice; Now thus, now than, so gois the game, Incertain is the dice; There is no man, I say, that can Both love and to be wise.

Flee always from the snare, Learn at me to beware; It is ane pain, and double trane Of endless woe and care; For to refrain that danger plain, Flee always from the snare.

ROBERT WEVER

c. 1550

_45._ _In Youth is Pleasure_

In a harbour grene aslepe whereas I lay, The byrdes sang swete in the middes of the day, I dreamèd fast of mirth and play: In youth is pleasure, in youth is pleasure.

Methought I walked still to and fro, And from her company I could not go-- But when I waked it was not so: In youth is pleasure, in youth is pleasure.

Therefore my hart is surely pyght Of her alone to have a sight Which is my joy and hartes delight: In youth is pleasure, in youth is pleasure.

RICHARD EDWARDES

1523-66

_46._ _Amantium Iræ_

In going to my naked bed as one that would have slept, I heard a wife sing to her child, that long before had wept; She sighèd sore and sang full sweet, to bring the babe to rest, That would not cease but crièd still, in sucking at her breast. She was full weary of her watch, and grievèd with her child, She rockèd it and rated it, till that on her it smiled. Then did she say, Now have I found this proverb true to prove, The falling out of faithful friends renewing is of love.

Then took I paper, pen, and ink, this proverb for to write, In register for to remain of such a worthy wight: As she proceeded thus in song unto her little brat, Much matter utter'd she of weight, in place whereas she sat: And provèd plain there was no beast, nor creature bearing life, Could well be known to live in love without discord and strife: Then kissèd she her little babe, and sware by God above, The falling out of faithful friends renewing is of love.

She said that neither king nor prince nor lord could live aright, Until their puissance they did prove, their manhood and their might. When manhood shall be matched so that fear can take no place, Then weary works make warriors each other to embrace, And left their force that failèd them, which did consume the rout, That might before have lived their time, their strength and nature out: Then did she sing as one that thought no man could her reprove, The falling out of faithful friends renewing is of love.

She said she saw no fish nor fowl, nor beast within her haunt, That met a stranger in their kind, but could give it a taunt: Since flesh might not endure, but rest must wrath succeed, And force the fight to fall to play in pasture where they feed, So noble nature can well end the work she hath begun, And bridle well that will not cease her tragedy in some: Thus in song she oft rehearsed, as did her well behove, The falling out of faithful friends renewing is of love.

I marvel much pardy (quoth she) for to behold the rout, To see man, woman, boy and beast, to toss the world about: Some kneel, some crouch, some beck, some check, and some can smoothly smile, And some embrace others in arm, and there think many a wile, Some stand aloof at cap and knee, some humble and some stout, Yet are they never friends in deed until they once fall out: Thus ended she her song and said, before she did remove, The falling out of faithful friends renewing is of love.

GEORGE GASCOIGNE

1525?-77

_47._ _A Lover’s Lullaby_

Sing lullaby, as women do, Wherewith they bring their babes to rest; And lullaby can I sing too, As womanly as can the best. With lullaby they still the child; And if I be not much beguiled, Full many a wanton babe have I, Which must be still’d with lullaby.

First lullaby my youthful years, It is now time to go to bed: For crookèd age and hoary hairs Have won the haven within my head. With lullaby, then, youth be still; With lullaby content thy will; Since courage quails and comes behind, Go sleep, and so beguile thy mind!

Next lullaby my gazing eyes, Which wonted were to glance apace; For every glass may now suffice To show the furrows in thy face. With lullaby then wink awhile; With lullaby your looks beguile; Let no fair face, nor beauty bright, Entice you eft with vain delight.

And lullaby my wanton will; Let reason’s rule now reign thy thought; Since all too late I find by skill How dear I have thy fancies bought; With lullaby now take thine ease, With lullaby thy doubts appease; For trust to this, if thou be still, My body shall obey thy will.

Thus lullaby my youth, mine eyes, My will, my ware, and all that was: I can no more delays devise; But welcome pain, let pleasure pass. With lullaby now take your leave; With lullaby your dreams deceive; And when you rise with waking eye, Remember then this lullaby.

ALEXANDER MONTGOMERIE

1540?-1610?

_48._ _The Night is Near Gone_

Hey! now the day dawis; The jolly cock crawis; Now shroudis the shawis Thro’ Nature anon. The thissel-cock cryis On lovers wha lyis: Now skaillis the skyis; The nicht is neir gone.

The fieldis ouerflowis With gowans that growis, Quhair lilies like low is As red as the rone.

_48._ shroudis] dress themselves. shawis] woods. skaillis] clears. gowans] daisies. low] flame. rone] rowan.

The turtle that true is, With notes that renewis, Her pairty pursuis: The nicht is neir gone.

Now hairtis with hindis Conform to their kindis, Hie tursis their tyndis On ground quhair they grone. Now hurchonis, with hairis, Aye passis in pairis; Quhilk duly declaris The nicht is neir gone.

The season excellis Through sweetness that smellis; Now Cupid compellis Our hairtis echone On Venus wha waikis, To muse on our maikis, Syne sing for their saikis-- 'The nicht is neir gone!'

All courageous knichtis Aganis the day dichtis The breist-plate that bright is To fight with their fone. The stonèd steed stampis Through courage, and crampis, Syne on the land lampis: The nicht is neir gone.

pairty] partner, mate. tursis] carry. tyndis] antlers. grone] groan, bell. hurchonis] hedgehogs, 'urchins.' maikis] mates. fone] foes. stonèd steed] stallion. crampis] prances. lampis] gallops.

The freikis on feildis That wight wapins weildis With shyning bright shieldis At Titan in trone; Stiff speiris in reistis Ouer corseris crestis Are broke on their breistis: The nicht is neir gone.

So hard are their hittis, Some sweyis, some sittis, And some perforce flittis On ground quhile they grone. Syne groomis that gay is On blonkis that brayis With swordis assayis:-- The nicht is neir gone.

_48._ freikis] men, warriors. wight wapins] stout weapons. at Titan] over against Titan (the sun), or read 'as.' flittis] are cast. blonkis] white palfreys.

WILLIAM STEVENSON

1530?-1575

_49._ _Jolly Good Ale and Old_

I cannot eat but little meat, My stomach is not good; But sure I think that I can drink With him that wears a hood. Though I go bare, take ye no care, I nothing am a-cold; I stuff my skin so full within Of jolly good ale and old. Back and side go bare, go bare; Both foot and hand go cold; But, belly, God send thee good ale enough, Whether it be new or old.

I love no roast but a nut-brown toast, And a crab laid in the fire; A little bread shall do me stead; Much bread I not desire. No frost nor snow, no wind, I trow, Can hurt me if I wold; I am so wrapp'd and thoroughly lapp'd Of jolly good ale and old. Back and side go bare, go bare, &c.

And Tib, my wife, that as her life Loveth well good ale to seek, Full oft drinks she till ye may see The tears run down her cheek: Then doth she trowl to me the bowl

Even as a maltworm should, And saith, ‘Sweetheart, I took my part Of this jolly good ale and old.’ Back and side go bare, go bare, &c.

Now let them drink till they nod and wink, Even as good fellows should do; They shall not miss to have the bliss Good ale doth bring men to; And all poor souls that have scour’d bowls Or have them lustily troll’d, God save the lives of them and their wives, Whether they be young or old. Back and side go bare, go bare; Both foot and hand go cold; But, belly, God send thee good ale enough, Whether it be new or old.

ANONYMOUS (SCOTTISH)

16th Cent.

_50._ _When Flora had O’erfret the Firth_

Quhen Flora had o’erfret the firth In May of every moneth queen; Quhen merle and mavis singis with mirth Sweet melling in the shawis sheen; Quhen all luvaris rejoicit bene And most desirous of their prey, I heard a lusty luvar mene --‘I luve, but I dare nocht assay!’

‘Strong are the pains I daily prove, But yet with patience I sustene, I am so fetterit with the luve Only of my lady sheen, Quhilk for her beauty micht be queen, Nature so craftily alway Has done depaint that sweet serene: --Quhom I luve I dare nocht assay.

‘She is so bricht of hyd and hue, I luve but her alone, I ween; Is none her luve that may eschew, That blinkis of that dulce amene; So comely cleir are her twa een That she mae luvaris dois affray Than ever of Greece did fair Helene: --Quhom I luve I dare nocht assay!’

o’erfret] adorned. shawis] woods. sheen] beautiful. mene] mourn. hyd] skin. blinkis] gets a glimpse. dulce amene] gentle and pleasant one. mae] more.

_51._ _Lusty May_

16th Cent.

O lusty May, with Flora queen! The balmy dropis from Phoebus sheen Preluciand beams before the day: By that Diana growis green Through gladness of this lusty May.

Then Esperus, that is so bricht, Til woful hairtis castis his light, With bankis that bloomis on every brae; And schouris are shed forth of their sicht Through gladness of this lusty May.

Birdis on bewis of every birth, Rejoicing notis makand their mirth Richt plesantly upon the spray, With flourishingis o’er field and firth Through gladness of this lusty May.

All luvaris that are in care To their ladies they do repair In fresh morningis before the day, And are in mirth ay mair and mair Through gladness of this lusty May.

_51._ sheen] bright. til] into. schouris] showers. bewis] boughs. birth] kind. 52. wiss] wish.

_52._ _My Heart is High Above_

16th Cent.

My heart is high above, my body is full of bliss, For I am set in luve as well as I would wiss I luve my lady pure and she luvis me again, I am her serviture, she is my soverane; She is my very heart, I am her howp and heill, She is my joy invart, I am her luvar leal; I am her bond and thrall, she is at my command; I am perpetual her man, both foot and hand; The thing that may her please my body sall fulfil; Quhatever her disease, it does my body ill. My bird, my bonny ane, my tender babe venust, My luve, my life alane, my liking and my lust! We interchange our hairtis in others armis soft, Spriteless we twa depairtis, usand our luvis oft. We mourn when licht day dawis, we plain the nicht is short, We curse the cock that crawis, that hinderis our disport. I glowffin up aghast, quhen I her miss on nicht, And in my oxter fast I find the bowster richt; Then languor on me lies like Morpheus the mair, Quhilk causes me uprise and to my sweet repair. And then is all the sorrow forth of remembrance That ever I had a-forrow in luvis observance. Thus never I do rest, so lusty a life I lead, Quhen that I list to test the well of womanheid. Luvaris in pain, I pray God send you sic remeid As I have nicht and day, you to defend from deid! Therefore be ever true unto your ladies free, And they will on you rue as mine has done on me.

heill] health. invart] inward. venust] delightful. glowffin] blink on awaking. oxter] armpit. a-forrow] aforetime.

NUMBERS

FROM

ELIZABETHAN MISCELLANIES & SONG-BOOKS

BY UNNAMED OR UNCERTAIN AUTHORS

_53._ _A Praise of His Lady_

Tottel’s Miscellany, 1557

Give place, you ladies, and begone! Boast not yourselves at all! For here at hand approacheth one Whose face will stain you all.

The virtue of her lively looks Excels the precious stone; I wish to have none other books To read or look upon.

In each of her two crystal eyes Smileth a naked boy; It would you all in heart suffice To see that lamp of joy.

I think Nature hath lost the mould Where she her shape did take; Or else I doubt if Nature could So fair a creature make.

She may be well compared Unto the Phœnix kind, Whose like was never seen or heard, That any man can find.

In life she is Diana chaste, In troth Penelopey; In word and eke in deed steadfast. --What will you more we say?

If all the world were sought so far, Who could find such a wight? Her beauty twinkleth like a star Within the frosty night.

Her rosial colour comes and goes With such a comely grace, More ruddier, too, than doth the rose, Within her lively face.

At Bacchus' feast none shall her meet, Ne at no wanton play, Nor gazing in an open street, Nor gadding as a stray.

The modest mirth that she doth use Is mix'd with shamefastness; All vice she doth wholly refuse, And hateth idleness.

O Lord! it is a world to see How virtue can repair, And deck in her such honesty, Whom Nature made so fair.

Truly she doth so far exceed Our women nowadays, As doth the jeliflower a weed; And more a thousand ways.

How might I do to get a graff Of this unspotted tree? --For all the rest are plain but chaff, Which seem good corn to be.

This gift alone I shall her give; When death doth what he can, Her honest fame shall ever live Within the mouth of man.

? by _John Heywood_

_54._ _To Her Sea-faring Lover_

Tottel's Miscellany, 1557

Shall I thus ever long, and be no whit the neare? And shall I still complain to thee, the which me will not hear? Alas! say nay! say nay! and be no more so dumb, But open thou thy manly mouth and say that thou wilt come: Whereby my heart may think, although I see not thee, That thou wilt come--thy word so sware--if thou a live man be. The roaring hugy waves they threaten my poor ghost, And toss thee up and down the seas in danger to be lost. Shall they not make me fear that they have swallowed thee? --But as thou art most sure alive, so wilt thou come to me. Whereby I shall go see thy ship ride on the strand, And think and say _Lo where he comes_ and _Sure here will he land:_

_54._ neare] nearer.

And then I shall lift up to thee my little hand, And thou shalt think thine heart in ease, in health to see me stand. And if thou come indeed (as Christ thee send to do!) Those arms which miss thee now shall then embrace [and hold] thee too: Each vein to every joint the lively blood shall spread Which now for want of thy glad sight doth show full pale and dead. But if thou slip thy troth, and do not come at all, As minutes in the clock do strike so call for death I shall: To please both thy false heart and rid

myself from woe, That rather had to die in troth than live forsaken so!

_55._ _The Faithless Shepherdess_

William Byrd’s _Songs of Sundry Natures_, 1589

While that the sun with his beams hot Scorchèd the fruits in vale and mountain, Philon the shepherd, late forgot, Sitting beside a crystal fountain In shadow of a green oak tree, Upon his pipe this song play’d he: Adieu, Love, adieu, Love, untrue Love! Untrue Love, untrue Love, adieu, Love! Your mind is light, soon lost for new love.

So long as I was in your sight I was your heart, your soul, your treasure; And evermore you sobb’d and sigh’d Burning in flames beyond all measure: --Three days endured your love to me, And it was lost in other three! Adieu, Love, adieu, Love, untrue Love! Untrue Love, untrue Love, adieu, Love! Your mind is light, soon lost for new love.

Another shepherd you did see, To whom your heart was soon enchainèd; Full soon your love was leapt from me, Full soon my place he had obtainèd. Soon came a third your love to win, And we were out and he was in. Adieu, Love, adieu, Love, untrue Love! Untrue Love, untrue Love, adieu, Love! Your mind is light, soon lost for new love.

Sure you have made me passing glad That you your mind so soon removèd, Before that I the leisure had To choose you for my best belovèd: For all my love was pass’d and done Two days before it was begun. Adieu, Love, adieu, Love, untrue Love! Untrue Love, untrue Love, adieu, Love! Your mind is light, soon lost for new love.

_56._ _Crabbed Age and Youth_

The Passionate Pilgrim, 1599

Crabbèd Age and Youth Cannot live together: Youth is full of pleasance, Age is full of care; Youth like summer morn, Age like winter weather; Youth like summer brave, Age like winter bare. Youth is full of sport, Age’s breath is short; Youth is nimble, Age is lame; Youth is hot and bold, Age is weak and cold; Youth is wild, and Age is tame. Age, I do abhor thee; Youth, I do adore thee; O, my Love, my Love is young! Age, I do defy thee: O, sweet shepherd, hie thee! For methinks thou stay’st too long.

? by _William Shakespeare_

_57._ _Phyllida’s Love-Call_

England’s Helicon, 1600

Phyllida. Corydon, arise, my Corydon! Titan shineth clear. _Corydon._ Who is it that calleth Corydon? Who is it that I hear? _Phyl._ Phyllida, thy true love, calleth thee, Arise then, arise then, Arise and keep thy flock with me! _Cor._ Phyllida, my true love, is it she? I come then, I come then, I come and keep my flock with thee.

Phyl. Here are cherries ripe for my Corydon; Eat them for my sake. _Cor._ Here’s my oaten pipe, my lovely one, Sport for thee to make.

Phyl. Here are threads, my true love, fine as silk, To knit thee, to knit thee, A pair of stockings white as milk. _Cor._ Here are reeds, my true love, fine and neat, To make thee, to make thee, A bonnet to withstand the heat.

Phyl. I will gather flowers, my Corydon, To set in thy cap. _Cor._ I will gather pears, my lovely one, To put in thy lap. _Phyl._ I will buy my true love garters gay, For Sundays, for Sundays, To wear about his legs so tall. _Cor._ I will buy my true love yellow say, For Sundays, for Sundays, To wear about her middle small.

Phyl. When my Corydon sits on a hill Making melody-- _Cor._ When my lovely one goes to her wheel, Singing cheerily-- _Phyl._ Sure methinks my true love doth excel For sweetness, for sweetness, Our Pan, that old Arcadian knight. _Cor._ And methinks my true love bears the bell For clearness, for clearness, Beyond the nymphs that be so bright.

Phyl. Had my Corydon, my Corydon, Been, alack! her swain-- _Cor._ Had my lovely one, my lovely one, Been in Ida plain--

say] _soie_, silk.

Phyl. Cynthia Endymion had refused, Preferring, preferring, My Corydon to play withal. _Cor._ The Queen of Love had been excused Bequeathing, bequeathing, My Phyllida the golden ball.

Phyl. Yonder comes my mother, Corydon! Whither shall I fly? _Cor._ Under yonder beech, my lovely one, While she passeth by. _Phyl._ Say to her thy true love was not here; Remember, remember, To-morrow is another day. _Cor._ Doubt me not, my true love, do not fear; Farewell then, farewell then! Heaven keep our loves alway!

_58._ _A Pedlar_

John Dowland’s _Second Book of Songs or Airs_, 1600

Fine knacks for ladies! cheap, choice, brave, and new, Good pennyworths--but money cannot move: I keep a fair but for the Fair to view-- A beggar may be liberal of love. Though all my wares be trash, the heart is true, The heart is true.

Great gifts are guiles and look for gifts again; My trifles come as treasures from my mind: It is a precious jewel to be plain; Sometimes in shell the orient’st pearls we find:-- Of others take a sheaf, of me a grain! Of me a grain!

_59._ _Hey nonny no!_

Christ Church MS.

Hey nonny no! Men are fools that wish to die! Is’t not fine to dance and sing When the bells of death do ring? Is’t not fine to swim in wine, And turn upon the toe, And sing hey nonny no! When the winds blow and the seas flow? Hey nonny no!

_60._ _Preparations_

Christ Church MS.

Yet if His Majesty, our sovereign lord, Should of his own accord Friendly himself invite, And say ‘I’ll be your guest to-morrow night,’ How should we stir ourselves, call

and command All hands to work! ‘Let no man idle stand!

‘Set me fine Spanish tables in the hall; See they be fitted all; Let there be room to eat And order taken that there want no meat. See every sconce and candlestick made bright, That without tapers they may give a light.

‘Look to the presence: are the carpets spread, The dazie o’er the head, The cushions in the chairs, And all the candles lighted on the stairs? Perfume the chambers, and in any case Let each man give attendance in his place!’

Thus, if a king were coming, would we do; And ’twere good reason too; For ’tis a duteous thing To show all honour to an earthly king, And after all our travail and our cost, So he be pleased, to think no labour lost.

But at the coming of the King of Heaven All’s set at six and seven; We wallow in our sin, Christ cannot find a chamber in the inn. We entertain Him always like a stranger, And, as at first, still lodge Him in the manger.

_61._ _The New Jerusalem_

Song of Mary the Mother of Christ (London: E. Alide), 1601

Hierusalem, my happy home, When shall I come to thee? When shall my sorrows have an end, Thy joys when shall I see?

O happy harbour of the Saints! O sweet and pleasant soil! In thee no sorrow may be found, No grief, no care, no toil.

There lust and lucre cannot dwell, There envy bears no sway; There is no hunger, heat, nor cold, But pleasure every way.

Thy walls are made of precious stones, Thy bulwarks diamonds square; Thy gates are of right orient pearl, Exceeding rich and rare.

Thy turrets and thy pinnacles With carbuncles do shine; Thy very streets are paved with gold, Surpassing clear and fine.

Ah, my sweet home, Hierusalem, Would God I were in thee! Would God my woes were at an end, Thy joys that I might see!

Thy gardens and thy gallant walks Continually are green; There grows such sweet and pleasant flowers As nowhere else are seen.

Quite through the streets, with silver sound, The flood of Life doth flow; Upon whose banks on every side The wood of Life doth grow.

There trees for evermore bear fruit, And evermore do spring; There evermore the angels sit, And evermore do sing.

Our Lady sings _Magnificat_ With tones surpassing sweet; And all the virgins bear their part, Sitting about her feet.

Hierusalem, my happy home, Would God I were in thee! Would God my woes were at an end, Thy joys that I might see!

_62._ _Icarus_

Robert Jones’s _Second Book of Songs and Airs_, 1601

Love wing’d my Hopes and taught me how to fly Far from base earth, but not to mount too high: For true pleasure Lives in measure, Which if men forsake, Blinded they into folly run and grief for pleasure take.

But my vain Hopes, proud of their new-taught flight, Enamour’d sought to woo the sun’s fair light, Whose rich brightness Moved their lightness To aspire so high That all scorch’d and consumed with fire now drown’d in woe they lie.

And none but Love their woeful hap did rue, For Love did know that their desires were true; Though fate frownèd, And now drownèd They in sorrow dwell, It was the purest light of heav’n for whose fair love they fell.

_63._ _Madrigal_

Davison’s _Poetical Rhapsody_, 1602

My Love in her attire doth show her wit, It doth so well become her; For every season she hath dressings fit, For Winter, Spring, and Summer. No beauty she doth miss When all her robes are on: But Beauty’s self she is When all her robes are gone.

_64._ _How can the Heart forget her?_

Davison’s _Poetical Rhapsody_, 1602

At her fair hands how have I grace entreated With prayers oft repeated! Yet still my love is thwarted: Heart, let her go, for she’ll not be converted-- Say, shall she go? O no, no, no, no, no! She is most fair, though she be marble-hearted.

How often have my sighs declared my anguish, Wherein I daily languish! Yet still she doth procure it: Heart, let her go, for I can not endure it-- Say, shall she go? O no, no, no, no, no! She gave the wound, and she alone must cure it.

But shall I still a true affection owe her, Which prayers, sighs, tears do show her, And shall she still disdain me? Heart, let her go, if they no grace can gain me-- Say, shall she go? O no, no, no, no, no! She made me hers, and hers she will retain me.

But if the love that hath and still doth burn me No love at length return me, Out of my thoughts I’ll set her: Heart, let her go, O heart I pray thee, let her! Say, shall she go? O no, no, no, no, no! Fix’d in the heart, how can the heart forget her?

? _F._ or _W. Davison_

_65._ _Tears_

John Dowland’s _Third and Last Book of Songs or Airs_, 1603

Weep you no more, sad fountains; What need you flow so fast? Look how the snowy mountains Heaven’s sun doth gently waste! But my Sun’s heavenly eyes View not your weeping, That now lies sleeping Softly, now softly lies Sleeping.

Sleep is a reconciling, A rest that peace begets; Doth not the sun rise smiling When fair at even he sets? Rest you then, rest, sad eyes! Melt not in weeping, While she lies sleeping Softly, now softly lies Sleeping.

_66._ _My Lady’s Tears_

John Dowland’s _Third and Last Book of Songs or Airs_, 1603

I saw my Lady weep, And Sorrow proud to be advancèd so In those fair eyes where all perfections keep. Her face was full of woe; But such a woe (believe me) as wins more hearts Than Mirth can do with her enticing parts.

Sorrow was there made fair, And Passion wise; Tears a delightful thing; Silence beyond all speech, a wisdom rare: She made her sighs to sing, And all things with so sweet a sadness move As made my heart at once both grieve, and love.

O fairer than aught else The world can show, leave off in time to grieve! Enough, enough: your joyful look excels: Tears kill the heart, believe. O strive not to be excellent in woe, Which only breeds your beauty’s overthrow.

_67._ _Sister, Awake!_

Thomas Bateson’s _First Set of English Madrigals_, 1604

Sister, awake! close not your eyes! The day her light discloses, And the bright morning doth arise Out of her bed of roses.

See the clear sun, the world’s bright eye, In at our window peeping: Lo, how he blusheth to espy Us idle wenches sleeping!

Therefore awake! make haste, I say, And let us, without staying, All in our gowns of green so gay Into the Park a-maying!

_68._ _Devotion_

Captain Tobias Hume’s _The First Part of Airs, &c._, 1605

Fain would I change that note To which fond Love hath charm’d me Long, long to sing by rote, Fancying that that harm’d me: Yet when this thought doth come, ‘Love is the perfect sum Of all delight,’ I have no other choice Either for pen or voice To sing or write.

O Love! they wrong thee much That say thy sweet is bitter, When thy rich fruit is such As nothing can be sweeter. Fair house of joy and bliss, Where truest pleasure is, I do adore thee: I know thee what thou art, I serve thee with my heart, And fall before thee.

_69._ _Since First I saw your Face_

Thomas Ford’s _Music of Sundry Kinds_, 1607

Since first I saw your face I resolved to honour and renown ye; If now I be disdainèd I wish my heart had never known ye. What? I that loved and you that liked, shall we begin to wrangle? No, no, no, my heart is fast, and cannot disentangle.

If I admire or praise you too much, that fault you may forgive me; Or if my hands had stray’d but a touch, then justly might you leave me. I ask’d you leave, you bade me love; is’t now a time to chide me? No, no, no, I’ll love you still what fortune e’er betide me.

The Sun, whose beams most glorious are, rejecteth no beholder, And your sweet beauty past compare made my poor eyes the bolder: Where beauty moves and wit delights and signs of kindness bind me, There, O there! where'er I go I'll leave my heart behind me!

_70._ _There is a Lady sweet and kind_

Thomas Ford's _Music of Sundry Kinds_, 1607

There is a Lady sweet and kind, Was never face so pleased my mind; I did but see her passing by, And yet I love her till I die.

Her gesture, motion, and her smiles, Her wit, her voice my heart beguiles, Beguiles my heart, I know not why, And yet I love her till I die.

Cupid is wingèd and doth range, Her country so my love doth change: But change she earth, or change she sky, Yet will I love her till I die.

_71._ _Love not me for comely grace_

John Wilbye's _Second Set of Madrigals_, 1609

Love not me for comely grace, For my pleasing eye or face, Nor for any outward part, No, nor for a constant heart: For these may fail or turn to ill, So thou and I shall sever: Keep, therefore, a true woman's eye, And love me still but know not why-- So hast thou the same reason still To doat upon me ever!

_72._ _The Wakening_

John Attye's _First Book of Airs_, 1622

On a time the amorous Silvy Said to her shepherd, 'Sweet, how do ye? Kiss me this once and then God be with ye, My sweetest dear! Kiss me this once and then God be with ye, For now the morning draweth near.' With that, her fairest bosom showing, Op'ning her lips, rich perfumes blowing, She said, 'Now kiss me and be going, My sweetest dear! Kiss me this once and then be going, For now the morning draweth near.' With that the shepherd waked from sleeping, And spying where the day was peeping, He said, 'Now take my soul in keeping, My sweetest dear! Kiss me and take my soul in keeping, Since I must go, now day is near.'

NICHOLAS BRETON

1542-1626

_73._ _Phillida and Coridon_

In the merry month of May, In a morn by break of day. Forth I walk'd by the wood-side When as May was in his pride: There I spièd all alone Phillida and Coridon. Much ado there was, God wot! He would love and she would not. She said, Never man was true; He said, None was false to you. He said, He had loved her long; She said, Love should have no wrong. Coridon would kiss her then; She said, Maids must kiss no men Till they did for good and all; Then she made the shepherd call All the heavens to witness truth Never loved a truer youth. Thus with many a pretty oath,

Yea and nay, and faith and troth, Such as silly shepherds use When they will not Love abuse, Love, which had been long deluded, Was with kisses sweet concluded; And Phillida, with garlands gay, Was made the Lady of the May.

NICHOLAS BRETON?

_74._ _A Cradle Song_

The Arbor of Amorous Devices, 1593-4

Come little babe, come silly soul, Thy father’s shame, thy mother’s grief, Born as I doubt to all our dole, And to thyself unhappy chief: Sing lullaby, and lap it warm, Poor soul that thinks no creature harm.

Thou little think’st and less dost know The cause of this thy mother’s moan; Thou want’st the wit to wail her woe, And I myself am all alone: Why dost thou weep? why dost thou wail? And know’st not yet what thou dost ail.

Come, little wretch--ah, silly heart! Mine only joy, what can I more? If there be any wrong thy smart, That may the destinies implore: ’Twas I, I say, against my will, I wail the time, but be thou still.

And dost thou smile? O, thy sweet face! Would God Himself He might thee see!-- No doubt thou wouldst soon purchase grace, I know right well, for thee and me: But come to mother, babe, and play, For father false is fled away.

Sweet boy, if it by fortune chance Thy father home again to send, If death do strike me with his lance, Yet mayst thou me to him commend: If any ask thy mother’s name, Tell how by love she purchased blame.

Then will his gentle heart soon yield: I know him of a noble mind: Although a lion in the field, A lamb in town thou shalt him find: Ask blessing, babe, be not afraid, His sugar’d words hath me betray’d.

Then mayst thou joy and be right glad; Although in woe I seem to moan, Thy father is no rascal lad, A noble youth of blood and bone: His glancing looks, if he once smile, Right honest women may beguile.

Come, little boy, and rock asleep; Sing lullaby and be thou still; I, that can do naught else but weep, Will sit by thee and wail my fill: God bless my babe, and lullaby From this thy father’s quality.

SIR WALTER RALEIGH

1552-1618

The Silent Lover

_75._ _i_

Passions are liken’d best to floods and streams: The shallow murmur, but the deep are dumb; So, when affection yields discourse, it seems The bottom is but shallow whence they come. They that are rich in words, in words discover That they are poor

in that which makes a lover.

_76._ _ii_

Wrong not, sweet empress of my heart, The merit of true passion, With thinking that he feels no smart, That sues for no compassion.

Silence in love bewrays more woe Than words, though ne’er so witty: A beggar that is dumb, you know, May challenge double pity.

Then wrong not, dearest to my heart, My true, though secret passion; He smarteth most that hides his smart, And sues for no compassion.

_77._ _His Pilgrimage_

Give me my scallop-shell of quiet, My staff of faith to walk upon, My scrip of joy, immortal diet, My bottle of salvation, My gown of glory, hope’s true gage; And thus I’ll take my pilgrimage.

Blood must be my body’s balmer; No other balm will there be given; Whilst my soul, like quiet palmer, Travelleth towards the land of heaven; Over the silver mountains, Where spring the nectar fountains; There will I kiss The bowl of bliss; And drink mine everlasting fill Upon every milken hill. My soul will be a-dry before; But, after, it will thirst no more.

_78._ _The Conclusion_

Even such is Time, that takes in trust Our youth, our joys, our all we have, And pays us but with earth and dust; Who in the dark and silent grave, When we have wander’d all our ways, Shuts up the story of our days; But from this earth, this grave, this dust, My God shall raise me up, I trust.

EDMUND SPENSER

1552-1599

_79._ _Whilst it is prime_

Fresh Spring, the herald of loves mighty king, In whose cote-armour richly are displayd All sorts of flowers, the which on earth do spring. In goodly colours gloriously arrayd-- Goe to my love, where she is carelesse layd, Yet in her winters bowre not well awake; Tell her the joyous time wil not be staid, Unlesse she doe him by the forelock take; Bid her therefore her selfe soone ready make, To wayt on Love amongst his lovely crew; Where every one, that misseth then her make, Shall be by him amearst with penance dew. Make hast, therefore, sweet love, whilest it is prime; For none can call againe the passèd time.

_79._ make] mate.

_80._ _A Ditty_

In praise of Eliza, Queen of the Shepherds

See where she sits upon the grassie greene, (O seemely sight!) Yclad in Scarlot, like a mayden Queene, And ermines white: Upon her head a Cremosin coronet With Damaske roses and Daffadillies set: Bay leaves betweene, And primroses greene, Embellish the sweete Violet.

Tell me, have ye seene her angelick face Like Phœbe fayre? Her heavenly haveour, her princely grace, Can you well compare? The Redde rose medled with the White yfere, In either cheeke depeincten lively chere: Her modest eye, Her Majestie, Where have you seene the like but there?

I see Calliope speede her to the place, Where my Goddesse shines; And after her the other Muses trace With their Violines. Bene they not Bay braunches which they do beare, All for Elisa in her hand to weare? So sweetely they play, And sing all the way, That it a heaven is to heare.

medled] mixed. yfere] together.

Lo, how finely the Graces can it foote To the Instrument: They dauncen deffly, and singen soote, In their meriment. Wants not a fourth Grace to make the daunce even? Let that rowme to my Lady be yeven. She shal be a Grace, To fyll the fourth place, And reigne with the rest in heaven.

Bring hether the Pincke and purple Cullambine, With Gelliflowres; Bring Coronations, and Sops-in-wine Worne of Paramoures: Strowe me the ground with Daffadowndillies, And Cowslips, and Kingcups, and lovèd Lillies: The pretie Pawnce, And the Chevisaunce, Shall match with the fayre flowre Delice.

Now ryse up, Elisa, deckèd as thou art In royall aray; And now ye daintie Damsells may depart Eche one her way. I feare I have troubled your troupes to longe: Let dame Elisa thanke you for her song: And if you come hether When Damsines I gether, I will part them all you among.

soote] sweet. coronations] carnations. sops-in-wine] striped pinks. pawnce] pansy. chevisaunce] wallflower. flowre delice] iris.

_81._ _Prothalamion_

Calme was the day, and through the trembling ayre Sweete-breathing Zephyrus did softly play A gentle spirit, that lightly did delay Hot Titans beames, which then did glyster fayre; When I, (whom sullein care, Through discontent of my long fruitlesse stay In Princes Court, and expectation vayne Of idle hopes, which still doe fly away, Like empty shaddowes, did afflict my brayne,) Walkt forth to ease my payne Along the shoare of silver streaming Themmes; Whose rutty Bancke, the which his River hemmes, Was paynted all with variable flowers, And all the meades adornd with daintie gemmes Fit to decke maydens bowres, And crowne their Paramours Against the Brydale day, which is not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

There, in a Meadow, by the Rivers side, A Flocke of Nymphes I chauncèd to espy, All lovely Daughters of the Flood thereby, With goodly greenish locks, all loose untyde, As each had bene a Bryde; And each one had a little wicker basket, Made of fine twigs, entraylèd curiously, In which they gathered flowers to fill their flasket,

And with fine Fingers cropt full feateously The tender stalkes on hye. Of every sort, which in that Meadow grew, They gathered some; the Violet, pallid blew,

The little Dazie, that at evening closes, The virgin Lillie, and the Primrose trew, With store of vermeil Roses, To decke their Bridegromes posies Against the Brydale day, which was not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

With that I saw two Swannes of goodly hewe Come softly swimming downe along the Lee; Two fairer Birds I yet did never see; The snow, which doth the top of Pindus strew, Did never whiter shew; Nor Jove himselfe, when he a Swan would be, For love of Leda, whiter did appeare; Yet Leda was (they say) as white as he, Yet not so white as these, nor nothing neare; So purely white they were, That even the gentle streame, the which them bare, Seem'd foule to them, and bad his billowes spare To wet their silken feathers, least they might Soyle their fayre plumes with water not so fayre, And marre their beauties bright, That shone as heavens light, Against their Brydale day, which was not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song. Eftsoones the Nymphes, which now had Flowers their fill, Ran all in haste to see that silver brood, As they came floating on the Christal Flood; Whom when they sawe, they stood amazèd still, Their wondring eyes to fill; Them seem'd they never saw a sight so fayre, Of Fowles, so lovely, that they sure did deeme Them heavenly borne, or to be that same payre Which through the Skie draw Venus silver Teeme; For sure they did not seeme To be begot of any earthly Seede, But rather Angels, or of Angels breede; Yet were they bred of Somers-heat, they say, In sweetest Season, when each Flower and weede The earth did fresh aray; So fresh they seem'd as day, Even as their Brydale day, which was not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

Then forth they all out of their baskets drew Great store of Flowers, the honour of the field, That to the sense did fragrant odours yield, All which upon those goodly Birds they threw And all the Waves did strew, That like old Peneus Waters they did seeme, When downe along by pleasant Tempes shore, Scattred with Flowres, through Thessaly they streeme, That they appeare, through Lillies plenteous store, Like a Brydes Chamber flore. Two of those Nymphes, meane while, two Garlands bound Of freshest Flowres which in that Mead they found, The which presenting all in trim Array, Their snowie Foreheads therewithall they crownd, Whil'st one did sing this Lay, Prepared against that Day, Against their Brydale day, which was not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

'Ye gentle Birdes! the worlds faire ornament, And heavens glorie, whom this happie hower Doth leade unto your lovers blisfull bower, Joy may you have, and gentle hearts content Of your loves couplement; And let faire Venus, that is Queene of love, With her heart-quelling Sonne upon you smile, Whose smile, they say, hath vertue to remove All Loves dislike, and friendships faultie guile For ever to assoile. Let endlesse Peace your steadfast hearts accord, And blessèd Plentie wait upon your bord; And let your bed with pleasures chast abound, That fruitfull issue may to you afford, Which may your foes confound, And make your joyes redound Upon your Brydale day, which is not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softlie, till I end my Song.'

So ended she; and all the rest around To her redoubled that her undersong, Which said their brydale daye should not be long: And gentle Eccho from the neighbour ground Their accents did resound. So forth those joyous Birdes did passe along, Adowne the Lee, that to them murmurde low, As he would speake, but that he lackt a tong, Yet did by signes his glad affection show, Making his streame run slow. And all the foule which in his flood did dwell Gan flock about these twaine, that did excell The rest, so far as Cynthia doth shend The lesser starres. So they, enrangèd well, Did on those two attend, And their best service lend Against their wedding day, which was not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

At length they all to mery London came, To mery London, my most kyndly Nurse, That to me gave this Lifes first native sourse, Though from another place I take my name, An house of auncient fame: There when they came, whereas those bricky towres The which on Themmes brode agèd backe doe ryde, Where now the studious Lawyers have their bowers, There whylome wont the Templer Knights to byde, Till they decayd through pride: Next whereunto there standes a stately place, Where oft I gaynèd giftes and goodly grace Of that great Lord, which therein wont to dwell, Whose want too well now feeles my freendles case; But ah! here fits not well Olde woes, but joyes, to tell Against the Brydale daye, which is not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

Yet therein now doth lodge a noble Peer, Great Englands glory, and the Worlds wide wonder, Whose dreadfull name late through all Spaine did thunder, And Hercules two pillors standing neere Did make to quake and feare: Faire branch of Honor, flower of Chevalrie! That fillest England with thy triumphes fame, Joy have thou of thy noble victorie, And endlesse happinesse of thine owne name That promiseth the same; That through thy prowesse, and victorious armes, Thy country may be freed from forraine harmes; And great Elisaes glorious name may ring Through al the world, fil'd with thy wide Alarmes, Which some brave muse may sing To ages following, Upon the Brydale day, which is not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly till I end my Song.

From those high Towers this noble Lord issuing, Like Radiant Hesper, when his golden hayre In th' Ocean billowes he hath bathèd fayre, Descended to the Rivers open vewing, With a great traine ensuing. Above the rest were goodly to bee seene Two gentle Knights of lovely face and feature, Beseeming well the bower of anie Queene, With gifts of wit, and ornaments of nature, Fit for so goodly stature, That like the twins of Jove they seem'd in sight, Which decke the Bauldricke of the Heavens bright; They two, forth pacing to the Rivers side, Received those two faire Brides, their Loves delight; Which, at th' appointed tyde, Each one did make his Bryde Against their Brydale day, which is not long: Sweete Themmes! runne softly, till I end my Song.

_82._ _Epithalamion_

Ye learnèd sisters, which have oftentimes Beene to me ayding, others to adorne, Whom ye thought worthy of your gracefull rymes, That even the greatest did not greatly scorne To heare theyr names sung in your simple layes, But joyèd in theyr

praise; And when ye list your owne mishaps to mourne, Which death, or love, or fortunes wreck did rayse, Your string could soone to sadder tenor turne, And teach the woods and waters to lament Your dolefull dreriment: Now lay those sorrowfull complaints aside; And, having all your heads with girlands crownd, Helpe me mine owne loves prayses to resound; Ne let the same of any be envide: So Orpheus did for his owne bride! So I unto my selfe alone will sing; The woods shall to me answer, and my Eccho ring.

Early, before the worlds light-giving lampe His golden beame upon the hils doth spred, Having disperst the nights unchearefull dampe, Doe ye awake; and, with fresh lusty-hed, Go to the bowre of my belovèd love, My truest turtle dove; Bid her awake; for Hymen is awake, And long since ready forth his maske to move, With his bright Tead that flames with many a flake, And many a bachelor to waite on him, In theyr fresh garments trim. Bid her awake therefore, and soone her dight, For lo! the wishèd day is come at last, That shall, for all the paynes and sorrowes past, Pay to her usury of long delight: And, whylest she doth her dight, Doe ye to her of joy and solace sing, That all the woods may answer, and your eccho ring.

Bring with you all the Nymphes that you can heare Both of the rivers and the forrests greene,

tead] torch.

And of the sea that neighbours to her neare: Al with gay girlands goodly wel beseene. And let them also with them bring in hand Another gay girland For my fayre love, of lillyes and of roses, Bound truelove wize, with a blew silke riband. And let them make great store of bridale poses, And let them eeke bring store of other flowers, To deck the bridale bowers. And let the ground whereas her foot shall tread, For feare the stones her tender foot should wrong, Be strewed with fragrant flowers all along, And diapred lyke the discolored mead. Which done, doe at her chamber dore awayt, For she will waken strayt; The whiles doe ye this song unto her sing, The woods shall to you answer, and your Eccho ring.

Ye Nymphes of Mulla, which with carefull heed The silver scaly trouts doe tend full well, And greedy pikes which use therein to feed; (Those trouts and pikes all others doo excell;) And ye likewise, which keepe the rushy lake, Where none doo fishes take; Bynd up the locks the which hang scatterd light, And in his waters, which your mirror make, Behold your faces as the christall bright, That when you come whereas my love doth lie, No blemish she may spie. And eke, ye lightfoot mayds, which keepe the deere, That on the hoary mountayne used to towre; And the wylde wolves, which seeke them to devoure, With your steele darts doo chace from comming neer; Be also present heere,

To helpe to decke her, and to help to sing, That all the woods may answer, and your eccho ring.

Wake now, my love, awake! for it is time; The Rosy Morne long since left Tithones bed, All ready to her silver coche to clyme; And Phœbus gins to shew his glorious hed. Hark! how the cheerefull birds do chaunt theyr laies And carroll of Loves praise. The merry Larke hir mattins sings aloft; The Thrush replyes; the Mavis descant playes;

The Ouzell shrills; the Ruddock warbles soft; So goodly all agree, with sweet consent, To this dayes merriment. Ah! my deere love, why doe ye sleepe thus long? When meeter were that ye should now awake, T’ awayt the comming of your joyous make, And hearken to the birds love-learnèd song, The deawy leaves among! Nor they of joy and pleasance to you sing, That all the woods them answer, and theyr eccho ring. My love is now awake out of her dreames, And her fayre eyes, like stars that dimmèd were With darksome cloud, now shew theyr goodly beams More bright then Hesperus his head doth rere. Come now, ye damzels, daughters of delight, Helpe quickly her to dight: But first come ye fayre houres, which were begot In Joves sweet paradice of Day and Night; Which doe the seasons of the yeare allot, And al, that ever in this world is fayre, Doe make and still repayre:

ruddock] redbreast.

And ye three handmayds of the Cyprian Queene, The which doe still adorne her beauties pride, Helpe to addorne my beautifullest bride: And, as ye her array, still throw betweene Some graces to be seene; And, as ye use to Venus, to her sing, The whiles the woods shal answer, and your eccho ring.

Now is my love all ready forth to come: Let all the virgins therefore well awayt: And ye fresh boyes, that tend upon her groome, Prepare your selves; for he is comming strayt. Set all your things in seemely good aray, Fit for so joyfull day: The joyfulst day that ever sunne did see. Faire Sun! shew forth thy favourable ray, And let thy lifull heat not fervent be, For feare of burning her sunshyny face, Her beauty to disgrace. O fayrest Phœbus! father of the Muse! If ever I did honour thee aright, Or sing the thing that mote thy mind delight, Doe not thy servants simple boone refuse; But let this day, let this one day, be myne; Let all the rest be thine. Then I thy soverayne prayses loud wil sing, That all the woods shal answer, and theyr eccho ring.

Harke! how the Minstrils gin to shrill aloud Their merry Musick that resounds from far, The pipe, the tabor, and the trembling Croud, That well agree withouten breach or jar.

croud] violin.

But, most of all, the Damzels doe delite When they their tymbrels smyte, And thereunto doe daunce and carrol sweet, That all the sences they doe ravish quite; The whyles the boyes run up and downe the street, Crying aloud with strong confusèd noyce, As if it were one voyce, Hymen, iö Hymen, Hymen, they do shout; That even to the heavens theyr shouting shrill Doth reach, and all the firmament doth fill; To which the people standing all about, As in approvance, doe thereto applaud, And loud advaunce her laud; And evermore they Hymen, Hymen sing, That al the woods them answer, and theyr eccho ring.

Loe! where she comes along with portly pace, Lyke Phœbe, from her chamber of the East, Arysing forth to run her mighty race, Clad all in white, that seemes a virgin best. So well it her beseemes, that ye would weene Some angell she had beene. Her long loose yellow locks lyke golden wyre, Sprinckled with perle, and perling flowres atweene, Doe lyke a golden mantle her attyre; And, being crownèd with a girland

greene, Seeme lyke some mayden Queene. Her modest eyes, abashèd to behold So many gazers as on her do stare, Upon the lowly ground affixèd are; Ne dare lift up her countenance too bold, But blush to heare her prayses sung so loud, So farre from being proud. Nathlesse doe ye still loud her prayses sing, That all the woods may answer, and your eccho ring.

Tell me, ye merchants daughters, did ye see So fayre a creature in your towne before; So sweet, so lovely, and so mild as she, Adornd with beautyes grace and vertues store? Her goodly eyes lyke Saphyres shining bright, Her forehead yvory white, Her cheekes lyke apples which the sun hath rudded, Her lips lyke cherryes charming men to byte, Her brest like to a bowle of creame uncrudded, Her paps lyke lyllies budded, Her snowie necke lyke to a marble towre; And all her body like a pallace fayre, Ascending up, with many a stately stayre, To honors seat and chastities sweet bowre. Why stand ye still ye virgins in amaze, Upon her so to gaze, Whiles ye forget your former lay to sing, To which the woods did answer, and your eccho ring?

But if ye saw that which no eyes can see, The inward beauty of her lively spright, Garnisht with heavenly guifts of high degree, Much more then would ye wonder at that sight, And stand astonisht lyke to those which red Medusaes mazeful hed. There dwels sweet love, and constant chastity, Unspotted fayth, and comely womanhood, Regard of honour, and mild modesty; There vertue raynes as Queene in royal throne, And giveth lawes alone, The which the base affections doe obay, And yeeld theyr services unto her will; Ne thought of thing uncomely ever may Thereto approch to tempt her mind to ill. Had ye once seene these her celestial threasures, And unrevealèd pleasures, Then would ye wonder, and her prayses sing, That al the woods should answer, and your echo ring.

Open the temple gates unto my love, Open them wide that she may enter in, And all the postes adorne as doth behove, And all the pillours deck with girlands trim, For to receyve this Saynt with honour dew, That commeth in to you. With trembling steps, and humble reverence, She commeth in, before th’ Almighties view; Of her ye virgins learne obedience, When so ye come into those holy places, To humble your proud faces: Bring her up to th’ high altar, that she may The sacred ceremonies there partake, The which do endlesse matrimony make; And let the roring Organs loudly play The praises of the Lord in lively notes; The whiles, with hollow throates, The Choristers the joyous Antheme sing, That al the woods may answere, and their eccho ring.

Behold, whiles she before the altar stands, Hearing the holy priest that to her speakes, And blesseth her with his two happy hands, How the red roses flush up in her cheekes, And the pure snow, with goodly vermill stayne Like crimsin dyde in grayne: That even th’ Angels, which continually About the sacred Altare doe remaine, Forget their service and about her fly, Ofte peeping in her face, that seems more fayre, The more they on it stare. But her sad eyes, still fastened on the ground, Are governèd with goodly modesty, That suffers not one looke to glaunce awry, Which may let in a little thought unsownd. Why blush ye, love, to give to me your hand, The pledge of all our band! Sing, ye sweet Angels, Alleluya sing, That all the woods may answere, and your eccho ring.

Now al is done: bring home the bride againe; Bring home the triumph of our victory: Bring home with you the glory of her gaine; With joyance bring her and with jollity. Never had man more joyfull day then this, Whom heaven would heape with blis, Make feast therefore now all this live-long day; This day for ever to me holy is. Poure out the wine without restraint or stay, Poure not by cups, but by the belly full, Poure out to all that wull, And sprinkle all the postes and wals with wine, That they may sweat, and drunken be withall. Crowne ye God Bacchus with a coronall, And Hymen also crowne with wreathes of vine; And let the Graces daunce unto the rest, For they can doo it best: The whiles the maydens doe theyr carroll sing, To which the woods shall answer, and theyr eccho ring.

Ring ye the bels, ye yong men of the towne, And leave your wonted labors for this day: This day is holy; doe ye write it downe, That ye for ever it remember may. This day the sunne is in his chiefest hight, With Barnaby the bright, From whence declining daily by degrees, He somewhat loseth of his heat and light, When once the Crab behind his back he sees. But for this time it ill ordainèd was, To chose the longest day in all the yeare, And shortest night, when longest fitter weare: Yet never day so long, but late would passe. Ring ye the bels, to make it weare away, And bonefiers make all day; And daunce about them, and about them sing, That all the woods may answer, and your eccho ring.

Ah! when will this long weary day have end, And lende me leave to come unto my love? How slowly do the houres theyr numbers spend? How slowly does sad Time his feathers move? Hast thee, O fayrest Planet, to thy home, Within the Westerne fome: Thy tyrèd steedes long since have need of rest. Long though it be, at last I see it gloome, And the bright evening-star with golden creast Appeare out of the East. Fayre childe of beauty! glorious lampe of love! That all the host of heaven in rankes doost lead, And guydest lovers through the nights sad dread, How chearefully thou lookest from above, And seemst to laugh atweene thy twinkling light, As joying in the sight Of these glad many, which for joy doe sing, That all the woods them answer, and their echo ring!

Now ceasse, ye damsels, your delights fore-past; Enough it is that all the day was youres: Now day is doen, and night is nighing fast, Now bring the Bryde into the brydall boures. The night is come, now soon her disaray, And in her bed her lay; Lay her in lillies and in violets, And silken courteins over her display, And odourd sheetes, and Arras coverlets. Behold how goodly my faire love does ly, In proud humility! Like unto Maia, when as Jove her took In Tempe, lying on the flowry gras, Twixt sleepe and wake, after she weary was, With bathing in the Acidalian brooke. Now it is night, ye damsels may be gon, And leave my love alone, And leave likewise your former lay to sing: The woods no more shall answere, nor your echo ring.

Now welcome, night! thou night so long expected, That long daies labour doest at last defray, And all my cares, which cruell Love collected, Hast sumd in one, and cancellèd for aye: Spread thy broad wing over my love and me, That no man may us see; And in thy sable mantle us enwrap, From feare of perrill and foule horror free. Let no false treason seeke us to entrap, Nor any dread disquiet once annoy The safety of our joy; But let the night be calme, and quietsome, Without tempestuous storms or

sad afray: Lyke as when Jove with fayre Alcmena lay, When he begot the great Tirynthian groome: Or lyke as when he with thy selfe did lie And begot Majesty. And let the mayds and yong men cease to sing; Ne let the woods them answer nor theyr eccho ring.

Let no lamenting cryes, nor dolefull teares, Be heard all night within, nor yet without: Ne let false whispers, breeding hidden feares, Breake gentle sleepe with misconceivèd dout. Let no deluding dreames, nor dreadfull sights, Make sudden sad affrights; Ne let house-fyres, nor lightnings helpelesse harmes, Ne let the Pouke, nor other evill sprights, Ne let mischivous witches with theyr charmes, Ne let hob Goblins, names whose sence we see not, Fray us with things that be not: Let not the shriech Oule nor the Storke be heard, Nor the night Raven, that still deadly yels; Nor damnèd ghosts, cald up with mighty spels, Nor griesly vultures, make us once affeard: Ne let th’ unpleasant Quyre of Frogs still croking Make us to wish theyr choking. Let none of these theyr drery accents sing; Ne let the woods them answer, nor theyr eccho ring.

But let stil Silence trew night-watches keepe, That sacred Peace may in assurance rayne, And tymely Sleep, when it is tyme to sleepe, May poure his limbs forth on your pleasant playne; The whiles an hundred little wingèd loves, Like divers-fethered doves, Shall fly and flutter round about your bed, And in the secret darke, that none reproves, Their prety stealthes shal worke, and snares shal spread To filch away sweet snatches of delight, Conceald through covert night. Ye sonnes of Venus, play your sports at will! For greedy pleasure, carelesse of your toyes, Thinks more upon her paradise of joyes, Then what ye do, albe it good or ill. All night therefore attend your merry play, For it will soone be day: Now none doth hinder you, that say or sing; Ne will the woods now answer, nor your Eccho ring.

Who is the same, which at my window peepes? Or whose is that faire face that shines so bright? Is it not Cinthia, she that never sleepes, But walkes about high heaven al the night? O! fayrest goddesse, do thou not envy My love with me to spy: For thou likewise didst love, though now unthought, And for a fleece of wooll, which privily The Latmian shepherd once unto thee brought, His pleasures with thee wrought. Therefore to us be favorable now; And sith of wemens labours thou hast charge, And generation goodly dost enlarge, Encline thy will t’effect our wishfull vow, And the chast wombe informe with timely seed That may our comfort breed: Till which we cease our hopefull hap to sing; Ne let the woods us answere, nor our Eccho ring.

And thou, great Juno! which with awful might The lawes of wedlock still dost patronize; And the religion of the faith first plight With sacred rites hast taught to solemnize; And eeke for comfort often callèd art Of women in their smart; Eternally bind thou this lovely band, And all thy blessings unto us impart. And thou, glad Genius! in whose gentle hand The bridale bowre and geniall bed remaine, Without blemish or staine; And the sweet pleasures of theyr loves delight With secret ayde doest succour and supply, Till they bring forth the fruitfull progeny; Send us the timely fruit of this same night. And thou, fayre Hebe! and thou, Hymen free! Grant that it may so be. Til which we cease your further prayse to sing; Ne any woods shall

answer, nor your Eccho ring.

And ye high heavens, the temple of the gods, In which a thousand torches flaming bright Doe burne, that to us wretched earthly clods In dreadful darknesse lend desirèd light And all ye powers which in the same remayne, More then we men can fayne! Poure out your blessing on us plentiously, And happy influence upon us raine, That we may raise a large posterity, Which from the earth, which they may long possesse With lasting happinesse, Up to your haughty pallaces may mount; And, for the guerdon of theyr glorious merit, May heavenly tabernacles there inherit, Of blessèd Saints for to increase the count. So let us rest, sweet love, in hope of this, And cease till then our tymely joyes to sing: The woods no more us answer, nor our eccho ring!

Song! made in lieu of many ornaments. _With which my love should duly have been dect,_ _Which cutting off through hasty accidents,_ _Ye would not stay your dew time to expect_ _But promist both to recompens;_ _Be unto her a goodly ornament,_ _And for short time an endlesse moniment._

_83._ _From ‘Daphnaïda’_

An Elegy

SHE fell away in her first ages spring, Whil’st yet her leafe was greene, and fresh her rinde, And whil’st her braunch faire blossomes foorth did bring, She fell away against all course of kinde. For age to dye is right, but youth is wrong; She fel away like fruit blowne downe with winde. Weepe, Shepheard! weepe, to make my undersong.

Yet fell she not as one enforst to dye, Ne dyde with dread and grudging discontent, But as one toyld with travaile downe doth lye, So lay she downe, as if to sleepe she went, And closde her eyes with carelesse quietnesse; The whiles soft death away her spirit hent, And soule assoyld from sinfull fleshlinesse.

How happie was I when I saw her leade The Shepheards daughters dauncing in a rownd! How trimly would she trace and softly tread The tender grasse, with rosie garland crownd! And when she list advance her heavenly voyce, Both Nymphes and Muses nigh she made astownd, And flocks and shepheards causèd to rejoyce.

But now, ye Shepheard lasses! who shall lead Your wandring troupes, or sing your virelayes? Or who shall dight your bowres, sith she is dead That was the Lady of your holy-dayes? Let now your blisse be turnèd into bale, And into plaints convert your joyous playes, And with the same fill every hill and dale.

For I will walke this wandring pilgrimage, Throughout the world from one to other end, And in affliction wast my better age: My bread shall be the anguish of my mind, My drink the teares which fro mine eyes do raine, My bed the ground that hardest I may finde; So will I wilfully increase my paine.

Ne sleepe (the harbenger of wearie wights) Shall ever lodge upon mine ey-lids more; Ne shall with rest refresh my fainting sprights, Nor failing force to former strength restore: But I will wake and sorrow all the night With Philumene, my fortune

to deplore; With Philumene, the partner of my plight.

And ever as I see the starres to fall, And under ground to goe to give them light Which dwell in darknes, I to minde will call How my fair Starre (that shinde on me so bright) Fell sodainly and faded under ground; Since whose departure, day is turnd to night, And night without a Venus starre is found.

And she, my love that was, my Saint that is, When she beholds from her celestiall throne (In which shee joyeth in eternall blis) My bitter penance, will my case bemone, And pitie me that living thus doo die; For heavenly spirits have compassion On mortall men, and rue their miserie.

So when I have with sorowe satisfide Th’ importune fates, which vengeance on me seeke, And th’ heavens with long languor pacifide, She, for pure pitie of my sufferance meeke, Will send for me; for which I daylie long: And will till then my painful penance eeke. Weep, Shepheard! weep, to make my undersong!

_84._ _Easter_

MOST glorious Lord of Lyfe! that, on this day, Didst make Thy triumph over death and sin; And, having harrowd hell, didst bring away Captivity thence captive, us to win: This joyous day, deare Lord, with joy begin; And grant that we, for whom thou diddest dye, Being with Thy deare blood clene washt from sin, May live for ever in felicity! And that Thy love we weighing worthily, May likewise love Thee for the same againe; And for Thy sake, that all lyke deare didst buy, With love may one another entertayne! So let us love, deare Love, lyke as we ought, --Love is the lesson which the Lord us taught.

JOHN LYLY

1553-1606

_85._ _Cards and Kisses_

Cupid and my Campaspe play’d At cards for kisses--Cupid paid: He stakes his quiver, bow, and arrows, His mother’s doves, and team of sparrows; Loses them too; then down he throws The coral of his lips, the rose Growing on’s cheek (but none knows how); With these, the crystal of his brow, And then the dimple of his chin: All these did my Campaspe win. At last he set her both his eyes-- She won, and Cupid blind did rise. O Love! has she done this for thee? What shall, alas! become of me?

_86._ _Spring’s Welcome_

WHAT bird so sings, yet so does wail? O ’tis the ravish’d nightingale. _Jug, jug, jug, jug, tereu!_ she cries, And still her woes at midnight rise. Brave prick-song! Who is’t now we hear? None but the lark so shrill and clear; Now at heaven’s gate she claps her wings, The morn not waking till she sings. Hark, hark, with what a pretty throat Poor robin redbreast tunes his note! Hark how the jolly cuckoos sing _Cuckoo!_ to welcome in the spring! _Cuckoo!_ to welcome in the spring!

ANTHONY MUNDAY

1553-1633

_87._ _Beauty Bathing_

BEAUTY sat bathing by a spring, Where fairest shades did hide her; The winds blew calm, the birds did sing, The cool streams ran beside her. My wanton thoughts enticed mine eye To see what was forbidden: But better memory said Fie; So vain desire was chidden-- Hey nonny nonny O! Hey nonny nonny!

Into a slumber then I fell, And fond imagination Seemèd to see, but could not tell, Her feature or her fashion: But ev'n as babes in dreams do smile, And sometimes fall a-weeping, So I awaked as wise that while As when I fell a-sleeping.

SIR PHILIP SIDNEY

1554-86

_88._ _The Bargain_

My true love hath my heart, and I have his, But just exchange one for another given: I hold his dear, and mine he cannot miss, There never was a better bargain driven: My true love hath my heart, and I have his.

His heart in me keeps him and me in one, My heart in him his thoughts and senses guides: He loves my heart, for once it was his own, I cherish his because in me it bides: My true love hath my heart, and I have his.

_89._ _Song_

Who hath his fancy pleasèd With fruits of happy sight, Let here his eyes be raisèd On Nature's sweetest light; A light which doth dissever And yet unite the eyes, A light which, dying never, Is cause the looker dies.

She never dies, but lasteth In life of lover's heart; He ever dies that wasteth In love his chiefest part: Thus is her life still guarded In never-dying faith; Thus is his death rewarded, Since she lives in his death.

Look then, and die! The pleasure Doth answer well the pain: Small loss of mortal treasure, Who may immortal gain! Immortal be her graces, Immortal is her mind; They, fit for heavenly places-- This, heaven in it doth bind.

But eyes these beauties see not, Nor sense that grace descries; Yet eyes deprivèd be not From sight of her fair eyes-- Which, as of inward glory They are the outward seal, So may they live still sorry, Which die not in that weal.

But who hath fancies pleasèd With fruits of happy sight, Let here his eyes be raisèd On Nature's sweetest light!

_90._ _Voices at the Window_

Who is it that, this dark night, _Underneath my window plaineth?_ It is one who from thy sight Being, ah, exiled, disdaineth Every other vulgar light.

Why, alas, and are you he? _Be not yet those fancies changèd?_ Dear, when you find change in me, Though from me you be estrangèd, Let my change to ruin be.

Well, in absence this will die: _Leave to see, and leave to wonder._ Absence sure will help, if I Can learn how myself to sunder From what in my heart doth lie.

But time will these thoughts remove; _Time doth work what no man knoweth._ Time doth as the subject prove: With time still the affection groweth In the faithful turtle-dove.

What if you new beauties see? _Will not they stir new affection?_ I will think they pictures be (Image-like, of saints' perfection) Poorly counterfeiting thee.

But your reason's purest light _Bids you leave such minds to nourish._ Dear, do reason no such spite! Never doth thy beauty flourish More than in my reason's sight.

_90._ leave] cease.

_91._ _Philomela_

The Nightingale, as soon as April bringeth Unto her rested sense a perfect waking, While late-bare Earth, proud of new clothing, springeth, Sings out her woes, a thorn her song-book making; And mournfully bewailing, Her throat in tunes expresseth What grief her breast oppresseth, For Tereus' force on her chaste will prevailing.

O Philomela fair, O take some gladness _That here is juster cause of plaintful sadness!_ _Thine earth now springs, mine fadeth;_ _Thy thorn without, my thorn my heart invadeth._

Alas! she hath no other cause of anguish But Tereus' love, on her by strong hand wroken; Wherein she suffering, all her spirits languish, Full womanlike complains her will was broken But I, who, daily craving, Cannot have to content me, Have more cause to lament me, Since wanting is more woe than too much having.

O Philomela fair, O take some gladness _That here is juster cause of plaintful sadness!_ _Thine earth now springs, mine fadeth;_ _Thy thorn without, my thorn my heart invadeth._

_92._ _The Highway_

Highway, since you my chief Parnassus be, And that my Muse, to some ears not unsweet, Tempers her words to trampling horses' feet More oft than to a chamber-melody,-- Now blessèd you bear onward blessèd me To her, where I my heart, safe-left, shall meet; My Muse and I must you of duty greet With thanks and wishes, wishing thankfully; Be you still fair, honour'd by public heed; By no encroachment wrong'd, nor time forgot; Nor blamed for blood, nor shamed for sinful deed; And that you know I envy you no lot Of highest wish, I wish you so much bliss, Hundreds of years you Stella's feet may kiss!

_93._ _His Lady's Cruelty_

With how sad steps, O moon, thou climb'st the skies! How silently, and with how wan a face! What! may it be that even in heavenly place That busy archer his sharp

arrows tries? Sure, if that long-with-love-acquainted eyes Can judge of love, thou feel’st a lover’s case: I read it in thy looks; thy languish’d grace To me, that feel the like, thy state descries. Then, even of fellowship, O Moon, tell me, Is constant love deem’d there but want of wit? Are beauties there as proud as here they be? Do they above love to be loved, and yet Those lovers scorn whom that love doth possess? Do they call ‘virtue’ there--ungratefulness?

_94._ _Sleep_

Come, Sleep; O Sleep! the certain knot of peace, The baiting-place of wit, the balm of woe, The poor man’s wealth, the prisoner’s release, Th’ indifferent judge between the high and low; With shield of proof shield me from out the prease Of those fierce darts Despair at me doth throw: O make in me those civil wars to cease; I will good tribute pay, if thou do so. Take thou of me smooth pillows, sweetest bed, A chamber deaf to noise and blind of light, A rosy garland and a weary head; And if these things, as being thine by right, Move not thy heavy grace, thou shalt in me, Livelier than elsewhere, Stella’s image see.

_94._ prease] press.

_95._ _Splendidis longum valedico Nugis_

Leave me, O Love, which reachest but to dust, And thou, my mind, aspire to higher things! Grow rich in that which never taketh rust: Whatever fades, but fading pleasure brings. Draw in thy beams, and humble all thy might To that sweet yoke where lasting freedoms be; Which breaks the clouds and opens forth the light That doth both shine and give us sight to see. O take fast hold! let that light be thy guide In this small course which birth draws out to death, And think how evil becometh him to slide Who seeketh Heaven, and comes of heavenly breath. Then farewell, world! thy uttermost I see: Eternal Love, maintain thy life in me!

FULKE GREVILLE, LORD BROOKE

1554-1628

_96._ _Myra_

I, with whose colours Myra dress’d her head, I, that ware posies of her own hand-making, I, that mine own name in the chimneys read By Myra finely wrought ere I was waking: Must I look on, in hope time coming may With change bring back my turn again to play?

I, that on Sunday at the church-stile found A garland sweet with true-love-knots in flowers, Which I to wear about mine arms was bound That each of us might know that all was ours: Must I lead now an idle life in wishes, And follow Cupid for his loaves and fishes?

_96._ chimneys] _cheminées_, chimney-screens of tapestry work.

I, that did wear the ring her mother left, I, for whose love she gloried to be blamèd, I, with whose eyes her eyes committed theft, I, who did make her blush when I was

namèd: Must I lose ring, flowers, blush, theft, and go naked, Watching with sighs till dead love be awakèd?

Was it for this that I might Myra see Washing the water with her beauty's white? Yet would she never write her love to me. Thinks wit of change when thoughts are in delight? Mad girls may safely love as they may leave; No man can _print_ a kiss: lines may deceive.

_96._ deceive] betray.

THOMAS LODGE

1556?-1625

_97._ _Rosalind's Madrigal_

Love in my bosom like a bee Doth suck his sweet: Now with his wings he plays with me, Now with his feet. Within mine eyes he makes his nest, His bed amidst my tender breast; My kisses are his daily feast, And yet he robs me of my rest: Ah! wanton, will ye?

And if I sleep, then percheth he With pretty flight, And makes his pillow of my knee The livelong night. Strike I my lute, he tunes the string; He music plays if so I sing; He lends me every lovely thing, Yet cruel he my heart doth sting: Whist, wanton, still ye!

Else I with roses every day Will whip you hence, And bind you, when you long to play, For your offence. I'll shut mine eyes to keep you in; I'll make you fast it for your sin; I'll count your power not worth a pin. --Alas! what hereby shall I win If he gainsay me?

What if I beat the wanton boy With many a rod? He will repay me with annoy, Because a god. Then sit thou safely on my knee; Then let thy bower my bosom be; Lurk in mine eyes, I like of thee; O Cupid, so thou pity me, Spare not, but play thee!

_98._ _Phillis_ I

My Phillis hath the morning sun At first to look upon her; And Phillis hath morn-waking birds Her risings still to honour. My Phillis hath prime-feather'd flowers, That smile when she treads on them; And Phillis hath a gallant flock, That leaps since she doth own them. But Phillis hath too hard a heart, Alas that she should have it! It yields no mercy to desert, Nor grace to those that crave it.

_99._ _Phillis_ 2

Love guards the roses of thy lips And flies about them like a bee; If I approach he forward skips, And if I kiss he stingeth me.

Love in thine eyes doth build his bower, And sleeps within their pretty shine; And if I look the boy will lower, And from their orbs shoot shafts divine.

Love works thy heart within his fire, And in my tears doth firm the same; And if I tempt it will retire, And of my plaints doth make a game.

Love, let me cull her choicest flowers; And pity me, and calm her eye; Make soft her heart, dissolve her lowers Then will I praise thy deity.

But if thou do not, Love, I'll truly serve her In spite of thee, and by firm faith deserve her.

_100._ _Rosaline_

Like to the clear in highest sphere Where all imperial glory shines, Of selfsame colour is her hair Whether unfolded or in twines: Heigh ho, fair Rosaline! Her eyes are sapphires set in snow, Resembling heaven by every wink; The gods do fear whenas they glow, And I do tremble when I think Heigh ho, would she were mine!

Her cheeks are like the blushing cloud That beautifies Aurora's face, Or like the silver crimson shroud That Phœbus' smiling looks doth grace. Heigh ho, fair Rosaline! Her lips are like two budded roses Whom ranks of lilies neighbour nigh, Within whose bounds she balm encloses Apt to entice a deity: Heigh ho, would she were mine!

Her neck like to a stately tower Where Love himself imprison'd lies, To watch for glances every hour From her divine and sacred eyes: Heigh ho, fair Rosaline! Her paps are centres of delight, Her breasts are orbs of heavenly frame, Where Nature moulds the dew of light To feed perfection with the same: Heigh ho, would she were mine!

With orient pearl, with ruby red, With marble white, with sapphire blue, Her body every way is fed, Yet soft to touch and sweet in view: Heigh ho, fair Rosaline! Nature herself her shape admires; The gods are wounded in her sight; And Love forsakes his heavenly fires And at her eyes his brand doth light: Heigh ho, would she were mine!

Then muse not, Nymphs, though I bemoan The absence of fair Rosaline, Since for a fair there's fairer none, Nor for her virtues so divine: Heigh ho, fair Rosaline! Heigh ho, my heart! would God that she were mine!

GEORGE PEELE

1558?-97

_101._ _Fair and Fair_

Œnone. Fair and fair, and twice so fair, As fair as any may be; The fairest shepherd on our green, A love for any lady.

Paris. Fair and fair, and twice so fair, As fair as any may be; Thy love is fair for thee alone And for no other lady.

Œnone. My love is fair, my love is gay, As fresh as bin the flowers in May And of my love my roundelay, My merry, merry, merry roundelay, Concludes with Cupid's curse,-- 'They that do change old love for new Pray gods they change for worse!' _Ambo Simul._ They that do change old love for new, Pray gods they change for worse!

Œnone. Fair and fair, etc. _Paris._ Fair and fair, etc. Thy love is fair, etc. _Œnone._ My love can pipe, my love can sing, My love can many a pretty thing, And of his lovely praises ring My merry, merry, merry roundelays Amen to Cupid's curse,-- 'They that do change,' etc. _Paris._ They that do change, etc. _Ambo._ Fair and fair, etc.

_102._ _A Farewell to Arms_

(TO QUEEN ELIZABETH)

His golden locks Time hath to silver turn'd; O Time too swift, O swiftness never ceasing! His youth 'gainst time and age hath ever spurn'd, But spurn'd in vain; youth waneth by increasing: Beauty, strength, youth, are flowers but fading seen; Duty, faith, love, are roots, and ever green.

His helmet now shall make a hive for bees; And, lovers' sonnets turn'd to holy psalms, A man-at-arms must now serve on his knees, And feed on prayers, which are Age his alms: But though from court to cottage he depart, His Saint is sure of his unspotted heart.

And when he saddest sits in homely cell, He'll teach his swains this carol for a song,-- 'Blest be the hearts that wish my sovereign well, Curst be the souls that think her any wrong.' Goddess, allow this agèd man his right To be your beadsman now that was your knight.

ROBERT GREENE

1560-92

_103._ _Samela_

Like to Diana in her summer weed, Girt with a crimson robe of brightest dye, Goes fair Samela. Whiter than be the flocks that straggling feed When wash'd by Arethusa faint they lie, Is fair Samela. As fair Aurora in her morning grey, Deck'd with the ruddy glister of her love Is fair Samela; Like lovely Thetis on a calmèd day Whenas her brightness Neptune's fancy move, Shines fair Samela.

Her tresses gold, her eyes like glassy streams, Her teeth are pearl, the breasts are ivory Of fair Samela; Her cheeks like rose and lily yield forth gleams; Her brows bright arches framed of ebony. Thus fair Samela Passeth fair Venus in her bravest hue, And Juno in the show of majesty (For she's Samela!), Pallas in wit,--all three, if you well view, For beauty, wit, and matchless dignity, Yield to Samela.

_104._ _Fawnia_

Ah! were she pitiful as she is fair, Or but as mild as she is seeming so, Then were my hopes greater than my despair, Then all the world were heaven, nothing woe. Ah! were her heart relenting as her hand, That seems to melt even with the mildest touch, Then knew I where to seat me in a land Under wide heavens, but yet there is not such. So as she shows she seems the budding rose, Yet sweeter far than is an earthly

flower; Sovran of beauty, like the spray she grows; Compass'd she is with thorns and canker'd flower. Yet were she willing to be pluck'd and worn, She would be gather'd, though she grew on thorn.

Ah! when she sings, all music else be still, For none must be comparèd to her note; Ne'er breathed such glee from Philomela's bill, Nor from the morning-singer's swelling throat. Ah! when she riseth from her blissful bed She comforts all the world as doth the sun, And at her sight the night's foul vapour's fled; When she is set the gladsome day is done. O glorious sun, imagine me the west, Shine in my arms, and set thou in my breast!

_105._ _Sephestia's Lullaby_

Weep not, my wanton, smile upon my knee; When thou art old there's grief enough for thee. Mother's wag, pretty boy, Father's sorrow, father's joy; When thy father first did see Such a boy by him and me, He was glad, I was woe; Fortune changèd made him so, When he left his pretty boy, Last his sorrow, first his joy.

Weep not, my wanton, smile upon my knee; When thou art old there's grief enough for thee. Streaming tears that never stint, Like pearl-drops from a flint, Fell by course from his eyes, That one another's place supplies; Thus he grieved in every part, Tears of blood fell from his heart, When he left his pretty boy, Father's sorrow, father's joy.

Weep not, my wanton, smile upon my knee; When thou art old there's grief enough for thee. The wanton smiled, father wept, Mother cried, baby leapt; More he crow'd, more we cried, Nature could not sorrow hide: He must go, he must kiss Child and mother, baby bliss, For he left his pretty boy, Father's sorrow, father's joy.

Weep not, my wanton, smile upon my knee, When thou art old there's grief enough for thee.

ALEXANDER HUME

1560-1609

_106._ _A Summer Day_

O perfect Light, which shaid away The darkness from the light, And set a ruler o'er the day, Another o'er the night--

Thy glory, when the day forth flies, More vively doth appear Than at mid day unto our eyes The shining sun is clear.

The shadow of the earth anon Removes and drawis by, While in the East, when it is gone, Appears a clearer sky.

Which soon perceive the little larks, The lapwing and the snipe, And tune their songs, like Nature's clerks, O'er meadow, muir, and stripe.

Our hemisphere is polisht clean, And lighten'd more and more, While everything is clearly seen Which seemit dim before:

Except the glistering astres bright, Which all the night were clear, Offuskit with a greater light No longer do appear.

shaid] parted. stripe] rill. offuskit] darkened.

The golden globe incontinent Sets up his shining head, And o’er the earth and firmament Displays his beams abread.

For joy the birds with boulden throats Against his visage sheen Take up their kindly musick notes In woods and gardens green.

The dew upon the tender crops, Like pearlis white and round, Or like to melted silver drops, Refreshis all the ground.

The misty reek, the clouds of rain, From tops of mountains skails, Clear are the highest hills and plain, The vapours take the vales.

The ample heaven of fabrick sure In cleanness does surpass The crystal and the silver pure, Or clearest polisht glass.

The time so tranquil is and still That nowhere shall ye find, Save on a high and barren hill, An air of peeping wind.

All trees and simples, great and small, That balmy leaf do bear, Than they were painted on a wall No more they move or steir.

boulden] swollen. sheen] bright. skails] clears. simples] herbs.

Calm is the deep and purple sea, Yea, smoother than the sand; The waves that weltering wont to be Are stable like the land.

So silent is the cessile air That every cry and call The hills and dales and forest fair Again repeats them all.

The flourishes and fragrant flowers, Through Phoebus’ fostering heat, Refresht with dew and silver showers Cast up an odour sweet.

The cloggit busy humming bees, That never think to drone, On flowers and flourishes of trees Collect their liquor brown.

The Sun, most like a speedy post With ardent course ascends; The beauty of the heavenly host Up to our zenith tends.

The burning beams down from his face So fervently can beat, That man and beast now seek a place To save them from the heat.

The herds beneath some leafy tree Amidst the flowers they lie; The stable ships upon the sea Tend up their sails to dry.

cessile] yielding, ceasing. flourishes] blossoms.

With gilded eyes and open wings The cock his courage shows; With claps of joy his breast he dings, And twenty times he crows.

The dove with whistling wings so blue The winds can fast collect; Her purple pens turn many a hue Against the sun direct.

Now noon is went; gone is midday, The heat doth slake at last; The sun descends down West away, For three of clock is past.

The rayons of the sun we see Diminish in their strength; The shade of every tower and tree Extendit is in length.

Great is the calm, for everywhere The wind is setting down; The reek throws right up in the air From every tower and town.

The gloming comes; the day is spent; The sun goes out of sight; And painted is the occident With purple sanguine bright.

Our west horizon circular From time the sun be set Is all with rubies, as it were, Or roses red o'erfret.

What pleasure were to walk and see, Endlong a river clear, The perfect form of every tree Within the deep appear.

O then it were a seemly thing, While all is still and calm, The praise of God to play and sing With cornet and with shalm!

All labourers draw home at even, And can to other say, Thanks to the gracious God of heaven, Which sent this summer day.

GEORGE CHAPMAN

1560-1634

_107._ _Bridal Song_

O come, soft rest of cares! come, Night! Come, naked Virtue's only tire, The reapèd harvest of the light Bound up in sheaves of sacred fire. Love calls to war: Sighs his alarms, Lips his swords are, The field his arms.

Come, Night, and lay thy velvet hand On glorious Day's outfacing face; And all thy crownèd flames command For torches to our nuptial grace. Love calls to war: Sighs his alarms, Lips his swords are, The field his arms.

ROBERT SOUTHWELL

1561-95

_108._ _Times go by Turns_

The loppèd tree in time may grow again, Most naked plants renew both fruit and flower; The sorest wight may find release of pain, The driest soil suck in some moist'ning shower; Times go by turns and chances change by course, From foul to fair, from better hap to worse.

The sea of Fortune doth not ever flow, She draws her favours to the lowest ebb; Her tides hath equal times to come and go, Her loom doth weave the fine and coarsest web; No joy so great but runneth to an end, No hap so hard but may in fine amend.

Not always fall of leaf nor ever spring, No endless night yet not eternal day; The saddest birds a season find to sing, The roughest storm a calm may soon allay: Thus with succeeding turns God tempereth all, That man may hope to rise, yet fear to fall.

A chance may win that by mischance was lost; The net that holds no great, takes little fish; In some things all, in all things none are crost, Few all they need, but none have all they wish; Unmeddled joys here to no man befall: Who least, hath some; who most, hath never all.

unmeddled] unmixed.

_109._ _The Burning Babe_

As I in hoary winter's night Stood shivering in the snow, Surprised I was with sudden heat Which made my heart to glow; And lifting up a fearful eye To view what fire was near, A pretty babe all burning bright Did in the air appear; Who, scorchèd with excessive heat, Such floods of tears did shed, As though His floods should quench His flames, Which with His tears were bred: 'Alas!' quoth He, 'but newly born In fiery heats I fry, Yet none approach to warm their hearts Or feel my fire but I!

'My faultless breast the furnace is; The fuel, wounding thorns; Love is the fire, and sighs the smoke; The ashes, shames and scorns; The fuel Justice layeth on, And Mercy blows the coals, The metal in this furnace wrought Are men's defilèd souls: For which, as now on fire I am To work them to their good, So will I melt into a bath, To wash them in my blood.' With this He vanish'd out of sight And swiftly shrunk away, And straight I callèd unto mind That it was Christmas Day.

HENRY CONSTABLE

1562?-1613?

_110._ _On the Death of Sir Philip Sidney_

Give pardon, blessèd soul, to my bold cries, If they, importune, interrupt thy song, Which now with joyful notes thou sing'st among The angel-quiristers of th' heavenly skies. Give pardon eke, sweet soul, to my slow eyes, That since I saw thee now it is so long, And yet the tears that unto thee belong To thee as yet they did not sacrifice. I did not know that thou wert dead before; I did not feel the grief I did sustain; The greater stroke astonisheth the more; Astonishment takes from us sense of pain; I stood amazed when others' tears begun, And now begin to weep when they have done.

SAMUEL DANIEL

1562-1619

_111._ _Love is a Sickness_

LOVE is a sickness full of woes, All remedies refusing; A plant that with most cutting grows, Most barren with best using. Why so? More we enjoy it, more it dies; If not enjoy'd, it sighing cries-- Heigh ho!

Love is a torment of the mind, A tempest everlasting; And Jove hath made it of a kind Not well, nor full nor fasting. Why so? More we enjoy it, more it dies; If not enjoy’d, it sighing cries-- Heigh ho!

_112._ _Ulysses and the Siren_

Siren. Come, worthy Greek! Ulysses, come, Possess these shores with me: The winds and seas are troublesome, And here we may be free. Here may we sit and view their toil That travail in the deep, And joy the day in mirth the while, And spend the night in sleep.

Ulysses. Fair Nymph, if fame or honour were To be attain’d with ease, Then would I come and rest me there, And leave such toils as these. But here it dwells, and here must I With danger seek it forth: To spend the time luxuriously Becomes not men of worth.

Siren. Ulysses, O be not deceived With that unreal name; This honour is a thing conceived, And rests on others’ fame: Begotten only to molest Our peace, and to beguile The best thing of our life--our rest, And give us up to toil.

Ulysses. Delicious Nymph, suppose there were No honour nor report, Yet manliness would scorn to wear The time in idle sport: For toil doth give a better touch To make us feel our joy, And ease finds tediousness as much As labour yields annoy.

Siren. Then pleasure likewise seems the shore Whereto tends all your toil, Which you forgo to make it more, And perish oft the while. Who may disport them diversely Find never tedious day, And ease may have variety As well as action may.

Ulysses. But natures of the noblest frame These toils and dangers please; And they take comfort in the same As much as you in ease; And with the thought of actions past Are recreated still: When Pleasure leaves a touch at last To show that it was ill.

Siren. That doth _Opinion_ only cause That’s out of _Custom_ bred, Which makes us many other laws Than ever _Nature_ did. No widows wail for our delights, Our sports are without blood; The world we see by warlike wights Receives more hurt than good.

Ulysses. But yet the state of things require These motions of unrest: And these great Spirits of high desire Seem born to turn them best: To purge the mischiefs that increase And all good order mar: For oft we see a wicked peace To be well changed for war.

Siren. Well, well, Ulysses, then I see I shall not have thee here: And therefore I will come to thee, And take my fortune there. I must be won, that cannot win, Yet lost were I not won; For beauty hath created been T’ undo, or be undone.

_113._ _Beauty, Time, and Love_

SONNETS. I

Fair is my Love and cruel as she’s fair; Her brow-shades frown, although her eyes are sunny, Her smiles are lightning, though her pride despair, And her disdains are gall, her favours honey: A modest maid, deck’d with a blush of honour, Whose feet do tread green paths of youth and love; The wonder of all eyes that look upon her, Sacred on earth, design’d a Saint above. Chastity and Beauty, which were deadly foes, Live reconcilèd friends within her brow; And had she Pity to conjoin with those, Then who had heard the plaints I utter now? For had she not been fair, and thus unkind, My Muse had slept, and none had known my mind.

II

My spotless love hovers with purest wings, About the temple of the proudest frame, Where blaze those lights, fairest of earthly things, Which clear our clouded world with brightest flame. My ambitious thoughts, confinèd in her face, Affect no honour but what she can give; My hopes do rest in limits of her grace; I weigh no comfort unless she relieve. For she, that can my heart imparadise, Holds in her fairest hand what dearest is; My Fortune’s wheel’s the circle of her eyes, Whose rolling grace deign once a turn of bliss. All my life’s sweet consists in her alone; So much I love the most Unloving one.

III

And yet I cannot reprehend the flight Or blame th’ attempt presuming so to soar; The mounting venture for a high delight Did make the honour of the fall the more. For who gets wealth, that puts not from the shore? Danger hath honour, great designs their fame; Glory doth follow, courage goes before; And though th’ event oft answers not the same-- Suffice that high attempts have never shame. The mean observer, whom base safety keeps, Lives without honour, dies without a name, And in eternal darkness ever sleeps.-- And therefore, _Delia_, ’tis to me no blot To have attempted, tho’ attain’d thee not.

IV

When men shall find thy flow’r, thy glory, pass, And thou with careful brow, sitting alone, Receivèd hast this message from thy glass, That tells the truth and says that _All is gone_; Fresh shalt thou see in me the wounds thou mad’st, Though spent thy flame, in me the heat remaining: I that have loved thee thus before thou fad’st-- My faith shall wax, when thou art in thy waning. The world shall find this miracle in me, That fire can burn when all the matter’s spent: Then what my faith hath been thyself shalt see, And that thou wast unkind thou may’st repent.-- Thou may’st repent that thou hast scorn’d my tears, When Winter snows upon thy sable hairs.

V

Beauty, sweet Love, is like the morning dew, Whose short refresh upon the tender green Cheers for a time, but till the sun doth show, And straight ’tis gone as it had

never been. Soon doth it fade that makes the fairest flourish, Short is the glory of the blushing rose; The hue which thou so carefully dost nourish, Yet which at length thou must be forced to lose. When thou, surcharged with burthen of thy years, Shalt bend thy wrinkles homeward to the earth; And that, in Beauty's Lease expired, appears The Date of Age, the Calends of our Death-- But ah, no more!--this must not be foretold, For women grieve to think they must be old.

VI

I must not grieve my Love, whose eyes would read Lines of delight, whereon her youth might smile; Flowers have time before they come to seed, And she is young, and now must sport the while. And sport, Sweet Maid, in season of these years, And learn to gather flowers before they wither; And where the sweetest blossom first appears, Let Love and Youth conduct thy pleasures thither. Lighten forth smiles to clear the clouded air, And calm the tempest which my sighs do raise; Pity and smiles do best become the fair; Pity and smiles must only yield thee praise. Make me to say when all my griefs are gone, Happy the heart that sighed for such a one!

VII

Let others sing of Knights and Paladines In agèd accents and untimely words, Paint shadows in imaginary lines, Which well the reach of their high wit records: But I must sing of thee, and those fair eyes Authentic shall my verse in time to come; When yet th' unborn shall say, _Lo, where she lies!_ _Whose beauty made him speak, that else was dumb!_ These are the arcs, the trophies I erect, That fortify thy name against old age; And these thy sacred virtues must protect Against the Dark, and Time's consuming rage. Though th' error of my youth in them appear, Suffice, they show I lived, and loved thee dear.

MARK ALEXANDER BOYD

1563-1601

_114._ _Sonet_

Fra bank to bank, fra wood to wood I rin, Ourhailit with my feeble fantasie; Like til a leaf that fallis from a tree, Or til a reed ourblawin with the win.

Twa gods guides me: the ane of tham is blin, Yea and a bairn brocht up in vanitie; The next a wife ingenrit of the sea, And lichter nor a dauphin with her fin.

Unhappy is the man for evermair That tills the sand and sawis in the air; But twice unhappier is he, I lairn, That feidis in his hairt a mad desire, And follows on a woman throw the fire, Led by a blind and teachit by a bairn.

JOSHUA SYLVESTER

1563-1618

_115._ _Ubique_

Were I as base as is the lowly plain, And you, my Love, as high as heaven above, Yet should the thoughts of me, your humble swain, Ascend to heaven in honour of my love. Were I as high as heaven above the plain, And you, my Love, as humble and as low As are the deepest bottoms of the main, Wheresoe’er you were, with you my love should go. Were you the earth, dear Love, and I the skies, My love should shine on you like to the Sun, And look upon you with ten thousand eyes, Till heaven wax’d blind, and till the world were done. Wheresoe’er I am,--below, or else above you-- Wheresoe’er you are, my heart shall truly love you.

MICHAEL DRAYTON

1563-1631

_116._ _To His Coy Love_

I pray thee, leave, love me no more, Call home the heart you gave me! I but in vain that saint adore That can but will not save me. These poor half-kisses kill me quite-- Was ever man thus servèd? Amidst an ocean of delight For pleasure to be starvèd?

Show me no more those snowy breasts With azure riverets branchèd, Where, whilst mine eye with plenty feasts, Yet is my thirst not stanchèd; O Tantalus, thy pains ne’er tell! By me thou art prevented: ’Tis nothing to be plagued in Hell, But thus in Heaven tormented.

Clip me no more in those dear arms, Nor thy life’s comfort call me, O these are but too powerful charms, And do but more enthral me! But see how patient I am grown In all this coil about thee: Come, nice thing, let my heart alone, I cannot live without thee!

_117._ _The Parting_

Since there’s no help, come let us kiss and part-- Nay, I have done, you get no more of me; And I am glad, yea, glad with all my heart, That thus so cleanly I myself can free. Shake hands for ever, cancel all our vows, And when we meet at any time again, Be it not seen in either of our brows That we one jot of former love retain. Now at the last gasp of Love’s latest breath, When, his pulse failing, Passion speechless lies, When Faith is kneeling by his bed of death, And Innocence is closing up his eyes, --Now if thou wouldst, when all have given him over, From death to life thou might’st him yet recover.

_118._ _Sirena_

Near to the silver _Trent_ SIRENA dwelleth; She to whom Nature lent All that excelleth; By which the Muses late And the neat Graces Have for their greater state Taken their places; Twisting an anadem Wherewith to crown her, As it belong’d to them Most to renown her. _On thy bank,_ _In a rank,_ _Let thy swans sing her,_ _And with their music_ _Along let them bring her._

Tagus and _Pactolus_ Are to thee debtor, Nor for their gold to us Are they the better: Henceforth of all the rest Be thou the River Which, as the daintiest, Puts them down ever. For as my precious one O'er thee doth travel, She to pearl paragon Turneth thy gravel. _On thy bank ..._

Our mournful Philomel, That rarest tuner, Henceforth in Aperil Shall wake the sooner, And to her shall complain From the thick cover, Redoubling every strain Over and over: For when my Love too long Her chamber keepeth, As though it suffer'd wrong, The Morning weepeth. _On thy bank ..._

Oft have I seen the Sun, To do her honour, Fix himself at his noon To look upon her; And hath gilt every grove, Every hill near her, With his flames from above Striving to cheer her: And when she from his sight Hath herself turnèd, He, as it had been night, In clouds hath mournèd. _On thy bank ..._

The verdant meads are seen, When she doth view them, In fresh and gallant green Straight to renew them; And every little grass Broad itself spreadeth, Proud that this bonny lass Upon it treadeth: Nor flower is so sweet In this large cincture, But it upon her feet Leaveth some tincture. _On thy bank ..._

The fishes in the flood, When she doth angle, For the hook strive a-good Them to entangle; And leaping on the land, From the clear water, Their scales upon the sand Lavishly scatter; Therewith to pave the mould Whereon she passes, So herself to behold As in her glasses. _On thy bank ..._

When she looks out by night, The stars stand gazing, Like comets to our sight Fearfully blazing; As wond'ring at her eyes With their much brightness, Which so amaze the skies, Dimming their lightness. The raging tempests are calm When she speaketh, Such most delightsome balm From her lips breaketh. _On thy bank ..._

In all our _Brittany_ There's not a fairer, Nor can you fit any Should you compare her. Angels her eyelids keep, All hearts surprising; Which look whilst she doth sleep Like the sun's rising: She alone of her kind Knoweth true measure, And her unmatchèd mind Is heaven's treasure. _On thy bank ..._

Fair _Dove_ and _Darwen_ clear, Boast ye your beauties, To _Trent_ your mistress here Yet pay your duties: My Love was higher born Tow'rds the full fountains, Yet she doth moorland scorn And the _Peak_ mountains; Nor would she none should dream Where she abideth, Humble as is the stream Which by her slideth. _On thy bank ..._

Yet my poor rustic Muse Nothing can move her, Nor the means I can use, Though her true lover: Many a long winter's night Have I waked for her, Yet this my piteous plight Nothing can stir her. All thy sands, silver _Trent_, Down to the _Humber_, The sighs that I have spent Never can number. _On thy bank,_ _In a rank,_ _Let thy swans sing her,_ _And with their music_ _Along let them bring her._

_119._ _Agincourt_

Fair stood the wind for France When we our sails advance, Nor now to prove our chance Longer will tarry; But putting to the main, At Caux, the mouth of Seine, With all his martial train Landed King Harry.

And taking many a fort, Furnish’d in warlike sort, Marcheth tow’rds Agincourt In happy hour; Skirmishing day by day With those that stopp’d his way, Where the French gen’ral lay With all his power.

Which, in his height of pride, King Henry to deride, His ransom to provide Unto him sending; Which he neglects the while As from a nation vile, Yet with an angry smile Their fall portending.

And turning to his men, Quoth our brave Henry then, ‘Though they to one be ten Be not amazèd: Yet have we well begun; Battles so bravely won Have ever to the sun By fame been raisèd.

‘And for myself (quoth he) This my full rest shall be: England ne’er mourn for me Nor more esteem me: Victor I will remain Or on this earth lie slain, Never shall she sustain Loss to redeem me.

‘Poitiers and Cressy tell, When most their pride did swell, Under our swords they fell: No less our skill is Than when our grandsire great, Claiming the regal seat, By many a warlike feat Lopp’d the French lilies.’

The Duke of York so dread The eager vaward led; With the main Henry sped Among his henchmen. Excester had the rear, A braver man not there; O Lord, how hot they were On the false Frenchmen!

They now to fight are gone, Armour on armour shone, Drum now to drum did groan, To hear was wonder; That with the cries they make The very earth did shake: Trumpet to trumpet spake, Thunder to thunder.

Well it thine age became, O noble Erpingham, Which didst the signal aim To our hid forces! When from a meadow by, Like a storm suddenly The English archery Stuck the French horses.

With Spanish yew so strong, Arrows a cloth-yard long That like to serpents stung, Piercing the weather; None from his fellow starts, But playing manly parts, And like true English hearts Stuck close together.

When down their bows they threw, And forth their bilbos drew, And on the French they flew, Not one was tardy; Arms were from shoulders sent, Scalps to the teeth were rent, Down the French peasants went-- Our men were hardy.

This while our noble king, His broadsword brandishing,

bilbos] swords, from Bilboa.

Down the French host did ding As to o’erwhelm it; And many a deep wound lent, His arms with blood besprent, And many a cruel dent Bruisèd his helmet.

Gloster, that duke so good, Next of the royal blood, For famous England stood With his brave brother; Clarence, in steel so bright, Though but a maiden knight, Yet in that furious fight Scarce such another.

Warwick in blood did wade, Oxford the foe invade, And cruel slaughter made Still as they ran up; Suffolk his axe did ply, Beaumont and Willoughby Bare them right

doughtily, Ferrers and Fanhope.

Upon Saint Crispin’s Day Fought was this noble fray, Which fame did not delay To England to carry. O when shall English men With such acts fill a pen? Or England breed again Such a King Harry?

_120._ _To the Virginian Voyage_

You brave heroic minds Worthy your country’s name, That honour still pursue; Go and subdue! Whilst loitering hinds Lurk here at home with shame.

Britons, you stay too long: Quickly aboard bestow you, And with a merry gale Swell your stretch’d sail With vows as strong As the winds that blow you.

Your course securely steer, West and by south forth keep! Rocks, lee-shores, nor shoals When Eolus scowls You need not fear; So absolute the deep.

And cheerfully at sea Success you still entice To get the pearl and gold, And ours to hold _Virginia,_ Earth’s only paradise.

Where nature hath in store Fowl, venison, and fish, And the fruitfull’st soil Without your toil Three harvests more, All greater than your wish.

And the ambitious vine Crowns with his purple mass The cedar reaching high To kiss the sky, The cypress, pine, And useful sassafras.

To whom the Golden Age Still nature’s laws doth give, No other cares attend, But them to defend From winter’s rage, That long there doth not live.

When as the luscious smell Of that delicious land Above the seas that flows The clear wind throws, Your hearts to swell Approaching the dear strand;

In kenning of the shore (Thanks to God first given) O you the happiest men, Be frolic then! Let cannons roar, Frighting the wide heaven.

And in regions far, Such heroes bring ye forth As those from whom we came; And plant our name Under that star Not known unto our North.

And as there plenty grows Of laurel everywhere-- Apollo’s sacred tree-- You it may see A poet’s brows To crown, that may sing there.

Thy _Voyages_ attend, Industrious Hakluyt, Whose reading shall inflame Men to seek fame, And much commend To after times thy wit.

CHRISTOPHER MARLOWE

1564-93

_121._ _The Passionate Shepherd to His Love_

Come live with me and be my Love, And we will all the pleasures prove That hills and valleys, dales and fields Or woods or steepy mountain yields.

And we will sit upon the rocks, And see the shepherds feed their flocks By shallow rivers, to whose falls Melodious birds sing madrigals.

And I will make thee beds of roses And a thousand fragrant posies; A cap of flowers, and a kirtle Embroider’d all with leaves of myrtle.

A gown made of the finest wool Which from our pretty lambs we pull; Fair-linèd slippers for the cold, With buckles of the purest gold.

A belt of straw and ivy-buds With coral clasps and amber studs: And if these pleasures may thee move, Come live with me and be my Love.

The shepherd swains shall dance and sing For thy delight each May morning: If these delights thy mind may move, Then live with me and be my Love.

_122._ _Her Reply_

(WRITTEN BY SIR WALTER RALEIGH)

If all the world and love were young, And truth in every shepherd’s tongue, These pretty pleasures might me move To live with thee and be thy Love.

But Time drives flocks from field to fold; When rivers rage and rocks grow cold; And Philomel becometh dumb; The rest complains of cares to come.

The flowers do fade, and wanton fields To wayward Winter reckoning yields: A honey tongue, a heart of gall, Is fancy’s spring, but sorrow’s fall.

Thy gowns, thy shoes, thy beds of roses, Thy cap, thy kirtle, and thy posies, Soon break, soon wither--soon forgotten, In folly ripe, in reason rotten.

Thy belt of straw and ivy-buds, Thy coral clasps and amber studs,-- All these in me no means can move To come to thee and be thy Love.

But could youth last, and love still breed, Had joys no date, nor age no need, Then these delights my mind might move To live with thee and be thy Love.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

1564-1616

_123._ _Silvia_

Who is Silvia? What is she? That all our swains commend her? Holy, fair, and wise is she; The heaven such grace did lend her, That she might admirèd be.

Is she kind as she is fair? For beauty lives with kindness: Love doth to her eyes repair, To help him of his blindness; And, being help’d, inhabits there.

Then to Silvia let us sing, That Silvia is excelling; She excels each mortal thing Upon the dull earth dwelling: To her let us garlands bring.

_124._ _The Blossom_

On a day--alack the day!-- Love, whose month is ever May, Spied a blossom passing fair Playing in the wanton air: Through the velvet leaves the wind All unseen ’gan passage find; That the lover, sick to death, Wish’d himself the heaven’s breath. Air,

quoth he, thy cheeks may blow; Air, would I might triumph so! But, alack, my hand is sworn Ne’er to pluck thee from thy thorn: Vow, alack, for youth unmeet; Youth so apt to pluck a sweet! Do not call it sin in me That I am forsworn for thee; Thou for whom e’en Jove would swear Juno but an Ethiop were; And deny himself for Jove, Turning mortal for thy love.

Spring and Winter

_125._ _i_

When daisies pied and violets blue, And lady-smocks all silver-white, And cuckoo-buds of yellow hue Do paint the meadows with delight, The cuckoo then, on every tree, Mocks married men; for thus sings he, Cuckoo! Cuckoo, cuckoo!--O word of fear, Unpleasing to a married ear!

When shepherds pipe on oaten straws, And merry larks are ploughmen’s clocks, When turtles tread, and rooks, and daws, And maidens bleach their summer smocks The cuckoo then, on every tree, Mocks married men; for thus sings he, Cuckoo! Cuckoo, cuckoo!--O word of fear, Unpleasing to a married ear!

_126._ _ii_

When icicles hang by the wall, And Dick the shepherd blows his nail, And Tom bears logs into the hall, And milk comes frozen home in pail, When blood is nipp’d, and ways be foul, Then nightly sings the staring owl, To-whit! To-who!--a merry note. While greasy Joan doth keel the pot.

When all aloud the wind doth blow, And coughing drowns the parson’s saw, And birds sit brooding in the snow, And Marian’s nose looks red and raw, When roasted crabs hiss in the bowl, Then nightly sings the staring owl, To-whit! To-who!--a merry note, While greasy Joan doth keel the pot.

_126._ keel] skim.

Fairy Land

_127._ _i_

Over hill, over dale, Thorough bush, thorough brier, Over park, over pale, Thorough flood, thorough fire, I do wander everywhere. Swifter than the moonè’s sphere; And I serve the fairy queen, To dew her orbs upon the green: The cowslips tall her pensioners be; In their gold coats spots you see; Those be rubies, fairy favours, In those freckles live their savours: I must go seek some dew-drops here, And hang a pearl in every cowslip’s ear.

_128._ _ii_

You spotted snakes with double tongue, Thorny hedgehogs, be not seen; Newts and blind-worms, do no wrong; Come not near our fairy queen.

Philomel, with melody, Sing in our sweet lullaby; Lulla, lulla, lullaby; lulla, lulla, lullaby! Never harm, Nor spell nor charm, Come our lovely lady nigh; So, good night, with lullaby.

Weaving spiders, come not here; Hence, you long-legg’d spinners, hence! Beetles black, approach not near; Worm nor snail, do no offence.

Philomel, with melody, Sing in our sweet lullaby; Lulla, lulla, lullaby; lulla, lulla, lullaby! Never harm. Nor spell nor charm, Come our lovely lady nigh; So, good night, with lullaby.

_129._ _iii_

Come unto these yellow sands, And then take hands: Court’sied when you have, and kiss’d,-- The wild waves whist,-- Foot it featly here and there; And, sweet sprites, the burthen bear. Hark, hark! Bow, wow, The watch-dogs bark. Bow, wow. Hark, hark! I hear The strain of strutting chanticleer Cry, Cock-a-diddle-dow!

_130._ _iv_

Where the bee sucks, there suck I: In a cowslip’s bell I lie; There I couch when owls do cry. On the bat’s back I do fly After summer merrily: Merrily, merrily, shall I live now, Under the blossom that hangs on the bough.

_131._ _v_

Full fathom five thy father lies; Of his bones are coral made; Those are pearls that were his eyes: Nothing of him that doth fade, But doth suffer a sea-change Into something rich and strange. Sea-nymphs hourly ring his knell: Ding-dong. Hark! now I hear them-- Ding-dong, bell!

_132._ _Love_

Tell me where is Fancy bred, Or in the heart or in the head? How begot, how nourishèd? Reply, reply. It is engender’d in the eyes, With gazing fed; and Fancy dies In the cradle where it lies. Let us all ring Fancy’s knell: I’ll begin it,--Ding, dong, bell. _All._ Ding, dong, bell.

_133._ _Sweet-and-Twenty_

O mistress mine, where are you roaming? O, stay and hear! your true love’s coming, That can sing both high and low: Trip no further, pretty sweeting; Journeys end in lovers meeting, Every wise man’s son doth know.

What is love? ’tis not hereafter; Present mirth hath present laughter; What’s to come is still unsure: In delay there lies no plenty; Then come kiss me, sweet-and-twenty! Youth’s a stuff will not endure.

_134._ _Dirge_

Come away, come away, death, And in sad cypres let me be laid; Fly away, fly away, breath; I am slain by a fair cruel maid. My shroud of white, stuck all with yew, O prepare it! My part of death, no one so true Did share it.

Not a flower, not a flower sweet, On my black coffin let there be strown; Not a friend, not a friend greet My poor corse, where my bones shall be thrown: A thousand thousand sighs to save, Lay me, O, where Sad true lover never find my grave To weep there!

_134._ cypres] crape.

_135._ _Under the Greenwood Tree_

Amiens sings:

Under the greenwood tree, Who loves to lie with me, And turn his merry note Unto the sweet bird’s throat, Come hither, come hither, come hither: Here shall he see No enemy But winter and rough weather.

Who doth ambition shun, And loves to live i’ the sun, Seeking the food he eats, And pleased with what he gets, Come hither, come hither, come hither: Here shall he see No enemy But winter and rough weather.

Jaques replies:

If it do come to pass That any man turn ass, Leaving his wealth and ease A stubborn will to please, Ducdamè, ducdamè, ducdamè: Here shall he see Gross fools as he, An if he will come to me.

_136._ _Blow blow, thou Winter Wind_

Blow, blow, thou winter wind, Thou art not so unkind As man’s ingratitude; Thy tooth is not so keen, Because thou art not seen, Although thy breath be rude. Heigh ho! sing, heigh ho! unto the green holly: Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly: Then heigh ho, the holly! This life is most jolly.

Freeze, freeze, thou bitter sky, That dost not bite so nigh As benefits forgot: Though thou the waters warp, Thy sting is not so sharp As friend remember’d not. Heigh ho! sing, heigh ho! unto the green holly: Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly: Then heigh ho, the holly! This life is most jolly.

_137._ _It was a Lover and his Lass_

It was a lover and his lass, With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino, That o’er the green corn-field did pass, In the spring time, the only pretty ring time, When birds do sing, hey ding a ding, ding; Sweet lovers love the spring.

Between the acres of the rye, With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino, These pretty country folks would lie, In the spring time, the only pretty ring time, When birds do sing, hey ding a ding, ding; Sweet lovers love the spring.

This carol they began that hour, With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino, How that life was but a flower In the spring time, the only pretty ring time, When birds do sing, hey ding a ding, ding; Sweet lovers love the spring.

And, therefore, take the present time With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino, For love is crownèd with the prime In the spring time, the only pretty ring time, When birds do sing, hey ding a ding, ding; Sweet lovers love the spring.

_138._ _Take, O take those Lips away_

Take, O take those lips away, That so sweetly were forsworn; And those eyes, the break of day, Lights that do mislead the morn! But my kisses bring again, Bring again; Seals of love, but seal’d in vain, Seal’d in vain!

_139._ _Aubade_

Hark! hark! the lark at heaven’s gate sings, And Phœbus ’gins arise, His steeds to water at those springs On chaliced flowers that lies; And winking Mary-buds begin To ope their golden eyes: With everything that pretty bin, My lady sweet, arise! Arise, arise!

_140._ _Fidele_

Fear no more the heat o’ the sun, Nor the furious winter’s rages; Thou thy worldly task hast done, Home art gone, and ta’en thy wages Golden lads and girls all must, As chimney-sweepers, come to dust.

Fear no more the frown o’ the great, Thou art past the tyrant’s stroke; Care no more to clothe and eat; To thee the reed is as the oak: The sceptre, learning, physic, must All follow this, and come to dust.

Fear no more the lightning-flash, Nor the all-dreaded thunder-stone; Fear not slander, censure rash; Thou hast finished joy and moan: All lovers young, all lovers must Consign to thee, and come to dust.

No exerciser harm thee! Nor no witchcraft charm thee! Ghost unlaid forbear thee! Nothing ill come near thee! Quiet consummation have; And renownèd be thy grave!

_141._ _Bridal Song_

Roses, their sharp spines being gone, Not royal in their smells alone, But in their hue; Maiden pinks, of odour faint, Daisies smell-less, yet most quaint, And sweet thyme true;

Primrose, firstborn child of Ver; Merry springtime’s harbinger, With her bells dim; Oxlips in their cradles growing, Marigolds on death-beds blowing, Larks’-heels trim;

All dear Nature’s children sweet Lie ’fore bride and bridegroom’s feet, Blessing their sense! Not an angel of the air, Bird melodious or bird fair, Be absent hence!

The crow, the slanderous cuckoo, nor The boding raven, nor chough hoar, Nor chattering pye, May on our bride-house perch or sing, Or with them any discord bring, But from it fly!

? or _John Fletcher_.

_142._ _Dirge of the Three Queens_

URNS and odours bring away! Vapours, sighs, darken the day! Our dole more deadly looks than dying; Balms and gums and heavy cheers, Sacred vials fill’d with tears, And clamours through the wild air flying!

Come, all sad and solemn shows, That are quick-eyed Pleasure’s foes! We convènt naught else but woes.

? or _John Fletcher_.

_142._ dole] lamentation. convent] summon.

_143._ _Orpheus_

Orpheus with his lute made trees And the mountain tops that freeze Bow themselves when he did sing: To his music plants and flowers Ever sprung; as sun and showers There had made a lasting spring.

Every thing that heard him play, Even the billows of the sea, Hung their heads and then lay by. In sweet music is such art, Killing care and grief of heart Fall asleep, or hearing, die.

? or _John Fletcher_.

_144._ _The Phœnix and the Turtle_

Let the bird of loudest lay On the sole Arabian tree, Herald sad and trumpet be, To whose sound chaste wings obey.

But thou shrieking harbinger, Foul precurrer of the fiend, Augur of the fever's end, To this troop come thou not near.

From this session interdict Every fowl of tyrant wing Save the eagle, feather'd king: Keep the obsequy so strict.

Let the priest in surplice white That defunctive music can, Be the death-divining swan, Lest the requiem lack his right.

And thou, treble-dated crow, That thy sable gender mak'st With the breath thou giv'st and tak'st, 'Mongst our mourners shalt thou go.

Here the anthem doth commence:-- Love and constancy is dead; Phœnix and the turtle fled In a mutual flame from hence.

So they loved, as love in twain Had the essence but in one; Two distincts, division none; Number there in love was slain.

can] knows.

Hearts remote, yet not asunder; Distance, and no space was seen 'Twixt the turtle and his queen: But in them it were a wonder.

So between them love did shine, That the turtle saw his right Flaming in the phœnix' sight; Either was the other's mine.

Property was thus appall'd, That the self was not the same; Single nature's double name Neither two nor one was call'd.

Reason, in itself confounded, Saw division grow together; To themselves yet either neither; Simple were so well compounded,

That it cried, 'How true a twain Seemeth this concordant one! Love hath reason, reason none If what parts can so remain.'

Whereupon it made this threne To the phœnix and the dove, Co-supremes and stars of love, As chorus to their tragic scene.

THRENOS

Beauty, truth, and rarity, Grace in all simplicity, Here enclosed in cinders lie.

Death is now the phœnix' nest; And the turtle's loyal breast To eternity doth rest,

Leaving no posterity: 'Twas not their infirmity, It was married chastity.

Truth may seem, but cannot be; Beauty brag, but 'tis not she; Truth and beauty buried be.

To this urn let those repair That are either true or fair; For these dead birds sigh a prayer.

Sonnets

_145._ _i_

Shall I compare thee to a Summer's day? Thou art more lovely and more temperate: Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May, And Summer's lease hath all too short a date: Sometime too hot the eye of heaven shines, And often is his gold complexion dimm'd; And every fair from fair sometime declines, By chance or nature's changing course untrimm'd: But thy eternal Summer shall not fade Nor lose possession of that fair thou owest; Nor shall Death brag thou wanderest in his shade, When in eternal lines to time thou growest: So long as men can breathe, or eyes can see, So long lives this, and this gives life to thee.

_146._ _ii_

When, in disgrace with Fortune and men's eyes, I all alone beweep my outcast state, And trouble deaf heaven with my bootless cries, And look upon myself, and curse my fate, Wishing me like to one more rich in hope, Featured like him, like him with friends possest, Desiring this man's art and that man's scope, With what I most enjoy contented least; Yet in these thoughts myself almost despising-- Haply I think on thee: and then my state, Like to the Lark at break of day arising From sullen earth, sings hymns at Heaven's gate; For thy sweet love rememb'red such wealth brings That then I scorn to change my state with Kings.

_147._ _iii_

When to the Sessions of sweet silent thought I summon up remembrance of things past, I sigh the lack of many a thing I sought, And with old woes new wail my dear time's waste: Then can I drown an eye, unused to flow, For precious friends hid in death's dateless night, And weep afresh love's long-since-cancell'd woe, And moan th' expense of many a vanish'd sight: Then can I grieve at grievances foregone, And heavily from woe to woe tell o'er The sad account of fore-bemoanèd moan, Which I new pay as if not paid before. But if the while I think on thee, dear friend, All losses are restored and sorrows end.

_148._ _iv_

Thy bosom is endearèd with all hearts Which I, by lacking, have supposèd dead; And there reigns Love, and all Love's loving parts, And all those friends which I thought burièd. How many a holy and obsequious tear Hath dear religious love stol'n from mine eye, As interest of the dead!--which now appear But things removed that

hidden in thee lie. Thou art the grave where buried love doth live. Hung with the trophies of my lovers gone. Who all their parts of me to thee did give: --That due of many now is thine alone: Their images I loved I view in thee, And thou, all they, hast all the all of me.

_149._ _v_

What is your substance, whereof are you made, That millions of strange shadows on you tend? Since every one hath, every one, one shade, And you, but one, can every shadow lend. Describe Adonis, and the counterfeit Is poorly imitated after you; On Helen's cheek all art of beauty set, And you in Grecian tires are painted new: Speak of the spring and foison of the year, The one doth shadow of your beauty show. The other as your bounty doth appear; And you in every blessèd shape we know. In all external grace you have some part, But you like none, none you, for constant heart.

_149._ foison] plenty.

_150._ _vi_

O how much more doth beauty beauteous seem By that sweet ornament which truth doth give! The Rose looks fair, but fairer we it deem For that sweet odour which doth in it live. The Canker-blooms have full as deep a dye As the perfumèd tincture of the Roses, Hang on such thorns, and play as wantonly When summer's breath their maskèd buds discloses: But--for their virtue only is their show-- They live unwoo'd and unrespected fade, Die to themselves. Sweet Roses do not so; Of their sweet deaths are sweetest odours made. And so of you, beauteous and lovely youth, When that shall vade, my verse distils your truth.

_151._ _vii_

Being your slave, what should I do but tend Upon the hours and times of your desire? I have no precious time at all to spend, Nor services to do, till you require. Nor dare I chide the world-without-end hour Whilst I, my sovereign, watch the clock for you, Nor think the bitterness of absence sour When you have bid your servant once adieu; Nor dare I question with my jealous thought Where you may be, or your affairs suppose, But, like a sad slave, stay and think of nought Save, where you are how happy you make those! So true a fool is love, that in your Will, Though you do any thing, he thinks no ill.

_152._ _viii_

That time of year thou may'st in me behold When yellow leaves, or none, or few, do hang Upon those boughs which shake against the cold-- Bare ruin'd choirs where late the sweet birds sang. In me thou see'st the twilight of such day As after Sunset fadeth in the West, Which by and by black night doth take away, Death's second self, that seals up all in rest. In me thou see'st the glowing of such fire That on the ashes of his youth doth lie, As the death-bed whereon it must expire, Consumed with that which it was nourish'd by. This thou perceiv'st, which makes thy love more strong To love that well which thou must leave ere long.

_153._ _ix_

Farewell! thou art too dear for my possessing, And like enough thou know’st thy estimate: The charter of thy worth gives thee releasing; My bonds in thee are all determinate. For how do I hold thee but by thy granting? And for that riches where is my deserving? The cause of this fair gift in me is wanting, And so my patent back again is swerving. Thyself thou gav’st, thy own worth then not knowing, Or me, to whom thou gav’st it, else mistaking; So thy great gift, upon misprision growing, Comes home again, on better judgment making. Thus have I had thee, as a dream doth flatter In sleep a King; but waking, no such matter.

_154._ _x_

Then hate me when thou wilt; if ever, now; Now, while the world is bent my deeds to cross. Join with the spite of fortune, make me bow, And do not drop in for an after loss: Ah! do not, when my heart hath ’scaped this sorrow, Come in the rearward of a conquered woe; Give not a windy night a rainy morrow, To linger out a purposed overthrow. If thou wilt leave me, do not leave me last, When other petty griefs have done their spite, But in the onset come: so shall I taste At first the very worst of fortune’s might; And other strains of woe, which now seem woe, Compared with loss of thee will not seem so!

_155._ _xi_

They that have power to hurt and will do none, That do not do the thing they most do show, Who, moving others, are themselves as stone, Unmovèd, cold, and to temptation slow-- They rightly do inherit heaven’s graces, And husband nature’s riches from expense; They are the Lords and owners of their faces, Others, but stewards of their excellence. The summer’s flower is to the summer sweet, Though to itself it only live and die; But if that flower with base infection meet, The basest weed outbraves his dignity: For sweetest things turn sourest by their deeds; Lilies that fester smell far worse than weeds.

_156._ _xii_

How like a Winter hath my absence been From thee, the pleasure of the fleeting year! What freezings have I felt, what dark days seen, What old December’s bareness everywhere! And yet this time removed was summer’s time; The teeming Autumn, big with rich increase, Bearing the wanton burden of the prime Like widow’d wombs after their Lord’s decease: Yet this abundant issue seem’d to me But hope of orphans and unfather’d fruit; For Summer and his pleasures wait on thee, And, thou away, the very birds are mute: Or if they sing, ’tis with so dull a cheer That leaves look pale, dreading the Winter’s near.

_157._ _xiii_

From you have I been absent in the spring, When proud-pied April, dress’d in all his trim, Hath put a spirit of youth in everything, That heavy Saturn laugh’d and leap’d with him. Yet nor the lays of birds, nor the sweet smell Of different flowers in odour and in hue, Could make me any summer’s story tell, Or from their proud lap pluck them where they grew; Nor did I wonder at the Lily’s white, Nor praise the deep vermilion in the Rose; They were but sweet, but figures of delight, Drawn after

you, you pattern of all those. Yet seem’d it Winter still, and, you away, As with your shadow I with these did play.

_158._ _xiv_

My love is strengthen’d, though more weak in seeming; I love not less, though less the show appear: That love is merchandised whose rich esteeming The owner’s tongue doth publish everywhere. Our love was new, and then but in the spring, When I was wont to greet it with my lays; As Philomel in summer’s front doth sing And stops her pipe in growth of riper days: Not that the summer is less pleasant now Than when her mournful hymns did hush the night, But that wild music burthens every bough, And sweets grown common lose their dear delight. Therefore, like her, I sometime hold my tongue, Because I would not dull you with my song.

_159._ _xv_

To me, fair friend, you never can be old; For as you were when first your eye I eyed, Such seems your beauty still. Three Winters cold Have from the forests shook three Summers’ pride; Three beauteous springs to yellow Autumn turn’d In process of the seasons have I seen, Three April perfumes in three hot Junes burn’d, Since first I saw you fresh, which yet are green, Ah! yet doth beauty, like a dial-hand, Steal from his figure, and no pace perceived; So your sweet hue, which methinks still doth stand, Hath motion, and mine eye may be deceived: For fear of which, hear this, thou age unbred: Ere you were born was beauty’s summer dead.

_160._ _xvi_

When in the chronicle of wasted time I see descriptions of the fairest wights, And beauty making beautiful old rime In praise of Ladies dead and lovely Knights; Then, in the blazon of sweet beauty’s best, Of hand, of foot, of lip, of eye, of brow, I see their antique pen would have exprest Even such a beauty as you master now. So all their praises are but prophecies Of this our time, all you prefiguring; And for they look’d but with divining eyes, They had not skill enough your worth to sing: For we, which now behold these present days, Have eyes to wonder, but lack tongues to praise.

_161._ _xvii_

O never say that I was false of heart, Though absence seem’d my flame to qualify! As easy might I from myself depart, As from my soul, which in thy breast doth lie: That is my home of love; if I have ranged, Like him that travels I return again, Just to the time, not with the time exchanged, So that myself bring water for my stain. Never believe, though in my nature reign’d All frailties that besiege all kinds of blood, That it could so prepost’rously be stain’d, To leave for nothing all thy sum of good: For nothing this wide Universe I call, Save thou, my Rose; in it thou art my all.

_162._ _xviii_

Let me not to the marriage of true minds Admit impediments. Love is not love Which alters when it alteration finds, Or bends with the remover to remove: O, no! it is an ever-fixèd mark, That looks on tempests and is never shaken; It is the star to every wand’ring bark, Whose worth’s unknown, although his height be taken. Love’s

not Time’s fool, though rosy lips and cheeks Within his bending sickle’s compass come; Love alters not with his brief hours and weeks, But bears it out even to the edge of doom:-- If this be error and upon me proved, I never writ, nor no man ever loved.

_163._ _xix_

Th’ expense of Spirit in a waste of shame Is lust in action; and till action, lust Is perjured, murderous, bloody, full of blame, Savage, extreme, rude, cruel, not to trust; Enjoy’d no sooner but despisèd straight; Past reason hunted; and, no sooner had, Past reason hated, as a swallow’d bait On purpose laid to make the taker mad: Mad in pursuit, and in possession so; Had, having, and in quest to have, extreme; A bliss in proof, and proved, a very woe; Before, a joy proposed; behind, a dream. All this the world well knows; yet none knows well To shun the heaven that leads men to this hell.

_164._ _xx_

Poor soul, the centre of my sinful earth-- My sinful earth these rebel powers array-- Why dost thou pine within and suffer dearth, Painting thy outward walls so costly gay? Why so large cost, having so short a lease, Dost thou upon thy fading mansion spend? Shall worms, inheritors of this excess, Eat up thy charge? Is this thy body’s end? Then, soul, live thou upon thy servant’s loss, And let that pine to aggravate thy store; Buy terms divine in selling hours of dross; Within be fed, without be rich no more: So shalt thou feed on Death, that feeds on men; And Death once dead, there’s no more dying then.

RICHARD ROWLANDS

1565-1630?

_165._ _Lullaby_

Upon my lap my sovereign sits And sucks upon my breast; Meantime his love maintains my life And gives my sense her rest. Sing lullaby, my little boy, Sing lullaby, mine only joy!

When thou hast taken thy repast, Repose, my babe, on me; So may thy mother and thy nurse Thy cradle also be. Sing lullaby, my little boy, Sing lullaby, mine only joy!

I grieve that duty doth not work All that my wishing would; Because I would not be to thee But in the best I should. Sing lullaby, my little boy, Sing lullaby, mine only joy!

Yet as I am, and as I may, I must and will be thine, Though all too little for thyself Vouchsafing to be mine. Sing lullaby, my little boy, Sing lullaby, mine only joy!

THOMAS NASHE

1567-1601

_166._ _Spring_

Spring, the sweet Spring, is the year’s pleasant king; Then blooms each thing, then maids dance in a ring, Cold doth not sting, the pretty birds do sing-- Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo!

The palm and may make country houses gay, Lambs frisk and play, the shepherds pipe all day, And we hear aye birds tune this merry lay-- Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo!

The fields breathe sweet, the daisies kiss our feet, Young lovers meet, old wives a-sunning sit, In every street these tunes our ears do greet-- Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo! Spring, the sweet Spring!

_167._ _In Time of Pestilence_

1593

ADIEU, farewell earth’s bliss! This world uncertain is: Fond are life’s lustful joys, Death proves them all but toys. None from his darts can fly; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

Rich men, trust not in wealth, Gold cannot buy you health; Physic himself must fade; All things to end are made; The plague full swift goes by; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

Beauty is but a flower Which wrinkles will devour; Brightness falls from the air; Queens have died young and fair; Dust hath closed Helen’s eye; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

Strength stoops unto the grave, Worms feed on Hector brave; Swords may not fight with fate; Earth still holds ope her gate; _Come, come!_ the bells do cry; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

Wit with his wantonness Tasteth death’s bitterness; Hell’s executioner Hath no ears for to hear What vain art can reply; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

Haste therefore each degree To welcome destiny; Heaven is our heritage, Earth but a player’s stage. Mount we unto the sky; I am sick, I must die-- _Lord, have mercy on us!_

THOMAS CAMPION

1567?-1619

_168._ _Cherry-Ripe_

There is a garden in her face Where roses and white lilies blow; A heavenly paradise is that place, Wherein all pleasant fruits do flow: There cherries grow which none may buy Till ‘Cherry-ripe’ themselves do cry.

Those cherries fairly do enclose Of orient pearl a double row, Which when her lovely laughter shows, They look like rose-buds fill’d with snow; Yet them nor peer nor prince can buy Till ‘Cherry-ripe’ themselves do cry.

Her eyes like angels watch them still; Her brows like bended bows do stand, Threat'ning with piercing frowns to kill All that attempt with eye or hand Those sacred cherries to come nigh, Till 'Cherry-ripe' themselves do cry.

_169._ _Laura_

Rose-cheek'd _Laura_, come; Sing thou smoothly with thy beauty's Silent music, either other Sweetly gracing.

Lovely forms do flow From concent divinely framèd: Heaven is music, and thy beauty's Birth is heavenly.

These dull notes we sing Discords need for helps to grace them; Only beauty purely loving Knows no discord;

But still moves delight, Like clear springs renew'd by flowing, Ever perfect, ever in them- selves eternal.

Devotion

_170._ _i_

Follow thy fair sun, unhappy shadow! Though thou be black as night, And she made all of light, Yet follow thy fair sun, unhappy shadow!

Follow her, whose light thy light depriveth! Though here thou liv'st disgraced, And she in heaven is placed, Yet follow her whose light the world reviveth!

Follow those pure beams, whose beauty burneth! That so have scorchèd thee As thou still black must be, Till her kind beams thy black to brightness turneth.

Follow her, while yet her glory shineth! There comes a luckless night That will dim all her light; And this the black unhappy shade divineth.

Follow still, since so thy fates ordainèd! The sun must have his shade, Till both at once do fade,-- The sun still proud, the shadow still disdainèd.

_171._ _ii_

Follow your saint, follow with accents sweet! Haste you, sad notes, fall at her flying feet! There, wrapt in cloud of sorrow, pity move, And tell the ravisher of my soul I perish for her love: But if she scorns my never-ceasing pain, Then burst with sighing in her sight, and ne'er return again!

All that I sung still to her praise did tend; Still she was first, still she my songs did end; Yet she my love and music both doth fly, The music that her echo is and beauty's sympathy: Then let my notes pursue her scornful flight! It shall suffice that they were breathed and died for her delight.

_172._ _Vobiscum est Iope_

When thou must home to shades of underground, And there arrived, a new admirèd guest, The beauteous spirits do engirt thee round, White Iope, blithe Helen, and the rest, To hear the stories of thy finish'd love From that smooth tongue whose music hell can move;

Then wilt thou speak of banqueting delights, Of masques and revels which sweet youth did make, Of tourneys and great challenges of knights, And all these triumphs for thy beauty’s sake: When thou hast told these honours done to thee, Then tell, O tell, how thou didst murder me!

_173._ _Hymn in Praise of Neptune_

Of Neptune’s empire let us sing, At whose command the waves obey; To whom the rivers tribute pay, Down the high mountains sliding: To whom the scaly nation yields Homage for the crystal fields Wherein they dwell: And every sea-dog pays a gem Yearly out of his wat’ry cell To deck great Neptune’s diadem.

The Tritons dancing in a ring Before his palace gates do make The water with their echoes quake, Like the great thunder sounding: The sea-nymphs chant their accents shrill, And the sirens, taught to kill With their sweet voice, Make ev’ry echoing rock reply Unto their gentle murmuring noise The praise of Neptune’s empery.

_174._ _Winter Nights_

Now winter nights enlarge The number of their hours, And clouds their storms discharge Upon the airy towers. Let now the chimneys blaze And cups o’erflow with wine; Let well-tuned words amaze With harmony divine. Now yellow waxen lights Shall wait on honey love, While youthful revels, masques, and courtly sights Sleep’s leaden spells remove.

This time doth well dispense With lovers’ long discourse; Much speech hath some defence Though beauty no remorse. All do not all things well; Some measures comely tread, Some knotted riddles tell, Some poems smoothly read. The summer hath his joys, And winter his delights; Though love and all his pleasures are but toys, They shorten tedious nights.

_175._ _Integer Vitae_

The man of life upright, Whose guiltless heart is free From all dishonest deeds, Or thought of vanity;

The man whose silent days In harmless joys are spent, Whom hopes cannot delude, Nor sorrow discontent;

That man needs neither towers Nor armour for defence, Nor secret vaults to fly From thunder’s violence:

He only can behold With unaffrighted eyes The horrors of the deep And terrors of the skies.

Thus, scorning all the cares That fate or fortune brings, He makes the heaven his book, His wisdom heavenly things;

Good thoughts his only friends, His wealth a well-spent age, The earth his sober inn And quiet pilgrimage.

_176._ _O come quickly!_

Never weather-beaten sail more willing bent to shore, Never tirèd pilgrim's limbs affected slumber more, Than my wearied sprite now longs to fly out of my troubled breast: O come quickly, sweetest Lord, and take my soul to rest!

Ever blooming are the joys of heaven's high Paradise, Cold age deafs not there our ears nor vapour dims our eyes: Glory there the sun outshines; whose beams the Blessèd only see: O come quickly, glorious Lord, and raise my sprite to Thee!

JOHN REYNOLDS

16th Cent.

_177._ _A Nosegay_

Say, crimson Rose and dainty Daffodil, With Violet blue; Since you have seen the beauty of my saint, And eke her view; Did not her sight (fair sight!) you lonely fill, With sweet delight Of goddess' grace and angels' sacred teint In fine, most bright?

Say, golden Primrose, sanguine Cowslip fair, With Pink most fine; Since you beheld the visage of my dear, And eyes divine;

_177._ teint] tint, hue.

Did not her globy front, and glistering hair, With cheeks most sweet, So gloriously like damask flowers appear, The gods to greet?

Say, snow-white Lily, speckled Gillyflower, With Daisy gay; Since you have viewed the Queen of my desire, In her array; Did not her ivory paps, fair Venus' bower, With heavenly glee, A Juno's grace, conjure you to require Her face to see?

Say Rose, say Daffodil, and Violet blue, With Primrose fair, Since ye have seen my nymph's sweet dainty face And gesture rare, Did not (bright Cowslip, blooming Pink) her view (White Lily) shine-- (Ah, Gillyflower, ah Daisy!) with a grace Like stars divine?

SIR HENRY WOTTON

1568-1639

_178._ _Elizabeth of Bohemia_

You meaner beauties of the night, That poorly satisfy our eyes More by your number than your light, You common people of the skies; What are you when the moon shall rise?

You curious chanters of the wood, That warble forth Dime Nature's lays, Thinking your passions understood By your weak accents; what's your praise When Philomel her voice shall raise?

You violets that first appear, By your pure purple mantles known Like the proud virgins of the year, As if the spring were all your own; What are you when the rose is blown?

So, when my mistress shall be seen In form and beauty of her mind, By virtue first, then choice, a Queen, Tell me, if she were not design’d Th’ eclipse and glory of her kind.

_179._ _The Character of a Happy Life_

How happy is he born and taught That serveth not another’s will; Whose armour is his honest thought, And simple truth his utmost skill!

Whose passions not his masters are; Whose soul is still prepared for death, Untied unto the world by care Of public fame or private breath;

Who envies none that chance doth raise, Nor vice; who never understood How deepest wounds are given by praise; Nor rules of state, but rules of good; Who hath his life from rumours freed; Whose conscience is his strong retreat; Whose state can neither flatterers feed, Nor ruin make oppressors great;

Who God doth late and early pray More of His grace than gifts to lend; And entertains the harmless day With a religious book or friend;

--This man is freed from servile bands Of hope to rise or fear to fall: Lord of himself, though not of lands, And having nothing, yet hath all.

_180._ _Upon the Death of Sir Albert Morton’s Wife_

He first deceased; she for a little tried To live without him, liked it not, and died.

SIR JOHN DAVIES

1569-1626

_181._ _Man_

I know my soul hath power to know all things, Yet she is blind and ignorant in all: I know I’m one of Nature’s little kings, Yet to the least and vilest things am thrall.

I know my life’s a pain and but a span; I know my sense is mock’d in everything; And, to conclude, I know myself a Man-- Which is a proud and yet a wretched thing.

SIR ROBERT AYTON

1570-1638

_182._ _To His Forsaken Mistress_

I do confess thou’rt smooth and fair, And I might have gone near to love thee, Had I not found the slightest prayer That lips could move, had power to move thee; But I can let thee now alone As worthy to be loved by none.

I do confess thou’rt sweet; yet find Thee such an unthrift of thy sweets, Thy favours are but like the wind That kisseth everything it meets: And since thou canst with more than one, Thou’rt worthy to be kiss’d by none.

The morning rose that untouch’d stands Arm’d with her briers, how sweet she smells! But pluck’d and strain’d through ruder hands, Her sweets no longer with her dwells: But scent and beauty both are gone, And leaves fall from her, one by one.

Such fate ere long will thee betide When thou hast handled been awhile, With sere flowers to be thrown aside; And I shall sigh, while some will smile, To see thy love to every one Hath brought thee to be loved by none.

_183._ _To an Inconstant One_

I loved thee once; I’ll love no more-- Thine be the grief as is the blame; Thou art not what thou wast before, What reason I should be the same? He that can love unloved again, Hath better store of love than brain: God send me love my debts to pay, While unthrifts fool their love away!

Nothing could have my love o’erthrown If thou hadst still continued mine; Yea, if thou hadst remain’d thy own, I might perchance have yet been thine. But thou thy freedom didst recall That it thou might elsewhere enthral: And then how could I but disdain A captive’s captive to remain?

When new desires had conquer’d thee And changed the object of thy will, It had been lethargy in me, Not constancy, to love thee still. Yea, it had been a sin to go And prostitute affection so: Since we are taught no prayers to say To such as must to others pray.

Yet do thou glory in thy choice-- Thy choice of his good fortune boast; I’ll neither grieve nor yet rejoice To see him gain what I have lost: The height of my disdain shall be To laugh at him, to blush for thee; To love thee still, but go no more A-begging at a beggar’s door.

BEN JONSON

1573-1637

_184._ _Hymn to Diana_

Queen and huntress, chaste and fair, Now the sun is laid to sleep, Seated in thy silver chair, State in wonted manner keep: Hesperus entreats thy light, Goddess excellently bright.

Earth, let not thy envious shade Dare itself to interpose; Cynthia’s shining orb was made Heaven to clear when day did close: Bless us then with wishèd sight, Goddess excellently bright.

Lay thy bow of pearl apart, And thy crystal-shining quiver; Give unto the flying hart Space to breathe, how short soever: Thou that mak’st a day of night-- Goddess excellently bright.

_185._ _To Celia_

Drink to me only with thine eyes, And I will pledge with mine; Or leave a kiss but in the cup And I’ll not look for wine. The thirst that from the soul doth rise Doth ask a

drink divine; But might I of Jove’s nectar sup, I would not change for thine.

I sent thee late a rosy wreath, Not so much honouring thee As giving it a hope that there It could not wither’d be; But thou thereon didst only breathe, And sent’st it back to me; Since when it grows, and smells, I swear, Not of itself but thee!

_186._ _Simplex Munditiis_

Still to be neat, still to be drest, As you were going to a feast; Still to be powder’d, still perfumed: Lady, it is to be presumed, Though art’s hid causes are not found, All is not sweet, all is not sound.

Give me a look, give me a face That makes simplicity a grace; Robes loosely flowing, hair as free: Such sweet neglect more taketh me Than all th’ adulteries of art; They strike mine eyes, but not my heart.

_187._ _The Shadow_

Follow a shadow, it still flies you; Seem to fly it, it will pursue: So court a mistress, she denies you; Let her alone, she will court you. Say, are not women truly, then, Styled but the shadows of us men?

At morn and even, shades are longest; At noon they are or short or none: So men at weakest, they are strongest, But grant us perfect, they’re not known. Say, are not women truly, then, Styled but the shadows of us men?

_188._ _The Triumph_

See the Chariot at hand here of Love, Wherein my Lady rideth! Each that draws is a swan or a dove, And well the car Love guideth. As she goes, all hearts do duty Unto her beauty; And enamour’d do wish, so they might But enjoy such a sight, That they still were to run by her side, Through swords, through seas, whither she would ride.

Do but look on her eyes, they do light All that Love’s world compriseth! Do but look on her hair, it is bright As Love’s star when it riseth! Do but mark, her forehead’s smoother Than words that soothe her; And from her arch’d brows such a grace Sheds itself through the face, As alone there triumphs to the life All the gain, all the good, of the elements’ strife.

Have you seen but a bright lily grow Before rude hands have touch’d it? Have you mark’d but the fall of the snow Before the soil hath smutch’d it? Have you felt the wool of beaver, Or swan’s down ever? O have smelt o’ the bud o’ the brier, Or the nard in the fire? Or have tasted the bag of the bee? O so white, O so soft, O so sweet is she!

_189._ _An Elegy_

Though beauty be the mark of praise, And yours of whom I sing be such As not the world can praise too much, Yet ’tis your Virtue now I raise.

A virtue, like allay so gone Throughout your form as, though that move And draw and conquer all men’s love, This subjects you to love of one.

Wherein you triumph yet--because ’Tis of your flesh, and that you use The noblest freedom, not to choose Against or faith or honour’s laws.

_189._ allay] alloy.

But who should less expect from you? In whom alone Love lives again: By whom he is restored to men, And kept and bred and brought up true.

His falling temples you have rear’d, The withered garlands ta’en away; His altars kept from that decay That envy wish’d, and nature fear’d:

And on them burn so chaste a flame, With so much loyalty’s expense, As Love to acquit such excellence Is gone himself into your name.

And you are he--the deity To whom all lovers are design’d That would their better objects find Among which faithful troop am I--

Who as an off’ring at your shrine Have sung this hymn, and here entreat One spark of your diviner heat To light upon a love of mine.

Which if it kindle not, but scant Appear, and that to shortest view; Yet give me leave to adore in you What I in her am grieved to want!

_190._ _A Farewell to the World_

False world, good night! since thou hast brought That hour upon my morn of age; Henceforth I quit thee from my thought, My part is ended on thy stage.

Yes, threaten, do. Alas! I fear As little as I hope from thee: I know thou canst not show nor bear More hatred than thou hast to me.

My tender, first, and simple years Thou didst abuse and then betray; Since stir’d’st up jealousies and fears, When all the causes were away.

Then in a soil hast planted me Where breathe the basest of thy fools; Where envious arts professèd be, And pride and ignorance the schools;

Where nothing is examined, weigh’d, But as ’tis rumour’d, so believed; Where every freedom is betray’d, And every goodness tax’d or grieved.

But what we’re born for, we must bear: Our frail condition it is such That what to all may happen here, If ’t chance to me, I must not grutch.

Else I my state should much mistake To harbour a divided thought From all my kind--that, for my sake, There should a miracle be wrought.

No, I do know that I was born To age, misfortune, sickness, grief: But I will bear these with that scorn As shall not need thy false relief.

Nor for my peace will I go far, As wanderers do, that still do roam; But make my strengths, such as they are, Here in my bosom, and at home.

_191._ _The Noble Balm_

High-spirited friend, I send nor balms nor cor’sives to your wound: Your fate hath found A gentler and more agile hand to tend The cure of that which is but corporal;

And doubtful days, which were named critical, Have made their fairest flight And now are out of sight. Yet doth some wholesome physic for the mind Wrapp’d in this paper lie, Which in the taking if you misapply, You are unkind.

Your covetous hand, Happy in that fair honour it hath gain’d, Must now be rein’d. True valour doth her own renown command In one full action; nor have you now more To do, than be a husband of that store. Think but how dear you bought This fame which you have caught: Such thoughts will make you more in love with truth. ’Tis wisdom, and that high, For men to use their fortune reverently, Even in youth.

Epitaphs

_i_

_192._ _On Elizabeth L. H._

Wouldst thou hear what Man can say In a little? Reader, stay. Underneath this stone doth lie As much Beauty as could die: Which in life did harbour give To more Virtue than doth live. If at all she had a fault, Leave it buried in this vault. One name was _Elizabeth_, The other, let it sleep with death: Fitter, where it died, to tell Than that it lived at all. Farewell.

_ii_

_193._ _On Salathiel Pavy_

A child of Queen Elizabeth’s Chapel

Weep with me, all you that read This little story; And know, for whom a tear you shed Death’s self is sorry. ’Twas a child that so did thrive In grace and feature, As Heaven and Nature seem’d to strive Which own’d the creature. Years he number’d scarce thirteen When Fates turn’d cruel, Yet three fill’d zodiacs had he been The stage’s jewel; And did act (what now we moan) Old men so duly, As sooth the Parcae thought him one, He play’d so truly. So, by error, to his fate They all consented; But, viewing him since, alas, too late! They have repented; And have sought, to give new birth, In baths to steep him; But, being so much too good for earth, Heaven vows to keep him.

_194._ _A Part of an Ode_

to the Immortal Memory and Friendship of that noble pair, Sir Lucius Cary and Sir H. Morison

It is not growing like a tree In bulk, doth make man better be; Or standing long an oak, three hundred year, To fall a log at last, dry, bald, and sere: A lily of a day Is fairer far in May, Although it fall and die that night; It was the plant and flower of light. In small proportions we just beauties see; And in short measures, life may perfect be.

Call, noble _Lucius_, then for wine, And let thy looks with gladness shine: Accept this garland, plant it on thy head, And think--nay, know--thy _Morison_’s not dead. He leap’d the present age, Possest with holy rage To see that bright eternal Day Of which we Priests and Poets say Such truths as we expect for happy men; And there he

lives with memory--and Ben

Jonson: who sung this of him, ere he went Himself to rest, Or tast a part of that full joy he meant To have exprest In this bright Asterism Where it were friendship’s schism-- Were not his _Lucius_ long with us to tarry-- To separate these twy Lights, the Dioscuri, And keep the one half from his _Harry_. But fate doth so alternate the design, Whilst that in Heav’n, this light on earth must shine.

And shine as you exalted are! Two names of friendship, but one star: Of hearts the union: and those not by chance Made, or indenture, or leased out to advance The profits for a time. No pleasures vain did chime Of rimes or riots at your feasts, Orgies of drink or feign’d protests; But simple love of greatness and of good, That knits brave minds and manners more than blood.

This made you first to know the _Why_ _You liked_, then after, to apply That liking, and approach so one the t’other Till either grew a portion of the other: Each stylèd by his end The copy of his friend. You lived to be the great surnames And titles by which all made claims Unto the Virtue--nothing perfect done But as a _CARY_ or a _MORISON_.

And such the force the fair example had As they that saw The good, and durst not practise it, were glad That such a law Was left yet to mankind, Where they might read and find Friendship indeed was written, not in words, And with the heart, not pen, Of two so early men, Whose lines her rules were and records: Who, ere the first down bloomed on the chin, Had sow’d these fruits, and got the harvest in.

JOHN DONNE

1573-1631

_195._ _Daybreak_

Stay, O sweet, and do not rise! The light that shines comes from thine eyes; The day breaks not: it is my heart, Because that you and I must part. Stay! or else my joys will die And perish in their infancy.

_196._ _Song_

Go and catch a falling star, Get with child a mandrake root, Tell me where all past years are, Or who cleft the Devil’s foot; Teach me to hear mermaids singing, Or to keep off envy’s stinging, And find What wind Serves to advance an honest mind.

If thou be’st born to strange sights, Things invisible to see, Ride ten thousand days and nights Till Age snow white hairs on thee; Thou, when thou return’st, wilt tell me All strange wonders that befell thee, And swear No where Lives a woman true and fair.

If thou find’st one, let me know; Such a pilgrimage were sweet, Yet do not; I would not go, Though at next door we might meet. Though she were true when you met her, And last till you write your letter, Yet she Will be False, ere I come, to two or three.

_197._

That Time and Absence proves _Rather helps than hurts to loves_

Absence, hear thou my protestation Against thy strength, Distance and length: Do what thou canst for alteration, For hearts of truest mettle Absence doth join and Time doth settle.

Who loves a mistress of such quality, His mind hath found Affection’s ground Beyond time, place, and all mortality. To hearts that cannot vary Absence is present, Time doth tarry.

My senses want their outward motion Which now within Reason doth win, Redoubled by her secret notion: Like rich men that take pleasure In hiding more than handling treasure.

By Absence this good means I gain, That I can catch her Where none can watch her, In some close corner of my brain: There I embrace and kiss her, And so enjoy her and none miss her.

_198._ _The Ecstasy_

Where, like a pillow on a bed, A pregnant bank swell’d up, to rest The violet’s reclining head, Sat we two, one another’s best.

Our hands were firmly cèmented By a fast balm which thence did spring; Our eye-beams twisted, and did thread Our eyes upon one double string.

So to engraft our hands, as yet Was all the means to make us one; And pictures in our eyes to get Was all our propagation.

As ’twixt two equal armies Fate Suspends uncertain victory, Our souls--which to advance their state Were gone out--hung ’twixt her and me.

And whilst our souls negotiate there, We like sepulchral statues lay; All day the same our postures were, And we said nothing, all the day.

_199._ _The Dream_

Dear love, for nothing less than thee Would I have broke this happy dream, It was a theme For reason, much too strong for fantasy. Therefore thou waked’st me wisely; yet My dream thou brok’st not, but continued’st it. Thou art so true that thoughts of thee suffice To make dreams truths and fables histories; Enter these arms, for since thou thought’st it best Not to dream all my dream, let’s act the rest.

As lightning, or a taper’s light, Thine eyes, and not thy noise, waked me; Yet I thought thee-- For thou lov’st truth--an angel, at first sight; But when I saw thou saw’st my heart, And knew’st my thoughts beyond an angel’s art, When thou knew’st what I dreamt, when thou knew’st when Excess of joy would wake me, and cam’st then, I must confess it could not choose but be Profane to think thee anything but thee.

Coming and staying show’d thee thee, But rising makes me doubt that now Thou art not thou. That Love is weak where Fear’s as strong as he; ’Tis not all spirit pure and brave If mixture it of Fear, Shame, Honour have. Perchance as torches, which

must ready be, Men light and put out, so thou deal’st with me. Thou cam’st to kindle, go’st to come: then I Will dream that hope again, but else would die.

_200._ _The Funeral_

Whoever comes to shroud me, do not harm Nor question much That subtle wreath of hair about mine arm; The mystery, the sign you must not touch, For ’tis my outward soul, Viceroy to that which, unto heav’n being gone, Will leave this to control And keep these limbs, her provinces, from dissolution.

For if the sinewy thread my brain lets fall Through every part Can tie those parts, and make me one of all; Those hairs, which upward grew, and strength and art Have from a better brain, Can better do’t: except she meant that I By this should know my pain, As prisoners then are manacled, when they’re condemn’d to die.

Whate’er she meant by ’t, bury it with me, For since I am Love’s martyr, it might breed idolatry If into other hands these reliques came. As ’twas humility T’ afford to it all that a soul can do, So ’tis some bravery That, since you would have none of me, I bury some of you.

_201._ _A Hymn to God the Father_

Wilt Thou forgive that sin where I begun, Which was my sin, though it were done before? Wilt Thou forgive that sin through which I run, And do run still, though still I do deplore? When Thou hast done, Thou hast not done; For I have more.

Wilt Thou forgive that sin which I have won Others to sin, and made my sins their door? Wilt Thou forgive that sin which I did shun A year or two, but wallow’d in a score? When Thou hast done, Thou hast not done; For I have more.

I have a sin of fear, that when I’ve spun My last thread, I shall perish on the shore; But swear by Thyself that at my death Thy Son Shall shine as He shines now and heretofore: And having done that, Thou hast done; I fear no more.

_202._ _Death_

Death, be not proud, though some have callèd thee Mighty and dreadful, for thou art not so: For those whom thou think’st thou dost overthrow Die not, poor Death; nor yet canst thou kill me. From Rest and Sleep, which but thy picture be, Much pleasure, then from thee much more must flow; And soonest our best men with thee do go-- Rest of their bones and souls’ delivery! Thou’rt slave to fate, chance, kings, and desperate men, And dost with poison, war, and sickness dwell; And poppy or charms can make us sleep as well And better than thy stroke. Why swell’st thou then? One short sleep past, we wake eternally, And Death shall be no more: Death, thou shalt die!

RICHARD BARNEFIELD

1574-1627

_203._ _Philomel_

As it fell upon a day In the merry month of May, Sitting in a pleasant shade Which a grove of myrtles made, Beasts did leap and birds did sing, Trees did grow and plants did spring; Everything did banish moan Save the Nightingale alone: She, poor bird, as all forlorn Lean'd her breast up-till a thorn, And there sung the dolefull'st ditty, That to hear it was great pity. _Fie, fie, fie!_ now would she cry; _Tereu, Tereu!_ by and by; That to hear her so complain Scarce I could from tears refrain; For her griefs so lively shown Made me think upon mine own. Ah! thought I, thou mourn'st in vain, None takes pity on thy pain: Senseless trees they cannot hear thee, Ruthless beasts they will not cheer thee: King Pandion he is dead, All thy friends are lapp'd in lead; All thy fellow birds do sing Careless of thy sorrowing: Even so, poor bird, like thee, None alive will pity me.

THOMAS DEKKER

1575-1641

_204._ _Sweet Content_

Art thou poor, yet hast thou golden slumbers? O sweet content! Art thou rich, yet is thy mind perplex'd? O punishment! Dost thou laugh to see how fools are vex'd To add to golden numbers golden numbers? O sweet content! O sweet, O sweet content! Work apace, apace, apace, apace; Honest labour bears a lovely face; Then hey nonny nonny--hey nonny nonny!

Canst drink the waters of the crispèd spring? O sweet content! Swim'st thou in wealth, yet sink'st in thine own tears? O punishment! Then he that patiently want's burden bears, No burden bears, but is a king, a king! O sweet content! O sweet, O sweet content! Work apace, apace, apace, apace; Honest labour bears a lovely face; Then hey nonny nonny--hey nonny nonny!

THOMAS HEYWOOD

157?-1650

_205._ _Matin Song_

Pack, clouds, away! and welcome, day! With night we banish sorrow. Sweet air, blow soft; mount, lark, aloft To give my Love good-morrow! Wings from the wind to please her mind, Notes from the lark I'll borrow: Bird, prune thy wing! nightingale, sing! To give my Love good-morrow! To give my Love good-morrow Notes from them all I'll borrow.

Wake from thy nest, robin red-breast! Sing, birds, in every furrow! And from each bill let music shrill Give my fair Love good-morrow! Blackbird and thrush in every bush, Stare, linnet, and cocksparrow, You pretty elves, among yourselves Sing my fair Love good-morrow! To give my Love good-morrow! Sing, birds, in every furrow!

_205._ stare] starling.

_206._ _The Message_

Ye little birds that sit and sing Amidst the shady valleys, And see how Phillis sweetly walks Within her garden-alleys; Go, pretty birds, about her bower; Sing, pretty birds, she may not lower; Ah me! methinks I see her frown! Ye pretty wantons, warble.

Go tell her through your chirping bills, As you by me are bidden, To her is only known my love, Which from the world is hidden. Go, pretty birds, and tell her so, See that your notes strain not too low. For still methinks I see her frown; Ye pretty wantons, warble.

Go tune your voices' harmony And sing, I am her lover; Strain loud and sweet, that every note With sweet content may move her: And she that hath the sweetest voice, Tell her I will not change my choice: --Yet still methinks I see her frown! Ye pretty wantons, warble.

O fly! make haste! see, see, she falls Into a pretty slumber! Sing round about her rosy bed That waking she may wonder: Say to her, 'tis her lover true That sendeth love to you, to you! And when you hear her kind reply, Return with pleasant warblings.

JOHN FLETCHER

1579-1625

_207._ _Sleep_

Come, Sleep, and with thy sweet deceiving Lock me in delight awhile; Let some pleasing dreams beguile All my fancies; that from thence I may feel an influence All my powers of care bereaving!

Though but a shadow, but a sliding, Let me know some little joy! We that suffer long annoy Are contented with a thought Through an idle fancy wrought: O let my joys have some abiding!

_208._ _Bridal Song_

Cynthia, to thy power and thee We obey. Joy to this great company! And no day Come to steal this night away Till the rites of love are ended, And the lusty bridegroom say, Welcome, light, of all befriended!

Pace out, you watery powers below; Let your feet, Like the galleys when they row, Even beat; Let your unknown measures, set To the still winds, tell to all That gods are come, immortal, great, To honour this great nuptial!

_209._ _Aspatia's Song_

Lay a garland on my herse Of the dismal yew; Maidens, willow branches bear; Say, I died true.

My love was false, but I was firm From my hour of birth. Upon my buried body lie Lightly, gentle earth!

_210._ _Hymn to Pan_

Sing his praises that doth keep Our flocks from harm, Pan, the father of our sheep; And arm in arm Tread we softly in a round, Whilst the hollow neighbouring ground Fills the music with her sound.

Pan, O great god Pan, to thee Thus do we sing! Thou who keep’st us chaste and free As the young spring: Ever be thy honour spoke From that place the morn is broke To that place day doth unyoke!

_211._ _Away, Delights_

Away, delights! go seek some other dwelling, For I must die. Farewell, false love! thy tongue is ever telling Lie after lie. For ever let me rest now from thy smarts; Alas, for pity go And fire their hearts That have been hard to thee! Mine was not so.

Never again deluding love shall know me, For I will die; And all those griefs that think to overgrow me Shall be as I: For ever will I sleep, while poor maids cry-- ‘Alas, for pity stay, And let us die With thee! Men cannot mock us in the clay.’

_212._ _Love’s Emblems_

Now the lusty spring is seen; Golden yellow, gaudy blue, Daintily invite the view: Everywhere on every green Roses blushing as they blow, And enticing men to pull, Lilies whiter than the snow, Woodbines of sweet honey full: All love’s emblems, and all cry, ‘Ladies, if not pluck’d, we die.’

Yet the lusty spring hath stay’d; Blushing red and purest white Daintily to love invite Every woman, every maid: Cherries kissing as they grow, And inviting men to taste, Apples even ripe below, Winding gently to the waist: All love’s emblems, and all cry, ‘Ladies, if not pluck’d, we die.’

_213._ _Hear, ye Ladies_

Hear, ye ladies that despise What the mighty Love has done; Fear examples and be wise: Fair Callisto was a nun; Leda, sailing on the stream To deceive the hopes of man, Love accounting but a dream, Doted on a silver swan; Danaë, in a brazen tower, Where no love was, loved a shower.

Hear, ye ladies that are coy, What the mighty Love can do; Fear the fierceness of the boy: The chaste Moon he makes to woo; Vesta, kindling holy fires, Circled round about with spies, Never dreaming loose desires, Doting at the altar dies; Ilion, in a short hour, higher He can build, and once more fire.

_214._ _God Lyaeus_

God Lyaeus, ever young, Ever honour’d, ever sung, Stain’d with blood of lusty grapes, In a thousand lusty shapes Dance upon the mazer’s brim, In the crimson liquor swim;

_214._ mazer] a bowl of maple-wood.

From thy plenteous hand divine Let a river run with wine: God of youth, let this day here Enter neither care nor fear.

_215._ _Beauty Clear and Fair_

Beauty clear and fair, Where the air Rather like a perfume dwells; Where the violet and the rose Their blue veins and blush disclose, And come to honour nothing else;

Where to live near And planted there Is to live, and still live new; Where to gain a favour is More than light, perpetual bliss-- Make me live by serving you!

Dear, again back recall To this light, A stranger to himself and all! Both the wonder and the story Shall be yours, and eke the glory; I am your servant, and your thrall.

_216._ _Melancholy_

Hence, all you vain delights, As short as are the nights Wherein you spend your folly! There’s naught in this life sweet, If men were wise to see’t, But only melancholy-- O sweetest melancholy! Welcome, folded arms and fixèd eyes, A sight that piercing mortifies, A look that’s fasten’d to the ground, A tongue chain’d up without a sound!

Fountain-heads and pathless groves, Places which pale passion loves! Moonlight walks, when all the fowls Are warmly housed, save bats and owls! A midnight bell, a parting groan-- These are the sounds we feed upon: Then stretch our bones in a still gloomy valley, Nothing’s so dainty sweet as lovely melancholy.

_217._ _Weep no more_

Weep no more, nor sigh, nor groan, Sorrow calls no time that’s gone: Violets pluck’d, the sweetest rain Makes not fresh nor grow again. Trim thy locks, look cheerfully; Fate’s hid ends eyes cannot see. Joys as wingèd dreams fly fast, Why should sadness longer last? Grief is but a wound to woe; Gentlest fair, mourn, mourn no moe.

JOHN WEBSTER

?-1630?

_218._ _A Dirge_

Call for the robin-redbreast and the wren, Since o’er shady groves they hover, And with leaves and flowers do cover The friendless bodies of unburied men. Call unto his funeral dole The ant, the field-mouse, and the mole, To rear him hillocks that shall keep him warm, And (when gay tombs are robb’d) sustain no harm; But keep the wolf far thence, that’s foe to men, For with his nails he’ll dig them up again.

_218._ dole] lamentation.

_219._ _The Shrouding of the Duchess of Malfi_

Hark! Now everything is still, The screech-owl and the whistler shrill, Call upon our dame aloud, And bid her quickly don her shroud!

Much you had of land and rent; Your length in clay’s now competent: A long war disturb’d your mind; Here your perfect peace is sign’d.

Of what is't fools make such vain keeping? Sin their conception, their birth weeping, Their life a general mist of error, Their death a hideous storm of terror. Strew your hair with powders sweet, Don clean linen, bathe your feet, And--the foul fiend more to check-- A crucifix let bless your neck: 'Tis now full tide 'tween night and day; End your groan and come away.

_220._ _Vanitas Vanitatum_

All the flowers of the spring Meet to perfume our burying; These have but their growing prime, And man does flourish but his time: Survey our progress from our birth-- We are set, we grow, we turn to earth. Courts adieu, and all delights, All bewitching appetites! Sweetest breath and clearest eye Like perfumes go out and die; And consequently this is done As shadows wait upon the sun. Vain the ambition of kings Who seek by trophies and dead things To leave a living name behind, And weave but nets to catch the wind.

WILLIAM ALEXANDER, EARL OF STIRLING

1580?-1640

_221._ _Aurora_

O happy Tithon! if thou know'st thy hap, And valuest thy wealth, as I my want, Then need'st thou not--which ah! I grieve to grant-- Repine at Jove, lull'd in his leman's lap: That golden shower in which he did repose-- One dewy drop it stains Which thy Aurora rains Upon the rural plains, When from thy bed she passionately goes.

Then, waken'd with the music of the merles, She not remembers Memnon when she mourns: That faithful flame which in her bosom burns From crystal conduits throws those liquid pearls: Sad from thy sight so soon to be removed, She so her grief delates. --O favour'd by the fates Above the happiest states, Who art of one so worthy well-beloved!

PHINEAS FLETCHER

1580-1650

_222._ _A Litany_

Drop, drop, slow tears, And bathe those beauteous feet Which brought from Heaven The news and Prince of Peace: Cease not, wet eyes, His mercy to entreat; To cry for vengeance Sin doth never cease. In your deep floods Drown all my faults and fears; Nor let His eye See sin, but through my tears.

SIR JOHN BEAUMONT

1583-1627

_223._ _Of his Dear Son, Gervase_

Dear Lord, receive my son, whose winning love To me was like a friendship, far above The course of nature or his tender age; Whose looks could all my bitter griefs assuage: Let his pure soul, ordain’d seven years to be In that frail body which was part of me, Remain my pledge in Heaven, as sent to show How to this port at every step I go.

WILLIAM DRUMMOND, OF HAWTHORNDEN

1585-1649

_224._ _Invocation_

Phœbus, arise! And paint the sable skies With azure, white, and red; Rouse Memnon’s mother from her Tithon’s bed, That she thy career may with roses spread; The nightingales thy coming each-where sing; Make an eternal spring! Give life to this dark world which lieth dead; Spread forth thy golden hair In larger locks than thou wast wont before, And emperor-like decore With diadem of pearl thy temples fair: Chase hence the ugly night Which serves but to make dear thy glorious light. This is that happy morn, That day, long wishèd day Of all my life so dark (If cruel stars have not my ruin sworn And fates not hope betray), Which, only white, deserves A diamond for ever should it mark: This is the morn should bring into this grove My Love, to hear and recompense my love. Fair King, who all preserves, But show thy blushing beams, And thou two sweeter eyes Shalt see than those which by Penèus’ streams Did once thy heart surprise: Nay, suns, which shine as clear As thou when two thou did to Rome appear. Now, Flora, deck thyself in fairest guise: If that ye, winds, would hear A voice surpassing far Amphion’s lyre, Your stormy chiding stay; Let zephyr only breathe And with her tresses play, Kissing sometimes these purple ports of death.

The winds all silent are; And Phœbus in his chair Ensaffroning sea and air Makes vanish every star: Night like a drunkard reels Beyond the hills to shun his flaming wheels: The fields with flowers are deck’d in every hue, The clouds bespangle with bright gold their blue; Here is the pleasant place-- And everything, save Her, who all should grace.

_225._ _Madrigal_

Like the Idalian queen, Her hair about her eyne, With neck and breast’s ripe apples to be seen, At first glance of the morn In Cyprus’ gardens gathering those fair flow’rs Which of her blood were born, I saw, but fainting saw, my paramours. The Graces naked danced about the place, The winds and trees amazed With silence on her gazed, The flowers did smile, like those upon her face; And as their aspen stalks those fingers band, That she might read my case, A hyacinth I wish’d me in her hand.

_225._ paramours] = sing. paramour. band] bound.

_226._ _Spring Bereaved 1_

That zephyr every year So soon was heard to sigh in forests here, It was for her: that wrapp’d in gowns of green Meads were so early seen, That in the saddest months

oft sung the merles, It was for her; for her trees dropp’d forth pearls. That proud and stately courts Did envy those our shades and calm resorts, It was for her; and she is gone, O woe! Woods cut again do grow, Bud doth the rose and daisy, winter done; But we, once dead, no more do see the sun.

_227._ _Spring Bereaved 2_

Sweet Spring, thou turn’st with all thy goodly train, Thy head with flames, thy mantle bright with flow’rs: The zephyrs curl the green locks of the plain, The clouds for joy in pearls weep down their show’rs. Thou turn’st, sweet youth, but ah! my pleasant hours And happy days with thee come not again; The sad memorials only of my pain Do with thee turn, which turn my sweets in sours. Thou art the same which still thou wast before, Delicious, wanton, amiable, fair; But she, whose breath embalm’d thy wholesome air, Is gone--nor gold nor gems her can restore. Neglected virtue, seasons go and come, While thine forgot lie closèd in a tomb.

_228._ _Spring Bereaved 3_

Alexis, here she stay’d; among these pines, Sweet hermitress, she did alone repair; Here did she spread the treasure of her hair, More rich than that brought from the Colchian mines. She set her by these muskèd eglantines, --The happy place the print seems yet to bear: Her voice did sweeten here thy sugar’d lines, To which winds, trees, beasts, birds, did lend their ear. Me here she first perceived, and here a morn Of bright carnations did o’erspread her face; Here did she sigh, here first my hopes were born, And I first got a pledge of promised grace: But ah! what served it to be happy so? Sith passèd pleasures double but new woe?

_229._ _Her Passing_

The beauty and the life Of life’s and beauty’s fairest paragon --O tears! O grief!--hung at a feeble thread To which pale Atropos had set her knife; The soul with many a groan Had left each outward part, And now did take his last leave of the heart: Naught else did want, save death, ev’n to be dead; When the afflicted band about her bed, Seeing so fair him come in lips, cheeks, eyes, Cried, ‘_Ah! and can Death enter Paradise?_’

_230._ _Inexorable_

My thoughts hold mortal strife; I do detest my life, And with lamenting cries Peace to my soul to bring Oft call that prince which here doth monarchise: --But he, grim-grinning King, Who caitiffs scorns, and doth the blest surprise. Late having deck’d with beauty’s rose his tomb, Disdains to crop a weed, and will not come.

_231._ _Change should breed Change_

New doth the sun appear, The mountains’ snows decay, Crown’d with frail flowers forth comes the baby year. My soul, time posts away; And thou yet in that frost Which flower and fruit hath lost, As if all here immortal were, dost stay. For shame! thy powers awake, Look to that Heaven which never night makes black, And there at that immortal sun’s bright rays, Deck thee with flowers which fear not rage of days!

_232._ _Saint John Baptist_

The last and greatest Herald of Heaven’s King, Girt with rough skins, hies to the deserts wild, Among that savage brood the woods forth bring, Which he than man more harmless found and mild. His food was locusts, and what young doth spring With honey that from virgin hives distill’d; Parch’d body, hollow eyes, some uncouth thing Made him appear, long since from earth exiled. There burst he forth: ‘All ye, whose hopes rely On God, with me amidst these deserts mourn; Repent, repent, and from old errors turn!’ --Who listen’d to his voice, obey’d his cry? Only the echoes, which he made relent, Rung from their marble caves ‘Repent! Repent!’

GILES FLETCHER

158?-1623

_233._ _Wooing Song_

Love is the blossom where there blows Every thing that lives or grows: Love doth make the Heav’ns to move, And the Sun doth burn in love: Love the strong and weak doth yoke, And makes the ivy climb the oak, Under whose shadows lions wild, Soften’d by love, grow tame and mild: Love no med’cine can appease, He burns the fishes in the seas: Not all the skill his wounds can stench, Not all the sea his fire can quench. Love did make the bloody spear Once a leavy coat to wear, While in his leaves there shrouded lay Sweet birds, for love that sing and play And of all love’s joyful flame I the bud and blossom am. Only bend thy knee to me, Thy wooing shall thy winning be

See, see the flowers that below Now as fresh as morning blow; And of all the virgin rose That as bright Aurora shows; How they all unleavèd die, Losing their virginity! Like unto a summer shade, But now born, and now they fade. Every thing doth pass away; There is danger in delay: Come, come, gather then the rose, Gather it, or it you lose! All the sand of Tagus’ shore Into my bosom casts his ore: All the valleys’ swimming corn To my house is yearly borne: Every grape of every vine Is gladly bruised to make me wine: While ten thousand kings, as proud, To carry up my train have bow’d, And a world of ladies send me In my chambers to attend me: All the stars in Heav’n that shine, And ten thousand more, are mine: Only bend thy knee to me, Thy wooing shall thy winning be!

FRANCIS BEAUMONT

1586-1616

_234._ _On the Tombs in Westminster Abbey_

Mortality, behold and fear! What a change of flesh is here! Think how many royal bones Sleep within this heap of stones: Here they lie had realms and lands, Who now want strength to stir their hands: Where from their pulpits seal’d with dust They preach, ‘In greatness is no trust.’ Here’s an acre sown indeed With the richest, royall’st seed That the earth did e’er suck in Since the first man died for sin: Here the bones of birth have cried-- ‘Though gods they were, as men they died.’ Here are

sands, ignoble things, Dropt from the ruin’d sides of kings; Here’s a world of pomp and state, Buried in dust, once dead by fate.

JOHN FORD

1586-1639

_235._ _Dawn_

Fly hence, shadows, that do keep Watchful sorrows charm’d in sleep! Tho’ the eyes be overtaken, Yet the heart doth ever waken Thoughts chain’d up in busy snares Of continual woes and cares: Love and griefs are so exprest As they rather sigh than rest. Fly hence, shadows, that do keep Watchful sorrows charm’d in sleep!

GEORGE WITHER

1588-1667

_236._ _I loved a Lass_

I loved a lass, a fair one, As fair as e’er was seen; She was indeed a rare one, Another Sheba Queen: But, fool as then I was, I thought she loved me too: But now, alas! she’s left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

Her hair like gold did glister, Each eye was like a star, She did surpass her sister, Which pass’d all others far; She would me honey call, She’d--O she’d kiss me too! But now, alas! she’s left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

Many a merry meeting My love and I have had; She was my only sweeting, She made my heart full glad; The tears stood in her eyes Like to the morning dew: But now, alas! she’s left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

Her cheeks were like the cherry, Her skin was white as snow; When she was blithe and merry She angel-like did show; Her waist exceeding small, The fives did fit her shoe: But now, alas! she’s left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

In summer time or winter She had her heart’s desire; I still did scorn to stint her From sugar, sack, or fire; The world went round about, No cares we ever knew: But now, alas! she’s left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

To maidens’ vows and swearing Henceforth no credit give; You may give them the hearing. But never them believe; They are as false as fair, Unconstant, frail, untrue: For mine, alas! hath left me, _Falero, lero, loo_!

_237._ _The Lover’s Resolution_

Shall I, wasting in despair, Die because a woman’s fair? Or make pale my cheeks with care ’Cause another’s rosy are? Be she fairer than the day, Or the flow’ry meads in May, If she think not well of me, What care I how fair she be?

Shall my silly heart be pined ’Cause I see a woman kind? Or a well disposèd nature Joinèd with a lovely feature? Be she meeker, kinder, than Turtle-dove or pelican, If

she be not so to me, What care I how kind she be?

Shall a woman’s virtues move Me to perish for her love? Or her well-deservings known Make me quite forget my own? Be she with that goodness blest Which may merit name of Best, If she be not such to me, What care I how good she be?

’Cause her fortune seems too high, Shall I play the fool and die? She that bears a noble mind, If not outward helps she find, Thinks what with them he would do That without them dares her woo; And unless that mind I see, What care I how great she be?

Great, or good, or kind, or fair, I will ne’er the more despair; If she love me, this believe, I will die ere she shall grieve; If she slight me when I woo, I can scorn and let her go; For if she be not for me, What care I for whom she be?

_238._ _The Choice_

Me so oft my fancy drew Here and there, that I ne’er knew Where to place desire before So that range it might no more; But as he that passeth by Where, in all her jollity, Flora’s riches in a row Do in seemly order grow, And a thousand flowers stand Bending as to kiss his hand; Out of which delightful store One he may take and no more; Long he pausing doubteth whether Of those fair ones he should gather.

First the Primrose courts his eyes, Then the Cowslip he espies; Next the Pansy seems to woo him, Then Carnations bow unto him; Which whilst that enamour’d swain From the stalk intends to strain, (As half-fearing to be seen) Prettily her leaves between Peeps the Violet, pale to see That her virtues slighted be; Which so much his liking wins That to seize her he begins.

Yet before he stoop’d so low He his wanton eye did throw On a stem that grew more high, And the Rose did there espy. Who, beside her previous scent, To procure his eyes content Did display her goodly breast, Where he found at full exprest All the good that Nature showers On a thousand other flowers; Wherewith he affected takes it, His belovèd flower he makes it, And without desire of more Walks through all he saw before.

So I wand’ring but erewhile Through the garden of this Isle, Saw rich beauties, I confess, And in number numberless. Yea, so differing lovely too, That I had a world to do Ere I could set up my rest, Where to choose and choose the best. Thus I fondly fear’d, till Fate (Which I must confess in that Did a greater favour to me Than the world can malice do me) Show’d to me that matchless flower. Subject for this song of our; Whose perfection having eyed, Reason instantly espied That Desire, which ranged abroad, There would find a period: And no marvel if it might, For it there hath all delight, And in her hath nature placed What each several fair one graced.

Let who list, for me, advance The admirèd flowers of France, Let who will praise and behold The reservèd Marigold; Let the sweet-breath’d Violet now Unto whom she pleaseth bow; And the fairest Lily spread Where she will her golden head; I have such a flower to wear That for those I do not care.

Let the young and happy swains Playing on the Britain plains Court unblamed their shepherdesses, And with their gold curlèd tresses Toy uncensured, until I Grudge at their prosperity. Let all times, both present, past, And the age that shall be last, Vaunt the beauties they bring forth. I have found in one such worth, That content I neither care What the best before me were; Nor desire to live and see Who shall fair hereafter be; For I know the hand of Nature Will not make a fairer creature.

_239._ _A Widow's Hymn_

How near me came the hand of Death, When at my side he struck my dear, And took away the precious breath Which quicken'd my belovèd peer! How helpless am I thereby made! By day how grieved, by night how sad! And now my life's delight is gone, --Alas! how am I left alone!

The voice which I did more esteem Than music in her sweetest key, Those eyes which unto me did seem More comfortable than the day; Those now by me, as they have been, Shall never more be heard or seen; But what I once enjoy'd in them Shall seem hereafter as a dream.

_239._ peer] companion.

Lord! keep me faithful to the trust Which my dear spouse reposed in me: To him now dead preserve me just In all that should performèd be! For though our being man and wife Extendeth only to this life, Yet neither life nor death should end The being of a faithful friend.

WILLIAM BROWNE, OF TAVISTOCK

1588-1643

_240._ _A Welcome_

Welcome, welcome! do I sing, _Far more welcome than the spring;_ _He that parteth from you never_ _Shall enjoy a spring for ever._

He that to the voice is near Breaking from your iv'ry pale, Need not walk abroad to hear The delightful nightingale. _Welcome, welcome, then...._

He that looks still on your eyes, Though the winter have begun To benumb our arteries, Shall not want the summer's sun. _Welcome, welcome, then...._

He that still may see your cheeks, Where all rareness still reposes, Is a fool if e'er he seeks Other lilies, other roses. _Welcome, welcome, then...._

He to whom your soft lip yields, And perceives your breath in kissing, All the odours of the fields Never, never shall be missing. _Welcome, welcome, then...._

He that question would anew What fair Eden was of old, Let him rightly study you, And a brief of that behold. _Welcome, welcome, then...._

_241._ _The Sirens' Song_

Steer, hither steer your wingèd pines, All beaten mariners! Here lie Love’s undiscover’d mines, A prey to passengers-- Perfumes far sweeter than the best Which make the Phœnix’ urn and nest. Fear not your ships, Nor any to oppose you save our lips; But come on shore, Where no joy dies till Love hath gotten more.

For swelling waves our panting breasts, Where never storms arise, Exchange, and be awhile our guests: For stars gaze on our eyes. The compass Love shall hourly sing, And as he goes about the ring, We will not miss To tell each point he nameth with a kiss. --Then come on shore, Where no joy dies till Love hath gotten more.

_242._ _The Rose_

A rose, as fair as ever saw the North, Grew in a little garden all alone; A sweeter flower did Nature ne’er put forth, Nor fairer garden yet was never known: The maidens danced about it morn and noon. And learnèd bards of it their ditties made; The nimble fairies by the pale-faced moon Water’d the root and kiss’d her pretty shade. But well-a-day!--the gardener careless grew; The maids and fairies both were kept away, And in a drought the caterpillars threw Themselves upon the bud and every spray. God shield the stock! If heaven send no supplies, The fairest blossom of the garden dies.

_243._ _Song_

For her gait, if she be walking; Be she sitting, I desire her For her state’s sake; and admire her For her wit if she be talking; Gait and state and wit approve her; For which all and each I love her.

Be she sullen, I commend her For a modest. Be she merry, For a kind one her prefer I. Briefly, everything doth lend her So much grace, and so approve her, That for everything I love her.

_244._ _Memory_

So shuts the marigold her leaves At the departure of the sun; So from the honeysuckle sheaves The bee goes when the day is done; So sits the turtle when she is but one, And so all woe, as I since she is gone.

To some few birds kind Nature hath Made all the summer as one day: Which once enjoy’d, cold winter’s wrath As night they sleeping pass away. Those happy creatures are, that know not yet The pain to be deprived or to forget.

I oft have heard men say there be Some that with confidence profess The helpful Art of Memory: But could they teach Forgetfulness, I’d learn; and try what further art could do To make me love her and forget her too.

Epitaphs

_245._ _In Obitum M.S. Xº Maij, 1614_

May! Be thou never graced with birds that sing, Nor Flora’s pride! In thee all flowers and roses spring, Mine only died.

_246._ _On the Countess Dowager of Pembroke_

Underneath this sable herse Lies the subject of all verse: Sidney’s sister, Pembroke’s mother: Death, ere thou hast slain another Fair and learn’d and good as she, Time shall throw a dart at thee.

ROBERT HERRICK

1591-1674

_247._ _Corinna’s going a-Maying_

Get up, get up for shame! The blooming morn Upon her wings presents the god unshorn. See how Aurora throws her fair Fresh-quilted colours through the air: Get up, sweet slug-a-bed, and see The dew bespangling herb and tree! Each flower has wept and bow’d toward the east Above an hour since, yet you not drest; Nay! not so much as out of bed? When all the birds have matins said And sung their thankful hymns, ’tis sin. Nay, profanation, to keep in, Whereas a thousand virgins on this day Spring sooner than the lark, to fetch in May.

Rise and put on your foliage, and be seen To come forth, like the spring-time, fresh and green, And sweet as Flora. Take no care For jewels for your gown or hair: Fear not; the leaves will strew Gems in abundance upon you:

Besides, the childhood of the day has kept, Against you come, some orient pearls unwept. Come, and receive them while the light Hangs on the dew-locks of the night: And Titan on the eastern hill Retires himself, or else stands still Till you come forth! Wash, dress, be brief in praying: Few beads are best when once we go a-Maying.

Come, my Corinna, come; and coming, mark How each field turns a street, each street a park, Made green and trimm’d with trees! see how Devotion gives each house a bough Or branch! each porch, each door, ere this, An ark, a tabernacle is, Made up of white-thorn neatly interwove, As if here were those cooler shades of love. Can such delights be in the street And open fields, and we not see’t? Come, we’ll abroad: and let’s obey The proclamation made for May, And sin no more, as we have done, by staying; But, my Corinna, come, let’s go a-Maying.

There’s not a budding boy or girl this day But is got up and gone to bring in May. A deal of youth ere this is come Back, and with white-thorn laden home. Some have despatch’d their cakes and cream, Before that we have left to dream: And some have wept and woo’d, and plighted troth, And chose their priest, ere we can cast off sloth:

beads] prayers.

Many a green-gown has been given, Many a kiss, both odd and even: Many a glance, too, has been sent From out the eye, love’s firmament: Many a jest told of the keys betraying This night, and locks pick’d: yet we’re not a-Maying!

Come, let us go, while we are in our prime, And take the harmless folly of the time! We shall grow old apace, and die Before we know our liberty. Our life is short, and our days run As fast away as does the sun. And, as a vapour or a drop of rain, Once lost, can ne’er be found again, So when or you or I are made A fable, song, or fleeting shade, All love, all liking, all delight Lies drown’d with us in endless night. Then,

while time serves, and we are but decaying, Come, my Corinna, come, let’s go a-Maying.

_247._ green-gown] tumble on the grass.

_248._ _To the Virgins, to make much of Time_

Gather ye rosebuds while ye may, Old Time is still a-flying: And this same flower that smiles to-day To-morrow will be dying.

The glorious lamp of heaven, the sun, The higher he’s a-getting, The sooner will his race be run, And nearer he’s to setting.

That age is best which is the first, When youth and blood are warmer; But being spent, the worse, and worst Times still succeed the former.

Then be not coy, but use your time, And while ye may, go marry: For having lost but once your prime, You may for ever tarry.

_249._ _To the Western Wind_

Sweet western wind, whose luck it is, Made rival with the air, To give Perenna’s lip a kiss, And fan her wanton hair:

Bring me but one, I’ll promise thee, Instead of common showers, Thy wings shall be embalm’d by me, And all beset with flowers.

_250._ _To Electra_

I dare not ask a kiss, I dare not beg a smile, Lest having that, or this, I might grow proud the while.

No, no, the utmost share Of my desire shall be Only to kiss that air That lately kissèd thee.

_251._ _To Violets_

Welcome, maids of honour! You do bring In the spring, And wait upon her.

She has virgins many, Fresh and fair; Yet you are More sweet than any.

You’re the maiden posies, And so graced To be placed ’Fore damask roses.

Yet, though thus respected, By-and-by Ye do lie, Poor girls, neglected.

_252._ _To Daffodils_

Fair daffodils, we weep to see You haste away so soon; As yet the early-rising sun Has not attain’d his noon. Stay, stay Until the hasting day Has run But to the evensong; And, having pray’d together, we Will go with you along.

We have short time to stay, as you, We have as short a spring; As quick a growth to meet decay, As you, or anything. We die As your hours do, and dry Away Like to the summer’s rain; Or as the pearls of morning’s dew, Ne’er to be found again.

_253._ _To Blossoms_

Fair pledges of a fruitful tree, Why do ye fall so fast? Your date is not so past But you may stay yet here awhile To blush and gently smile, And go at last.

What! were ye born to be An hour or half’s delight, And so to bid good night? ’Twas pity Nature brought you forth Merely to show your worth And lose you quite.

But you are lovely leaves, where we May read how soon things have Their end, though ne’er so brave: And after they have shown their pride Like you awhile, they glide Into the grave.

_254._ _The Primrose_

Ask me why I send you here This sweet Infanta of the year? Ask me why I send to you This primrose, thus bepearl’d with dew? I will whisper to your ears:-- The sweets of love are mix’d with tears.

Ask me why this flower does show So yellow-green, and sickly too? Ask me why the stalk is weak And bending (yet it doth not break)? I will answer:--These discover What fainting hopes are in a lover.

_255._ _The Funeral Rites of the Rose_

The Rose was sick and smiling died; And, being to be sanctified, About the bed there sighing stood The sweet and flowery sisterhood: Some hung the head, while some did bring, To wash her, water from the spring; Some laid her forth, while others wept, But all a solemn fast there kept: The holy sisters, some among, The sacred dirge and trental sung. But ah! what sweets smelt everywhere, As Heaven had spent all perfumes there. At last, when prayers for the dead And rites were all accomplishèd, They, weeping, spread a lawny loom, And closed her up as in a tomb.

_255._ trental] services for the dead, of thirty masses.

_256._ _Cherry-Ripe_

Cherry-ripe, ripe, ripe, I cry, Full and fair ones; come and buy. If so be you ask me where They do grow, I answer: There Where my Julia’s lips do smile; There’s the land, or cherry-isle, Whose plantations fully show All the year where cherries grow.

_257._ _A Meditation for his Mistress_

You are a tulip seen to-day, But, dearest, of so short a stay That where you grew scarce man can say.

You are a lovely July-flower, Yet one rude wind or ruffling shower Will force you hence, and in an hour.

You are a sparkling rose i’ th’ bud, Yet lost ere that chaste flesh and blood Can show where you or grew or stood.

You are a full-spread, fair-set vine, And can with tendrils love entwine, Yet dried ere you distil your wine.

You are like balm enclosèd well In amber or some crystal shell, Yet lost ere you transfuse your smell.

You are a dainty violet, Yet withered ere you can be set Within the virgin’s coronet.

You are the queen all flowers among; But die you must, fair maid, ere long, As he, the maker of this song.

_258._ _Delight in Disorder_

A sweet disorder in the dress Kindles in clothes a wantonness: A lawn about the shoulders thrown Into a fine distraction: An erring lace, which here and there Enthrals the crimson stomacher: A cuff neglectful, and thereby Ribbands to flow confusedly: A winning wave, deserving note, In the tempestuous petticoat: A careless shoe-string, in whose tie I see a wild civility: Do more bewitch me than when art Is too precise in every part.

_259._ _Upon Julia’s Clothes_

Whenas in silks my Julia goes, Then, then, methinks, how sweetly flows The liquefaction of her clothes!

Next, when I cast mine eyes and see That brave vibration each way free, --O how that glittering taketh me!

_260._ _The Bracelet: To Julia_

Why I tie about thy wrist, Julia, this silken twist; For what other reason is’t But to show thee how, in part, Thou my pretty captive art? But thy bond-slave is my heart: ’Tis but silk that bindeth thee, Knap the thread and thou art free; But ’tis otherwise with me: --I am bound and fast bound, so That from thee I cannot go; If I could, I would not so.

_261._ _To Daisies, not to shut so soon_

Shut not so soon; the dull-eyed night Has not as yet begun To make a seizure on the light, Or to seal up the sun.

No marigolds yet closèd are, No shadows great appear; Nor doth the early shepherd’s star Shine like a spangle here.

Stay but till my Julia close Her life-begetting eye, And let the whole world then dispose Itself to live or die.

_262._ _The Night-piece: To Julia_

Her eyes the glow-worm lend thee, The shooting stars attend thee; And the elves also, Whose little eyes glow Like the sparks of fire, befriend thee.

No Will-o’-the-wisp mislight thee, Nor snake or slow-worm bite thee; But on, on thy way Not making a stay, Since ghost there’s none to affright thee.

Let not the dark thee cumber: What though the moon does slumber? The stars of the night Will lend thee their light Like tapers clear without number.

Then, Julia, let me woo thee, Thus, thus to come unto me; And when I shall meet Thy silv’ry feet, My soul I’ll pour into thee.

_263._ _To Music, to becalm his Fever_

Charm me asleep, and melt me so With thy delicious numbers, That, being ravish’d, hence I go Away in easy slumbers. Ease my sick head, And make my bed, Thou power that canst sever From me this ill, And quickly still, Though thou not kill My fever.

Thou sweetly canst convert the same From a consuming fire Into a gentle licking flame, And make it thus expire. Then make me weep My pains asleep; And give me such reposes That I, poor I, May think thereby I live and die ’Mongst roses.

Fall on me like the silent dew, Or like those maiden showers Which, by the peep of day, do strew A baptism o’er the flowers. Melt, melt my pains With thy soft strains; That, having ease me given, With full delight I leave this light, And take my flight For Heaven.

_264._ _To Dianeme_

Sweet, be not proud of those two eyes Which starlike sparkle in their skies; Nor be you proud that you can see All hearts your captives, yours yet free; Be you not proud of that rich hair Which wantons with the love-sick air; Whenas that ruby which you wear, Sunk from the tip of your soft ear, Will last to be a precious stone When all your world of beauty’s gone.

_265._ _To Œnone_

What conscience, say, is it in thee, When I a heart had one, To take away that heart from me, And to retain thy own?

For shame or pity now incline To play a loving part; Either to send me kindly thine, Or give me back my heart.

Covet not both; but if thou dost Resolve to part with neither, Why, yet to show that thou art just, Take me and mine together!

_266._ _To Anthea, who may command him Anything_

Bid me to live, and I will live Thy Protestant to be; Or bid me love, and I will give A loving heart to thee.

A heart as soft, a heart as kind, A heart as sound and free As in the whole world thou canst find, That heart I’ll give to thee.

Bid that heart stay, and it will stay To honour thy decree: Or bid it languish quite away, And’t shall do so for thee.

Bid me to weep, and I will weep While I have eyes to see: And, having none, yet will I keep A heart to weep for thee.

Bid me despair, and I’ll despair Under that cypress-tree: Or bid me die, and I will dare E’en death to die for thee.

Thou art my life, my love, my heart, The very eyes of me: And hast command of every part To live and die for thee.

_267._ _To the Willow-tree_

Thou art to all lost love the best, The only true plant found, Wherewith young men and maids distrest, And left of love, are crown’d.

When once the lover’s rose is dead, Or laid aside forlorn: Then willow-garlands ’bout the head Bedew’d with tears are worn.

When with neglect, the lovers’ bane, Poor maids rewarded be For their love lost, their only gain Is but a wreath from thee.

And underneath thy cooling shade, When weary of the light, The love-spent youth and love-sick maid Come to weep out the night.

_268._ _The Mad Maid’s Song_

Good-morrow to the day so fair, Good-morning, sir, to you; Good-morrow to mine own torn hair Bedabbled with the dew.

Good-morning to this primrose too, Good-morrow to each maid That will with flowers the tomb bestrew Wherein my love is laid.

Ah! woe is me, woe, woe is me! Alack and well-a-day! For pity, sir, find out that bee Which bore my love away.

I’ll seek him in your bonnet brave, I’ll seek him in your eyes; Nay, now I think they’ve made his grave I’ th’ bed of strawberries.

I’ll seek him there; I know ere this The cold, cold earth doth shake him; But I will go, or send a kiss By you, sir, to awake him.

Pray hurt him not; though he be dead, He knows well who do love him, And who with green turfs rear his head, And who do rudely move him.

He’s soft and tender (pray take heed); With bands of cowslips bind him, And bring him home--but ’tis decreed That I shall never find him!

_269._ _Comfort to a Youth that had lost his Love_

What needs complaints, When she a place Has with the race Of saints?

In endless mirth She thinks not on What’s said or done In Earth.

She sees no tears, Or any tone Of thy deep groan She hears:

Nor does she mind Or think on’t now That ever thou Wast kind;

But changed above, She likes not there, As she did here, Thy love.

Forbear therefore, And lull asleep Thy woes, and weep No more.

_270._ _To Meadows_

Ye have been fresh and green, Ye have been fill’d with flowers, And ye the walks have been Where maids have spent their hours.

You have beheld how they With wicker arks did come To kiss and bear away The richer cowslips home.

You’ve heard them sweetly sing, And seen them in a round: Each virgin like a spring, With honeysuckles crown’d.

But now we see none here Whose silv’ry feet did tread And with dishevell’d hair Adorn’d this smoother mead.

Like unthrifts, having spent Your stock and needy grown, You’re left here to lament Your poor estates, alone.

_271._ _A Child’s Grace_

Here a little child I stand Heaving up my either hand; Cold as paddocks though they be, Here I lift them up to Thee, For a benison to fall On our meat and on us all. Amen.

_271._ paddocks] frogs.

_272._ _Epitaph_

upon a Child that died

Here she lies, a pretty bud, Lately made of flesh and blood: Who as soon fell fast asleep As her little eyes did peep. Give her strewings, but not stir The earth that lightly covers her.

_273._ _Another_

Here a pretty baby lies Sung asleep with lullabies: Pray be silent and not stir Th’ easy earth that covers her.

_274._ _His Winding-sheet_

Come thou, who art the wine and wit Of all I’ve writ: The grace, the glory, and the best Piece of the rest. Thou art of what I did intend The all and end; And what was made, was made to meet Thee, thee, my sheet. Come then and be to my chaste side Both bed and bride: We two, as reliques left, will have One rest, one grave: And hugging close, we will not fear Lust entering here: Where all desires are dead and cold As is the mould; And all affections are forgot, Or trouble not. Here, here, the slaves and prisoners be From shackles free: And weeping widows long oppress’d Do here find rest. The wrongèd client ends his laws Here, and his cause. Here those long suits of Chancery lie Quiet, or die: And all Star-Chamber bills do cease Or hold their peace. Here needs no Court for our Request Where all are best, All wise, all equal, and all just Alike i’ th’ dust. Nor need we here to fear the frown Of court or crown: Where fortune bears no sway o’er things, There all are kings. In this securer place we’ll keep As lull’d asleep; Or for a little time we’ll lie As robes laid by; To be another day re-worn, Turn’d, but not torn: Or like old testaments engross’d, Lock’d up, not lost. And for a while lie here conceal’d, To be reveal’d Next at the great Platonick year, And then meet here.

_274._ Platonick year] the perfect or cyclic year, when the sun, moon, and five planets end their revolutions together and start anew. See _Timæus_, p. 39.

_275._ _Litany to the Holy Spirit_

In the hour of my distress, When temptations me oppress, And when I my sins confess, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When I lie within my bed, Sick in heart and sick in head, And with doubts discomforted, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the house doth sigh and weep, And the world is drown’d in sleep, Yet mine eyes the watch do keep, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the passing bell doth toll, And the Furies in a shoal Come to fright a parting soul, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the tapers now burn blue, And the comforters are few, And that number more than true, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the priest his last hath pray’d, And I nod to what is said, ’Cause my speech is now decay’d, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When, God knows, I’m toss’d about Either with despair or doubt; Yet before the glass be out, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the tempter me pursu’th With the sins of all my youth, And half damns me with untruth, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the flames and hellish cries Fright mine ears and fright mine eyes, And all terrors me surprise, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

When the Judgment is reveal’d, And that open’d which was seal’d, When to Thee I have appeal’d, Sweet Spirit, comfort me!

FRANCIS QUARLES

1592-1644

_276._ _A Divine Rapture_

E’en like two little bank-dividing brooks, That wash the pebbles with their wanton streams, And having ranged and search’d a thousand nooks, Meet both at length in silver-breasted Thames, Where in a greater current they conjoin: So I my Best-belovèd’s am; so He is mine.

E’en so we met; and after long pursuit, E’en so we joined; we both became entire; No need for either to renew a suit, For I was flax, and He was flames of fire: Our firm-united souls did more than twine; So I my Best-belovèd’s am; so He is mine.

If all those glittering Monarchs, that command The servile quarters of this earthly ball, Should tender in exchange their shares of land, I would not change my fortunes for them all: Their wealth is but a counter to my coin: The world’s but theirs; but my Belovèd’s mine.

_277._ _Epigram_

Respice Finem

My soul, sit thou a patient looker-on; Judge not the play before the play is done: Her plot hath many changes; every day Speaks a new scene; the last act crowns the play.

HENRY KING, BISHOP OF CHICHESTER

1592-1669

_278._ _A Contemplation upon Flowers_

Brave flowers--that I could gallant it like you, And be as little vain! You come abroad, and make a harmless show, And to your beds of earth again. You are not proud: you know your birth: For your embroider'd garments are from earth.

You do obey your months and times, but I Would have it ever Spring: My fate would know no Winter, never die, Nor think of such a thing. O that I could my bed of earth but view And smile, and look as cheerfully as you!

O teach me to see Death and not to fear, But rather to take truce! How often have I seen you at a bier, And there look fresh and spruce! You fragrant flowers! then teach me, that my breath Like yours may sweeten and perfume my death.

_279._ _A Renunciation_

We, that did nothing study but the way To love each other, with which thoughts the day Rose with delight to us and with them set, Must learn the hateful art, how to forget. We, that did nothing wish that Heaven could give Beyond ourselves, nor did desire to live Beyond that wish, all these now cancel must, As if not writ in faith, but words and dust. Yet witness those clear vows which lovers make, Witness the chaste desires that never brake Into unruly heats; witness that breast Which in thy bosom anchor'd his whole rest-- 'Tis no default in us: I dare acquite Thy maiden faith, thy purpose fair and white As thy pure self. Cross planets did envý Us to each other, and Heaven did untie Faster than vows could bind. Oh, that the stars, When lovers meet, should stand opposed in wars!

Since then some higher Destinies command, Let us not strive, nor labour to withstand What is past help. The longest date of grief Can never yield a hope of our relief: Fold back our arms; take home our fruitless loves, That must new fortunes try, like turtle-doves Dislodgèd from their haunts. We must in tears Unwind a love knit up in many years. In this last kiss I here surrender thee Back to thyself.--So, thou again art free: Thou in another, sad as that, resend The truest heart that lover e'er did lend. Now turn from each: so fare our sever'd hearts As the divorced soul from her body parts.

_280._ _Exequy on his Wife_

Accept, thou shrine of my dead saint, Instead of dirges this complaint; And for sweet flowers to crown thy herse Receive a strew of weeping verse From thy grieved friend, whom thou might'st see Quite melted into tears for thee. Dear loss! since thy untimely fate, My task hath been to meditate On thee, on thee! Thou art the book, The library whereon I look, Tho' almost blind. For thee, loved clay, I languish out, not

live, the day.... Thou hast benighted me; thy set This eve of blackness did beget, Who wast my day (tho' overcast Before thou hadst thy noontide past): And I remember must in tears Thou scarce hadst seen so many years As day tells hours. By thy clear sun My love and fortune first did run; But thou wilt never more appear Folded within my hemisphere, Since both thy light and motion, Like a fled star, is fall'n and gone, And 'twixt me and my soul's dear wish The earth now interposèd is.... I could allow thee for a time To darken me and my sad clime; Were it a month, a year, or ten, I would thy exile live till then, And all that space my mirth adjourn-- So thou wouldst promise to return, And putting off thy ashy shroud At length disperse this sorrow's cloud. But woe is me! the longest date Too narrow is to calculate These empty hopes: never shall I Be so much blest as to descry A glimpse of thee, till that day come Which shall the earth to cinders doom, And a fierce fever must calcine The body of this world--like thine, My little world! That fit of fire Once off, our bodies shall aspire To our souls' bliss: then we shall rise And view ourselves with clearer eyes In that calm region where no night Can hide us from each other's sight. Meantime thou hast her, earth: much good May my harm do thee! Since it stood With Heaven's will I might not call Her longer mine, I give thee all My short-lived right and interest In her whom living I loved best. Be kind to her, and prithee look Thou write into thy Doomsday book Each parcel of this rarity Which in thy casket shrined doth lie, As thou wilt answer Him that lent-- Not gave--thee my dear monument. So close the ground, and 'bout her shade Black curtains draw: my bride is laid. Sleep on, my Love, in thy cold bed Never to be disquieted! My last good-night! Thou wilt not wake Till I thy fate shall overtake: Till age, or grief, or sickness must Marry my body to that dust It so much loves; and fill the room My heart keeps empty in thy tomb. Stay for me there: I will not fail To meet thee in that hollow vale. And think not much of my delay: I am already on the way, And follow thee with all the speed Desire can make, or sorrows breed. Each minute is a short degree And every hour a step towards thee.... 'Tis true--with shame and grief I yield-- Thou, like the van, first took'st the field; And gotten hast the victory In thus adventuring to die Before me, whose more years might crave A just precedence in the grave. But hark! my pulse, like a soft drum, Beats my approach, tells thee I come; And slow howe'er my marches be I shall at last sit down by thee. The thought of this bids me go on And wait my dissolution With hope and comfort. Dear--forgive The crime--I am content to live Divided, with but half a heart, Till we shall meet and never part.

GEORGE HERBERT

1593-1632

_281._ _Virtue_

Sweet day, so cool, so calm, so bright! The bridal of the earth and sky-- The dew shall weep thy fall to-night; For thou must die.

Sweet rose, whose hue angry and brave Bids the rash gazer wipe his eye, Thy root is ever in its grave, And thou must die.

Sweet spring, full of sweet days and roses, A box where sweets compacted lie, My music shows ye have your closes, And all must die.

Only a sweet and virtuous soul, Like season’d timber, never gives; But though the whole world turn to coal, Then chiefly lives.

_282._ _Easter_

I got me flowers to straw Thy way, I got me boughs off many a tree; But Thou wast up by break of day, And brought’st Thy sweets along with Thee.

Yet though my flowers be lost, they say A heart can never come too late; Teach it to sing Thy praise this day. And then this day my life shall date.

_283._ _Discipline_

Throw away Thy rod, Throw away Thy wrath; O my God, Take the gentle path!

For my heart’s desire Unto Thine is bent: I aspire To a full consent.

Not a word or look I affect to own, But by book, And Thy Book alone.

Though I fail, I weep; Though I halt in pace, Yet I creep To the throne of grace.

Then let wrath remove; Love will do the deed: For with love Stony hearts will bleed.

Love is swift of foot; Love’s a man of war, And can shoot, And can hit from far.

Who can ’scape his bow? That which wrought on Thee, Brought Thee low, Needs must work on me.

Throw away Thy rod; Though man frailties hath, Thou art God: Throw away Thy wrath!

_284._ _A Dialogue_

Man. Sweetest Saviour, if my soul Were but worth the having, Quickly should I then control Any thought of waving. But when all my care and pains Cannot give the name of gains To Thy wretch so full of stains, What delight or hope remains?

Saviour. What, child, is the balance thine, Thine the poise and measure? If I say, ‘Thou shalt be Mine,’ Finger not My treasure. What the gains in having thee Do amount to, only He Who for man was sold can see That transferr’d th’ accounts to Me.

Man. But as I can see no merit Leading to this favour, So the way to fit me for it Is beyond my savour. As the reason, then, is Thine, So the way is none of mine; I disclaim the whole design; Sin disclaims and I resign.

Saviour. That is all: if that I could Get without repining; And My clay, My creature, would Follow My resigning;

savour] savoir, knowing.

That as I did freely part With My glory and desert, Left all joys to feel all smart----

Man. Ah, no more! Thou break’st my heart!

_285._ _The Pulley_

When God at first made Man, Having a glass of blessings standing by-- Let us (said He) pour on him all we can; Let the world’s riches, which dispersèd lie, Contract into a span.

So strength first made a way, Then beauty flow’d, then wisdom, honour, pleasure: When almost all was out, God made a stay, Perceiving that, alone of all His treasure, Rest in the bottom lay.

For if I should (said He) Bestow this jewel also on My creature, He would adore My gifts instead of Me, And rest in Nature, not the God of Nature; So both should losers be.

Yet let him keep the rest, But keep them with repining restlessness; Let him be rich and weary, that at least, If goodness lead him not, yet weariness May toss him to My breast.

_286._ _Love_

Love bade me welcome; yet my soul drew back, Guilty of dust and sin. But quick-eyed Love, observing me grow slack From my first entrance in, Drew nearer to me, sweetly questioning If I lack’d anything.

‘A guest,’ I answer’d, ‘worthy to be here:’ Love said, ‘You shall be he.’ ‘I, the unkind, ungrateful? Ah, my dear, I cannot look on Thee.’ Love took my hand and smiling did reply, ‘Who made the eyes but I?’

‘Truth, Lord; but I have marr’d them: let my shame Go where it doth deserve.’ ‘And know you not,’ says Love, ‘Who bore the blame?’ ‘My dear, then I will serve.’ ‘You must sit down,’ says Love, ‘and taste my meat.’ So I did sit and eat.

JAMES SHIRLEY

1596-1666

_287._ _A Hymn_

Fly, my Soul! What hangs upon Thy drooping wings, And weighs them down With love of gaudy mortal things?

The Sun is now i’ the east: each shade As he doth rise Is shorter made, That earth may lessen to our eyes.

O be not careless then and play Until the Star of Peace Hide all his beams in dark recess! Poor pilgrims needs must lose their way, When all the shadows do increase.

_288._ _Death the Leveller_

The glories of our blood and state Are shadows, not substantial things; There is no armour against Fate; Death lays his icy hand on kings: Sceptre and Crown Must tumble down, And in the dust be equal made With the poor crookèd scythe and spade.

Some men with swords may reap the field, And plant fresh laurels where they kill: But their strong nerves at last must yield; They tame but one another still: Early or late They stoop to fate, And must give up their murmuring breath When they, pale captives, creep to death.

The garlands wither on your brow; Then boast no more your mighty deeds! Upon Death’s purple altar now See where the victor-victim bleeds. Your heads must come To the cold tomb: Only the actions of the just Smell sweet and blossom in their dust.

THOMAS CAREW

1595?-1639?

_289._ _Song_

Ask me no more where Jove bestows, When June is past, the fading rose; For in your beauty’s orient deep These flowers, as in their causes, sleep.

Ask me no more whither do stray The golden atoms of the day; For in pure love heaven did prepare Those powders to enrich your hair.

Ask me no more whither doth haste The nightingale when May is past; For in your sweet dividing throat She winters and keeps warm her note.

Ask me no more where those stars ’light That downwards fall in dead of night For in your eyes they sit, and there Fixèd become as in their sphere.

Ask me no more if east or west The Phœnix builds her spicy nest; For unto you at last she flies, And in your fragrant bosom dies.

_290._ _Persuasions to Joy: a Song_

If the quick spirits in your eye Now languish and anon must die; If every sweet and every grace Must fly from that forsaken face; Then, Celia, let us reap our joys Ere Time such goodly fruit destroys.

Or if that golden fleece must grow. For ever free from agèd snow; If those bright suns must know no shade, Nor your fresh beauties ever fade; Then fear not, Celia, to bestow What, still being gather’d, still must grow.

Thus either Time his sickle brings In vain, or else in vain his wings.

_291._ _To His Inconstant Mistress_

When thou, poor Excommunicate From all the joys of Love, shalt see The full reward and glorious fate Which my strong faith shall purchase me, Then curse thine own inconstancy!

A fairer hand than thine shall cure That heart which thy false oaths did wound; And to my soul a soul more pure Than thine shall by Love’s hand be bound, And both with equal glory crown’d.

Then shalt thou weep, entreat, complain To Love, as I did once to thee; When all thy tears shall be as vain As mine were then: for thou shalt be Damn’d for thy false

apostasy.

_292._ _The Unfading Beauty_

He that loves a rosy cheek, Or a coral lip admires, Or from star-like eyes doth seek Fuel to maintain his fires: As old Time makes these decay, So his flames must waste away.

But a smooth and steadfast mind, Gentle thoughts and calm desires, Hearts with equal love combined, Kindle never-dying fires. Where these are not, I despise Lovely cheeks or lips or eyes.

_293._ _Ingrateful Beauty threatened_

Know, Celia, since thou art so proud, ’Twas I that gave thee thy renown. Thou hadst in the forgotten crowd Of common beauties lived unknown, Had not my verse extoll’d thy name, And with it imp’d the wings of Fame.

That killing power is none of thine; I gave it to thy voice and eyes; Thy sweets, thy graces, all are mine; Thou art my star, shin’st in my skies; Then dart not from thy borrow’d sphere Lightning on him that fix’d thee there.

_293._ imp’d] grafted with new feathers.

Tempt me with such affrights no more, Lest what I made I uncreate; Let fools thy mystic form adore, I know thee in thy mortal state. Wise poets, that wrapt Truth in tales, Knew her themselves through all her veils.

_294._ _Epitaph_

On the Lady Mary Villiers

The Lady Mary Villiers lies Under this stone; with weeping eyes The parents that first gave her birth, And their sad friends, laid her in earth. If any of them, Reader, were Known unto thee, shed a tear; Or if thyself possess a gem As dear to thee, as this to them, Though a stranger to this place, Bewail in theirs thine own hard case: For thou perhaps at thy return May’st find thy Darling in an urn.

_295._ _Another_

This little vault, this narrow room, Of Love and Beauty is the tomb; The dawning beam, that ’gan to clear Our clouded sky, lies darkened here, For ever set to us: by Death Sent to enflame the World Beneath, ’Twas but a bud, yet did contain More sweetness than shall spring again; A budding Star, that might have grown Into a Sun when it had blown. This hopeful Beauty did create New life in Love’s declining state; But now his empire ends, and we From fire and wounding darts are free; His brand, his bow, let no man fear: The flames, the arrows, all lie here.

JASPER MAYNE

1604-1672

_296._ _Time_

Time is the feather’d thing, And, whilst I praise The sparklings of thy looks and call them rays, Takes wing, Leaving behind him as he flies An unperceivèd dimness in thine eyes. His minutes, whilst they’re told, Do make us old; And every sand of his fleet glass, Increasing age as it doth pass, Insensibly sows wrinkles there Where flowers and roses do appear. Whilst we do speak, our fire Doth into ice expire, Flames turn to frost; And ere we can Know how our crow turns swan, Or how a silver snow Springs there where jet did grow, Our fading spring is in dull winter lost. Since then the Night hath hurl’d Darkness, Love’s shade, Over its enemy the Day, and made The world Just such a blind and shapeless thing As ’twas before light did from darkness spring, Let us employ its treasure And make shade pleasure: Let’s number out the hours by blisses, And count the minutes by our kisses; Let the heavens new motions feel And by our embraces wheel; And whilst we try the way By which Love doth convey Soul unto soul, And mingling so Makes them such raptures know As makes them entrancèd lie In mutual ecstasy, Let the harmonious spheres in music roll!

WILLIAM HABINGTON

1605-1654

_297._ _To Roses in the Bosom of Castara_

Ye blushing virgins happy are In the chaste nunnery of her breasts-- For he’d profane so chaste a fair, Whoe’er should call them Cupid’s nests.

Transplanted thus how bright ye grow! How rich a perfume do ye yield! In some close garden cowslips so Are sweeter than i’ th’ open field.

In those white cloisters live secure From the rude blasts of wanton breath!-- Each hour more innocent and pure, Till you shall wither into death.

Then that which living gave you room, Your glorious sepulchre shall be. There wants no marble for a tomb Whose breast hath marble been to me.

_298._ _Nox Nocti Indicat Scientiam_

When I survey the bright Celestial sphere; So rich with jewels hung, that Night Doth like an Ethiop bride appear:

My soul her wings doth spread And heavenward flies, Th’ Almighty’s mysteries to read In the large volumes of the skies.

For the bright firmament Shoots forth no flame So silent, but is eloquent In speaking the Creator’s name.

No unregarded star Contracts its light Into so small a character, Removed far from our human sight,

But if we steadfast look We shall discern In it, as in some holy book, How man may heavenly knowledge learn.

It tells the conqueror That far-stretch’d power, Which his proud dangers traffic for, Is but the triumph of an hour:

That from the farthest North, Some nation may, Yet undiscover’d, issue forth, And o’er his new-got conquest sway:

Some nation yet shut in With hills of ice May be let out to scourge his sin, Till they shall equal him in vice.

And then they likewise shall Their ruin have; For as yourselves your empires fall, And every kingdom hath a grave.

Thus those celestial fires, Though seeming mute, The fallacy of our desires And all the pride of life confute:--

For they have watch’d since first The World had birth: And found sin in itself accurst, And nothing permanent on Earth.

THOMAS RANDOLPH

1605-1635

_299._ _A Devout Lover_

I have a mistress, for perfections rare In every eye, but in my thoughts most fair. Like tapers on the altar shine her eyes; Her breath is the perfume of sacrifice; And wheresoever my fancy would begin, Still her perfection lets religion in. We sit and talk, and kiss away the hours As chastely as the morning dews kiss flowers: I touch her, like my beads, with devout care, And come unto my courtship as my prayer.

_300._ _An Ode to Master Anthony Stafford_

to hasten Him into the Country

Come, spur away, I have no patience for a longer stay, But must go down And leave the chargeable noise of this great town: I will the country see, Where old simplicity, Though hid in gray, Doth look more gay Than foppery in plush and scarlet clad. Farewell, you city wits, that are Almost at civil war-- ’Tis time that I grow wise, when all the world grows mad.

More of my days I will not spend to gain an idiot’s praise; Or to make sport For some slight Puisne of the Inns of Court. Then, worthy Stafford, say, How shall we spend the day? With what delights Shorten the nights? When from this tumult we are got secure, Where mirth with all her freedom goes, Yet shall no finger lose; Where every word is thought, and every thought is pure?

There from the tree We’ll cherries pluck, and pick the strawberry; And every day Go see the wholesome country girls make hay, Whose brown hath lovelier grace Than any painted face That I do know Hyde Park can show: Where I had rather gain a kiss than meet (Though some of them in greater state Might court my love with plate) The beauties of the Cheap, and wives of Lombard Street.

But think upon Some other pleasures: these to me are none. Why do I prate Of women, that are things against my fate! I never mean to wed That torture to my bed: My Muse is she My love shall be. Let clowns get wealth and heirs: when I am gone

And that great bugbear, grisly Death, Shall take this idle breath, If I a poem leave, that poem is my son.

Of this no more! We'll rather taste the bright Pomona's store. No fruit shall 'scape Our palates, from the damson to the grape. Then, full, we'll seek a shade, And hear what music's made; How Philomel Her tale doth tell, And how the other birds do fill the quire; The thrush and blackbird lend their throats, Warbling melodious notes; We will all sports enjoy which others but desire.

Ours is the sky, Where at what fowl we please our hawk shall fly: Nor will we spare To hunt the crafty fox or timorous hare; But let our hounds run loose In any ground they'll choose; The buck shall fall, The stag, and all. Our pleasures must from their own warrants be, For to my Muse, if not to me, I'm sure all game is free: Heaven, earth, are all but parts of her great royalty.

And when we mean To taste of Bacchus' blessings now and then, And drink by stealth A cup or two to noble Barkley's health, I'll take my pipe and try The Phrygian melody; Which he that hears, Lets through his ears A madness to distemper all the brain: Then I another pipe will take And Doric music make, To civilize with graver notes our wits again.

SIR WILLIAM DAVENANT

1606-1668

_301._ _Aubade_

The lark now leaves his wat'ry nest, And climbing shakes his dewy wings. He takes this window for the East, And to implore your light he sings-- Awake, awake! the morn will never rise Till she can dress her beauty at your eyes.

The merchant bows unto the seaman's star, The ploughman from the sun his season takes; But still the lover wonders what they are Who look for day before his mistress wakes. Awake, awake! break thro' your veils of lawn! Then draw your curtains, and begin the dawn!

_302._ _To a Mistress Dying_

Lover. Your beauty, ripe and calm and fresh As eastern summers are, Must now, forsaking time and flesh, Add light to some small star.

Philosopher. Whilst she yet lives, were stars decay'd, Their light by hers relief might find; But Death will lead her to a shade Where Love is cold and Beauty blind.

Lover. Lovers, whose priests all poets are, Think every mistress, when she dies, Is changed at least into a star: And who dares doubt the poets wise?

Philosopher. But ask not bodies doom'd to die To what abode they go; Since Knowledge is but Sorrow's spy, It is not safe to know.

_303._ _Praise and Prayer_

Praise is devotion fit for mighty minds, The diff'ring world's agreeing sacrifice; Where Heaven divided faiths united finds: But Prayer in various discord upward flies.

For Prayer the ocean is where diversely Men steer their course, each to a sev'ral coast; Where all our interests so discordant be That half beg winds by which the rest are lost.

By Penitence when we ourselves forsake, 'Tis but in wise design on piteous Heaven; In Praise we nobly give what God may take, And are, without a beggar's blush, forgiven.

EDMUND WALLER

1606-1687

_304._ _On a Girdle_

That which her slender waist confined Shall now my joyful temples bind; No monarch but would give his crown His arms might do what this has done.

It was my Heaven's extremest sphere, The pale which held that lovely deer: My joy, my grief, my hope, my love, Did all within this circle move.

A narrow compass! and yet there Dwelt all that's good, and all that's fair! Give me but what this ribband bound, Take all the rest the sun goes round!

_305._ _Go, lovely Rose_

Go, lovely Rose-- Tell her that wastes her time and me, That now she knows, When I resemble her to thee, How sweet and fair she seems to be.

Tell her that's young, And shuns to have her graces spied, That hadst thou sprung In deserts where no men abide, Thou must have uncommended died.

Small is the worth Of beauty from the light retired: Bid her come forth, Suffer herself to be desired, And not blush so to be admired.

Then die--that she The common fate of all things rare May read in thee; How small a part of time they share That are so wondrous sweet and fair!

_306._ _Old Age_

The seas are quiet when the winds give o'er; So calm are we when passions are no more. For then we know how vain it was to boast Of fleeting things, so certain to be lost. Clouds of affection from our younger eyes Conceal that emptiness which age descries.

The soul's dark cottage, batter'd and decay'd, Lets in new light through chinks that Time hath made: Stronger by weakness, wiser men become As they draw near to their eternal home. Leaving the old, both worlds at once they view That stand upon the threshold of the new.

JOHN MILTON

1608-1674

_307._ _Hymn on the Morning of Christ’s Nativity_

It was the Winter wilde, While the Heav’n-born-childe, All meanly wrapt in the rude manger lies; Nature in aw to him Had doff’t her gawdy trim, With her great Master so to sympathize: It was no season then for her To wanton with the Sun her lusty Paramour.

Only with speeches fair She woo’s the gentle Air To hide her guilty front with innocent Snow, And on her naked shame, Pollute with sinfull blame, The Saintly Vail of Maiden white to throw, Confounded, that her Makers eyes Should look so neer upon her foul deformities.

But he her fears to cease, Sent down the meek-eyd Peace, She crown’d with Olive green, came softly sliding Down through the turning sphear His ready Harbinger, With Turtle wing the amorous clouds dividing, And waving wide her mirtle wand, She strikes a universall Peace through Sea and Land.

No War, or Battails sound Was heard the World around, The idle spear and shield were high up hung; The hookèd Chariot stood Unstain’d with hostile blood, The Trumpet spake not to the armèd throng, And Kings sate still with awfull eye, As if they surely knew their sovran Lord was by.

But peacefull was the night Wherin the Prince of light His raign of peace upon the earth began: The Windes with wonder whist, Smoothly the waters kist, Whispering new joyes to the milde Ocean, Who now hath quite forgot to rave, While Birds of Calm sit brooding on the charmèd wave.

The Stars with deep amaze Stand fixt in stedfast gaze, Bending one way their pretious influence, And will not take their flight, For all the morning light, Or Lucifer that often warn’d them thence; But in their glimmering Orbs did glow, Untill their Lord himself bespake, and bid them go.

And though the shady gloom Had given day her room, The Sun himself with-held his wonted speed, And hid his head for shame, As his inferiour flame, The new enlightn’d world no more should need; He saw a greater Sun appear Then his bright Throne, or burning Axletree could bear.

The Shepherds on the Lawn, Or ere the point of dawn, Sate simply chatting in a rustick row; Full little thought they than, That the mighty Pan Was kindly com to live with them below; Perhaps their loves, or els their sheep, Was all that did their silly thoughts so busie keep.

When such musick sweet Their hearts and ears did greet, As never was by mortall finger strook, Divinely-warbled voice Answering the stringèd noise, As all their souls in blisfull rapture took The Air such pleasure loth to lose, With thousand echo’s still prolongs each heav’nly close.

Nature that heard such sound Beneath the hollow round Of Cynthia’s seat, the Airy region thrilling, Now was almost won To think her part was don, And that her raign had here its last fulfilling; She knew such harmony alone Could hold all Heav’n and

Earth in happier union.

At last surrounds their sight A Globe of circular light, That with long beams the shame-fac't night array'd, The helmèd Cherubim And sworded Seraphim, Are seen in glittering ranks with wings displaid, Harping in loud and solemn quire, With unexpressive notes to Heav'ns new-born Heir.

Such musick (as 'tis said) Before was never made, But when of old the sons of morning sung, While the Creator Great His constellations set, And the well-ballanc't world on hinges hung, And cast the dark foundations deep, And bid the weltring waves their oozy channel keep.

Ring out ye Crystall sphears, Once bless our human ears, (If ye have power to touch our senses so) And let your silver chime Move in melodious time; And let the Base of Heav'ns deep Organ blow And with your ninefold harmony Make up full consort to th'Angelike symphony.

For if such holy Song Enwrap our fancy long, Time will run back, and fetch the age of gold, And speckl'd vanity Will sicken soon and die, And leprous sin will melt from earthly mould, And Hell it self will pass away, And leave her dolorous mansions to the peering day.

Yea Truth, and Justice then Will down return to men, Th'enameld Arras of the Rain-bow wearing, And Mercy set between, Thron'd in Celestiall sheen, With radiant feet the tissued clouds down stearing, And Heav'n as at som festivall, Will open wide the Gates of her high Palace Hall.

But wisest Fate sayes no, This must not yet be so, The Babe lies yet in smiling Infancy, That on the bitter cross Must redeem our loss; So both himself and us to glorifie: Yet first to those ychain'd in sleep, The wakefull trump of doom must thunder through the deep,

With such a horrid clang As on mount Sinai rang While the red fire, and smouldring clouds out brake: The agèd Earth agast With terrour of that blast, Shall from the surface to the center shake; When at the worlds last session, The dreadfull Judge in middle Air shall spread his throne.

And then at last our bliss Full and perfect is, But now begins; for from this happy day Th'old Dragon under ground In straiter limits bound, Not half so far casts his usurpèd sway, And wrath to see his Kingdom fail, Swindges the scaly Horrour of his foulded tail.

The Oracles are dumm, No voice or hideous humm Runs through the archèd roof in words deceiving. Apollo from his shrine Can no more divine, With hollow shreik the steep of Delphos leaving. No nightly trance, or breathèd spell, Inspire's the pale-ey'd Priest from the prophetic cell.

The lonely mountains o're, And the resounding shore, A voice of weeping heard, and loud lament; From haunted spring, and dale Edg'd with poplar pale, The parting Genius is with sighing sent, With flowre-inwov'n tresses torn The Nimphs in twilight shade of tangled thickets mourn.

In consecrated Earth, And on the holy Hearth, The Lars, and Lemures moan with midnight plaint, In Urns, and Altars round, A drear, and dying sound Affrights the Flamins at their service quaint; And the chill Marble seems to sweat, While each peculiar power forgoes his wonted seat.

Peor, and Baalim, Forsake their Temples dim, With that twise-batter'd god of Palestine, And moonèd Ashtaroth, Heav'ns Queen and Mother both, Now sits not girt with Tapers holy shine, The Libyc Hammon shrinks his horn, In vain the Tyrian Maids their wounded Thamuz mourn.

And sullen Moloch fled, Hath left in shadows dred, His burning Idol all of blackest hue, In vain with Cymbals ring, They call the grisly king, In dismall dance about the furnace blue; The brutish gods of Nile as fast, Isis and Orus, and the Dog Anubis hast.

Nor is Osiris seen In Memphian Grove, or Green, Trampling the unshowr'd Grasse with lowings loud: Nor can he be at rest Within his sacred chest, Naught but profoundest Hell can be his shroud, In vain with Timbrel'd Anthems dark The sable-stolèd Sorcerers bear his worshipt Ark.

He feels from Juda's Land The dredded Infants hand, The rayes of Bethlehem blind his dusky eyn; Nor all the gods beside, Longer dare abide, Not Typhon huge ending in snaky twine: Our Babe to shew his Godhead true, Can in his swadling bands controul the damnèd crew, So when the Sun in bed, Curtain'd with cloudy red, Pillows his chin upon an Orient wave, The flocking shadows pale, Troop to th'infernall jail, Each fetter'd Ghost slips to his severall grave, And the yellow-skirted Fayes, Fly after the Night-steeds, leaving their Moon-lov'd maze.

But see the Virgin blest, Hath laid her Babe to rest. Time is our tedious Song should here have ending, Heav'ns youngest teemèd Star, Hath fixt her polisht Car, Her sleeping Lord with Handmaid Lamp attending: And all about the Courtly Stable, Bright-harnest Angels sit in order serviceable.

_308._ _On Time_

Fly envious Time, till thou run out thy race, Call on the lazy leaden-stepping hours, Whose speed is but the heavy Plummets pace; And glut thy self with what thy womb devours, Which is no more then what is false and vain, And meerly mortal dross; So little is our loss, So little is thy gain. For when as each thing bad thou hast entomb'd, And last of all, thy greedy self consum'd, Then long Eternity shall greet our bliss With an individual kiss; And Joy shall overtake us as a flood, When every thing that is sincerely good And perfectly divine, With Truth, and Peace, and Love shall ever shine About the supreme Throne Of him, t'whose happy-making sight alone, When once our heav'nly-guided soul shall clime, Then all this Earthy grosnes quit, Attir'd with Stars, we shall for ever sit, Triumphing over Death, and Chance, and thee O Time.

_309._ _At a Solemn Musick_

Blest pair of Sirens, pledges of Heav'ns joy, Sphear-born harmonious Sisters, Voice, and Vers, Wed your divine sounds, and mixt power employ Dead things with inbreath'd sense able to pierce, And to our high-rais'd phantasie present, That undisturbèd Song of pure content, Ay sung before the saphire-colour'd throne To him

that sits theron With Saintly shout, and solemn Jubily, Where the bright Seraphim in burning row Their loud up-lifted Angel trumpets blow, And the Cherubick host in thousand quires Touch their immortal Harps of golden wires, With those just Spirits that wear victorious Palms, Hymns devout and holy Psalms Singing everlastingly; That we on Earth with undiscording voice May rightly answer that melodious noise; As once we did, till disproportion'd sin Jarr'd against natures chime, and with harsh din Broke the fair musick that all creatures made To their great Lord, whose love their motion sway'd In perfect Diapason, whilst they stood In first obedience, and their state of good. O may we soon again renew that Song, And keep in tune with Heav'n, till God ere long To his celestial consort us unite, To live with him, and sing in endles morn of light.

_310._ _L'Allegro_

Hence loathèd Melancholy Of Cerberus and blackest midnight born, In Stygian Cave forlorn 'Mongst horrid shapes, and shreiks, and sights unholy. Find out som uncouth cell, Where brooding darknes spreads his jealous wings, And the night-Raven sings; There, under Ebon shades, and low-brow'd Rocks, As ragged as thy Locks, In dark Cimmerian desert ever dwell. But com thou Goddes fair and free, In Heav'n ycleap'd Euphrosyne, And by men, heart-easing Mirth, Whom lovely Venus, at a birth With two sister Graces more To Ivy-crownèd Bacchus bore; Or whether (as som Sager sing) The frolick Wind that breathes the Spring, Zephir with Aurora playing, As he met her once a Maying, There on Beds of Violets blew, And fresh-blown Roses washt in dew, Fill'd her with thee a daughter fair, So bucksom, blith, and debonair. Haste thee nymph, and bring with thee Jest and youthful Jollity, Quips and Cranks, and wanton Wiles, Nods, and Becks, and Wreathèd Smiles, Such as hang on Hebe's cheek, And love to live in dimple sleek; Sport that wrincled Care derides, And Laughter holding both his sides. Com, and trip it as ye go On the light fantastick toe, And in thy right hand lead with thee, The Mountain Nymph, sweet Liberty; And if I give thee honour due, Mirth, admit me of thy crue To live with her, and live with thee, In unreprovèd pleasures free; To hear the Lark begin his flight, And singing startle the dull night, From his watch-towre in the skies, Till the dappled dawn doth rise; Then to com in spight of sorrow, And at my window bid good morrow, Through the Sweet-Briar, or the Vine, Or the twisted Eglantine. While the Cock with lively din, Scatters the rear of darknes thin, And to the stack, or the Barn dore, Stoutly struts his Dames before, Oft listening how the Hounds and horn Chearly rouse the slumbring morn, From the side of som Hoar Hill, Through the high wood echoing shrill. Som time walking not unseen By Hedge-row Elms, on Hillocks green, Right against the Eastern gate, Wher the great Sun begins his state, Rob'd in flames, and Amber light, The clouds in thousand Liveries dight. While the Plowman neer at hand, Whistles ore the Furrow'd Land, And the Milkmaid singeth blithe, And the Mower whets his sithe, And every Shepherd tells his tale Under the Hawthorn in the dale. Streit mine eye hath caught new pleasures Whilst the Lantskip round it measures, Russet Lawns, and Fallows Gray, Where the nibling flocks do stray, Mountains on whose barren brest The labouring clouds do often rest: Meadows trim with Daisies pide, Shallow Brooks, and Rivers wide. Towers, and Battlements it sees Boosom'd high in tufted Trees, Wher perhaps som beauty lies, The Cynosure of neighbouring

eyes. Hard by, a Cottage chimney smokes, From betwixt two agèd Okes, Where Corydon and Thyrsis met, Are at their savory dinner set Of Hearbs, and other Country Messes, Which the neat-handed Phillis dresses; And then in haste her Bowre she leaves, With Thestylis to bind the Sheaves; Or if the earlier season lead To the tann'd Haycock in the Mead, Som times with secure delight The up-land Hamlets will invite, When the merry Bells ring round, And the jocond rebecks sound To many a youth, and many a maid, Dancing in the Chequer'd shade; And young and old com forth to play On a Sunshine Holyday, Till the live-long day-light fail, Then to the Spicy Nut-brown Ale, With stones told of many a feat, How Faery Mab the junkets eat, She was pincht, and pull'd she sed, And he by Friars Lanthorn led Tells how the drudging Goblin swet, To ern his Cream-bowle duly set, When in one night, ere glimps of morn, His shadowy Flale hath thresh'd the Corn That ten day-labourers could not end, Then lies him down the Lubbar Fend, And stretch'd out all the Chimney's length, Basks at the fire his hairy strength; And Crop-full out of dores he flings, Ere the first Cock his Mattin rings. Thus don the Tales, to bed they creep, By whispering Windes soon lull'd asleep. Towred Cities please us then, And the busie humm of men, Where throngs of Knights and Barons bold, In weeds of Peace high triumphs hold, With store of Ladies, whose bright eies Rain influence, and judge the prise Of Wit, or Arms, while both contend To win her Grace, whom all commend. There let Hymen oft appear In Saffron robe, with Taper clear, And pomp, and feast, and revelry, With mask, and antique Pageantry, Such sights as youthfull Poets dream On Summer eeves by haunted stream. Then to the well-trod stage anon, If Jonsons learnèd Sock be on, Or sweetest Shakespear fancies childe, Warble his native Wood-notes wilde, And ever against eating Cares, Lap me in soft Lydian Aires, Married to immortal verse Such as the meeting soul may pierce In notes, with many a winding bout Of linckèd sweetnes long drawn out, With wanton heed, and giddy cunning, The melting voice through mazes running; Untwisting all the chains that ty The hidden soul of harmony. That Orpheus self may heave his head From golden slumber on a bed Of heapt Elysian flowres, and hear Such streins as would have won the ear Of Pluto, to have quite set free His half regain'd Eurydice. These delights, if thou canst give, Mirth with thee, I mean to live.

_311._ _Il Penseroso_

Hence vain deluding joyes, The brood of folly without father bred, How little you bested, Or fill the fixèd mind with all your toyes; Dwell in som idle brain, And fancies fond with gaudy shapes possess, As thick and numberless As the gay motes that people the Sun Beams, Or likest hovering dreams The fickle Pensioners of Morpheus train. But hail thou Goddes, sage and holy, Hail divinest Melancholy, Whose Saintly visage is too bright To hit the Sense of human sight; And therfore to our weaker view, Ore laid with black staid Wisdoms hue. Black, but such as in esteem, Prince Memnons sister might beseem, Or that Starr'd Ethiope Queen that strove To set her beauties praise above The Sea Nymphs, and their powers offended. Yet thou art higher far descended, Thee bright-hair'd Vesta long of yore, To solitary Saturn bore; His daughter she (in Saturns raign, Such mixture was not held a stain) Oft in glimmering Bowres, and glades He met her, and in secret shades Of woody Ida's inmost grove, Whilst yet there was no fear of Jove. Com pensive Nun, devout and pure, Sober, stedfast, and demure, All in a robe of darkest grain, Flowing with majestick train, And

sable stole of Cipres Lawn, Over thy decent shoulders drawn. Com, but keep thy wonted state, With eev'n step, and musing gate, And looks commercing with the skies, Thy rapt soul sitting in thine eyes: There held in holy passion still, Forget thy self to Marble, till With a sad Leaden downward cast, Thou fix them on the earth as fast. And joyn with thee calm Peace, and Quiet, Spare Fast, that oft with gods doth diet, And hears the Muses in a ring, Ay round about Joves Altar sing. And adde to these retirèd Leasure, That in trim Gardens takes his pleasure; But first, and chiefest, with thee bring, Him that yon soars on golden wing, Guiding the fiery-wheelèd throne, The Cherub Contemplation, And the mute Silence hist along, 'Less Philomel will daign a Song, In her sweetest, saddest plight, Smoothing the rugged brow of night, While Cynthia checks her Dragon yoke, Gently o're th'accustom'd Oke; Sweet Bird that shunn'st the noise of folly, Most musicall, most melancholy! Thee Chauntress oft the Woods among, I woo to hear thy eeven-Song; And missing thee, I walk unseen On the dry smooth-shaven Green, To behold the wandring Moon, Riding neer her highest noon, Like one that had bin led astray Through the Heav'ns wide pathles way; And oft, as if her head she bow'd, Stooping through a fleecy cloud. Oft on a Plat of rising ground, I hear the far-off Curfeu sound Over som wide-water'd shoar, Swinging slow with sullen roar; Or if the Ayr will not permit, Som still removèd place will fit. Where glowing Embers through the room Teach light to counterfeit a gloom, Far from all resort of mirth, Save the Cricket on the hearth, Or the Belmans drousie charm, To bless the dores from nightly harm: Or let my Lamp at midnight hour, Be seen in som high lonely Towr, Where I may oft out-watch the Bear, With thrice great Hermes, or unsphear The spirit of Plato to unfold What Worlds, or what vast Regions hold The immortal mind that hath forsook Her mansion in this fleshly nook: And of those Dæmons that are found In fire, air, flood, or under ground, Whose power hath a true consent With Planet, or with Element. Som time let Gorgeous Tragedy In Scepter'd Pall com sweeping by, Presenting Thebs, or Pelops line, Or the tale of Troy divine. Or what (though rare) of later age, Ennoblèd hath the Buskind stage. But, O sad Virgin, that thy power Might raise Musæeus from his bower Or bid the soul of Orpheus sing Such notes as warbled to the string, Drew Iron tears down Pluto's cheek, And made Hell grant what Love did seek. Or call up him that left half told The story of Cambuscan bold, Of Camball, and of Algarsife, And who had Canace to wife, That own'd the vertuous Ring and Glass, And of the wondrous Hors of Brass, On which the Tartar King did ride; And if ought els, great Bards beside, In sage and solemn tunes have sung, Of Turneys and of Trophies hung; Of Forests, and inchantments drear, Where more is meant then meets the ear. Thus night oft see me in thy pale career, Till civil-suited Morn appeer, Not trickt and frounc't as she was wont, With the Attick Boy to hunt, But Cherchef't in a comly Cloud, While rocking Winds are Piping loud, Or usher'd with a shower still, When the gust hath blown his fill, Ending on the russling Leaves, With minute drops from off the Eaves. And when the Sun begins to fling His flaring beams, me Goddes bring To archèd walks of twilight groves, And shadows brown that Sylvan loves, Of Pine, or monumental Oake, Where the rude Ax with heavèd stroke, Was never heard the Nymphs to daunt, Or fright them from their hallow'd haunt. There in close covert by som Brook, Where no profaner eye may look, Hide me from Day's garish eie, While the Bee with Honied thie, That at her flowry work doth sing, And the Waters murmuring With such consort

as they keep, Entice the dewy-feather’d Sleep; And let som strange mysterious dream, Wave at his Wings in Airy stream, Of lively portrature display’d, Softly on my eye-lids laid. And as I wake, sweet musick breath Above, about, or underneath, Sent by som spirit to mortals good, Or th’unseen Genius of the Wood. But let my due feet never fail, To walk the studious Cloysters pale, And love the high embowèd Roof, With antick Pillars massy proof, And storied Windows richly dight, Casting a dimm religious light. There let the pealing Organ blow, To the full voic’d Quire below, In Service high, and Anthems cleer, As may with sweetnes, through mine ear, Dissolve me into extasies, And bring all Heav’n before mine eyes. And may at last my weary age Find out the peacefull hermitage, The Hairy Gown and Mossy Cell, Where I may sit and rightly spell Of every Star that Heav’n doth shew, And every Herb that sips the dew; Till old experience do attain To somthing like Prophetic strain. These pleasures Melancholy give, And I with thee will choose to live.

_312._ _From ‘Arcades’_

O’re the smooth enameld green Where no print of step hath been, Follow me as I sing, And touch the warbled string. Under the shady roof Of branching Elm Star-proof, Follow me, I will bring you where she sits Clad in splendor as befits Her deity. Such a rural Queen All Arcadia hath not seen.

From ‘Comus’

_313._ _i_

The Star that bids the Shepherd fold, Now the top of Heav’n doth hold, And the gilded Car of Day, His glowing Axle doth allay In the steep Atlantick stream, And the slope Sun his upward beam Shoots against the dusky Pole, Pacing toward the other gole Of his Chamber in the East. Mean while welcom Joy, and Feast, Midnight shout, and revelry, Tipsie dance, and Jollity. Braid your Locks with rosie Twine Dropping odours, dropping Wine. Rigor now is gon to bed, And Advice with scrupulous head, Strict Age, and sowre Severity, With their grave Saws in slumber ly. We that are of purer fire Imitate the Starry Quire, Who in their nightly watchfull Sphears, Lead in swift round the Months and Years. The Sounds, and Seas with all their finny drove Now to the Moon in wavering Morrice move, And on the Tawny Sands and Shelves, Trip the pert Fairies and the dapper Elves; By dimpled Brook, and Fountain brim, The Wood-Nymphs deckt with Daisies trim, Their merry wakes and pastimes keep: What hath night to do with sleep? Night hath better sweets to prove, Venus now wakes, and wak’ns Love.... Com, knit hands, and beat the ground, In a light fantastick round.

_314._ _ii_

ECHO

Sweet Echo, sweetest Nymph that liv’st unseen Within thy airy shell By slow Meander’s margent green, And in the violet imbroider’d vale Where the love-lorn Nightingale Nightly to thee her sad Song mourneth well. Canst thou not tell me of a gentle Pair That likest thy Narcissus are? O if thou have Hid them in som flowry Cave, Tell me but where Sweet Queen of Parly, Daughter of the Sphear! So maist thou be

translated to the skies, And give resounding grace to all Heav’ns Harmonies?

315. iii

SABRINA

The Spirit sings:

Sabrina fair Listen where thou art sitting Under the glassie, cool, translucent wave, In twisted braids of Lillies knitting The loose train of thy amber-dropping hair, Listen for dear honour’s sake, Goddess of the silver lake, Listen and save!

Listen and appear to us, In name of great Oceanus, By the earth-shaking Neptune’s mace, And Tethys grave majestick pace, By hoary Nereus wrincled look, And the Carpathian wisards hook, By scaly Tritons winding shell, And old sooth-saying Glaucus spell, By Leucothea’s lovely hands, And her son that rules the strands, By Thetis tinsel-slipper’d feet, And the Songs of Sirens sweet, By dead Parthenope’s dear tomb, And fair Ligea’s golden comb, Wherwith she sits on diamond rocks Sleeking her soft alluring locks, By all the Nymphs that nightly dance Upon thy streams with wily glance, Rise, rise, and heave thy rosie head From thy coral-pav’n bed, And bridle in thy headlong wave, Till thou our summons answered have. Listen and save!

Sabrina replies:

By the rushy-fringèd bank, Where grows the Willow and the Osier dank, My sliding Chariot stayes, Thick set with Agat, and the azurn sheen Of Turkis blew, and Emrauld green That in the channell strayes, Whilst from off the waters fleet Thus I set my printless feet O’re the Cowslips Velvet head, That bends not as I tread, Gentle swain at thy request I am here.

_316._ _iv_

The Spirit epiloguizes:

To the Ocean now I fly, And those happy climes that ly Where day never shuts his eye, Up in the broad fields of the sky: There I suck the liquid ayr All amidst the Gardens fair Of Hesperus, and his daughters three That sing about the golden tree: Along the crispèd shades and bowres Revels the spruce and jocond Spring, The Graces, and the rosie-boosom’d Howres, Thither all their bounties bring, That there eternal Summer dwels, And West winds, with musky wing About the cedar’n alleys fling Nard, and Cassia’s balmy smels. Iris there with humid bow, Waters the odorous banks that blow Flowers of more mingled hew Than her purfl’d scarf can shew, And drenches with Elysian dew (List mortals, if your ears be true) Beds of Hyacinth, and roses Where young Adonis oft reposes, Waxing well of his deep wound In slumber soft, and on the ground Sadly sits th’ Assyrian Queen; But far above in spangled sheen Celestial Cupid her fam’d son advanc’t, Holds his dear Psyche sweet intranc’t After her wandring labours long, Till free consent the gods among Make her his eternal Bride, And from her fair unspotted side Two blissful twins are to be born, Youth and Joy; so Jove hath sworn. But now my task is smoothly don, I can fly, or I can run Quickly to the green earths end, Where the bow’d welkin slow doth bend, And

from thence can soar as soon To the corners of the Moon. Mortals that would follow me, Love vertue, she alone is free. She can teach ye how to clime Higher then the Spheary chime; Or if Vertue feeble were, Heav'n it self would stoop to her.

_317._ _Lycidas_

A Lament for a friend drowned in his passage from Chester on the Irish Seas, 1637

Yet once more, O ye Laurels, and once more Ye Myrtles brown, with Ivy never-sear, I com to pluck your Berries harsh and crude, And with forc'd fingers rude, Shatter your leaves before the mellowing year. Bitter constraint, and sad occasion dear, Compels me to disturb your season due: For Lycidas is dead, dead ere his prime Young Lycidas, and hath not left his peer: Who would not sing for Lycidas? he knew Himself to sing, and build the lofty rhyme. He must not flote upon his watry bear Unwept, and welter to the parching wind, Without the meed of som melodious tear. Begin, then, Sisters of the sacred well, That from beneath the seat of Jove doth spring, Begin, and somwhat loudly sweep the string. Hence with denial vain, and coy excuse, So may som gentle Muse With lucky words favour my destin'd Urn, And as he passes turn, And bid fair peace be to my sable shrowd. For we were nurst upon the self-same hill, Fed the same flock, by fountain, shade, and rill. Together both, ere the high Lawns appear'd Under the opening eye-lids of the morn, We drove a field, and both together heard What time the Gray-fly winds her sultry horn, Batt'ning our flocks with the fresh dews of night, Oft till the Star that rose, at Ev'ning, bright Toward Heav'ns descent had slop'd his westering wheel. Mean while the Rural ditties were not mute, Temper'd to th'Oaten Flute; Rough Satyrs danc'd, and Fauns with clov'n heel, From the glad sound would not be absent long, And old Damætas lov'd to hear our song But O the heavy change, now thou art gon, Now thou art gon, and never must return! Thee Shepherd, thee the Woods, and desert Caves, With wilde Thyme and the gadding Vine o'regrown, And all their echoes mourn. The Willows, and the Hazle Copses green, Shall now no more be seen, Fanning their joyous Leaves to thy soft layes. As killing as the Canker to the Rose, Or Taint-worm to the weanling Herds that graze, Or Frost to Flowers, that their gay wardrop wear, When first the White thorn blows; Such, Lycidas, thy loss to Shepherds ear. Where were ye Nymphs when the remorseless deep Clos'd o're the head of your lov'd Lycidas? For neither were ye playing on the steep, Where your old Bards, the famous Druids ly, Nor on the shaggy top of Mona high, Nor yet where Deva spreads her wisard stream: Ay me, I fondly dream! Had ye bin there--for what could that have don? What could the Muse her self that Orpheus bore, The Muse her self, for her inchanting son Whom Universal nature did lament, When by the rout that made the hideous roar, His goary visage down the stream was sent, Down the swift Hebrus to the Lesbian shore. Alas! what boots it with uncessant care To tend the homely slighted Shepherds trade, And strictly meditate the thankles Muse, Were it not better don as others use, To sport with Amaryllis in the shade, Or with the tangles of Neæra's hair? Fame is the spur that the clear spirit doth raise (That last infirmity of Noble mind) To scorn delights, and live laborious dayes; But the fair Guerdon when we hope to find, And think to burst out into sudden blaze, Comes the blind Fury with th'abhorrèd shears, And slits

the thin spun life. But not the praise, Phœbus repli'd, and touch'd my trembling ears; Fame is no plant that grows on mortal soil, Nor in the glistering foil Set off to th'world, nor in broad rumour lies, But lives and spreds aloft by those pure eyes, And perfet witnes of all judging Jove; As he pronounces lastly on each deed, Of so much fame in Heav'n expect thy meed. O fountain Arethuse, and thou honour'd floud, Smooth-sliding Mincius, crown'd with vocall reeds, That strain I heard was of a higher mood: But now my Oate proceeds, And listens to the Herald of the Sea That came in Neptune's plea, He ask'd the Waves, and ask'd the Fellon winds, What hard mishap hath doom'd this gentle swain? And question'd every gust of rugged wings That blows from off each beakèd Promontory, They knew not of his story, And sage Hippotades their answer brings, That not a blast was from his dungeon stray'd, The Ayr was calm, and on the level brine, Sleek Panope with all her sisters play'd. It was that fatall and perfidious Bark Built in th'eclipse, and rigg'd with curses dark, That sunk so low that sacred head of thine. Next Camus, reverend Sire, went footing slow, His Mantle hairy, and his Bonnet sedge, Inwrought with figures dim, and on the edge Like to that sanguine flower inscrib'd with woe. Ah; Who hath reft (quoth he) my dearest pledge? Last came, and last did go, The Pilot of the Galilean lake, Two massy Keyes he bore of metals twain, (The Golden opes, the Iron shuts amain) He shook his Miter'd locks, and stern bespake, How well could I have spar'd for thee, young swain, Anow of such as for their bellies sake, Creep and intrude, and climb into the fold? Of other care they little reck'ning make, Then how to scramble at the shearers feast, And shove away the worthy bidden guest. Blind mouthes! that scarce themselves know how to hold A Sheep-hook, or have learn'd ought els the least That to the faithfull Herdmans art belongs! What recks it them? What need they? They are sped; And when they list, their lean and flashy songs Grate on their scrannel Pipes of wretched straw, The hungry Sheep look up, and are not fed, But swoln with wind, and the rank mist they draw, Rot inwardly, and foul contagion spread: Besides what the grim Woolf with privy paw Daily devours apace, and nothing sed, But that two-handed engine at the door, Stands ready to smite once, and smite no more. Return Alpheus, the dread voice is past, That shrunk thy streams; Return Sicilian Muse, And call the Vales, and bid them hither cast Their Bels, and Flourets of a thousand hues. Ye valleys low where the milde whispers use, Of shades and wanton winds, and gushing brooks, On whose fresh lap the swart Star sparely looks, Throw hither all your quaint enameld eyes, That on the green terf suck the honied showres, And purple all the ground with vernal flowres. Bring the rathe Primrose that forsaken dies. The tufted Crow-toe, and pale Gessamine, The white Pink, and the Pansie freakt with jeat, The glowing Violet. The Musk-rose, and the well attir'd Woodbine. With Cowslips wan that hang the pensive hed, And every flower that sad embroidery wears: Bid Amaranthus all his beauty shed, And Daffadillies fill their cups with tears, To strew the Laureat Herse where Lycid lies. For so to interpose a little ease, Let our frail thoughts dally with false surmise. Ay me! Whilst thee the shores, and sounding Seas Wash far away, where ere thy bones are hurld, Whether beyond the stormy Hebrides, Where thou perhaps under the whelming tide Visit'st the bottom of the monstrous world; Or whether thou to our moist vows deny'd, Sleep'st by the fable of Bellerus old, Where the great vision of the guarded Mount Looks toward Namancos and Bayona's hold; Look homeward Angel now, and melt with ruth. And, O ye

Dolphins, waft the haples youth. Weep no more, woful Shepherds weep no more, For Lycidas your sorrow is not dead, Sunk though he be beneath the watry floar, So sinks the day-star in the Ocean bed, And yet anon repairs his drooping head, And tricks his beams, and with new spangled Ore, Flames in the forehead of the morning sky: So Lycidas sunk low, but mounted high, Through the dear might of him that walk'd the waves Where other groves, and other streams along, With Nectar pure his oozy Lock's he laves, And hears the unexpressive nuptiall Song, In the blest Kingdoms meek of joy and love. There entertain him all the Saints above, In solemn troops, and sweet Societies That sing, and singing in their glory move, And wipe the tears for ever from his eyes. Now Lycidas the Shepherds weep no more; Hence forth thou art the Genius of the shore, In thy large recompense, and shalt be good To all that wander in that perilous flood. Thus sang the uncouth Swain to th'Okes and rills, While the still morn went out with Sandals gray, He touch'd the tender stops of various Quills, With eager thought warbling his Dorick lay: And now the Sun had stretch'd out all the hills, And now was dropt into the Western bay; At last he rose, and twitch'd his Mantle blew: To morrow to fresh Woods, and Pastures new.

_317._* _To the Lady Margaret Ley_

Daughter to that good Earl, once President Of Englands Counsel, and her Treasury, Who liv'd in both, unstain'd with gold or fee, And left them both, more in himself content, Till the sad breaking of that Parlament Broke him, as that dishonest victory At Chæronèa, fatal to liberty Kil'd with report that Old man eloquent, Though later born, then to have known the dayes Wherin your Father flourisht, yet by you Madam, me thinks I see him living yet; So well your words his noble vertues praise, That all both judge you to relate them true, And to possess them, Honour'd Margaret.

_318._ _On His Blindness_

When I consider how my light is spent, E're half my days, in this dark world and wide, And that one Talent which is death to hide, Lodg'd with me useless, though my Soul more bent To serve therewith my Maker, and present My true account, least he returning chide, Doth God exact day-labour, light deny'd, I fondly ask; But patience to prevent That murmur, soon replies, God doth not need Either man's work or his own gifts, who best Bear his milde yoak, they serve him best, his State Is Kingly. Thousands at his bidding speed And post o're Land and Ocean without rest: They also serve who only stand and waite.

_319._ _To Mr. Lawrence_

Lawrence of vertuous Father vertuous Son, Now that the Fields are dank, and ways are mire, Where shall we sometimes meet, and by the fire Help wast a sullen day; what may be won From the hard Season gaining: time will run On smoother, till Favonius re-inspire The frozen earth; and cloth in fresh attire The Lillie and Rose, that neither sow'd nor spun. What neat repast shall feast us, light and choice, Of Attick tast, with Wine, whence we may rise To hear the Lute well toucht, or artfull voice Warble immortal Notes and Tuskan Ayre? He who of those delights can judge, and spare To interpose them oft, is not unwise.

_320._ _To Cyriack Skinner_

Cyriack, whose Grandsire on the Royal Bench Of Brittish Themis, with no mean applause Pronounc’t and in his volumes taught our Lawes, Which others at their Barr so often wrench: To day deep thoughts resolve with me to drench In mirth, that after no repenting drawes; Let Euclid rest and Archimedes pause, And what the Swede intend, and what the French. To measure life, learn thou betimes, and know Toward solid good what leads the nearest way; For other things mild Heav’n a time ordains, And disapproves that care, though wise in show, That with superfluous burden loads the day, And when God sends a cheerful hour, refrains.

_321._ _On His Deceased Wife_

Methought I saw my late espousèd Saint Brought to me like Alcestis from the grave, Whom Joves great Son to her glad Husband gave, Rescu’d from death by force though pale and faint. Mine as whom washt from spot of child-bed taint, Purification in the old Law did save, And such, as yet once more I trust to have Full sight of her in Heaven without restraint, Came vested all in white, pure as her mind: Her face was vail’d, yet to my fancied sight, Love, sweetness, goodness, in her person shin’d So clear, as in no face with more delight. But O as to embrace me she enclin’d I wak’d, she fled, and day brought back my night.

_322._ _Light_

Hail holy light, ofspring of Heav’n first-born, Or of th’ Eternal Coeternal beam May I express thee unblam’d? since God is light, And never but in unapproachèd light Dwelt from Eternitie, dwelt then in thee, Bright effluence of bright essence increate. Or hear’st thou rather pure Ethereal stream, Whose Fountain who shall tell? before the Sun, Before the Heavens thou wert, and at the voice Of God, as with a Mantle didst invest The rising world of waters dark and deep, Won from the void and formless infinite. Thee I re-visit now with bolder wing, Escap’t the Stygian Pool, though long detain’d In that obscure sojourn, while in my flight Through utter and through middle darkness borne With other notes then to th’ Orphean Lyre I sung of Chaos and Eternal Night, Taught by the heav’nly Muse to venture down The dark descent, and up to reascend, Though hard and rare: thee I revisit safe, And feel thy sovran vital Lamp; but thou Revisit’st not these eyes, that rowle in vain To find thy piercing ray, and find no dawn; So thick a drop serene hath quencht thir Orbs, Or dim suffusion veild. Yet not the more Cease I to wander where the Muses haunt Cleer Spring, or shadie Grove, or Sunnie Hill, Smit with the love of sacred song; but chief Thee _Sion_ and the flowrie Brooks beneath That wash thy hallowd feet, and warbling flow, Nightly I visit: nor somtimes forget Those other two equal’d with me in Fate, So were I equal’d with them in renown. Blind Thamyris and blind Mæonides, And Tiresias and Phineus Prophets old. Then feed on thoughts, that voluntarie move Harmonious numbers; as the wakeful Bird Sings darkling, and in shadiest Covert hid Tunes her nocturnal Note. Thus with the Year Seasons return, but not to me returns Day, or the sweet approach of Ev’n or Morn, Or sight of vernal bloom, or Summers Rose, Or flocks, or herds, or human face divine; But cloud in stead, and ever-during dark Surrounds me, from the chearful waies of men Cut off, and for the Book of knowledg fair Presented with a Universal blanc Of Natures works to mee expung’d and ras’d, And wisdome at one entrance quite shut out. So much the rather thou

Celestial light Shine inward, and the mind through all her powers Irradiate, there plant eyes, all mist from thence Purge and disperse, that I may see and tell Of things invisible to mortal sight.

From ‘Samson Agonistes’

_323._ _i_

Oh how comely it is and how reviving To the Spirits of just men long opprest! When God into the hands of thir deliverer Puts invincible might To quell the mighty of the Earth, th’ oppressour, The brute and boist’rous force of violent men Hardy and industrious to support Tyrannic power, but raging to pursue The righteous and all such as honour Truth; He all thir Ammunition And feats of War defeats With plain Heroic magnitude of mind And celestial vigour arm’d, Thir Armories and Magazins contemns, Renders them useless, while With wingèd expedition Swift as the lightning glance he executes His errand on the wicked, who surpris’d Lose thir defence distracted and amaz’d.

_324._ _ii_

All is best, though we oft doubt, What th’ unsearchable dispose Of highest wisdom brings about, And ever best found in the close. Oft he seems to hide his face, But unexpectedly returns And to his faithful Champion hath in place Bore witness gloriously; whence Gaza mourns And all that band them to resist His uncontroulable intent. His servants he with new acquist Of true experience from this great event With peace and consolation hath dismist, And calm of mind all passion spent.

SIR JOHN SUCKLING

1609-1642

_325._ _A Doubt of Martyrdom_

O for some honest lover’s ghost, Some kind unbodied post Sent from the shades below! I strangely long to know Whether the noble chaplets wear Those that their mistress’ scorn did bear Or those that were used kindly.

For whatsoe’er they tell us here To make those sufferings dear, ’Twill there, I fear, be found That to the being crown’d T’ have loved alone will not suffice, Unless we also have been wise And have our loves enjoy’d.

What posture can we think him in That, here unloved, again Departs, and ’s thither gone Where each sits by his own? Or how can that Elysium be Where I my mistress still must see Circled in other’s arms?

For there the judges all are just, And Sophonisba must Be his whom she held dear, Not his who loved her here. The sweet Philoclea, since she died, Lies by her Pirocles his side, Not by Amphialus.

Some bays, perchance, or myrtle bough For difference crowns the brow Of those kind souls that were The noble martyrs here: And if that be the only odds (As who can tell?), ye kinder gods, Give me the woman here!

_326._ _The Constant Lover_

Out upon it, I have loved Three whole days together! And am like to love three more, If it prove fair weather.

Time shall moult away his wings Ere he shall discover In the whole wide world again Such a constant lover.

But the spite on ’t is, no praise Is due at all to me: Love with me had made no stays, Had it any been but she.

Had it any been but she, And that very face, There had been at least ere this A dozen dozen in her place.

_327._ _Why so Pale and Wan?_

Why so pale and wan, fond lover? Prithee, why so pale? Will, when looking well can’t move her, Looking ill prevail? Prithee, why so pale?

Why so dull and mute, young sinner? Prithee, why so mute? Will, when speaking well can’t win her, Saying nothing do’t? Prithee, why so mute?

Quit, quit for shame! This will not move; This cannot take her. If of herself she will not love, Nothing can make her: The devil take her!

_328._ _When, Dearest, I but think of Thee_

When, dearest, I but think of thee, Methinks all things that lovely be Are present, and my soul delighted: For beauties that from worth arise Are like the grace of deities, Still present with us, tho’ unsighted.

Thus while I sit and sigh the day With all his borrow’d lights away, Till night’s black wings do overtake me, Thinking on thee, thy beauties then, As sudden lights do sleepy men, So they by their bright rays awake me.

Thus absence dies, and dying proves No absence can subsist with loves That do partake of fair perfection: Since in the darkest night they may By love’s quick motion find a way To see each other by reflection.

The waving sea can with each flood Bathe some high promont that hath stood Far from the main up in the river: O think not then but love can do As much! for that’s an ocean too, Which flows not every day, but ever!

SIR RICHARD FANSHAWE

1608-1666

_329._ _A Rose_

Blown in the morning, thou shalt fade ere noon. What boots a life which in such haste forsakes thee? Thou’rt wondrous frolic, being to die so soon, And passing proud a little colour makes thee. If thee thy brittle beauty so deceives, Know then the thing that swells thee is thy bane; For the same beauty doth, in bloody leaves, The sentence of thy early death contain. Some clown’s coarse lungs will poison thy sweet flower, If

by the careless plough thou shalt be torn; And many Herods lie in wait each hour To murder thee as soon as thou art born-- Nay, force thy bud to blow--their tyrant breath Anticipating life, to hasten death!

WILLIAM CARTWRIGHT

1611-1643

_330._ _To Chloe_

Who for his sake wished herself younger

There are two births; the one when light First strikes the new awaken’d sense; The other when two souls unite, And we must count our life from thence: When you loved me and I loved you Then both of us were born anew.

Love then to us new souls did give And in those souls did plant new powers; Since when another life we live, The breath we breathe is his, not ours: Love makes those young whom age doth chill, And whom he finds young keeps young still.

_331._ _Falsehood_

Still do the stars impart their light To those that travel in the night; Still time runs on, nor doth the hand Or shadow on the dial stand; The streams still glide and constant are: Only thy mind Untrue I find, Which carelessly Neglects to be Like stream or shadow, hand or star.

Fool that I am! I do recall My words, and swear thou’rt like them all, Thou seem’st like stars to nourish fire, But O how cold is thy desire! And like the hand upon the brass Thou point’st at me In mockery; If I come nigh Shade-like thou’lt fly, And as the stream with murmur pass.

_332._ _On the Queen’s Return from the Low Countries_

Hallow the threshold, crown the posts anew! The day shall have its due. Twist all our victories into one bright wreath, On which let honour breathe; Then throw it round the temples of our Queen! ’Tis she that must preserve those glories green.

When greater tempests than on sea before Received her on the shore; When she was shot at ‘for the King’s own good’ By legions hired to blood; How bravely did she do, how bravely bear! And show’d, though they durst rage, she durst not fear.

Courage was cast about her like a dress Of solemn comeliness: A gathered mind and an untroubled face Did give her dangers grace: Thus, arm’d with innocence, secure they move Whose highest ‘treason’ is but highest love.

_333._ _On a Virtuous Young Gentlewoman that died suddenly_

She who to Heaven more Heaven doth annex, Whose lowest thought was above all our sex, Accounted nothing death but t’ be reprieved, And died as free from sickness as she lived. Others are dragg’d away, or must be driven, She only saw her time and stept to Heaven; Where seraphims view all her glories o’er, As one return’d that had been there before. For while she did this lower world adorn, Her body seem’d rather

assumed than born; So rarified, advanced, so pure and whole, That body might have been another’s soul; And equally a miracle it were That she could die, or that she could live here.

JAMES GRAHAM, MARQUIS OF MONTROSE

1612-1650

_334._ _I’ll never love Thee more_

My dear and only Love, I pray That little world of thee Be govern’d by no other sway Than purest monarchy; For if confusion have a part (Which virtuous souls abhor), And hold a synod in thine heart, I’ll never love thee more.

Like Alexander I will reign, And I will reign alone; My thoughts did evermore disdain A rival on my throne. He either fears his fate too much, Or his deserts are small, That dares not put it to the touch, To gain or lose it all.

And in the empire of thine heart, Where I should solely be, If others do pretend a part Or dare to vie with me, Or if _Committees_ thou erect, And go on such a score, I’ll laugh and sing at thy neglect, And never love thee more.

But if thou wilt prove faithful then, And constant of thy word, I’ll make thee glorious by my pen And famous by my sword; I’ll serve thee in such noble ways Was never heard before; I’ll crown and deck thee all with bays, And love thee more and more.

THOMAS JORDAN

1612?-1685

_335._ _Coronemus nos Rosis antequam marcescant_

Let us drink and be merry, dance, joke, and rejoice, With claret and sherry, theorbo and voice! The changeable world to our joy is unjust, All treasure’s uncertain, Then down with your dust! In frolics dispose your pounds, shillings, and pence, For we shall be nothing a hundred years hence.

We’ll sport and be free with Moll, Betty, and Dolly, Have oysters and lobsters to cure melancholy: Fish-dinners will make a man spring like a flea, Dame Venus, love’s lady, Was born of the sea; With her and with Bacchus we’ll tickle the sense, For we shall be past it a hundred years hence.

Your most beautiful bride who with garlands is crown’d And kills with each glance as she treads on the ground, Whose lightness and brightness doth shine in such splendour That none but the stars Are thought fit to attend her, Though now she be pleasant and sweet to the sense, Will be damnable mouldy a hundred years hence.

Then why should we turmoil in cares and in fears, Turn all our tranquill’ty to sighs and to tears? Let’s eat, drink, and play till the worms do corrupt us, ’Tis certain, _Post mortem_ _Nulla voluptas_. For health, wealth and beauty, wit, learning and sense,

Must all come to nothing a hundred years hence.

RICHARD CRASHAW

1613?-1649

_336._ _Wishes to His Supposed Mistress_

Whoe’er she be-- That not impossible She That shall command my heart and me:

Where’er she lie, Lock’d up from mortal eye In shady leaves of destiny:

Till that ripe birth Of studied Fate stand forth, And teach her fair steps to our earth:

Till that divine Idea take a shrine Of crystal flesh, through which to shine:

Meet you her, my Wishes, Bespeak her to my blisses, And be ye call’d my absent kisses.

I wish her Beauty, That owes not all its duty To gaudy tire, or glist’ring shoe-tie:

Something more than Taffeta or tissue can, Or rampant feather, or rich fan.

A Face, that’s best By its own beauty drest, And can alone commend the rest.

A Face, made up Out of no other shop Than what Nature’s white hand sets ope.

A Cheek, where youth And blood, with pen of truth, Write what the reader sweetly ru’th.

A Cheek, where grows More than a morning rose, Which to no box his being owes.

Lips, where all day A lover’s kiss may play, Yet carry nothing thence away.

Looks, that oppress Their richest tires, but dress And clothe their simplest nakedness.

Eyes, that displace The neighbour diamond, and outface That sunshine by their own sweet grace.

Tresses, that wear Jewels but to declare How much themselves more precious are:

Whose native ray Can tame the wanton day Of gems that in their bright shades play.

Each ruby there, Or pearl that dare appear, Be its own blush, be its own tear.

A well-tamed Heart, For whose more noble smart Love may be long choosing a dart.

Eyes, that bestow Full quivers on love’s bow, Yet pay less arrows than they owe.

Smiles, that can warm The blood, yet teach a charm, That chastity shall take no harm.

Blushes, that bin The burnish of no sin, Nor flames of aught too hot within.

Joys, that confess Virtue their mistress, And have no other head to dress.

Fears, fond and slight As the coy bride’s, when night First does the longing lover right.

Days, that need borrow No part of their good-morrow From a fore-spent night of sorrow.

Days, that in spite Of darkness, by the light Of a clear mind, are day all night.

Nights, sweet as they, Made short by lovers’ play, Yet long by th’ absence of the day.

Life, that dares send A challenge to his end, And when it comes, say, ‘Welcome, friend!’

Sydneian showers Of sweet discourse, whose powers Can crown old Winter’s head with flowers.

Soft silken hours, Open suns, shady bowers; ’Bove all, nothing within that lowers.

Whate’er delight Can make Day’s forehead bright, Or give down to the wings of Night.

I wish her store Of worth may leave her poor Of wishes; and I wish--no more.

Now, if Time knows That Her, whose radiant brows Weave them a garland of my vows;

Her, whose just bays My future hopes can raise, A trophy to her present praise;

Her, that dares be What these lines wish to see; I seek no further, it is She.

’Tis She, and here, Lo! I unclothe and clear My Wishes’ cloudy character.

May she enjoy it Whose merit dare apply it, But modesty dares still deny it!

Such worth as this is Shall fix my flying Wishes, And determine them to kisses.

Let her full glory, My fancies, fly before ye; Be ye my fictions--but her story.

_337._ _The Weeper_

Hail, sister springs, Parents of silver-footed rills! Ever bubbling things, Thawing crystal, snowy hills! Still spending, never spent; I mean Thy fair eyes, sweet Magdalene.

Heavens thy fair eyes be; Heavens of ever-falling stars; ’Tis seed-time still with thee, And stars thou sow’st whose harvest dares Promise the earth to countershine Whatever makes Heaven’s forehead fine.

Every morn from hence A brisk cherub something sips Whose soft influence Adds sweetness to his sweetest lips; Then to his music: and his song Tastes of this breakfast all day long.

When some new bright guest Takes up among the stars a room, And Heaven will make a feast, Angels with their bottles come, And draw from these full eyes of thine

Their Master’s water, their own wine.

The dew no more will weep The primrose’s pale cheek to deck; The dew no more will sleep Nuzzled in the lily’s neck: Much rather would it tremble here, And leave them both to be thy tear.

When sorrow would be seen In her brightest majesty, --For she is a Queen-- Then is she drest by none but thee: Then and only then she wears Her richest pearls--I mean thy tears.

Not in the evening’s eyes, When they red with weeping are For the Sun that dies, Sits Sorrow with a face so fair. Nowhere but here did ever meet Sweetness so sad, sadness so sweet.

Does the night arise? Still thy tears do fall and fall. Does night lose her eyes? Still the fountain weeps for all. Let day and night do what they will, Thou hast thy task, thou weepest still.

Not _So long she lived_ Will thy tomb report of thee; But _So long she grieved_: Thus must we date thy memory. Others by days, by months, by years, Measure their ages, thou by tears.

Say, ye bright brothers, The fugitive sons of those fair eyes Your fruitful mothers, What make you here? What hopes can ’tice You to be born? What cause can borrow You from those nests of noble sorrow?

Whither away so fast For sure the sordid earth Your sweetness cannot taste, Nor does the dust deserve your birth. Sweet, whither haste you then? O say, Why you trip so fast away?

We go not to seek _The darlings of Aurora’s bed,_ _The rose’s modest cheek,_ _Nor the violet’s humble head._ _No such thing: we go to meet_ _A worthier object--our Lord’s feet._

_338._ _A Hymn to the Name and Honour of the Admirable Saint Teresa_

Love, thou art absolute, sole Lord Of life and death. To prove the word, We’ll now appeal to none of all Those thy old soldiers, great and tall, Ripe men of martyrdom, that could reach down With strong arms their triumphant crown: Such as could with lusty breath Speak loud, unto the face of death, Their great Lord’s glorious name; to none Of those whose spacious bosoms spread a throne For love at large to fill. Spare blood and sweat: We’ll see Him take a private seat, And make His mansion in the mild And milky soul of a soft child.

Scarce has she learnt to lisp a name Of martyr, yet she thinks it shame Life should so long play with that breath Which spent can buy so brave a death. She never undertook to know What death with love should have to do. Nor has she e’er yet understood Why, to show love, she should shed blood; Yet, though she cannot tell you why, She can love, and she can die. Scarce has she blood enough to make A guilty sword blush for her sake; Yet has a heart dares hope to prove How much less strong is death than love....

Since ’tis not to be had at home, She’ll travel for a martyrdom. No home for her, confesses she, But where she may a martyr be. She’ll to the Moors, and trade with them For this unvalued diadem; She offers them her dearest breath, With Christ’s name in ’t, in change for death: She’ll bargain with them, and will give Them God, and teach them how to live In Him; or, if they this deny, For Him she’ll teach them how to die. So shall she leave amongst them sown Her Lord’s blood, or at least her own.

Farewell then, all the world, adieu! Teresa is no more for you. Farewell all pleasures, sports, and joys, Never till now esteemèd toys!

Farewell whatever dear may be-- Mother’s arms, or father’s knee! Farewell house, and farewell home! She’s for the Moors and Martyrdom.

Sweet, not so fast; lo! thy fair spouse, Whom thou seek’st with so swift vows, Calls thee back, and bids thee come T’ embrace a milder martyrdom....

O how oft shalt thou complain Of a sweet and subtle pain! Of intolerable joys! Of a death, in which who dies Loves his death, and dies again, And would for ever so be slain; And lives and dies, and knows not why To live, but that he still may die! How kindly will thy gentle heart Kiss the sweetly-killing dart! And close in his embraces keep Those delicious wounds, that weep Balsam, to heal themselves with thus, When these thy deaths, so numerous, Shall all at once die into one, And melt thy soul’s sweet mansion; Like a soft lump of incense, hasted By too hot a fire, and wasted Into perfuming clouds, so fast Shalt thou exhale to heaven at last In a resolving sigh, and then,-- O what? Ask not the tongues of men.

Angels cannot tell; suffice, Thyself shalt feel thine own full joys, And hold them fast for ever there. So soon as thou shalt first appear, The moon of maiden stars, thy white Mistress, attended by such bright Souls as thy shining self, shall come, And in her first ranks make thee room; Where, ’mongst her snowy family, Immortal welcomes wait for thee. O what delight, when she shall stand And teach thy lips heaven, with her hand, On which thou now may’st to thy wishes Heap up thy consecrated kisses! What joy shall seize thy soul, when she, Bending her blessèd eyes on thee, Those second smiles of heaven, shall dart Her mild rays through thy melting heart!

Angels, thy old friends, there shall greet thee. Glad at their own home now to meet thee. All thy good works which went before, And waited for thee at the door, Shall own thee there; and all in one Weave a constellation Of crowns, with which the King, thy spouse, Shall build up thy triumphant brows. All thy old woes shall now smile on thee, And thy pains sit bright upon thee: All thy sorrows here shall shine, And thy sufferings be divine. Tears shall take comfort, and turn gems, And wrongs repent to diadems. Even thy deaths shall live, and new Dress the soul which late they slew. Thy wounds shall blush to such bright scars As keep account of the Lamb’s wars.

Those rare works, where thou shalt leave writ Love’s noble history, with wit Taught thee by none but Him, while here They feed our souls, shall clothe thine there. Each heavenly word by whose hid flame Our hard hearts shall strike fire, the same Shall flourish on thy brows, and be Both fire to us and flame to thee; Whose light shall live bright in thy face By glory, in our hearts by grace. Thou shalt look round about,

and see Thousands of crown’d souls throng to be Themselves thy crown, sons of thy vows, The virgin-births with which thy spouse Made fruitful thy fair soul; go now, And with them all about thee bow To Him; put on, He’ll say, put on, My rosy Love, that thy rich zone, Sparkling with the sacred flames Of thousand souls, whose happy names Heaven keeps upon thy score: thy bright Life brought them first to kiss the light That kindled them to stars; and so Thou with the Lamb, thy Lord, shalt go. And, wheresoever He sets His white Steps, walk with Him those ways of light, Which who in death would live to see, Must learn in life to die like thee.

_339._ _Upon the Book and Picture of the Seraphical Saint Teresa_

O thou undaunted daughter of desires! By all thy dower of lights and fires; By all the eagle in thee, all the dove; By all thy lives and deaths of love; By thy large draughts of intellectual day, And by thy thirsts of love more large than they; By all thy brim-fill’d bowls of fierce desire, By thy last morning’s draught of liquid fire; By the full kingdom of that final kiss That seized thy parting soul, and seal’d thee His; By all the Heav’n thou hast in Him (Fair sister of the seraphim!); By all of Him we have in thee; Leave nothing of myself in me. Let me so read thy life, that I Unto all life of mine may die!

_340._ _Verses from the Shepherds’ Hymn_

We saw Thee in Thy balmy nest, Young dawn of our eternal day; We saw Thine eyes break from the East, And chase the trembling shades away: We saw Thee, and we blest the sight, We saw Thee by Thine own sweet light.

Poor world, said I, what wilt thou do To entertain this starry stranger? Is this the best thou canst bestow-- A cold and not too cleanly manger? Contend, the powers of heaven and earth, To fit a bed for this huge birth.

Proud world, said I, cease your contest, And let the mighty babe alone; The phœnix builds the phœnix’ nest, Love’s architecture is His own. The babe, whose birth embraves this morn, Made His own bed ere He was born.

I saw the curl’d drops, soft and slow, Come hovering o’er the place’s head, Off’ring their whitest sheets of snow, To furnish the fair infant’s bed. Forbear, said I, be not too bold; Your fleece is white, but ’tis too cold.

I saw th’ obsequious seraphim Their rosy fleece of fire bestow, For well they now can spare their wings, Since Heaven itself lies here below. Well done, said I; but are you sure Your down, so warm, will pass for pure?

No, no, your King’s not yet to seek Where to repose His royal head; See, see how soon His new-bloom’d cheek ’Twixt mother’s breasts is gone to bed! Sweet choice, said we; no way but so, Not to lie cold, yet sleep in snow

She sings Thy tears asleep, and dips Her kisses in Thy weeping eye; She spreads the red leaves of Thy lips, That in their buds yet blushing lie. She ’gainst those mother diamonds tries The points of her young eagle’s eyes.

Welcome--tho’ not to those gay flies, Gilded i’ th’ beams of earthly kings, Slippery souls in smiling eyes-- But to poor shepherds, homespun things, Whose wealth’s their

flocks, whose wit’s to be Well read in their simplicity.

Yet, when young April’s husband show’rs Shall bless the fruitful Maia’s bed, We’ll bring the first-born of her flowers, To kiss Thy feet and crown Thy head. To Thee, dread Lamb! whose love must keep The shepherds while they feed their sheep.

To Thee, meek Majesty, soft King Of simple graces and sweet loves! Each of us his lamb will bring, Each his pair of silver doves! At last, in fire of Thy fair eyes, Ourselves become our own best sacrifice!

_341._ _Christ Crucified_

Thy restless feet now cannot go For us and our eternal good, As they were ever wont. What though They swim, alas! in their own flood?

Thy hands to give Thou canst not lift, Yet will Thy hand still giving be; It gives, but O, itself’s the gift! It gives tho’ bound, tho’ bound ’tis free!

_342._ _An Epitaph upon Husband and Wife_

Who died and were buried together.

To these whom death again did wed This grave’s the second marriage-bed. For though the hand of Fate could force ’Twixt soul and body a divorce, It could not sever man and wife, Because they both lived but one life. Peace, good reader, do not weep; Peace, the lovers are asleep. They, sweet turtles, folded lie In the last knot that love could tie. Let them sleep, let them sleep on, Till the stormy night be gone, And the eternal morrow dawn; Then the curtains will be drawn, And they wake into a light Whose day shall never die in night.

RICHARD LOVELACE

1618-1658

_343._ _To Lucasta, going to the Wars_

Tell me not, Sweet, I am unkind, That from the nunnery Of thy chaste breast and quiet mind To war and arms I fly.

True, a new mistress now I chase, The first foe in the field; And with a stronger faith embrace A sword, a horse, a shield.

Yet this inconstancy is such As thou too shalt adore; I could not love thee, Dear, so much, Loved I not Honour more.

_344._ _To Lucasta, going beyond the Seas_

If to be absent were to be Away from thee; Or that when I am gone You or I were alone; Then, my Lucasta, might I crave Pity from blustering wind or swallowing wave.

But I’ll not sigh one blast or gale To swell my sail, Or pay a tear to ’suage The foaming blue god’s rage; For whether he will let me pass Or no, I’m still as happy as I was.

Though seas and land betwixt us both, Our faith and troth, Like separated souls, All time and space controls: Above the highest sphere we meet Unseen, unknown; and greet as Angels greet.

So then we do anticipate Our after-fate, And are alive i' the skies, If thus our lips and eyes Can speak like spirits unconfined In Heaven, their earthy bodies left behind.

_345._ _Gratiana Dancing_

She beat the happy pavèment-- By such a star made firmament, Which now no more the roof envìes! But swells up high, with Atlas even, Bearing the brighter nobler heaven, And, in her, all the deities.

Each step trod out a Lover's thought, And the ambitious hopes he brought Chain'd to her brave feet with such arts, Such sweet command and gentle awe, As, when she ceased, we sighing saw The floor lay paved with broken hearts.

_346._ _To Amarantha, that she would dishevel her Hair_

Amarantha sweet and fair, Ah, braid no more that shining hair! As my curious hand or eye Hovering round thee, let it fly!

Let it fly as unconfined As its calm ravisher the wind, Who hath left his darling, th' East, To wanton o'er that spicy nest.

Every tress must be confest, But neatly tangled at the best; Like a clew of golden thread Most excellently ravellèd.

Do not then wind up that light In ribbands, and o'ercloud in night, Like the Sun in's early ray; But shake your head, and scatter day!

_347._ _The Grasshopper_

O thou that swing'st upon the waving hair Of some well-fillèd oaten beard, Drunk every night with a delicious tear Dropt thee from heaven, where thou wert rear'd!

The joys of earth and air are thine entire, That with thy feet and wings dost hop and fly; And when thy poppy works, thou dost retire To thy carved acorn-bed to lie.

Up with the day, the Sun thou welcom'st then, Sport'st in the gilt plaits of his beams, And all these merry days mak'st merry men, Thyself, and melancholy streams.

_348._ _To Althea, from Prison_

When Love with unconfinèd wings Hovers within my gates, And my divine Althea brings To whisper at the grates; When I lie tangled in her hair And fetter'd to her eye, The birds that wanton in the air Know no such liberty.

When flowing cups run swiftly round With no allaying Thames, Our careless heads with roses bound, Our hearts with loyal flames; When thirsty grief in wine we steep, When healths and draughts go free-- Fishes that tipple in the deep Know no such liberty.

When, like committed linnets, I With shriller throat shall sing The sweetness, mercy, majesty, And glories of my King; When I shall voice aloud how good He is, how

great should be, Enlargèd winds, that curl the flood, Know no such liberty.

Stone walls do not a prison make, Nor iron bars a cage; Minds innocent and quiet take That for an hermitage; If I have freedom in my love And in my soul am free, Angels alone, that soar above, Enjoy such liberty.

ABRAHAM COWLEY

1618-1667

Anacreontics

_349._ _1. Drinking_

The thirsty earth soaks up the rain, And drinks and gapes for drink again; The plants suck in the earth, and are With constant drinking fresh and fair; The sea itself (which one would think Should have but little need of drink) Drinks twice ten thousand rivers up, So fill'd that they o'erflow the cup. The busy Sun (and one would guess By 's drunken fiery face no less) Drinks up the sea, and when he's done, The Moon and Stars drink up the Sun: They drink and dance by their own light, They drink and revel all the night: Nothing in Nature's sober found, But an eternal health goes round. Fill up the bowl, then, fill it high. Fill all the glasses there--for why Should every creature drink but I? Why, man of morals, tell me why?

_350._ _2. The Epicure_

Underneath this myrtle shade, On flowery beds supinely laid, With odorous oils my head o'erflowing, And around it roses growing, What should I do but drink away The heat and troubles of the day? In this more than kingly state Love himself on me shall wait. Fill to me, Love! nay, fill it up! And mingled cast into the cup Wit and mirth and noble fires, Vigorous health and gay desires. The wheel of life no less will stay In a smooth than rugged way: Since it equally doth flee, Let the motion pleasant be. Why do we precious ointments shower?-- Nobler wines why do we pour?-- Beauteous flowers why do we spread Upon the monuments of the dead? Nothing they but dust can show, Or bones that hasten to be so. Crown me with roses while I live, Now your wines and ointments give: After death I nothing crave, Let me alive my pleasures have: All are Stoics in the grave.

_351._ _3. The Swallow_

Foolish prater, what dost thou So early at my window do? Cruel bird, thou'st ta'en away A dream out of my arms to-day; A dream that ne'er must equall'd be By all that waking eyes may see. Thou this damage to repair Nothing half so sweet and fair, Nothing half so good, canst bring, Tho' men say thou bring'st the Spring.

_352._ _On the Death of Mr. William Hervey_

It was a dismal and a fearful night: Scarce could the Morn drive on th' unwilling Light, When Sleep, Death's image, left my troubled breast By something liker Death possest. My eyes with tears did uncommanded flow, And on my soul hung the dull weight Of some intolerable fate. What bell was that? Ah me! too much I know!

My sweet companion and my gentle peer, Why hast thou left me thus unkindly here, Thy end for ever and my life to moan? O, thou hast left me all alone! Thy soul and body, when death’s agony Besieged around thy noble heart, Did not with more reluctance part Than I, my dearest Friend, do part from thee.

My dearest Friend, would I had died for thee! Life and this world henceforth will tedious be: Nor shall I know hereafter what to do If once my griefs prove tedious too. Silent and sad I walk about all day, As sullen ghosts stalk speechless by Where their hid treasures lie; Alas! my treasure’s gone; why do I stay?

Say, for you saw us, ye immortal lights, How oft unwearied have we spent the nights, Till the Ledæan stars, so famed for love, Wonder’d at us from above! We spent them not in toys, in lusts, or wine; But search of deep Philosophy, Wit, Eloquence, and Poetry-- Arts which I loved, for they, my Friend, were thine.

Ye fields of Cambridge, our dear Cambridge, say Have ye not seen us walking every day? Was there a tree about which did not know The love betwixt us two? Henceforth, ye gentle trees, for ever fade; Or your sad branches thicker join And into darksome shades combine, Dark as the grave wherein my Friend is laid!

Large was his soul: as large a soul as e’er Submitted to inform a body here; High as the place ’twas shortly in Heaven to have, But low and humble as his grave. So high that all the virtues there did come, As to their chiefest seat Conspicuous and great; So low, that for me too it made a room.

Knowledge he only sought, and so soon caught As if for him Knowledge had rather sought; Nor did more learning ever crowded lie In such a short mortality. Whene’er the skilful youth discoursed or writ, Still did the notions throng About his eloquent tongue; Nor could his ink flow faster than his wit.

His mirth was the pure spirits of various wit, Yet never did his God or friends forget; And when deep talk and wisdom came in view, Retired, and gave to them their due. For the rich help of books he always took, Though his own searching mind before Was so with notions written o’er, As if wise Nature had made that her book.

With as much zeal, devotion, piety, He always lived, as other saints do die. Still with his soul severe account he kept, Weeping all debts out ere he slept. Then down in peace and innocence he lay, Like the Sun’s laborious light, Which still in water sets at night, Unsullied with his journey of the day.

But happy Thou, ta’en from this frantic age, Where ignorance and hypocrisy does rage! A fitter time for Heaven no soul e’er chose-- The place now only free from those. There ’mong the blest thou dost for ever shine; And wheresoe’er thou casts thy view Upon that white and radiant crew, See’st not a soul clothed with more light than thine.

_353._ _The Wish_

Well then! I now do plainly see This busy world and I shall ne’er agree. The very honey of all earthly joy Does of all meats the soonest cloy; And they, methinks, deserve my pity Who for it can endure the stings, The crowd and buzz and

murmurings, Of this great hive, the city.

Ah, yet, ere I descend to the grave May I a small house and large garden have; And a few friends, and many books, both true, Both wise, and both delightful too! And since love ne’er will from me flee, A Mistress moderately fair, And good as guardian angels are, Only beloved and loving me.

O fountains! when in you shall I Myself eased of unpeaceful thoughts espy? O fields! O woods! when, when shall I be made The happy tenant of your shade? Here’s the spring-head of Pleasure’s flood: Here’s wealthy Nature’s treasury, Where all the riches lie that she Has coin’d and stamp’d for good.

Pride and ambition here Only in far-fetch’d metaphors appear; Here nought but winds can hurtful murmurs scatter, And nought but Echo flatter. The gods, when they descended, hither From heaven did always choose their way: And therefore we may boldly say That ’tis the way too thither.

How happy here should I And one dear She live, and embracing die! She who is all the world, and can exclude In deserts solitude. I should have then this only fear: Lest men, when they my pleasures see, Should hither throng to live like me, And so make a city here.

ALEXANDER BROME

1620-1666

_354._ _The Resolve_

Tell me not of a face that’s fair, Nor lip and cheek that’s red, Nor of the tresses of her hair, Nor curls in order laid, Nor of a rare seraphic voice That like an angel sings; Though if I were to take my choice I would have all these things: But if that thou wilt have me love, And it must be a she, The only argument can move Is that she will love me.

The glories of your ladies be But metaphors of things, And but resemble what we see Each common object brings. Roses out-red their lips and cheeks, Lilies their whiteness stain; What fool is he that shadows seeks And may the substance gain? Then if thou’lt have me love a lass, Let it be one that’s kind: Else I’m a servant to the glass That’s with Canary lined.

ANDREW MARVELL

1621-1678

_355._ _An Horatian Ode_

upon Cromwell’s Return from Ireland

The forward youth that would appear Must now forsake his Muses dear, Nor in the shadows sing His numbers languishing.

’Tis time to leave the books in dust, And oil the unused armour’s rust, Removing from the wall The corslet of the hall.

So restless Cromwell could not cease In the inglorious arts of peace, But through adventurous war Urgèd his active star:

And like the three-fork’d lightning, first Breaking the clouds where it was nurst, Did thorough his own side His fiery way divide:

For ’tis all one to courage high, The emulous, or enemy; And with such, to enclose Is more than to oppose.

Then burning through the air he went And palaces and temples rent; And Cæsar’s head at last Did through his laurels blast.

’Tis madness to resist or blame The face of angry Heaven’s flame; And if we would speak true, Much to the man is due,

Who, from his private gardens, where He lived reservèd and austere (As if his highest plot To plant the bergamot),

Could by industrious valour climb To ruin the great work of time, And cast the Kingdoms old Into another mould;

Though Justice against Fate complain, And plead the ancient rights in vain-- But those do hold or break As men are strong or weak--

Nature, that hateth emptiness, Allows of penetration less, And therefore must make room Where greater spirits come.

What field of all the civil war Where his were not the deepest scar? And Hampton shows what part He had of wiser art;

Where, twining subtle fears with hope, He wove a net of such a scope That Charles himself might chase To Caresbrooke’s narrow case; That thence the Royal actor borne The tragic scaffold might adorn: While round the armèd bands Did clap their bloody hands.

He nothing common did or mean Upon that memorable scene, But with his keener eye The axe’s edge did try;

Nor call’d the gods, with vulgar spite, To vindicate his helpless right; But bow’d his comely head Down, as upon a bed.

This was that memorable hour Which first assured the forcèd power: So when they did design The Capitol’s first line,

A Bleeding Head, where they begun, Did fright the architects to run; And yet in that the State Foresaw its happy fate!

And now the Irish are ashamed To see themselves in one year tamed: So much one man can do That does both act and know.

They can affirm his praises best, And have, though overcome, confest How good he is, how just And fit for highest trust.

Nor yet grown stiffer with command, But still in the republic’s hand-- How fit he is to sway That can so well obey!

He to the Commons’ feet presents A Kingdom for his first year’s rents, And, what he may, forbears His fame, to make it theirs:

And has his sword and spoils ungirt To lay them at the public’s skirt. So when the falcon high Falls heavy from the sky,

She, having kill’d, no more doth search But on the next green bough to perch; Where, when he first does lure, The falconer has her sure.

What may not then our Isle presume While victory his crest does plume? What may not others fear, If thus he crowns each year?

As Cæsar he, ere long, to Gaul, To Italy an Hannibal, And to all States not free Shall climacteric be.

The Pict no shelter now shall find Within his particolour’d mind, But, from this valour, sad Shrink underneath the plaid; Happy, if in the tufted brake The English hunter him mistake, Nor lay his hounds in near The Caledonian deer.

But thou, the war’s and fortune’s son, March indefatigably on; And for the last effect, Still keep the sword erect:

Besides the force it has to fright The spirits of the shady night, The same arts that did gain A power, must it maintain.

_356._ _A Garden_

Written after the Civil Wars

See how the flowers, as at parade, Under their colours stand display’d: Each regiment in order grows, That of the tulip, pink, and rose. But when the vigilant patrol Of stars walks round about the pole, Their leaves, that to the stalks are curl’d, Seem to their staves the ensigns furl’d. Then in some flower’s belovèd hut Each bee, as sentinel, is shut, And sleeps so too; but if once stirr’d, She runs you through, nor asks the word. O thou, that dear and happy Isle, The garden of the world erewhile, Thou Paradise of the four seas Which Heaven planted us to please, But, to exclude the world, did guard With wat’ry if not flaming sword; What luckless apple did we taste To make us mortal and thee waste! Unhappy! shall we never more That sweet militia restore, When gardens only had their towers, And all the garrisons were flowers; When roses only arms might bear, And men did rosy garlands wear?

_357._ _To His Coy Mistress_

Had we but world enough, and time, This coyness, Lady, were no crime We would sit down and think which way To walk and pass our long love’s day. Thou by the Indian Ganges’ side Shouldst rubies find: I by the tide Of Humber would complain. I would Love you ten years before the Flood, And you should, if you please, refuse Till the conversion of the Jews. My vegetable love should grow Vaster than empires, and more slow; An hundred years should go to praise Thine eyes and on thy forehead gaze; Two hundred to adore each breast, But thirty thousand to the rest; An age at

least to every part, And the last age should show your heart. For, Lady, you deserve this state, Nor would I love at lower rate. But at my back I always hear Time’s winged chariot hurrying near; And yonder all before us lie Deserts of vast eternity. Thy beauty shall no more be found, Nor, in thy marble vault, shall sound My echoing song: then worms shall try That long preserved virginity, And your quaint honour turn to dust, And into ashes all my lust: The grave’s a fine and private place, But none, I think, do there embrace. Now therefore, while the youthful hue Sits on thy skin like morning dew, And while thy willing soul transpires At every pore with instant fires, Now let us sport us while we may, And now, like amorous birds of prey, Rather at once our time devour Than languish in his slow-chapt power. Let us roll all our strength and all Our sweetness up into one ball, And tear our pleasures with rough strife Thorough the iron gates of life: Thus, though we cannot make our sun Stand still, yet we will make him run.

slow-chapt] slow-jawed, slowly devouring.

_358._ _The Picture of Little T. C. in a Prospect of Flowers_

See with what simplicity This nymph begins her golden days! In the green grass she loves to lie, And there with her fair aspect tames The wilder flowers, and gives them names; But only with the roses plays, And them does tell What colour best becomes them, and what smell.

Who can foretell for what high cause This darling of the gods was born? Yet this is she whose chaster laws The wanton Love shall one day fear, And, under her command severe, See his bow broke and ensigns torn. Happy who can Appease this virtuous enemy of man!

O then let me in time compound And parley with those conquering eyes, Ere they have tried their force to wound; Ere with their glancing wheels they drive In triumph over hearts that strive, And them that yield but more despise: Let me be laid, Where I may see the glories from some shade.

Meantime, whilst every verdant thing Itself does at thy beauty charm, Reform the errors of the Spring; Make that the tulips may have share Of sweetness, seeing they are fair, And roses of their thorns disarm; But most procure That violets may a longer age endure.

But O, young beauty of the woods, Whom Nature courts with fruits and flowers, Gather the flowers, but spare the buds; Lest Flora, angry at thy crime To kill her infants in their prime, Do quickly make th’ example yours; And ere we see, Nip in the blossom all our hopes and thee.

_359._ _Thoughts in a Garden_

How vainly men themselves amaze To win the palm, the oak, or bays, And their uncessant labours see Crown’d from some single herb or tree, Whose short and narrow-vergèd shade Does prudently their toils upbraid; While all the flowers and trees do close To weave the garlands of repose!

Fair Quiet, have I found thee here, And Innocence thy sister dear? Mistaken long, I sought you then In busy companies of men: Your sacred plants, if here below, Only among the plants will grow: Society is all but rude To this delicious solitude.

No white nor red was ever seen So amorous as this lovely green. Fond lovers, cruel as their flame, Cut in these trees their mistress' name: Little, alas! they know or heed How far these beauties hers exceed! Fair trees! wheres'e'er your barks I wound, No name shall but your own be found.

When we have run our passions' heat, Love hither makes his best retreat: The gods, that mortal beauty chase, Still in a tree did end their race; Apollo hunted Daphne so Only that she might laurel grow; And Pan did after Syrinx speed Not as a nymph, but for a reed.

What wondrous life in this I lead! Ripe apples drop about my head; The luscious clusters of the vine Upon my mouth do crush their wine; The nectarine and curious peach Into my hands themselves do reach; Stumbling on melons, as I pass, Ensnared with flowers, I fall on grass.

Meanwhile the mind from pleasure less Withdraws into its happiness; The mind, that ocean where each kind Does straight its own resemblance find; Yet it creates, transcending these, Far other worlds, and other seas; Annihilating all that's made To a green thought in a green shade.

Here at the fountain's sliding foot, Or at some fruit-tree's mossy root, Casting the body's vest aside, My soul into the boughs does glide; There, like a bird, it sits and sings, Then whets and combs its silver wings, And, till prepared for longer flight, Waves in its plumes the various light.

Such was that happy Garden-state While man there walk'd without a mate: After a place so pure and sweet, What other help could yet be meet! But 'twas beyond a mortal's share To wander solitary there: Two paradises 'twere in one, To live in Paradise alone.

How well the skilful gard'ner drew Of flowers and herbs this dial new! Where, from above, the milder sun Does through a fragrant zodiac run: And, as it works, th' industrious bee Computes its time as well as we. How could such sweet and wholesome hours Be reckon'd, but with herbs and flowers!

_360._ _Bermudas_

Where the remote Bermudas ride In the ocean's bosom unespied, From a small boat that row'd along The listening woods received this song:

'What should we do but sing His praise That led us through the watery maze Unto an isle so long unknown, And yet far kinder than our own? Where He the huge sea-monsters wracks, That lift the deep upon their backs, He lands us on a grassy stage, Safe from the storms' and prelates' rage: He gave us this eternal Spring Which here enamels everything, And sends the fowls to us in care On daily visits through the air: He hangs in shades the orange bright Like golden lamps in a green night, And does in the pomegranates close Jewels more rich than Ormus shows: He makes the

figs our mouths to meet And throws the melons at our feet; But apples plants of such a price, No tree could ever bear them twice. With cedars chosen by His hand From Lebanon He stores the land; And makes the hollow seas that roar Proclaim the ambergris on shore. He cast (of which we rather boast) The Gospel's pearl upon our coast; And in these rocks for us did frame A temple where to sound His name. O, let our voice His praise exalt Till it arrive at Heaven's vault, Which thence (perhaps) rebounding may Echo beyond the Mexique bay!'

Thus sung they in the English boat A holy and a cheerful note: And all the way, to guide their chime, With falling oars they kept the time.

_361._ _An Epitaph_

Enough; and leave the rest to Fame! 'Tis to commend her, but to name. Courtship which, living, she declined, When dead, to offer were unkind: Nor can the truest wit, or friend, Without detracting, her commend.

To say--she lived a virgin chaste In this age loose and all unlaced; Nor was, when vice is so allowed, Of virtue or ashamed or proud; That her soul was on Heaven so bent, No minute but it came and went; That, ready her last debt to pay, She summ'd her life up every day; Modest as morn, as mid-day bright, Gentle as evening, cool as night: --'Tis true; but all too weakly said. 'Twas more significant, she's dead.

HENRY VAUGHAN

1621-1695

_362._ _The Retreat_

Happy those early days, when I Shin'd in my Angel-infancy! Before I understood this place Appointed for my second race, Or taught my soul to fancy aught But a white celestial thought: When yet I had not walk'd above A mile or two from my first Love, And looking back--at that short space-- Could see a glimpse of His bright face: When on some gilded cloud, or flow'r, My gazing soul would dwell an hour, And in those weaker glories spy Some shadows of eternity: Before I taught my tongue to wound My Conscience with a sinful sound, Or had the black art to dispense A several sin to ev'ry sense, But felt through all this fleshly dress Bright shoots of everlastingness.

O how I long to travel back, And tread again that ancient track! That I might once more reach that plain Where first I left my glorious train; From whence th' enlightned spirit sees That shady City of Palm-trees. But ah! my soul with too much stay Is drunk, and staggers in the way! Some men a forward motion love, But I by backward steps would move; And when this dust falls to the urn, In that state I came, return.

_363._ _Peace_

My soul, there is a country Far beyond the stars, Where stands a wingèd sentry All skilful in the wars: There, above noise and danger, Sweet Peace sits crown'd with smiles, And One born in a manger Commands the beauteous files. He is thy gracious Friend, And--O my soul, awake!-- Did in pure love descend To die here for thy sake. If

thou canst get but thither, There grows the flower of Peace, The Rose that cannot wither, Thy fortress, and thy ease. Leave then thy foolish ranges; For none can thee secure But One who never changes-- Thy God, thy life, thy cure.

_364._ _The Timber_

Sure thou didst flourish once! and many springs, Many bright mornings, much dew, many showers, Pass'd o'er thy head; many light hearts and wings, Which now are dead, lodg'd in thy living bowers.

And still a new succession sings and flies; Fresh groves grow up, and their green branches shoot Towards the old and still enduring skies, While the low violet thrives at their root.

But thou beneath the sad and heavy line Of death, doth waste all senseless, cold, and dark; Where not so much as dreams of light may shine, Nor any thought of greenness, leaf, or bark.

And yet--as if some deep hate and dissent, Bred in thy growth betwixt high winds and thee, Were still alive--thou dost great storms resent Before they come, and know'st how near they be.

Else all at rest thou liest, and the fierce breath Of tempests can no more disturb thy ease; But this thy strange resentment after death Means only those who broke--in life--thy peace.

_365._ _Friends Departed_

They are all gone into the world of light! And I alone sit ling'ring here; Their very memory is fair and bright, And my sad thoughts doth clear.

It glows and glitters in my cloudy breast, Like stars upon some gloomy grove, Or those faint beams in which this hill is drest After the sun's remove.

I see them walking in an air of glory, Whose light doth trample on my days: My days, which are at best but dull and hoary, Mere glimmering and decays.

O holy Hope! and high Humility, High as the heavens above! These are your walks, and you have show'd them me, To kindle my cold love.

Dear, beauteous Death! the jewel of the Just, Shining nowhere, but in the dark; What mysteries do lie beyond thy dust, Could man outlook that mark!

He that hath found some fledg'd bird's nest may know, At first sight, if the bird be flown; But what fair well or grove he sings in now, That is to him unknown.

And yet as Angels in some brighter dreams Call to the soul, when man doth sleep: So some strange thoughts transcend our wonted themes, And into glory peep.

If a star were confin'd into a tomb, Her captive flames must needs burn there; But when the hand that lock'd her up gives room, She'll shine through all the sphere.

O Father of eternal life, and all Created glories under Thee! Resume Thy spirit from this world of thrall Into true liberty.

Either disperse these mists, which blot and fill My perspective still as they pass: Or else remove me hence unto that hill, Where I shall need no glass.

JOHN BUNYAN

1628-1688

_366._ _The Shepherd Boy sings in the Valley of Humiliation_

He that is down needs fear no fall, He that is low, no pride; He that is humble ever shall Have God to be his guide.

I am content with what I have, Little be it or much: And, Lord, contentment still I crave, Because Thou savest such.

Fullness to such a burden is That go on pilgrimage: Here little, and hereafter bliss, Is best from age to age.

BALLADS AND SONGS BY UNKNOWN AUTHORS

_367._ _Thomas the Rhymer_

True Thomas lay on Huntlie bank; A ferlie he spied wi’ his e’e; And there he saw a ladye bright Come riding down by the Eildon Tree.

Her skirt was o’ the grass-green silk, Her mantle o’ the velvet fyne; At ilka tett o’ her horse’s mane, Hung fifty siller bells and nine.

True Thomas he pu’d aff his cap, And louted low down on his knee: ‘Hail to thee, Mary, Queen of Heaven! For thy peer on earth could never be.’

‘O no, O no, Thomas,’ she said, ‘That name does not belang to me; I’m but the Queen o’ fair Elfland, That am hither come to visit thee.

‘Harp and carp, Thomas,’ she said; ‘Harp and carp along wi’ me; And if ye dare to kiss my lips, Sure of your bodie I will be.’

ferlie] marvel. tett] tuft, lock. harp and carp] play and recite (as a minstrel).

‘Betide me weal, betide me woe, That weird shall never daunten me.’ Syne he has kiss’d her rosy lips, All underneath the Eildon Tree.

‘Now ye maun go wi’ me,’ she said, ‘True Thomas, ye maun go wi’ me; And ye maun serve me seven years, Thro’ weal or woe as may chance to be.’

She’s mounted on her milk-white steed, She’s ta’en true Thomas up behind; And aye, whene’er her bridle rang, The steed gaed swifter than the wind.

O they rade on, and farther on, The steed gaed swifter than the wind; Until they reach’d a desert wide, And living land was left behind.

‘Light down, light down now, true Thomas, And lean your head upon my knee; Abide ye there a little space, And I will show you ferlies three.

‘O see ye not yon narrow road, So thick beset wi’ thorns and briers? That is the Path of Righteousness, Though after it but few inquires.

‘And see ye not yon braid, braid road, That lies across the lily leven? That is the Path of Wickedness, Though some call it the Road to Heaven.

leven]? lawn.

‘And see ye not yon bonny road That winds about the fernie brae? That is the Road to fair Elfland, Where thou and I this night maun gae.

‘But, Thomas, ye sall haud your tongue, Whatever ye may hear or see; For speak ye word in Elfyn-land, Ye’ll ne’er win back to your ain countrie.’

O they rade on, and farther on, And they waded rivers abune the knee; And they saw neither sun nor moon, But they heard the roaring of the sea.

It was mirk, mirk night, there was nae starlight, They waded thro’ red blude to the knee; For a’ the blude that’s shed on the earth Rins through the springs o’ that countrie.

Syne they came to a garden green, And she pu’d an apple frae a tree: ‘Take this for thy wages, true Thomas; It will give thee the tongue that can never lee.’

‘My tongue is my ain,’ true Thomas he said; ‘A gudely gift ye wad gie to me! I neither dought to buy or sell At fair or tryst where I might be.

‘I dought neither speak to prince or peer, Nor ask of grace from fair ladye!’-- ‘Now haud thy peace, Thomas,’ she said, ‘For as I say, so must it be.’

dought] could.

He has gotten a coat of the even cloth, And a pair o’ shoon of the velvet green; And till seven years were gane and past, True Thomas on earth was never seen.

_368._ _Sir Patrick Spens_

I. _The Sailing_

The king sits in Dunfermline town Drinking the blude-red wine; ‘O whare will I get a skeely skipper To sail this new ship o’ mine?’

O up and spak an eldern knight, Sat at the king’s right knee; ‘Sir Patrick Spens is the best sailor That ever sail’d the sea.’

Our king has written a braid letter, And seal’d it with his hand, And sent it to Sir Patrick Spens, Was walking on the strand.

‘To Noroway, to Noroway, To Noroway o’er the faem; The king’s daughter o’ Noroway, ’Tis thou must bring her hame.’

The first word that Sir Patrick read So loud, loud laugh’d he; The neist word that Sir Patrick read The tear blinded his e’e.

_368._ skeely] skilful.

‘O wha is this has done this deed And tauld the king o’ me, To send us out, at this time o’ year, To sail upon the sea?

‘Be it wind, be it weet, be it hail, be it sleet, Our ship must sail the faem; The king’s daughter o’ Noroway, ’Tis we must fetch her hame.’

They hoysed their sails on Monenday morn Wi’ a’ the speed they may; They hae landed in Noroway Upon a Wodensday.

II. _The Return_

‘Mak ready, mak ready, my merry men a’; Our gude ship sails the morn.’ ‘Now ever alack, my master dear, I fear a deadly storm.

‘I saw the new moon late yestreen Wi’ the auld moon in her arm; And if we gang to sea, master, I fear we’ll come to harm.’

They hadna sail’d a league, a league, A league but barely three, When the lift grew dark, and the wind blew loud, And gurly grew the sea.

The ankers brak, and the topmast lap, It was sic a deadly storm: And the waves cam owre the broken ship Till a’ her sides were torn.

lift] sky. lap] sprang.

‘Go fetch a web o’ the silken claith, Another o’ the twine, And wap them into our ship’s side, And let nae the sea come in.’

They fetch’d a web o’ the silken claith, Another o’ the twine, And they wapp’d them round that gude ship’s side, But still the sea came in.

O laith, laith were our gude Scots lords To wet their cork-heel’d shoon; But lang or a’ the play was play’d They wat their hats aboon.

And mony was the feather bed That flatter’d on the faem; And mony was the gude lord’s son That never mair cam hame.

O lang, lang may the ladies sit, Wi’ their fans into their hand, Before they see Sir Patrick Spens Come sailing to the strand!

And lang, lang may the maidens sit Wi’ their gowd kames in their hair, A-waiting for their ain dear loves! For them they’ll see nae mair.

Half-owre, half-owre to Aberdour, ’Tis fifty fathoms deep; And there lies gude Sir Patrick Spens, Wi’ the Scots lords at his feet!

flatter’d] tossed afloat. kames] combs.

_369._ _The Lass of Lochroyan_

‘O wha will shoe my bonny foot? And wha will glove my hand? And wha will bind my middle jimp Wi’ a lang, lang linen band?

‘O wha will kame my yellow hair, With a haw bayberry kame? And wha will be my babe’s father Till Gregory come hame?’

‘Thy father, he will shoe thy foot, Thy brother will glove thy hand, Thy mither will bind thy middle jimp Wi’ a lang, lang linen band.

‘Thy sister will kame thy yellow hair, Wi’ a haw bayberry kame; The Almighty will be thy babe’s father Till Gregory come hame.’

‘And wha will build a bonny ship, And set it on the sea? For I will go to seek my love, My ain love Gregory.’

Up then spak her father dear, A wafu’ man was he; ‘And I will build a bonny ship, And set her on the sea.

jimp] trim. kame] comb. haw bayberry]? a corruption for ‘braw ivory’: or bayberry may = laurel-wood.

‘And I will build a bonny ship, And set her on the sea, And ye sal gae and seek your love, Your ain love Gregory.’

Then he’s gart build a bonny ship, And set it on the sea, Wi’ four-and-twenty mariners, To bear her company.

O he’s gart build a bonny ship, To sail on the salt sea; The mast was o’ the beaten gold, The sails o’ cramoisie.

The sides were o’ the gude stout aik, The deck o’ mountain pine, The anchor o’ the silver shene, The ropes o’ silken twine.

She hadna sail’d but twenty leagues, But twenty leagues and three, When she met wi’ a rank reiver, And a’ his companie.

‘Now are ye Queen of Heaven hie, Come to pardon a’ our sin? Or are ye Mary Magdalane, Was born at Bethlam?’

‘I’m no the Queen of Heaven hie, Come to pardon ye your sin, Nor am I Mary Magdalane, Was born in Bethlam.

cramoisie] crimson. reiver] robber.

‘But I’m the lass of Lochroyan, That’s sailing on the sea To see if I can find my love, My ain love Gregory.’

‘O see na ye yon bonny bower? It’s a’ covered owre wi’ tin; When thou hast sail’d it round about, Lord Gregory is within.’

And when she saw the stately tower, Shining both clear and bright, Whilk stood aboon the jawing wave, Built on a rock of height,

Says, ‘Row the boat, my mariners, And bring me to the land, For yonder I see my love’s castle, Close by the salt sea strand.’

She sail’d it round, and sail’d it round, And loud and loud cried she, ‘Now break, now break your fairy charms, And set my true-love free.’

She’s ta’en her young son in her arms. And to the door she’s gane, And long she knock’d, and sair she ca’d. But answer got she nane.

‘O open, open, Gregory! O open! if ye be within; For here’s the lass of Lochroyan, Come far fra kith and kin.

‘O open the door, Lord Gregory! O open and let me in! The wind blows loud and cauld, Gregory, The rain drops fra my chin.

‘The shoe is frozen to my foot, The glove unto my hand, The wet drops fra my yellow hair, Na langer dow I stand.’

O up then spak his ill mither, --An ill death may she die! ‘Ye’re no the lass of Lochroyan, She’s far out-owre the sea.

‘Awa’, awa’, ye ill woman, Ye’re no come here for gude; Ye’re but some witch or wil’ warlock, Or mermaid o’ the flood.’

‘I am neither witch nor wil’ warlock, Nor mermaid o’ the sea, But I am Annie of Lochroyan, O open the door to me!’

‘Gin ye be Annie of Lochroyan, As I trow thou binna she, Now tell me of some love-tokens That pass’d ’tween thee and me.’

‘O dinna ye mind, love Gregory, As we sat at the wine, We changed the rings frae our fingers? And I can shew thee thine.

dow] can.

‘O yours was gude, and gude enough, But ay the best was mine, For yours was o’ the gude red gowd, But mine o’ the diamond fine.

‘Yours was o’ the gude red gowd, Mine o’ the diamond fine; Mine was o’ the purest troth, But thine was false within.’

‘If ye be the lass of Lochroyan, As I kenna thou be, Tell me some mair o’ the love-tokens Pass’d between thee and me.’

‘And dinna ye mind, love Gregory! As we sat on the hill, Thou twin’d me o’ my maidenheid, Right sair against my will?

‘Now open the door, love Gregory! Open the door! I pray; For thy young son is in my arms, And will be dead ere day.’

‘Ye lie, ye lie, ye ill woman, So loud I hear ye lie; For Annie of the Lochroyan Is far out-owre the sea.’

Fair Annie turn’d her round about: ‘Weel, sine that it be sae, May ne’er woman that has borne a son Hae a heart sae fu’ o’ wae!

‘Tak down, tak down that mast o’ gowd, Set up a mast of tree; It disna become a forsaken lady To sail sae royallie.’

When the cock had crawn, and the day did dawn, And the sun began to peep, Up then raise Lord Gregory, And sair, sair did he weep.

‘O I hae dream’d a dream, mither, I wish it may bring good! That the bonny lass of Lochroyan At my bower window stood.

‘O I hae dream’d a dream, mither, The thought o’t gars me greet! That fair Annie of Lochroyan Lay dead at my bed-feet.’

‘Gin it be for Annie of Lochroyan That ye mak a’ this mane, She stood last night at your bower-door, But I hae sent her hame.’

‘O wae betide ye, ill woman, An ill death may ye die! That wadna open the door yoursell Nor yet wad waken me.’

O he’s gane down to yon shore-side, As fast as he could dree, And there he saw fair Annie’s bark A rowing owre the sea.

‘O Annie, Annie,’ loud he cried, ‘O Annie, O Annie, bide!’ But ay the mair he cried ‘Annie,’ The braider grew the tide.

‘O Annie, Annie, dear Annie, Dear Annie, speak to me!’ But ay the louder he gan call, The louder roar’d the sea.

The wind blew loud, the waves rose hie And dash’d the boat on shore; Fair Annie’s corpse was in the faem, The babe rose never more.

Lord Gregory tore his gowden locks And made a wafu’ moan; Fair Annie’s corpse lay at his feet, His bonny son was gone.

‘O cherry, cherry was her cheek, And gowden was her hair, And coral, coral was her lips, Nane might with her compare,’

Then first he kiss’d her pale, pale cheek, And syne he kiss’d her chin, And syne he kiss’d her wane, wane lips, There was na breath within.

‘O wae betide my ill mither, An ill death may she die! She turn’d my true-love frae my door, Who cam so far to me.

‘O wae betide my ill mither, An ill death may she die! She has no been the deid o’ ane, But she’s been the deid of three.’

Then he’s ta’en out a little dart, Hung low down by his gore, He thrust it through and through his heart, And words spak never more.

_369._ gore] skirt, waist.

_370._ _The Dowie Houms of Yarrow_

Late at een, drinkin’ the wine, And ere they paid the lawin’, They set a combat them between, To fight it in the dawin’.

‘O stay at hame, my noble lord! O stay at hame, my marrow! My cruel brother will you betray, On the dowie houms o’ Yarrow.’

‘O fare ye weel, my lady gay! O fare ye weel, my Sarah! For I maun gae, tho’ I ne’er return Frae the dowie banks o’ Yarrow.’

She kiss’d his cheek, she kamed his hair, As she had done before, O; She belted on his noble brand, An’ he’s awa to Yarrow.

_370._ lawin’] reckoning. marrow] mate, husband or wife. dowie] doleful. houms] water-meads.

O he’s gane up yon high, high hill-- I wat he gaed wi’ sorrow-- An’ in a den spied nine arm’d men, I’ the dowie houms o’ Yarrow.

‘O are ye come to drink the wine, As ye hae doon before, O? Or are ye come to wield the brand, On the dowie banks o’ Yarrow?’

‘I am no come to drink the wine, As I hae don before, O, But I am come to wield the brand, On the dowie houms o’ Yarrow.’

Four he hurt, an’ five he slew, On the dowie houms o’ Yarrow, Till that stubborn knight came him behind, An’ ran his body thorrow.

‘Gae hame, gae hame, good brother John, An’ tell your sister Sarah To come an’ lift her noble lord, Who’s sleepin’ sound on Yarrow.’

‘Yestreen I dream’d a dolefu’ dream; I ken’d there wad be sorrow; I dream’d I pu’d the heather green, On the dowie banks o’ Yarrow.’

She gaed up yon high, high hill-- I wat she gaed wi’ sorrow-- An’ in a den spied nine dead men, On the dowie houms o’ Yarrow.

She kiss’d his cheek, she kamed his hair, As oft she did before, O; She drank the red blood frae him ran, On the dowie houms o’ Yarrow.

‘O haud your tongue, my douchter dear, For what needs a’ this sorrow? I’ll wed you on a better lord Than him you lost on Yarrow.’

‘O haud your tongue, my father dear, An’ dinna grieve your Sarah; A better lord was never born Than him I lost on Yarrow.

‘Tak hame your ousen, tak hame your kye, For they hae bred our sorrow; I wiss that they had a’ gane mad Whan they cam first to Yarrow.’

_371._ _Clerk Saunders_

Clerk Saunders and may Margaret Walk’d owre yon garden green; And deep and heavy was the love That fell thir twa between.

‘A bed, a bed,’ Clerk Saunders said, ‘A bed for you and me!’ ‘Fye na, fye na,’ said may Margaret, ’Till anes we married be!’

‘Then I’ll take the sword frae my scabbard And slowly lift the pin; And you may swear, and save your aith, Ye ne’er let Clerk Saunders in.

‘Take you a napkin in your hand, And tie up baith your bonnie e’en, And you may swear, and save your aith, Ye saw me na since late yestreen.’

It was about the midnight hour, When they asleep were laid, When in and came her seven brothers, Wi’ torches burning red:

When in and came her seven brothers, Wi’ torches burning bright: They said, ‘We hae but one sister, And behold her lying with a knight!’

Then out and spake the first o’ them, ‘I bear the sword shall gar him die.’ And out and spake the second o’ them, ‘His father has nae mair but he.’

And out and spake the third o’ them, ‘I wot that they are lovers dear.’ And out and spake the fourth o’ them, ‘They hae been in love this mony a year.’

Then out and spake the fifth o’ them, ‘It were great sin true love to twain.’ And out and spake the sixth o’ them, ‘It were shame to slay a sleeping man.’

Then up and gat the seventh o’ them, And never a word spake he; But he has striped his bright brown brand Out through Clerk Saunders’ fair bodye.

striped] thrust.

Clerk Saunders he started, and Margaret she turn’d Into his arms as asleep she lay; And sad and silent was the night That was atween thir twae.

And they lay still and sleepit sound Until the day began to daw’; And kindly she to him did say, ‘It is time, true love, you were awa’.’

But he lay still, and sleepit sound, Albeit the sun began to sheen; She look’d atween her and the wa’, And dull and drowsie were his e’en.

Then in and came her father dear; Said, ‘Let a’ your mourning be; I’ll carry the dead corse to the clay, And I’ll come back and comfort thee.’

‘Comfort weel your seven sons, For comforted I will never be: I ween ’twas neither knave nor loon Was in the bower last night wi’ me.’

The clinking bell gaed through the town, To carry the dead corse to the clay; And Clerk Saunders stood at may Margaret’s window, I wot, an hour before the day.

‘Are ye sleeping, Marg’ret?’ he says, ‘Or are ye waking presentlie? Give me my faith and troth again, I wot, true love, I gied to thee.’

‘Your faith and troth ye sail never get, Nor our true love sail never twin, Until ye come within my bower, And kiss me cheik and chin.’

‘My mouth it is full cold, Marg’ret; It has the smell, now, of the ground; And if I kiss thy comely mouth, Thy days of life will not be lang.

‘O cocks are crowing a merry midnight; I wot the wild fowls are boding day; Give me my faith and troth again, And let me fare me on my way.’

‘Thy faith and troth thou sallna get, And our true love sail never twin, Until ye tell what comes o’ women, I wot, who die in strong traivelling?’

‘Their beds are made in the heavens high, Down at the foot of our good Lord’s knee, Weel set about wi’ gillyflowers; I wot, sweet company for to see.

‘O cocks are crowing a merry midnight; I wot the wild fowls are boding day; The psalms of heaven will soon be sung, And I, ere now, will be miss’d away.’

Then she has taken a crystal wand, And she has stroken her troth thereon; She has given it him out at the shot-window, Wi’ mony a sad sigh and heavy groan.

twin] part in two.

‘I thank ye, Marg’ret; I thank ye, Marg’ret; And ay I thank ye heartilie; Gin ever the dead come for the quick, Be sure, Marg’ret, I’ll come for thee.’

It’s hosen and shoon, and gown alone, She climb’d the wall, and follow’d him, Until she came to the green forest, And there she lost the sight o’ him.

‘Is there ony room at your head, Saunders? Is there ony room at your feet? Or ony room at your side, Saunders, Where fain, fain, I wad sleep?’

‘There’s nae room at my head, Marg’ret, There’s nae room at my feet; My bed it is fu’ lowly now, Amang the hungry worms I sleep.

‘Cauld mould is my covering now, But and my winding-sheet; The dew it falls nae sooner down Than my resting-place is weet.

‘But plait a wand o’ bonny birk, And lay it on my breast; And shed a tear upon my grave, And wish my saul gude rest.’

Then up and crew the red, red cock, And up and crew the gray: ‘’Tis time, ’tis time, my dear Marg’ret, That you were going away.

‘And fair Marg’ret, and rare Marg’ret, And Marg’ret o’ veritie, Gin e’er ye love another man, Ne’er love him as ye did me.’

_372._ _Fair Annie_

The reivers they stole Fair Annie, As she walk’d by the sea; But a noble knight was her ransom soon, Wi’ gowd and white monie.

She bided in strangers’ land wi’ him, And none knew whence she cam; She lived in the castle wi’ her love, But never told her name.

‘It’s narrow, narrow, mak your bed, And learn to lie your lane; For I’m gaun owre the sea, Fair Annie, A braw Bride to bring hame. Wi’ her I will get gowd and gear, Wi’ you I ne’er gat nane.

‘But wha will bake my bridal bread, Or brew my bridal ale? And wha will welcome my bright Bride, That I bring owre the dale?’

‘It’s I will bake your bridal bread, And brew your bridal ale; And I will welcome your bright Bride, That you bring owre the dale.’

‘But she that welcomes my bright Bride Maun gang like maiden fair; She maun lace on her robe sae jimp, And comely braid her hair.

‘Bind up, bind up your yellow hair, And tie it on your neck; And see you look as maiden-like As the day that first we met.’

‘O how can I gang maiden-like, When maiden I am nane? Have I not borne six sons to thee, And am wi’ child again?’

‘I’ll put cooks into my kitchen, And stewards in my hall, And I’ll have bakers for my bread, And brewers for my ale; But you’re to welcome my bright Bride, That I bring owre the dale.’

Three months and a day were gane and past, Fair Annie she gat word That her love's ship was come at last, Wi' his bright young Bride aboard.

She 's ta'en her young son in her arms, Anither in her hand; And she's gane up to the highest tower, Looks over sea and land.

jimp] trim.

'Come doun, come doun, my mother dear, Come aff the castle wa'! I fear if langer ye stand there, Ye'll let yoursell doun fa'.'

She's ta'en a cake o' the best bread, A stoup o' the best wine, And a' the keys upon her arm, And to the yett is gane.

'O ye're welcome hame, my ain gude lord, To your castles and your towers; Ye're welcome hame, my ain gude lord, To your ha's, but and your bowers. And welcome to your hame, fair lady! For a' that's here is yours.'

'O whatna lady's that, my lord, That welcomes you and me? Gin I be lang about this place, Her friend I mean to be.'

Fair Annie served the lang tables Wi' the white bread and the wine; But ay she drank the wan water To keep her colour fine.

And she gaed by the first table, And smiled upon them a'; But ere she reach'd the second table, The tears began to fa'.

yett] gate.

She took a napkin lang and white, And hung it on a pin; It was to wipe away the tears, As she gaed out and in.

When bells were rung and mass was sung, And a' men bound for bed, The bridegroom and the bonny Bride In ae chamber were laid.

Fair Annie's ta'en a harp in her hand, To harp thir twa asleep; But ay, as she harpit and she sang, Fu' sairly did she weep.

'O gin my sons were seven rats, Rinnin' on the castle wa', And I mysell a great grey cat, I soon wad worry them a'!

'O gin my sons were seven hares, Rinnin' owre yon lily lea, And I mysell a good greyhound, Soon worried they a' should be!'

Then out and spak the bonny young Bride, In bride-bed where she lay: 'That's like my sister Annie,' she says; 'Wha is it doth sing and play?

'I'll put on my gown,' said the new-come Bride, 'And my shoes upon my feet; I will see wha doth sae sadly sing, And what is it gars her greet.

'What ails you, what ails you, my housekeeper, That ye mak sic a mane? Has ony wine-barrel cast its girds, Or is a' your white bread gane?'

'It isna because my wine is spilt, Or that my white bread's gane; But because I've lost my true love's love, And he's wed to anither ane.'

‘Noo tell me wha was your father?’ she says, ‘Noo tell me wha was your mother? And had ye ony sister?’ she says, ‘And had ye ever a brother?’

‘The Earl of Wemyss was my father, The Countess of Wemyss my mother, Young Elinor she was my sister dear, And Lord John he was my brother.’

‘If the Earl of Wemyss was your father, I wot sae was he mine; And it’s O my sister Annie! Your love ye sallna tyne.

‘Tak your husband, my sister dear; You ne’er were wrang’d for me, Beyond a kiss o’ his merry mouth As we cam owre the sea.

‘Seven ships, loaded weel, Cam owre the sea wi’ me; Ane o’ them will tak me hame, And six I’ll gie to thee.’

tyne] lose.

_373._ _Edward, Edward_

‘Why does your brand sae drop wi’ blude, Edward, Edward? Why does your brand sae drop wi’ blude, And why sae sad gang ye, O?’ ‘O I hae kill’d my hawk sae gude, Mither, mither; O I hae kill’d my hawk sae gude, And I had nae mair but he, O.’

‘Your hawk’s blude was never sae red, Edward, Edward; Your hawk’s blude was never sae red, My dear son, I tell thee, O.’ ‘O I hae kill’d my red-roan steed, Mither, mither; O I hae kill’d my red-roan steed, That erst was sae fair and free, O.’

‘Your steed was auld, and ye hae got mair, Edward, Edward; Your steed was auld, and ye hae got mair; Some other dule ye dree, O.’ ‘O I hae kill’d my father dear, Mither, mither; O I hae kill’d my father dear, Alas, and wae is me, O!’

dule ye dree] grief you suffer.

‘And whatten penance will ye dree for that, Edward, Edward? Whatten penance will ye dree for that? My dear son, now tell me, O.’ ‘I’ll set my feet in yonder boat, Mither, mither; I’ll set my feet in yonder boat, And I’ll fare over the sea, O.’

‘And what will ye do wi’ your tow’rs and your ha’, Edward, Edward? And what will ye do wi’ your tow’rs and your ha’, That were sae fair to see, O?’ ‘I’ll let them stand till they doun fa’, Mither, mither; I’ll let them stand till they doun fa’, For here never mair maun I be, O.’

‘And what will ye leave to your bairns and your wife, Edward, Edward? And what will ye leave to your bairns and your wife, When ye gang owre the sea, O?’ ‘The warld’s room: let them beg through life, Mither, mither; The warld’s room: let them beg through life; For them never mair will I see, O.’

‘And what will ye leave to your ain mither dear. Edward, Edward? And what will ye leave to your ain mither dear, My dear son, now tell me, O?’ ‘The curse of hell frae me sall ye bear, Mither, mither; The curse of hell frae me sall ye bear: Sic counsels ye gave to me, O!’

_374._ _Edom o’ Gordon_

It fell about the Martinmas, When the wind blew shrill and cauld, Said Edom o’ Gordon to his men, ‘We maun draw to a hauld.

‘And what a hauld sall we draw to, My merry men and me? We will gae to the house o’ the Rodes, To see that fair ladye.’

The lady stood on her castle wa’, Beheld baith dale and down; There she was ware of a host of men Cam riding towards the town.

‘O see ye not, my merry men a’, O see ye not what I see? Methinks I see a host of men; I marvel wha they be.’

She ween’d it had been her lovely lord, As he cam riding hame; It was the traitor, Edom o’ Gordon, Wha reck’d nae sin nor shame.

town] stead.

She had nae sooner buskit hersell, And putten on her gown, But Edom o’ Gordon an’ his men Were round about the town.

They had nae sooner supper set, Nae sooner said the grace, But Edom o’ Gordon an’ his men Were lighted about the place.

The lady ran up to her tower-head, Sae fast as she could hie, To see if by her fair speeches She could wi’ him agree.

‘Come doun to me, ye lady gay, Come doun, come doun to me; This night sall ye lig within mine arms, To-morrow my bride sall be.’

‘I winna come down, ye fals Gordon, I winna come down to thee; I winna forsake my ain dear lord, That is sae far frae me.’

‘Gie owre your house, ye lady fair, Gie owre your house to me; Or I sall brenn yoursel therein, But and your babies three.’

‘I winna gie owre, ye fals Gordon, To nae sic traitor as yee; And if ye brenn my ain dear babes, My lord sail mak ye dree.

buskit] attired.

‘Now reach my pistol, Glaud, my man, And charge ye weel my gun; For, but an I pierce that bluidy butcher, My babes, we been undone!’

She stood upon her castle wa’, And let twa bullets flee: She miss’d that bluidy butcher’s heart, And only razed his knee.

‘Set fire to the house!’ quo’ fals Gordon, All wud wi’ dule and ire: ‘Fals lady, ye sail rue this deid As ye brenn in the fire!’

Wae worth, wae worth ye, Jock, my man! I paid ye weel your fee; Why pu’ ye out the grund-wa’ stane, Lets in the reek to me?

‘And e’en wae worth ye, Jock, my man! I paid ye weel your hire; Why pu’ ye out the grund-wa’ stane, To me lets in the fire?’

‘Ye paid me weel my hire, ladye, Ye paid me weel my fee: But now I’m Edom o’ Gordon’s man-- Maun either do or die.’

O then bespake her little son, Sat on the nurse’s knee: Says, ‘Mither dear, gie owre this house, For the reek it smithers me.’

wud] mad. grund-wa’] ground-wall.

‘I wad gie a’ my gowd, my bairn, Sae wad I a’ my fee, For ae blast o’ the western wind, To blaw the reek frae thee.’

O then bespake her dochter dear-- She was baith jimp and sma’: ‘O row me in a pair o’ sheets, And tow me owre the wa’!’

They row’d her in a pair o’ sheets, And tow’d her owre the wa’; But on the point o’ Gordon’s spear She gat a deadly fa’.

O bonnie, bonnie was her mouth, And cherry were her cheiks, And clear, clear was her yellow hair, Whereon the red blood dreips.

Then wi’ his spear he turn’d her owre; O gin her face was wane! He said, ‘Ye are the first that e’er I wish’d alive again.’

He turn’d her owre and owre again; O gin her skin was white! ‘I might hae spared that bonnie face To hae been some man’s delight.

‘Busk and boun, my merry men a’, For ill dooms I do guess; I canna look in that bonnie face As it lies on the grass.’

jimp] slender, trim. row] roll, wrap. Busk and boun] trim up and prepare to go.

‘Wha looks to freits, my master dear, It’s freits will follow them; Let it ne’er be said that Edom o’ Gordon Was daunted by a dame.’

But when the lady saw the fire Come flaming owre her head, She wept, and kiss’d her children twain, Says, ‘Bairns, we been but dead.’

The Gordon then his bugle blew, And said, ‘Awa’, awa’! This house o’ the Rodes is a’ in a flame; I hauld it time to ga’.’

And this way lookit her ain dear lord, As he cam owre the lea; He saw his castle a’ in a lowe, As far as he could see.

Then sair, O sair, his mind misgave, And all his heart was wae: ‘Put on, put on, my wighty men, Sae fast as ye can gae.

‘Put on, put on, my wighty men, Sae fast as ye can drie! For he that’s hindmost o’ the thrang Sall ne’er get good o’ me.’

Then some they rade, and some they ran, Out-owre the grass and bent; But ere the foremost could win up, Baith lady and babes were brent.

freits] ill omens. lowe] flame. wighty] stout, doughty.

And after the Gordon he is gane, Sae fast as he might drie; And soon i’ the Gordon’s foul heart’s blude He’s wroken his dear ladye.

wroken] avenged.

_375._ _The Queen’s Marie_

Marie Hamilton’s to the kirk gane, Wi’ ribbons in her hair; The King thought mair o’ Marie Hamilton Than ony that were there.

Marie Hamilton’s to the kirk gane Wi’ ribbons on her breast; The King thought mair o’ Marie Hamilton Than he listen’d to the priest.

Marie Hamilton’s to the kirk gane, Wi’ gloves upon her hands; The King thought mair o’ Marie Hamilton Than the Queen and a’ her lands.

She hadna been about the King’s court A month, but barely one, Till she was beloved by a’ the King’s court And the King the only man.

She hadna been about the King’s court A month, but barely three, Till frae the King’s court Marie Hamilton, Marie Hamilton durstna be.

The King is to the Abbey gane, To pu’ the Abbey tree, To scale the babe frae Marie’s heart; But the thing it wadna be.

O she has row’d it in her apron, And set it on the sea-- ‘Gae sink ye or swim ye, bonny babe, Ye’se get nae mair o’ me.’

Word is to the kitchen gane, And word is to the ha’, And word is to the noble room Amang the ladies a’, That Marie Hamilton’s brought to bed, And the bonny babe’s miss’d and awa’.

Scarcely had she lain down again, And scarcely fa’en asleep, When up and started our gude Queen Just at her bed-feet; Saying--‘Marie Hamilton, where’s your babe? For I am sure I heard it greet.’

‘O no, O no, my noble Queen! Think no sic thing to be; ’Twas but a stitch into my side, And sair it troubles me!’

‘Get up, get up, Marie Hamilton: Get up and follow me; For I am going to Edinburgh town, A rich wedding for to see.’

row’d] rolled, wrapped. greet] cry.

O slowly, slowly rase she up, And slowly put she on; And slowly rade she out the way Wi’ mony a weary groan.

The Queen was clad in scarlet, Her merry maids all in green; And every town that they cam to, They took Marie for the Queen.

‘Ride hooly, hooly, gentlemen, Ride hooly now wi’ me! For never, I am sure, a wearier burd Rade in your companie.’--

But little wist Marie Hamilton, When she rade on the brown, That she was gaen to Edinburgh town, And a’ to be put down.

‘Why weep ye so, ye burgess wives, Why look ye so on me? O I am going to Edinburgh town, A rich wedding to see.’

When she gaed up the tolbooth stairs, The corks frae her heels did flee; And lang or e’er she cam down again, She was condemn’d to die.

When she cam to the Netherbow port, She laugh’d loud laughters three; But when she came to the gallows foot The tears blinded her e’e.

hooly] gently.

‘Yestreen the Queen had four Maries, The night she’ll hae but three; There was Marie Seaton, and Marie Beaton, And Marie Carmichael, and me.

‘O often have I dress’d my Queen And put gowd upon her hair; But now I’ve gotten for my reward The gallows to be my share.

‘Often have I dress’d my Queen And often made her bed; But now I’ve gotten for my reward The gallows tree to tread.

‘I charge ye all, ye mariners, When ye sail owre the faem, Let neither my father nor mother get wit But that I’m coming hame.

‘I charge ye all, ye mariners, That sail upon the sea, That neither my father nor mother get wit The dog’s death I’m to die.

‘For if my father and mother got wit, And my bold brethren three, O mickle wad be the gude red blude This day wad be spilt for me!

‘O little did my mother ken, The day she cradled me, The lands I was to travel in Or the death I was to die!

_376._ _Binnorie_

There were twa sisters sat in a bour; _Binnorie, O Binnorie_! There cam a knight to be their wooer, _By the bonnie milldams o’ Binnorie_.

He courted the eldest with glove and ring, But he lo’ed the youngest abune a thing.

The eldest she was vexèd sair, And sair envied her sister fair.

Upon a morning fair and clear, She cried upon her sister dear:

‘O sister, sister, tak my hand, And let’s go down to the river-strand.’

She’s ta’en her by the lily hand, And led her down to the river-strand.

The youngest stood upon a stane, The eldest cam and push’d her in.

‘O sister, sister, reach your hand! And ye sall be heir o’ half my land:

‘O sister, reach me but your glove! And sweet William sall be your love.’

Sometimes she sank, sometimes she swam, Until she cam to the miller’s dam.

Out then cam the miller’s son, And saw the fair maid soummin’ in.

‘O father, father, draw your dam! There’s either a mermaid or a milk-white swan.’

soummin’] swimming.

The miller hasted and drew his dam, And there he found a drown’d womàn.

You couldna see her middle sma’, Her gowden girdle was sae braw.

You couldna see her lily feet, Her gowden fringes were sae deep.

All amang her yellow hair A string o’ pearls was twisted rare.

You couldna see her fingers sma’, Wi’ diamond rings they were cover’d a’.

And by there cam a harper fine, That harpit to the king at dine.

And when he look’d that lady on, He sigh’d and made a heavy moan.

He’s made a harp of her breast-bane, Whose sound wad melt a heart of stane.

He’s ta’en three locks o’ her yellow hair, And wi’ them strung his harp sae rare.

He went into her father’s hall, And there was the court assembled all.

He laid his harp upon a stane, And straight it began to play by lane.

‘O yonder sits my father, the King, And yonder sits my mother, the Queen; ‘And yonder stands my brother Hugh, And by him my William, sweet and true.’

But the last tune that the harp play’d then-- _Binnorie, O Binnorie_! Was, ‘Woe to my sister, false Helèn!’ _By the bonnie milldams o’ Binnorie._

_377._ _The Bonnie House o’ Airlie_

It fell on a day, and a bonnie simmer day, When green grew aits and barley, That there fell out a great dispute Between Argyll and Airlie.

Argyll has raised an hunder men, An hunder harness’d rarely, And he’s awa’ by the back of Dunkell, To plunder the castle of Airlie.

Lady Ogilvie looks o’er her bower-window, And O but she looks warely! And there she spied the great Argyll, Come to plunder the bonnie house of Airlie.

‘Come down, come down, my Lady Ogilvie, Come down and kiss me fairly:’ ‘O I winna kiss the fause Argyll, If he shouldna leave a standing stane in Airlie.’

He hath taken her by the left shoulder, Says, ‘Dame, where lies thy dowry?’ ‘O it’s east and west yon wan water side, And it’s down by the banks of the Airlie.’

They hae sought it up, they hae sought it down, They hae sought it maist severely, Till they fand it in the fair plum-tree That shines on the bowling-green of Airlie.

He hath taken her by the middle sae small, And O but she grat sairly! And laid her down by the bonnie burn-side, Till they plunder’d the castle of Airlie.

‘Gif my gude lord war here this night, As he is with King Charlie, Neither you, nor ony ither Scottish lord, Durst avow to the plundering of Airlie.

‘Gif my gude lord war now at hame, As he is with his king, There durst nae a Campbell in a’ Argyll Set fit on Airlie green.

‘Ten bonnie sons I have borne unto him, The eleventh ne’er saw his daddy; But though I had an hunder mair, I’d gie them a’ to King Charlie!’

_378._ _The Wife of Usher’s Well_

There lived a wife at Usher’s well, And a wealthy wife was she; She had three stout and stalwart sons, And sent them o’er the sea.

They hadna been a week from her, A week but barely ane, When word came to the carline wife That her three sons were gane.

They hadna been a week from her, A week but barely three, When word came to the carline wife That her sons she’d never see.

‘I wish the wind may never cease. Nor fashes in the flood, Till my three sons come hame to me, In earthly flesh and blood!’

It fell about the Martinmas, When nights are lang and mirk, The carline wife’s three sons came hame, And their hats were o’ the birk.

It neither grew in syke nor ditch, Nor yet in ony sheugh; But at the gates o’ Paradise That birk grew fair eneugh.

‘Blow up the fire, my maidens! Bring water from the well! For a’ my house shall feast this night, Since my three sons are well.’

And she has made to them a bed, She’s made it large and wide; And she’s ta’en her mantle her about, Sat down at the bedside.

fashes] troubles. syke] marsh. sheugh] trench.

Up then crew the red, red cock, And up and crew the gray; The eldest to the youngest said. ‘’Tis time we were away.’

The cock he hadna craw’d but once, And clapp’d his wings at a’, When the youngest to the eldest said, ‘Brother, we must awa’.

‘The cock doth craw, the day doth daw, The channerin’ worm doth chide; Gin we be miss’d out o’ our place, A sair pain we maun bide.’

‘Lie still, lie still but a little wee while, Lie still but if we may; Gin my mother should miss us when she wakes, She’ll go mad ere it be day.’

‘Fare ye weel, my mother dear! Fareweel to barn and byre! And fare ye weel, the bonny lass That kindles my mother’s fire!’

_378._ channerin’] fretting.

_379._ _The Three Ravens_

There were three ravens sat on a tree, They were as black as they might be.

The one of them said to his make, ‘Where shall we our breakfast take?’

_379._ make] mate.

‘Down in yonder greene field There lies a knight slain under his shield;

‘His hounds they lie down at his feet, So well they can their master keep;

‘His hawks they flie so eagerly, There ’s no fowl dare come him nigh.’

Down there comes a fallow doe As great with young as she might goe.

She lift up his bloudy head And kist his wounds that were so red.

She gat him up upon her back And carried him to earthen lake.

She buried him before the prime, She was dead herself ere evensong time.

God send every gentleman Such hounds, such hawks, and such a leman.

_380._ _The Twa Corbies_

(SCOTTISH VERSION)

As I was walking all alane I heard twa corbies making a mane: The tane unto the tither did say, ‘Whar sall we gang and dine the day?’

_380._ corbies] ravens.

‘--In behint yon auld fail dyke I wot there lies a new-slain knight; And naebody kens that he lies there But his hawk, his hound, and his lady fair.

‘His hound is to the hunting gane, His hawk to fetch the wild-fowl hame, His lady’s ta’en anither mate, So we may mak our dinner sweet.

‘Ye’ll sit on his white hause-bane, And I’ll pike out his bonny blue e’en: Wi’ ae lock o’ his gowden hair We’ll theek our nest when it grows bare.

‘Mony a one for him maks mane, But nane sall ken whar he is gane: O’er his white banes, when they are bare, The wind sall blaw for evermair.’

_380._ fail] turf. hause] neck. theek] thatch.

_381._ _A Lyke-Wake Dirge_

This ae nighte, this ae nighte, --_Every nighte and alle_, Fire and fleet and candle-lighte, _And Christe receive thy saule_.

When thou from hence away art past, --_Every nighte and alle_, To Whinny-muir thou com’st at last; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

_381._ fleet] house-room.

If ever thou gavest hosen and shoon, --_Every nighte and alle_, Sit thee down and put them on; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

If hosen and shoon thou ne’er gav’st nane --_Every nighte and alle_, The whinnes sall prick thee to the bare bane; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

From Whinny-muir when thou may’st pass, --_Every nighte and alle_, To Brig o’ Dread thou com’st at last; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

From Brig o’ Dread when thou may’st pass, --_Every nighte and alle_, To Purgatory fire thou com’st at last; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

If ever thou gavest meat or drink, --_Every nighte and alle_, The fire sall never make thee shrink; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

If meat or drink thou ne’er gav’st nane, --_Every nighte and alle_, The fire will burn thee to the bare bane; _And Christe receive thy saule_.

This ae nighte, this ae nighte, --_Every nighte and alle_, Fire and fleet and candle-lighte, _And Christe receive thy saule_.

_382._ _The Seven Virgins._

A CAROL

All under the leaves and the leaves of life I met with virgins seven, And one of them was Mary mild, Our Lord’s mother of Heaven.

‘O what are you seeking, you seven fair maids. All under the leaves of life? Come tell, come tell, what seek you All under the leaves of life?’

‘We’re seeking for no leaves, Thomas, But for a friend of thine; We’re seeking for sweet Jesus Christ, To be our guide and thine.’

‘Go down, go down, to yonder town, And sit in the gallery, And there you’ll see sweet Jesus Christ Nail’d to a big yew-tree.’

So down they went to yonder town As fast as foot could fall, And many a grievous bitter tear From the virgins’ eyes did fall.

‘O peace, Mother, O peace, Mother, Your weeping doth me grieve: I must suffer this,’ He said, ‘For Adam and for Eve.

‘O Mother, take you John Evangelist All for to be your son, And he will comfort you sometimes, Mother, as I have done.’

‘O come, thou John Evangelist, Thou’rt welcome unto me; But more welcome my own dear Son, Whom I nursed on my knee.’

Then He laid His head on His right shoulder, Seeing death it struck Him nigh-- ‘The Holy Ghost be with your soul, I die, Mother dear, I die.’

O the rose, the gentle rose, And the fennel that grows so green! God give us grace in every place To pray for our king and queen.

Furthermore for our enemies all Our prayers they should be strong: Amen, good Lord; your charity Is the ending of my song.

_383._ _Two Rivers_

Says Tweed to Till-- ‘What gars ye rin sae still?’ Says Till to Tweed-- ‘Though ye rin with speed And I rin slaw, For ae man that ye droon I droon twa.’

_384._ _Cradle Song_

O my deir hert, young Jesus sweit, Prepare thy creddil in my spreit, And I sall rock thee in my hert And never mair from thee depart.

But I sall praise thee evermoir With sangis sweit unto thy gloir; The knees of my hert sall I bow, And sing that richt _Balulalow_!

_385._ _The Call_

My blood so red For thee was shed, Come home again, come home again; My own sweet heart, come home again! You’ve gone astray Out of your way, Come home again, come home again!

_386._ _The Bonny Earl of Murray_

Ye Highlands and ye Lawlands, O where hae ye been? They hae slain the Earl of Murray, And hae laid him on the green.

Now wae be to thee, Huntley! And whairfore did ye sae! I bade you bring him wi’ you. But forbade you him to slay.

He was a braw gallant, And he rid at the ring; And the bonny Earl of Murray, O he might hae been a king!

He was a braw gallant, And he play’d at the ba’; And the bonny Earl of Murray Was the flower amang them a’!

He was a braw gallant, And he play’d at the gluve; And the bonny Earl of Murray, O he was the Queen’s luve!

O lang will his Lady Look owre the Castle Downe, Ere she see the Earl of Murray Come sounding through the town!

_387._ _Helen of Kirconnell_

I wish I were where Helen lies, Night and day on me she cries; O that I were where Helen lies, On fair Kirconnell lea!

Curst be the heart that thought the thought, And curst the hand that fired the shot, When in my arms burd Helen dropt, And died to succour me!

O think na ye my heart was sair, When my Love dropp’d and spak nae mair! There did she swoon wi’ meikle care, On fair Kirconnell lea.

As I went down the water side, None but my foe to be my guide, None but my foe to be my guide, On fair Kirconnell lea;

I lighted down my sword to draw, I hackèd him in pieces sma’, I hackèd him in pieces sma’, For her sake that died for me.

O Helen fair, beyond compare! I’ll mak a garland o’ thy hair, Shall bind my heart for evermair, Until the day I die!

O that I were where Helen lies! Night and day on me she cries; Out of my bed she bids me rise, Says, ‘Haste, and come to me!’

O Helen fair! O Helen chaste! If I were with thee, I’d be blest, Where thou lies low and taks thy rest, On fair Kirconnell lea.

I wish my grave were growing green, A winding-sheet drawn owre my e’en, And I in Helen’s arms lying, On fair Kirconnell lea.

I wish I were where Helen lies! Night and day on me she cries; And I am weary of the skies, For her sake that died for me.

_388._ _Waly, Waly_

O waly, waly, up the bank, And waly, waly, doun the brae, And waly, waly, yon burn-side, Where I and my Love wont to gae! I lean'd my back unto an aik, I thocht it was a trustie tree; But first it bow'd and syne it brak-- Sae my true love did lichtlie me.

O waly, waly, gin love be bonnie A little time while it is new! But when 'tis auld it waxeth cauld, And fades awa' like morning dew. O wherefore should I busk my heid, Or wherefore should I kame my hair? For my true Love has me forsook, And says he'll never lo'e me mair.

Now Arthur's Seat sall be my bed, The sheets sall ne'er be 'filed by me; Saint Anton's well sall be my drink; Since my true Love has forsaken me. Marti'mas wind, when wilt thou blaw, And shake the green leaves aff the tree? O gentle Death, when wilt thou come? For of my life I am wearìe.

'Tis not the frost, that freezes fell, Nor blawing snaw's inclemencie, 'Tis not sic cauld that makes me cry; But my Love's heart grown cauld to me. When we cam in by Glasgow toun, We were a comely sicht to see; My Love was clad in the black velvèt, And I mysel in cramasie.

But had I wist, before I kist, That love had been sae ill to win, I had lock'd my heart in a case o' gowd. And pinn'd it wi' a siller pin. And O! if my young babe were born, And set upon the nurse's knee; And I mysel were dead and gane, And the green grass growing over me!

_388._ cramasie] crimson.

_389._ _Barbara Allen's Cruelty_

In Scarlet town, where I was born, There was a fair maid dwellin', Made every youth cry _Well-a-way_! Her name was Barbara Allen.

All in the merry month of May, When green buds they were swellin', Young Jemmy Grove on his death-bed lay, For love of Barbara Allen.

He sent his man in to her then, To the town where she was dwellin', 'O haste and come to my master dear, If your name be Barbara Allen.'

So slowly, slowly rase she up, And slowly she came nigh him, And when she drew the curtain by-- 'Young man, I think you're dyin'.'

'O it's I am sick and very very sick, And it's all for Barbara Allen.' 'O the better for me ye'se never be, Tho' your heart's blood were a-spillin'!

'O dinna ye mind, young man,' says she, 'When the red wine ye were fillin', That ye made the healths go round and round, And slighted Barbara Allen?'

He turn'd his face unto the wall, And death was with him dealin': 'Adieu, adieu, my dear friends all, And be kind to Barbara Allen!'

As she was walking o’er the fields, She heard the dead-bell knellin’; And every jow the dead-bell gave Cried ‘Woe to Barbara Allen.’

‘O mother, mother, make my bed, O make it saft and narrow: My love has died for me to-day, I’ll die for him to-morrow.

‘Farewell,’ she said, ‘ye virgins all, And shun the fault I fell in: Henceforth take warning by the fall Of cruel Barbara Allen.’

_389._ jow] beat, toll.

_390._ _Pipe and Can_

I

The Indian weed witherèd quite; Green at morn, cut down at night; Shows thy decay: all flesh is hay: Thus think, then drink Tobacco.

And when the smoke ascends on high, Think thou behold’st the vanity Of worldly stuff, gone with a puff: Thus think, then drink Tobacco.

But when the pipe grows foul within, Think of thy soul defiled with sin, And that the fire doth it require: Thus think, then drink Tobacco.

The ashes, that are left behind, May serve to put thee still in mind That unto dust return thou must: Thus think, then drink Tobacco.

II

When as the chill Charokko blows, And Winter tells a heavy tale; When pyes and daws and rooks and crows Sit cursing of the frosts and snows; Then give me ale.

Ale in a Saxon rumkin then, Such as will make grimalkin prate; Bids valour burgeon in tall men, Quickens the poet’s wit and pen, Despises fate.

Ale, that the absent battle fights, And frames the march of Swedish drum, Disputes with princes, laws, and rights, What’s done and past tells mortal wights, And what’s to come.

Charokko] Scirocco.

Ale, that the plowman’s heart up-keeps And equals it with tyrants’ thrones, That wipes the eye that over-weeps, And lulls in sure and dainty sleeps Th’ o’er-wearied bones.

Grandchild of Ceres, Bacchus’ daughter, Wine’s emulous neighbour, though but stale, Ennobling all the nymphs of water, And filling each man’s heart with laughter--Ha! give me ale!

_391._ _Love will find out the Way_

Over the mountains And over the waves, Under the fountains And under the graves; Under floods that are deepest, Which Neptune obey, Over rocks that are

steepest, Love will find out the way.

When there is no place For the glow-worm to lie, When there is no space For receipt of a fly; When the midge dares not venture Lest herself fast she lay, If Love come, he will enter And will find out the way.

You may esteem him A child for his might; Or you may deem him A coward for his flight; But if she whom Love doth honour Be conceal'd from the day-- Set a thousand guards upon her, Love will find out the way.

Some think to lose him By having him confined; And some do suppose him, Poor heart! to be blind; But if ne'er so close ye wall him, Do the best that ye may, Blind Love, if so ye call him, He will find out his way.

You may train the eagle To stoop to your fist; Or you may inveigle The Phœnix of the east; The lioness, you may move her To give over her prey; But you'll ne'er stop a lover-- He will find out the way.

If the earth it should part him, He would gallop it o'er; If the seas should o'erthwart him, He would swim to the shore; Should his Love become a swallow, Through the air to stray, Love will lend wings to follow, And will find out the way.

There is no striving To cross his intent; There is no contriving His plots to prevent; But if once the message greet him That his True Love doth stay, If Death should come and meet him, Love will find out the way!

_392._ _Phillada flouts Me_

O what a plague is love! How shall I bear it? She will inconstant prove, I greatly fear it. She so torments my mind That my strength faileth, And wavers with the wind As a ship saileth. Please her the best I may, She loves still to gainsay; Alack and well-a-day! Phillada flouts me.

At the fair yesterday She did pass by me; She look'd another way And would not spy me: I woo'd her for to dine, But could not get her; Will had her to the wine-- He might entreat her. With Daniel she did dance, On me she look'd askance: O thrice unhappy chance! Phillada flouts me.

Fair maid, be not so coy, Do not disdain me! I am my mother's joy: Sweet, entertain me! She'll give me, when she dies, All that is fitting: Her poultry and her bees, And her goose sitting, A pair of mattrass beds, And a bag full of shreds; And yet, for all this guedes, Phillada flouts me!

She hath a clout of mine Wrought with blue Coventry, Which she keeps for a sign Of my fidelity: But i' faith, if she flinch She shall not wear it; To Tib, my t'other wench, I mean to bear it. And yet it grieves my heart So soon from her to part: Death strike me with his dart! Phillada flouts me.

Thou shalt eat crudded cream All the year lasting,

guedes] goods, property of any kind.

And drink the crystal stream Pleasant in tasting; Whig and whey whilst thou lust, And bramble-berries, Pie-lid and pastry-crust, Pears, plums, and cherries. Thy raiment shall be thin, Made of a weevil’s skin-- Yet all’s not worth a pin! Phillada flouts me.

In the last month of May I made her posies; I heard her often say That she loved roses. Cowslips and gillyflowers And the white lily I brought to deck the bowers For my sweet Philly. But she did all disdain, And threw them back again; Therefore ’tis flat and plain Phillada flouts me.

Fair maiden, have a care, And in time take me; I can have those as fair If you forsake me: For Doll the dairy-maid Laugh’d at me lately, And wanton Winifred Favours me greatly. One throws milk on my clothes, T’other plays with my nose; What wanting signs are those? Phillada flouts me.

I cannot work nor sleep At all in season: Love wounds my heart so deep Without all reason. I ’gin to pine away In my love’s shadow, Like as a fat beast may, Penn’d in a meadow. I shall be dead, I fear, Within this thousand year: And all for that my dear Phillada flouts me.

WILLIAM STRODE

1602-1645

_393._ _Chloris in the Snow_

I saw fair Chloris walk alone, When feather’d rain came softly down, As Jove descending from his Tower To court her in a silver shower: The wanton snow flew to her breast, Like pretty birds into their nest, But, overcome with whiteness there, For grief it thaw’d into a tear: Thence falling on her garments’ hem, To deck her, froze into a gem.

THOMAS STANLEY

1625-1678

_394._ _The Relapse_

Turn away those cruel eyes, The stars of my undoing! Or death, in such a bright disguise, May tempt a second wooing.

Punish their blind and impious pride, Who dare contemn thy glory; It was my fall that deified Thy name, and seal’d thy story.

Yet no new sufferings can prepare A higher praise to crown thee; Though my first death proclaim thee fair, My second will unthrone thee.

Lovers will doubt thou canst entice No other for thy fuel, And if thou burn one victim twice, Both think thee poor and cruel.

THOMAS D’URFEY

1653-1723

_395._ _Chloe Divine_

Chloe’s a Nymph in flowery groves, A Nereid in the streams; Saint-like she in the temple moves, A woman in my dreams.

Love steals artillery from her eyes, The Graces point her charms; Orpheus is rivalled in her voice, And Venus in her arms.

Never so happily in one Did heaven and earth combine: And yet ’tis flesh and blood alone That makes her so divine.

CHARLES COTTON

1630-1687

_396._ _To Cœlia_

When, Cœlia, must my old day set, And my young morning rise In beams of joy so bright as yet Ne’er bless’d a lover’s eyes? My state is more advanced than when I first attempted thee: I sued to be a servant then, But now to be made free.

I’ve served my time faithful and true, Expecting to be placed In happy freedom, as my due, To all the joys thou hast: Ill husbandry in love is such A scandal to love’s power, We ought not to misspend so much As one poor short-lived hour.

Yet think not, sweet, I’m weary grown. That I pretend such haste; Since none to surfeit e’er was known Before he had a taste: My infant love could humbly wait When, young, it scarce knew how To plead; but grown to man’s estate, He is impatient now.

KATHERINE PHILIPS (‘ORINDA’)

1631-1664

_397._ _To One persuading a Lady to Marriage_

Forbear, bold youth; all’s heaven here, And what you do aver To others courtship may appear, ’Tis sacrilege to her. She is a public deity; And were’t not very odd She should dispose herself to be A petty household god?

First make the sun in private shine And bid the world adieu, That so he may his beams confine In compliment to you: But if of that you do despair, Think how you did amiss To strive to fix her beams which are More bright and large than his.

JOHN DRYDEN

1631-1700

_398._ _Ode_

To the Pious Memory of the accomplished young lady, Mrs. Anne Killigrew, excellent in the two sister arts of Poesy and Painting

Thou youngest virgin-daughter of the skies, Made in the last promotion of the blest; Whose palms, new pluck'd from Paradise, In spreading branches more sublimely rise, Rich with immortal green above the rest: Whether, adopted to some neighbouring star, Thou roll'st above us, in thy wandering race, Or, in procession fixt and regular, Mov'd with the heaven's majestic pace; Or, called to more superior bliss, Thou tread'st with seraphims the vast abyss: Whatever happy region is thy place, Cease thy celestial song a little space; Thou wilt have time enough for hymns divine, Since Heaven's eternal year is thine. Hear, then, a mortal Muse thy praise rehearse, In no ignoble verse; But such as thy own voice did practise here, When thy first-fruits of Poesy were given, To make thyself a welcome inmate there; While yet a young probationer, And candidate of heaven.

If by traduction came thy mind, Our wonder is the less, to find A soul so charming from a stock so good; Thy father was transfus'd into thy blood: So wert thou born into the tuneful strain, An early, rich, and inexhausted vein. But if thy pre-existing soul Was form'd at first with myriads more, It did through all the mighty poets roll Who Greek or Latin laurels wore, And was that Sappho last, which once it was before. If so, then cease thy flight, O heaven-born mind! Thou hast no dross to purge from thy rich ore: Nor can thy soul a fairer mansion find, Than was the beauteous frame she left behind: Return, to fill or mend the quire of thy celestial kind.

May we presume to say, that, at thy birth, New joy was sprung in heaven as well as here on earth? For sure the milder planets did combine On thy auspicious horoscope to shine, And even the most malicious were in trine. Thy brother-angels at thy birth Strung each his lyre, and tun'd it high, That all the people of the sky Might know a poetess was born on earth; And then, if ever, mortal ears Had heard the music of the spheres. And if no clust'ring swarm of bees On thy sweet mouth distill'd their golden dew, 'Twas that such vulgar miraclès Heaven had not leisure to renew: For all the blest fraternity of love Solemniz'd there thy birth, and kept thy holiday above.

O gracious God! how far have we Profan'd thy heavenly gift of Poesy! Made prostitute and profligate the Muse, Debas'd to each obscene and impious use, Whose harmony was first ordain'd above, For tongues of angels and for hymns of love! O wretched we! why were we hurried down This lubrique and adulterate age (Nay, added fat pollutions of our own), To increase the streaming ordures of the stage? What can we say to excuse our second fall? Let this thy Vestal, Heaven, atone for all! Her Arethusian stream remains unsoil'd, Unmixt with foreign filth, and undefil'd; Her wit was more than man, her innocence a child.

Art she had none, yet wanted none, For Nature did that want supply: So rich in treasures of her own, She might our boasted stores defy: Such noble vigour did her verse adorn, That it seem'd borrowed, where 'twas only born. Her morals, too, were in her bosom bred, By great examples daily fed, What in the best of books, her father's life, she read. And to be read herself she need not fear; Each test, and every light, her Muse will bear, Though Epictetus with his lamp were there. Even love (for love sometimes her Muse exprest) Was but a lambent flame which play'd about her breast, Light as the vapours of a morning dream; So cold herself, whilst she such warmth exprest, 'Twas Cupid bathing in Diana's stream....

Now all those charms, that blooming grace, The well-proportion’d shape, and beauteous face, Shall never more be seen by mortal eyes; In earth the much-lamented virgin lies. Not wit, nor piety could fate prevent; Nor was the cruel destiny content To finish all the murder at a blow, To sweep at once her life and beauty too; But, like a hardened felon, took a pride To work more mischievously slow, And plunder’d first, and then destroyed. O double sacrilege on things divine, To rob the relic, and deface the shrine! But thus Orinda died: Heaven, by the same disease, did both translate; As equal were their souls, so equal was their fate.

Meantime, her warlike brother on the seas His waving streamers to the winds displays, And vows for his return, with vain devotion, pays. Ah, generous youth! that wish forbear, The winds too soon will waft thee here! Slack all thy sails, and fear to come, Alas, thou know’st not, thou art wreck’d at home! No more shalt thou behold thy sister’s face, Thou hast already had her last embrace. But look aloft, and if thou kenn’st from far, Among the Pleiads a new kindl’d star, If any sparkles than the rest more bright, ’Tis she that shines in that propitious light.

When in mid-air the golden trump shall sound, To raise the nations under ground; When, in the Valley of Jehoshaphat, The judging God shall close the book of Fate, And there the last assizes keep For those who wake and those who sleep; When rattling bones together fly From the four corners of the sky; When sinews o’er the skeletons are spread, Those cloth’d with flesh, and life inspires the dead; The sacred poets first shall hear the sound, And foremost from the tomb shall bound, For they are cover’d with the lightest ground; And straight, with inborn vigour, on the wing, Like mounting larks, to the new morning sing. There thou, sweet Saint, before the quire shalt go, As harbinger of Heaven, the way to show, The way which thou so well hast learn’d below.

_399._ _A Song for St. Cecilia’s Day, 1687_

From harmony, from heavenly harmony, This universal frame began: When nature underneath a heap Of jarring atoms lay, And could not heave her head, The tuneful voice was heard from high, ‘Arise, ye more than dead!’ Then cold, and hot, and moist, and dry, In order to their stations leap, And Music’s power obey. From harmony, from heavenly harmony, This universal frame began: From harmony to harmony Through all the compass of the notes it ran, The diapason closing full in Man.

What passion cannot Music raise and quell? When Jubal struck the chorded shell, His listening brethren stood around, And, wondering, on their faces fell To worship that celestial sound: Less than a God they thought there could not dwell Within the hollow of that shell, That spoke so sweetly, and so well. What passion cannot Music raise and quell?

The trumpet’s loud clangour Excites us to arms, With shrill notes of anger, And mortal alarms. The double double double beat Of the thundering drum Cries Hark! the foes come; Charge, charge, ’tis too late to retreat!

The soft complaining flute, In dying notes, discovers The woes of hopeless lovers, Whose dirge is whisper’d by the warbling lute.

Sharp violins proclaim Their jealous pangs and desperation, Fury, frantic indignation, Depth of pains, and height of passion. For the fair, disdainful dame.

But O, what art can teach, What human voice can reach, The sacred organ’s praise? Notes inspiring holy love, Notes that wing their heavenly ways To mend the choirs above.

Orpheus could lead the savage race; And trees unrooted left their place, Sequacious of the lyre; But bright Cecilia rais’d the wonder higher: When to her organ vocal breath was given, An angel heard, and straight appear’d Mistaking Earth for Heaven.

GRAND CHORUS.

As from the power of sacred lays The spheres began to move, And sung the great Creator’s praise To all the Blest above; So when the last and dreadful hour This crumbling pageant shall devour, The trumpet shall be heard on high, The dead shall live, the living die, And Music shall untune the sky!

_400._ _Ah, how sweet it is to love!_

Ah, how sweet it is to love! Ah, how gay is young Desire! And what pleasing pains we prove When we first approach Love’s fire! Pains of love be sweeter far Than all other pleasures are.

Sighs which are from lovers blown Do but gently heave the heart: Ev’n the tears they shed alone Cure, like trickling balm, their smart: Lovers, when they lose their breath, Bleed away in easy death.

Love and Time with reverence use, Treat them like a parting friend; Nor the golden gifts refuse Which in youth sincere they send: For each year their price is more, And they less simple than before.

Love, like spring-tides full and high, Swells in every youthful vein; But each tide does less supply, Till they quite shrink in again: If a flow in age appear, ’Tis but rain, and runs not clear.

_401._ _Hidden Flame_

I feed a flame within, which so torments me That it both pains my heart, and yet contents me: ’Tis such a pleasing smart, and I so love it, That I had rather die than once remove it.

Yet he, for whom I grieve, shall never know it; My tongue does not betray, nor my eyes show it. Not a sigh, nor a tear, my pain discloses, But they fall silently, like dew on roses.

Thus, to prevent my Love from being cruel, My heart’s the sacrifice, as ’tis the fuel; And while I suffer this to give him quiet, My faith rewards my love, though he deny it.

On his eyes will I gaze, and there delight me; While I conceal my love no frown can fright me. To be more happy I dare not aspire, Nor can I fall more low, mounting no higher.

_402._ _Song to a Fair Young Lady, going out of the Town in the Spring_

Ask not the cause why sullen Spring So long delays her flowers to bear; Why warbling birds forget to sing, And winter storms invert the year: Chloris is gone; and fate provides To make it Spring where she resides.

Chloris is gone, the cruel fair; She cast not back a pitying eye: But left her lover in despair To sigh, to languish, and to die: Ah! how can those fair eyes endure To give the wounds they will not cure?

Great God of Love, why hast thou made A face that can all hearts command, That all religions can invade, And change the laws of every land? Where thou hadst plac'd such power before, Thou shouldst have made her mercy more.

When Chloris to the temple comes, Adoring crowds before her fall; She can restore the dead from tombs And every life but mine recall. I only am by Love design'd To be the victim for mankind.

CHARLES WEBBE

c. 1678

_403._ _Against Indifference_

More love or more disdain I crave, Sweet, be not still indifferent: O send me quickly to my grave, Or else afford me more content! Or love or hate me more or less, For love abhors all lukewarmness.

Give me a tempest if 'twill drive Me to the place where I would be; Or if you'll have me still alive, Confess you will be kind to me. Give hopes of bliss or dig my grave: More love or more disdain I crave.

SIR GEORGE ETHEREGE

1635-1691

_404._ _Song_

Ladies, though to your conquering eyes Love owes his chiefest victories, And borrows those bright arms from you With which he does the world subdue, Yet you yourselves are not above The empire nor the griefs of love.

Then rack not lovers with disdain, Lest Love on you revenge their pain: You are not free because you're fair: The Boy did not his Mother spare. Beauty's but an offensive dart: It is no armour for the heart.

_405._ _To a Lady asking him how long he would love her_

It is not, Celia, in our power To say how long our love will last; It may be we within this hour May lose those joys we now do taste; The Blessèd, that immortal be, From change in love are only free.

Then since we mortal lovers are, Ask not how long our love will last; But while it does, let us take care Each minute be with pleasure past: Were it not madness to deny To live because we’re sure to die?

THOMAS TRAHERNE

1637?-1674

_406._ _News_

News from a foreign country came As if my treasure and my wealth lay there; So much it did my heart inflame, ’Twas wont to call my Soul into mine ear; Which thither went to meet The approaching sweet, And on the threshold stood To entertain the unknown Good. It hover’d there As if ’twould leave mine ear, And was so eager to embrace The joyful tidings as they came, ’Twould almost leave its dwelling-place To entertain that same.

As if the tidings were the things, My very joys themselves, my foreign treasure-- Or else did bear them on their wings-- With so much joy they came, with so much pleasure. My Soul stood at that gate To recreate Itself with bliss, and to Be pleased with speed. A fuller view It fain would take, Yet journeys back would make Unto my heart; as if ’twould fain Go out to meet, yet stay within To fit a place to entertain And bring the tidings in.

What sacred instinct did inspire My soul in childhood with a hope so strong? What secret force moved my desire To expect my joys beyond the seas, so young? Felicity I knew Was out of view, And being here alone, I saw that happiness was gone From me! For this I thirsted absent bliss, And thought that sure beyond the seas, Or else in something near at hand-- I knew not yet--since naught did please I knew--my Bliss did stand.

But little did the infant dream That all the treasures of the world were by: And that himself was so the cream And crown of all which round about did lie. Yet thus it was: the Gem, The Diadem, The ring enclosing all That stood upon this earthly ball, The Heavenly eye, Much wider than the sky, Wherein they all included were, The glorious Soul, that was the King Made to possess them, did appear A small and little thing!

THOMAS FLATMAN

1637-1688

_407._ _The Sad Day_

O the sad day! When friends shall shake their heads, and say Of miserable me-- ‘Hark, how he groans! Look, how he pants for breath! See how he struggles with the pangs of death!’ When they shall say of these dear eyes-- ‘How hollow, O how dim they be! Mark how his breast doth rise and swell Against his potent enemy!’ When some old friend shall step to my bedside, Touch my chill face, and thence shall gently slide. But--when his next companions say ‘How does he do? What hopes?’--shall turn away, Answering only, with a lift-up hand-- ‘Who can his fate withstand?’

Then shall a gasp or two do more Than e’er my rhetoric could before: Persuade the world to trouble me no more!

CHARLES SACKVILLE, EARL OF DORSET

1638-1706

_408._ _Song_

Written at Sea, in the First Dutch War (1665), the night before an Engagement.

To all you ladies now at land We men at sea indite; But first would have you understand How hard it is to write: The Muses now, and Neptune too, We must implore to write to you-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

For though the Muses should prove kind, And fill our empty brain, Yet if rough Neptune rouse the wind To wave the azure main, Our paper, pen, and ink, and we, Roll up and down our ships at sea-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

Then if we write not by each post, Think not we are unkind; Nor yet conclude our ships are lost By Dutchmen or by wind: Our tears we’ll send a speedier way, The tide shall bring them twice a day-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

The King with wonder and surprise Will swear the seas grow bold, Because the tides will higher rise Than e’er they did of old: But let him know it is our tears Bring floods of grief to Whitehall stairs-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

Should foggy Opdam chance to know Our sad and dismal story, The Dutch would scorn so weak a foe, And quit their fort at Goree: For what resistance can they find From men who’ve left their hearts behind?-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

Let wind and weather do its worst, Be you to us but kind; Let Dutchmen vapour, Spaniards curse, No sorrow we shall find: ’Tis then no matter how things go, Or who’s our friend, or who’s our foe-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

To pass our tedious hours away We throw a merry main, Or else at serious ombre play; But why should we in vain Each other’s ruin thus pursue? We were undone when we left you-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

But now our fears tempestuous grow And cast our hopes away; Whilst you, regardless of our woe, Sit careless at a play: Perhaps permit some happier man To kiss your hand, or flirt your fan-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

When any mournful tune you hear, That dies in every note As if it sigh’d with each man’s care For being so remote, Think then how often love we’ve made To you, when all those tunes were play’d-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

In justice you cannot refuse To think of our distress, When we for hopes of honour lose Our certain happiness: All those designs are but to prove Ourselves more worthy of your love-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

And now we’ve told you all our loves, And likewise all our fears, In hopes this declaration moves Some pity for our tears: Let’s hear of no inconstancy-- We have too

much of that at sea-- With a fa, la, la, la, la.

SIR CHARLES SEDLEY

1639-1701

_409._ _To Chloris_

Ah, Chloris! that I now could sit As unconcern’d as when Your infant beauty could beget No pleasure, nor no pain! When I the dawn used to admire, And praised the coming day, I little thought the growing fire Must take my rest away.

Your charms in harmless childhood lay Like metals in the mine; Age from no face took more away Than youth conceal’d in thine. But as your charms insensibly To their perfection prest, Fond love as unperceived did fly, And in my bosom rest.

My passion with your beauty grew, And Cupid at my heart, Still as his mother favour’d you, Threw a new flaming dart: Each gloried in their wanton part; To make a lover, he Employ’d the utmost of his art-- To make a beauty, she.

_410._ _To Celia_

Not, Celia, that I juster am Or better than the rest! For I would change each hour, like them, Were not my heart at rest.

But I am tied to very thee By every thought I have; Thy face I only care to see, Thy heart I only crave.

All that in woman is adored In thy dear self I find-- For the whole sex can but afford The handsome and the kind.

Why then should I seek further store, And still make love anew? When change itself can give no more, ’Tis easy to be true!

APHRA BEHN

1640-1689

_411._ _Song_

Love in fantastic triumph sate Whilst bleeding hearts around him flow’d, For whom fresh pains he did create And strange tyrannic power he show’d: From thy bright eyes he took his fires, Which round about in sport he hurl’d; But ’twas from mine he took desires Enough t’ undo the amorous world.

From me he took his sighs and tears, From thee his pride and cruelty; From me his languishments and fears, And every killing dart from thee. Thus thou and I the god have arm’d And set him up a deity; But my poor heart alone is harm’d, Whilst thine the victor is, and free!

_412._ _The Libertine_

A thousand martyrs I have made, All sacrificed to my desire, A thousand beauties have betray’d That languish in resistless fire: The untamed heart to hand I brought, And fix’d the wild and wand’ring thought.

I never vow’d nor sigh’d in vain, But both, tho’ false, were well received; The fair are pleased to give us pain, And what they wish is soon believed: And tho’ I talk’d of wounds and smart, Love’s pleasures only touch’d my heart.

Alone the glory and the spoil I always laughing bore away; The triumphs without pain or toil, Without the hell the heaven of joy; And while I thus at random rove Despise the fools that whine for love.

JOHN WILMOT, EARL OF ROCHESTER

1647-1680

_413._ _Return_

Absent from thee, I languish still; Then ask me not, When I return? The straying fool ’twill plainly kill To wish all day, all night to mourn.

Dear, from thine arms then let me fly, That my fantastic mind may prove The torments it deserves to try, That tears my fix’d heart from my love.

When, wearied with a world of woe, To thy safe bosom I retire, Where love, and peace, and truth does flow, May I contented there expire!

Lest, once more wandering from that heaven, I fall on some base heart unblest; Faithless to thee, false, unforgiven-- And lose my everlasting rest.

_414._ _Love and Life_

All my past life is mine no more; The flying hours are gone, Like transitory dreams given o’er, Whose images are kept in store By memory alone.

The time that is to come is not; How can it then be mine? The present moment’s all my lot; And that, as fast as it is got, Phillis, is only thine.

Then talk not of inconstancy. False hearts, and broken vows; If I by miracle can be This live-long minute true to thee, ’Tis all that Heaven allows.

_415._ _Constancy_

I cannot change as others do, Though you unjustly scorn; Since that poor swain that sighs for you For you alone was born. No, Phillis, no; your heart to move A surer way I’ll try; And, to revenge my slighted love, Will still love on and die.

When kill’d with grief Amyntas lies, And you to mind shall call The sighs that now unpitied rise, The tears that vainly fall-- That welcome hour, that ends this smart, Will then begin your pain; For such a faithful tender heart Can never break in vain.

_416._ _To His Mistress_

(_After Quarles_)

Why dost thou shade thy lovely face? O why Does that eclipsing hand of thine deny The sunshine of the Sun’s enlivening eye?

Without thy light what light remains in me? Thou art my life; my way, my light’s in thee; I live, I move, and by thy beams I see.

Thou art my life--if thou but turn away My life’s a thousand deaths. Thou art my way-- Without thee, Love, I travel not but stray.

My light thou art--without thy glorious sight My eyes are darken’d with eternal night. My Love, thou art my way, my life, my light.

Thou art my way; I wander if thou fly. Thou art my light; if hid, how blind am I! Thou art my life; if thou withdraw’st, I die.

My eyes are dark and blind, I cannot see: To whom or whither should my darkness flee, But to that light?--and who’s that light but thee?

If I have lost my path, dear lover, say, Shall I still wander in a doubtful way? Love, shall a lamb of Israel’s sheepfold stray?

My path is lost, my wandering steps do stray; I cannot go, nor can I safely stay; Whom should I seek but thee, my path, my way?

And yet thou turn’st thy face away and fly’st me! And yet I sue for grace and thou deny’st me! Speak, art thou angry, Love, or only try’st me?

Thou art the pilgrim’s path, the blind man’s eye, The dead man’s life. On thee my hopes rely: If I but them remove, I surely die.

Dissolve thy sunbeams, close thy wings and stay! See, see how I am blind, and dead, and stray! --O thou that art my life, my light, my way!

Then work thy will! If passion bid me flee, My reason shall obey, my wings shall be Stretch’d out no farther than from me to thee!

JOHN SHEFFIELD, DUKE OF BUCKINGHAMSHIRE

1649-1720

_417._ _The Reconcilement_

Come, let us now resolve at last To live and love in quiet; We’ll tie the knot so very fast That Time shall ne’er untie it.

The truest joys they seldom prove Who free from quarrels live: ’Tis the most tender part of love Each other to forgive.

When least I seem’d concern’d, I took No pleasure nor no rest; And when I feign’d an angry look, Alas! I loved you best.

Own but the same to me--you’ll find How blest will be our fate. O to be happy--to be kind-- Sure never is too late!

_418._ _On One who died discovering her Kindness_

Some vex their souls with jealous pain, While others sigh for cold disdain: Love’s various slaves we daily see-- Yet happy all compared with me!

Of all mankind I loved the best A nymph so far above the rest That we outshined the Blest above; In beauty she, as I in love.

And therefore They, who could not bear To be outdone by mortals here, Among themselves have placed her now, And left me wretched here below.

All other fate I could have borne, And even endured her very scorn; But oh! thus all at once to find That dread account--both dead and kind! What heart can hold? If yet I live, ’Tis but to show how much I grieve.

THOMAS OTWAY

1652-1685

_419._ _The Enchantment_

I did but look and love awhile, ’Twas but for one half-hour; Then to resist I had no will, And now I have no power.

To sigh and wish is all my ease; Sighs which do heat impart Enough to melt the coldest ice, Yet cannot warm your heart.

O would your pity give my heart One corner of your breast, ’Twould learn of yours the winning art, And quickly steal the rest.

JOHN OLDHAM

1653-1683

_420._ _A Quiet Soul_

Thy soul within such silent pomp did keep, As if humanity were lull’d asleep; So gentle was thy pilgrimage beneath, Time’s unheard feet scarce make less noise, Or the soft journey which a planet goes: Life seem’d all calm as its last breath. A still tranquillity so hush’d thy breast, As if some Halcyon were its guest, And there had built her nest; It hardly now enjoys a greater rest.

JOHN CUTTS, LORD CUTTS

1661-1707

_421._ _Song_

Only tell her that I love: Leave the rest to her and Fate: Some kind planet from above May perhaps her pity move: Lovers on their stars must wait.-- Only tell her that I love!

Why, O why should I despair! Mercy’s pictured in her eye: If she once vouchsafe to hear, Welcome Hope and farewell Fear! She’s too good to let me die.-- Why, O why

should I despair?

MATTHEW PRIOR

1664-1721

_422._ _The Question to Lisetta_

What nymph should I admire or trust, But Chloe beauteous, Chloe just? What nymph should I desire to see, But her who leaves the plain for me? To whom should I compose the lay, But her who listens when I play? To whom in song repeat my cares, But her who in my sorrow shares? For whom should I the garland make, But her who joys the gift to take, And boasts she wears it for my sake? In love am I not fully blest? Lisetta, prithee tell the rest.

LISETTA’S REPLY

Sure Chloe just, and Chloe fair, Deserves to be your only care; But, when you and she to-day Far into the wood did stray, And I happened to pass by, Which way did you cast your eye? But, when your cares to her you sing, You dare not tell her whence they spring; Does it not more afflict your heart, That in those cares she bears a part? When you the flowers for Chloe twine, Why do you to her garland join The meanest bud that falls from mine? Simplest of swains! the world may see Whom Chloe loves, and who loves me.

_423._ _To a Child of Quality, Five Years Old, 1704. The Author then Forty_

Lords, knights, and squires, the numerous band That wear the fair Miss Mary’s fetters, Were summoned by her high command To show their passions by their letters.

My pen amongst the rest I took, Lest those bright eyes, that cannot read, Should dart their kindling fire, and look The power they have to be obey’d.

Nor quality, nor reputation, Forbid me yet my flame to tell; Dear Five-years-old befriends my passion, And I may write till she can spell.

For, while she makes her silkworms beds With all the tender things I swear; Whilst all the house my passion reads, In papers round her baby’s hair;

She may receive and own my flame; For, though the strictest prudes should know it, She’ll pass for a most virtuous dame, And I for an unhappy poet.

Then too, alas! when she shall tear The rhymes some younger rival sends, She’ll give me leave to write, I fear, And we shall still continue friends.

For, as our different ages move, ’Tis so ordain’d (would Fate but mend it!), That I shall be past making love When she begins to comprehend it.

_424._ _Song_

The merchant, to secure his treasure, Conveys it in a borrow’d name: Euphelia serves to grace my measure; But Chloe is my real flame.

My softest verse, my darling lyre, Upon Euphelia’s toilet lay; When Chloe noted her desire That I should sing, that I should play.

My lyre I tune, my voice I raise; But with my numbers mix my sighs: And while I sing Euphelia’s praise, I fix my soul on Chloe’s eyes.

Fair Chloe blush’d: Euphelia frown’d: I sung, and gazed: I play’d, and trembled: And Venus to the Loves around Remark’d, how ill we all dissembled.

_425._ _On My Birthday, July 21_

I, my dear, was born to-day-- So all my jolly comrades say: They bring me music, wreaths, and mirth, And ask to celebrate my birth: Little, alas! my comrades know That I was born to pain and woe; To thy denial, to thy scorn, Better I had ne’er been born: I wish to die, even whilst I say-- ‘I, my dear, was born to-day.’

I, my dear, was born to-day: Shall I salute the rising ray, Well-spring of all my joy and woe? Clotilda, thou alone dost know. Shall the wreath surround my hair? Or shall the music please my ear? Shall I my comrades’ mirth receive, And bless my birth, and wish to live? Then let me see great Venus chase Imperious anger from thy face; Then let me hear thee smiling say-- ‘Thou, my dear, wert born to-day.’

_426._ _The Lady who offers her Looking-Glass to Venus_

Venus, take my votive glass: Since I am not what I was, What from this day I shall be, Venus, let me never see.

_427._ _A Letter_

to Lady Margaret Cavendish Holles-Harley, when a Child

My noble, lovely, little Peggy, Let this my First Epistle beg ye, At dawn of morn, and close of even, To lift your heart and hands to Heaven. In double duty say your prayer: _Our Father_ first, then _Notre Père_.

And, dearest child, along the day, In every thing you do and say, Obey and please my lord and lady, So God shall love and angels aid ye.

If to these precepts you attend, No second letter need I send, And so I rest your constant friend.

_428._ _For my own Monument_

As doctors give physic by way of prevention, Mat, alive and in health, of his tombstone took care; For delays are unsafe, and his pious intention May haply be never fulfill’d by his heir.

Then take Mat’s word for it, the sculptor is paid; That the figure is fine, pray believe your own eye; Yet credit but lightly what more may be said, For we flatter ourselves, and teach marble to lie.

Yet counting as far as to fifty his years, His virtues and vices were as other men’s are; High hopes he conceived, and he smother’d great fears, In a life parti-colour’d, half pleasure, half care.

Nor to business a drudge, nor to faction a slave, He strove to make interest and freedom agree; In public employments industrious and grave, And alone with his friends, Lord! how merry was he!

Now in equipage stately, now humbly on foot, Both fortunes he tried, but to neither would trust; And whirl’d in the round as the wheel turn’d about, He found riches had wings, and knew man was but dust.

This verse, little polish’d, tho’ mighty sincere, Sets neither his titles nor merit to view; It says that his relics collected lie here, And no mortal yet knows too if this may be true.

Fierce robbers there are that infest the highway, So Mat may be kill’d, and his bones never found; False witness at court, and fierce tempests at sea, So Mat may yet chance to be hang’d or be drown’d.

If his bones lie in earth, roll in sea, fly in air, To Fate we must yield, and the thing is the same; And if passing thou giv’st him a smile or a tear, He cares not--yet, prithee, be kind to his fame.

WILLIAM WALSH

1663-1708

_429._ _Rivals_

Of all the torments, all the cares, With which our lives are curst; Of all the plagues a lover bears, Sure rivals are the worst! By partners in each other kind Afflictions easier grow; In love alone we hate to find Companions of our woe.

Sylvia, for all the pangs you see Are labouring in my breast, I beg not you would favour me, Would you but slight the rest! How great soe’er your rigours are, With them alone I’ll cope; I can endure my own despair, But not another’s hope.

LADY GRISEL BAILLIE

1665-1746

_430._ _Werena my Hearts licht I wad dee_

There ance was a may, and she lo’ed na men; She biggit her bonnie bow’r doun in yon glen; But now she cries, Dool and a well-a-day! Come doun the green gait and come here away!

When bonnie young Johnnie cam owre the sea, He said he saw naething sae lovely as me; He hecht me baith rings and mony braw things-- And werena my heart’s licht, I wad dee.

He had a wee titty that lo’ed na me, Because I was twice as bonnie as she; She raised sic a pother ’twixt him and his mother That werena my heart’s licht, I wad dee.

The day it was set, and the bridal to be: The wife took a dwam and lay doun to dee; She maned and she graned out o’ dolour and pain, Till he vow’d he never wad see me again.

His kin was for ane of a higher degree, Said--What had he do wi’ the likes of me? Appose I was bonnie, I wasna for Johnnie-- And werena my heart’s licht, I wad dee.

They said I had neither cow nor calf, Nor dribbles o’ drink rins thro’ the draff, Nor pickles o’ meal rins thro’ the mill-e’e-- And werena my heart’s licht, I wad dee.

may] maid. biggit] built. gait] way, path. hecht] promised. titty] sister. dwam] sudden illness. appose] suppose. pickles] small quantities.

His titty she was baith wylie and slee: She spied me as I cam owre the lea; And then she ran in and made a loud din-- Believe your ain e’en, an ye trow not me.

His bonnet stood ay fu’ round on his brow, His auld ane look’d ay as well as some’s new: But now he lets ’t wear ony gait it will hing, And casts himsel dowie upon the corn bing.

And now he gaes daund’ring about the dykes, And a’ he dow do is to hund the tykes: The live-lang nicht he ne’er steeks his e’e-- And werena my heart’s licht, I wad dee.

Were I but young for thee, as I hae been, We should hae been gallopin’ doun in yon green, And linkin’ it owre the lily-white lea-- And wow, gin I were but young for thee!

_430._ hing] hang. dowie] dejectedly. hund the tykes] direct the dogs. steeks] closes. linkin’] tripping.

WILLIAM CONGREVE

1670-1729.

_431._ _False though She be_

False though she be to me and love, I’ll ne’er pursue revenge; For still the charmer I approve, Though I deplore her change.

In hours of bliss we oft have met: They could not always last; And though the present I regret, I’m grateful for the past.

_432._ _A Hue and Cry after Fair Amoret_

Fair Amoret is gone astray-- Pursue and seek her, ev’ry lover; I’ll tell the signs by which you may The wand’ring Shepherdess discover.

Coquette and coy at once her air, Both studied, tho’ both seem neglected; Careless she is, with artful care, Affecting to seem unaffected.

With skill her eyes dart ev’ry glance, Yet change so soon you’d ne’er suspect them, For she’d persuade they wound by chance, Tho’ certain aim and art direct them.

She likes herself, yet others hates For that which in herself she prizes; And, while she laughs at them, forgets She is the thing that she despises.

JOSEPH ADDISON

1672-1719

_433._ _Hymn_

The spacious firmament on high, With all the blue ethereal sky, And spangled heavens, a shining frame, Their great Original proclaim. Th’ unwearied Sun from day to day Does his Creator’s power display; And publishes to every land The work of an Almighty hand.

Soon as the evening shades prevail, The Moon takes up the wondrous tale; And nightly to the listening Earth Repeats the story of her birth: Whilst all the stars that round her burn, And all the planets in their turn, Confirm the tidings as they roll, And spread the truth from pole to pole.

What though in solemn silence all Move round the dark terrestrial ball; What though nor real voice nor sound Amidst their radiant orbs be found? In Reason’s ear they all rejoice, And utter forth a glorious voice; For ever singing as they shine, ‘The Hand that made us is divine.’

ISAAC WATTS

1674-1748

_434._ _The Day of Judgement_

When the fierce North-wind with his airy forces Rears up the Baltic to a foaming fury; And the red lightning with a storm of hail comes Rushing amain down;

How the poor sailors stand amazed and tremble, While the hoarse thunder, like a bloody trumpet, Roars a loud onset to the gaping waters Quick to devour them.

Such shall the noise be, and the wild disorder (If things eternal may be like these earthly), Such the dire terror when the great Archangel Shakes the creation;

Tears the strong pillars of the vault of Heaven, Breaks up old marble, the repose of princes, Sees the graves open, and the bones arising, Flames all around them.

Hark, the shrill outcries of the guilty wretches! Lively bright horror and amazing anguish Stare thro’ their eyelids, while the living worm lies Gnawing within them.

Thoughts, like old vultures, prey upon their heart-strings, And the smart twinges, when the eye beholds the Lofty Judge frowning, and a flood of vengeance Rolling afore him.

Hopeless immortals! how they scream and shiver, While devils push them to the pit wide-yawning Hideous and gloomy, to receive them headlong Down to the centre!

Stop here, my fancy: (all away, ye horrid Doleful ideas!) come, arise to Jesus, How He sits God-like! and the saints around Him Throned, yet adoring!

O may I sit there when He comes triumphant, Dooming the nations! then ascend to glory, While our Hosannas all along the passage Shout the Redeemer.

_435._ _A Cradle Hymn_

Hush! my dear, lie still and slumber, Holy angels guard thy bed! Heavenly blessings without number Gently falling on thy head.

Sleep, my babe; thy food and raiment, House and home, thy friends provide; All without thy care or payment: All thy wants are well supplied.

How much better thou'rt attended Than the Son of God could be, When from heaven He descended And became a child like thee!

Soft and easy is thy cradle: Coarse and hard thy Saviour lay, When His birthplace was a stable And His softest bed was hay.

Blessèd babe! what glorious features-- Spotless fair, divinely bright! Must He dwell with brutal creatures? How could angels bear the sight?

Was there nothing but a manger Cursèd sinners could afford To receive the heavenly stranger? Did they thus affront their Lord?

Soft, my child: I did not chide thee, Though my song might sound too hard; 'Tis thy mother sits beside thee, And her arms shall be thy guard.

Yet to read the shameful story How the Jews abused their King, How they served the Lord of Glory, Makes me angry while I sing.

See the kinder shepherds round Him, Telling wonders from the sky! Where they sought Him, there they found Him, With His Virgin mother by.

See the lovely babe a-dressing; Lovely infant, how He smiled! When He wept, the mother's blessing Soothed and hush'd the holy child.

Lo, He slumbers in His manger, Where the hornèd oxen fed: Peace, my darling; here's no danger, Here's no ox anear thy bed.

'Twas to save thee, child, from dying, Save my dear from burning flame, Bitter groans and endless crying, That thy blest Redeemer came.

May'st thou live to know and fear Him, Trust and love Him all thy days; Then go dwell for ever near Him, See His face, and sing His praise!

THOMAS PARNELL

1679-1718

_436._ _Song_

When thy beauty appears In its graces and airs All bright as an angel new dropp’d from the sky, At distance I gaze and am awed by my fears: So strangely you dazzle my eye!

But when without art Your kind thoughts you impart, When your love runs in blushes through every vein; When it darts from your eyes, when it pants in your heart, Then I know you’re a woman again.

There’s a passion and pride In our sex (she replied), And thus, might I gratify both, I would do: Still an angel appear to each lover beside, But still be a woman to you.

ALLAN RAMSAY

1686-1758

_437._ _Peggy_

My Peggy is a young thing, Just enter’d in her teens, Fair as the day, and sweet as May, Fair as the day, and always gay; My Peggy is a young thing, And I’m not very auld, Yet well I like to meet her at The wawking of the fauld.

My Peggy speaks sae sweetly Whene’er we meet alane, I wish nae mair to lay my care, I wish nae mair of a’ that’s rare; My Peggy speaks sae sweetly, To a’ the lave I’m cauld, But she gars a’ my spirits glow At wawking of the fauld.

My Peggy smiles sae kindly Whene’er I whisper love, That I look down on a’ the town, That I look down upon a crown; My Peggy smiles sae kindly, It makes me blyth and bauld, And naething gi’es me sic delight As wawking of the fauld.

My Peggy sings sae saftly When on my pipe I play, By a’ the rest it is confest, By a’ the rest, that she sings best; My Peggy sings sae saftly, And in her sangs are tauld With innocence the wale of sense, At wawking of the fauld.

wawking] watching. lave] rest. wale] choice, best.

WILLIAM OLDYS

1687-1761

_438._ _On a Fly drinking out of his Cup_

Busy, curious, thirsty fly! Drink with me and drink as I: Freely welcome to my cup, Couldst thou sip and sip it up: Make the most of life you may, Life is short and wears away.

Both alike are mine and thine Hastening quick to their decline: Thine’s a summer, mine’s no more, Though repeated to threescore. Threescore summers, when they’re gone, Will appear as short as one!

JOHN GAY

1688-1732

_439._ _Song_

O ruddier than the cherry! O sweeter than the berry! O nymph more bright Than moonshine night, Like kidlings blithe and merry! Ripe as the melting cluster! No lily has such lustre; Yet hard to tame As raging flame, And fierce as storms that bluster!

ALEXANDER POPE

1688-1744

_440._ _On a certain Lady at Court_

I know a thing that’s most uncommon; (Envy, be silent and attend!) I know a reasonable woman, Handsome and witty, yet a friend.

Not warp’d by passion, awed by rumour; Not grave through pride, nor gay through folly; An equal mixture of good-humour And sensible soft melancholy.

‘Has she no faults then (Envy says), Sir?’ Yes, she has one, I must aver: When all the world conspires to praise her, The woman’s deaf, and does not hear.

_441._ _Elegy to the Memory of an Unfortunate Lady_

What beck’ning ghost, along the moonlight shade Invites my steps, and points to yonder glade? ’Tis she!--but why that bleeding bosom gored, Why dimly gleams the visionary sword? O, ever beauteous, ever friendly! tell, Is it, in Heav’n, a crime to love too well? To bear too tender or too firm a heart, To act a lover’s or a Roman’s part? Is there no bright reversion in the sky For those who greatly think, or bravely die? Why bade ye else, ye Pow’rs! her soul aspire Above the vulgar flight of low desire? Ambition first sprung from your blest abodes; The glorious fault of angels and of gods; Thence to their images on earth it flows, And in the breasts of kings and heroes glows. Most souls, ’tis true, but peep out once an age, Dull sullen pris’ners in the body’s cage: Dim lights of life, that burn a length of years, Useless, unseen, as lamps in sepulchres; Like Eastern kings a lazy state they keep, And close confined to their own palace, sleep. From these perhaps (ere Nature bade her die) Fate snatch’d her early to the pitying sky. As into air the purer spirits flow, And sep’rate from their kindred dregs below, So flew the soul to its congenial place, Nor left one virtue to redeem her race. But thou, false guardian of a charge too good! Thou, mean deserter of thy brother’s blood! See on these ruby lips the trembling breath, These cheeks now fading at the blast of Death: Cold is that breast which warm’d the world before, And those love-darting eyes must roll no more. Thus, if eternal Justice rules the ball, Thus shall your wives, and thus your children fall; On all the line a sudden vengeance waits, And frequent herses shall besiege your gates. There passengers shall stand, and pointing say (While the long fun’rals blacken all the way), ‘Lo! these were they whose souls the Furies steel’d And cursed with hearts unknowing how to yield.’ Thus unlamented pass the proud away, The gaze of fools, and pageant of a day! So perish all whose breast ne’er learn’d to glow For others’ good, or melt at others’ woe! What can atone (O ever-injured shade!) Thy fate unpitied, and thy rites unpaid? No friend’s complaint, no kind domestic tear Pleased thy pale ghost, or graced thy mournful bier. By foreign hands thy dying eyes were closed, By foreign hands thy decent limbs

composed, By foreign hands thy humble grave adorn’d, By strangers honour’d, and by strangers mourn’d! What tho’ no friends in sable weeds appear, Grieve for an hour, perhaps, then mourn a year, And bear about the mockery of woe To midnight dances, and the public show? What tho’ no weeping Loves thy ashes grace, Nor polish’d marble emulate thy face? What tho’ no sacred earth allow thee room, Nor hallow’d dirge be mutter’d o’er thy tomb? Yet shall thy grave with rising flow’rs be drest, And the green turf lie lightly on thy breast: There shall the morn her earliest tears bestow, There the first roses of the year shall blow; While angels with their silver wings o’ershade The ground now sacred by thy reliques made. So peaceful rests, without a stone, a name, What once had beauty, titles, wealth, and fame. How loved, how honour’d once, avails thee not, To whom related, or by whom begot; A heap of dust alone remains of thee, ’Tis all thou art, and all the proud shall be! Poets themselves must fall, like those they sung, Deaf the praised ear, and mute the tuneful tongue. Ev’n he, whose soul now melts in mournful lays, Shall shortly want the gen’rous tear he pays; Then from his closing eyes thy form shall part, And the last pang shall tear thee from his heart; Life’s idle business at one gasp be o’er, The Muse forgot, and thou beloved no more!

_442._ _The Dying Christian to his Soul_

Vital spark of heav’nly flame! Quit, O quit this mortal frame: Trembling, hoping, lingering, flying, O the pain, the bliss of dying! Cease, fond Nature, cease thy strife, And let me languish into life.

Hark! they whisper; angels say, Sister Spirit, come away! What is this absorbs me quite? Steals my senses, shuts my sight, Drowns my spirits, draws my breath? Tell me, my soul, can this be death?

The world recedes; it disappears! Heav’n opens on my eyes! my ears With sounds seraphic ring! Lend, lend your wings! I mount! I fly! O Grave! where is thy victory? O Death! where is thy sting?

GEORGE BUBB DODINGTON, LORD MELCOMBE

1691?-1762

_443._ _Shorten Sail_

Love thy country, wish it well, Not with too intense a care; ’Tis enough that, when it fell, Thou its ruin didst not share.

Envy’s censure, Flattery’s praise, With unmoved indifference view: Learn to tread Life’s dangerous maze With unerring Virtue’s clue.

Void of strong desire and fear, Life’s wide ocean trust no more; Strive thy little bark to steer With the tide, but near the shore.

Thus prepared, thy shorten’d sail Shall, whene’er the winds increase, Seizing each propitious gale, Waft thee to the port of Peace.

Keep thy conscience from offence And tempestuous passions free, So, when thou art call’d from hence, Easy shall thy passage be.

--Easy shall thy passage be, Cheerful thy allotted stay, Short the account ’twixt God and thee, Hope shall meet thee on thy way.

HENRY CAREY

1693?-1743

_444._ _Sally in our Alley_

Of all the girls that are so smart There’s none like pretty Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley. There is no lady in the land Is half so sweet as Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

Her father he makes cabbage-nets, And through the streets does cry ’em; Her mother she sells laces long To such as please to buy ’em: But sure such folks could ne’er beget So sweet a girl as Sally! She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

When she is by, I leave my work, I love her so sincerely; My master comes like any Turk, And bangs me most severely: But let him bang his bellyful, I’ll bear it all for Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

Of all the days that’s in the week I dearly love but one day-- And that’s the day that comes betwixt A Saturday and Monday; For then I’m drest all in my best To walk abroad with Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

My master carries me to church, And often am I blamèd Because I leave him in the lurch As soon as text is namèd; I leave the church in sermon-time And slink away to Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

When Christmas comes about again, O, then I shall have money; I’ll hoard it up, and box it all, I’ll give it to my honey: I would it were ten thousand pound, I’d give it all to Sally; She is the darling of my heart, And she lives in our alley.

My master and the neighbours all Make game of me and Sally, And, but for her, I’d better be A slave and row a galley; But when my seven long years are out, O, then I’ll marry Sally; O, then we’ll wed, and then we’ll bed-- But not in our alley!

_445._ _A Drinking-Song_

Bacchus must now his power resign-- I am the only God of Wine! It is not fit the wretch should be In competition set with me, Who can drink ten times more than he.

Make a new world, ye powers divine! Stock’d with nothing else but Wine: Let Wine its only product be, Let Wine be earth, and air, and sea-- And let that Wine be all for me!

WILLIAM BROOME

?-1745

_446._ _The Rosebud_

Queen of fragrance, lovely Rose, The beauties of thy leaves disclose! --But thou, fair Nymph, thyself survey In this sweet offspring of a day. That miracle of face must fail, Thy charms are sweet, but charms are frail: Swift as the short-lived flower they fly, At morn they bloom, at evening die: Though Sickness yet a while forbears, Yet Time destroys what Sickness spares: Now Helen lives alone in fame, And Cleopatra's but a name: Time must indent that heavenly brow, And thou must be what they are now.

_447._ _Belinda's Recovery from Sickness_

Thus when the silent grave becomes Pregnant with life as fruitful wombs; When the wide seas and spacious earth Resign us to our second birth; Our moulder'd frame rebuilt assumes New beauty, and for ever blooms, And, crown'd with youth's immortal pride, We angels rise, who mortals died.

JAMES THOMSON

1700-1748

_448._ _On the Death of a particular Friend_

As those we love decay, we die in part, String after string is sever'd from the heart; Till loosen'd life, at last but breathing clay, Without one pang is glad to fall away.

Unhappy he who latest feels the blow! Whose eyes have wept o'er every friend laid low, Dragg'd ling'ring on from partial death to death, Till, dying, all he can resign is--breath.

GEORGE LYTTELTON, LORD LYTTELTON

1709-1773

_449._ _Tell me, my Heart if this be Love_

When Delia on the plain appears, Awed by a thousand tender fears I would approach, but dare not move: Tell me, my heart, if this be love?

Whene'er she speaks, my ravish'd ear No other voice than hers can hear, No other wit but hers approve: Tell me, my heart, if this be love?

If she some other youth commend, Though I was once his fondest friend, His instant enemy I prove: Tell me, my heart, if this be love?

When she is absent, I no more Delight in all that pleased before-- The clearest spring, or shadiest grove: Tell me, my heart, if this be love?

When fond of power, of beauty vain, Her nets she spread for every swain, I strove to hate, but vainly strove: Tell me, my heart, if this be love?

SAMUEL JOHNSON

1709-1784

_450._ _One-and-Twenty_

Long-expected one-and-twenty, Ling’ring year, at length is flown: Pride and pleasure, pomp and plenty, Great *** ****, are now your own.

Loosen’d from the minor’s tether, Free to mortgage or to sell, Wild as wind, and light as feather, Bid the sons of thrift farewell.

Call the Betsies, Kates, and Jennies, All the names that banish care; Lavish of your grandsire’s guineas, Show the spirit of an heir.

All that prey on vice and folly Joy to see their quarry fly: There the gamester, light and jolly, There the lender, grave and sly.

Wealth, my lad, was made to wander, Let it wander as it will; Call the jockey, call the pander, Bid them come and take their fill.

When the bonny blade carouses, Pockets full, and spirits high-- What are acres? What are houses? Only dirt, or wet or dry.

Should the guardian friend or mother Tell the woes of wilful waste, Scorn their counsel, scorn their pother;-- You can hang or drown at last!

_451._ _On the Death of Mr. Robert Levet, a Practiser in Physic_

Condemn’d to Hope’s delusive mine, As on we toil from day to day, By sudden blasts or slow decline Our social comforts drop away.

Well tried through many a varying year, See Levet to the grave descend, Officious, innocent, sincere, Of every friendless name the friend.

Yet still he fills affection’s eye, Obscurely wise and coarsely kind; Nor, lettered Arrogance, deny Thy praise to merit unrefined.

When fainting nature call’d for aid, And hov’ring death prepared the blow, His vig’rous remedy display’d The power of art without the show.

In Misery’s darkest cavern known, His useful care was ever nigh, Where hopeless Anguish pour’d his groan, And lonely Want retired to die.

No summons mock’d by chill delay, No petty gain disdain’d by pride; The modest wants of every day The toil of every day supplied.

His virtues walk’d their narrow round, Nor made a pause, nor left a void; And sure th’ Eternal Master found The single talent well employ’d.

The busy day, the peaceful night, Unfelt, uncounted, glided by; His frame was firm--his powers were bright, Though now his eightieth year was nigh.

Then with no fiery throbbing pain, No cold gradations of decay, Death broke at once the vital chain, And freed his soul the nearest way.

RICHARD JAGO

1715-1781

_452._ _Absence_

With leaden foot Time creeps along While Delia is away: With her, nor plaintive was the song, Nor tedious was the day.

Ah, envious Pow’r! reverse my doom; Now double thy career, Strain ev’ry nerve, stretch ev’ry plume, And rest them when she’s here!

THOMAS GRAY

1716-1771

_453._ _Elegy written in a Country Churchyard_

The Curfew tolls the knell of parting day, The lowing herd wind slowly o’er the lea, The plowman homeward plods his weary way, And leaves the world to darkness and to me.

Now fades the glimmering landscape on the sight, And all the air a solemn stillness holds, Save where the beetle wheels his droning flight, And drowsy tinklings lull the distant folds; Save that from yonder ivy-mantled tow’r The moping owl does to the moon complain Of such as, wand’ring near her secret bow’r, Molest her ancient solitary reign.

Beneath those rugged elms, that yew-tree’s shade, Where heaves the turf in many a mould’ring heap, Each in his narrow cell for ever laid, The rude Forefathers of the hamlet sleep.

The breezy call of incense-breathing Morn, The swallow twitt’ring from the straw-built shed, The cock’s shrill clarion, or the echoing horn, No more shall rouse them from their lowly bed.

For them no more the blazing hearth shall burn, Or busy housewife ply her evening care: No children run to lisp their sire’s return, Or climb his knees the envied kiss to share.

Oft did the harvest to their sickle yield, Their furrow oft the stubborn glebe has broke: How jocund did they drive their team afield! How bow’d the woods beneath their sturdy stroke!

Let not Ambition mock their useful toil, Their homely joys, and destiny obscure; Nor Grandeur hear with a disdainful smile The short and simple annals of the poor.

The boast of heraldry, the pomp of pow’r, And all that beauty, all that wealth e’er gave, Awaits alike th’ inevitable hour: The paths of glory lead but to the grave.

Nor you, ye Proud, impute to These the fault, If Memory o’er their Tomb no Trophies raise, Where through the long-drawn aisle and fretted vault The pealing anthem swells the note of praise.

Can storied urn or animated bust Back to its mansion call the fleeting breath? Can Honour’s voice provoke the silent dust, Or Flatt’ry soothe the dull cold ear of death?

Perhaps in this neglected spot is laid Some heart once pregnant with celestial fire; Hands, that the rod of empire might have sway’d, Or waked to ecstasy the living lyre.

But Knowledge to their eyes her ample page Rich with the spoils of time did ne’er unroll; Chill Penury repress’d their noble rage, And froze the genial current of the soul.

Full many a gem of purest ray serene The dark unfathom’d caves of ocean bear: Full many a flower is born to blush unseen, And waste its sweetness on the desert air.

Some village Hampden that with dauntless breast The little tyrant of his fields withstood, Some mute inglorious Milton here may rest, Some Cromwell guiltless of his country’s blood.

Th’ applause of list’ning senates to command, The threats of pain and ruin to despise, To scatter plenty o’er a smiling land, And read their history in a nation’s eyes, Their lot forbade: nor circumscribed alone Their growing virtues, but their crimes confined; Forbade to wade through slaughter to a throne. And shut the gates of mercy on mankind,

The struggling pangs of conscious truth to hide, To quench the blushes of ingenuous shame, Or heap the shrine of Luxury and Pride With incense kindled at the Muse’s flame.

Far from the madding crowd’s ignoble strife Their sober wishes never learn’d to stray; Along the cool sequester’d vale of life They kept the noiseless tenor of their way.

Yet ev’n these bones from insult to protect Some frail memorial still erected nigh, With uncouth rhymes and shapeless sculpture deck’d, Implores the passing tribute of a sigh.

Their name, their years, spelt by th’ unletter’d muse, The place of fame and elegy supply: And many a holy text around she strews, That teach the rustic moralist to die.

For who, to dumb Forgetfulness a prey, This pleasing anxious being e’er resign’d, Left the warm precincts of the cheerful day, Nor cast one longing ling’ring look behind?

On some fond breast the parting soul relies, Some pious drops the closing eye requires; E’en from the tomb the voice of Nature cries, E’en in our Ashes live their wonted Fires.

For thee, who, mindful of th’ unhonour’d dead, Dost in these lines their artless tale relate; If chance, by lonely contemplation led, Some kindred spirit shall inquire thy fate,

Haply some hoary-headed Swain may say, ‘Oft have we seen him at the peep of dawn Brushing with hasty steps the dews away To meet the sun upon the upland lawn.

‘There at the foot of yonder nodding beech That wreathes its old fantastic roots so high, His listless length at noontide would he stretch, And pore upon the brook that babbles by.

‘Hard by yon wood, now smiling as in scorn, Mutt’ring his wayward fancies he would rove, Now drooping, woeful wan, like one forlorn, Or crazed with care, or cross’d in hopeless love.

‘One morn I miss’d him on the custom’d hill. Along the heath and near his fav’rite tree; Another came; nor yet beside the rill, Nor up the lawn, nor at the wood was he;

‘The next with dirges due in sad array Slow through the church-way path we saw him borne. Approach and read (for thou canst read) the lay Graved on the stone beneath yon aged thorn:’

THE EPITAPH.

Here rests his head upon the lap of Earth _A Youth to Fortune and to Fame unknown._ _Fair Science frown’d not on his humble birth,_ _And Melancholy marked him for her own._

Large was his bounty, and his soul sincere, _Heav’n did a recompense as largely send:_ _He gave to Mis’ry all he had, a tear,_ _He gain’d from Heav’n (’twas all he wish’d) a friend._

No farther seek his merits to disclose, _Or draw his frailties from their dread abode,_ _(There they alike in trembling hope repose,)_ _The bosom of his Father and his God._

_454._ _The Curse upon Edward_

Weave the warp, and weave the woof, The winding-sheet of Edward’s race. Give ample room, and verge enough The characters of hell to trace. Mark the year, and mark the night, When Severn shall re-echo with affright The shrieks of death, thro’ Berkley’s roofs that ring, Shrieks of an agonizing King! She-wolf of France, with unrelenting fangs, That tear’st the bowels of thy mangled mate, From thee be born, who o’er thy country hangs The scourge of Heav’n. What terrors round him wait! Amazement in his van, with Flight combined, And Sorrow’s faded form, and Solitude behind.

Mighty Victor, mighty Lord! Low on his funeral couch he lies! No pitying heart, no eye, afford A tear to grace his obsequies. Is the sable warrior fled? Thy son is gone. He rests among the dead. The swarm that in thy noon tide beam were born? Gone to salute the rising morn. Fair laughs the morn, and soft the zephyr blows, While proudly riding o’er the azure realm In gallant trim the gilded vessel goes; Youth on the prow, and Pleasure at the helm; Regardless of the sweeping whirlwind’s sway, That, hush’d in grim repose, expects his evening prey,

Fill high the sparkling bowl, The rich repast prepare; Reft of a crown, he yet may share the feast: Close by the regal chair Fell Thirst and Famine scowl A baleful smile upon their baffled guest. Heard ye the din of battle bray, Lance to lance, and horse to

horse? Long years of havoc urge their destined course, And thro’ the kindred squadrons mow their way. Ye Towers of Julius, London’s lasting shame, With many a foul and midnight murder fed, Revere his consort’s faith, his father’s fame, And spare the meek usurper’s holy head. Above, below, the rose of snow, Twined with her blushing foe, we spread: The bristled boar in infant-gore Wallows beneath the thorny shade. Now, brothers, bending o’er th’ accursèd loom Stamp we our vengeance deep, and ratify his doom.

Edward, lo! to sudden fate (Weave we the woof. The thread is spun) Half of thy heart we consecrate. (The web is wove. The work is done.)

_455._ _The Progress of Poesy_

A PINDARIC ODE

Awake, Æolian lyre, awake, And give to rapture all thy trembling strings, From Helicon’s harmonious springs A thousand rills their mazy progress take: The laughing flowers, that round them blow, Drink life and fragrance as they flow. Now the rich stream of music winds along Deep, majestic, smooth and strong, Thro’ verdant vales, and Ceres’ golden reign: Now rolling down the steep amain, Headlong, impetuous, see it pour; The rocks and nodding groves rebellow to the roar.

O Sovereign of the willing soul, Parent of sweet and solemn-breathing airs, Enchanting shell! the sullen Cares And frantic Passions hear thy soft controul. On Thracia’s hills the Lord of War Has curb’d the fury of his car, And dropp’d his thirsty lance at thy command. Perching on the sceptred hand Of Jove, thy magic lulls the feather’d king With ruffled plumes and flagging wing: Quench’d in dark clouds of slumber lie The terror of his beak, and lightnings of his eye.

Thee the voice, the dance, obey, Temper’d to thy warbled lay. O’er Idalia’s velvet-green The rosy-crownèd Loves are seen On Cytherea’s day With antic Sports, and blue-eyed Pleasures, Frisking light in frolic measures; Now pursuing, now retreating, Now in circling troops they meet: To brisk notes in cadence beating, Glance their many-twinkling feet. Slow melting strains their Queen’s approach declare: Where’er she turns the Graces homage pay. With arms sublime, that float upon the air, In gliding state she wins her easy way: O’er her warm cheek and rising bosom move The bloom of young Desire and purple light of Love.

Man’s feeble race what ills await, Labour, and Penury, the racks of Pain, Disease, and Sorrow’s weeping train, And Death, sad refuge from the storms of fate! The fond complaint, my song, disprove And justify the laws of Jove. Say, has he giv’n in vain the heav’nly Muse? Night, and all her sickly dews, Her spectres wan, and birds of boding cry, He gives to range the dreary sky: Till down the eastern cliffs afar Hyperion’s march they spy, and glitt’ring shafts of war.

In climes beyond the solar road, Where shaggy forms o’er ice-built mountains roam, The Muse has broke the twilight gloom To cheer the shiv’ring native’s dull abode. And oft, beneath the od’rous shade Of Chili’s boundless forests laid, She deigns to hear the savage youth repeat In loose numbers wildly sweet Their

feather-cinctured chiefs, and dusky loves. Her track, where'er the Goddess roves, Glory pursue and generous Shame, Th' unconquerable Mind, and Freedom's holy flame.

Woods, that wave o'er Delphi's steep, Isles, that crown th' Ægean deep, Fields, that cool Ilissus laves, Or where Mæander's amber waves In lingering lab'rinths creep, How do your tuneful echoes languish, Mute, but to the voice of anguish? Where each old poetic mountain Inspiration breathed around: Ev'ry shade and hallow'd fountain Murmur'd deep a solemn sound: Till the sad Nine, in Greece's evil hour, Left their Parnassus for the Latian plains. Alike they scorn the pomp of tyrant Power, And coward Vice, that revels in her chains. When Latium had her lofty spirit lost, They sought, O Albion! next thy sea-encircled coast.

Far from the sun and summer gale, In thy green lap was Nature's darling laid, What time, where lucid Avon stray'd, To Him the mighty mother did unveil Her awful face: the dauntless child Stretch'd forth his little arms, and smiled. This pencil take (she said), whose colours clear Richly paint the vernal year: Thine too these golden keys, immortal boy! This can unlock the gates of joy; Of horror that, and thrilling fears, Or ope the sacred source of sympathetic tears.

Nor second he, that rode sublime Upon the seraph-wings of Ecstasy, The secrets of th' abyss to spy. He pass'd the flaming bounds of place and time: The living Throne, the sapphire-blaze, Where Angels tremble while they gaze, He saw; but blasted with excess of light, Closed his eyes in endless night. Behold, where Dryden's less presumptuous car, Wide o'er the fields of glory bear Two coursers of ethereal race, With necks in thunder clothed, and long-resounding pace.

Hark, his hands the lyre explore! Bright-eyed Fancy hovering o'er Scatters from her pictured urn Thoughts that breathe, and words that burn. But ah! 'tis heard no more---- O Lyre divine! what daring Spirit Wakes thee now? Tho' he inherit Nor the pride, nor ample pinion, That the Theban eagle bear Sailing with supreme dominion Thro' the azure deep of air: Yet oft before his infant eyes would run Such forms as glitter in the Muse's ray, With orient hues, unborrow'd of the Sun: Yet shall he mount, and keep his distant way Beyond the limits of a vulgar fate, Beneath the Good how far--but far above the Great.

_456._ _On a Favourite Cat, Drowned in a Tub of Gold Fishes_

Twas on a lofty vase's side, Where China's gayest art had dyed The azure flowers that blow; Demurest of the tabby kind, The pensive Selima reclined, Gazed on the lake below.

Her conscious tail her joy declared; The fair round face, the snowy beard, The velvet of her paws, Her coat, that with the tortoise vies, Her ears of jet, and emerald eyes, She saw; and purr'd applause.

Still had she gazed; but 'midst the tide Two angel forms were seen to glide, The Genii of the stream: Their scaly armour's Tyrian hue Thro' richest purple to the view Betray'd a golden gleam.

The hapless Nymph with wonder saw: A whisker first and then a claw, With many an ardent wish, She stretch’d in vain to reach the prize. What female heart can gold despise? What Cat’s averse to fish?

Presumptuous Maid! with looks intent Again she stretch’d, again she bent, Nor knew the gulf between. (Malignant Fate sat by, and smiled.) The slipp’ry verge her feet beguiled, She tumbled headlong in.

Eight times emerging from the flood She mew’d to ev’ry wat’ry god, Some speedy aid to send. No Dolphin came, no Nereid stirr’d: Nor cruel _Tom_, nor _Susan_ heard. A Fav’rite has no friend!

From hence, ye Beauties, undeceived, Know, one false step is ne’er retrieved, And be with caution bold. Not all that tempts your wand’ring eyes And heedless hearts, is lawful prize; Nor all that glisters, gold.

WILLIAM COLLINS

1721-1759

_457._ _Ode to Simplicity_

O thou, by Nature taught To breathe her genuine thought In numbers warmly pure and sweetly strong: Who first on mountains wild, In Fancy, loveliest child, Thy babe and Pleasure’s, nursed the pow’rs of song!

Thou, who with hermit heart Disdain’st the wealth of art, And gauds, and pageant weeds, and trailing pall: But com’st a decent maid, In Attic robe array’d, O chaste, unboastful nymph, to thee I call!

By all the honey’d store On Hybla’s thymy shore, By all her blooms and mingled murmurs dear, By her whose love-lorn woe, In evening musings slow, Soothed sweetly sad Electra’s poet’s ear:

By old Cephisus deep, Who spread his wavy sweep In warbled wand’rings round thy green retreat; On whose enamell’d side, When holy Freedom died, No equal haunt allured thy future feet!

O sister meek of Truth, To my admiring youth Thy sober aid and native charms infuse! The flow’rs that sweetest breathe, Though beauty cull’d the wreath, Still ask thy hand to range their order’d hues.

While Rome could none esteem, But virtue’s patriot theme, You loved her hills, and led her laureate band; But stay’d to sing alone To one distinguish’d throne, And turn’d thy face, and fled her alter’d land.

No more, in hall or bow’r, The passions own thy pow’r. Love, only Love her forceless numbers mean; For thou hast left her shrine, Nor olive more, nor vine, Shall gain thy feet to bless the servile scene.

Though taste, though genius bless To some divine excess, Faint’s the cold work till thou inspire the whole; What each, what all supply, May court, may charm our eye,

Thou, only thou, canst raise the meeting soul!

Of these let others ask, To aid some mighty task, I only seek to find thy temperate vale; Where oft my reed might sound To maids and shepherds round, And all thy sons, O Nature, learn my tale.

_458._ _How sleep the Brave_

How sleep the brave, who sink to rest By all their country’s wishes blest! When Spring, with dewy fingers cold, Returns to deck their hallow’d mould, She there shall dress a sweeter sod Than Fancy’s feet have ever trod.

By fairy hands their knell is rung; By forms unseen their dirge is sung; There Honour comes, a pilgrim grey, To bless the turf that wraps their clay; And Freedom shall awhile repair To dwell, a weeping hermit, there!

_459._ _Ode to Evening_

If aught of oaten stop, or pastoral song, May hope, chaste Eve, to soothe thy modest ear, Like thy own solemn springs, Thy springs and dying gales;

O nymph reserved, while now the bright-hair’d sun Sits in yon western tent, whose cloudy skirts, With brede ethereal wove, O’erhang his wavy bed:

Now air is hush’d, save where the weak-eyed bat With short shrill shriek flits by on leathern wing, Or where the beetle winds His small but sullen horn,

As oft he rises, ’midst the twilight path Against the pilgrim borne in heedless hum: Now teach me, maid composed, To breathe some soften’d strain,

Whose numbers, stealing through thy darkening vale, May not unseemly with its stillness suit, As, musing slow, I hail Thy genial loved return!

For when thy folding-star arising shows His paly circlet, at his warning lamp The fragrant hours, and elves Who slept in buds the day, And many a nymph who wreathes her brows with sedge, And sheds the freshening dew, and, lovelier still, The pensive pleasures sweet, Prepare thy shadowy car:

Then lead, calm votaress, where some sheety lake Cheers the lone heath, or some time-hallow’d pile, Or upland fallows grey Reflect its last cool gleam.

Or if chill blustering winds, or driving rain, Prevent my willing feet, be mine the hut That from the mountain’s side Views wilds and swelling floods,

And hamlets brown, and dim-discover’d spires, And hears their simple bell, and marks o’er all Thy dewy fingers draw The gradual dusky veil.

While Spring shall pour his show’rs, as oft he wont, And bathe thy breathing tresses, meekest Eve! While Summer loves to sport Beneath thy lingering light;

While sallow Autumn fills thy lap with leaves, Or Winter, yelling through the troublous air, Affrights thy shrinking train, And rudely rends thy robes:

So long, regardful of thy quiet rule, Shall Fancy, Friendship, Science, rose-lipp’d Health Thy gentlest influence own, And hymn thy favourite name!

_460._ _Fidele_

To fair Fidele’s grassy tomb Soft maids and village hinds shall bring Each opening sweet of earliest bloom, And rifle all the breathing Spring.

No wailing ghost shall dare appear To vex with shrieks this quiet grove; But shepherd lads assemble here, And melting virgins own their love.

No wither’d witch shall here be seen, No goblins lead their nightly crew; The female fays shall haunt the green, And dress thy grave with pearly dew.

The redbreast oft at evening hours Shall kindly lend his little aid, With hoary moss, and gather’d flowers, To deck the ground where thou art laid.

When howling winds, and beating rain, In tempests shake thy sylvan cell; Or ’midst the chase, on every plain, The tender thought on thee shall dwell;

Each lonely scene shall thee restore, For thee the tear be duly shed; Beloved, till life can charm no more; And mourn’d, till Pity’s self be dead.

MARK AKENSIDE

1721-1770

_461._ _Amoret_

If rightly tuneful bards decide, If it be fix’d in Love’s decrees, That Beauty ought not to be tried But by its native power to please, Then tell me, youths and lovers, tell-- What fair can Amoret excel?

Behold that bright unsullied smile, And wisdom speaking in her mien: Yet--she so artless all the while, So little studious to be seen-- We naught but instant gladness know, Nor think to whom the gift we owe.

But neither music, nor the powers Of youth and mirth and frolic cheer, Add half the sunshine to the hours, Or make life’s prospect half so clear, As memory brings it to the eye From scenes where Amoret was by.

This, sure, is Beauty’s happiest part; This gives the most unbounded sway; This shall enchant the subject heart When rose and lily fade away; And she be still, in spite of Time, Sweet Amoret in all her prime.

_462._ _The Complaint_

Away! away! Tempt me no more, insidious Love: Thy soothing sway Long did my youthful bosom prove: At length thy treason is discerned, At length some dear-bought caution earn’d: Away! nor hope my riper age to move.

I know, I see Her merit. Needs it now be shown, Alas! to me? How often, to myself unknown, The graceful, gentle, virtuous maid Have I admired! How often said-- What joy to call a heart like hers one’s own!

But, flattering god, O squanderer of content and ease In thy abode Will care’s rude lesson learn to please? O say, deceiver, hast thou won Proud Fortune to attend thy

throne, Or placed thy friends above her stern decrees?

_463._ _The Nightingale_

To-night retired, the queen of heaven With young Endymion stays; And now to Hesper it is given Awhile to rule the vacant sky, Till she shall to her lamp supply A stream of brighter rays.

Propitious send thy golden ray, Thou purest light above! Let no false flame seduce to stray Where gulf or steep lie hid for harm; But lead where music's healing charm May soothe afflicted love.

To them, by many a grateful song In happier seasons vow'd, These lawns, Olympia's haunts, belong: Oft by yon silver stream we walk'd, Or fix'd, while Philomela talk'd, Beneath yon copses stood.

Nor seldom, where the beechen boughs That roofless tower invade, We came, while her enchanting Muse The radiant moon above us held: Till, by a clamorous owl compell'd, She fled the solemn shade.

But hark! I hear her liquid tone! Now Hesper guide my feet! Down the red marl with moss o'ergrown, Through yon wild thicket next the plain, Whose hawthorns choke the winding lane Which leads to her retreat.

See the green space: on either hand Enlarged it spreads around: See, in the midst she takes her stand, Where one old oak his awful shade Extends o'er half the level mead, Enclosed in woods profound.

Hark! how through many a melting note She now prolongs her lays: How sweetly down the void they float! The breeze their magic path attends; The stars shine out; the forest bends; The wakeful heifers graze.

Whoe'er thou art whom chance may bring To this sequester'd spot, If then the plaintive Siren sing, O softly tread beneath her bower And think of Heaven's disposing power, Of man's uncertain lot.

O think, o'er all this mortal stage What mournful scenes arise: What ruin waits on kingly rage; How often virtue dwells with woe; How many griefs from knowledge flow; How swiftly pleasure flies!

O sacred bird! let me at eve, Thus wandering all alone, Thy tender counsel oft receive, Bear witness to thy pensive airs, And pity Nature's common cares, Till I forget my own.

TOBIAS GEORGE SMOLLETT

1721-1771

_464._ _To Leven Water_

Pure stream, in whose transparent wave My youthful limbs I wont to lave; No torrents stain thy limpid source, No rocks impede thy dimpling course Devolving from thy parent lake A charming maze thy waters make By bowers of birch and groves of

pine And edges flower’d with eglantine.

Still on thy banks so gaily green May numerous herds and flocks be seen, And lasses chanting o’er the pail, And shepherds piping in the dale, And ancient faith that knows no guile, And industry embrown’d with toil, And hearts resolved and hands prepared The blessings they enjoy to guard.

CHRISTOPHER SMART

1722-1770

_465._ _Song to David_

Sublime--invention ever young, Of vast conception, tow’ring tongue To God th’ eternal theme; Notes from yon exaltations caught, Unrivall’d royalty of thought O’er meaner strains supreme.

His muse, bright angel of his verse, Gives balm for all the thorns that pierce, For all the pangs that rage; Blest light still gaining on the gloom, The more than Michal of his bloom, Th’ Abishag of his age.

He sang of God--the mighty source Of all things--the stupendous force On which all strength depends; From whose right arm, beneath whose eyes, All period, power, and enterprise Commences, reigns, and ends.

Tell them, I AM, Jehovah said To Moses; while earth heard in dread, And, smitten to the heart, At once above, beneath, around, All Nature, without voice or sound, Replied, O LORD, THOU ART.

The world, the clustering spheres, He made; The glorious light, the soothing shade, Dale, champaign, grove, and hill; The multitudinous abyss, Where Secrecy remains in bliss, And Wisdom hides her skill.

The pillars of the Lord are seven, Which stand from earth to topmost heaven; His Wisdom drew the plan; His Word accomplished the design, From brightest gem to deepest mine; From Christ enthroned, to Man.

For Adoration all the ranks Of Angels yield eternal thanks, And David in the midst; With God’s good poor, which, last and least In man’s esteem, Thou to Thy feast, O blessèd Bridegroom, bidd’st!

For Adoration, David’s Psalms Lift up the heart to deeds of alms; And he, who kneels and chants, Prevails his passions to control, Finds meat and medicine to the soul, Which for translation pants.

For Adoration, in the dome Of Christ, the sparrows find a home, And on His olives perch: The swallow also dwells with thee, O man of God’s humility, Within his Saviour’s church.

Sweet is the dew that falls betimes, And drops upon the leafy limes; Sweet, Hermon’s fragrant air: Sweet is the lily’s silver bell, And sweet the wakeful tapers’ smell That watch for early prayer.

Sweet the young nurse, with love intense, Which smiles o’er sleeping innocence; Sweet, when the lost arrive: Sweet the musician’s ardour beats, While his vague mind’s in quest of sweets, The choicest flowers to hive.

Strong is the horse upon his speed; Strong in pursuit the rapid glede, Which makes at once his game: Strong the tall ostrich on the ground; Strong through the turbulent profound Shoots Xiphias to his aim.

Strong is the lion--like a coal His eyeball,--like a bastion’s mole His chest against the foes: Strong the gier-eagle on his sail; Strong against tide th’ enormous whale Emerges as he goes.

But stronger still, in earth and air, And in the sea, the man of prayer, And far beneath the tide: And in the seat to faith assigned, Where ask is have, where seek is find, Where knock is open wide.

Precious the penitential tear; And precious is the sigh sincere, Acceptable to God: And precious are the winning flowers, In gladsome Israel’s feast of bowers Bound on the hallow’d sod.

Glorious the sun in mid career; Glorious th’ assembled fires appear; Glorious the comet’s train: Glorious the trumpet and alarm; Glorious the Almighty’s stretch’d-out arm; Glorious th’ enraptured main:

glede] kite. Xiphias] sword-fish.

Glorious the northern lights astream; Glorious the song, when God’s the theme; Glorious the thunder’s roar: Glorious Hosanna from the den; Glorious the catholic Amen; Glorious the martyr’s gore:

Glorious--more glorious--is the crown Of Him that brought salvation down, By meekness call’d thy Son: Thou that stupendous truth believed;-- And now the matchless deed’s achieved, Determined, dared, and done!

JANE ELLIOT

1727-1805

_466._ _A Lament for Flodden_

I’ve heard them lilting at our ewe-milking, Lasses a’ lilting before dawn o’ day; But now they are moaning on ilka green loaning-- The Flowers of the Forest are a’ wede away.

At bughts, in the morning, nae blythe lads are scorning. Lasses are lonely and dowie and wae; Nae daffing, nae gabbing, but sighing and sabbing, Ilk ane lifts her leglin and hies her away.

In hairst, at the shearing, nae youths now are jeering, Bandsters are lyart, and runkled, and gray: At fair or at preaching, nae wooing, nae fleeching-- The Flowers of the Forest are a’ wede away.

_466._ loaning] lane, field-track. wede] weeded. bughts] sheep-folds. daffing] joking. leglin] milk-pail. hairst] harvest. bandsters] binders. lyart] gray-haired. runkled] wrinkled. fleeching] coaxing.

At e’en, in the gloaming, nae swankies are roaming ’Bout stacks wi’ the lasses at bogle to play; But ilk ane sits eerie, lamenting her dearie-- The Flowers of the Forest are a’ wede away.

Dool and wae for the order sent our lads to the Border! The English, for ance, by guile wan the day; The Flowers of the Forest, that fought aye the foremost, The prime of our land, lie cauld in the clay.

We’ll hear nae mair lilting at our ewe-milking; Women and bairns are heartless and wae; Sighing and moaning on ilka green loaning-- The Flowers of the Forest are a’ wede away.

_466._ swankies] lusty lads. bogle] bogy, hide-and-seek. dool] mourning.

OLIVER GOLDSMITH

1728-1774

_467._ _Woman_

When lovely woman stoops to folly, And finds too late that men betray, What charm can soothe her melancholy? What art can wash her tears away?

The only art her guilt to cover, To hide her shame from ev’ry eye, To give repentance to her lover, And wring his bosom is--to die.

_468._ _Memory_

O memory, thou fond deceiver, Still importunate and vain, To former joys recurring ever, And turning all the past to pain:

Thou, like the world, th’ oppress’d oppressing, Thy smiles increase the wretch’s woe: And he who wants each other blessing In thee must ever find a foe.

ROBERT CUNNINGHAME-GRAHAM OF GARTMORE

1735-1797

_469._ _If Doughty Deeds_

If doughty deeds my lady please, Right soon I’ll mount my steed; And strong his arm and fast his seat, That bears frae me the meed. I’ll wear thy colours in my cap, Thy picture in my heart; And he that bends not to thine eye Shall rue it to his smart! Then tell me how to woo thee, Love; O tell me how to woo thee! For thy dear sake nae care I’ll take, Tho’ ne’er another trow me.

If gay attire delight thine eye I’ll dight me in array; I’ll tend thy chamber door all night, And squire thee all the day. If sweetest sounds can win thine ear, These sounds I’ll strive to catch; Thy voice I’ll steal to woo thysel’, That voice that nane can match.

Then tell me how to woo thee, Love ...

But if fond love thy heart can gain, I never broke a vow; Nae maiden lays her skaith to me, I never loved but you. For you alone I ride the ring, For you I wear the blue; For you alone I strive to sing, O tell me how to woo! Then tell me how to woo thee, Love; O tell me how to woo thee! For thy dear sake nae care I'll take Tho' ne'er another trow me.

WILLIAM COWPER

1731-1800

_470._ _To Mary Unwin_

Mary! I want a lyre with other strings, Such aid from Heaven as some have feign'd they drew, An eloquence scarce given to mortals, new And undebased by praise of meaner things; That ere through age or woe I shed my wings, I may record thy worth with honour due, In verse as musical as thou art true, And that immortalizes whom it sings: But thou hast little need. There is a Book By seraphs writ with beams of heavenly light, On which the eyes of God not rarely look, A chronicle of actions just and bright-- There all thy deeds, my faithful Mary, shine; And since thou own'st that praise, I spare thee mine.

_471._ _My Mary_

The twentieth year is wellnigh past Since first our sky was overcast; Ah, would that this might be the last! My Mary!

Thy spirits have a fainter flow, I see thee daily weaker grow; 'Twas my distress that brought thee low, My Mary!

Thy needles, once a shining store, For my sake restless heretofore, Now rust disused, and shine no more; My Mary!

For though thou gladly wouldst fulfil The same kind office for me still, Thy sight now seconds not thy will, My Mary!

But well thou play'dst the housewife's part, And all thy threads with magic art Have wound themselves about this heart, My Mary!

Thy indistinct expressions seem Like language utter'd in a dream; Yet me they charm, whate'er the theme, My Mary!

Thy silver locks, once auburn bright, Are still more lovely in my sight Than golden beams of orient light, My Mary!

For could I view nor them nor thee, What sight worth seeing could I see? The sun would rise in vain for me, My Mary!

Partakers of thy sad decline, Thy hands their little force resign; Yet, gently press'd, press gently mine, My Mary!

Such feebleness of limbs thou prov’st, That now at every step thou mov’st Upheld by two; yet still thou lov’st, My Mary!

And still to love, though press’d with ill, In wintry age to feel no chill, With me is to be lovely still, My Mary!

But ah! by constant heed I know How oft the sadness that I show Transforms thy smiles to looks of woe, My Mary!

And should my future lot be cast With much resemblance of the past, Thy worn-out heart will break at last-- My Mary!

JAMES BEATTIE

1735-1803

_472._ _An Epitaph_

Like thee I once have stemm’d the sea of life, Like thee have languish’d after empty joys, Like thee have labour’d in the stormy strife, Been grieved for trifles, and amused with toys.

Forget my frailties; thou art also frail: Forgive my lapses; for thyself may’st fall: Nor read unmoved my artless tender tale-- I was a friend, O man, to thee, to all.

ISOBEL PAGAN

1740-1821

_473._ _Ca’ the Yowes to the Knowes_

Ca’ the yowes to the knowes, Ca’ them where the heather grows, Ca’ them where the burnie rows, My bonnie dearie.

As I gaed down the water side, There I met my shepherd lad; He row’d me sweetly in his plaid, And he ca’d me his dearie.

‘Will ye gang down the water side, And see the waves sae sweetly glide Beneath the hazels spreading wide? The moon it shines fu’ clearly.’

_473._ yowes] ewes. knowes] knolls, little hills. rows] rolls. row’d] rolled, wrapped.

‘I was bred up at nae sic school, My shepherd lad, to play the fool, And a’ the day to sit in dool, And naebody to see me.’

‘Ye sall get gowns and ribbons meet, Cauf-leather shoon upon your feet, And in my arms ye’se lie and sleep, And ye sall be my dearie.’

‘If ye’ll but stand to what ye’ve said, I’se gang wi’ you, my shepherd lad, And ye may row me in your plaid, And I sall be your dearie.’

‘While waters wimple to the sea, While day blinks in the lift sae hie, Till clay-cauld death sail blin’ my e’e, Ye aye sall be my dearie!’

_473._ dool] dule, sorrow. lift] sky.

ANNA LÆTITIA BARBAULD

1743-1825

_474._ _Life_

Life! I know not what thou art, But know that thou and I must part; And when, or how, or where we met, I own to me's a secret yet. But this I know, when thou art fled, Where'er they lay these limbs, this head, No clod so valueless shall be As all that then remains of me. O whither, whither dost thou fly? Where bend unseen thy trackless course? And in this strange divorce, Ah, tell where I must seek this compound I? To the vast ocean of empyreal flame From whence thy essence came Dost thou thy flight pursue, when freed From matter's base encumbering weed? Or dost thou, hid from sight, Wait, like some spell-bound knight, Through blank oblivious years th' appointed hour To break thy trance and reassume thy power? Yet canst thou without thought or feeling be? O say, what art thou, when no more thou'rt thee?

Life! we have been long together, Through pleasant and through cloudy weather; 'Tis hard to part when friends are dear; Perhaps 'twill cost a sigh, a tear;-- Then steal away, give little warning, Choose thine own time; Say not Good-night, but in some brighter clime Bid me Good-morning!

FANNY GREVILLE

18th Cent.

_475._ _Prayer for Indifference_

I ask no kind return of love, No tempting charm to please; Far from the heart those gifts remove, That sighs for peace and ease.

Nor peace nor ease the heart can know, That, like the needle true, Turns at the touch of joy or woe, But, turning, trembles too.

Far as distress the soul can wound, 'Tis pain in each degree: 'Tis bliss but to a certain bound, Beyond is agony.

JOHN LOGAN

1748-1788

_476._ _To the Cuckoo_

Hail, beauteous stranger of the grove! Thou messenger of Spring! Now Heaven repairs thy rural seat, And woods thy welcome ring.

What time the daisy decks the green, Thy certain voice we hear: Hast thou a star to guide thy path, Or mark the rolling year?

Delightful visitant! with thee I hail the time of flowers, And hear the sound of music sweet From birds among the bowers.

The schoolboy, wand'ring through the wood To pull the primrose gay, Starts, the new voice of Spring to hear, And imitates thy lay.

What time the pea puts on the bloom, Thou fli'st thy vocal vale, An annual guest in other lands, Another Spring to hail.

Sweet bird! thy bower is ever green, Thy sky is ever clear; Thou hast no sorrow in thy song, No Winter in thy year!

O could I fly, I'd fly with thee! We'd make, with joyful wing, Our annual visit o'er the globe, Companions of the Spring.

LADY ANNE LINDSAY

1750-1825

_477._ _Auld Robin Gray_

When the sheep are in the fauld, and the kye at hame, And a' the warld to rest are gane, The waes o' my heart fa' in showers frae my e'e, While my gudeman lies sound by me.

Young Jamie lo'ed me weel, and sought me for his bride; But saving a croun he had naething else beside: To make the croun a pund, young Jamie gaed to sea; And the croun and the pund were baith for me.

He hadna been awa' a week but only twa, When my father brak his arm, and the cow was stown awa'; My mother she fell sick,--and my Jamie at the sea-- And auld Robin Gray came a-courtin' me.

My father couldna work, and my mother couldna spin; I toil'd day and night, but their bread I couldna win; Auld Rob maintain'd them baith, and wi' tears in his e'e Said, 'Jennie, for their sakes, O, marry me!'

My heart it said nay; I look'd for Jamie back; But the wind it blew high, and the ship it was a wrack; His ship it was a wrack--Why didna Jamie dee? Or why do I live to cry, Wae's me!

My father urged me sair: my mother didna speak; But she look'd in my face till my heart was like to break: They gi'ed him my hand, tho' my heart was in the sea; Sae auld Robin Gray he was gudeman to me.

I hadna been a wife a week but only four, When mournfu' as I sat on the stane at the door, I saw my Jamie's wraith,--for I couldna think it he, Till he said, 'I'm come hame to marry thee.'

O sair, sair did we greet, and muckle did we say; We took but ae kiss, and we tore ourselves away: I wish that I were dead, but I'm no like to dee; And why was I born to say, Wae's me!

I gang like a ghaist, and I carena to spin; I daurna think on Jamie, for that wad be a sin; But I’ll do my best a gude wife aye to be, For auld Robin Gray he is kind unto me.

SIR WILLIAM JONES

1746-1794

_478._ _Epigram_

On parent knees, a naked new-born child, Weeping thou sat’st while all around thee smiled: So live, that sinking to thy life’s last sleep, Calm thou may’st smile, whilst all around thee weep.

THOMAS CHATTERTON

1752-1770

_479._ _Song from Ælla_

O sing unto my roundelay, O drop the briny tear with me; Dance no more at holyday, Like a running river be: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

Black his cryne as the winter night, White his rode as the summer snow, Red his face as the morning light, Cold he lies in the grave below: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

Sweet his tongue as the throstle’s note, Quick in dance as thought can be, Deft his tabor, cudgel stout; O he lies by the willow-tree! My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

_479._ cryne] hair. rode] complexion.

Hark! the raven flaps his wing In the brier’d dell below; Hark! the death-owl loud doth sing To the nightmares, as they go: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

See! the white moon shines on high; Whiter is my true-love’s shroud: Whiter than the morning sky, Whiter than the evening cloud: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

Here upon my true-love’s grave Shall the barren flowers be laid; Not one holy saint to save All the coldness of a maid: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

With my hands I’ll dent the briers Round his holy corse to gre: Ouph and fairy, light your fires, Here my body still shall be: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed All under the willow-tree.

dent] fasten. gre] grow. ouph] elf.

Come, with acorn-cup and thorn, Drain my heartès blood away; Life and all its good I scorn, Dance by night, or feast by day: My love is dead, Gone to his death-bed

All under the willow-tree.

GEORGE CRABBE

1754-1832

_480._ _Meeting_

My Damon was the first to wake The gentle flame that cannot die; My Damon is the last to take The faithful bosom’s softest sigh: The life between is nothing worth, O cast it from thy thought away! Think of the day that gave it birth, And this its sweet returning day.

Buried be all that has been done, Or say that naught is done amiss; For who the dangerous path can shun In such bewildering world as this? But love can every fault forgive, Or with a tender look reprove; And now let naught in memory live But that we meet, and that we love.

_481._ _Late Wisdom_

We’ve trod the maze of error round, Long wandering in the winding glade; And now the torch of truth is found, It only shows us where we strayed: By long experience taught, we know-- Can rightly judge of friends and foes; Can all the worth of these allow, And all the faults discern in those.

Now, ’tis our boast that we can quell The wildest passions in their rage, Can their destructive force repel, And their impetuous wrath assuage.-- Ah, Virtue! dost thou arm when now This bold rebellious race are fled? When all these tyrants rest, and thou Art warring with the mighty dead?

_482._ _A Marriage Ring_

The ring, so worn as you behold, So thin, so pale, is yet of gold: The passion such it was to prove-- Worn with life’s care, love yet was love.

WILLIAM BLAKE

1757-1827

_483._ _To the Muses_

Whether on Ida’s shady brow Or in the chambers of the East, The chambers of the Sun, that now From ancient melody have ceased;

Whether in heaven ye wander fair, Or the green corners of the earth, Or the blue regions of the air Where the melodious winds have birth;

Whether on crystal rocks ye rove, Beneath the bosom of the sea, Wandering in many a coral grove; Fair Nine, forsaking Poetry;

How have you left the ancient love That bards of old enjoy’d in you! The languid strings do scarcely move, The sound is forced, the notes are few.

_484._ _To Spring_

O thou with dewy locks, who lookest down Through the clear windows of the morning, turn Thine angel eyes upon our western isle, Which in full choir hails thy approach, O Spring!

The hills tell one another, and the listening Valleys hear; all our longing eyes are turn’d Up to thy bright pavilions: issue forth And let thy holy feet visit our clime!

Come o’er the eastern hills, and let our winds Kiss thy perfumèd garments; let us taste Thy morn and evening breath; scatter thy pearls Upon our lovesick land that mourns for thee.

O deck her forth with thy fair fingers; pour Thy soft kisses on her bosom; and put Thy golden crown upon her languish’d head, Whose modest tresses are bound up for thee.

_485._ _Song_

My silks and fine array, My smiles and languish’d air, By Love are driven away; And mournful lean Despair Brings me yew to deck my grave: Such end true lovers have.

His face is fair as heaven When springing buds unfold: O why to him was’t given, Whose heart is wintry cold? His breast is Love’s all-worshipp’d tomb, Where all Love’s pilgrims come.

Bring me an axe and spade, Bring me a winding-sheet; When I my grave have made, Let winds and tempests beat: Then down I’ll lie, as cold as clay: True love doth pass away!

_486._ _Reeds of Innocence_

Piping down the valleys wild, Piping songs of pleasant glee, On a cloud I saw a child, And he laughing said to me:

‘Pipe a song about a Lamb!’ So I piped with merry cheer. ‘Piper, pipe that song again;’ So I piped: he wept to hear.

‘Drop thy pipe, thy happy pipe; Sing thy songs of happy cheer!’ So I sung the same again, While he wept with joy to hear.

‘Piper, sit thee down and write In a book that all may read.’ So he vanish’d from my sight; And I pluck’d a hollow reed,

And I made a rural pen, And I stain’d the water clear, And I wrote my happy songs Every child may joy to hear.

_487._ _The Little Black Boy_

My mother bore me in the southern wild, And I am black, but O, my soul is white! White as an angel is the English child, But I am black, as if bereaved of light.

My mother taught me underneath a tree, And, sitting down before the heat of day, She took me on her lap and kissèd me, And, pointing to the East, began to say:

‘Look at the rising sun: there God does live, And gives His light, and gives His heat away, And flowers and trees and beasts and men receive Comfort in morning, joy in the noonday.

‘And we are put on earth a little space, That we may learn to bear the beams of love; And these black bodies and this sunburnt face Are but a cloud, and like a shady grove.

‘For when our souls have learn’d the heat to bear, The cloud will vanish, we shall hear His voice, Saying, “Come out from the grove, my love and care, And round my golden tent like lambs rejoice.”’

Thus did my mother say, and kissèd me, And thus I say to little English boy. When I from black and he from white cloud free, And round the tent of God like lambs we joy,

I’ll shade him from the heat till he can bear To lean in joy upon our Father’s knee; And then I’ll stand and stroke his silver hair, And be like him, and he will then love me.

_488._ _Hear the Voice_

Hear the voice of the Bard, Who present, past, and future, sees; Whose ears have heard The Holy Word That walk’d among the ancient trees;

Calling the lapsèd soul, And weeping in the evening dew; That might control The starry pole, And fallen, fallen light renew!

‘O Earth, O Earth, return! Arise from out the dewy grass! Night is worn, And the morn Rises from the slumbrous mass.

‘Turn away no more; Why wilt thou turn away? The starry floor, The watery shore, Is given thee till the break of day.’

_489._ _The Tiger_

Tiger, tiger, burning bright In the forests of the night, What immortal hand or eye Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies Burnt the fire of thine eyes? On what wings dare he aspire? What the hand dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder and what art Could twist the sinews of thy heart? And, when thy heart began to beat, What dread hand and what dread feet?

What the hammer? What the chain? In what furnace was thy brain? What the anvil? What dread grasp Dare its deadly terrors clasp?

When the stars threw down their spears, And watered heaven with their tears, Did He smile His work to see? Did He who made the lamb make thee?

Tiger, tiger, burning bright In the forests of the night, What immortal hand or eye Dare frame thy fearful symmetry?

_490._ _Cradle Song_

Sleep, sleep, beauty bright, Dreaming in the joys of night; Sleep, sleep; in thy sleep Little sorrows sit and weep.

Sweet babe, in thy face Soft desires I can trace, Secret joys and secret smiles, Little pretty infant wiles.

As thy softest limbs I feel Smiles as of the morning steal O'er thy cheek, and o'er thy breast Where thy little heart doth rest.

O the cunning wiles that creep In thy little heart asleep! When thy little heart doth wake, Then the dreadful night shall break.

_491._ _Night_

The sun descending in the west, The evening star does shine; The birds are silent in their nest. And I must seek for mine. The moon, like a flower In heaven's high bower, With silent delight Sits and smiles on the night.

Farewell, green fields and happy grove, Where flocks have took delight: Where lambs have nibbled, silent move The feet of angels bright; Unseen they pour blessing And joy without ceasing On each bud and blossom, On each sleeping bosom.

They look in every thoughtless nest Where birds are cover'd warm; They visit caves of every beast, To keep them all from harm: If they see any weeping That should have been sleeping, They pour sleep on their head, And sit down by their bed.

When wolves and tigers howl for prey, They pitying stand and weep, Seeking to drive their thirst away And keep them from the sheep. But, if they rush dreadful, The angels, most heedful, Receive each mild spirit, New worlds to inherit.

And there the lion's ruddy eyes Shall flow with tears of gold: And pitying the tender cries, And walking round the fold: Saying, 'Wrath by His meekness, And, by His health, sickness, Are driven away From our immortal day.

'And now beside thee, bleating lamb, I can lie down and sleep, Or think on Him who bore thy name, Graze after thee, and weep. For, wash'd in life's river, My bright mane for ever Shall shine like the gold As I guard o'er the fold.'

_492._ _Love's Secret_

Never seek to tell thy love, Love that never told can be; For the gentle wind doth move Silently, invisibly.

I told my love, I told my love, I told her all my heart, Trembling, cold, in ghastly fears. Ah! she did depart!

Soon after she was gone from me, A traveller came by, Silently, invisibly: He took her with a sigh.

ROBERT BURNS

1759-1796

_493._ _Mary Morison_

O Mary, at thy window be, It is the wish’d, the trysted hour! Those smiles and glances let me see, That make the miser’s treasure poor: How blythely wad I bide the stour A weary slave frae sun to sun, Could I the rich reward secure, The lovely Mary Morison!

Yestreen, when to the trembling string The dance gaed thro’ the lighted ha’, To thee my fancy took its wing, I sat, but neither heard nor saw:

_493._ stour] dust, turmoil.

Tho’ this was fair, and that was braw, And yon the toast of a’ the town, I sigh’d, and said amang them a’, ‘Ye are na Mary Morison.’

O Mary, canst thou wreck his peace, Wha for thy sake wad gladly die? Or canst thou break that heart of his, Whase only faut is loving thee? If love for love thou wiltna gie, At least be pity to me shown; A thought ungentle canna be The thought o’ Mary Morison.

_494._ _Jean_

Of a’ the airts the wind can blaw, I dearly like the west, For there the bonnie lassie lives, The lassie I lo’e best: There wild woods grow, and rivers row, And monie a hill between; But day and night my fancy’s flight Is ever wi’ my Jean.

I see her in the dewy flowers, I see her sweet and fair: I hear her in the tunefu’ birds, I hear her charm the air: There’s not a bonnie flower that springs By fountain, shaw, or green; There’s not a bonnie bird that sings, But minds me o’ my Jean.

_494._ airts] points of the compass. row] roll.

_495._ _Auld Lang Syne_

Should auld acquaintance be forgot, And never brought to min’? Should auld acquaintance be forgot, And days o’ lang syne?

We twa hae rin about the braes, And pu’d the gowans fine; But we’ve wandered monie a weary fit Sin’ auld lang syne.

We twa hae paidl’t i’ the burn, Frae mornin’ sun till dine; But seas between us braid hae roar’d Sin’ auld lang syne.

And here’s a hand, my trusty fiere, And gie’s a hand o’ thine; And we’ll tak a right guid-willie waught For auld lang syne.

And surely ye’ll be your pint-stowp, And surely I’ll be mine; And we’ll tak a cup o’ kindness yet For auld lang syne!

For auld lang syne, my dear, For auld lang syne, We’ll tak a cup o’ kindness yet For auld lang syne.

gowans] daisies. fit] foot. dine] dinner-time. fiere] partner. guid-willie waught] friendly draught.

_496._ _My Bonnie Mary_

Go fetch to me a pint ’o wine, An’ fill it in a silver tassie, That I may drink, before I go, A service to my bonnie lassie. The boat rocks at the pier o’ Leith, Fu’ loud the wind blaws frae the ferry, The ship rides by the Berwick-law, And I maun leave my bonnie Mary.

The trumpets sound, the banners fly, The glittering spears are rankèd ready; The shouts o’ war are heard afar, The battle closes thick and bloody; But it’s no the roar o’ sea or shore Wad mak me langer wish to tarry; Nor shout o’ war that’s heard afar--It’s leaving thee, my bonnie Mary!

_496._ tassie] cup.

_497._ _John Anderson, my Jo_

John Anderson, my jo, John, When we were first acquent, Your locks were like the raven, Your bonnie brow was brent; But now your brow is beld, John, Your locks are like the snow; But blessings on your frosty pow, John Anderson, my jo!

_497._ jo] sweetheart. brent] smooth, unwrinkled. beld] bald. pow] pate.

John Anderson, my jo, John, We clamb the hill thegither; And monie a canty day, John, We’ve had wi’ ane anither: Now we maun totter down, John, But hand in hand we’ll go, And sleep thegither at the foot, John Anderson, my jo.

_497._ canty] cheerful.

_498._ _The Banks o’ Doon_

Ye flowery banks o’ bonnie Doon, How can ye blume sae fair! How can ye chant, ye little birds, And I sae fu’ o’ care!

Thou’ll break my heart, thou bonnie bird, That sings upon the bough; Thou minds me o’ the happy days When my fause luve was true.

Thou’ll break my heart, thou bonnie bird, That sings beside thy mate; For sae I sat, and sae I sang, And wistna o’ my fate.

Aft hae I roved by bonnie Doon, To see the woodbine twine; And ilka bird sang o’ its luve, And sae did I o’ mine.

Wi’ lightsome heart I pu’d a rose Upon a morn in June; And sae I flourish’d on the morn, And sae was pu’d or’ noon.

_498._ or’] ere.

Wi’ lightsome heart I pu’d a rose Upon its thorny tree; But my fause luver staw my rose, And left the thorn wi’ me.

_498._ staw] stole.

_499._ _Ae Fond Kiss_

Ae fond kiss, and then we sever; Ae fareweel, alas, for ever! Deep in heart-wrung tears I’ll pledge thee, Warring sighs and groans I’ll wage thee!

Who shall say that Fortune grieves him While the star of hope she leaves him? Me, nae cheerfu’ twinkle lights me, Dark despair around benights me.

I’ll ne’er blame my partial fancy; Naething could resist my Nancy; But to see her was to love her, Love but her, and love for ever.

Had we never loved sae kindly, Had we never loved sae blindly, Never met--or never parted, We had ne’er been broken-hearted.

Fare thee weel, thou first and fairest! Fare thee weel, thou best and dearest! Thine be ilka joy and treasure, Peace, enjoyment, love, and pleasure!

Ae fond kiss, and then we sever! Ae fareweel, alas, for ever! Deep in heart-wrung tears I’ll pledge thee, Warring sighs and groans I’ll wage thee!

_499._ wage] stake, plight.

_500._ _Bonnie Lesley_

O saw ye bonnie Lesley As she gaed o’er the Border? She’s gane, like Alexander, To spread her conquests farther.

To see her is to love her, And love but her for ever; For Nature made her what she is, And ne’er made sic anither!

Thou art a queen, fair Lesley, Thy subjects we, before thee: Thou art divine, fair Lesley, The hearts o’ men adore thee.

The Deil he couldna scaith thee, Or aught that wad belang thee; He’d look into thy bonnie face And say, ‘I canna wrang thee!’

The Powers aboon will tent thee, Misfortune sha’na steer thee: Thou’rt like themsel’ sae lovely, That ill they’ll ne’er let near thee.

Return again, fair Lesley, Return to Caledonie! That we may brag we hae a lass There’s nane again sae bonnie!

scaith] harm. tent] watch. steer] molest.

_501._ _Highland Mary_

Ye banks and braes and streams around The castle o’ Montgomery, Green be your woods, and fair your flowers, Your waters never drumlie! There simmer first unfauld her robes, And there the langest tarry; For there I took the last fareweel O’ my sweet Highland Mary.

How sweetly bloom’d the gay green birk, How rich the hawthorn’s blossom, As underneath their fragrant shade I clasp’d her to my bosom! The golden hours on angel wings Flew o’er me and my dearie; For dear to me as light and life Was my sweet Highland Mary.

Wi’ monie a vow and lock’d embrace Our parting was fu’ tender; And, pledging aft to meet again, We tore oursels asunder; But oh! fell Death’s untimely frost, That nipt my flower sae early! Now green’s the sod, and cauld’s the clay, That wraps my Highland Mary!

O pale, pale now, those rosy lips I aft hae kiss’d sae fondly! And closed for aye the sparkling glance That dwelt on me sae kindly!

drumlie] miry.

And mouldering now in silent dust That heart that lo’ed me dearly! But still within my bosom’s core Shall live my Highland Mary.

_502._ _O were my Love yon Lilac fair_

O were my Love yon lilac fair, Wi’ purple blossoms to the spring, And I a bird to shelter there, When wearied on my little wing; How I wad mourn when it was torn By autumn wild and winter rude! But I wad sing on wanton wing When youthfu’ May its bloom renew’d.

O gin my Love were yon red rose That grows upon the castle wa’, And I mysel a drap o’ dew, Into her bonnie breast to fa’; O there, beyond expression blest, I’d feast on beauty a’ the night; Seal’d on her silk-saft faulds to rest, Till fley’d awa’ by Phœbus’ light.

_503._ _A Red, Red Rose_

O my Luve’s like a red, red rose That’s newly sprung in June: O my Luve’s like the melodie That’s sweetly play’d in tune!

As fair art thou, my bonnie lass, So deep in luve am I: And I will luve thee still, my dear, Till a’ the seas gang dry:

Till a’ the seas gang dry, my dear, And the rocks melt wi’ the sun; I will luve thee still, my dear, While the sands o’ life shall run.

And fare thee weel, my only Luve, And fare thee weel a while! And I will come again, my Luve, Tho’ it were ten thousand mile.

_504._ _Lament for Culloden_

The lovely lass o’ Inverness, Nae joy nor pleasure can she see; For e’en and morn she cries, ‘Alas!’ And aye the saut tear blin’s her e’e: ‘Drumossie moor, Drumossie day, A waefu’ day it was to me! For there I lost my father dear, My father dear and brethren three.

‘Their winding-sheet the bluidy clay, Their graves are growing green to see; And by them lies the dearest lad That ever blest a woman’s e’e! Now wae to thee, thou cruel lord, A bluidy man I trow thou be; For monie a heart thou hast made sair, That ne’er did wrang to thine or thee.’

_505._ _The Farewell_

It was a’ for our rightfu’ King We left fair Scotland’s strand; It was a’ for our rightfu’ King We e’er saw Irish land, My dear-- We e’er saw Irish land.

Now a’ is done that men can do, And a’ is done in vain; My love and native land, farewell, For I maun cross the main, My dear-- For I maun cross the main.

He turn’d him right and round about Upon the Irish shore; And gae his bridle-reins a shake, With, Adieu for evermore, My dear-- With, Adieu for evermore!

The sodger frae the wars returns, The sailor frae the main; But I hae parted frae my love, Never to meet again, My dear-- Never to meet again.

When day is gane, and night is come, And a’ folk bound to sleep, I think on him that’s far awa’, The lee-lang night, and weep, My dear-- The lee-lang night, and weep.

lee-lang] livelong.

_506._ _Hark! The Mavis_

Ca’ the yowes to the knowes, _Ca’ them where the heather grows,_ _Ca’ them where the burnie rows,_ _My bonnie dearie._

Hark! the mavis’ evening sang Sounding Clouden’s woods amang. Then a-faulding let us gang, My bonnie dearie.

We’ll gae down by Clouden side, Through the hazels spreading wide, O’er the waves that sweetly glide To the moon sae clearly.

Yonder Clouden’s silent towers, Where at moonshine midnight hours O’er the dewy bending flowers Fairies dance sae cheery.

Ghaist nor bogle shalt thou fear; Thou’rt to Love and Heaven sae dear, Nocht of ill may come thee near, My bonnie dearie.

Fair and lovely as thou art, Thou hast stown my very heart; I can die--but canna part, My bonnie dearie.

While waters wimple to the sea; While day blinks in the lift sae hie; Till clay-cauld death shall blin’ my e’e, Ye shall be my dearie.

Ca’ the yowes to the knowes ...

lift] sky.

HENRY ROWE

1750-1819

_507._ _Sun_

Angel, king of streaming morn; Cherub, call’d by Heav’n to shine; T’ orient tread the waste forlorn; Guide ætherial, pow’r divine; Thou, Lord of all within!

Golden spirit, lamp of day, Host, that dips in blood the plain, Bids the crimson’d mead be gay, Bids the green blood burst the vein; Thou, Lord of all within!

Soul, that wraps the globe in light; Spirit, beckoning to arise; Drives the frowning brow of night, Glory bursting o’er the skies; Thou, Lord of all within!

_508._ _Moon_

Thee too, modest tressèd maid, When thy fallen stars appear; When in lawn of fire array’d Sov’reign of yon powder’d sphere; To thee I chant at close of day, Beneath, O maiden Moon! thy ray.

Throned in sapphired ring supreme, Pregnant with celestial juice, On silver wing thy diamond stream Gives what summer hours produce; While view’d impearl’d earth’s rich inlay, Beneath, O maiden Moon! thy ray.

Glad, pale Cynthian wine I sip, Breathed the flow’ry leaves among; Draughts delicious wet my lip; Drown’d in nectar drunk my song; While tuned to Philomel the lay, Beneath, O maiden Moon! thy ray.

Dew, that od’rous ointment yields, Sweets, that western winds disclose, Bathing spring’s more purpled fields, Soft’s the band that winds the rose; While o’er thy myrtled lawns I stray Beneath, O maiden Moon! thy ray.

WILLIAM LISLE BOWLES

1762-1850

_509._ _Time and Grief_

O Time! who know’st a lenient hand to lay Softest on sorrow’s wound, and slowly thence (Lulling to sad repose the weary sense) The faint pang stealest unperceived away; On thee I rest my only hope at last, And think, when thou hast dried the bitter tear That flows in vain o’er all my soul held dear, I may look back on every sorrow past, And meet life’s peaceful evening with a smile: As some lone bird, at day’s departing hour, Sings in the sunbeam, of the transient shower Forgetful, though its wings are wet the while:-- Yet ah! how much must this poor heart endure, Which hopes from thee, and thee alone, a cure!

JOANNA BAILLIE

1762-1851

_510._ _The Outlaw’s Song_

The chough and crow to roost are gone, The owl sits on the tree, The hush’d wind wails with feeble moan, Like infant charity. The wild-fire dances on the fen, The red star sheds its ray; Uprouse ye then, my merry men! It is our op’ning day.

Both child and nurse are fast asleep, And closed is every flower, And winking tapers faintly peep High from my lady’s bower; Bewilder’d hinds with shorten’d ken Shrink on their murky way; Uprouse ye then, my merry men! It is our op’ning day.

Nor board nor garner own we now, Nor roof nor latchèd door, Nor kind mate, bound by holy vow To bless a good man’s store; Noon lulls us in a gloomy den, And night is grown our day; Uprouse ye then, my merry men! And use it as ye may.

MARY LAMB

1765-1847

_511._ _A Child_

A child’s a plaything for an hour; Its pretty tricks we try For that or for a longer space-- Then tire, and lay it by.

But I knew one that to itself All seasons could control; That would have mock’d the sense of pain Out of a grievèd soul.

Thou straggler into loving arms, Young climber-up of knees, When I forget thy thousand ways Then life and all shall cease.

CAROLINA, LADY NAIRNE

1766-1845

_512._ _The Land o’ the Leal_

I’m wearin’ awa’, John Like snaw-wreaths in thaw, John, I’m wearin’ awa’ To the land o’ the leal. There’s nae sorrow there, John, There’s neither cauld nor care, John, The day is aye fair In the land o’ the leal.

Our bonnie bairn’s there, John, She was baith gude and fair, John; And O! we grudged her sair To the land o’ the leal. But sorrow’s sel’ wears past, John, And joy’s a-coming fast, John, The joy that’s aye to last In the land o’ the leal.

Sae dear’s the joy was bought, John, Sae free the battle fought, John, That sinfu’ man e’er brought To the land o’ the leal. O, dry your glistening e’e, John! My saul langs to be free, John, And angels beckon me To the land o’ the leal.

O, haud ye leal and true, John! Your day it’s wearin’ through, John, And I’ll welcome you To the land o’ the leal. Now fare-ye-weel, my ain John, This warld’s cares are vain, John, We’ll meet, and we’ll be fain, In the land o’ the leal.

JAMES HOGG

1770-1835

_513._ _A Boy’s Song_

Where the pools are bright and deep, Where the grey trout lies asleep, Up the river and over the lea, That’s the way for Billy and me.

Where the blackbird sings the latest, Where the hawthorn blooms the sweetest, Where the nestlings chirp and flee, That’s the way for Billy and me.

Where the mowers mow the cleanest, Where the hay lies thick and greenest, There to track the homeward bee, That’s the way for Billy and me.

Where the hazel bank is steepest, Where the shadow falls the deepest, Where the clustering nuts fall free, That’s the way for Billy and me.

Why the boys should drive away Little sweet maidens from the play, Or love to banter and fight so well, That’s the thing I never could tell.

But this I know, I love to play Through the meadow, among the hay; Up the water and over the lea, That’s the way for Billy and me.

_514._ _Kilmeny_

Bonnie Kilmeny gaed up the glen; But it wasna to meet Duneira’s men, Nor the rosy monk of the isle to see, For Kilmeny was pure as pure could be. It was only to hear the yorlin sing, And pu’ the cress-flower round the spring; The scarlet hypp and the hindberrye, And the nut that hung frae the hazel tree; For Kilmeny was pure as pure could be. But lang may her minny look o’er the wa’, And lang may she seek i’ the green-wood shaw; Lang the laird o’ Duneira blame, And lang, lang greet or Kilmeny come hame!

_514._ yorlin] the yellow-hammer. hindberrye] bramble. minny] mother. greet] mourn.

When many a day had come and fled, When grief grew calm, and hope was dead, When mess for Kilmeny’s soul had been sung, When the bedesman had pray’d and the dead bell rung, Late, late in gloamin’ when all was still, When the fringe was red on the westlin hill, The wood was sere, the moon i’ the wane, The reek o’ the cot hung over the plain, Like a little wee cloud in the world its lane; When the ingle low’d wi’ an eiry leme, Late, late in the gloamin’ Kilmeny came hame!

‘Kilmeny, Kilmeny, where have you been? Lang hae we sought baith holt and den; By linn, by ford, and green-wood tree, Yet you are halesome and fair to see. Where gat you that joup o’ the lily scheen? That bonnie snood of the birk sae green? And these roses, the fairest that ever were seen? Kilmeny, Kilmeny, where have you been?’

Kilmeny look’d up with a lovely grace, But nae smile was seen on Kilmeny’s face; As still was her look, and as still was her e’e, As the stillness that lay on the emerant lea, Or the mist that sleeps on a waveless sea. For Kilmeny had been, she knew not where, And Kilmeny had seen what she could not declare; Kilmeny had been where the cock never crew, Where the rain never fell, and the wind never blew. But it seem’d as the harp of the sky had rung, And the airs of heaven play’d round her tongue,

westlin] western. its lane] alone, by itself. low’d] flamed. eiry leme] eery gleam. linn] waterfall. joup] mantle.

When she spake of the lovely forms she had seen, And a land where sin had never been; A land of love and a land of light, Withouten sun, or moon, or night; Where the river swa’d a living stream, And the light a pure celestial beam; The land of vision, it would seem, A still, an everlasting dream.

In yon green-wood there is a waik, And in that waik there is a wene, And in that wene there is a maike, That neither has flesh, blood, nor bane; And down in yon green-wood he walks his lane.

In that green wene Kilmeny lay, Her bosom happ'd wi' flowerets gay; But the air was soft and the silence deep, And bonnie Kilmeny fell sound asleep. She kenn'd nae mair, nor open'd her e'e, Till waked by the hymns of a far countrye.

She 'waken'd on a couch of the silk sae slim, All striped wi' the bars of the rainbow's rim; And lovely beings round were rife, Who erst had travell'd mortal life; And aye they smiled and 'gan to speer, 'What spirit has brought this mortal here?'--

'Lang have I journey'd, the world wide,' A meek and reverend fere replied; 'Baith night and day I have watch'd the fair, Eident a thousand years and mair.

swa'd] swelled. waik] a row of deep damp grass. wene]? whin, a furze-bush. maike] a mate, match, equal. his lane] alone, by himself. happ'd] covered. speer] inquire. fere] fellow. eident] unintermittently.

Yes, I have watch'd o'er ilk degree, Wherever blooms femenitye; But sinless virgin, free of stain In mind and body, fand I nane. Never, since the banquet of time, Found I a virgin in her prime. Till late this bonnie maiden I saw As spotless as the morning snaw: Full twenty years she has lived as free As the spirits that sojourn in this countrye: I have brought her away frae the snares of men, That sin or death she never may ken.'--

They clasp'd her waist and her hands sae fair, They kiss'd her cheek and they kemed her hair, And round came many a blooming fere, Saying, 'Bonnie Kilmeny, ye're welcome here! Women are freed of the littand scorn: O blest be the day Kilmeny was born! Now shall the land of the spirits see, Now shall it ken what a woman may be! Many a lang year, in sorrow and pain, Many a lang year through the world we've gane, Commission'd to watch fair womankind, For it's they who nurice the immortal mind. We have watch'd their steps as the dawning shone, And deep in the green-wood walks alone; By lily bower and silken bed, The viewless tears have o'er them shed; Have soothed their ardent minds to sleep, Or left the couch of love to weep.

kemed] combed.

We have seen! we have seen! but the time must come, And the angels will weep at the day of doom!

'O would the fairest of mortal kind Aye keep the holy truths in mind, That kindred spirits their motions see, Who watch their ways with anxious e'e, And grieve for the guilt of humanitye! O, sweet to Heaven the maiden's prayer, And the sigh that heaves a bosom sae fair! And dear to Heaven the words of truth, And the praise of virtue frae beauty's mouth! And dear to the viewless forms of air, The minds that kyth as the body fair!

'O bonnie Kilmeny! free frae stain, If ever you seek the world again, That world of sin, of sorrow and fear, O tell of the joys that are waiting here; And tell of the signs you shall shortly see; Of the times that are now, and the times that shall be.'-- They lifted Kilmeny, they led her away, And she walk'd in the light of a sunless day; The sky was a dome of crystal bright, The fountain of vision, and fountain of light: The emerald fields were of dazzling glow, And the flowers of everlasting blow. Then deep

in the stream her body they laid, That her youth and beauty never might fade; And they smiled on heaven, when they saw her lie In the stream of life that wander'd bye. And she heard a song, she heard it sung, She kenn'd not where; but sae sweetly it rung,

kyth] show, appear.

It fell on the ear like a dream of the morn: 'O, blest be the day Kilmeny was born! Now shall the land of the spirits see, Now shall it ken what a woman may be! The sun that shines on the world sae bright, A borrow'd gleid frae the fountain of light; And the moon that sleeks the sky sae dun, Like a gouden bow, or a beamless sun, Shall wear away, and be seen nae mair, And the angels shall miss them travelling the air. But lang, lang after baith night and day, When the sun and the world have elyed away; When the sinner has gane to his waesome doom, Kilmeny shall smile in eternal bloom!'--

They bore her away, she wist not how, For she felt not arm nor rest below; But so swift they wain'd her through the light, 'Twas like the motion of sound or sight; They seem'd to split the gales of air, And yet nor gale nor breeze was there. Unnumber'd groves below them grew, They came, they pass'd, and backward flew, Like floods of blossoms gliding on, In moment seen, in moment gone. O, never vales to mortal view Appear'd like those o'er which they flew! That land to human spirits given, The lowermost vales of the storied heaven; From thence they can view the world below, And heaven's blue gates with sapphires glow, More glory yet unmeet to know.

gleid] spark, glow. elyed] vanished.

They bore her far to a mountain green, To see what mortal never had seen; And they seated her high on a purple sward, And bade her heed what she saw and heard, And note the changes the spirits wrought, For now she lived in the land of thought. She look'd, and she saw nor sun nor skies, But a crystal dome of a thousand dyes: She look'd, and she saw nae land aright, But an endless whirl of glory and light: And radiant beings went and came, Far swifter than wind, or the linkèd flame. She hid her e'en frae the dazzling view; She look'd again, and the scene was new.

She saw a sun on a summer sky, And clouds of amber sailing bye; A lovely land beneath her lay, And that land had glens and mountains gray; And that land had valleys and hoary piles, And marlèd seas, and a thousand isles. Its fields were speckled, its forests green And its lakes were all of the dazzling sheen, Like magic mirrors, where slumbering lay The sun and the sky and the cloudlet gray; Which heaved and trembled, and gently swung, On every shore they seem'd to be hung; For there they were seen on their downward plain A thousand times and a thousand again; In winding lake and placid firth, Little peaceful heavens in the bosom of earth.

marlèd] variegated, parti-coloured.

Kilmeny sigh'd and seem'd to grieve, For she found her heart to that land did cleave; She saw the corn wave on the vale, She saw the deer run down the dale; She saw the plaid and the broad claymore, And the brows that the badge of freedom bore; And she thought she had seen the land before.

She saw a lady sit on a throne, The fairest that ever the sun shone on! A lion lick’d her hand of milk, And she held him in a leish of silk; And a leifu’ maiden stood at her knee, With a silver wand and melting e’e; Her sovereign shield till love stole in, And poison’d all the fount within.

Then a gruff untoward bedesman came, And hundit the lion on his dame; And the guardian maid wi’ the dauntless e’e, She dropp’d a tear, and left her knee; And she saw till the queen frae the lion fled, Till the bonniest flower of the world lay dead; A coffin was set on a distant plain, And she saw the red blood fall like rain; Then bonnie Kilmeny’s heart grew sair, And she turn’d away, and could look nae mair.

Then the gruff grim carle girn’d amain, And they trampled him down, but he rose again; And he baited the lion to deeds of weir, Till he lapp’d the blood to the kingdom dear;

leifu’] lone, wistful. girn’d] snarled. weir] war.

And weening his head was danger-preef, When crown’d with the rose and clover leaf, He gowl’d at the carle, and chased him away To feed wi’ the deer on the mountain gray. He gowl’d at the carle, and geck’d at Heaven, But his mark was set, and his arles given. Kilmeny a while her e’en withdrew; She look’d again, and the scene was new.

She saw before her fair unfurl’d One half of all the glowing world, Where oceans roll’d, and rivers ran, To bound the aims of sinful man. She saw a people, fierce and fell, Burst frae their bounds like fiends of hell; Their lilies grew, and the eagle flew; And she herkèd on her ravening crew, Till the cities and towers were wrapp’d in a blaze, And the thunder it roar’d o’er the lands and the seas. The widows they wail’d, and the red blood ran, And she threatened an end to the race of man; She never lened, nor stood in awe, Till caught by the lion’s deadly paw. O, then the eagle swink’d for life, And brainyell’d up a mortal strife; But flew she north, or flew she south, She met wi’ the gowl o’ the lion’s mouth.

With a mooted wing and waefu’ maen, The eagle sought her eiry again; But lang may she cower in her bloody nest, And lang, lang sleek her wounded breast,

gowl’d] howled. geck’d] mocked. arles] money paid on striking a bargain; fig. a beating. lened] crouched. swink’d] laboured. brainyell’d] stirred, beat. mooted] moulted.

Before she sey another flight, To play with the norland lion’s might.

But to sing the sights Kilmeny saw, So far surpassing nature’s law, The singer’s voice wad sink away, And the string of his harp wad cease to play. But she saw till the sorrows of man were bye, And all was love and harmony; Till the stars of heaven fell calmly away, Like flakes of snaw on a winter day.

Then Kilmeny begg’d again to see The friends she had left in her own countrye; To tell of the place where she had been, And the glories that lay in the land unseen; To warn the living maidens fair, The loved of Heaven, the spirits’ care, That all whose minds unmeled remain Shall bloom in beauty when time is gane.

With distant music, soft and deep, They lull’d Kilmeny sound asleep; And when she awaken’d, she lay her lane, All happ’d with flowers, in the green-wood wene. When seven lang years had come and fled, When grief was calm, and hope was dead; When scarce was remember’d Kilmeny’s name, Late, late in a gloamin’ Kilmeny came hame! And O, her beauty was fair to see, But still and steadfast was her e’e! Such beauty bard may never declare, For there was no pride nor passion there;

sey] essay. unmeled] unblemished. her lane] alone, by herself.

And the soft desire of maiden’s e’en In that mild face could never be seen. Her seymar was the lily flower, And her cheek the moss-rose in the shower; And her voice like the distant melodye, That floats along the twilight sea. But she loved to raike the lanely glen, And keepèd afar frae the haunts of men; Her holy hymns unheard to sing, To suck the flowers, and drink the spring. But wherever her peaceful form appear’d, The wild beasts of the hill were cheer’d; The wolf play’d blythly round the field, The lordly byson low’d and kneel’d; The dun deer woo’d with manner bland, And cower’d aneath her lily hand. And when at even the woodlands rung, When hymns of other worlds she sung In ecstasy of sweet devotion, O, then the glen was all in motion! The wild beasts of the forest came, Broke from their bughts and faulds the tame, And goved around, charm’d and amazed; Even the dull cattle croon’d and gazed, And murmur’d and look’d with anxious pain For something the mystery to explain. The buzzard came with the throstle-cock; The corby left her houf in the rock; The blackbird alang wi’ the eagle flew; The hind came tripping o’er the dew;

seymar]=cymar, a slight covering. raike] range, wander. bughts] milking-pens. goved] stared, gazed. corby] raven. houf] haunt.

The wolf and the kid their raike began, And the tod, and the lamb, and the leveret ran; The hawk and the hern attour them hung, And the merle and the mavis forhooy’d their young; And all in a peaceful ring were hurl’d; It was like an eve in a sinless world!

When a month and a day had come and gane, Kilmeny sought the green-wood wene; There laid her down on the leaves sae green, And Kilmeny on earth was never mair seen. But O, the words that fell from her mouth Were words of wonder, and words of truth! But all the land were in fear and dread, For they kendna whether she was living or dead. It wasna her hame, and she couldna remain; She left this world of sorrow and pain, And return’d to the land of thought again.

_514._ raike] ramble. tod] fox. attour] out over. forhooy’d] neglected.

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

1770-1850

Lucy

_515._ _i_

Strange fits of passion have I known: And I will dare to tell, But in the lover’s ear alone, What once to me befell.

When she I loved look’d every day Fresh as a rose in June, I to her cottage bent my way, Beneath an evening moon.

Upon the moon I fix’d my eye, All over the wide lea; With quickening pace my horse drew nigh Those paths so dear to me.

And now we reach’d the orchard-plot; And, as we climb’d the hill, The sinking moon to Lucy’s cot Came near and nearer still.

In one of those sweet dreams I slept, Kind Nature’s gentlest boon! And all the while my eyes I kept On the descending moon.

My horse moved on; hoof after hoof He raised, and never stopp’d: When down behind the cottage roof, At once, the bright moon dropp’d.

What fond and wayward thoughts will slide Into a lover’s head! ‘O mercy!’ to myself I cried, ‘If Lucy should be dead!’

_516._ _ii_

She dwelt among the untrodden ways Beside the springs of Dove, A Maid whom there were none to praise And very few to love:

A violet by a mossy stone Half hidden from the eye! Fair as a star, when only one Is shining in the sky.

She lived unknown, and few could know When Lucy ceased to be; But she is in her grave, and oh, The difference to me!

_517._ _iii_

I traveled among unknown men, In lands beyond the sea; Nor, England! did I know till then What love I bore to thee.

’Tis past, that melancholy dream! Nor will I quit thy shore A second time; for still I seem To love thee more and more.

Among thy mountains did I feel The joy of my desire; And she I cherish’d turn’d her wheel Beside an English fire.

Thy mornings show’d, thy nights conceal’d, The bowers where Lucy play’d; And thine too is the last green field That Lucy’s eyes survey’d.

_518._ _iv_

Three years she grew in sun and shower; Then Nature said, ‘A lovelier flower On earth was never sown; This child I to myself will take; She shall be mine, and I will make A lady of my own.

‘Myself will to my darling be Both law and impulse: and with me The girl, in rock and plain, In earth and heaven, in glade and bower, Shall feel an overseeing power To kindle or restrain.

‘She shall be sportive as the fawn That wild with glee across the lawn Or up the mountain springs; And hers shall be the breathing balm, And hers the silence and the calm Of mute insensate things.

‘The floating clouds their state shall lend To her; for her the willow bend; Nor shall she fail to see Even in the motions of the storm Grace that shall mould the maiden’s form By silent sympathy.

‘The stars of midnight shall be dear To her; and she shall lean her ear In many a secret place Where rivulets dance their wayward round, And beauty born of murmuring sound Shall pass into her face.

‘And vital feelings of delight Shall rear her form to stately height, Her virgin bosom swell; Such thoughts to Lucy I will give While she and I together live Here in this happy dell.’

Thus Nature spake--The work was done-- How soon my Lucy’s race was run! She died, and left to me This heath, this calm and quiet scene; The memory of what has been, And never more will be.

_519._ _v_

A slumber did my spirit seal; I had no human fears: She seem’d a thing that could not feel The touch of earthly years.

No motion has she now, no force; She neither hears nor sees; Roll’d round in earth’s diurnal course, With rocks, and stones, and trees.

_520._ _Upon Westminster Bridge_

Earth has not anything to show more fair: Dull would he be of soul who could pass by A sight so touching in its majesty: This City now doth like a garment wear The beauty of the morning; silent, bare, Ships, towers, domes, theatres, and temples lie Open unto the fields, and to the sky; All bright and glittering in the smokeless air. Never did sun more beautifully steep In his first splendour valley, rock, or hill; Ne’er saw I, never felt, a calm so deep! The river glideth at his own sweet will: Dear God! the very houses seem asleep; And all that mighty heart is lying still!

_521._ _Evening on Calais Beach_

It is a beauteous evening, calm and free, The holy time is quiet as a Nun Breathless with adoration; the broad sun Is sinking down in its tranquillity; The gentleness of heaven broods o’er the sea: Listen! the mighty Being is awake, And doth with his eternal motion make A sound like thunder--everlastingly. Dear Child! dear Girl! that walkest with me here, If thou appear untouch’d by solemn thought, Thy nature is not therefore less divine: Thou liest in Abraham’s bosom all the year; And worshipp’st at the Temple’s inner shrine, God being with thee when we know it not.

_522._ _On the Extinction of the Venetian Republic, 1802_

Once did she hold the gorgeous East in fee; And was the safeguard of the West: the worth Of Venice did not fall below her birth, Venice, the eldest Child of Liberty. She was a maiden City, bright and free; No guile seduced, no force could violate; And, when she took unto herself a mate, She must espouse the everlasting Sea. And what if she had seen those glories fade, Those titles vanish, and that strength decay; Yet shall some tribute of regret be paid When her long life hath reach’d its final day: Men

are we, and must grieve when even the Shade Of that which once was great is pass’d away.

England, 1802

_523._ _i_

O friend! I know not which way I must look For comfort, being, as I am, opprest, To think that now our life is only drest For show; mean handy-work of craftsman, cook, Or groom!--We must run glittering like a brook In the open sunshine, or we are unblest: The wealthiest man among us is the best: No grandeur now in nature or in book Delights us. Rapine, avarice, expense, This is idolatry; and these we adore: Plain living and high thinking are no more: The homely beauty of the good old cause Is gone; our peace, our fearful innocence, And pure religion breathing household laws.

_524._ _ii_

Milton! thou shouldst be living at this hour: England hath need of thee: she is a fen Of stagnant waters: altar, sword, and pen, Fireside, the heroic wealth of hall and bower, Have forfeited their ancient English dower Of inward happiness. We are selfish men; O raise us up, return to us again, And give us manners, virtue, freedom, power! Thy soul was like a Star, and dwelt apart; Thou hadst a voice whose sound was like the sea: Pure as the naked heavens, majestic, free, So didst thou travel on life’s common way, In cheerful godliness; and yet thy heart The lowliest duties on herself did lay.

_525._ _iii_

Great men have been among us; hands that penn’d And tongues that utter’d wisdom--better none: The later Sidney, Marvel, Harrington, Young Vane, and others who call’d Milton friend. These moralists could act and comprehend: They knew how genuine glory was put on; Taught us how rightfully a nation shone In splendour: what strength was, that would not bend But in magnanimous meekness. France, ’tis strange, Hath brought forth no such souls as we had then. Perpetual emptiness! unceasing change! No single volume paramount, no code, No master spirit, no determined road; But equally a want of books and men!

_526._ _iv_

It is not to be thought of that the flood Of British freedom, which, to the open sea Of the world’s praise, from dark antiquity Hath flow’d, ‘with pomp of waters, unwithstood,’-- Roused though it be full often to a mood Which spurns the check of salutary bands,-- That this most famous stream in bogs and sands Should perish; and to evil and to good Be lost for ever. In our halls is hung Armoury of the invincible Knights of old: We must be free or die, who speak the tongue That Shakespeare spake; the faith and morals hold Which Milton held.--In everything we are sprung Of Earth’s first blood, have titles manifold.

_527._ _v_

When I have borne in memory what has tamed Great Nations, how ennobling thoughts depart When men change swords for ledgers, and desert The student’s

bower for gold, some fears unnamed I had, my Country--am I to be blamed? Now, when I think of thee, and what thou art, Verily, in the bottom of my heart, Of those unfilial fears I am ashamed. For dearly must we prize thee; we who find In thee a bulwark for the cause of men; And I by my affection was beguiled: What wonder if a Poet now and then, Among the many movements of his mind, Felt for thee as a lover or a child!

_528._ _The Solitary Reaper_

Behold her, single in the field, Yon solitary Highland Lass! Reaping and singing by herself; Stop here, or gently pass! Alone she cuts and binds the grain, And sings a melancholy strain; O listen! for the Vale profound Is overflowing with the sound.

No Nightingale did ever chaunt More welcome notes to weary bands Of travellers in some shady haunt, Among Arabian sands:

A voice so thrilling ne'er was heard In spring-time from the Cuckoo-bird, Breaking the silence of the seas Among the farthest Hebrides.

Will no one tell me what she sings?-- Perhaps the plaintive numbers flow For old, unhappy, far-off things, And battles long ago: Or is it some more humble lay, Familiar matter of to-day? Some natural sorrow, loss, or pain, That has been, and may be again?

Whatever the theme, the Maiden sang As if her song could have no ending; I saw her singing at her work, And o'er the sickle bending;-- I listen'd, motionless and still; And, as I mounted up the hill, The music in my heart I bore, Long after it was heard no more.

_529._ _Perfect Woman_

She was a phantom of delight When first she gleam’d upon my sight; A lovely apparition, sent To be a moment’s ornament; Her eyes as stars of twilight fair; Like twilight’s, too, her dusky hair; But all things else about her drawn From May-time and the cheerful dawn; A dancing shape, an image gay, To haunt, to startle, and waylay.

I saw her upon nearer view, A Spirit, yet a Woman too! Her household motions light and free, And steps of virgin liberty; A countenance in which did meet Sweet records, promises as sweet; A creature not too bright or good For human nature’s daily food; For transient sorrows, simple wiles, Praise, blame, love, kisses, tears, and smiles.

And now I see with eye serene The very pulse of the machine; A being breathing thoughtful breath, A traveller between life and death; The reason firm, the temperate will, Endurance, foresight, strength, and skill; A perfect Woman, nobly plann’d, To warn, to comfort, and command; And yet a Spirit still, and bright With something of angelic light.

_530._ _Daffodils_

I wander’d lonely as a cloud That floats on high o’er vales and hills, When all at once I saw a crowd, A host, of golden daffodils; Beside the lake, beneath the trees,

Fluttering and dancing in the breeze.

Continuous as the stars that shine And twinkle on the Milky Way, They stretch’d in never-ending line Along the margin of a bay: Ten thousand saw I at a glance, Tossing their heads in sprightly dance.

The waves beside them danced, but they Out-did the sparkling waves in glee: A poet could not but be gay, In such a jocund company: I gazed--and gazed--but little thought What wealth the show to me had brought:

For oft, when on my couch I lie In vacant or in pensive mood, They flash upon that inward eye Which is the bliss of solitude; And then my heart with pleasure fills, And dances with the daffodils.

_531._ _Ode to Duty_

Stern Daughter of the Voice of God! O Duty! if that name thou love, Who art a light to guide, a rod To check the erring and reprove; Thou, who art victory and law When empty terrors overawe; From vain temptations dost set free; And calm’st the weary strife of frail humanity!

There are who ask not if thine eye Be on them; who, in love and truth, Where no misgiving is, rely Upon the genial sense of youth: Glad hearts! without reproach or blot; Who do thy work, and know it not: O, if through confidence misplaced They fail, thy saving arms, dread Power! around them cast.

Serene will be our days and bright, And happy will our nature be, When love is an unerring light, And joy its own security. And they a blissful course may hold Even now, who, not unwisely bold, Live in the spirit of this creed; Yet seek thy firm support, according to their need.

I, loving freedom, and untried; No sport of every random gust, Yet being to myself a guide, Too blindly have reposed my trust: And oft, when in my heart was heard Thy timely mandate, I deferr’d The task, in smoother walks to stray; But thee I now would serve more strictly, if I may.

Through no disturbance of my soul, Or strong compunction in me wrought, I supplicate for thy control; But in the quietness of thought. Me this uncharter’d freedom tires; I feel the weight of chance-desires; My hopes no more must change their name, I long for a repose that ever is the same.

Yet not the less would I throughout Still act according to the voice Of my own wish; and feel past doubt That my submissiveness was choice: Not seeking in the school of pride For ‘precepts over dignified,’ Denial and restraint I prize No farther than they breed a second Will more wise.

Stern Lawgiver! yet thou dost wear The Godhead’s most benignant grace; Nor know we anything so fair As is the smile upon thy face: Flowers laugh before thee on their beds, And fragrance in thy footing treads; Thou dost preserve the stars from wrong; And the most ancient heavens, through Thee, are fresh and strong.

To humbler functions, awful Power! I call thee: I myself commend Unto thy guidance from this hour; O, let my weakness have an end! Give unto me, made lowly wise, The spirit of self-sacrifice; The confidence of reason give; And in the light of truth thy bondman let me live!

_532._ _The Rainbow_

My heart leaps up when I behold A rainbow in the sky: So was it when my life began; So is it now I am a man; So be it when I shall grow old, Or let me die! The Child is father of the Man; And I could wish my days to be Bound each to each by natural piety.

The Sonnet

_533._ _i_

Nuns fret not at their convent’s narrow room, And hermits are contented with their cells, And students with their pensive citadels; Maids at the wheel, the weaver at his loom, Sit blithe and happy; bees that soar for bloom, High as the highest peak of Furness fells, Will murmur by the hour in foxglove bells: In truth the prison unto which we doom Ourselves no prison is: and hence for me, In sundry moods, ’twas pastime to be bound Within the Sonnet’s scanty plot of ground; Pleased if some souls (for such there needs must be) Who have felt the weight of too much liberty, Should find brief solace there, as I have found.

_534._ _ii_

Scorn not the Sonnet; Critic, you have frown'd, Mindless of its just honours; with this key Shakespeare unlock'd his heart; the melody Of this small lute gave ease to Petrarch's wound; A thousand times this pipe did Tasso sound; With it Camöens sooth'd an exile's grief; The Sonnet glitter'd a gay myrtle leaf Amid the cypress with which Dante crown'd His visionary brow: a glow-worm lamp, It cheer'd mild Spenser, call'd from Faery-land To struggle through dark ways; and when a damp Fell round the path of Milton, in his hand The Thing became a trumpet; whence he blew Soul-animating strains--alas, too few!

_535._ _The World_

The world is too much with us; late and soon, Getting and spending, we lay waste our powers: Little we see in Nature that is ours; We have given our hearts away, a sordid boon! This sea that bares her bosom to the moon; The winds that will be howling at all hours, And are up-gather’d now like sleeping flowers; For this, for everything, we are out of tune; It moves us not.--Great God! I’d rather be A Pagan suckled in a creed outworn; So might I, standing on this pleasant lea, Have glimpses that would make me less forlorn; Have sight of Proteus rising from the sea; Or hear old Triton blow his wreathèd horn.

_536._ _Ode_

Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Early Childhood

There was a time when meadow, grove, and stream, The earth, and every common sight, To me did seem Apparell’d in celestial light, The glory and the freshness of a dream, It is not now as it hath been of yore;-- Turn wheresoe’er I may, By night or day, The things which I have seen I now can see no more. The rainbow comes and goes, And lovely is the rose; The moon doth with delight Look round her when the heavens are bare; Waters on a starry night Are beautiful and fair; The sunshine is a glorious birth; But yet I know, where’er I go, That there hath pass’d away a glory from the earth.

Now, while the birds thus sing a joyous song, And while the young lambs bound As to the tabor’s sound, To me alone there came a thought of grief: A timely utterance gave that thought relief, And I again am strong: The cataracts blow their trumpets from the steep; No more shall grief of mine the season wrong; I hear the echoes through the mountains throng, The winds come to me from the fields of sleep, And all the earth is gay; Land and sea Give themselves up to jollity, And with the heart of May Doth every beast keep holiday;-- Thou Child of Joy, Shout round me, let me hear thy shouts, thou happy Shepherd-boy!

Ye blessèd creatures, I have heard the call Ye to each other make; I see The heavens laugh with you in your jubilee; My heart is at your festival, My head hath its coronal, The fullness of your bliss, I feel--I feel it all. O evil day! if I were sullen While Earth herself is adorning, This sweet May-morning, And the children are culling On every side, In a thousand valleys far and wide, Fresh flowers; while the sun shines warm, And the babe leaps up on his mother’s arm:-- I hear, I hear, with joy I hear! --But there’s a tree, of many, one, A single field which I have look’d upon, Both of them speak of something that is gone: The pansy at my feet Doth the same tale repeat: Whither is fled the visionary gleam? Where is it now, the glory and the dream?

Our birth is but a sleep and a forgetting: The Soul that rises with us, our life’s Star, Hath had elsewhere its setting, And cometh from afar: Not in entire forgetfulness, And not in utter nakedness, But trailing clouds of glory do we come From God, who is our home: Heaven lies about us in our infancy! Shades of the prison-house begin to close Upon the growing Boy, But he beholds the light, and whence it flows, He sees it in his joy; The Youth, who daily farther from the east Must travel, still is Nature’s priest, And by the vision splendid Is on his way attended; At length the Man perceives it die away, And fade into the light of common day.

Earth fills her lap with pleasures of her own; Yearnings she hath in her own natural kind, And, even with something of a mother’s mind, And no unworthy aim, The homely nurse doth all she can To make her foster-child, her inmate Man, Forget the glories he hath known, And that imperial palace whence he came.

Behold the Child among his new-born blisses, A six years’ darling of a pigmy size! See, where ’mid work of his own hand he lies, Fretted by sallies of his mother’s kisses, With light upon him from his father’s eyes! See, at his feet, some little plan or chart, Some fragment from his dream of human life, Shaped by himself with newly-learnèd art; A wedding or a festival, A mourning or a funeral; And this hath

now his heart, And unto this he frames his song: Then will he fit his tongue To dialogues of business, love, or strife; But it will not be long Ere this be thrown aside, And with new joy and pride The little actor cons another part; Filling from time to time his ‘humorous stage’ With all the Persons, down to palsied Age, That Life brings with her in her equipage; As if his whole vocation Were endless imitation.

Thou, whose exterior semblance doth belie Thy soul’s immensity; Thou best philosopher, who yet dost keep Thy heritage, thou eye among the blind, That, deaf and silent, read’st the eternal deep, Haunted for ever by the eternal mind,-- Mighty prophet! Seer blest! On whom those truths do rest, Which we are toiling all our lives to find, In darkness lost, the darkness of the grave; Thou, over whom thy Immortality Broods like the Day, a master o’er a slave, A presence which is not to be put by; To whom the grave Is but a lonely bed without the sense or sight Of day or the warm light, A place of thought where we in waiting lie; Thou little Child, yet glorious in the might Of heaven-born freedom on thy being’s height, Why with such earnest pains dost thou provoke The years to bring the inevitable yoke, Thus blindly with thy blessedness at strife? Full soon thy soul shall have her earthly freight, And custom lie upon thee with a weight, Heavy as frost, and deep almost as life! O joy! that in our embers Is something that doth live, That nature yet remembers What was so fugitive! The thought of our past years in me doth breed Perpetual benediction: not indeed For that which is most worthy to be blest-- Delight and liberty, the simple creed Of childhood, whether busy or at rest, With new-fledged hope still fluttering in his breast:-- Not for these I raise The song of thanks and praise; But for those obstinate questionings Of sense and outward things, Fallings from us, vanishings; Blank misgivings of a Creature Moving about in worlds not realized, High instincts before which our mortal Nature Did tremble like a guilty thing surprised: But for those first affections, Those shadowy recollections, Which, be they what they may, Are yet the fountain-light of all our day, Are yet a master-light of all our seeing; Uphold us, cherish, and have power to make Our noisy years seem moments in the being Of the eternal Silence: truths that wake, To perish never: Which neither listlessness, nor mad endeavour, Nor Man nor Boy, Nor all that is at enmity with joy, Can utterly abolish or destroy! Hence in a season of calm weather Though inland far we be, Our souls have sight of that immortal sea Which brought us hither, Can in a moment travel thither, And see the children sport upon the shore, And hear the mighty waters rolling evermore.

Then sing, ye birds, sing, sing a joyous song! And let the young lambs bound As to the tabor’s sound! We in thought will join your throng, Ye that pipe and ye that play, Ye that through your hearts to-day Feel the gladness of the May! What though the radiance which was once so bright Be now for ever taken from my sight, Though nothing can bring back the hour Of splendour in the grass, of glory in the flower; We will grieve not, rather find Strength in what remains behind; In the primal sympathy Which having been must ever be; In the soothing thoughts that spring Out of human suffering; In the faith that looks through death, In years that bring the philosophic mind.

And O ye Fountains, Meadows, Hills, and Groves, Forebode not any severing of our loves! Yet in my heart of hearts I feel your might; I only have relinquished one delight To live beneath your more habitual sway. I love the brooks which down their channels fret, Even more than when I tripp’d lightly as they; The innocent brightness of a new-born Day Is lovely yet; The clouds that gather round the setting sun Do take a sober colouring from an eye That hath kept watch o’er man’s mortality; Another race hath been, and other palms are won. Thanks to the human heart by which we live, Thanks to its tenderness, its joys, and fears, To me the meanest flower that blows can give Thoughts that do often lie too deep for tears.

_537._ _Desideria_

Surprised by joy--impatient as the Wind I turned to share the transport--O! with whom But Thee, deep buried in the silent tomb, That spot which no vicissitude can find? Love, faithful love, recall'd thee to my mind-- But how could I forget thee? Through what power, Even for the least division of an hour, Have I been so beguiled as to be blind To my most grievous loss?--That thought's return Was the worst pang that sorrow ever bore, Save one, one only, when I stood forlorn, Knowing my heart's best treasure was no more; That neither present time, nor years unborn Could to my sight that heavenly face restore.

_538._ _Valedictory Sonnet to the River Duddon_

I thought of Thee, my partner and my guide, As being pass’d away.--Vain sympathies! For, backward, Duddon! as I cast my eyes, I see what was, and is, and will abide; Still glides the Stream, and shall for ever glide; The Form remains, the Function never dies; While we, the brave, the mighty, and the wise, We Men, who in our morn of youth defied The elements, must vanish;--be it so! Enough, if something from our hands have power To live, and act, and serve the future hour; And if, as toward the silent tomb we go, Through love, through hope, and faith’s transcendent dower, We feel that we are greater than we know.

_539._ _Mutability_

From low to high doth dissolution climb, And sink from high to low, along a scale Of awful notes, whose concord shall not fail; A musical but melancholy chime, Which they can hear who meddle not with crime. Nor avarice, nor over-anxious care. Truth fails not; but her outward forms that bear The longest date do melt like frosty rime, That in the morning whiten’d hill and plain And is no more; drop like the tower sublime Of yesterday, which royally did wear His crown of weeds, but could not even sustain Some casual shout that broke the silent air, Or the unimaginable touch of Time.

_540._ _The Trosachs_

There’s not a nook within this solemn Pass But were an apt confessional for one Taught by his summer spent, his autumn gone, That Life is but a tale of morning grass Wither’d at eve. From scenes of art which chase That thought away, turn, and with watchful eyes Feed it ’mid Nature’s old felicities, Rocks, rivers, and smooth lakes more clear than glass Untouch’d, unbreathed upon. Thrice happy quest, If from

a golden perch of aspen spray (October’s workmanship to rival May) The pensive warbler of the ruddy breast That moral sweeten by a heaven-taught lay, Lulling the year, with all its cares, to rest!

_541._ _Speak!_

Why art thou silent! Is thy love a plant Of such weak fibre that the treacherous air Of absence withers what was once so fair? Is there no debt to pay, no boon to grant? Yet have my thoughts for thee been vigilant-- Bound to thy service with unceasing care, The mind’s least generous wish a mendicant For naught but what thy happiness could spare. Speak--though this soft warm heart, once free to hold A thousand tender pleasures, thine and mine, Be left more desolate, more dreary cold Than a forsaken bird’s-nest fill’d with snow ’Mid its own bush of leafless eglantine-- Speak, that my torturing doubts their end may know!

SIR WALTER SCOTT

1771-1832

_542._ _Proud Maisie_

Proud Maisie is in the wood, Walking so early; Sweet Robin sits on the bush, Singing so rarely.

‘Tell me, thou bonny bird, When shall I marry me?’ --‘When six braw gentlemen Kirkward shall carry ye.’

‘Who makes the bridal bed, Birdie, say truly?’ --‘The grey-headed sexton That delves the grave duly.

‘The glow-worm o’er grave and stone Shall light thee steady; The owl from the steeple sing Welcome, proud lady!’

_543._ _Brignall Banks_

O Brignall banks are wild and fair, And Greta woods are green, And you may gather garlands there, Would grace a summer queen: And as I rode by Dalton Hall, Beneath the turrets high, A Maiden on the castle wall Was singing merrily:--

‘O, Brignall banks are fresh and fair, And Greta woods are green! I’d rather rove with Edmund there Than reign our English Queen.’

‘If, Maiden, thou wouldst wend with me To leave both tower and town, Thou first must guess what life lead we, That dwell by dale and down: And if thou canst that riddle read, As read full well you may, Then to the green-wood shalt thou speed As blithe as Queen of May.’

Yet sung she, ‘Brignall banks are fair, And Greta woods are green! I’d rather rove with Edmund there Than reign our English Queen.

‘I read you by your bugle horn And by your palfrey good, I read you for a Ranger sworn To keep the King’s green-wood.’ ‘A Ranger, Lady, winds his horn, And ’tis at peep of light; His blast is heard at merry morn, And mine at dead of night.’

Yet sung she, ‘Brignall banks are fair, And Greta woods are gay! I would I were with Edmund there, To reign his Queen of May!

‘With burnish’d brand and musketoon So gallantly you come, I read you for a bold Dragoon, That lists the tuck of drum.’ ‘I list no more the tuck of drum, No more the trumpet hear; But when the beetle sounds his hum, My comrades take the spear.

‘And O! though Brignall banks be fair, And Greta woods be gay, Yet mickle must the maiden dare, Would reign my Queen of May!

‘Maiden! a nameless life I lead, A nameless death I’ll die; The fiend whose lantern lights the mead Were better mate than I! And when I’m with my comrades met Beneath the green-wood bough, What once we were we all forget, Nor think what we are now.’

Chorus. Yet Brignall banks are fresh and fair, And Greta woods are green, And you may gather flowers there Would grace a summer queen.

_544._ _Lucy Ashton’s Song_

Look not thou on beauty’s charming; Sit thou still when kings are arming; Taste not when the wine-cup glistens; Speak not when the people listens; Stop thine ear against the singer; From the red gold keep thy finger; Vacant heart and hand and eye, Easy live and quiet die.

_545._ _Answer_

Sound, sound the clarion, fill the fife! To all the sensual world proclaim, One crowded hour of glorious life Is worth an age without a name.

_546._ _The Rover’s Adieu_

A weary lot is thine, fair maid, A weary lot is thine! To pull the thorn thy brow to braid, And press the rue for wine. A lightsome eye, a soldier’s mien, A feather of the blue, A doublet of the Lincoln green-- No more of me ye knew, My Love! No more of me ye knew.

‘This morn is merry June, I trow, The rose is budding fain; But she shall bloom in winter snow Ere we two meet again.’ --He turn’d his charger as he spake Upon the river shore, He gave the bridle-reins a shake, Said ‘Adieu for evermore, My Love! And adieu for evermore.’

Patriotism

_547._ _1. Innominatus_

Breathes there the man with soul so dead, Who never to himself hath said, ‘This is my own, my native land!’ Whose heart hath ne’er within him burn’d As home his footsteps he hath turn’d From wandering on a foreign strand? If such there breathe, go, mark him well; For him no Minstrel raptures swell; High though his titles, proud his name, Boundless his wealth as wish can claim; Despite those titles, power, and pelf, The wretch, concentred all in self, Living, shall forfeit fair renown, And, doubly dying, shall go down To the vile dust from whence he sprung, Unwept, unhonour’d,

and unsung.

_548._ _2. Nelson, Pitt, Fox_

To mute and to material things New life revolving summer brings; The genial call dead Nature hears, And in her glory reappears. But oh, my Country’s wintry state What second spring shall renovate? What powerful call shall bid arise The buried warlike and the wise; The mind that thought for Britain’s weal, The hand that grasp’d the victor steel? The vernal sun new life bestows Even on the meanest flower that blows; But vainly, vainly may he shine Where glory weeps o’er NELSON’S shrine; And vainly pierce the solemn gloom That shrouds, O PITT, thy hallow’d tomb!

Deep graved in every British heart, O never let those names depart! Say to your sons,--Lo, here his grave, Who victor died on Gadite wave! To him, as to the burning levin, Short, bright, resistless course was given. Where’er his country’s foes were found Was heard the fated thunder’s sound, Till burst the bolt on yonder shore, Roll’d, blazed, destroy’d--and was no more.

Nor mourn ye less his perish’d worth, Who bade the conqueror go forth, And launch’d that thunderbolt of war On Egypt, Hafnia, Trafalgar; Who, born to guide such high emprise, For Britain’s weal was early wise; Alas! to whom the Almighty gave, For Britain’s sins, an early grave! --His worth, who in his mightiest hour A bauble held the pride of power, Spurn’d at the sordid lust of pelf, And served his Albion for herself; Who, when the frantic crowd amain Strain’d at subjection’s bursting rein, O’er their wild mood full conquest gain’d, The pride he would not crush, restrain’d, Show’d their fierce zeal a worthier cause, And brought the freeman’s arm to aid the freeman’s laws.

Hadst thou but lived, though stripp’d of power, A watchman on the lonely tower, Thy thrilling trump had roused the land, When fraud or danger were at hand; By thee, as by the beacon-light, Our pilots had kept course aright; As some proud column, though alone, Thy strength had propp’d the tottering throne. Now is the stately column broke, The beacon-light is quench’d in smoke, The trumpet’s silver voice is still, The warder silent on the hill!

O think, how to his latest day, When Death, just hovering, claim’d his prey. With Palinure’s unalter’d mood Firm at his dangerous post he stood; Each call for needful rest repell’d, With dying hand the rudder held, Till in his fall with fateful sway The steerage of the realm gave way. Then--while on Britain’s thousand plains One unpolluted church remains, Whose peaceful bells ne’er sent around The bloody tocsin’s maddening sound, But still upon the hallow’d day Convoke the swains to praise and pray; While faith and civil peace are dear, Grace this cold marble with a tear:-- He who preserved them, PITT, lies here!

Nor yet suppress the generous sigh, Because his rival slumbers nigh; Nor be thy _Requiescat_ dumb Lest it be said o’er Fox’s tomb. For talents mourn, untimely lost, When best employ’d, and wanted most; Mourn genius high, and lore profound, And wit that loved to play, not wound; And all the reasoning powers divine To penetrate, resolve, combine; And feelings keen, and fancy’s glow-- They sleep with him who sleeps below: And, if thou mourn’st they could not save From error him who owns this

grave, Be every harsher thought suppress’d, And sacred be the last long rest. _Here_, where the end of earthly things Lays heroes, patriots, bards, and kings; Where stiff the hand, and still the tongue, Of those who fought, and spoke, and sung; _Here_, where the fretted vaults prolong The distant notes of holy song, As if some angel spoke agen, ‘All peace on earth, good-will to men’; If ever from an English heart, O, _here_ let prejudice depart, And, partial feeling cast aside, Record that Fox a Briton died! When Europe crouch’d to France’s yoke, And Austria bent, and Prussia broke, And the firm Russian’s purpose brave Was bartered by a timorous slave-- Even then dishonour’s peace he spurn’d, The sullied olive-branch return’d, Stood for his country’s glory fast, And nail’d her colours to the mast! Heaven, to reward his firmness, gave A portion in this honour’d grave; And ne’er held marble in its trust Of two such wondrous men the dust.

With more than mortal powers endow’d, How high they soar’d above the crowd! Theirs was no common party race, Jostling by dark intrigue for place; Like fabled gods, their mighty war Shook realms and nations in its jar; Beneath each banner proud to stand, Look’d up the noblest of the land, Till through the British world were known The names of PITT and FOX alone. Spells of such force no wizard grave E’er framed in dark Thessalian cave, Though his could drain the ocean dry, And force the planets from the sky. These spells are spent, and, spent with these, The wine of life is on the lees. Genius, and taste, and talent gone, For ever tomb’d beneath the stone, Where--taming thought to human pride!-- The mighty chiefs sleep side by side. Drop upon Fox’s grave the tear, ’Twill trickle to his rival’s bier; O’er PITT’s the mournful requiem sound, And FOX’s shall the notes rebound. The solemn echo seems to cry, ‘Here let their discord with them die. Speak not for those a separate doom Whom fate made Brothers in the tomb; But search the land of living men, Where wilt thou find their like agen?’

SAMUEL TAYLOR COLERIDGE

1772-1834

_549._ _The Rime of the Ancient Mariner_

PART I

[Sidenote: An ancient Mariner meeteth three gallants bidden to a wedding feast, and detaineth one.]

It is an ancient Mariner, And he stoppeth one of three. ‘By thy long grey beard and glittering eye, Now wherefore stopp’st thou me?

The Bridegroom’s doors are open’d wide, And I am next of kin; The guests are met, the feast is set: May’st hear the merry din.’

He holds him with his skinny hand, ‘There was a ship,’ quoth he. ‘Hold off! unhand me, grey-beard loon!’ Eftsoons his hand dropt he.

[Sidenote: The Wedding-Guest is spellbound by the eye of the old seafaring man, and constrained to hear his tale.]

He holds him with his glittering eye-- The Wedding-Guest stood still, And listens like a three years' child: The Mariner hath his will.

The Wedding-Guest sat on a stone: He cannot choose but hear; And thus spake on that ancient man, The bright-eyed Mariner.

'The ship was cheer'd, the harbour clear'd, Merrily did we drop Below the kirk, below the hill, Below the lighthouse top.

[Sidenote: The Mariner tells how the ship sailed southward with a good wind and fair weather, till it reached the Line.]

The Sun came up upon the left, Out of the sea came he! And he shone bright, and on the right Went down into the sea.

Higher and higher every day, Till over the mast at noon----' The Wedding-Guest here beat his breast, For he heard the loud bassoon.

[Sidenote: The Wedding Guest heareth the bridal music; but the Mariner continueth his tale.]

The bride hath paced into the hall, Red as a rose is she; Nodding their heads before her goes The merry minstrelsy.

The Wedding-Guest he beat his breast, Yet he cannot choose but hear; And thus spake on that ancient man, The bright-eyed Mariner.

[Sidenote: The ship drawn by a storm toward the South Pole.]

'And now the Storm-blast came, and he Was tyrannous and strong: He struck with his o'ertaking wings, And chased us south along.

With sloping masts and dipping prow, As who pursued with yell and blow Still treads the shadow of his foe, And forward bends his head, The ship drove fast, loud roar'd the blast, And southward aye we fled.

And now there came both mist and snow, And it grew wondrous cold: And ice, mast-high, came floating by, As green as emerald.

[Sidenote: The land of ice, and of fearful sounds, where no living thing was to be seen.]

And through the drifts the snowy clifts Did send a dismal sheen: Nor shapes of men nor beasts we ken-- The ice was all between.

The ice was here, the ice was there, The ice was all around: It crack'd and growl'd, and roar'd and howl'd, Like noises in a swound!

[Sidenote: Till a great sea-bird, called the Albatross, came through the snow-fog, and was received with great joy and hospitality.]

At length did cross an Albatross, Thorough the fog it came; As if it had been a Christian soul, We hail'd it in God's name.

It ate the food it ne’er had eat, And round and round it flew. The ice did split with a thunder-fit; The helmsman steer’d us through!

[Sidenote: And lo! the Albatross proveth a bird of good omen, and followeth the ship as it returned northward through fog and floating ice.]

And a good south wind sprung up behind; The Albatross did follow, And every day, for food or play, Came to the mariners’ hollo!

In mist or cloud, on mast or shroud, It perch’d for vespers nine; Whiles all the night, through fog-smoke white, Glimmer’d the white moonshine.’

[Sidenote: The ancient Mariner inhospitably killeth the pious bird of good omen.]

‘God save thee, ancient Mariner, From the fiends, that plague thee thus!-- Why look’st thou so?’--‘With my crossbow I shot the Albatross.

PART II

‘The Sun now rose upon the right: Out of the sea came he, Still hid in mist, and on the left Went down into the sea.

And the good south wind still blew behind, But no sweet bird did follow, Nor any day for food or play Came to the mariners’ hollo!

[Sidenote: His shipmates cry out against the ancient Mariner for killing the bird of good luck.]

And I had done a hellish thing, And it would work ’em woe: For all averr’d I had kill’d the bird That made the breeze to blow. Ah wretch! said they, the bird to slay, That made the breeze to blow!

[Sidenote: But when the fog cleared off, they justify the same, and thus make themselves accomplices in the crime.]

Nor dim nor red, like God’s own head, The glorious Sun uprist: Then all averr’d I had kill’d the bird That brought the fog and mist. ’Twas right, said they, such birds to slay, That bring the fog and mist.

[Sidenote: The fair breeze continues; the ship enters the Pacific Ocean, and sails northward, even till it reaches the Line.]

The fair breeze blew, the white foam flew, The furrow follow’d free; We were the first that ever burst Into that silent sea.

[Sidenote: The ship hath been suddenly becalmed.]

Down dropt the breeze, the sails dropt down, ’Twas sad as sad could be; And we did speak only to break The silence of the sea!

All in a hot and copper sky, The bloody Sun, at noon, Right up above the mast did stand, No bigger than the Moon.

Day after day, day after day, We stuck, nor breath nor motion; As idle as a painted ship Upon a painted ocean.

[Sidenote: And the Albatross begins to be avenged.]

Water, water, everywhere, And all the boards did shrink; Water, water, everywhere, Nor any drop to drink.

The very deep did rot: O Christ! That ever this should be! Yea, slimy things did crawl with legs Upon the slimy sea.

About, about, in reel and rout The death-fires danced at night; The water, like a witch's oils, Burnt green, and blue, and white.

[Sidenote: A Spirit had followed them, one of the invisible inhabitants of this planet, neither departed souls nor angels; concerning whom the learned Jew, Josephus, and the Platonic Constantinopolitan, Michael Psellus, may be consulted. They are very numerous, and there is no climate or element without one or more.]

And some in dreams assurèd were Or the Spirit that plagued us so; Nine fathom deep he had follow'd us From the land of mist and snow.

And every tongue, through utter drought, Was wither'd at the root; We could not speak, no more than if We had been choked with soot.

[Sidenote: The shipmates in their sore distress, would fain throw the whole guilt on the ancient Mariner: in sign whereof they hang the dead sea-bird round his neck.]

Ah! well a-day! what evil looks Had I from old and young! Instead of the cross, the Albatross About my neck was hung.

PART III

[Sidenote: The ancient Mariner beholdeth a sign in the element afar off.]

'There passed a weary time. Each throat Was parch'd, and glazed each eye. A weary time! a weary time! How glazed each weary eye! When looking westward, I beheld A something in the sky.

At first it seem'd a little speck, And then it seem'd a mist; It moved and moved, and took at last A certain shape, I wist.

A speck, a mist, a shape, I wist! And still it near'd and near'd: As if it dodged a water-sprite, It plunged, and tack'd, and veer'd.

[Sidenote: At its nearer approach, it seemeth him to be a ship; and at a dear ransom he freeth his speech from the bonds of thirst.]

With throats unslaked, with black lips baked, We could nor laugh nor wail; Through utter drought all dumb we stood! I bit my arm, I suck'd the blood, And cried, A sail! a sail!

[Sidenote: A flash of joy;]

With throats unslaked, with black lips baked, Agape they heard me call: Gramercy! they for joy did grin, And all at once their breath drew in, As they were drinking all.

[Sidenote: And horror follows. For can it be a ship that comes onward without wind or tide?]

See! see! (I cried) she tacks no more! Hither to work us weal-- Without a breeze, without a tide, She steadies with upright keel!

The western wave was all aflame, The day was wellnigh done! Almost upon the western wave Rested the broad, bright Sun; When that strange shape drove suddenly Betwixt us and the Sun.

[Sidenote: It seemeth him but the skeleton of a ship.]

And straight the Sun was fleck'd with bars (Heaven's Mother send us grace!), As if through a dungeon-grate he peer'd With broad and burning face.

Alas! (thought I, and my heart beat loud) How fast she nears and nears! Are those her sails that glance in the Sun, Like restless gossameres?

[Sidenote: And its ribs are seen as bars on the face of the setting Sun. The Spectre-Woman and her Death-mate, and no other, on board the skeleton ship. Like vessel, like crew!]

Are those her ribs through which the Sun Did peer, as through a grate? And is that Woman all her crew? Is that a Death? and are there two? Is Death that Woman's mate?

Her lips were red, her looks were free, Her locks were yellow as gold: Her skin was as white as leprosy, The Nightmare Life-in-Death was she, Who thicks man's blood with cold.

[Sidenote: Death and Life-in-Death have diced for the ship's crew, and she (the latter) winneth the ancient Mariner.]

The naked hulk alongside came, And the twain were casting dice; "The game is done! I've won! I've won!" Quoth she, and whistles thrice.

[Sidenote: No twilight within the courts of the Sun.]

The Sun's rim dips; the stars rush out: At one stride comes the dark; With far-heard whisper, o'er the sea, Off shot the spectre-bark.

[Sidenote: At the rising of the Moon,]

We listen'd and look'd sideways up! Fear at my heart, as at a cup, My life-blood seem'd to sip! The stars were dim, and thick the night, The steersman's face by his lamp gleam'd white; From the sails the dew did drip-- Till clomb above the eastern bar The hornèd Moon, with one bright star Within the nether tip.

[Sidenote: One after another,]

One after one, by the star-dogg'd Moon, Too quick for groan or sigh, Each turn'd his face with a ghastly pang, And cursed me with his eye.

[Sidenote: His shipmates drop down dead.]

Four times fifty living men (And I heard nor sigh nor groan), With heavy thump, a lifeless lump, They dropp’d down one by one.

[Sidenote: But Life-in-Death begins her work on the ancient Mariner.]

The souls did from their bodies fly-- They fled to bliss or woe! And every soul, it pass’d me by Like the whizz of my crossbow!’

PART IV

[Sidenote: The Wedding-Guest feareth that a spirit is talking to him.]

‘I fear thee, ancient Mariner! I fear thy skinny hand! And thou art long, and lank, and brown, As is the ribb’d sea-sand.

[Sidenote: But the ancient Mariner assureth him of his bodily life, and proceedeth to relate his horrible penance.]

I fear thee and thy glittering eye, And thy skinny hand so brown.’-- ‘Fear not, fear not, thou Wedding-Guest! This body dropt not down.

Alone, alone, all, all alone, Alone on a wide, wide sea! And never a saint took pity on My soul in agony.

[Sidenote: He despiseth the creatures of the calm.]

The many men, so beautiful! And they all dead did lie: And a thousand thousand slimy things Lived on; and so did I.

[Sidenote: And envieth that they should live, and so many lie dead.]

I look’d upon the rotting sea, And drew my eyes away; I look’d upon the rotting deck, And there the dead men lay.

I look’d to heaven, and tried to pray; But or ever a prayer had gusht, A wicked whisper came, and made My heart as dry as dust.

I closed my lids, and kept them close, And the balls like pulses beat; But the sky and the sea, and the sea and the sky, Lay like a load on my weary eye, And the dead were at my feet.

[Sidenote: But the curse liveth for him in the eye of the dead men.]

The cold sweat melted from their limbs, Nor rot nor reek did they: The look with which they look’d on me Had never pass’d away.

An orphan’s curse would drag to hell A spirit from on high; But oh! more horrible than that Is the curse in a dead man’s eye! Seven days, seven nights, I saw that curse, And yet I could not die.

[Sidenote: In his loneliness and fixedness he yearneth towards the Moon, and the stars that still sojourn, yet still move onward; and everywhere the blue sky belongs to them, and is their appointed rest and their native country and their own natural

homes, which they enter unannounced, as lords that are certainly expected, and yet there is a silent joy at their arrival.]

The moving Moon went up the sky, And nowhere did abide; Softly she was going up, And a star or two beside--

Her beams bemock'd the sultry main, Like April hoar-frost spread; But where the ship's huge shadow lay, The charmèd water burnt alway A still and awful red.

[Sidenote: By the light of the Moon he beholdeth God's creatures of the great calm.]

Beyond the shadow of the ship, I watch'd the water-snakes: They moved in tracks of shining white, And when they rear'd, the elfish light Fell off in hoary flakes.

Within the shadow of the ship I watch'd their rich attire: Blue, glossy green, and velvet black, They coil'd and swam; and every track Was a flash of golden fire.

[Sidenote: Their beauty and their happiness.]

[Sidenote: He blesseth them in his heart.]

O happy living things! no tongue Their beauty might declare: A spring of love gush'd from my heart, And I bless'd them unaware: Sure my kind saint took pity on me, And I bless'd them unaware.

[Sidenote: The spell begins to break.]

The selfsame moment I could pray; And from my neck so free The Albatross fell off, and sank Like lead into the sea.

PART V

'O sleep! it is a gentle thing, Beloved from pole to pole! To Mary Queen the praise be given! She sent the gentle sleep from Heaven, That slid into my soul.

[Sidenote: By grace of the holy Mother, the ancient Mariner is refreshed with rain.]

The silly buckets on the deck, That had so long remain'd, I dreamt that they were fill'd with dew; And when I awoke, it rain'd.

My lips were wet, my throat was cold, My garments all were dank; Sure I had drunken in my dreams, And still my body drank.

I moved, and could not feel my limbs: I was so light--almost I thought that I had died in sleep, And was a blessèd ghost.

[Sidenote: He heareth sounds and seeth strange sights and commotions in the sky and the element.]

And soon I heard a roaring wind: It did not come anear; But with its sound it shook the sails, That were so thin and sere.

The upper air burst into life; And a hundred fire-flags sheen; To and fro they were hurried about! And to and fro, and in and out, The wan stars danced between.

And the coming wind did roar more loud. And the sails did sigh like sedge; And the rain pour’d down from one black cloud; The Moon was at its edge.

The thick black cloud was cleft, and still The Moon was at its side; Like waters shot from some high crag, The lightning fell with never a jag, A river steep and wide.

[Sidenote: The bodies of the ship’s crew are inspired, and the ship moves on;]

The loud wind never reached the ship, Yet now the ship moved on! Beneath the lightning and the Moon The dead men gave a groan.

They groan’d, they stirr’d, they all uprose, Nor spake, nor moved their eyes; It had been strange, even in a dream, To have seen those dead men rise.

The helmsman steer’d, the ship moved on; Yet never a breeze up-blew; The mariners all ’gan work the ropes, Where they were wont to do; They raised their limbs like lifeless tools-- We were a ghastly crew.

The body of my brother’s son Stood by me, knee to knee: The body and I pull’d at one rope, But he said naught to me.’

[Sidenote: But not by the souls of the men, nor by demons of earth or middle air, but by a blessed troop of angelic spirits, sent down by the invocation of the guardian saint.]

‘I fear thee, ancient Mariner!’ ‘Be calm, thou Wedding-Guest: ’Twas not those souls that fled in pain, Which to their corses came again, But a troop of spirits blest:

For when it dawn’d--they dropp’d their arms, And cluster’d round the mast; Sweet sounds rose slowly through their mouths, And from their bodies pass’d.

Around, around, flew each sweet sound, Then darted to the Sun; Slowly the sounds came back again, Now mix’d, now one by one.

Sometimes a-dropping from the sky I heard the skylark sing; Sometimes all little birds that are, How they seem’d to fill the sea and air With their sweet jargoning!

And now ’twas like all instruments, Now like a lonely flute; And now it is an angel’s song, That makes the Heavens be mute.

It ceased; yet still the sails made on A pleasant noise till noon, A noise like of a hidden brook In the leafy month of June, That to the sleeping woods all night Singeth a quiet tune.

Till noon we quietly sail’d on, Yet never a breeze did breathe: Slowly and smoothly went the ship, Moved onward from beneath.

[Sidenote: The lonesome Spirit from the South Pole carries on the ship as far as the Line, in obedience to the angelic troop, but still requireth vengeance.]

Under the keel nine fathom deep, From the land, of mist and snow, The Spirit slid: and it was he That made the ship to go. The sails at noon left off their tune, And the ship stood still also.

The Sun, right up above the mast, Had fix’d her to the ocean: But in a minute she ’gan stir, With a short uneasy motion-- Backwards and forwards half her length With a short uneasy motion.

Then like a pawing horse let go, She made a sudden bound: It flung the blood into my head, And I fell down in a swound.

[Sidenote: The Polar Spirit’s fellow-demons, the invisible inhabitants of the element, take part in his wrong; and two of them relate, one to the other, that penance long and heavy for the ancient Mariner hath been accorded to the Polar Spirit, who returneth southward.]

How long in that same fit I lay, I have not to declare; But ere my living life return’d, I heard, and in my soul discern’d Two voices in the air.

“Is it he?” quoth one, “is this the man? By Him who died on cross, With his cruel bow he laid full low The harmless Albatross.

The Spirit who bideth by himself In the land of mist and snow, He loved the bird that loved the man Who shot him with his bow.”

The other was a softer voice, As soft as honey-dew: Quoth he, “The man hath penance done, And penance more will do.”

PART VI

First Voice:

‘“But tell me, tell me! speak again. Thy soft response renewing-- What makes that ship drive on so fast? What is the Ocean doing?”

Second Voice:

“Still as a slave before his lord, The Ocean hath no blast; His great bright eye most silently Up to the Moon is cast--

If he may know which way to go; For she guides him smooth or grim. See, brother, see! how graciously She looketh down on him.”

[Sidenote: The Mariner hath been cast into a trance; for the angelic power causeth the vessel to drive northward faster than human life could endure.]

First Voice:

“But why drives on that ship so fast, Without or wave or wind?”

Second Voice:

“The air is cut away before, And closes from behind.

Fly, brother, fly! more high, more high! Or we shall be belated: For slow and slow that ship will go, When the Mariner’s trance is abated.’

[Sidenote: The super-natural motion is retarded; the Mariner awakes, and his penance begins anew.]

I woke, and we were sailing on As in a gentle weather: 'Twas night, calm night, the Moon was high; The dead men stood together.

All stood together on the deck, For a charnel-dungeon fitter: All fix'd on me their stony eyes, That in the Moon did glitter.

The pang, the curse, with which they died. Had never pass'd away: I could not draw my eyes from theirs, Nor turn them up to pray.

[Sidenote: The curse is finally expiated.]

And now this spell was snapt: once more I viewed the ocean green, And look'd far forth, yet little saw Of what had else been seen--

Like one that on a lonesome road Doth walk in fear and dread, And having once turned round, walks on, And turns no more his head; Because he knows a frightful fiend Doth close behind him tread.

But soon there breathed a wind on me, Nor sound nor motion made: Its path was not upon the sea, In ripple or in shade.

It raised my hair, it fann'd my cheek Like a meadow-gale of spring-- It mingled strangely with my fears, Yet it felt like a welcoming.

Swiftly, swiftly flew the ship, Yet she sail'd softly too: Sweetly, sweetly blew the breeze-- On me alone it blew.

[Sidenote: And the ancient Mariner beholdeth his native country.]

O dream of joy! is this indeed The lighthouse top I see? Is this the hill? is this the kirk? Is this mine own countree?

We drifted o'er the harbour-bar, And I with sobs did pray-- O let me be awake, my God! Or let me sleep alway.

The harbour-bay was clear as glass, So smoothly it was strewn! And on the bay the moonlight lay, And the shadow of the Moon.

The rock shone bright, the kirk no less That stands above the rock: The moonlight steep'd in silentness The steady weathercock.

[Sidenote: The angelic spirits leave the dead bodies,]

And the bay was white with silent light Till rising from the same, Full many shapes, that shadows were, In crimson colours came.

[Sidenote: And appear in their own forms of light.]

A little distance from the prow Those crimson shadows were: I turn'd my eyes upon the deck-- O Christ! what saw I there!

Each corse lay flat, lifeless and flat, And, by the holy rood! A man all light, a seraph-man, On every corse there stood.

This seraph-band, each waved his hand: It was a heavenly sight! They stood as signals to the land, Each one a lovely light;

This seraph-band, each waved his hand, No voice did they impart-- No voice; but O, the silence sank Like music on my heart.

But soon I heard the dash of oars, I heard the Pilot's cheer; My head was turn'd perforce away, And I saw a boat appear.

The Pilot and the Pilot's boy, I heard them coming fast: Dear Lord in Heaven! it was a joy The dead men could not blast.

I saw a third--I heard his voice: It is the Hermit good! He singeth loud his godly hymns That he makes in the wood. He'll shrieve my soul, he'll wash away The Albatross's blood.

PART VII

[Sidenote: The Hermit of the Wood.]

'This hermit good lives in that wood Which slopes down to the sea. How loudly his sweet voice he rears! He loves to talk with marineres That come from a far countree.

He kneels at morn, and noon, and eve-- He hath a cushion plump. It is the moss that wholly hides The rotted old oak-stump.

The skiff-boat near'd: I heard them talk, "Why, this is strange, I trow! Where are those lights so many and fair, That signal made but now?"

[Sidenote: Approacheth the ship with wonder.]

"Strange, by my faith!" the Hermit said-- "And they answer'd not our cheer! The planks look warp'd! and see those sails, How thin they are and sere! I never saw aught like to them, Unless perchance it were Brown skeletons of leaves that lag My forest-brook along; When the ivy-tod is heavy with snow, And the owlet whoops to the wolf below, That eats the she-wolf's young."

"Dear Lord! it hath a fiendish look-- (The Pilot made reply) I am a-fear'd."--"Push on, push on!" Said the Hermit cheerily.

The boat came closer to the ship, But I nor spake nor stirr'd; The boat came close beneath the ship, And straight a sound was heard.

[Sidenote: The ship suddenly sinketh.]

Under the water it rumbled on, Still louder and more dread: It reach'd the ship, it split the bay; The ship went down like lead.

[Sidenote: The ancient Mariner is saved in the Pilot's boat.]

Stunn'd by that loud and dreadful sound, Which sky and ocean smote, Like one that hath been seven days drown'd My body lay afloat; But swift as dreams, myself I found Within the Pilot's boat.

Upon the whirl, where sank the ship, The boat spun round and round; And all was still, save that the hill Was telling of the sound.

I moved my lips--the Pilot shriek’d And fell down in a fit; The holy Hermit raised his eyes, And pray’d where he did sit.

I took the oars: the Pilot’s boy, Who now doth crazy go, Laugh’d loud and long, and all the while His eyes went to and fro. “Ha! ha!” quoth he, “full plain I see The Devil knows how to row.”

And now, all in my own countree, I stood on the firm land! The Hermit stepp’d forth from the boat, And scarcely he could stand.

[Sidenote: The ancient Mariner earnestly entreateth the Hermit to shrieve him; and the penance of life falls on him.]

“O shrieve me, shrieve me, holy man!” The Hermit cross’d his brow. “Say quick,” quoth he, “I bid thee say-- What manner of man art thou?”

Forthwith this frame of mine was wrench’d With a woful agony, Which forced me to begin my tale; And then it left me free.

[Sidenote: And ever and anon throughout his future life an agony constraineth him to travel from land to land;]

Since then, at an uncertain hour, That agony returns: And till my ghastly tale is told, This heart within me burns.

I pass, like night, from land to land; I have strange power of speech; That moment that his face I see, I know the man that must hear me: To him my tale I teach.

What loud uproar bursts from that door! The wedding-guests are there: But in the garden-bower the bride And bride-maids singing are: And hark, the little vesper bell, Which biddeth me to prayer!

O Wedding-Guest! this soul hath been Alone on a wide, wide sea: So lonely ’twas, that God Himself Scarce seemèd there to be.

O sweeter than the marriage-feast, ’Tis sweeter far to me, To walk together to the kirk With a goodly company!--

To walk together to the kirk, And all together pray, While each to his great Father bends, Old men, and babes, and loving friends, And youths and maidens gay!

[Sidenote: And to teach, by his own example, love and reverence to all things that God made and loveth.]

Farewell, farewell! but this I tell To thee, thou Wedding-Guest! He prayeth well, who loveth well Both man and bird and beast.

He prayeth best, who loveth best All things both great and small; For the dear God who loveth us, He made and loveth all.’

The Mariner, whose eye is bright, Whose beard with age is hoar, Is gone: and now the Wedding-Guest Turn’d from the bridegroom’s door,

He went like one that hath been stunn’d, And is of sense forlorn: A sadder and a wiser man He rose the morrow morn.

_550._ _Kubla Khan_

In Xanadu did Kubla Khan A stately pleasure-dome decree: Where Alph, the sacred river, ran Through caverns measureless to man Down to a sunless sea. So twice five miles of fertile ground With walls and towers were girdled round: And there were gardens bright with sinuous rills Where blossom'd many an incense-bearing tree; And here were forests ancient as the hills, Enfolding sunny spots of greenery.

But O, that deep romantic chasm which slanted Down the green hill athwart a cedarn cover! A savage place! as holy and enchanted As e'er beneath a waning moon was haunted By woman wailing for her demon-lover! And from this chasm, with ceaseless turmoil seething, As if this earth in fast thick pants were breathing, A mighty fountain momently was forced; Amid whose swift half-intermitted burst Huge fragments vaulted like rebounding hail, Or chaffy grain beneath the thresher's flail: And 'mid these dancing rocks at once and ever It flung up momently the sacred river. Five miles meandering with a mazy motion Through wood and dale the sacred river ran, Then reach'd the caverns measureless to man, And sank in tumult to a lifeless ocean: And 'mid this tumult Kubla heard from far Ancestral voices prophesying war! The shadow of the dome of pleasure Floated midway on the waves; Where was heard the mingled measure From the fountain and the caves. It was a miracle of rare device, A sunny pleasure-dome with caves of ice!

A damsel with a dulcimer In a vision once I saw: It was an Abyssinian maid, And on her dulcimer she play'd, Singing of Mount Abora. Could I revive within me, Her symphony and song, To such a deep delight 'twould win me, That with music loud and long, I would build that dome in air, That sunny dome! those caves of ice! And all who heard should see them there, And all should cry, Beware! Beware! His flashing eyes, his floating hair! Weave a circle round him thrice, And close your eyes with holy dread, For he on honey-dew hath fed, And drunk the milk of Paradise.

_551._ _Love_

All thoughts, all passions, all delights, Whatever stirs this mortal frame, All are but ministers of Love, And feed his sacred flame.

Oft in my waking dreams do I Live o'er again that happy hour, When midway on the mount I lay, Beside the ruin'd tower.

The moonshine, stealing o'er the scene, Had blended with the lights of eve; And she was there, my hope, my joy, My own dear Genevieve!

She lean'd against the armèd man, The statue of the armèd Knight; She stood and listen'd to my lay, Amid the lingering light.

Few sorrows hath she of her own, My hope! my joy! my Genevieve! She loves me best whene'er I sing The songs that make her grieve.

I play'd a soft and doleful air; I sang an old and moving story-- An old rude song, that suited well That ruin wild and hoary.

She listen'd with a flitting blush, With downcast eyes and modest grace; For well she knew I could not choose But gaze upon her face.

I told her of the Knight that wore Upon his shield a burning brand; And that for ten long years he woo’d The Lady of the Land.

I told her how he pined: and ah! The deep, the low, the pleading tone With which I sang another’s love, Interpreted my own.

She listened with a flitting blush, With downcast eyes, and modest grace; And she forgave me, that I gazed Too fondly on her face!

But when I told the cruel scorn That crazed that bold and lovely Knight, And that he cross’d the mountain-woods, Nor rested day nor night;

That sometimes from the savage den, And sometimes from the darksome shade, And sometimes starting up at once In green and sunny glade--

There came and look’d him in the face An angel beautiful and bright; And that he knew it was a Fiend, This miserable Knight!

And that, unknowing what he did, He leap’d amid a murderous band, And saved from outrage worse than death The Lady of the Land;--

And how she wept and clasp’d his knees; And how she tended him in vain-- And ever strove to expiate The scorn that crazed his brain;--

And that she nursed him in a cave; And how his madness went away, When on the yellow forest leaves A dying man he lay;--

His dying words--but when I reach’d That tenderest strain of all the ditty, My faltering voice and pausing harp Disturb’d her soul with pity!

All impulses of soul and sense Had thrill’d my guileless Genevieve; The music and the doleful tale, The rich and balmy eve;

And hopes, and fears that kindle hope, An undistinguishable throng, And gentle wishes long subdued, Subdued and cherish’d long!

She wept with pity and delight, She blush’d with love and virgin shame; And like the murmur of a dream, I heard her breathe my name.

Her bosom heaved--she stepp’d aside, As conscious of my look she stept-- Then suddenly, with timorous eye She fled to me and wept.

She half enclosed me with her arms, She press’d me with a meek embrace; And bending back her head, look’d up, And gazed upon my face.

’Twas partly love, and partly fear, And partly ’twas a bashful art, That I might rather feel, than see. The swelling of her heart.

I calm’d her fears, and she was calm, And told her love with virgin pride; And so I won my Genevieve, My bright and beauteous Bride.

_552._ _Youth and Age_

Verse, a breeze ’mid blossoms straying, Where Hope clung feeding, like a bee-- Both were mine! Life went a-maying With Nature, Hope, and Poesy, When I was young: When I was young?--Ah, woful When: Ah! for the change ’twixt Now and Then!

This breathing house not built with hands, This body that does me grievous wrong, O’er aery cliffs and glittering sands, How lightly then it flash’d along-- Like those trim skiffs, unknown of yore, On winding lakes and rivers wide, That ask no aid of sail or oar, That fear no spite of wind or tide! Naught cared this body for wind or weather When Youth and I lived in ’t together.

Flowers are lovely! Love is flower-like; Friendship is a sheltering tree; O the joys, that came down shower-like, Of Friendship, Love, and Liberty, Ere I was old! Ere I was old? Ah, woful Ere, Which tells me, Youth’s no longer here! O Youth! for years so many and sweet, ’Tis known that thou and I were one; I’ll think it but a fond conceit-- It cannot be that thou art gone! Thy vesper-bell hath not yet toll’d-- And thou wert aye a masker bold! What strange disguise hast now put on, To make believe that thou art gone? I see these locks in silvery slips, This drooping gait, this alter’d size: But springtide blossoms on thy lips, And tears take sunshine from thine eyes! Life is but thought: so think I will That Youth and I are housemates still.

Dewdrops are the gems of morning, But the tears of mournful eve! Where no hope is, life’s a warning That only serves to make us grieve, When we are old! That only serves to make us grieve With oft and tedious taking-leave, Like some poor nigh-related guest That may not rudely be dismist. Yet hath outstay’d his welcome while, And tells the jest without the smile.

_553._ _Time, Real and Imaginary_

AN ALLEGORY

On the wide level of a mountain’s head (I knew not where, but ’twas some faery place), Their pinions, ostrich-like, for sails outspread, Two lovely children run an endless race, A sister and a brother! This far outstripp’d the other; Yet ever runs she with reverted face, And looks and listens for the boy behind: For he, alas! is blind! O’er rough and smooth with even step he pass’d, And knows not whether he be first or last.

_554._ _Work without Hope_

All Nature seems at work. Slugs leave their lair-- The bees are stirring--birds are on the wing-- And Winter, slumbering in the open air, Wears on his smiling face a dream of Spring! And I, the while, the sole unbusy thing, Nor honey make, nor pair, nor build, nor sing.

Yet well I ken the banks where amaranths blow, Have traced the fount whence streams of nectar flow. Bloom, O ye amaranths! bloom for whom ye may, For me ye bloom not! Glide, rich streams, away! With lips unbrighten’d, wreathless brow, I stroll: And would you learn the spells that drowse my soul? Work without Hope draws nectar in a sieve, And Hope without an object cannot live.

_555._ _Glycine’s Song_

A sunny shaft did I behold, From sky to earth it slanted: And poised therein a bird so bold-- Sweet bird, thou wert enchanted!

He sank, he rose, he twinkled, he troll’d Within that shaft of sunny mist; His eyes of fire, his beak of gold, All else of amethyst!

And thus he sang: ‘Adieu! adieu! Love’s dreams prove seldom true. The blossoms, they make no delay: The sparking dew-drops will not stay. Sweet month of May, We must away; Far, far away! To-day! to-day!’

ROBERT SOUTHEY

1774-1843

_556._ _His Books_

My days among the Dead are past; Around me I behold, Where’er these casual eyes are cast, The mighty minds of old: My never-failing friends are they, With whom I converse day by day.

With them I take delight in weal And seek relief in woe; And while I understand and feel How much to them I owe, My cheeks have often been bedew’d With tears of thoughtful gratitude.

My thoughts are with the Dead; with them I live in long-past years, Their virtues love, their faults condemn, Partake their hopes and fears; And from their lessons seek and find Instruction with an humble mind.

My hopes are with the Dead; anon My place with them will be, And I with them shall travel on Through all Futurity; Yet leaving here a name, I trust, That will not perish in the dust.

WALTER SAVAGE LANDOR

1775-1864

_557._ _The Maid’s Lament_

I loved him not; and yet now he is gone, I feel I am alone. I check’d him while he spoke; yet, could he speak, Alas! I would not check. For reasons not to love him once I sought, And wearied all my thought To vex myself and him; I now would give My love, could he but live Who lately lived for me, and when he found ’Twas vain, in holy ground He hid his face amid the shades of death. I waste for him my breath Who wasted his for me; but mine returns, And this lorn bosom burns With stifling heat, heaving it up in sleep, And waking me to weep Tears that had melted his soft heart: for years Wept he as bitter tears. ‘Merciful God!’ such was his latest prayer, ‘These may she never share!’ Quieter is his breath, his breast more cold Than daisies in the mould, Where children spell, athwart the churchyard gate, His name and life’s brief date. Pray for him, gentle souls, whoe’er you be, And, O, pray too for me!

_558._ _Rose Aylmer_

Ah, what avails the sceptred race! Ah, what the form divine! What every virtue, every grace! Rose Aylmer, all were thine.

Rose Aylmer, whom these wakeful eyes May weep, but never see, A night of memories and sighs I consecrate to thee.

_559._ _Ianthe_

From you, Ianthe, little troubles pass Like little ripples down a sunny river; Your pleasures spring like daisies in the grass, Cut down, and up again as blithe as ever.

_560._ _Twenty Years hence_

Twenty years hence my eyes may grow, If not quite dim, yet rather so; Yet yours from others they shall know, Twenty years hence.

Twenty years hence, though it may hap That I be call'd to take a nap In a cool cell where thunder-clap Was never heard,

There breathe but o'er my arch of grass A not too sadly sigh'd 'Alas!' And I shall catch, ere you can pass, That wingèd word.

_561._ _Verse_

Past ruin'd Ilion Helen lives, Alcestis rises from the shades; Verse calls them forth; 'tis verse that gives Immortal youth to mortal maids.

Soon shall Oblivion's deepening veil Hide all the peopled hills you see, The gay, the proud, while lovers hail These many summers you and me.

_562._ _Proud Word you never spoke_

Proud word you never spoke, but you will speak Four not exempt from pride some future day. Resting on one white hand a warm wet cheek, Over my open volume you will say, 'This man loved me'--then rise and trip away.

_563._ _Resignation_

Why, why repine, my pensive friend, At pleasures slipp'd away? Some the stern Fates will never lend, And all refuse to stay.

I see the rainbow in the sky, The dew upon the grass; I see them, and I ask not why They glimmer or they pass.

With folded arms I linger not To call them back; 'twere vain: In this, or in some other spot, I know they'll shine again.

_564._ _Mother, I cannot mind my Wheel_

Mother, I cannot mind my wheel; My fingers ache, my lips are dry: O, if you felt the pain I feel! But O, who ever felt as I?

No longer could I doubt him true-- All other men may use deceit; He always said my eyes were blue, And often swore my lips were sweet.

_565._ _Autumn_

Mild is the parting year, and sweet The odour of the falling spray; Life passes on more rudely fleet, And balmless is its closing day.

I wait its close, I court its gloom, But mourn that never must there fall Or on my breast or on my tomb The tear that would have soothed it all.

_566._ _Remain!_

Remain, ah not in youth alone! --Tho' youth, where you are, long will stay-- But when my summer days are gone, And my autumnal haste away. '_Can I be always by your side?_' No; but the hours you can, you must, Nor rise at Death's approaching stride, Nor go when dust is gone to dust.

_567._ _Absence_

Here, ever since you went abroad, If there be change, no change I see: I only walk our wonted road, The road is only walk'd by me.

Yes; I forgot; a change there is-- Was it of _that_ you bade me tell? I catch at times, at times I miss The sight, the tone, I know so well.

Only two months since you stood here? Two shortest months? Then tell me why Voices are harsher than they were, And tears are longer ere they dry.

_568._ _Of Clementina_

In Clementina's artless mien Lucilla asks me what I see, And are the roses of sixteen Enough for me?

Lucilla asks, if that be all, Have I not cull'd as sweet before: Ah yes, Lucilla! and their fall I still deplore.

I now behold another scene, Where Pleasure beams with Heaven's own light, More pure, more constant, more serene, And not less bright.

Faith, on whose breast the Loves repose, Whose chain of flowers no force can sever, And Modesty who, when she goes, Is gone for ever.

_569._ _Ianthe's Question_

'Do you remember me? or are you proud?' Lightly advancing thro' her star-trimm'd crowd, Ianthe said, and look'd into my eyes. 'A _yes_, a _yes_ to both: for Memory Where you but once have been must ever be, And at your voice Pride from his throne must rise.'

_570._ _On Catullus_

Tell me not what too well I know About the bard of Sirmio. Yes, in Thalia's son Such stains there are--as when a Grace Sprinkles another's laughing face With nectar, and runs on.

_571._ _Dirce_

Stand close around, ye Stygian set, With Dirce in one boat convey'd! Or Charon, seeing, may forget That he is old and she a shade.

_572._ _Alciphron and Leucippe_

An ancient chestnut’s blossoms threw Their heavy odour over two: Leucippe, it is said, was one; The other, then, was Alciphron. ‘Come, come! why should we stand beneath This hollow tree’s unwholesome breath?’ Said Alciphron, ‘here’s not a blade Of grass or moss, and scanty shade. Come; it is just the hour to rove In the lone dingle shepherds love; There, straight and tall, the hazel twig Divides the crookèd rock-held fig, O’er the blue pebbles where the rill In winter runs and may run still. Come then, while fresh and calm the air, And while the shepherds are not there.’

Leucippe. But I would rather go when they Sit round about and sing and play. Then why so hurry me? for you Like play and song, and shepherds too.

Alciphron. I like the shepherds very well, And song and play, as you can tell. But there is play, I sadly fear, And song I would not have you hear.

Leucippe. What can it be? What can it be?

Alciphron. To you may none of them repeat The play that you have play’d with me, The song that made your bosom beat.

Leucippe. Don’t keep your arm about my waist.

Alciphron. Might you not stumble?

Leucippe. Well then, do. But why are we in all this haste?

Alciphron. To sing.

Leucippe. Alas! and not play too?

_573._ _Years_

Years, many parti-colour’d years, Some have crept on, and some have flown Since first before me fell those tears I never could see fall alone.

Years, not so many, are to come, Years not so varied, when from you One more will fall: when, carried home, I see it not, nor hear Adieu.

_574._ _Separation_

There is a mountain and a wood between us, Where the lone shepherd and late bird have seen us Morning and noon and eventide repass. Between us now the mountain and the wood Seem standing darker than last year they stood, And say we must not cross--alas! alas!

_575._ _Late Leaves_

The leaves are falling; so am I; The few late flowers have moisture in the eye; So have I too. Scarcely on any bough is heard Joyous, or even unjoyous, bird The whole wood through.

Winter may come: he brings but nigher His circle (yearly narrowing) to the fire Where old friends meet. Let him; now heaven is overcast, And spring and summer both are past, And all things sweet.

_576._ _Finis_

I strove with none, for none was worth my strife. Nature I loved and, next to Nature, Art: I warm’d both hands before the fire of life; It sinks, and I am ready to depart.

CHARLES LAMB

1775-1834

_577._ _The Old Familiar Faces_

I have had playmates, I have had companions, In my days of childhood, in my joyful school-days-- All, all are gone, the old familiar faces.

I have been laughing, I have been carousing, Drinking late, sitting late, with my bosom cronies-- All, all are gone, the old familiar faces.

I loved a Love once, fairest among women: Closed are her doors on me, I must not see her-- All, all are gone, the old familiar faces.

I have a friend, a kinder friend has no man: Like an ingrate, I left my friend abruptly; Left him, to muse on the old familiar faces.

Ghost-like I paced round the haunts of my childhood, Earth seem’d a desert I was bound to traverse, Seeking to find the old familiar faces.

Friend of my bosom, thou more than a brother, Why wert not thou born in my father’s dwelling? So might we talk of the old familiar faces--

How some they have died, and some they have left me, And some are taken from me; all are departed-- All, all are gone, the old familiar faces.

_578._ _Hester_

When maidens such as Hester die Their place ye may not well supply, Though ye among a thousand try With vain endeavour.

A month or more hath she been dead, Yet cannot I by force be led To think upon the wormy bed And her together.

A springy motion in her gait, A rising step, did indicate Of pride and joy no common rate, That flush’d her spirit:

I know not by what name beside I shall it call: if ’twas not pride, It was a joy to that allied, She did inherit.

Her parents held the Quaker rule, Which doth the human feeling cool; But she was train’d in Nature’s school; Nature had blest her.

A waking eye, a prying mind; A heart that stirs, is hard to bind; A hawk’s keen sight ye cannot blind; Ye could not Hester.

My sprightly neighbour! gone before To that unknown and silent shore, Shall we not meet, as heretofore, Some summer morning--

When from thy cheerful eyes a ray Hath struck a bliss upon the day, A bliss that would not go away, A sweet forewarning?

_579._ _On an Infant dying as soon as born_

I saw where in the shroud did lurk A curious frame of Nature’s work; A floweret crush’d in the bud, A nameless piece of Babyhood, Was in her cradle-coffin lying; Extinct, with scarce the sense of dying: So soon to exchange the imprisoning womb For darker closets of the tomb! She did but ope an eye, and put A clear beam forth, then straight up shut For the long dark: ne’er more to see Through glasses of mortality. Riddle of destiny, who can show What thy short visit meant, or know What thy errand here below? Shall we say that Nature blind Check’d her hand, and changed her mind, Just when she had exactly wrought A finish’d pattern without fault? Could she flag, or could she tire, Or lack’d she the Promethean fire (With her nine moons’ long workings sicken’d) That should thy little limbs have quicken’d? Limbs so firm, they seem’d to assure Life of health, and days mature: Woman’s self in miniature! Limbs so fair, they might supply (Themselves now but cold imagery) The sculptor to make Beauty by. Or did the stern-eyed Fate descry That babe or mother, one must die; So in mercy left the stock And cut the branch; to save the shock Of young years widow’d, and the pain When single state comes back again To the lone man who, reft of wife, Thenceforward drags a maimèd life? The economy of Heaven is dark, And wisest clerks have miss’d the mark, Why human buds, like this, should fall, More brief than fly ephemeral That has his day; while shrivell’d crones Stiffen with age to stocks and stones; And crabbèd use the conscience sears In sinners of an hundred years. Mother’s prattle, mother’s kiss, Baby fond, thou ne’er wilt miss: Rites, which custom does impose, Silver bells, and baby clothes; Coral redder than those lips Which pale death did late eclipse; Music framed for infants’ glee, Whistle never tuned for thee; Though thou want’st not, thou shalt have them, Loving hearts were they which gave them. Let not one be missing; nurse, See them laid upon the hearse Of infant slain by doom perverse. Why should kings and nobles have Pictured trophies to their grave, And we, churls, to thee deny Thy pretty toys with thee to lie-- A more harmless vanity?

THOMAS CAMPBELL

1774-1844

_580._ _Ye Mariners of England_

Ye Mariners of England That guard our native seas! Whose flag has braved a thousand years The battle and the breeze! Your glorious standard launch again To match another foe; And sweep through the deep, While the stormy winds do blow! While the battle rages loud and long And the stormy winds do blow.

The spirits of your fathers Shall start from every wave-- For the deck it was their field of fame, And Ocean was their grave: Where Blake and mighty Nelson fell Your manly hearts shall glow, As ye sweep through the deep, While the stormy winds do blow! While the battle rages loud and long And the stormy winds do blow.

Britannia needs no bulwarks, No towers along the steep; Her march is o’er the mountain-waves, Her home is on the deep. With thunders from her native oak She quells the floods below, As they roar on the shore, When the stormy winds do blow! When the battle rages loud and long, And the stormy winds do blow.

The meteor flag of England Shall yet terrific burn; Till danger’s troubled night depart And the star of peace return. Then, then, ye ocean-warriors! Our song and feast shall flow To the fame of your name, When the storm has ceased to blow! When the fiery fight is heard no more, And the storm has ceased to blow.

_581._ _The Battle of the Baltic_

Of Nelson and the North Sing the glorious day’s renown, When to battle fierce came forth All the might of Denmark's crown, And her arms along the deep proudly shone; By each gun the lighted brand In a bold determined hand, And the Prince of all the land Led them on.

Like leviathans afloat Lay their bulwarks on the brine, While the sign of battle flew On the lofty British line: It was ten of April morn by the chime: As they drifted on their path There was silence deep as death, And the boldest held his breath For a time.

But the might of England flush'd To anticipate the scene; And her van the fleeter rush'd O’er the deadly space between: ‘Hearts of oak!’ our captains cried, when each gun From its adamantine lips Spread a death-shade round the ships, Like the hurricane eclipse Of the sun.

Again! again! again! And the havoc did not slack, Till a feeble cheer the Dane To our cheering sent us back;-- Their shots along the deep slowly boom:-- Then ceased--and all is wail, As they strike the shattered sail, Or in conflagration pale Light the gloom.

Out spoke the victor then As he hail'd them o'er the wave: ‘Ye are brothers! ye are men! And we conquer but to save:--

So peace instead of death let us bring But yield, proud foe, thy fleet, With the crews, at England’s feet, And make submission meet To our King.’...

Now joy, old England, raise! For the tidings of thy might, By the festal cities’ blaze, Whilst the wine-cup shines in light! And yet amidst that joy and uproar, Let us think of them that sleep Full many a fathom deep, By thy wild and stormy steep, Elsinore!

THOMAS MOORE

1779-1852

_582._ _The Young May Moon_

The young May moon is beaming, love, The glow-worm’s lamp is gleaming, love; How sweet to rove Through Morna’s grove, When the drowsy world is dreaming, love! Then awake!--the heavens look bright, my dear, ’Tis never too late for delight, my dear; And the best of all ways To lengthen our days Is to steal a few hours from

the night, my dear!

Now all the world is sleeping, love, But the Sage, his star-watch keeping, love, And I, whose star More glorious far Is the eye from that casement peeping, love. Then awake!--till rise of sun, my dear, The Sage's glass we'll shun, my dear, Or in watching the flight Of bodies of light He might happen to take thee for one, my dear!

_583._ _The Irish Peasant to His Mistress_

Through grief and through danger thy smile hath cheer'd my way, Till hope seem'd to bud from each thorn that round me lay; The darker our fortune, the brighter our pure love burn'd, Till shame into glory, till fear into zeal was turn'd: Yes, slave as I was, in thy arms my spirit felt free, And bless'd even the sorrows that made me more dear to thee.

Thy rival was honour'd, while thou wert wrong'd and scorn'd; Thy crown was of briers, while gold her brows adorn'd; She woo'd me to temples, whilst thou lay'st hid in caves; Her friends were all masters, while thine, alas! were slaves; Yet cold in the earth, at thy feet, I would rather be Than wed what I loved not, or turn one thought from thee.

They slander thee sorely, who say thy vows are frail-- Hadst thou been a false one, thy cheek had look'd less pale! They say, too, so long thou hast worn those lingering chains, That deep in thy heart they have printed their servile stains: O, foul is the slander!--no chain could that soul subdue-- Where shineth thy spirit, there Liberty shineth too!

_584._ _The Light of Other Days_

Oft, in the stilly night, Ere slumber's chain has bound me, Fond Memory brings the light Of other days around me: The smiles, the tears Of boyhood's years, The words of love then spoken; The eyes that shone, Now dimm'd and gone, The cheerful hearts now broken! Thus, in the stilly night, Ere slumber's chain has bound me, Sad Memory brings the light Of other days around me.

When I remember all The friends, so link'd together, I've seen around me fall Like leaves in wintry weather, I feel like one Who treads alone Some banquet-hall deserted, Whose lights are fled, Whose garlands dead, And all but he departed! Thus, in the stilly night, Ere slumber's chain has bound me. Sad Memory brings the light Of other days around me.

_585._ _At the Mid Hour of Night_

At the mid hour of night, when stars are weeping, I fly To the lone vale we loved, when life shone warm in thine eye; And I think oft, if spirits can steal from the regions of air To revisit past scenes of delight, thou wilt come to me there, And tell me our love is remembered even in the sky.

Then I sing the wild song it once was rapture to hear, When our voices commingling breathed like one on the ear; And as Echo far off through the vale my sad orison rolls, I think, O my love! 'tis thy voice from the Kingdom of Souls Faintly answering still the notes that once were so dear.

EDWARD THURLOW, LORD THURLOW

1781-1829

_586._ _May_

May! queen of blossoms, And fulfilling flowers, With what pretty music Shall we charm the hours? Wilt thou have pipe and reed, Blown in the open mead? Or to the lute give heed In the green bowers?

Thou hast no need of us, Or pipe or wire; Thou hast the golden bee Ripen’d with fire; And many thousand more Songsters, that thee adore, Filling earth’s grassy floor With new desire.

Thou hast thy mighty herds, Tame and free-livers; Doubt not, thy music too In the deep rivers; And the whole plumy flight Warbling the day and night-- Up at the gates of light, See, the lark quivers!

EBENEZER ELLIOTT

1781-1849

_587._ _Battle Song_

Day, like our souls, is fiercely dark; What then? ’Tis day! We sleep no more; the cock crows--hark! To arms! away! They come! they come! the knell is rung Of us or them; Wide o’er their march the pomp is flung Of gold and gem. What collar’d hound of lawless sway, To famine dear-- What pensioned slave of Attila, Leads in the rear? Come they from Scythian wilds afar, Our blood to spill? Wear they the livery of the Czar? They do his will. Nor tassell’d silk, nor epaulet, Nor plume, nor torse-- No splendour gilds, all sternly met, Our foot and horse. But, dark and still, we inly glow, Condensed in ire! Strike, tawdry slaves, and ye shall know Our gloom is fire. In vain your pomp, ye evil powers, Insults the land; Wrongs, vengeance, and the Cause are ours, And God’s right hand! Madmen! they trample into snakes The wormy clod! Like fire, beneath their feet awakes The sword of God! Behind, before, above, below, They rouse the brave; Where’er they go, they make a foe, Or find a grave.

_588._ _Plaint_

Dark, deep, and cold the current flows Unto the sea where no wind blows, Seeking the land which no one knows.

O’er its sad gloom still comes and goes The mingled wail of friends and foes, Borne to the land which no one knows.

Why shrieks for help yon wretch, who goes With millions, from a world of woes, Unto the land which no one knows?

Though myriads go with him who goes, Alone he goes where no wind blows, Unto the land which no one knows.

For all must go where no wind blows, And none can go for him who goes; None, none return whence no one knows.

Yet why should he who shrieking goes With millions, from a world of woes, Reunion seek with it or those?

Alone with God, where no wind blows, And Death, his shadow--doom'd, he goes. That God is there the shadow shows.

O shoreless Deep, where no wind blows! And thou, O Land which no one knows! That God is All, His shadow shows.

ALLAN CUNNINGHAM

1784-1843

_589._ _The Sun rises bright in France_

The sun rises bright in France, And fair sets he; But he has tint the blythe blink he had In my ain countree.

O, it's nae my ain ruin That saddens aye my e'e, But the dear Marie I left behin' Wi' sweet bairnies three.

_589._ tint] lost.

My lanely hearth burn'd bonnie, And smiled my ain Marie; I've left a' my heart behin' In my ain countree.

The bud comes back to summer, And the blossom to the bee; But I'll win back, O never, To my ain countree.

O, I am leal to high Heaven, Where soon I hope to be, An' there I'll meet ye a' soon Frae my ain countree!

_590._ _Hame, Hame, Hame_

Hame, hame, hame, O hame fain wad I be-- O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countree!

When the flower is i' the bud and the leaf is on the tree, The larks shall sing me hame in my ain countree; Hame, hame, hame, O hame fain wad I be-- O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countree!

The green leaf o' loyaltie's beginning for to fa', The bonnie White Rose it is withering an' a'; But I'll water 't wi' the blude of usurping tyrannie, An' green it will graw in my ain countree.

O, there's nocht now frae ruin my country can save, But the keys o' kind heaven, to open the grave; That a' the noble martyrs wha died for loyaltie May rise again an' fight for their ain countree.

The great now are gane, a' wha ventured to save, The new grass is springing on the tap o' their grave; But the sun through the mirk blinks blythe in my e'e, 'I'll shine

on ye yet in your ain countree.’

Hame, hame, hame, O hame fain wad I be-- O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countree!

_591._ _The Spring of the Year_

Gone were but the winter cold, And gone were but the snow, I could sleep in the wild woods Where primroses blow.

Cold’s the snow at my head, And cold at my feet; And the finger of death’s at my e’en, Closing them to sleep.

Let none tell my father Or my mother so dear,-- I’ll meet them both in heaven At the spring of the year.

LEIGH HUNT

1784-1859

_592._ _Jenny kiss’d Me_

Jenny kiss’d me when we met, Jumping from the chair she sat in; Time, you thief, who love to get Sweets into your list, put that in! Say I’m weary, say I’m sad, Say that health and wealth have miss’d me, Say I’m growing old, but add, Jenny kiss’d me.

THOMAS LOVE PEACOCK

1785-1866

_593._ _Love and Age_

I play’d with you ’mid cowslips blowing, When I was six and you were four; When garlands weaving, flower-balls throwing, Were pleasures soon to please no more. Through groves and meads, o’er grass and heather, With little playmates, to and fro, We wander’d hand in hand together; But that was sixty years ago.

You grew a lovely roseate maiden, And still our early love was strong; Still with no care our days were laden, They glided joyously along; And I did love you very dearly, How dearly words want power to show, I thought your heart was touch’d as nearly; But that was fifty years ago.

Then other lovers came around you, Your beauty grew from year to year, And many a splendid circle found you The centre of its glittering sphere. I saw you then, first vows forsaking, On rank and wealth your hand bestow; O, then I thought my heart was breaking!-- But that was forty years ago.

And I lived on, to wed another: No cause she gave me to repine; And when I heard you were a mother, I did not wish the children mine. My own young flock, in fair progression, Made up a pleasant Christmas row: My joy in them was past expression; But that was thirty years ago.

You grew a matron plump and comely, You dwelt in fashion’s brightest blaze; My earthly lot was far more homely; But I too had my festal days. No merrier eyes have ever glisten’d Around the hearth-stone’s wintry glow, Than when my youngest child was christen’d; But that was twenty years ago.

Time pass’d. My eldest girl was married, And I am now a grandsire gray; One pet of four years old I’ve carried Among the wild-flower’d meads to play. In our old fields of childish pleasure, Where now, as then, the cowslips blow, She fills her basket’s ample measure; And that is not ten years ago.

But though first love’s impassion’d blindness Has pass’d away in colder light, I still have thought of you with kindness, And shall do, till our last good-night. The ever-rolling silent hours Will bring a time we shall not know, When our young days of gathering flowers Will be an hundred years ago.

_594._ _The Grave of Love_

I dug, beneath the cypress shade, What well might seem an elfin’s grave; And every pledge in earth I laid, That erst thy false affection gave.

I press’d them down the sod beneath; I placed one mossy stone above; And twined the rose’s fading wreath Around the sepulchre of love.

Frail as thy love, the flowers were dead Ere yet the evening sun was set: But years shall see the cypress spread, Immutable as my regret.

_595._ _Three Men of Gotham_

Seamen three! What men be ye? Gotham’s three wise men we be. Whither in your bowl so free? To rake the moon from out the sea. The bowl goes trim. The moon doth shine. And our ballast is old wine.-- And your ballast is old wine.

Who art thou, so fast adrift? I am he they call Old Care. Here on board we will thee lift. No: I may not enter there. Wherefore so? ’Tis Jove’s decree, In a bowl Care may not be.-- In a bowl Care may not be.

Fear ye not the waves that roll? No: in charmèd bowl we swim. What the charm that floats the bowl? Water may not pass the brim. The bowl goes trim. The moon doth shine. And our ballast is old wine.-- And your ballast is old wine.

CAROLINE SOUTHEY

1787-1854

_596._ _To Death_

Come not in terrors clad, to claim An unresisting prey: Come like an evening shadow, Death! So stealthily, so silently! And shut mine eyes, and steal my breath; Then willingly, O willingly, With thee I’ll go away!

What need to clutch with iron grasp What gentlest touch may take? What need with aspect dark to scare, So awfully, so terribly, The weary soul would hardly care, Call’d quietly, call’d tenderly, From thy dread power to break?

’Tis not as when thou markest out The young, the blest, the gay, The loved, the loving--they who dream So happily, so hopefully; Then harsh thy kindest call may seem, And shrinkingly, reluctantly, The summon’d may obey.

But I have drunk enough of life-- The cup assign’d to me Dash’d with a little sweet at best, So scantily, so scantily-- To know full well that all the rest More bitterly, more bitterly, Drugg’d to the last will be.

And I may live to pain some heart That kindly cares for me: To pain, but not to bless. O Death! Come quietly--come lovingly-- And shut mine eyes, and steal my breath; Then willingly, O willingly, I’ll go away with thee!

GEORGE GORDON BYRON, LORD BYRON

1788-1824

_597._ _When we Two parted_

When we two parted In silence and tears, Half broken-hearted To sever for years, Pale grew thy cheek and cold, Colder thy kiss; Truly that hour foretold Sorrow to this.

The dew of the morning Sunk chill on my brow-- It felt like the warning Of what I feel now. Thy vows are all broken, And light is thy fame; I hear thy name spoken, And share in its shame.

They name thee before me, A knell to mine ear; A shudder comes o’er me-- Why wert thou so dear? They know not I knew thee, Who knew thee too well: Long, long shall I rue thee, Too deeply to tell.

In secret we met-- In silence I grieve, That thy heart could forget, Thy spirit deceive. If I should meet thee After long years, How should I greet thee? With silence and tears.

_598._ _For Music_

There be none of Beauty’s daughters With a magic like thee; And like music on the waters Is thy sweet voice to me: When, as if its sound were causing The charmèd ocean’s pausing, The waves lie still and gleaming, And the lull’d winds seem dreaming:

And the midnight moon is weaving Her bright chain o’er the deep; Whose breast is gently heaving, As an infant’s asleep: So the spirit bows before thee, To listen and adore thee; With a full but soft emotion, Like the swell of Summer’s ocean.

_599._ _We’ll go no more a-roving_

So, we’ll go no more a-roving So late into the night, Though the heart be still as loving, And the moon be still as bright.

For the sword outwears its sheath, And the soul wears out the breast, And the heart must pause to breathe, And love itself have rest.

Though the night was made for loving, And the day returns too soon, Yet we'll go no more a-roving By the light of the moon.

_600._ _She walks in Beauty_

She walks in beauty, like the night Of cloudless climes and starry skies; And all that's best of dark and bright Meet in her aspect and her eyes: Thus mellow'd to that tender light Which heaven to gaudy day denies.

One shade the more, one ray the less, Had half impair'd the nameless grace Which waves in every raven tress, Or softly lightens o'er her face; Where thoughts serenely sweet express How pure, how dear their dwelling-place.

And on that cheek, and o'er that brow, So soft, so calm, yet eloquent, The smiles that win, the tints that glow, But tell of days in goodness spent, A mind at peace with all below, A heart whose love is innocent!

_601._ _The Isles of Greece_

The isles of Greece! the isles of Greece Where burning Sappho loved and sung, Where grew the arts of war and peace, Where Delos rose, and Phœbus sprung! Eternal summer gilds them yet, But all, except their sun, is set.

The Scian and the Teian muse, The hero's harp, the lover's lute, Have found the fame your shores refuse: Their place of birth alone is mute To sounds which echo further west Than your sires' 'Islands of the Blest.'

The mountains look on Marathon-- And Marathon looks on the sea; And musing there an hour alone, I dream'd that Greece might still be free; For standing on the Persians' grave, I could not deem myself a slave.

A king sate on the rocky brow Which looks o'er sea-born Salamis; And ships, by thousands, lay below, And men in nations;--all were his! He counted them at break of day-- And when the sun set, where were they?

And where are they? and where art thou, My country? On thy voiceless shore The heroic lay is tuneless now-- The heroic bosom beats no more! And must thy lyre, so long divine, Degenerate into hands like mine?

'Tis something in the dearth of fame, Though link'd among a fetter'd race, To feel at least a patriot's shame, Even as I sing, suffuse my face; For what is left the poet here? For Greeks a blush--for Greece a tear.

Must _we_ but weep o'er days more blest? Must _we_ but blush?--Our fathers bled. Earth! render back from out thy breast A remnant of our Spartan dead! Of the three hundred grant but three, To make a new Thermopylæ!

What, silent still? and silent all? Ah! no;--the voices of the dead Sound like a distant torrent's fall, And answer, 'Let one living head, But one, arise,--we come, we come!' 'Tis but the living who are dumb.

In vain--in vain: strike other chords; Fill high the cup with Samian wine! Leave battles to the Turkish hordes, And shed the blood of Scio's vine! Hark! rising to the

ignoble call-- How answers each bold Bacchanal!

You have the Pyrrhic dance as yet; Where is the Pyrrhic phalanx gone? Of two such lessons, why forget The nobler and the manlier one? You have the letters Cadmus gave-- Think ye he meant them for a slave?

Fill high the bowl with Samian wine! We will not think of themes like these! It made Anacreon's song divine: He served--but served Polycrates-- A tyrant; but our masters then Were still, at least, our countrymen.

The tyrant of the Chersonese Was freedom's best and bravest friend; _That_ tyrant was Miltiades! O that the present hour would lend Another despot of the kind! Such chains as his were sure to bind.

Fill high the bowl with Samian wine! On Suli's rock, and Parga's shore, Exists the remnant of a line Such as the Doric mothers bore; And there, perhaps, some seed is sown, The Heracleidan blood might own.

Trust not for freedom to the Franks-- They have a king who buys and sells; In native swords and native ranks The only hope of courage dwells: But Turkish force and Latin fraud Would break your shield, however broad.

Fill high the bowl with Samian wine! Our virgins dance beneath the shade-- I see their glorious black eyes shine; But gazing on each glowing maid, My own the burning tear-drop laves, To think such breasts must suckle slaves.

Place me on Sunium's marbled steep, Where nothing, save the waves and I, May hear our mutual murmurs sweep; There, swan-like, let me sing and die: A land of slaves shall ne'er be mine-- Dash down yon cup of Samian wine!

SIR AUBREY DE VERE

1788-1846

_602._ _The Children Band_

All holy influences dwell within The breast of Childhood: instincts fresh from God Inspire it, ere the heart beneath the rod Of grief hath bled, or caught the plague of sin. How mighty was that fervour which could win Its way to infant souls!--and was the sod Of Palestine by infant Croises trod? Like Joseph went they forth, or Benjamin, In all their touching beauty to redeem? And did their soft lips kiss the Sepulchre? Alas! the lovely pageant as a dream Faded! They sank not through ignoble fear; They felt not Moslem steel. By mountain, stream, In sands, in fens, they died--no mother near!

CHARLES WOLFE

1791-1823

_603._ _The Burial of Sir John Moore after Corunna_

Not a drum was heard, not a funeral note, As his corse to the rampart we hurried; Not a soldier discharged his farewell shot O’er the grave where our hero we buried.

We buried him darkly at dead of night, The sods with our bayonets turning, By the struggling moonbeam’s misty light And the lanthorn dimly burning.

No useless coffin enclosed his breast, Not in sheet or in shroud we wound him; But he lay like a warrior taking his rest With his martial cloak around him.

Few and short were the prayers we said, And we spoke not a word of sorrow; But we steadfastly gazed on the face that was dead, And we bitterly thought of the morrow.

We thought, as we hollow’d his narrow bed And smoothed down his lonely pillow, That the foe and the stranger would tread o’er his head, And we far away on the billow!

Lightly they’ll talk of the spirit that’s gone, And o’er his cold ashes upbraid him-- But little he’ll reck, if they let him sleep on In the grave where a Briton has laid him.

But half of our heavy task was done When the clock struck the hour for retiring; And we heard the distant and random gun That the foe was sullenly firing.

Slowly and sadly we laid him down, From the field of his fame fresh and gory; We carved not a line, and we raised not a stone, But we left him alone with his glory.

_604._ _To Mary_

If I had thought thou couldst have died, I might not weep for thee; But I forgot, when by thy side, That thou couldst mortal be: It never through my mind had past The time would e’er be o’er, And I on thee should look my last, And thou shouldst smile no more!

And still upon that face I look, And think ’twill smile again; And still the thought I will not brook, That I must look in vain. But when I speak--thou dost not say What thou ne’er left’st unsaid; And now I feel, as well I may, Sweet Mary, thou art dead!

If thou wouldst stay, e’en as thou art, All cold and all serene-- I still might press thy silent heart, And where thy smiles have been. While e’en thy chill, bleak corse I have, Thou seemest still mine own; But there--I lay thee in thy grave, And I am now alone!

I do not think, where’er thou art, Thou hast forgotten me; And I, perhaps, may soothe this heart In thinking too of thee: Yet there was round thee such a dawn Of light ne’er seen before, As fancy never could have drawn, And never can restore!

PERCY BYSSHE SHELLEY

1792-1822

_605._ _Hymn of Pan_

From the forests and highlands We come, we come; From the river-girt islands, Where loud waves are dumb, Listening to my sweet pipings. The wind in the reeds

and the rushes, The bees on the bells of thyme, The birds on the myrtle bushes, The cicale above in the lime, And the lizards below in the grass, Were as silent as ever old Tmolus was, Listening to my sweet pipings.

Liquid Peneus was flowing, And all dark Tempe lay In Pelion’s shadow, outgrowing The light of the dying day, Speeded by my sweet pipings. The Sileni and Sylvans and Fauns, And the Nymphs of the woods and waves, To the edge of the moist river-lawns, And the brink of the dewy caves, And all that did then attend and follow, Were silent with love, as you now, Apollo, With envy of my sweet pipings.

I sang of the dancing stars, I sang of the dædal earth, And of heaven, and the giant wars, And love, and death, and birth. And then I changed my pipings-- Singing how down the vale of Mænalus I pursued a maiden, and clasp’d a reed: Gods and men, we are all deluded thus; It breaks in our bosom, and then we bleed. All wept--as I think both ye now would, If envy or age had not frozen your blood-- At the sorrow of my sweet pipings.

_606._ _The Invitation_

Best and brightest, come away! Fairer far than this fair Day, Which, like thee to those in sorrow, Comes to bid a sweet good-morrow To the rough Year just awake In its cradle on the brake. The brightest hour of unborn Spring, Through the winter wandering, Found, it seems, the halcyon Morn To hoar February born. Bending from heaven, in azure mirth, It kiss’d the forehead of the Earth; And smiled upon the silent sea; And bade the frozen streams be free; And waked to music all their fountains; And breathed upon the frozen mountains; And like a prophetess of May Strew’d flowers upon the barren way, Making the wintry world appear Like one on whom thou smilest, dear.

Away, away, from men and towns, To the wild wood and the downs-- To the silent wilderness Where the soul need not repress Its music lest it should not find An echo in another’s mind, While the touch of Nature’s art Harmonizes heart to heart. I leave this notice on my door For each accustomed visitor:-- ‘I am gone into the fields To take what this sweet hour yields. Reflection, you may come to-morrow; Sit by the fireside with Sorrow. You with the unpaid bill, Despair,-- You tiresome verse-reciter, Care,-- I will pay you in the grave,-- Death will listen to your stave. Expectation too, be off! To-day is for itself enough. Hope, in pity, mock not Woe With smiles, nor follow where I go; Long having lived on your sweet food, At length I find one moment’s good After long pain: with all your love, This you never told me of.’

Radiant Sister of the Day, Awake! arise! and come away! To the wild woods and the plains; And the pools where winter rains Image all their roof of leaves; Where the pine its garland weaves Of sapless green and ivy dun Round stems that never kiss the sun; Where the lawns and pastures be, And the sandhills of the sea; When the melting hoar-frost wets The daisy-star that never sets, And wind-flowers, and violets Which yet join not scent to hue, Crown the pale year weak and new; When the night is left behind In the deep east, dun and blind, And the blue noon is over us, And the multitudinous Billows murmur at our feet Where the earth and ocean meet, And all things seem only one In the universal sun.

_607._ _Hellas_

The world’s great age begins anew, The golden years return, The earth doth like a snake renew Her winter weeds outworn: Heaven smiles, and faiths and empires gleam Like wrecks of a dissolving dream.

A brighter Hellas rears its mountains From waves serener far; A new Peneus rolls his fountains Against the morning star; Where fairer Tempes bloom, there sleep Young Cyclads on a sunnier deep.

A loftier Argo cleaves the main, Fraught with a later prize; Another Orpheus sings again, And loves, and weeps, and dies; A new Ulysses leaves once more Calypso for his native shore.

O write no more the tale of Troy, If earth Death’s scroll must be-- Nor mix with Laian rage the joy Which dawns upon the free, Although a subtler Sphinx renew Riddles of death Thebes never knew.

Another Athens shall arise, And to remoter time Bequeath, like sunset to the skies, The splendour of its prime; And leave, if naught so bright may live, All earth can take or Heaven can give.

Saturn and Love their long repose Shall burst, more bright and good Than all who fell, than One who rose, Than many unsubdued: Not gold, not blood, their altar dowers, But votive tears and symbol flowers.

O cease! must hate and death return? Cease! must men kill and die? Cease! drain not to its dregs the urn Of bitter prophecy! The world is weary of the past-- O might it die or rest at last!

_608._ _To a Skylark_

Hail to thee, blithe spirit! Bird thou never wert-- That from heaven or near it Pourest thy full heart In profuse strains of unpremeditated art.

Higher still and higher From the earth thou springest, Like a cloud of fire; The blue deep thou wingest, And singing still dost soar, and soaring ever singest.

In the golden light’ning Of the sunken sun, O’er which clouds are bright’ning, Thou dost float and run, Like an unbodied joy whose race is just begun.

The pale purple even Melts around thy flight; Like a star of heaven, In the broad daylight Thou art unseen, but yet I hear thy shrill delight--

Keen as are the arrows Of that silver sphere Whose intense lamp narrows In the white dawn clear, Until we hardly see, we feel that it is there.

All the earth and air With thy voice is loud, As, when night is bare, From one lonely cloud The moon rains out her beams, and heaven is overflow’d.

What thou art we know not; What is most like thee? From rainbow clouds there flow not Drops so bright to see, As from thy presence showers a rain of melody:--

Like a poet hidden In the light of thought, Singing hymns unbidden, Till the world is wrought To sympathy with hopes and fears it heeded not:

Like a high-born maiden In a palace tower, Soothing her love-laden Soul in secret hour With music sweet as love, which overflows her bower:

Like a glow-worm golden In a dell of dew, Scattering unbeholden Its aërial hue Among the flowers and grass which screen it from the view:

Like a rose embower’d In its own green leaves, By warm winds deflower’d, Till the scent it gives Makes faint with too much sweet these heavy-wingèd thieves

Sound of vernal showers On the twinkling grass, Rain-awaken’d flowers-- All that ever was Joyous and clear and fresh--thy music doth surpass.

Teach us, sprite or bird, What sweet thoughts are thine: I have never heard Praise of love or wine That panted forth a flood of rapture so divine.

Chorus hymeneal, Or triumphal chant, Match’d with thine would be all But an empty vaunt-- A thing wherein we feel there is some hidden want.

What objects are the fountains Of thy happy strain? What fields, or waves, or mountains? What shapes of sky or plain? What love of thine own kind? what ignorance of pain?

With thy clear keen joyance Languor cannot be: Shadow of annoyance Never came near thee: Thou lovest, but ne’er knew love’s sad satiety.

Waking or asleep, Thou of death must deem Things more true and deep Than we mortals dream, Or how could thy notes flow in such a crystal stream?

We look before and after, And pine for what is not: Our sincerest laughter With some pain is fraught; Our sweetest songs are those that tell of saddest thought.

Yet, if we could scorn Hate and pride and fear, If we were things born Not to shed a tear, I know not how thy joy we ever should come near.

Better than all measures Of delightful sound, Better than all treasures That in books are found, Thy skill to poet were, thou scorner of the ground!

Teach me half the gladness That thy brain must know; Such harmonious madness From my lips would flow, The world should listen then, as I am listening now.

_609._ _The Moon_

I

And, like a dying lady lean and pale, Who totters forth, wrapp’d in a gauzy veil, Out of her chamber, led by the insane And feeble wanderings of her fading brain, The moon arose up in the murky east A white and shapeless mass.

II

Art thou pale for weariness Of climbing heaven and gazing on the earth, Wandering companionless Among the stars that have a different birth, And ever changing, like a joyless eye That finds no object worth its constancy?

_610._ _Ode to the West Wind_

I

O wild West Wind, thou breath of Autumn’s being Thou from whose unseen presence the leaves dead Are driven like ghosts from an enchanter fleeing,

Yellow, and black, and pale, and hectic red, Pestilence-stricken multitudes! O thou Who chariotest to their dark wintry bed

The wingèd seeds, where they lie cold and low, Each like a corpse within its grave, until Thine azure sister of the Spring shall blow

Her clarion o’er the dreaming earth, and fill (Driving sweet buds like flocks to feed in air) With living hues and odours plain and hill;

Wild Spirit, which art moving everywhere; Destroyer and preserver; hear, O hear!

II

Thou on whose stream, ’mid the steep sky’s commotion, Loose clouds like earth’s decaying leaves are shed, Shook from the ‘tangled boughs of heaven and ocean,

Angels of rain and lightning! there are spread On the blue surface of thine airy surge, Like the bright hair uplifted from the head

Of some fierce Mænad, even from the dim verge Of the horizon to the zenith’s height, The locks of the approaching storm. Thou dirge Of the dying year, to which this closing night Will be the dome of a vast sepulchre, Vaulted with all thy congregated might

Of vapours, from whose solid atmosphere Black rain, and fire, and hail, will burst: O hear!

III

Thou who didst waken from his summer dreams The blue Mediterranean, where he lay, Lull’d by the coil of his crystàlline streams,

Beside a pumice isle in Baiæ’s bay, And saw in sleep old palaces and towers Quivering within the wave’s intenser day,

All overgrown with azure moss, and flowers So sweet, the sense faints picturing them! Thou For whose path the Atlantic’s level powers

Cleave themselves into chasms, while far below The sea-blooms and the oozy woods which wear The sapless foliage of the ocean, know

Thy voice, and suddenly grow gray with fear, And tremble and despoil themselves: O hear!

IV

If I were a dead leaf thou mightest bear; If I were a swift cloud to fly with thee; A wave to pant beneath thy power, and share The impulse of thy strength, only less free Than thou, O uncontrollable! if even I were as in my boyhood, and could be

The comrade of thy wanderings over heaven, As then, when to outstrip thy skiey speed Scarce seem'd a vision--I would ne'er have striven

As thus with thee in prayer in my sore need. O! lift me as a wave, a leaf, a cloud! I fall upon the thorns of life! I bleed!

A heavy weight of hours has chained and bow'd One too like thee--tameless, and swift, and proud.

V

Make me thy lyre, even as the forest is: What if my leaves are falling like its own? The tumult of thy mighty harmonies

Will take from both a deep autumnal tone, Sweet though in sadness. Be thou, Spirit fierce, My spirit! Be thou me, impetuous one!

Drive my dead thoughts over the universe, Like wither'd leaves, to quicken a new birth; And, by the incantation of this verse,

Scatter, as from an unextinguish'd hearth Ashes and sparks, my words among mankind! Be through my lips to unawaken'd earth

The trumpet of a prophecy! O Wind, If Winter comes, can Spring be far behind?

_611._ _The Indian Serenade_

I arise from dreams of thee In the first sweet sleep of night, When the winds are breathing low, And the stars are shining bright. I arise from dreams of thee, And a spirit in my feet Hath led me--who knows how? To thy chamber window, Sweet!

The wandering airs they faint On the dark, the silent stream-- And the Champak's odours [pine] Like sweet thoughts in a dream; The nightingale's complaint, It dies upon her heart, As I must on thine, O belovèd as thou art!

O lift me from the grass! I die! I faint! I fail! Let thy love in kisses rain On my lips and eyelids pale. My cheek is cold and white, alas! My heart beats loud and fast: O press it to thine own again, Where it will break at last!

_612._ _Night_

Swiftly walk over the western wave, Spirit of Night! Out of the misty eastern cave,-- Where, all the long and lone daylight, Thou wovest dreams of joy and fear Which make thee terrible and dear,-- Swift be thy flight!

Wrap thy form in a mantle grey, Star-inwrought! Blind with thine hair the eyes of Day; Kiss her until she be wearied out. Then wander o'er city and sea and land, Touching all with thine opiate wand-- Come, long-sought!

When I arose and saw the dawn, I sigh’d for thee; When light rode high, and the dew was gone, And noon lay heavy on flower and tree, And the weary Day turn’d to her rest, Lingering like an unloved guest, I sigh’d for thee.

Thy brother Death came, and cried, ‘Wouldst thou me?’ Thy sweet child Sleep, the filmy-eyed, Murmur’d like a noontide bee, ‘Shall I nestle near thy side? Wouldst thou me?’--And I replied, ‘No, not thee!’

Death will come when thou art dead, Soon, too soon-- Sleep will come when thou art fled. Of neither would I ask the boon I ask of thee, belovèd Night-- Swift be thine approaching flight, Come soon, soon!

_613._ _From the Arabic_

AN IMITATION

My faint spirit was sitting in the light Of thy looks, my love; It panted for thee like the hind at noon For the brooks, my love. Thy barb, whose hoofs outspeed the tempest’s flight, Bore thee far from me; My heart, for my weak feet were weary soon, Did companion thee.

Ah! fleeter far than fleetest storm or steed, Or the death they bear, The heart which tender thought clothes like a dove With the wings of care; In the battle, in the darkness, in the need, Shall mine cling to thee, Nor claim one smile for all the comfort, love, It may bring to thee.

_614._ _Lines_

When the lamp is shatter’d, The light in the dust lies dead; When the cloud is scatter’d, The rainbow’s glory is shed: When the lute is broken, Sweet tones are remember’d not When the lips have spoken, Loved accents are soon forgot.

As music and splendour Survive not the lamp and the lute, The heart’s echoes render No song when the spirit is mute-- No song but sad dirges, Like the wind through a ruin’d cell, Or the mournful surges That ring the dead seaman’s knell.

When hearts have once mingled, Love first leaves the well-built nest; The weak one is singled To endure what it once possest. O Love, who bewailest The frailty of all things here, Why choose you the frailest For your cradle, your home, and your bier?

Its passions will rock thee, As the storms rock the ravens on high: Bright reason will mock thee, Like the sun from a wintry sky. From thy nest every rafter Will rot, and thine eagle home Leave thee naked to laughter, When leaves fall and cold winds come.

_615._ _To---- _

One word is too often profaned For me to profane it; One feeling too falsely disdain’d For thee to disdain it; One hope is too like despair For prudence to smother; And pity from thee more dear Than that from another.

I can give not what men call love: But wilt thou accept not The worship the heart lifts above And the heavens reject not, The desire of the moth for the star, Of the night for the morrow, The devotion to something afar From the sphere of our sorrow?

_616._ _The Question_

I dream’d that, as I wander’d by the way, Bare Winter suddenly was changed to Spring; And gentle odours led my steps astray, Mix’d with a sound of waters murmuring Along a shelving bank of turf, which lay Under a copse, and hardly dared to fling Its green arms round the bosom of the stream, But kiss’d it and then fled, as thou mightest in dream.

There grew pied wind-flowers and violets; Daisies, those pearl’d Arcturi of the earth, The constellated flower that never sets; Faint oxlips; tender bluebells, at whose birth The sod scarce heaved; and that tall flower that wets-- Like a child, half in tenderness and mirth-- Its mother’s face with heaven-collected tears When the low wind, its playmate’s voice, it hears.

And in the warm hedge grew lush eglantine, Green cowbind and the moonlight-colour’d May, And cherry-blossoms, and white cups whose wine Was the bright dew yet drain’d not by the day; And wild roses, and ivy serpentine, With its dark buds and leaves wandering astray; And flowers, azure, black, and streak’d with gold, Fairer than any waken’d eyes behold.

And nearer to the river’s trembling edge There grew broad flag-flowers, purple prank’d with white, And starry river-buds among the sedge, And floating water-lilies, broad and bright, Which lit the oak that overhung the hedge With moonlight beams of their own watery light; And bulrushes, and reeds of such deep green As soothed the dazzled eye with sober sheen.

Methought that of these visionary flowers I made a nosegay, bound in such a way That the same hues which in their natural bowers Were mingled or opposed, the like array Kept these imprison’d children of the Hours Within my hand;--and then, elate and gay, I hasten’d to the spot whence I had come, That I might there present it--O! to whom?

_617._ _Remorse_

Away! the moor is dark beneath the moon, Rapid clouds have drunk the last pale beam of even: Away! the gathering winds will call the darkness soon, And profoundest midnight shroud the serene lights of heaven.

Pause not! the time is past! Every voice cries ‘Away!’ Tempt not with one last tear thy friend’s ungentle mood: Thy lover’s eye, so glazed and cold, dares not entreat thy stay: Duty and dereliction guide thee back to solitude.

Away, away! to thy sad and silent home; Pour bitter tears on its desolated hearth; Watch the dim shades as like ghosts they go and come, And complicate strange webs of melancholy mirth. The leaves of wasted autumn woods shall float around thine head, The blooms of dewy Spring shall gleam beneath thy feet: But thy soul or this world must fade in the frost that binds the dead, Ere midnight’s frown and morning’s

smile, ere thou and peace, may meet.

The cloud shadows of midnight possess their own repose, For the weary winds are silent, or the moon is in the deep; Some respite to its turbulence unresting ocean knows; Whatever moves or toils or grieves hath its appointed sleep. Thou in the grave shalt rest:--yet, till the phantoms flee, Which that house and heath and garden made dear to thee erewhile, Thy remembrance and repentance and deep musings are not free From the music of two voices, and the light of one sweet smile.

_618._ _Music, when Soft Voices die_

Music, when soft voices die, Vibrates in the memory; Odours, when sweet violets sicken, Live within the sense they quicken.

Rose leaves, when the rose is dead, Are heap'd for the belovèd's bed; And so thy thoughts, when thou art gone, Love itself shall slumber on.

HEW AINSLIE

1792-1878

_619._ _Willie and Helen_

'Wharefore sou'd ye talk o' love, Unless it be to pain us? Wharefore sou'd ye talk o' love Whan ye say the sea maun twain us?'

'It's no because my love is light, Nor for your angry deddy; It's a' to buy ye pearlins bright, An' to busk ye like a leddy.'

'O Willy, I can caird an' spin, Se ne'er can want for cleedin'; An' gin I hae my Willy's heart, I hae a' the pearls I'm heedin'.

'Will it be time to praise this cheek Whan years an' tears has blench'd it? Will it be time to talk o' love Whan cauld an' care has quench'd it?'

He's laid ae han' about her waist-- The ither's held to heaven; An' his luik was like the luik o' man Wha's heart in twa is riven.

_619._ cleedin'] clothing.

JOHN KEBLE

1792-1866

_620._ _Burial of the Dead_

I thought to meet no more, so dreary seem'd Death's interposing veil, and thou so pure, Thy place in Paradise Beyond where I could soar:

Friend of this worthless heart! but happier thoughts Spring like unbidden violets from the sod, Where patiently thou tak'st Thy sweet and sure repose.

The shadows fall more soothing: the soft air Is full of cheering whispers like thine own; While Memory, by thy grave, Lives o'er thy funeral day;

The deep knell dying down, the mourners' pause, Waiting their Saviour's welcome at the gate.-- Sure with the words of Heaven Thy spirit met us there,

And sought with us along th' accustom'd way The hallow'd porch, and entering in, beheld The pageant of sad joy So dear to Faith and Hope.

O! hadst thou brought a strain from Paradise To cheer us, happy soul, thou hadst not touch'd The sacred springs of grief More tenderly and true, Than those deep-warbled anthems, high and low, Low as the grave, high as th' Eternal Throne, Guiding through light and gloom Our mourning fancies wild,

Till gently, like soft golden clouds at eve Around the western twilight, all subside Into a placid faith, That even with beaming eye

Counts thy sad honours, coffin, bier, and pall; So many relics of a frail love lost, So many tokens dear Of endless love begun.

Listen! it is no dream: th' Apostles' trump Gives earnest of th' Archangel's;--calmly now, Our hearts yet beating high To that victorious lay

(Most like a warrior's, to the martial dirge Of a true comrade), in the grave we trust Our treasure for awhile: And if a tear steal down,

If human anguish o'er the shaded brow Pass shuddering, when the handful of pure earth Touches the coffin-lid; If at our brother's name,

Once and again the thought, 'for ever gone,' Come o'er us like a cloud; yet, gentle spright, Thou turnest not away, Thou know'st us calm at heart.

One look, and we have seen our last of thee, Till we too sleep and our long sleep be o'er. O cleanse us, ere we view That countenance pure again,

Thou, who canst change the heart, and raise the dead! As Thou art by to soothe our parting hour, Be ready when we meet, With Thy dear pardoning words.

JOHN CLARE

1793-1864

_621._ _Written in Northampton County Asylum_

I am! yet what I am who cares, or knows? My friends forsake me like a memory lost. I am the self-consumer of my woes; They rise and vanish, an oblivious host, Shadows of life, whose very soul is lost. And yet I am--I live--though I am toss'd

Into the nothingness of scorn and noise, Into the living sea of waking dream, Where there is neither sense of life, nor joys, But the huge shipwreck of my own esteem And all that's dear. Even those I loved the best Are strange--nay, they are stranger than the rest.

I long for scenes where man has never trod-- For scenes where woman never smiled or wept-- There to abide with my Creator, God, And sleep as I in childhood sweetly slept, Full of high thoughts, unborn. So let me lie,-- The grass below; above,

the vaulted sky.

FELICIA DOROTHEA HEMANS

1793-1835

_622._ _Dirge_

Calm on the bosom of thy God, Fair spirit, rest thee now! E’en while with ours thy footsteps trod, His seal was on thy brow.

Dust, to its narrow house beneath! Soul, to its place on high! They that have seen thy look in death No more may fear to die.

JOHN KEATS

1795-1821

_623._ _Song of the Indian Maid_

FROM ‘ENDYMION’

O Sorrow! Why dost borrow The natural hue of health, from vermeil lips?-- To give maiden blushes To the white rose bushes? Or is it thy dewy hand the daisy tips?

O Sorrow! Why dost borrow The lustrous passion from a falcon-eye?-- To give the glow-worm light? Or, on a moonless night, To tinge, on siren shores, the salt sea-spry?

_623._ sea-spry] sea-spray.

O Sorrow! Why dost borrow The mellow ditties from a mourning tongue?-- To give at evening pale Unto the nightingale, That thou mayst listen the cold dews among?

O Sorrow! Why dost borrow Heart’s lightness from the merriment of May?-- A lover would not tread A cowslip on the head, Though he should dance from eve till peep of day-- Nor any drooping flower Held sacred for thy bower, Wherever he may sport himself and play.

To Sorrow I bade good morrow, And thought to leave her far away behind; But cheerly, cheerly, She loves me dearly; She is so constant to me, and so kind: I would deceive her, And so leave her, But ah! she is so constant and so kind.

Beneath my palm-trees, by the river side, I sat a-weeping: in the whole world wide There was no one to ask me why I wept,-- And so I kept Brimming the water-lily cups with tears Cold as my fears. Beneath my palm-trees, by the river side, I sat a-weeping: what enamour’d bride, Cheated by shadowy wooer from the clouds, But hides and shrouds Beneath dark palm-trees by a river side?

And as I sat, over the light blue hills There came a noise of revellers: the rills Into the wide stream came of purple hue-- ’Twas Bacchus and his crew! The earnest trumpet spake, and silver thrills From kissing cymbals made a merry din-- ’Twas

Bacchus and his kin! Like to a moving vintage down they came, Crown'd with green leaves, and faces all on flame; All madly dancing through the pleasant valley, To scare thee, Melancholy! O then, O then, thou wast a simple name! And I forgot thee, as the berried holly By shepherds is forgotten, when in June Tall chestnuts keep away the sun and moon:-- I rush'd into the folly!

Within his car, aloft, young Bacchus stood, Trifling his ivy-dart, in dancing mood, With sidelong laughing; And little rills of crimson wine imbrued His plump white arms and shoulders, enough white For Venus' pearly bite; And near him rode Silenus on his ass, Pelted with flowers as he on did pass Tipsily quaffing.

'Whence came ye, merry Damsels! whence came ye, So many, and so many, and such glee? Why have ye left your bowers desolate, Your lutes, and gentler fate?'-- 'We follow Bacchus! Bacchus on the wing, A-conquering! Bacchus, young Bacchus! good or ill betide, We dance before him thorough kingdoms wide:-- Come hither, lady fair, and joinèd be To our wild minstrelsy!'

'Whence came ye, jolly Satyrs! whence came ye, So many, and so many, and such glee? Why have ye left your forest haunts, why left Your nuts in oak-tree cleft?'-- 'For wine, for wine we left our kernel tree; For wine we left our heath, and yellow brooms, And cold mushrooms; For wine we follow Bacchus through the earth; Great god of breathless cups and chirping mirth! Come hither, lady fair, and joinèd be To our mad minstrelsy!'

Over wide streams and mountains great we went, And, save when Bacchus kept his ivy tent, Onward the tiger and the leopard pants, With Asian elephants: Onward these myriads--with song and dance, With zebras striped, and sleek Arabians' prance, Web-footed alligators, crocodiles, Bearing upon their scaly backs, in files, Plump infant laughers mimicking the coil Of seamen, and stout galley-rowers' toil: With toying oars and silken sails they glide, Nor care for wind and tide.

Mounted on panthers' furs and lions' manes, From rear to van they scour about the plains; A three days' journey in a moment done; And always, at the rising of the sun, About the wilds they hunt with spear and horn, On spleenful unicorn.

I saw Osirian Egypt kneel adown Before the vine-wreath crown! I saw parch'd Abyssinia rouse and sing To the silver cymbals' ring! I saw the whelming vintage hotly pierce Old Tartary the fierce! The kings of Ind their jewel-sceptres vail, And from their treasures scatter pearlèd hail; Great Brahma from his mystic heaven groans, And all his priesthood moans, Before young Bacchus' eye-wink turning pale. Into these regions came I, following him, Sick-hearted, weary--so I took a whim To stray away into these forests drear, Alone, without a peer: And I have told thee all thou mayest hear.

Young Stranger! I've been a ranger In search of pleasure throughout every clime; Alas! 'tis not for me! Bewitch'd I sure must be, To lose in grieving all my maiden prime.

Come then, Sorrow, Sweetest Sorrow! Like an own babe I nurse thee on my breast: I thought to leave thee, And deceive thee, But now of all the world I love thee best.

There is not one, No, no, not one But thee to comfort a poor lonely maid; Thou art her mother, And her brother, Her playmate, and her wooer in the shade.

_624._ _Ode to a Nightingale_

My heart aches, and a drowsy numbness pains My sense, as though of hemlock I had drunk, Or emptied some dull opiate to the drains One minute past, and Lethe-wards had sunk: ’Tis not through envy of thy happy lot, But being too happy in thy happiness, That thou, light-wingèd Dryad of the trees, In some melodious plot Of beechen green, and shadows numberless, Singest of summer in full-throated ease.

O for a draught of vintage! that hath been Cool’d a long age in the deep-delvèd earth, Tasting of Flora and the country-green, Dance, and Provençal song, and sunburnt mirth! O for a beaker full of the warm South! Full of the true, the blushful Hippocrene, With beaded bubbles winking at the brim, And purple-stainèd mouth; That I might drink, and leave the world unseen, And with thee fade away into the forest dim:

Fade far away, dissolve, and quite forget What thou among the leaves hast never known, The weariness, the fever, and the fret Here, where men sit and hear each other groan; Where palsy shakes a few, sad, last grey hairs, Where youth grows pale, and spectre-thin, and dies; Where but to think is to be full of sorrow And leaden-eyed despairs; Where beauty cannot keep her lustrous eyes, Or new Love pine at them beyond to-morrow.

Away! away! for I will fly to thee, Not charioted by Bacchus and his pards, But on the viewless wings of Poesy, Though the dull brain perplexes and retards: Already with thee! tender is the night, And haply the Queen-Moon is on her throne, Cluster’d around by all her starry Fays But here there is no light, Save what from heaven is with the breezes blown Through verdurous glooms and winding mossy ways.

I cannot see what flowers are at my feet, Nor what soft incense hangs upon the boughs, But, in embalmèd darkness, guess each sweet Wherewith the seasonable month endows The grass, the thicket, and the fruit-tree wild; White hawthorn, and the pastoral eglantine; Fast-fading violets cover’d up in leaves; And mid-May’s eldest child, The coming musk-rose, full of dewy wine, The murmurous haunt of flies on summer eves.

Darkling I listen; and for many a time I have been half in love with easeful Death, Call’d him soft names in many a musèd rhyme, To take into the air my quiet breath; Now more than ever seems it rich to die, To cease upon the midnight with no pain, While thou art pouring forth thy soul abroad In such an ecstasy! Still wouldst thou sing, and I have ears in vain-- To thy high requiem become a sod.

Thou wast not born for death, immortal Bird! No hungry generations tread thee down; The voice I hear this passing night was heard In ancient days by emperor and clown: Perhaps the self-same song that found a path Through the sad heart of Ruth, when, sick for home, She stood in tears amid the alien corn; The same that ofttimes hath Charm’d magic casements, opening on the foam Of perilous seas, in faery lands forlorn.

Forlorn! the very word is like a bell To toll me back from thee to my sole self! Adieu! the fancy cannot cheat so well As she is famed to do, deceiving elf. Adieu! adieu! thy plaintive anthem fades Past the near meadows, over the still stream, Up the hill-side; and now ’tis buried deep In the next valley-glades: Was it a vision, or a waking dream? Fled is that music:--do I wake or sleep?

_625._ _Ode on a Grecian Urn_

Thou still unravish’d bride of quietness, Thou foster-child of Silence and slow Time, Sylvan historian, who canst thus express A flowery tale more sweetly than our rhyme: What leaf-fringed legend haunts about thy shape Of deities or mortals, or of both, In Tempe or the dales of Arcady? What men or gods are these? What maidens loth? What mad pursuit? What struggle to escape? What pipes and timbrels? What wild ecstasy?

Heard melodies are sweet, but those unheard Are sweeter; therefore, ye soft pipes, play on; Not to the sensual ear, but, more endear’d, Pipe to the spirit ditties of no tone: Fair youth, beneath the trees, thou canst not leave Thy song, nor ever can those trees be bare; Bold Lover, never, never canst thou kiss, Though winning near the goal--yet, do not grieve; She cannot fade, though thou hast not thy bliss, For ever wilt thou love, and she be fair!

Ah, happy, happy boughs! that cannot shed Your leaves, nor ever bid the Spring adieu; And, happy melodist, unwearièd, For ever piping songs for ever new; More happy love! more happy, happy love! For ever warm and still to be enjoy’d, For ever panting and for ever young; All breathing human passion far above, That leaves a heart high-sorrowful and cloy’d, A burning forehead, and a parching tongue.

Who are these coming to the sacrifice? To what green altar, O mysterious priest, Lead’st thou that heifer lowing at the skies, And all her silken flanks with garlands drest? What little town by river or sea-shore, Or mountain-built with peaceful citadel, Is emptied of its folk, this pious morn? And, little town, thy streets for evermore Will silent be; and not a soul, to tell Why thou art desolate, can e’er return.

O Attic shape! fair attitude! with brede Of marble men and maidens overwrought, With forest branches and the trodden weed; Thou, silent form! dost tease us out of thought As doth eternity. Cold Pastoral! When old age shall this generation waste, Thou shalt remain, in midst of other woe Than ours, a friend to man, to whom thou say’st, ‘Beauty is truth, truth beauty,--that is all Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know.’

_626._ _Ode to Psyche_

O Goddess! hear these tuneless numbers, wrung By sweet enforcement and remembrance dear, And pardon that thy secrets should be sung Even into thine own soft-conchèd ear: Surely I dream’d to-day, or did I see The wingèd Psyche with awaken’d eyes? I wander’d in a forest thoughtlessly, And, on the sudden, fainting with surprise, Saw two fair creatures, couchèd side by side In deepest grass, beneath the whisp’ring roof Of leaves and trembled blossoms, where there ran A brooklet, scarce espied: ’Mid hush’d, cool-rooted flowers fragrant-eyed, Blue, silver-white, and

budded Tyrian They lay calm-breathing on the bedded grass; Their arms embracèd, and their pinions too; Their lips touch'd not, but had not bade adieu, As if disjoinèd by soft-handed slumber, And ready still past kisses to outnumber At tender eye-dawn of aurorean love: The wingèd boy I knew; But who wast thou, O happy, happy dove? His Psyche true!

O latest-born and loveliest vision far Of all Olympus' faded hierarchy! Fairer than Phœbe's sapphire-region'd star, Or Vesper, amorous glow-worm of the sky; Fairer than these, though temple thou hast none, Nor altar heap'd with flowers; Nor Virgin-choir to make delicious moan Upon the midnight hours; No voice, no lute, no pipe, no incense sweet From chain-swung censer teeming; No shrine, no grove, no oracle, no heat Of pale-mouth'd prophet dreaming.

O brightest! though too late for antique vows, Too, too late for the fond believing lyre, When holy were the haunted forest boughs, Holy the air, the water, and the fire; Yet even in these days so far retired From happy pieties, thy lucent fans, Fluttering among the faint Olympians, I see, and sing, by my own eyes inspired. So let me be thy choir, and make a moan Upon the midnight hours; Thy voice, thy lute, thy pipe, thy incense sweet From swingèd censer teeming: Thy shrine, thy grove, thy oracle, thy heat Of pale-mouth'd prophet dreaming.

Yes, I will be thy priest, and build a fane In some untrodden region of my mind, Where branchèd thoughts, new grown with pleasant pain, Instead of pines shall murmur in the wind: Far, far around shall those dark-cluster'd trees Fledge the wild-ridgèd mountains steep by steep; And there by zephyrs, streams, and birds, and bees, The moss-lain Dryads shall be lull'd to sleep; And in the midst of this wide quietness A rosy sanctuary will I dress With the wreath'd trellis of a working brain, With buds, and bells, and stars without a name, With all the gardener Fancy e'er could feign, Who, breeding flowers, will never breed the same; And there shall be for thee all soft delight That shadowy thought can win, A bright torch, and a casement ope at night, To let the warm Love in!

_627._ _To Autumn_

Season of mists and mellow fruitfulness! Close bosom-friend of the maturing sun; Conspiring with him how to load and bless With fruit the vines that round the thatch-eaves run; To bend with apples the moss'd cottage-trees, And fill all fruit with ripeness to the core; To swell the gourd, and plump the hazel shells With a sweet kernel; to set budding more, And still more, later flowers for the bees, Until they think warm days will never cease, For Summer has o'er-brimm'd their clammy cells.

Who hath not seen thee oft amid thy store? Sometimes whoever seeks abroad may find Thee sitting careless on a granary floor, Thy hair soft-lifted by the winnowing wind, Or on a half-reap'd furrow sound asleep, Drowsed with the fume of poppies, while thy hook Spares the next swath and all its twinèd flowers; And sometimes like a gleaner thou dost keep Steady thy laden head across a brook; Or by a cider-press, with patient look, Thou watchest the last oozings hours by hours.

Where are the songs of Spring? Ay, where are they? Think not of them, thou hast thy music too,-- While barrèd clouds bloom the soft-dying day, And touch the

stubble-plains with rosy hue; Then in a wailful choir the small gnats mourn Among the river sallows, borne aloft Or sinking as the light wind lives or dies; And full-grown lambs loud bleat from hilly bourn; Hedge-crickets sing; and now with treble soft The redbreast whistles from a garden-croft; And gathering swallows twitter in the skies.

_628._ _Ode on Melancholy_

No, no! go not to Lethe, neither twist Wolf's-bane, tight-rooted, for its poisonous wine; Nor suffer thy pale forehead to be kist By nightshade, ruby grape of Proserpine; Make not your rosary of yew-berries, Nor let the beetle, nor the death-moth be Your mournful Psyche, nor the downy owl A partner in your sorrow's mysteries; For shade to shade will come too drowsily, And drown the wakeful anguish of the soul.

But when the melancholy fit shall fall Sudden from heaven like a weeping cloud, That fosters the droop-headed flowers all, And hides the green hill in an April shroud; Then glut thy sorrow on a morning rose, Or on the rainbow of the salt sand-wave, Or on the wealth of globèd peonies; Or if thy mistress some rich anger shows, Emprison her soft hand, and let her rave, And feed deep, deep upon her peerless eyes.

She dwells with Beauty--Beauty that must die; And Joy, whose hand is ever at his lips Bidding adieu; and aching Pleasure nigh, Turning to poison while the bee-mouth sips: Ay, in the very temple of Delight Veil'd Melancholy has her sovran shrine, Though seen of none save him whose strenuous tongue Can burst Joy's grape against his palate fine; His soul shall taste the sadness of her might, And be among her cloudy trophies hung.

_629._ _Fragment of an Ode to Maia_

(_Written on May-Day, 1818_)

Mother of Hermes! and still youthful Maia! May I sing to thee As thou wast hymnèd on the shores of Baiæ? Or may I woo thee In earlier Sicilian? or thy smiles Seek as they once were sought, in Grecian isles, By bards who died content on pleasant sward, Leaving great verse unto a little clan? O give me their old vigour! and unheard Save of the quiet primrose, and the span Of heaven, and few ears, Rounded by thee, my song should die away Content as theirs, Rich in the simple worship of a day.

_630._ _Bards of Passion and of Mirth_

Written on the Blank Page before Beaumont and Fletcher's Tragi-Comedy 'The Fair Maid of the Inn'

Bards of Passion and of Mirth, Ye have left your souls on earth! Have ye souls in heaven too, Doubled-lived in regions new? Yes, and those of heaven commune With the spheres of sun and moon; With the noise of fountains wondrous, And the parle of voices thund'rous; With the whisper of heaven's trees And one another, in soft ease Seated on Elysian lawns Browsed by none but Dian's fawns; Underneath large blue-bells tented, Where the daisies are rose-scented, And the rose herself has got Perfume which on earth is not; Where the nightingale doth sing Not a senseless, trancèd thing, But divine melodious truth; Philosophic numbers smooth; Tales and

golden histories Of heaven and its mysteries.

Thus ye live on high, and then On the earth ye live again; And the souls ye left behind you Teach us, here, the way to find you, Where your other souls are joying, Never slumber'd, never cloying. Here, your earth-born souls still speak To mortals, of their little week; Of their sorrows and delights; Of their passions and their spites; Of their glory and their shame; What doth strengthen and what maim. Thus ye teach us, every day, Wisdom, though fled far away.

Bards of Passion and of Mirth, Ye have left your souls on earth! Ye have souls in heaven too, Double-lived in regions new!

_631._ _Fancy_

Ever let the Fancy roam, Pleasure never is at home: At a touch sweet Pleasure melteth, Like to bubbles when rain pelteth; Then let wingèd Fancy wander Through the thought still spread beyond her: Open wide the mind's cage-door, She'll dart forth, and cloudward soar. O sweet Fancy! let her loose; Summer's joys are spoilt by use, And the enjoying of the Spring Fades as does its blossoming: Autumn's red-lipp'd fruitage too, Blushing through the mist and dew, Cloys with tasting: What do then? Sit thee by the ingle, when The sear faggot blazes bright, Spirit of a winter's night; When the soundless earth is muffled, And the cakèd snow is shuffled From the ploughboy's heavy shoon; When the Night doth meet the Noon In a dark conspiracy To banish Even from her sky. Sit thee there, and send abroad, With a mind self-overawed, Fancy, high-commission'd:--send her! She has vassals to attend her: She will bring, in spite of frost, Beauties that the earth hath lost; She will bring thee, all together, All delights of summer weather; All the buds and bells of May, From dewy sward or thorny spray; All the heapèd Autumn's wealth, With a still, mysterious stealth: She will mix these pleasures up Like three fit wines in a cup, And thou shalt quaff it:--thou shalt hear Distant harvest-carols clear; Rustle of the reapèd corn; Sweet birds antheming the morn: And, in the same moment--hark! 'Tis the early April lark, Or the rooks, with busy caw, Foraging for sticks and straw. Thou shalt, at one glance, behold The daisy and the marigold; White-plumed lilies, and the first Hedge-grown primrose that hath burst; Shaded hyacinth, alway Sapphire queen of the mid-May; And every leaf, and every flower Pearlèd with the self-same shower. Thou shalt see the fieldmouse peep Meagre from its cellèd sleep; And the snake all winter-thin Cast on sunny bank its skin; Freckled nest-eggs thou shalt see Hatching in the hawthorn-tree, When the hen-bird's wing doth rest Quiet on her mossy nest; Then the hurry and alarm When the beehive casts its swarm; Acorns ripe down-pattering While the autumn breezes sing.

O sweet Fancy! let her loose; Every thing is spoilt by use: Where's the cheek that doth not fade, Too much gazed at? Where's the maid Whose lip mature is ever new? Where's the eye, however blue, Doth not weary? Where's the face One would meet in every place? Where's the voice, however soft, One would hear so very oft? At a touch sweet Pleasure melteth Like to bubbles when rain pelteth. Let, then, wingèd Fancy find Thee a mistress to thy mind: Dulcet-eyed as Ceres' daughter, Ere the God of Torment taught her How to frown and how to chide; With a waist and with a side

White as Hebe’s, when her zone Slipt its golden clasp, and down Fell her kirtle to her feet, While she held the goblet sweet, And Jove grew languid.--Break the mesh Of the Fancy’s silken leash; Quickly break her prison-string, And such joys as these she’ll bring.-- Let the wingèd Fancy roam, Pleasure never is at home.

_632._ _Stanzas_

In a drear-nighted December, Too happy, happy tree, Thy branches ne’er remember Their green felicity: The north cannot undo them, With a sleety whistle through them; Nor frozen thawings glue them From budding at the prime.

In a drear-nighted December, Too happy, happy brook, Thy bubblings ne’er remember Apollo’s summer look; But with a sweet forgetting, They stay their crystal fretting, Never, never petting About the frozen time.

Ah! would ’twere so with many A gentle girl and boy! But were there ever any Writhed not at passèd joy? To know the change and feel it, When there is none to heal it, Nor numbèd sense to steal it, Was never said in rhyme.

_633._ _La Belle Dame sans Merci_

‘O what can ail thee, knight-at-arms, Alone and palely loitering? The sedge is wither’d from the lake, And no birds sing.

‘O what can ail thee, knight-at-arms, So haggard and so woe-begone? The squirrel’s granary is full, And the harvest’s done.

‘I see a lily on thy brow With anguish moist and fever dew; And on thy cheek a fading rose Fast withereth too.’

‘I met a lady in the meads, Full beautiful--a faery’s child, Her hair was long, her foot was light, And her eyes were wild.

‘I made a garland for her head, And bracelets too, and fragrant zone; She look’d at me as she did love, And made sweet moan.

‘I set her on my pacing steed And nothing else saw all day long, For sideways would she lean, and sing A faery’s song.

‘She found me roots of relish sweet, And honey wild and manna dew, And sure in language strange she said, “I love thee true!”

‘She took me to her elfin grot, And there she wept and sigh’d full sore; And there I shut her wild, wild eyes With kisses four.

‘And there she lullèd me asleep, And there I dream’d--Ah! woe betide! The latest dream I ever dream’d On the cold hill’s side.

‘I saw pale kings and princes too, Pale warriors, death-pale were they all; Who cried--“La belle Dame sans Merci Hath thee in thrall!”

‘I saw their starved lips in the gloam With horrid warning gapèd wide, And I awoke and found me here On the cold hill’s side.

‘And this is why I sojourn here Alone and palely loitering, Though the sedge is wither’d from the lake, And no birds sing.’

_634._ _On first looking into Chapman’s Homer_

Much have I travell’d in the realms of gold, And many goodly states and kingdoms seen; Round many western islands have I been Which bards in fealty to Apollo hold. Oft of one wide expanse had I been told That deep-brow’d Homer ruled as his demesne: Yet did I never breathe its pure serene Till I heard Chapman speak out loud and bold: Then felt I like some watcher of the skies When a new planet swims into his ken; Or like stout Cortez, when with eagle eyes He stared at the Pacific--and all his men Look’d at each other with a wild surmise-- Silent, upon a peak in Darien.

_635._ _When I have Fears that I may cease to be_

When I have fears that I may cease to be Before my pen has glean’d my teeming brain, Before high-pilèd books, in charact’ry, Hold like full garners the full-ripen’d grain; When I behold, upon the night’s starr’d face, Huge cloudy symbols of a high romance, And feel that I may never live to trace Their shadows, with the magic hand of chance; And when I feel, fair creature of an hour! That I shall never look upon thee more, Never have relish in the faery power Of unreflecting love;--then on the shore Of the wide world I stand alone, and think, Till Love and Fame to nothingness do sink.

_636._ _To Sleep_

O soft embalmer of the still midnight! Shutting with careful fingers and benign Our gloom-pleased eyes, embower’d from the light, Enshaded in forgetfulness divine; O soothest Sleep! if so it please thee, close, In midst of this thine hymn, my willing eyes, Or wait the amen, ere thy poppy throws Around my bed its lulling charities; Then save me, or the passèd day will shine Upon my pillow, breeding many woes; Save me from curious conscience, that still lords Its strength for darkness, burrowing like a mole; Turn the key deftly in the oilèd wards, And seal the hushèd casket of my soul.

_637._ _Last Sonnet_

Bright Star, would I were steadfast as thou art-- Not in lone splendour hung aloft the night, And watching, with eternal lids apart, Like Nature’s patient sleepless Eremite, The moving waters at their priest-like task Of pure ablution round earth’s human shores, Or gazing on the new soft-fallen mask Of snow upon the mountains and the moors-- No--yet still steadfast, still unchangeable, Pillow’d upon my fair love’s ripening breast, To feel for ever its soft fall and swell, Awake for ever in a sweet unrest, Still, still to hear her tender-taken breath, And so live ever--or else swoon to death.

JEREMIAH JOSEPH CALLANAN

1795-1839

_638._ _The Outlaw of Loch Lene_

FROM THE IRISH

O many a day have I made good ale in the glen, That came not of stream or malt, like the brewing of men: My bed was the ground; my roof, the green-wood above; And the wealth that I sought, one far kind glance from my Love.

Alas! on that night when the horses I drove from the field, That I was not near from terror my angel to shield! She stretch’d forth her arms; her mantle she flung to the wind, And swam o’er Loch Lene, her outlaw’d lover to find.

O would that a freezing sleet-wing’d tempest did sweep, And I and my love were alone, far off on the deep; I’d ask not a ship, or a bark, or a pinnace, to save-- With her hand round my waist, I’d fear not the wind or the wave.

’Tis down by the lake where the wild tree fringes its sides, The maid of my heart, my fair one of Heaven resides: I think, as at eve she wanders its mazes among, The birds go to sleep by the sweet wild twist of her song.

WILLIAM SIDNEY WALKER

1795-1846

_639._

Too solemn for day, too sweet for night, Come not in darkness, come not in light; But come in some twilight interim, When the gloom is soft, and the light is dim.

GEORGE DARLEY

1795-1846

_640._ _Song_

Sweet in her green dell the flower of beauty slumbers, Lull’d by the faint breezes sighing through her hair; Sleeps she and hears not the melancholy numbers Breathed to my sad lute ’mid the lonely air.

Down from the high cliffs the rivulet is teeming To wind round the willow banks that lure him from above: O that in tears, from my rocky prison streaming, I too could glide to the bower of my love!

Ah! where the woodbines with sleepy arms have wound her, Opes she her eyelids at the dream of my lay, Listening, like the dove, while the fountains echo round her, To her lost mate’s call in the forests far away.

Come then, my bird! For the peace thou ever bearest, Still Heaven’s messenger of comfort to me-- Come--this fond bosom, O faithfullest and fairest, Bleeds with its death-wound, its wound of love for thee!

_641._ _To Helene_

On a Gift-ring carelessly lost

I sent a ring--a little band Of emerald and ruby stone, And bade it, sparkling on thy hand, Tell thee sweet tales of one Whose constant memory Was full of loveliness, and thee.

A shell was graven on its gold,-- 'Twas Cupid fix'd without his wings-- To Helene once it would have told More than was ever told by rings: But now all's past and gone, Her love is buried with that stone.

Thou shalt not see the tears that start From eyes by thoughts like these beguiled; Thou shalt not know the beating heart, Ever a victim and a child: Yet Helene, love, believe The heart that never could deceive.

I'll hear thy voice of melody In the sweet whispers of the air; I'll see the brightness of thine eye In the blue evening's dewy star; In crystal streams thy purity; And look on Heaven to look on thee.

_642._ _The Fallen Star_

A star is gone! a star is gone! There is a blank in Heaven; One of the cherub choir has done His airy course this even.

He sat upon the orb of fire That hung for ages there, And lent his music to the choir That haunts the nightly air.

But when his thousand years are pass'd, With a cherubic sigh He vanish'd with his car at last, For even cherubs die!

Hear how his angel-brothers mourn-- The minstrels of the spheres-- Each chiming sadly in his turn And dropping splendid tears.

The planetary sisters all Join in the fatal song, And weep this hapless brother's fall, Who sang with them so long.

But deepest of the choral band The Lunar Spirit sings, And with a bass-according hand Sweeps all her sullen strings.

From the deep chambers of the dome Where sleepless Uriel lies, His rude harmonic thunders come Mingled with mighty sighs.

The thousand car-borne cherubim, The wandering eleven, All join to chant the dirge of him Who fell just now from Heaven.

HARTLEY COLERIDGE

1796-1849

_643._ _The Solitary-Hearted_

She was a queen of noble Nature's crowning, A smile of hers was like an act of grace; She had no winsome looks, no pretty frowning, Like daily beauties of the vulgar race: But if she smiled, a light was on her face, A clear, cool kindliness, a lunar beam Of peaceful radiance, silvering o'er the stream Of human thought with unabiding glory; Not quite a waking truth, not quite a dream, A visitation, bright and

transitory.

But she is changed,--hath felt the touch of sorrow, No love hath she, no understanding friend; O grief! when Heaven is forced of earth to borrow What the poor niggard earth has not to lend; But when the stalk is snapt, the rose must bend. The tallest flower that skyward rears its head Grows from the common ground, and there must shed Its delicate petals. Cruel fate, too surely, That they should find so base a bridal bed, Who lived in virgin pride, so sweet and purely.

She had a brother, and a tender father, And she was loved, but not as others are From whom we ask return of love,--but rather As one might love a dream; a phantom fair Of something exquisitely strange and rare, Which all were glad to look on, men and maids, Yet no one claim'd--as oft, in dewy glades, The peering primrose, like a sudden gladness, Gleams on the soul, yet unregarded fades;-- The joy is ours, but all its own the sadness.

'Tis vain to say--her worst of grief is only The common lot, which all the world have known; To her 'tis more, because her heart is lonely, And yet she hath no strength to stand alone,-- Once she had playmates, fancies of her own, And she did love them. They are past away As Fairies vanish at the break of day; And like a spectre of an age departed, Or unsphered Angel wofully astray, She glides along--the solitary-hearted.

_644._ _Song_

She is not fair to outward view As many maidens be, Her loveliness I never knew Until she smiled on me; O, then I saw her eye was bright, A well of love, a spring of light!

But now her looks are coy and cold, To mine they ne'er reply, And yet I cease not to behold The love-light in her eye: Her very frowns are fairer far Than smiles of other maidens are.

_645._ _Early Death_

She pass'd away like morning dew Before the sun was high; So brief her time, she scarcely knew The meaning of a sigh.

As round the rose its soft perfume, Sweet love around her floated; Admired she grew--while mortal doom Crept on, unfear'd, unnoted.

Love was her guardian Angel here, But Love to Death resign'd her; Tho' Love was kind, why should we fear But holy Death is kinder?

_646._ _Friendship_

When we were idlers with the loitering rills, The need of human love we little noted: Our love was nature; and the peace that floated On the white mist, and dwelt upon the hills, To sweet accord subdued our wayward wills: One soul was ours, one mind, one heart devoted, That, wisely doting, ask'd not why it doted, And ours the unknown joy, which knowing kills. But now I find how dear thou wert to me; That man is more than half of nature's treasure, Of that fair beauty which no eye can see, Of that sweet music which no ear can measure; And now the streams may sing for

others’ pleasure, The hills sleep on in their eternity.

THOMAS HOOD

1798-1845

_647._ _Autumn_

I saw old Autumn in the misty morn Stand shadowless like Silence, listening To silence, for no lonely bird would sing Into his hollow ear from woods forlorn, Nor lowly hedge nor solitary thorn;-- Shaking his languid locks all dewy bright With tangled gossamer that fell by night, Pearling his coronet of golden corn.

Where are the songs of Summer?--With the sun, Oping the dusky eyelids of the south, Till shade and silence waken up as one, And Morning sings with a warm odorous mouth. Where are the merry birds?--Away, away, On panting wings through the inclement skies, Lest owls should prey Undazzled at noonday, And tear with horny beak their lustrous eyes.

Where are the blooms of Summer?--In the west, Blushing their last to the last sunny hours, When the mild Eve by sudden Night is prest Like tearful Proserpine, snatch’d from her flow’rs To a most gloomy breast. Where is the pride of Summer,--the green prime,-- The many, many leaves all twinkling?--Three On the moss’d elm; three on the naked lime Trembling,--and one upon the old oak-tree! Where is the Dryad’s immortality?-- Gone into mournful cypress and dark yew, Or wearing the long gloomy Winter through In the smooth holly’s green eternity.

The squirrel gloats on his accomplished hoard, The ants have brimm’d their garners with ripe grain, And honey bees have stored The sweets of Summer in their luscious cells; The swallows all have wing’d across the main; But here the Autumn melancholy dwells, And sighs her tearful spells Amongst the sunless shadows of the plain. Alone, alone, Upon a mossy stone, She sits and reckons up the dead and gone With the last leaves for a love-rosary, Whilst all the wither’d world looks drearily, Like a dim picture of the drownèd past In the hush’d mind’s mysterious far away, Doubtful what ghostly thing will steal the last Into that distance, gray upon the gray.

O go and sit with her, and be o’ershaded Under the languid downfall of her hair: She wears a coronal of flowers faded Upon her forehead, and a face of care;-- There is enough of wither’d everywhere To make her bower,--and enough of gloom; There is enough of sadness to invite, If only for the rose that died, whose doom Is Beauty’s,--she that with the living bloom Of conscious cheeks most beautifies the light: There is enough of sorrowing, and quite Enough of bitter fruits the earth doth bear,-- Enough of chilly droppings for her bowl; Enough of fear and shadowy despair, To frame her cloudy prison for the soul!

_648._ _Silence_

There is a silence where hath been no sound, There is a silence where no sound may be, In the cold grave--under the deep, deep sea, Or in wide desert where no life is found, Which hath been mute, and still must sleep profound; No voice is hush’d--no

life treads silently, But clouds and cloudy shadows wander free, That never spoke, over the idle ground: But in green ruins, in the desolate walls Of antique palaces, where Man hath been, Though the dun fox or wild hyæna calls, And owls, that flit continually between, Shriek to the echo, and the low winds moan-- There the true Silence is, self-conscious and alone.

_649._ _Death_

It is not death, that sometime in a sigh This eloquent breath shall take its speechless flight; That sometime these bright stars, that now reply In sunlight to the sun, shall set in night; That this warm conscious flesh shall perish quite, And all life's ruddy springs forget to flow; That thoughts shall cease, and the immortal sprite Be lapp'd in alien clay and laid below; It is not death to know this--but to know That pious thoughts, which visit at new graves In tender pilgrimage, will cease to go So duly and so oft--and when grass waves Over the pass'd-away, there may be then No resurrection in the minds of men.

_650._ _Fair Ines_

O saw ye not fair Ines? She's gone into the West, To dazzle when the sun is down, And rob the world of rest: She took our daylight with her, The smiles that we love best, With morning blushes on her cheek, And pearls upon her breast.

O turn again, fair Ines, Before the fall of night, For fear the Moon should shine alone, And stars unrivall'd bright; And blessèd will the lover be That walks beneath their light, And breathes the love against thy cheek I dare not even write!

Would I had been, fair Ines, That gallant cavalier, Who rode so gaily by thy side, And whisper'd thee so near! Were there no bonny dames at home, Or no true lovers here, That he should cross the seas to win The dearest of the dear?

I saw thee, lovely Ines, Descend along the shore, With bands of noble gentlemen, And banners waved before; And gentle youth and maidens gay, And snowy plumes they wore: It would have been a beauteous dream,-- If it had been no more!

Alas, alas! fair Ines, She went away with song, With Music waiting on her steps, And shoutings of the throng; But some were sad, and felt no mirth, But only Music's wrong, In sounds that sang Farewell, farewell, To her you've loved so long.

Farewell, farewell, fair Ines! That vessel never bore So fair a lady on its deck, Nor danced so light before,-- Alas for pleasure on the sea, And sorrow on the shore! The smile that bless'd one lover's heart Has broken many more!

_651._ _Time of Roses_

It was not in the Winter Our loving lot was cast; It was the time of roses-- We pluck'd them as we pass'd!

That churlish season never frown'd On early lovers yet: O no--the world was newly crown'd With flowers when first we met!

'Twas twilight, and I bade you go, But still you held me fast; It was the time of roses-- We pluck'd them as we pass'd!

_652._ _Ruth_

She stood breast-high amid the corn, Clasp’d by the golden light of morn, Like the sweetheart of the sun, Who many a glowing kiss had won.

On her cheek an autumn flush, Deeply ripen’d;--such a blush In the midst of brown was born, Like red poppies grown with corn.

Round her eyes her tresses fell, Which were blackest none could tell, But long lashes veiled a light, That had else been all too bright.

And her hat, with shady brim, Made her tressy forehead dim; Thus she stood amid the stooks, Praising God with sweetest looks:--

Sure, I said, Heav’n did not mean, Where I reap thou shouldst but glean, Lay thy sheaf adown and come, Share my harvest and my home.

_653._ _The Death-bed_

We watch’d her breathing thro’ the night, Her breathing soft and low, As in her breast the wave of life Kept heaving to and fro.

So silently we seem’d to speak, So slowly moved about, As we had lent her half our powers To eke her living out.

Our very hopes belied our fears, Our fears our hopes belied-- We thought her dying when she slept, And sleeping when she died.

For when the morn came dim and sad, And chill with early showers, Her quiet eyelids closed--she had Another morn than ours.

_654._ _The Bridge of Sighs_

One more Unfortunate, Weary of breath, Rashly importunate, Gone to her death!

Take her up tenderly, Lift her with care; Fashion’d so slenderly Young, and so fair!

Look at her garments Clinging like cerements; Whilst the wave constantly Drips from her clothing; Take her up instantly, Loving, not loathing.

Touch her not scornfully; Think of her mournfully, Gently and humanly; Not of the stains of her, All that remains of her Now is pure womanly.

Make no deep scrutiny Into her mutiny Rash and undutiful: Past all dishonour, Death has left on her Only the beautiful.

Still, for all slips of hers, One of Eve’s family-- Wipe those poor lips of hers Oozing so clammily.

Loop up her tresses Escaped from the comb, Her fair auburn tresses; Whilst wonderment guesses Where was her home?

Who was her father? Who was her mother? Had she a sister? Had she a brother? Or was there a dearer one Still, and a nearer one Yet, than all other?

Alas! for the rarity Of Christian charity Under the sun! O, it was pitiful! Near a whole city full, Home she had none.

Sisterly, brotherly, Fatherly, motherly Feelings had changed: Love, by harsh evidence, Thrown from its eminence; Even God’s providence Seeming estranged.

Where the lamps quiver So far in the river, With many a light From window and casement, From garret to basement, She stood, with amazement, Houseless by night.

The bleak wind of March Made her tremble and shiver; But not the dark arch, Or the black flowing river:

Mad from life’s history, Glad to death’s mystery, Swift to be hurl’d-- Anywhere, anywhere Out of the world!

In she plunged boldly-- No matter how coldly The rough river ran-- Over the brink of it, Picture it--think of it, Dissolute Man! Lave in it, drink of it, Then, if you can!

Take her up tenderly, Lift her with care; Fashion’d so slenderly, Young, and so fair!

Ere her limbs frigidly Stiffen too rigidly, Decently, kindly, Smooth and compose them; And her eyes, close them, Staring so blindly!

Dreadfully staring Thro’ muddy impurity, As when with the daring Last look of despairing Fix’d on futurity.

Perishing gloomily, Spurr’d by contumely, Cold inhumanity, Burning insanity, Into her rest.-- Cross her hands humbly As if praying dumbly, Over her breast!

Owning her weakness, Her evil behaviour, And leaving, with meekness, Her sins to her Saviour!

WILLIAM THOM

1798-1848

_655._ _The Blind Boy’s Pranks_

Men grew sae cauld, maids sae unkind, Love kentna whaur to stay: Wi’ fient an arrow, bow, or string-- Wi’ droopin’ heart an’ drizzled wing, He faught his lonely way.

‘Is there nae mair in Garioch fair Ae spotless hame for me? Hae politics an’ corn an’ kye Ilk bosom stappit? Fie, O fie! I’ll swithe me o’er the sea.’

He launch’d a leaf o’ jessamine, On whilk he daur’d to swim, An’ pillow’d his head on a wee rosebud, Syne laithfu’, lanely, Love ’gan scud Down Ury’s waefu’ stream.

_655._ kentna] knew not. wi’ fient an arrow] i. q. with deuce an arrow. swithe] hie quickly. laithfu’] regretful.

The birds sang bonnie as Love drew near, But dowie when he gaed by; Till lull’d wi’ the sough o’ monie a sang, He sleepit fu’ soun’ and sail’d alang ’Neath Heaven’s gowden sky.

’Twas just whaur creeping Ury greets Its mountain cousin Don, There wander’d forth a weelfaur’d dame, Wha listless gazed on the bonnie stream, As it flirted an’ play’d with a sunny beam That flicker’d its bosom upon.

Love happit his head, I trow, that time The jessamine bark drew nigh, The lassie espied the wee rosebud, An’ aye her heart gae thud for thud, An’ quiet it wadna lie.

‘O gin I but had yon wearie wee flower That floats on the Ury sae fair!’-- She lootit her hand for the silly rose-leaf, But little wist she o’ the pawkie thief That was lurkin’ an’ laughin’ there!

Love glower’d when he saw her bonnie dark e’e, An’ swore by Heaven’s grace He ne’er had seen nor thought to see, Since e’er he left the Paphian lea, Sae lovely a dwallin’-place.

dowie] dejectedly. weelfaur’d] well-favoured, comely. happit] covered up. lootit] lowered. pawkie] sly. glower’d] stared.

Syne first of a’ in her blythesome breast He built a bower, I ween; An’ what did the waefu’ devilick neist? But kindled a gleam like the rosy east, That sparkled frae baith her e’en.

An’ then beneath ilk high e’e-bree He placed a quiver there; His bow? What but her shinin’ brow? An’ O sic deadly strings he drew Frae out her silken hair!

Guid be our guard! Sic deeds waur deen Roun’ a’ our countrie then; An’ monie a hangin’ lug was seen ’Mang farmers fat, an’ lawyers lean, An’ herds o’ common men!

_655._ e’e-bree] eyebrow. lug] ear.

SIR HENRY TAYLOR

1800-1886

_656._ _Elena’s Song_

Quoth tongue of neither maid nor wife To heart of neither wife nor maid-- Lead we not here a jolly life Betwixt the shine and shade?

Quoth heart of neither maid nor wife To tongue of neither wife nor maid-- Thou wagg’st, but I am worn with strife, And feel like flowers that fade.

THOMAS BABINGTON MACAULAY, LORD MACAULAY

1800-1859

_657._ _A Jacobite’s Epitaph_

To my true king I offer’d free from stain Courage and faith; vain faith, and courage vain. For him I threw lands, honours, wealth, away, And one dear hope, that was more prized than they. For him I languished in a foreign clime, Gray-hair’d with sorrow in my manhood’s prime; Heard on Lavernia Scargill’s whispering trees, And pined by Arno for my lovelier Tees; Beheld each night my home in fever’d sleep, Each morning started from the dream to weep; Till God, who saw me tried too sorely, gave The resting-place I ask’d, an early grave. O thou, whom chance leads to this nameless stone, From that proud country which was once mine own, By those white cliffs I

never more must see, By that dear language which I spake like thee, Forget all feuds, and shed one English tear O’er English dust. A broken heart lies here.

WILLIAM BARNES

1801-1886

_658._ _Mater Dolorosa_

I’d a dream to-night As I fell asleep, O! the touching sight Makes me still to weep: Of my little lad, Gone to leave me sad, Ay, the child I had, But was not to keep.

As in heaven high, I my child did seek, There in train came by Children fair and meek, Each in lily white, With a lamp alight; Each was clear to sight, But they did not speak.

Then, a little sad, Came my child in turn, But the lamp he had, O it did not burn! He, to clear my doubt, Said, half turn’d about, ‘Your tears put it out; Mother, never mourn.’

_659._ _The Wife a-lost_

Since I noo mwore do zee your feäce, Up steärs or down below, I’ll zit me in the lwonesome pleäce, Where flat-bough’d beech do grow; Below the beeches’ bough, my love, Where you did never come, An’ I don’t look to meet ye now, As I do look at hwome.

Since you noo mwore be at my zide, In walks in zummer het, I’ll goo alwone where mist do ride, Droo trees a-drippèn wet; Below the rain-wet bough, my love, Where you did never come, An’ I don’t grieve to miss ye now, As I do grieve at hwome.

Since now bezide my dinner-bwoard Your vaïce do never sound, I’ll eat the bit I can avword A-vield upon the ground; Below the darksome bough, my love, Where you did never dine, An’ I don’t grieve to miss ye now, As I at hwome do pine.

Since I do miss your vaïce an’ feäce In praÿer at eventide, I’ll praÿ wi’ woone sad vaïce vor greäce To goo where you do bide; Above the tree an’ bough, my love, Where you be gone avore, An’ be a-waitèn vor me now, To come vor evermwore.

WINTHROP MACKWORTH PRAED

1802-1839

_660._ _Fairy Song_

He has conn’d the lesson now; He has read the book of pain: There are furrows on his brow; I must make it smooth again.

Lo! I knock the spurs away; Lo! I loosen belt and brand; Hark! I hear the courser neigh For his stall in Fairy-land.

Bring the cap, and bring the vest; Buckle on his sandal shoon; Fetch his memory from the chest In the treasury of the moon.

I have taught him to be wise For a little maiden’s sake;-- Lo! he opens his glad eyes. Softly, slowly: Minstrel, wake!

SARA COLERIDGE

1802-1850

_661._ _O sleep my Babe_

Sleep, my babe, hear not the rippling wave, Nor feel the breeze that round thee ling’ring strays To drink thy balmy breath, And sigh one long farewell.

Soon shall it mourn above thy wat’ry bed, And whisper to me, on the wave-beat shore, Deep murm’ring in reproach, Thy sad untimely fate.

Ere those dear eyes had open’d on the light, In vain to plead, thy coming life was sold, O waken’d but to sleep, Whence it can wake no more!

A thousand and a thousand silken leaves The tufted beech unfolds in early spring, All clad in tenderest green, All of the self-same shape:

A thousand infant faces, soft and sweet, Each year sends forth, yet every mother views Her last not least beloved Like its dear self alone.

No musing mind hath ever yet foreshaped The face to-morrow’s sun shall first reveal, No heart hath e’er conceived What love that face will bring.

O sleep, my babe, nor heed how mourns the gale To part with thy soft locks and fragrant breath, As when it deeply sighs O’er autumn’s latest bloom.

_662._ _The Child_

See yon blithe child that dances in our sight! Can gloomy shadows fall from one so bright? Fond mother, whence these fears? While buoyantly he rushes o’er the lawn, Dream not of clouds to stain his manhood’s dawn, Nor dim that sight with tears.

No cloud he spies in brightly glowing hours, But feels as if the newly vested bowers For him could never fade: Too well we know that vernal pleasures fleet, But having him, so gladsome, fair, and sweet, Our loss is overpaid.

Amid the balmiest flowers that earth can give Some bitter drops distil, and all that live A mingled portion share; But, while he learns these truths which we lament, Such fortitude as ours will sure be sent, Such solace to his care.

GERALD GRIFFIN

1803-1840

_663._ _Eileen Aroon_

When like the early rose, Eileen Aroon! Beauty in childhood blows, Eileen Aroon! When, like a diadem, Buds blush around the stem, Which is the fairest gem?-- Eileen Aroon!

Is it the laughing eye, Eileen Aroon! Is it the timid sigh, Eileen Aroon! Is it the tender tone, Soft as the string'd harp's moan? O, it is truth alone,-- Eileen Aroon!

When like the rising day, Eileen Aroon! Love sends his early ray, Eileen Aroon! What makes his dawning glow, Changeless through joy or woe? Only the constant know:-- Eileen Aroon!

I know a valley fair, Eileen Aroon! I knew a cottage there, Eileen Aroon! Far in that valley's shade I knew a gentle maid, Flower of a hazel glade,-- Eileen Aroon!

Who in the song so sweet? Eileen Aroon! Who in the dance so fleet? Eileen Aroon! Dear were her charms to me, Dearer her laughter free, Dearest her constancy,-- Eileen Aroon!

Were she no longer true, Eileen Aroon! What should her lover do? Eileen Aroon! Fly with his broken chain Far o'er the sounding main, Never to love again,-- Eileen Aroon!

Youth must with time decay, Eileen Aroon! Beauty must fade away, Eileen Aroon! Castles are sack'd in war, Chieftains are scatter'd far, Truth is a fixèd star,-- Eileen Aroon!

JAMES CLARENCE MANGAN

1803-1840

_664._ _Dark Rosaleen_

O my Dark Rosaleen, Do not sigh, do not weep! The priests are on the ocean green, They march along the deep. There's wine from the royal Pope, Upon the ocean green; And Spanish ale shall give you hope, My Dark Rosaleen! My own Rosaleen! Shall glad your heart, shall give you hope, Shall give you health, and help, and hope, My Dark Rosaleen!

Over hills, and thro' dales, Have I roam'd for your sake; All yesterday I sail'd with sails On river and on lake. The Erne, at its highest flood, I dash'd across unseen, For there was lightning in my blood, My Dark Rosaleen! My own Rosaleen! O, there was lightning in my blood, Red lightning lighten'd thro' my blood. My Dark Rosaleen!

All day long, in unrest, To and fro, do I move. The very soul within my breast Is wasted for you, love! The heart in my bosom faints To think of you, my Queen, My life of life, my saint of saints, My Dark Rosaleen! My own Rosaleen! To hear your sweet and sad complaints, My life, my love, my saint of saints, My Dark Rosaleen!

Woe and pain, pain and woe, Are my lot, night and noon, To see your bright face clouded so, Like to the mournful moon. But yet will I rear your throne Again in golden sheen; 'Tis you shall reign, shall reign alone, My Dark Rosaleen! My own Rosaleen! 'Tis you shall have the golden throne, 'Tis you shall reign, and reign alone, My Dark Rosaleen!

Over dews, over sands, Will I fly, for your weal: Your holy delicate white hands Shall girdle me with steel. At home, in your emerald bowers, From morning's dawn

till e’en, You’ll pray for me, my flower of flowers, My Dark Rosaleen! My fond Rosaleen! You’ll think of me through daylight hours, My virgin flower, my flower of flowers, My Dark Rosaleen!

I could scale the blue air, I could plough the high hills, O, I could kneel all night in prayer, To heal your many ills! And one beamy smile from you Would float like light between My toils and me, my own, my true, My Dark Rosaleen! My fond Rosaleen! Would give me life and soul anew, A second life, a soul anew, My Dark Rosaleen!

O, the Erne shall run red, With redundance of blood, The earth shall rock beneath our tread, And flames wrap hill and wood, And gun-peal and slogan-cry Wake many a glen serene, Ere you shall fade, ere you shall die, My Dark Rosaleen! My own Rosaleen! The Judgement Hour must first be nigh, Ere you can fade, ere you can die, My Dark Rosaleen!

_665._ _The Nameless One_

Roll forth, my song, like the rushing river, That sweeps along to the mighty sea; God will inspire me while I deliver My soul of thee!

Tell thou the world, when my bones lie whitening Amid the last homes of youth and eld, That once there was one whose veins ran lightning No eye beheld.

Tell how his boyhood was one drear night-hour, How shone for him, through his griefs and gloom, No star of all heaven sends to light our Path to the tomb.

Roll on, my song, and to after ages Tell how, disdaining all earth can give, He would have taught men, from wisdom’s pages, The way to live.

And tell how trampled, derided, hated, And worn by weakness, disease, and wrong, He fled for shelter to God, who mated His soul with song.

--With song which alway, sublime or vapid, Flow’d like a rill in the morning beam, Perchance not deep, but intense and rapid-- A mountain stream.

Tell how this Nameless, condemn’d for years long To herd with demons from hell beneath, Saw things that made him, with groans and tears, long For even death.

Go on to tell how, with genius wasted, Betray’d in friendship, befool’d in love, With spirit shipwreck’d, and young hopes blasted, He still, still strove;

Till, spent with toil, dreeing death for others (And some whose hands should have wrought for him, If children live not for sires and mothers), His mind grew dim;

And he fell far through that pit abysmal, The gulf and grave of Maginn and Burns, And pawn’d his soul for the devil’s dismal Stock of returns.

But yet redeemed it in days of darkness, And shapes and signs of the final wrath, When death, in hideous and ghastly starkness, Stood on his path.

And tell how now, amid wreck and sorrow, And want, and sickness, and houseless nights, He bides in calmness the silent morrow, That no ray lights.

And lives he still, then? Yes! Old and hoary At thirty-nine, from despair and woe, He lives, enduring what future story Will never know.

Him grant a grave to, ye pitying noble, Deep in your bosoms: there let him dwell! He too, had tears for all souls in trouble, Here and in hell.

THOMAS LOVELL BEDDOES

1803-1849

_666._ _Wolfram’s Dirge_

If thou wilt ease thine heart Of love and all its smart, Then sleep, dear, sleep; And not a sorrow Hang any tear on your eyelashes; Lie still and deep, Sad soul, until the sea-wave washes The rim of the sun to-morrow, In eastern sky.

But wilt thou cure thine heart Of love and all its smart, Then die, dear, die; ’Tis deeper, sweeter, Than on a rose-bank to lie dreaming With folded eye; And there alone, amid the beaming Of Love’s stars, thou’lt meet her In eastern sky.

_667._ _Dream-Pedlary_

If there were dreams to sell, What would you buy? Some cost a passing bell; Some a light sigh, That shakes from Life’s fresh crown Only a rose-leaf down. If there were dreams to sell, Merry and sad to tell, And the crier rang the bell, What would you buy?

A cottage lone and still, With bowers nigh, Shadowy, my woes to still, Until I die. Such pearl from Life’s fresh crown Fain would I shake me down. Were dreams to have at will, This would best heal my ill, This would I buy.

_668._ _Song_

How many times do I love thee, dear? Tell me how many thoughts there be In the atmosphere Of a new-fall’n year, Whose white and sable hours appear The latest flake of Eternity: So many times do I love thee, dear.

How many times do I love again? Tell me how many beads there are In a silver chain Of evening rain, Unravell’d from the tumbling main, And threading the eye of a yellow star: So many times do I love again.

RALPH WALDO EMERSON

1803-1882

_669._ _Give All to Love_

Give all to love; Obey thy heart; Friends, kindred, days, Estate, good fame, Plans, credit, and the Muse-- Nothing refuse.

’Tis a brave master; Let it have scope: Follow it utterly, Hope beyond hope: High and more high It dives into noon, With wing unspent, Untold intent; But it is a god, Knows its own path, And the outlets of the sky.

It was never for the mean; It requireth courage stout, Souls above doubt, Valour unbending: Such ’twill reward;-- They shall return More than they were, And ever

ascending.

Leave all for love; Yet, hear me, yet, One word more thy heart behoved, One pulse more of firm endeavour-- Keep thee to-day, To-morrow, for ever, Free as an Arab Of thy beloved.

Cling with life to the maid; But when the surprise, First vague shadow of surmise, Flits across her bosom young, Of a joy apart from thee, Free be she, fancy-free; Nor thou detain her vesture's hem, Nor the palest rose she flung From her summer diadem.

Though thou loved her as thyself, As a self of purer clay; Though her parting dims the day, Stealing grace from all alive; Heartily know, When half-gods go The gods arrive.

_670._ _Uriel_

It fell in the ancient periods Which the brooding soul surveys, Or ever the wild Time coin'd itself Into calendar months and days.

This was the lapse of Uriel, Which in Paradise befell. Once, among the Pleiads walking, Sayd overheard the young gods talking; And the treason, too long pent, To his ears was evident. The young deities discuss'd Laws of form, and metre just, Orb, quintessence, and sunbeams, What subsisteth, and what seems. One, with low tones that decide, And doubt and reverend use defied, With a look that solved the sphere, And stirr'd the devils everywhere, Gave his sentiment divine Against the being of a line. 'Line in nature is not found; Unit and universe are round; In vain produced, all rays return; Evil will bless, and ice will burn.' As Uriel spoke with piercing eye, A shudder ran around the sky; The stern old war-gods shook their heads; The seraphs frown'd from myrtle-beds; Seem'd to the holy festival The rash word boded ill to all; The balance-beam of Fate was bent; The bounds of good and ill were rent; Strong Hades could not keep his own, But all slid to confusion.

A sad self-knowledge withering fell On the beauty of Uriel; In heaven once eminent, the god Withdrew that hour into his cloud; Whether doom'd to long gyration In the sea of generation, Or by knowledge grown too bright To hit the nerve of feebler sight. Straightway a forgetting wind Stole over the celestial kind, And their lips the secret kept, If in ashes the fire-seed slept. But, now and then, truth-speaking things Shamed the angels' veiling wings; And, shrilling from the solar course, Or from fruit of chemic force, Procession of a soul in matter, Or the speeding change of water, Or out of the good of evil born, Came Uriel's voice of cherub scorn, And a blush tinged the upper sky, And the gods shook, they knew not why.

_671._ _Bacchus_

Bring me wine, but wine which never grew In the belly of the grape, Or grew on vine whose tap-roots, reaching through Under the Andes to the Cape, Suffer'd no savour of the earth to 'scape.

Let its grapes the morn salute From a nocturnal root, Which feels the acrid juice Of Styx and Erebus; And turns the woe of Night, By its own craft, to a more rich delight.

We buy ashes for bread; We buy diluted wine; Give me of the true, Whose ample leaves and tendrils curl’d Among the silver hills of heaven Draw everlasting dew; Wine of wine, Blood of the world, Form of forms, and mould of statures, That I intoxicated, And by the draught assimilated, May float at pleasure through all natures; The bird-language rightly spell, And that which roses say so well:

Wine that is shed Like the torrents of the sun Up the horizon walls, Or like the Atlantic streams, which run When the South Sea calls.

Water and bread, Food which needs no transmuting, Rainbow-flowering, wisdom-fruiting, Wine which is already man, Food which teach and reason can.

Wine which Music is,-- Music and wine are one,-- That I, drinking this, Shall hear far Chaos talk with me; Kings unborn shall walk with me; And the poor grass shall plot and plan What it will do when it is man. Quicken’d so, will I unlock Every crypt of every rock.

I thank the joyful juice For all I know; Winds of remembering Of the ancient being blow, And seeming-solid walls of use Open and flow.

Pour, Bacchus! the remembering wine; Retrieve the loss of me and mine! Vine for vine be antidote, And the grape requite the lote! Haste to cure the old despair; Reason in Nature’s lotus drench’d-- The memory of ages quench’d-- Give them again to shine; Let wine repair what this undid; And where the infection slid, A dazzling memory revive; Refresh the faded tints, Recut the agèd prints, And write my old adventures with the pen Which on the first day drew, Upon the tablets blue, The dancing Pleiads and eternal men.

_672._ _Brahma_

If the red slayer think he slays, Or if the slain think he is slain, They know not well the subtle ways I keep, and pass, and turn again.

Far or forgot to me is near; Shadow and sunlight are the same; The vanish’d gods to me appear; And one to me are shame and fame.

They reckon ill who leave me out; When me they fly, I am the wings; I am the doubter and the doubt, And I the hymn the Brahmin sings.

The strong gods pine for my abode, And pine in vain the sacred Seven; But thou, meek lover of the good! Find me, and turn thy back on heaven.

RICHARD HENRY HORNE

1803-1884

_673._ _The Plough_

A LANDSCAPE IN BERKSHIRE

Above yon sombre swell of land Thou see’st the dawn’s grave orange hue, With one pale streak like yellow sand, And over that a vein of blue.

The air is cold above the woods; All silent is the earth and sky, Except with his own lonely moods The blackbird holds a colloquy.

Over the broad hill creeps a beam, Like hope that gilds a good man’s brow; And now ascends the nostril-stream Of stalwart horses come to plough.

Ye rigid Ploughmen, bear in mind Your labour is for future hours: Advance--spare not--nor look behind-- Plough deep and straight with all your powers!

ROBERT STEPHEN HAWKER

1804-1875

_674._ _King Arthur’s Waes-hael_

Waes-hael for knight and dame! O merry be their dole! Drink-hael! in Jesu’s name We fill the tawny bowl; But cover down the curving crest, Mould of the Orient Lady’s breast.

Waes-hael! yet lift no lid: Drain ye the reeds for wine. Drink-hael! the milk was hid That soothed that Babe divine; Hush’d, as this hollow channel flows, He drew the balsam from the rose.

Waes-hael! thus glow’d the breast Where a God yearn’d to cling; Drink-hael! so Jesu press’d Life from its mystic spring; Then hush and bend in reverent sign And breathe the thrilling reeds for wine.

Waes-hael! in shadowy scene Lo! Christmas children we: Drink-hael! behold we lean At a far Mother’s knee; To dream that thus her bosom smiled, And learn the lip of Bethlehem’s Child.

_675._ _Are they not all Ministering Spirits?_

We see them not--we cannot hear The music of their wing-- Yet know we that they sojourn near, The Angels of the spring!

They glide along this lovely ground When the first violet grows; Their graceful hands have just unbound The zone of yonder rose.

I gather it for thy dear breast, From stain and shadow free: That which an Angel’s touch hath blest Is meet, my love, for thee!

THOMAS WADE

1805-1875

_676._ _The Half-asleep_

O for the mighty wakening that aroused The old-time Prophets to their missions high; And to blind Homer’s inward sunlike eye Show’d the heart’s universe where he caroused Radiantly; the Fishers poor unhoused, And sent them forth to preach divinity; And made our Milton his great dark defy, To the light of one immortal theme espoused! But half asleep are those now most awake; And save calm-thoughted

Wordsworth, we have none Who for eternity put time at stake, And hold a constant course as doth the sun: We yield but drops that no deep thirstings slake; And feebly cease ere we have well begun.

FRANCIS MAHONY

1805-1866

_677._ _The Bells of Shandon_

With deep affection, And recollection, I often think of Those Shandon bells, Whose sounds so wild would, In the days of childhood, Fling around my cradle Their magic spells. On this I ponder Where'er I wander, And thus grow fonder, Sweet Cork, of thee; With thy bells of Shandon, That sound so grand on The pleasant waters Of the River Lee.

I've heard bells chiming Full many a clime in, Tolling sublime in Cathedral shrine, While at a glib rate Brass tongues would vibrate-- But all their music Spoke naught like thine; For memory, dwelling On each proud swelling Of the belfry knelling Its bold notes free, Made the bells of Shandon Sound far more grand on The pleasant waters Of the River Lee.

I've heard bells tolling Old Adrian's Mole in, Their thunder rolling From the Vatican, And cymbals glorious Swinging uproarious In the gorgeous turrets Of Notre Dame; But thy sounds were sweeter Than the dome of Peter Flings o'er the Tiber, Pealing solemnly-- O, the bells of Shandon Sound far more grand on The pleasant waters Of the River Lee.

There's a bell in Moscow, While on tower and kiosk O! In Saint Sophia The Turkman gets, And loud in air Calls men to prayer From the tapering summits Of tall minarets. Such empty phantom I freely grant them; But there's an anthem More dear to me,-- 'Tis the bells of Shandon, That sound so grand on The pleasant waters Of the River Lee.

ELIZABETH BARRETT BROWNING

1806-1861

_678._ _Rosalind's Scroll_

I left thee last, a child at heart, A woman scarce in years: I come to thee, a solemn corpse Which neither feels nor fears. I have no breath to use in sighs; They laid the dead-weights on mine eyes To seal them safe from tears.

Look on me with thine own calm look: I meet it calm as thou. No look of thine can change this smile, Or break thy sinful vow: I tell thee that my poor scorn'd heart Is of thine earth--thine earth--a part: It cannot vex thee now.

I have pray'd for thee with bursting sob When passion's course was free; I have pray'd for thee with silent lips In the anguish none could see; They whisper'd oft, 'She sleepeth soft'-- But I only pray'd for thee.

Go to! I pray for thee no more: The corpse’s tongue is still; Its folded fingers point to heaven, But point there stiff and chill: No farther wrong, no farther woe Hath licence from the sin below Its tranquil heart to thrill.

I charge thee, by the living’s prayer, And the dead’s silentness, To wring from out thy soul a cry Which God shall hear and bless! Lest Heaven’s own palm droop in my hand, And pale among the saints I stand, A saint companionless.

_679._ _The Deserted Garden_

I mind me in the days departed, How often underneath the sun With childish bounds I used to run To a garden long deserted.

The beds and walks were vanish’d quite; And wheresoe’er had struck the spade, The greenest grasses Nature laid, To sanctify her right.

I call’d the place my wilderness, For no one enter’d there but I. The sheep look’d in, the grass to espy, And pass’d it ne’ertheless.

The trees were interwoven wild, And spread their boughs enough about To keep both sheep and shepherd out, But not a happy child.

Adventurous joy it was for me; I crept beneath the boughs, and found A circle smooth of mossy ground Beneath a poplar-tree.

Old garden rose-trees hedged it in; Bedropt with roses waxen-white, Well satisfied with dew and light, And careless to be seen.

Long years ago, it might befall, When all the garden flowers were trim, The grave old gardener prided him On these the most of all.

Some Lady, stately overmuch, Here moving with a silken noise, Has blush’d beside them at the voice That liken’d her to such.

Or these, to make a diadem, She often may have pluck’d and twined; Half-smiling as it came to mind, That few would look at _them_.

O, little thought that Lady proud, A child would watch her fair white rose, When buried lay her whiter brows, And silk was changed for shroud!--

Nor thought that gardener (full of scorns For men unlearn’d and simple phrase) A child would bring it all its praise, By creeping through the thorns!

To me upon my low moss seat, Though never a dream the roses sent Of science or love’s compliment, I ween they smelt as sweet.

It did not move my grief to see The trace of human step departed: Because the garden was deserted, The blither place for me!

Friends, blame me not! a narrow ken Hath childhood ’twixt the sun and sward; We draw the moral afterward-- We feel the gladness then.

And gladdest hours for me did glide In silence at the rose-tree wall: A thrush made gladness musical Upon the other side.

Nor he nor I did e’er incline To peck or pluck the blossoms white:-- How should I know but that they might Lead lives as glad as mine?

To make my hermit-home complete, I brought clear water from the spring Praised in its own low murmuring, And cresses glossy wet.

And so, I thought, my likeness grew (Without the melancholy tale) To ‘gentle hermit of the dale,’ And Angelina too.

For oft I read within my nook Such minstrel stories; till the breeze Made sounds poetic in the trees, And then I shut the book.

If I shut this wherein I write, I hear no more the wind athwart Those trees, nor feel that childish heart Delighting in delight.

My childhood from my life is parted, My footstep from the moss which drew Its fairy circle round: anew The garden is deserted.

Another thrush may there rehearse The madrigals which sweetest are; No more for me!--myself afar Do sing a sadder verse.

Ah me! ah me! when erst I lay In that child’s-nest so greenly wrought, I laugh’d unto myself and thought, ‘The time will pass away.’

And still I laugh’d, and did not fear But that, whene’er was pass’d away The childish time, some happier play My womanhood would cheer.

I knew the time would pass away; And yet, beside the rose-tree wall, Dear God, how seldom, if at all, Did I look up to pray!

The time is past: and now that grows The cypress high among the trees, And I behold white sepulchres As well as the white rose,--

When wiser, meeker thoughts are given, And I have learnt to lift my face, Reminded how earth’s greenest place The colour draws from heaven,--

It something saith for earthly pain, But more for heavenly promise free, That I who was, would shrink to be That happy child again.

_680._ _Consolation_

All are not taken; there are left behind Living Belovèds, tender looks to bring And make the daylight still a happy thing, And tender voices, to make soft the wind: But if it were not so--if I could find No love in all this world for comforting, Nor any path but hollowly did ring Where ‘dust to dust’ the love from life disjoin’d, And if, before those sepulchres unmoving I stood alone (as some forsaken lamb Goes bleating up the moors in weary dearth) Crying ‘Where are ye, O my loved and loving?’-- I know a voice would sound, ‘Daughter, I AM. Can I suffice for Heaven and not for earth?’

_681._ _Grief_

I tell you, hopeless grief is passionless; That only men incredulous of despair, Half-taught in anguish, through the midnight air Beat upward to God’s throne in loud access Of shrieking and reproach. Full desertness In souls as countries lieth silent-bare Under the blanching, vertical eye-glare Of the absolute Heavens.

Deep-hearted man, express Grief for thy Dead in silence like to death-- Most like a monumental statue set In everlasting watch and moveless woe Till itself crumble to the dust beneath. Touch it; the marble eyelids are not wet: If it could weep, it could arise and go.

Sonnets from the Portuguese

_682._ _i_

I thought once how Theocritus had sung Of the sweet years, the dear and wish’d-for years, Who each one in a gracious hand appears To bear a gift for mortals old or young: And, as I mused it in his antique tongue, I saw in gradual vision through my tears The sweet, sad years, the melancholy years-- Those of my own life, who by turns had flung A shadow across me. Straightway I was ’ware, So weeping, how a mystic Shape did move Behind me, and drew me backward by the hair; And a voice said in mastery, while I strove, ‘Guess now who holds thee?’--‘Death’ I said. But there The silver answer rang--'Not Death, but Love.’

_683._ _ii_

Unlike are we, unlike, O princely Heart! Unlike our uses and our destinies. Our ministering two angels look surprise On one another, as they strike athwart Their wings in passing. Thou, bethink thee, art A guest for queens to social pageantries, With gages from a hundred brighter eyes Than tears even can make mine, to play thy part Of chief musician. What hast thou to do With looking from the lattice-lights at me-- A poor, tired, wandering singer, singing through The dark, and leaning up a cypress tree? The chrism is on thine head--on mine the dew-- And Death must dig the level where these agree.

_684._ _iii_

Go from me. Yet I feel that I shall stand Henceforward in thy shadow. Nevermore Alone upon the threshold of my door Of individual life I shall command The uses of my soul, nor lift my hand Serenely in the sunshine as before, Without the sense of that which I forbore-- Thy touch upon the palm. The widest land Doom takes to part us, leaves thy heart in mine With pulses that beat double. What I do And what I dream include thee, as the wine Must taste of its own grapes. And when I sue God for myself, He hears that name of thine, And sees within my eyes the tears of two.

_685._ _iv_

If thou must love me, let it be for naught Except for love’s sake only. Do not say, ‘I love her for her smile--her look--her way Of speaking gently,--for a trick of thought That falls in well with mine, and certes brought A sense of pleasant ease on such a day-- For these things in themselves, Belovèd, may Be changed, or change for thee--and love, so wrought, May be unwrought so. Neither love me for Thine own dear pity’s wiping my cheeks dry: A creature might forget to weep, who bore Thy comfort long, and lose thy love thereby! But love me for love’s sake, that evermore Thou mayst love on, through love’s eternity.

_686._ _v_

When our two souls stand up erect and strong, Face to face, silent, drawing nigh and nigher, Until the lengthening wings break into fire At either curving point,--what bitter wrong Can the earth do us, that we should not long Be here contented? Think! In mounting higher, The angels would press on us, and aspire To drop some golden orb of perfect song Into our deep, dear silence. Let us stay Rather on earth, Belovèd--where the unfit Contrarious moods of men recoil away And isolate pure spirits, and permit A place to stand and love in for a day, With darkness and the death-hour rounding it.

_687._ _A Musical Instrument_

What was he doing, the great god Pan, Down in the reeds by the river? Spreading ruin and scattering ban, Splashing and paddling with hoofs of a goat, And breaking the golden lilies afloat With the dragon-fly on the river.

He tore out a reed, the great god Pan, From the deep cool bed of the river; The limpid water turbidly ran, And the broken lilies a-dying lay, And the dragon-fly had fled away, Ere he brought it out of the river.

High on the shore sat the great god Pan, While turbidly flow’d the river; And hack’d and hew’d as a great god can With his hard bleak steel at the patient reed, Till there was not a sign of the leaf indeed To prove it fresh from the river.

He cut it short, did the great god Pan (How tall it stood in the river!), Then drew the pith, like the heart of a man, Steadily from the outside ring, And notch’d the poor dry empty thing In holes, as he sat by the river.

‘This is the way’ laugh’d the great god Pan (Laugh’d while he sat by the river), ‘The only way, since gods began To make sweet music, they could succeed.’ Then dropping his mouth to a hole in the reed, He blew in power by the river.

Sweet, sweet, sweet, O Pan! Piercing sweet by the river! Blinding sweet, O great god Pan! The sun on the hill forgot to die, And the lilies revived, and the dragon-fly Came back to dream on the river.

Yet half a beast is the great god Pan, To laugh as he sits by the river, Making a poet out of a man: The true gods sigh for the cost and pain-- For the reed which grows nevermore again As a reed with the reeds of the river.

FREDERICK TENNYSON

1807-1898

_688._ _The Holy Tide_

The days are sad, it is the Holy tide. The Winter morn is short, the Night is long; So let the lifeless Hours be glorified With deathless thoughts and echo’d in sweet song: And through the sunset of this purple cup They will resume the roses of their prime, And the old Dead will hear us and wake up, Pass with dim smiles and make our hearts sublime!

The days are sad, it is the Holy tide: Be dusky mistletoes and hollies strown, Sharp as the spear that pierced His sacred side, Red as the drops upon His thorny crown; No haggard Passion and no lawless Mirth Fright off the solemn Muse,--tell sweet old tales, Sing songs as we sit brooding o’er the hearth, Till the lamp flickers, and the memory fails.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW

1807-1882

_689._ _My Lost Youth_

Often I think of the beautiful town That is seated by the sea; Often in thought go up and down The pleasant streets of that dear old town, And my youth comes back to me. And a verse of a Lapland song Is haunting my memory still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I can see the shadowy lines of its trees, And catch, in sudden gleams, The sheen of the far-surrounding seas, And islands that were the Hesperides Of all my boyish dreams. And the burden of that old song, It murmurs and whispers still: ‘A Boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I remember the black wharves and the slips, And the sea-tides tossing free; And Spanish sailors with bearded lips, And the beauty and mystery of the ships, And the magic of the sea. And the voice of that wayward song Is singing and saying still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I remember the bulwarks by the shore, And the fort upon the hill; The sunrise gun with its hollow roar, The drum-beat repeated o’er and o’er, And the bugle wild and shrill. And the music of that old song Throbs in my memory still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I remember the sea-fight far away, How it thunder’d o’er the tide! And the dead sea-captains, as they lay In their graves o’erlooking the tranquil bay Where they in battle died. And the sound of that mournful song Goes through me with a thrill: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I can see the breezy dome of groves, The shadows of Deering’s woods; And the friendships old and the early loves Come back with a Sabbath sound, as of doves In quiet neighbourhoods. And the verse of that sweet old song, It flutters and murmurs still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

I remember the gleams and glooms that dart Across the schoolboy’s brain; The song and the silence in the heart, That in part are prophecies, and in part Are longings wild and vain. And the voice of that fitful song Sings on, and is never still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

There are things of which I may not speak; There are dreams that cannot die; There are thoughts that make the strong heart weak, And bring a pallor into the cheek, And a mist before the eye. And the words of that fatal song Come over me like

a chill: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

Strange to me now are the forms I meet When I visit the dear old town; But the native air is pure and sweet, And the trees that o’ershadow each well-known street, As they balance up and down, Are singing the beautiful song, Are sighing and whispering still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

And Deering’s woods are fresh and fair, And with joy that is almost pain My heart goes back to wander there, And among the dreams of the days that were I find my lost youth again. And the strange and beautiful song, The groves are repeating it still: ‘A boy’s will is the wind’s will, And the thoughts of youth are long, long thoughts.’

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER

1807-1892

_690._ _Vesta_

O Christ of God! whose life and death Our own have reconciled, Most quietly, most tenderly Take home thy star-named child!

Thy grace is in her patient eyes, Thy words are on her tongue; The very silence round her seems As if the angels sung.

Her smile is as a listening child’s Who hears its mother’s call; The lilies of Thy perfect peace About her pillow fall.

She leans from out our clinging arms To rest herself in Thine; Alone to Thee, dear Lord, can we Our well-beloved resign.

O, less for her than for ourselves We bow our heads and pray; Her setting star, like Bethlehem’s, To Thee shall point the way!

HELEN SELINA, LADY DUFFERIN

1807-1867

_691._ _Lament of the Irish Emigrant_

I’m sittin’ on the stile, Mary, Where we sat side by side On a bright May mornin’ long ago, When first you were my bride; The corn was springin’ fresh and green, And the lark sang loud and high-- And the red was on your lip, Mary, And the love-light in your eye.

The place is little changed, Mary, The day is bright as then, The lark’s loud song is in my ear, And the corn is green again; But I miss the soft clasp of your hand, And your breath warm on my cheek, And I still keep list’ning for the words You never more will speak.

’Tis but a step down yonder lane, And the little church stands near, The church where we were wed, Mary, I see the spire from here. But the graveyard lies between, Mary, And my step might break your rest-- For I’ve laid you, darling! down to sleep, With your baby on your breast.

I’m very lonely now, Mary, For the poor make no new friends, But, O, they love the better still, The few our Father sends! And you were all _I_ had, Mary, My blessin’ and my pride: There’s nothin’ left to care for now, Since my poor Mary died.

Yours was the good, brave heart, Mary, That still kept hoping on, When the trust in God had left my soul, And my arm’s young strength was gone: There was comfort ever on your lip, And the kind look on your brow-- I bless you, Mary, for that same, Though you cannot hear me now.

I thank you for the patient smile When your heart was fit to break, When the hunger pain was gnawin’ there, And you hid it, for my sake! I bless you for the pleasant word, When your heart was sad and sore-- O, I’m thankful you are gone, Mary, Where grief can’t reach you more!

I’m biddin’ you a long farewell, My Mary--kind and true! But I’ll not forget you, darling! In the land I’m goin’ to; They say there’s bread and work for all, And the sun shines always there-- But I’ll not forget old Ireland, Were it fifty times as fair!

And often in those grand old woods I’ll sit, and shut my eyes, And my heart will travel back again To the place where Mary lies; And I’ll think I see the little stile Where we sat side by side: And the springin’ corn, and the bright May morn, When first you were my bride.

CAROLINE ELIZABETH SARAH NORTON

1808-1876

_692._ _I do not love Thee_

I do not love thee!--no! I do not love thee! And yet when thou art absent I am sad; And envy even the bright blue sky above thee, Whose quiet stars may see thee and be glad.

I do not love thee!--yet, I know not why, Whate’er thou dost seems still well done, to me: And often in my solitude I sigh That those I do love are not more like thee!

I do not love thee!--yet, when thou art gone, I hate the sound (though those who speak be dear) Which breaks the lingering echo of the tone Thy voice of music leaves upon my ear.

I do not love thee!--yet thy speaking eyes, With their deep, bright, and most expressive blue, Between me and the midnight heaven arise, Oftener than any eyes I ever knew.

I know I do not love thee! yet, alas! Others will scarcely trust my candid heart; And oft I catch them smiling as they pass, Because they see me gazing where thou art.

CHARLES TENNYSON TURNER

1808-1879

_693._ _Letty’s Globe_

When Letty had scarce pass’d her third glad year, And her young artless words began to flow, One day we gave the child a colour’d sphere Of the wide earth, that she might mark and know, By tint and outline, all its sea and land. She patted all the world; old empires peep’d Between her baby fingers; her soft hand Was welcome at all frontiers. How she leap’d, And laugh’d and prattled in her world-wide bliss; But when we turn’d her sweet unlearnèd eye On our own isle, she raised a joyous cry-- ‘Oh! yes, I see it, Letty’s home is there!’ And while she hid all England with a kiss, Bright over Europe fell her golden hair.

EDGAR ALLAN POE

1809-1849

_694._ _To Helen_

Helen, thy beauty is to me Like those Nicèan barks of yore That gently, o’er a perfumed sea, The weary way-worn wanderer bore To his own native shore.

On desperate seas long wont to roam, Thy hyacinth hair, thy classic face, Thy Naiad airs have brought me home To the glory that was Greece, And the grandeur that was Rome.

Lo, in yon brilliant window-niche How statue-like I see thee stand, The agate lamp within thy hand, Ah! Psyche, from the regions which Are holy land!

_695._ _Annabel Lee_

It was many and many a year ago, In a kingdom by the sea, That a maiden there lived whom you may know By the name of Annabel Lee. And this maiden she lived with no other thought Than to love and be loved by me.

I was a child and she was a child In this kingdom by the sea: But we loved with a love that was more than love-- I and my Annabel Lee, With a love that the wingèd seraphs of heaven Coveted her and me.

And this was the reason that, long ago, In this kingdom by the sea, A wind blew out of a cloud, chilling My beautiful Annabel Lee, So that her high-born kinsmen came And bore her away from me, To shut her up in a sepulchre In this kingdom by the sea.

The angels, not half so happy in heaven, Went envying her and me-- Yes! that was the reason (as all men know, In this kingdom by the sea) That the wind came out of the cloud one night, Chilling and killing my Annabel Lee.

But our love it was stronger by far than the love Of those who were older than we-- Of many far wiser than we-- And neither the angels in heaven above, Nor the demons down under the sea, Can ever dissever my soul from the soul Of the beautiful Annabel

Lee:

For the moon never beams without bringing me dreams Of the beautiful Annabel Lee; And the stars never rise, but I feel the bright eyes Of the beautiful Annabel Lee; And so, all the night-tide, I lie down by the side Of my darling--my darling--my life and my bride, In the sepulchre there by the sea, In her tomb by the sounding sea.

_696._ _For Annie_

Thank Heaven! the crisis-- The danger is past, And the lingering illness Is over at last-- And the fever called ‘Living’ Is conquer’d at last.

Sadly, I know I am shorn of my strength, And no muscle I move As I lie at full length: But no matter--I feel I am better at length.

And I rest so composedly Now, in my bed, That any beholder Might fancy me dead-- Might start at beholding me, Thinking me dead.

The moaning and groaning, The sighing and sobbing, Are quieted now, With that horrible throbbing At heart--ah, that horrible, Horrible throbbing!

The sickness--the nausea-- The pitiless pain-- Have ceased, with the fever That madden’d my brain-- With the fever called ‘Living’ That burn’d in my brain.

And O! of all tortures That torture the worst Has abated--the terrible Torture of thirst For the naphthaline river Of Passion accurst-- I have drunk of a water That quenches all thirst.

--Of a water that flows, With a lullaby sound, From a spring but a very few Feet under ground-- From a cavern not very far Down under ground.

And ah! let it never Be foolishly said That my room it is gloomy, And narrow my bed; For man never slept In a different bed-- And, to _sleep_, you must slumber In just such a bed.

My tantalized spirit Here blandly reposes, Forgetting, or never Regretting its roses-- Its old agitations Of myrtles and roses:

For now, while so quietly Lying, it fancies A holier odour About it, of pansies-- A rosemary odour, Commingled with pansies-- With rue and the beautiful Puritan pansies.

And so it lies happily, Bathing in many A dream of the truth And the beauty of Annie-- Drown’d in a bath Of the tresses of Annie.

She tenderly kiss’d me, She fondly caress’d, And then I fell gently To sleep on her breast-- Deeply to sleep From the heaven of her breast.

When the light was extinguish’d, She cover’d me warm, And she pray’d to the angels To keep me from harm-- To the queen of the angels To shield me from harm.

And I lie so composedly, Now, in my bed (Knowing her love), That you fancy me dead-- And I rest so contentedly, Now, in my bed (With her love at my breast), That you fancy me dead-- That you shudder to look at me, Thinking me dead.

But my heart it is brighter Than all of the many Stars in the sky, For it sparkles with Annie-- It glows with the light Of the love of my Annie-- With the thought of the light Of the eyes of my Annie.

EDWARD FITZGERALD

1809-1883

_697._ _Old Song_

'Tis a dull sight To see the year dying, When winter winds Set the yellow wood sighing: Sighing, O sighing!

When such a time cometh I do retire Into an old room Beside a bright fire: O, pile a bright fire!

And there I sit Reading old things, Of knights and lorn damsels, While the wind sings-- O, drearily sings!

I never look out Nor attend to the blast; For all to be seen Is the leaves falling fast: Falling, falling!

But close at the hearth, Like a cricket, sit I, Reading of summer And chivalry-- Gallant chivalry!

Then with an old friend I talk of our youth-- How 'twas gladsome, but often Foolish, forsooth: But gladsome, gladsome!

Or, to get merry, We sing some old rhyme That made the wood ring again In summer time-- Sweet summer time!

Then go we smoking, Silent and snug: Naught passes between us, Save a brown jug-- Sometimes!

And sometimes a tear Will rise in each eye, Seeing the two old friends So merrily-- So merrily!

And ere to bed Go we, go we, Down on the ashes We kneel on the knee, Praying together!

Thus, then, live I Till, 'mid all the gloom, By Heaven! the bold sun Is with me in the room Shining, shining!

Then the clouds part, Swallows soaring between; The spring is alive, And the meadows are green!

I jump up like mad, Break the old pipe in twain, And away to the meadows, The meadows again!

_698._ _From Omar Khayyám_

I

A Book of Verses underneath the Bough, A Jug of Wine, a Loaf of Bread--and Thou Beside me singing in the Wilderness-- O. Wilderness were Paradise enow!

Some for the Glories of This World; and some Sigh for the Prophet’s Paradise to come; Ah, take the Cash, and let the Credit go, Nor heed the rumble of a distant Drum!

Look to the blowing Rose about us--‘Lo, Laughing,’ she says, ‘into the world I blow, At once the silken tassel of my Purse Tear, and its Treasure on the Garden throw.’

And those who husbanded the Golden grain And those who flung it to the winds like Rain Alike to no such aureate Earth are turn’d As, buried once, Men want dug up again.

II

Think, in this batter’d Caravanserai Whose Portals are alternate Night and Day, How Sultán after Sultán with his Pomp Abode his destined Hour, and went his way.

They say the Lion and the Lizard keep The Courts where Jamshyd gloried and drank deep: And Bahrám, that great Hunter--the wild Ass Stamps o’er his Head, but cannot break his Sleep.

I sometimes think that never blows so red The Rose as where some buried Cæsar bled; That every Hyacinth the Garden wears Dropt in her Lap from some once lovely Head.

And this reviving Herb whose tender Green Fledges the River-Lip on which we lean-- Ah, lean upon it lightly! for who knows From what once lovely Lip it springs unseen!

Ah, my Belovèd, fill the Cup that clears TO-DAY of past Regrets and Future Fears: _To-morrow!_--Why, To-morrow I may be Myself with Yesterday’s Sev’n thousand Years.

For some we loved, the loveliest and the best That from his Vintage rolling Time hath prest, Have drunk their Cup a Round or two before, And one by one crept silently to rest.

And we, that now make merry in the Room They left, and Summer dresses in new bloom, Ourselves must we beneath the Couch of Earth Descend--ourselves to make a Couch--for whom?

Ah, make the most of what we yet may spend, Before we too into the Dust descend; Dust unto Dust, and under Dust to lie, Sans Wine, sans Song, sans Singer, and--sans End!

III

Ah, with the Grape my fading Life provide, And wash my Body whence the Life has died, And lay me, shrouded in the living Leaf, By some not unfrequented

Garden-side....

Yon rising Moon that looks for us again-- How oft hereafter will she wax and wane; How oft hereafter rising look for us Through this same Garden--and for _one_ in vain!

And when like her, O Sákí, you shall pass Among the Guests star-scatter'd on the Grass, And in your joyous errand reach the spot Where I made One--turn down an empty Glass!

ALFRED TENNYSON, LORD TENNYSON

1809-1892

_699._ _Mariana_

With blackest moss the flower-plots Were thickly crusted, one and all: The rusted nails fell from the knots That held the pear to the gable-wall. The broken sheds look'd sad and strange: Unlifted was the clinking latch; Weeded and worn the ancient thatch Upon the lonely moated grange. She only said, 'My life is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary, I would that I were dead!'

Her tears fell with the dews at even; Her tears fell ere the dews were dried; She could not look on the sweet heaven, Either at morn or eventide. After the flitting of the bats, When thickest dark did trance the sky, She drew her casement-curtain by, And glanced athwart the glooming flats. She only said, 'The night is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary, I would that I were dead!'

Upon the middle of the night, Waking she heard the night-fowl crow: The cock sung out an hour ere light: From the dark fen the oxen's low Came to her: without hope of change, In sleep she seem'd to walk forlorn, Till cold winds woke the gray-eyed morn About the lonely moated grange. She only said, 'The day is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary, I would that I were dead!'

About a stone-cast from the wall A sluice with blacken'd waters slept, And o'er it many, round and small, The cluster'd marish-mosses crept. Hard by a poplar shook alway, All silver-green with gnarlèd bark: For leagues no other tree did mark The level waste, the rounding gray. She only said, 'My life is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary, I would that I were dead!'

And ever when the moon was low, And the shrill winds were up and away, In the white curtain, to and fro, She saw the gusty shadow sway. But when the moon was very low, And wild winds bound within their cell, The shadow of the poplar fell Upon her bed, across her brow. She only said, 'The night is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary, I would that I were dead!'

All day within the dreamy house, The doors upon their hinges creak'd; The blue fly sung in the pane; the mouse Behind the mouldering wainscot shriek'd, Or from the crevice peer'd about. Old faces glimmer'd thro' the doors, Old footsteps trod the upper floors, Old voices call'd her from without. She only said, 'My life is dreary, He cometh not,' she said; She said, 'I am aweary, aweary,' I would that I were dead!'

The sparrow’s chirrup on the roof, The slow clock ticking, and the sound Which to the wooing wind aloof The poplar made, did all confound Her sense; but most she loathed the hour When the thick-moted sunbeam lay Athwart the chambers, and the day Was sloping toward his western bower. Then, said she, ‘I am very dreary, He will not come,’ she said; She wept, ‘I am aweary, aweary, O God, that I were dead!’

_700.__The Lady of Shalott_

PART I

On either side the river lie Long fields of barley and of rye, That clothe the wold and meet the sky; And thro’ the field the road runs by To many-tower’d Camelot; And up and down the people go, Gazing where the lilies blow Round an island there below, The island of Shalott.

Willows whiten, aspens quiver, Little breezes dusk and shiver Thro’ the wave that runs for ever By the island in the river Flowing down to Camelot. Four gray walls, and four gray towers, Overlook a space of flowers, And the silent isle imbowers The Lady of Shalott.

By the margin, willow-veil’d, Slide the heavy barges trail’d By slow horses; and unhail’d The shallop flitteth silken-sail’d Skimming down to Camelot: But who hath seen her wave her hand? Or at the casement seen her stand? Or is she known in all the land, The Lady of Shalott?

Only reapers, reaping early In among the bearded barley, Hear a song that echoes cheerly From the river winding clearly, Down to tower’d Camelot: And by the moon the reaper weary, Piling sheaves in uplands airy, Listening, whispers ‘’Tis the fairy Lady of Shalott.’

PART II

There she weaves by night and day A magic web with colours gay. She has heard a whisper say, A curse is on her if she stay To look down to Camelot. She knows not what the curse may be, And so she weaveth steadily, And little other care hath she, The Lady of Shalott.

And moving thro’ a mirror clear That hangs before her all the year, Shadows of the world appear. There she sees the highway near Winding down to Camelot: There the river eddy whirls, And there the surly village-churls, And the red cloaks of market girls, Pass onward from Shalott.

Sometimes a troop of damsels glad, An abbot on an ambling pad, Sometimes a curly shepherd-lad, Or long-hair’d page in crimson clad, Goes by to tower’d Camelot; And sometimes thro’ the mirror blue The knights come riding two and two: She hath no loyal knight and true, The Lady of Shalott.

But in her web she still delights To weave the mirror’s magic sights, For often thro’ the silent nights A funeral, with plumes and lights, And music, went to Camelot: Or when the moon was overhead, Came two young lovers lately wed; ‘I am half sick of

shadows,’ said The Lady of Shalott.

PART III

A bow-shot from her bower-eaves, He rode between the barley-sheaves, The sun came dazzling thro’ the leaves, And flamed upon the brazen greaves Of bold Sir Lancelot. A red-cross knight for ever kneel’d To a lady in his shield, That sparkled on the yellow field, Beside remote Shalott.

The gemmy bridle glitter’d free, Like to some branch of stars we see Hung in the golden Galaxy. The bridle bells rang merrily As he rode down to Camelot; And from his blazon’d baldric slung A mighty silver bugle hung, And as he rode his armour rung, Beside remote Shalott.

All in the blue unclouded weather Thick-jewell’d shone the saddle-leather, The helmet and the helmet-feather Burn’d like one burning flame together, As he rode down to Camelot. As often thro’ the purple night, Below the starry clusters bright, Some bearded meteor, trailing light, Moves over still Shalott.

His broad clear brow in sunlight glow’d; On burnish’d hooves his war-horse trode; From underneath his helmet flow’d His coal-black curls as on he rode, As he rode down to Camelot. From the bank and from the river He flash’d into the crystal mirror, ‘Tirra lirra,’ by the river Sang Sir Lancelot.

She left the web, she left the loom, She made three paces thro’ the room, She saw the water-lily bloom, She saw the helmet and the plume, She look’d down to Camelot. Out flew the web and floated wide; The mirror crack’d from side to side; ‘The curse is come upon me!’ cried The Lady of Shalott.

PART IV

In the stormy east-wind straining, The pale yellow woods were waning, The broad stream in his banks complaining, Heavily the low sky raining Over tower’d Camelot; Down she came and found a boat Beneath a willow left afloat, And round about the prow she wrote _The Lady of Shalott_.

And down the river’s dim expanse-- Like some bold seer in a trance, Seeing all his own mischance-- With a glassy countenance Did she look to Camelot. And at the closing of the day She loosed the chain, and down she lay; The broad stream bore her far away, The Lady of Shalott.

Lying, robed in snowy white That loosely flew to left and right-- The leaves upon her falling light-- Thro’ the noises of the night She floated down to Camelot; And as the boat-head wound along The willowy hills and fields among, They heard her singing her last song, The Lady of Shalott.

Heard a carol, mournful, holy, Chanted loudly, chanted lowly, Till her blood was frozen slowly, And her eyes were darkened wholly, Turn’d to tower’d Camelot; For ere she reach’d upon the tide The first house by the water-side, Singing in her song she died, The Lady of Shalott.

Under tower and balcony, By garden-wall and gallery, A gleaming shape she floated by, Dead-pale between the houses high, Silent into Camelot. Out upon the wharfs they came, Knight and burgher, lord and dame, And round the prow they read her name, _The Lady of Shalott_.

Who is this? and what is here? And in the lighted palace near Died the sound of royal cheer; And they cross'd themselves for fear, All the knights at Camelot: But Lancelot mused a little space; He said, 'She has a lovely face; God in His mercy lend her grace, The Lady of Shalott.'

_701._ _The Miller's Daughter_

It is the miller's daughter, And she is grown so dear, so dear, That I would be the jewel That trembles in her ear: For hid in ringlets day and night, I'd touch her neck so warm and white.

And I would be the girdle About her dainty dainty waist, And her heart would beat against me, In sorrow and in rest: And I should know if it beat right, I'd clasp it round so close and tight.

And I would be the necklace, And all day long to fall and rise Upon her balmy bosom, With her laughter or her sighs: And I would lie so light, so light, I scarce should be unclasp'd at night.

_702._ _Song of the Lotos-Eaters_

There is sweet music here that softer falls Than petals from blown roses on the grass, Or night-dews on still waters between walls Of shadowy granite, in a gleaming pass; Music that gentlier on the spirit lies, Than tired eyelids upon tired eyes; Music that brings sweet sleep down from the blissful skies. Here are cool mosses deep, And thro' the moss the ivies creep, And in the stream the long-leaved flowers weep, And from the craggy ledge the poppy hangs in sleep.

Why are we weigh'd upon with heaviness, And utterly consumed with sharp distress, While all things else have rest from weariness? All things have rest: why should we toil alone, We only toil, who are the first of things, And make perpetual moan, Still from one sorrow to another thrown: Nor ever fold our wings, And cease from wanderings, Nor steep our brows in slumber's holy balm; Nor harken what the inner spirit sings, 'There is no joy but calm!'-- Why should we only toil, the roof and crown of things?

Lo! in the middle of the wood, The folded leaf is woo'd from out the bud With winds upon the branch, and there Grows green and broad, and takes no care, Sun-steep'd at noon, and in the moon Nightly dew-fed; and turning yellow Falls, and floats adown the air. Lo! sweeten'd with the summer light, The full-juiced apple, waxing over-mellow, Drops in a silent autumn night. All its allotted length of days, The flower ripens in its place, Ripens and fades, and falls, and hath no toil, Fast-rooted in the fruitful soil.

Hateful is the dark-blue sky, Vaulted o'er the dark-blue sea. Death is the end of life; ah, why Should life all labour be? Let us alone. Time driveth onward fast, And in

a little while our lips are dumb. Let us alone. What is it that will last? All things are taken from us, and become Portions and parcels of the dreadful Past. Let us alone. What pleasure can we have To war with evil? Is there any peace In ever climbing up the climbing wave? All things have rest, and ripen toward the grave In silence; ripen, fall and cease: Give us long rest or death, dark death, or dreamful ease.

How sweet it were, hearing the downward stream, With half-shut eyes ever to seem Falling asleep in a half-dream! To dream and dream, like yonder amber light, Which will not leave the myrrh-bush on the height; To hear each other's whisper'd speech; Eating the Lotos day by day, To watch the crisping ripples on the beach, And tender curving lines of creamy spray; To lend our hearts and spirits wholly To the influence of mild-minded melancholy; To muse and brood and live again in memory, With those old faces of our infancy Heap'd over with a mound of grass, Two handfuls of white dust, shut in an urn of brass!

Dear is the memory of our wedded lives, And dear the last embraces of our wives And their warm tears: but all hath suffer'd change; For surely now our household hearths are cold: Our sons inherit us: our looks are strange: And we should come like ghosts to trouble joy. Or else the island princes over-bold Have eat our substance, and the minstrel sings Before them of the ten years' war in Troy, And our great deeds, as half-forgotten things. Is there confusion in the little isle? Let what is broken so remain. The Gods are hard to reconcile: 'Tis hard to settle order once again. There _is_ confusion worse than death, Trouble on trouble, pain on pain, Long labour unto agèd breath, Sore task to hearts worn out with many wars And eyes grown dim with gazing on the pilot-stars. But, propt on beds of amaranth and moly, How sweet (while warm airs lull us, blowing lowly) With half-dropt eyelids still, Beneath a heaven dark and holy, To watch the long bright river drawing slowly His waters from the purple hill-- To hear the dewy echoes calling From cave to cave thro' the thick-twinèd vine-- To watch the emerald-colour'd water falling Thro' many a wov'n acanthus-wreath divine! Only to hear and see the far-off sparkling brine, Only to hear were sweet, stretch'd out beneath the pine.

The Lotos blooms below the barren peak: The Lotos blows by every winding creek: All day the wind breathes low with mellower tone: Thro' every hollow cave and alley lone Round and round the spicy downs the yellow Lotos-dust is blown. We have had enough of action, and of motion we, Roll'd to starboard, roll'd to larboard, when the surge was seething free, Where the wallowing monster spouted his foam-fountains in the sea. Let us swear an oath, and keep it with an equal mind, In the hollow Lotos-land to live and lie reclined On the hills like Gods together, careless of mankind. For they lie beside their nectar, and the bolts are hurl'd Far below them in the valleys, and the clouds are lightly curl'd Round their golden houses, girdled with the gleaming world: Where they smile in secret, looking over wasted lands, Blight and famine, plague and earthquake, roaring deeps and fiery sands, Clanging fights, and flaming towns, and sinking ships, and praying hands. But they smile, they find a music centred in a doleful song Steaming up, a lamentation and an ancient tale of wrong, Like a tale of little meaning tho' the words are strong; Chanted from an ill-used race of men that cleave the soil, Sow the seed, and reap the harvest with

enduring toil, Storing yearly little dues of wheat, and wine and oil; Till they perish and they suffer--some, 'tis whisper'd--down in hell Suffer endless anguish, others in Elysian valleys dwell, Resting weary limbs at last on beds of asphodel. Surely, surely, slumber is more sweet than toil, the shore Than labour in the deep mid-ocean, wind and wave and oar; O rest ye, brother mariners, we will not wander more.

_703._ _St. Agnes' Eve_

Deep on the convent-roof the snows Are sparkling to the moon: My breath to heaven like vapour goes: May my soul follow soon! The shadows of the convent-towers Slant down the snowy sward, Still creeping with the creeping hours That lead me to my Lord: Make Thou my spirit pure and clear As are the frosty skies, Or this first snowdrop of the year That in my bosom lies.

As these white robes are soil'd and dark, To yonder shining ground; As this pale taper's earthly spark, To yonder argent round; So shows my soul before the Lamb, My spirit before Thee; So in mine earthly house I am, To that I hope to be. Break up the heavens, O Lord! and far, Thro' all yon starlight keen, Draw me, thy bride, a glittering star, In raiment white and clean.

He lifts me to the golden doors; The flashes come and go; All heaven bursts her starry floors, And strows her lights below, And deepens on and up! the gates Roll back, and far within For me the Heavenly Bridegroom waits, To make me pure of sin. The sabbaths of Eternity, One sabbath deep and wide-- A light upon the shining sea--The Bridegroom with his bride!

_704._ _Blow, Bugle, blow_

The splendour falls on castle walls And snowy summits old in story: The long light shakes across the lakes, And the wild cataract leaps in glory. Blow, bugle, blow, set the wild echoes flying, Blow, bugle; answer, echoes, dying, dying, dying.

O hark, O hear! how thin and clear, And thinner, clearer, farther going! O sweet and far from cliff and scar The horns of Elfland faintly blowing! Blow, let us hear the purple glens replying: Blow, bugle; answer, echoes, dying, dying, dying.

O love, they die in yon rich sky, They faint on hill or field or river: Our echoes roll from soul to soul, And grow for ever and for ever. Blow, bugle, blow, set the wild echoes flying, And answer, echoes, answer, dying, dying, dying.

_705._ _Summer Night_

Now sleeps the crimson petal, now the white; Nor waves the cypress in the palace walk; Nor winks the gold fin in the porphyry font: The firefly wakens: waken thou with me.

Now droops the milk-white peacock like a ghost, And like a ghost she glimmers on to me.

Now lies the Earth all Danaë to the stars, And all thy heart lies open unto me.

Now slides the silent meteor on, and leaves A shining furrow, as thy thoughts in me.

Now folds the lily all her sweetness up, And slips into the bosom of the lake: So fold thyself, my dearest, thou, and slip Into my bosom and be lost in me.

_706._ _Come down, O Maid_

Come down, O maid, from yonder mountain height: What pleasure lives in height (the shepherd sang). In height and cold, the splendour of the hills? But cease to move so near the Heavens, and cease To glide a sunbeam by the blasted Pine, To sit a star upon the sparkling spire; And come, for Love is of the valley, come, For Love is of the valley, come thou down And find him; by the happy threshold, he, Or hand in hand with Plenty in the maize, Or red with spirted purple of the vats, Or foxlike in the vine; nor cares to walk With Death and Morning on the silver horns, Nor wilt thou snare him in the white ravine, Nor find him dropt upon the firths of ice, That huddling slant in furrow-cloven falls To roll the torrent out of dusky doors: But follow; let the torrent dance thee down To find him in the valley; let the wild Lean-headed Eagles yelp alone, and leave The monstrous ledges there to slope, and spill Their thousand wreaths of dangling water-smoke, That like a broken purpose waste in air: So waste not thou; but come; for all the vales Await thee; azure pillars of the hearth Arise to thee; the children call, and I Thy shepherd pipe, and sweet is every sound, Sweeter thy voice, but every sound is sweet; Myriads of rivulets hurrying thro’ the lawn, The moan of doves in immemorial elms, And murmuring of innumerable bees.

_707._ _From ‘In Memoriam’_

(ARTHUR HENRY HALLAM, MDCCCXXXIII)

I

Fair ship, that from the Italian shore Sailest the placid ocean-plains With my lost Arthur’s loved remains, Spread thy full wings, and waft him o’er.

So draw him home to those that mourn In vain; a favourable speed Ruffle thy mirror’d mast, and lead Thro’ prosperous floods his holy urn.

All night no ruder air perplex Thy sliding keel, till Phosphor, bright As our pure love, thro’ early light Shall glimmer on the dewy decks.

Sphere all your lights around, above; Sleep, gentle heavens, before the prow; Sleep, gentle winds, as he sleeps now, My friend, the brother of my love;

My Arthur, whom I shall not see Till all my widow’d race be run; Dear as the mother to the son, More than my brothers are to me.

II

I hear the noise about thy keel; I hear the bell struck in the night; I see the cabin-window bright; I see the sailor at the wheel.

Thou bring’st the sailor to his wife, And travell’d men from foreign lands; And letters unto trembling hands; And, thy dark freight, a vanish’d life.

So bring him: we have idle dreams: This look of quiet flatters thus Our home-bred fancies: O to us, The fools of habit, sweeter seems

To rest beneath the clover sod, That takes the sunshine and the rains, Or where the kneeling hamlet drains The chalice of the grapes of God;

Than if with thee the roaring wells Should gulf him fathom-deep in brine; And hands so often clasp'd in mine, Should toss with tangle and with shells.

III

Calm is the morn without a sound, Calm as to suit a calmer grief, And only thro' the faded leaf The chestnut pattering to the ground:

Calm and deep peace on this high wold, And on these dews that drench the furze, And all the silvery gossamers That twinkle into green and gold:

Calm and still light on yon great plain That sweeps with all its autumn bowers, And crowded farms and lessening towers, To mingle with the bounding main:

Calm and deep peace in this wide air, These leaves that redden to the fall; And in my heart, if calm at all, If any calm, a calm despair:

Calm on the seas, and silver sleep, And waves that sway themselves in rest, And dead calm in that noble breast Which heaves but with the heaving deep.

IV

To-night the winds begin to rise And roar from yonder dropping day: The last red leaf is whirl'd away, The rooks are blown about the skies;

The forest crack'd, the waters curl'd, The cattle huddled on the lea; And wildly dash'd on tower and tree The sunbeam strikes along the world:

And but for fancies, which aver That all thy motions gently pass Athwart a plane of molten glass, I scarce could brook the strain and stir

That makes the barren branches loud; And but for fear it is not so, The wild unrest that lives in woe Would dote and pore on yonder cloud

That rises upward always higher, And onward drags a labouring breast, And topples round the dreary west, A looming bastion fringed with fire.

V

Thou comest, much wept for: such a breeze Compell'd thy canvas, and my prayer Was as the whisper of an air To breathe thee over lonely seas.

For I in spirit saw thee move Thro' circles of the bounding sky, Week after week: the days go by: Come quick, thou bringest all I love.

Henceforth, wherever thou mayst roam My blessing, like a line of light, Is on the waters day and night, And like a beacon guards thee home.

So may whatever tempest mars Mid-ocean, spare thee, sacred bark; And balmy drops in summer dark Slide from the bosom of the stars.

So kind an office hath been done, Such precious relics brought by thee; The dust of him I shall not see Till all my widow'd race be run.

VI

Now, sometimes in my sorrow shut, Or breaking into song by fits, Alone, alone, to where he sits, The Shadow cloak'd from head to foot,

Who keeps the keys of all the creeds, I wander, often falling lame, And looking back to whence I came, Or on to where the pathway leads; And crying, How changed from where it ran Thro' lands where not a leaf was dumb; But all the lavish hills would hum The murmur of a happy Pan:

When each by turns was guide to each, And Fancy light from Fancy caught, And Thought leapt out to wed with Thought Ere Thought could wed itself with Speech;

And all we met was fair and good, And all was good that Time could bring, And all the secret of the Spring Moved in the chambers of the blood;

And many an old philosophy On Argive heights divinely sang, And round us all the thicket rang To many a flute of Arcady.

VII

How fares it with the happy dead? For here the man is more and more; But he forgets the days before God shut the doorways of his head.

The days have vanish'd, tone and tint, And yet perhaps the hoarding sense Gives out at times (he knows not whence) A little flash, a mystic hint;

And in the long harmonious years (If Death so taste Lethean springs) May some dim touch of earthly things Surprise thee ranging with thy peers.

If such a dreamy touch should fall, O turn thee round, resolve the doubt; My guardian angel will speak out In that high place, and tell thee all.

VIII

The wish, that of the living whole No life may fail beyond the grave, Derives it not from what we have The likest God within the soul?

Are God and Nature then at strife, That Nature lends such evil dreams? So careful of the type she seems, So careless of the single life;

That I, considering everywhere Her secret meaning in her deeds, And finding that of fifty seeds She often brings but one to bear,

I falter where I firmly trod, And falling with my weight of cares Upon the great world’s altar-stairs That slope thro’ darkness up to God,

I stretch lame hands of faith, and grope, And gather dust and chaff, and call To what I feel is Lord of all, And faintly trust the larger hope.

IX

‘So careful of the type?’ but no. From scarpèd cliff and quarried stone She cries, ‘A thousand types are gone I care for nothing, all shall go.

Thou makest thine appeal to me: I bring to life, I bring to death: The spirit does but mean the breath: I know no more.’ And he, shall he,

Man, her last work, who seem’d so fair, Such splendid purpose in his eyes, Who roll’d the psalm to wintry skies, Who built him fanes of fruitless prayer,

Who trusted God was love indeed And love Creation’s final law-- Tho’ Nature, red in tooth and claw With ravine, shriek’d against his creed--

Who loved, who suffer’d countless ills, Who battled for the True, the Just, Be blown about the desert dust, Or seal’d within the iron hills?

No more? A monster then, a dream, A discord. Dragons of the prime, That tare each other in their slime, Were mellow music matched with him.

O life as futile, then as frail! O for thy voice to soothe and bless! What hope of answer, or redress? Behind the veil, behind the veil.

X

Unwatch’d, the garden bough shall sway, The tender blossom flutter down; Unloved, that beech will gather brown, This maple burn itself away; Unloved, the sunflower, shining fair, Ray round with flames her disk of seed, And many a rose-carnation feed With summer spice the humming air;

Unloved, by many a sandy bar, The brook shall babble down the plain, At noon or when the lesser wain Is twisting round the polar star;

Uncared for, gird the windy grove, And flood the haunts of hern and crake; Or into silver arrows break The sailing moon in creek and cove;

Till from the garden and the wild A fresh association blow, And year by year the landscape grow Familiar to the stranger’s child;

As year by year the labourer tills His wonted glebe, or lops the glades; And year by year our memory fades From all the circle of the hills.

XI

Now fades the last long streak of snow, Now burgeons every maze of quick About the flowering squares, and thick By ashen roots the violets blow.

Now rings the woodland loud and long, The distance takes a lovelier hue, And drown’d in yonder living blue The lark becomes a sightless song.

Now dance the lights on lawn and lea, The flocks are whiter down the vale, And milkier every milky sail On winding stream or distant sea;

Where now the seamew pipes, or dives In yonder greening gleam, and fly The happy birds, that change their sky To build and brood; that live their lives

From land to land; and in my breast Spring wakens too; and my regret Becomes an April violet, And buds and blossoms like the rest.

XII

Love is and was my Lord and King, And in his presence I attend To hear the tidings of my friend, Which every hour his couriers bring.

Love is and was my King and Lord, And will be, tho’ as yet I keep Within his court on earth, and sleep Encompass’d by his faithful guard,

And hear at times a sentinel Who moves about from place to place, And whispers to the worlds of space, In the deep night, that all is well.

_708._ _Maud_

Come into the garden, Maud, For the black bat, Night, has flown, Come into the garden, Maud, I am here at the gate alone; And the woodbine spices are wafted abroad, And the musk of the roses blown.

For a breeze of morning moves, And the planet of Love is on high, Beginning to faint in the light that she loves On a bed of daffodil sky, To faint in the light of the sun she loves, To faint in his light, and to die.

All night have the roses heard The flute, violin, bassoon; All night has the casement jessamine stirr’d To the dancers dancing in tune; Till a silence fell with the waking bird, And a hush with the setting moon.

I said to the lily, ‘There is but one With whom she has heart to be gay. When will the dancers leave her alone? She is weary of dance and play.’ Now half to the setting moon are gone, And half to the rising day; Low on the sand and loud on the stone The last wheel echoes away.

I said to the rose, ‘The brief night goes In babble and revel and wine.

O young lord-lover, what sighs are those For one that will never be thine? But mine, but mine,’ so I sware to the rose, ‘For ever and ever, mine.’

And the soul of the rose went into my blood, As the music clash’d in the hall; And long by the garden lake I stood, For I heard your rivulet fall From the lake to the meadow and on to the wood, Our wood, that is dearer than all;

From the meadow your walks have left so sweet That whenever a March-wind sighs He sets the jewel-print of your feet In violets blue as your eyes, To the woody

hollows in which we meet And the valleys of Paradise.

The slender acacia would not shake One long milk-bloom on the tree; The white lake-blossom fell into the lake, As the pimpernel dozed on the lea; But the rose was awake all night for your sake, Knowing your promise to me; The lilies and roses were all awake, They sigh'd for the dawn and thee.

Queen rose of the rosebud garden of girls, Come hither, the dances are done, In gloss of satin and glimmer of pearls, Queen lily and rose in one; Shine out, little head, sunning over with curls. To the flowers, and be their sun.

There has fallen a splendid tear From the passion-flower at the gate. She is coming, my dove, my dear; She is coming, my life, my fate; The red rose cries, 'She is near, she is near;' And the white rose weeps, 'She is late,' The larkspur listens, 'I hear, I hear;' And the lily whispers, 'I wait.'

She is coming, my own, my sweet; Were it ever so airy a tread, My heart would hear her and beat, Were it earth in an earthy bed; My dust would hear her and beat, Had I lain for a century dead; Would start and tremble under her feet, And blossom in purple and red.

_709._ _O that 'twere possible_

O that 'twere possible After long grief and pain To find the arms of my true love Round me once again!...

A shadow flits before me, Not thou, but like to thee: Ah, Christ! that it were possible For one short hour to see The souls we loved, that they might tell us What and where they be!

RICHARD MONCKTON MILNES, LORD HOUGHTON

1809-1885

_710._ _Shadows_

They seem'd, to those who saw them meet, The casual friends of every day; Her smile was undisturb'd and sweet, His courtesy was free and gay.

But yet if one the other's name In some unguarded moment heard, The heart you thought so calm and tame Would struggle like a captured bird:

And letters of mere formal phrase Were blister'd with repeated tears,-- And this was not the work of days, But had gone on for years and years!

Alas, that love was not too strong For maiden shame and manly pride! Alas, that they delay'd so long The goal of mutual bliss beside!

Yet what no chance could then reveal, And neither would be first to own, Let fate and courage now conceal, When truth could bring remorse alone.

HENRY ALFORD

1810-1871

_711._ _The Bride_

‘Rise,’ said the Master, ‘come unto the feast.’ She heard the call and rose with willing feet; But thinking it not otherwise than meet For such a bidding to put on her best, She is gone from us for a few short hours Into her bridal closet, there to wait For the unfolding of the palace gate That gives her entrance to the blissful bowers. We have not seen her yet, though we have been Full often to her chamber door, and oft Have listen’d underneath the postern green, And laid fresh flowers, and whisper’d short and soft. But she hath made no answer, and the day From the clear west is fading fast away.

SIR SAMUEL FERGUSON

1810-1886

_712._ _Cean Dubh Deelish_

Put your head, darling, darling, darling, Your darling black head my heart above; O mouth of honey, with thyme for fragrance, Who, with heart in breast, could deny you love?

O many and many a young girl for me is pining. Letting her locks of gold to the cold wind free, For me, the foremost of our gay young fellows; But I’d leave a hundred, pure love, for thee!

_712._ _Cean dubh deelish_] darling black head.

Then put your head, darling, darling, darling, Your darling black head my heart above; O mouth of honey, with thyme for fragrance, Who, with heart in breast, could deny you love?

_713._ _Cashel of Munster_

FROM THE IRISH

I’d wed you without herds, without money or rich array. And I’d wed you on a dewy morn at day-dawn gray; My bitter woe it is, love, that we are not far away In Cashel town, tho’ the bare deal board were our marriage-bed this day!

O fair maid, remember the green hill-side, Remember how I hunted about the valleys wide; Time now has worn me; my locks are turn’d to gray; The year is scarce and I am poor--but send me not, love, away!

O deem not my blood is of base strain, my girl; O think not my birth was as the birth of a churl; Marry me and prove me, and say soon you will That noble blood is written on my right side still.

My purse holds no red gold, no coin of the silver white; No herds are mine to drive through the long twilight; But the pretty girl that would take me, all bare tho’ I be and lone, O, I’d take her with me kindly to the county Tyrone!

O my girl, I can see ’tis in trouble you are; And O my girl, I see ’tis your people’s reproach you bear! --_I am a girl in trouble for his sake with whom I fly,_ _And, O, may no other maiden know such reproach as I!_

_714._ _The Fair Hills of Ireland_

FROM THE IRISH

A plenteous place is Ireland for hospitable cheer, _Uileacan dubh O!_ Where the wholesome fruit is bursting from the yellow barley ear; _Uileacan dubh O!_ There is honey in the trees where her misty vales expand, And her forest paths in summer are by falling waters fann’d, There is dew at high noontide there, and springs i’ the yellow sand, On the fair hills of holy Ireland.

Curl’d he is and ringleted, and plaited to the knee-- _Uileacan dubh O!_ Each captain who comes sailing across the Irish Sea; _Uileacan dubh O!_ And I will make my journey, if life and health but stand, Unto that pleasant country, that fresh and fragrant strand, And leave your boasted braveries, your wealth and high command, For the fair hills of holy Ireland.

Large and profitable are the stacks upon the ground, _Uileacan dubh O!_ The butter and the cream do wondrously abound; _Uileacan dubh O!_ The cresses on the water and the sorrels are at hand, And the cuckoo’s calling daily his note of music bland, And the bold thrush sings so bravely his song i’ the forests grand, On the fair hills of holy Ireland.

ROBERT BROWNING

1812-1889

_715._ _Song from ‘Paracelsus’_

Heap cassia, sandal-buds and stripes Of labdanum, and aloe-balls, Smear’d with dull nard an Indian wipes From out her hair: such balsam falls Down sea-side mountain pedestals, From tree-tops where tired winds are fain, Spent with the vast and howling main, To treasure half their island-gain.

And strew faint sweetness from some old Egyptian’s fine worm-eaten shroud Which breaks to dust when once unroll’d; Or shredded perfume, like a cloud From closet long to quiet vow’d, With moth’d and dropping arras hung, Mouldering her lute and books among, As when a queen, long dead, was young.

_716._ _The Wanderers_

Over the sea our galleys went, With cleaving prows in order brave To a speeding wind and a bounding wave-- A gallant armament: Each bark built out of a forest-tree Left leafy and rough as first it grew, And nail’d all over the gaping sides, Within and without, with black bull-hides, Seethed in fat and suppled in flame, To bear the playful billows’ game; So, each good ship was rude to see, Rude and bare to the outward view. But each upbore a stately tent Where cedar pales in scented row Kept

out the flakes of the dancing brine, And an awning droop’d the mast below, In fold on fold of the purple fine, That neither noontide nor star-shine Nor moonlight cold which maketh mad, Might pierce the regal tenement. When the sun dawn’d, O, gay and glad We set the sail and plied the oar; But when the night-wind blew like breath, For joy of one day’s voyage more, We sang together on the wide sea, Like men at peace on a peaceful shore; Each sail was loosed to the wind so free, Each helm made sure by the twilight star, And in a sleep as calm as death, We, the voyagers from afar, Lay stretch’d along, each weary crew In a circle round its wondrous tent Whence gleam’d soft light and curl’d rich scent, And with light and perfume, music too: So the stars wheel’d round, and the darkness past, And at morn we started beside the mast, And still each ship was sailing fast!

Now, one morn, land appear’d--a speck Dim trembling betwixt sea and sky-- ‘Avoid it,’ cried our pilot, ‘check The shout, restrain the eager eye!’ But the heaving sea was black behind For many a night and many a day, And land, though but a rock, drew nigh So we broke the cedar pales away, Let the purple awning flap in the wind, And a statue bright was on every deck! We shouted, every man of us, And steer’d right into the harbour thus, With pomp and pæan glorious.

A hundred shapes of lucid stone! All day we built its shrine for each, A shrine of rock for every one, Nor paused till in the westering sun We sat together on the beach To sing because our task was done; When lo! what shouts and merry songs! What laughter all the distance stirs! A loaded raft with happy throngs Of gentle islanders! ‘Our isles are just at hand,’ they cried, ‘Like cloudlets faint in even sleeping; Our temple-gates are open’d wide, Our olive-groves thick shade are keeping For these majestic forms’--they cried. O, then we awoke with sudden start From our deep dream, and knew, too late, How bare the rock, how desolate, Which had received our precious freight: Yet we call’d out--‘Depart! Our gifts, once given, must here abide: Our work is done; we have no heart To mar our work,’--we cried.

_717._ _Thus the Mayne glideth_

Thus the Mayne glideth Where my Love abideth; Sleep’s no softer: it proceeds On through lawns, on through meads, On and on, whate’er befall. Meandering and musical, Though the niggard pasturage Bears not on its shaven ledge Aught but weeds and waving grasses To view the river as it passes, Save here and there a scanty patch Of primroses too faint to catch A weary bee.... And scarce it pushes Its gentle way through strangling rushes Where the glossy kingfisher Flutters when noon-heats are near, Glad the shelving banks to shun, Red and steaming in the sun, Where the shrew-mouse with pale throat Burrows, and the speckled stoat; Where the quick sandpipers flit In and out the marl and grit That seems to breed them, brown as they; Naught disturbs its quiet way, Save some lazy stork that springs, Trailing it with legs and wings, Whom the shy fox from the hill Rouses, creep he ne’er so still.

_718._ _Pippa’s Song_

The year’s at the spring, And day’s at the morn; Morning’s at seven; The hill-side’s dew-pearl’d; The lark’s on the wing; The snail’s on the thorn; God’s in His heaven-- All’s right with the world!

_719._ _You’ll love Me yet_

You’ll love me yet!--and I can tarry Your love’s protracted growing: June rear’d that bunch of flowers you carry, From seeds of April’s sowing.

I plant a heartful now: some seed At least is sure to strike, And yield--what you’ll not pluck indeed, Not love, but, may be, like.

You’ll look at least on love’s remains, A grave’s one violet: Your look?--that pays a thousand pains. What’s death? You’ll love me yet!

_720._ _Porphyria’s Lover_

The rain set early in to-night, The sullen wind was soon awake, It tore the elm-tops down for spite, And did its worst to vex the lake: I listen’d with heart fit to break. When glided in Porphyria; straight She shut the cold out and the storm, And kneel’d and made the cheerless grate Blaze up, and all the cottage warm; Which done, she rose, and from her form Withdrew the dripping cloak and shawl, And laid her soil’d gloves by, untied Her hat and let the damp hair fall, And, last, she sat down by my side And call’d me. When no voice replied, She put my arm about her waist, And made her smooth white shoulder bare, And all her yellow hair displaced, And, stooping, made my cheek lie there, And spread, o’er all, her yellow hair, Murmuring how she loved me--she Too weak, for all her heart’s endeavour, To set its struggling passion free From pride, and vainer ties dissever, And give herself to me for ever. But passion sometimes would prevail, Nor could to-night’s gay feast restrain A sudden thought of one so pale For love of her, and all in vain: So, she was come through wind and rain. Be sure I look’d up at her eyes Happy and proud; at last I knew Porphyria worshipp’d me; surprise Made my heart swell, and still it grew While I debated what to do. That moment she was mine, mine, fair, Perfectly pure and good: I found A thing to do, and all her hair In one long yellow string I wound Three times her little throat around, And strangled her. No pain felt she; I am quite sure she felt no pain. As a shut bud that holds a bee, I warily oped her lids: again Laugh’d the blue eyes without a stain. And I untighten’d next the tress About her neck; her cheek once more Blush’d bright beneath my burning kiss: I propp’d her head up as before, Only, this time my shoulder bore Her head, which droops upon it still: The smiling rosy little head, So glad it has its utmost will, That all it scorn’d at once is fled, And I, its love, am gain’d instead! Porphyria’s love: she guess’d not how Her darling one wish would be heard. And thus we sit together now, And all night long we have not stirr’d, And yet God has not said a word!

_721._ _Song_

Nay but you, who do not love her, Is she not pure gold, my mistress? Holds earth aught--speak truth--above her? Aught like this tress, see, and this tress, And this last fairest tress of all, So fair, see, ere I let it fall?

Because, you spend your lives in praising; To praise, you search the wide world over: Then why not witness, calmly gazing, If earth holds aught--speak truth--above her? Above this tress, and this, I touch But cannot praise, I love so much!

_722._ _Earl Mertoun’s Song_

There’s a woman like a dewdrop, she’s so purer than the purest; And her noble heart’s the noblest, yes, and her sure faith’s the surest: And her eyes are dark and humid, like the depth on depth of lustre Hid i’ the harebell, while her tresses, sunnier than the wild-grape cluster, Gush in golden-tinted plenty down her neck’s rose-misted marble: Then her voice’s music … call it the well’s bubbling, the bird’s warble!

And this woman says, ‘My days were sunless and my nights were moonless, Parch’d the pleasant April herbage, and the lark’s heart’s outbreak tuneless, If you loved me not!’ And I who (ah, for words of flame!) adore her, Who am mad to lay my spirit prostrate palpably before her-- I may enter at her portal soon, as now her lattice takes me, And by noontide as by midnight make her mine, as hers she makes me!

_723._ _In a Gondola_

The moth’s kiss, first! Kiss me as if you made me believe You were not sure, this eve, How my face, your flower, had pursed Its petals up; so, here and there You brush it, till I grow aware Who wants me, and wide ope I burst.

The bee’s kiss, now! Kiss me as if you enter’d gay My heart at some noonday, A bud that dares not disallow The claim, so all is render’d up, And passively its shatter’d cup Over your head to sleep I bow.

_724._ _Meeting at Night_

The gray sea and the long black land; And the yellow half-moon large and low; And the startled little waves that leap In fiery ringlets from their sleep, As I gain the cove with pushing prow, And quench its speed i’ the slushy sand.

Then a mile of warm sea-scented beach; Three fields to cross till a farm appears; A tap at the pane, the quick sharp scratch And blue spurt of a lighted match, And a voice less loud, thro’ its joys and fears, Than the two hearts beating each to each!

_725._ _Parting at Morning_

Round the cape of a sudden came the sea, And the sun look’d over the mountain’s rim And straight was a path of gold for him, And the need of a world of men for me.

_726._ _The Lost Mistress_

All’s over, then: does truth sound bitter As one at first believes? Hark, ’tis the sparrows’ good-night twitter About your cottage eaves!

And the leaf-buds on the vine are woolly, I noticed that, to-day; One day more bursts them open fully --You know the red turns gray.

To-morrow we meet the same then, dearest? May I take your hand in mine? Mere friends are we,--well, friends the merest Keep much that I resign:

For each glance of the eye so bright and black, Though I keep with heart’s endeavour,-- Your voice, when you wish the snowdrops back, Though it stay in my soul for ever!--

Yet I will but say what mere friends say, Or only a thought stronger; I will hold your hand but as long as all may, Or so very little longer!

_727._ _The Last Ride together_

I said--Then, dearest, since ’tis so, Since now at length my fate I know, Since nothing all my love avails, Since all, my life seem’d meant for, fails, Since this was written and needs must be-- My whole heart rises up to bless Your name in pride and thankfulness! Take back the hope you gave,--I claim Only a memory of the same, --And this beside, if you will not blame; Your leave for one more last ride with me.

My mistress bent that brow of hers, Those deep dark eyes where pride demurs When pity would be softening through, Fix’d me a breathing-while or two With life or death in the balance: right! The blood replenish’d me again; My last thought was at least not vain: I and my mistress, side by side Shall be together, breathe and ride, So, one day more am I deified. Who knows but the world may end to-night?

Hush! if you saw some western cloud All billowy-bosom’d, over-bow’d By many benedictions--sun’s And moon’s and evening-star’s at once-- And so, you, looking and loving best, Conscious grew, your passion drew Cloud, sunset, moonrise, star-shine too, Down on you, near and yet more near, Till flesh must fade for heaven was here!-- Thus leant she and linger’d--joy and fear! Thus lay she a moment on my breast.

Then we began to ride. My soul Smooth’d itself out, a long-cramp’d scroll Freshening and fluttering in the wind. Past hopes already lay behind. What need to strive with a life awry? Had I said that, had I done this, So might I gain, so might I miss. Might she have loved me? just as well She might have hated, who can tell! Where had I been now if the worst befell? And here we are riding, she and I.

Fail I alone, in words and deeds? Why, all men strive and who succeeds? We rode; it seem’d my spirit flew, Saw other regions, cities new, As the world rush’d by on either side. I thought,--All labour, yet no less Bear up beneath their unsuccess. Look at the end of work, contrast The petty done, the undone vast, This present of theirs with the hopeful past! I hoped she would love me; here we ride.

What hand and brain went ever pair’d? What heart alike conceived and dared? What act proved all its thought had been? What will but felt the fleshly screen? We ride and I see her bosom heave. There’s many a crown for who can reach. Ten lines, a statesman’s life in each! The flag stuck on a heap of bones, A soldier’s doing! what atones? They scratch his name on the Abbey-stones. My riding is better, by their leave.

What does it all mean, poet? Well, Your brains beat into rhythm, you tell What we felt only; you express’d You hold things beautiful the best, And pace them in rhyme so, side by side. ’Tis something, nay ’tis much: but then, Have you yourself what’s best for men? Are you--poor, sick, old ere your time-- Nearer one whit your own sublime Than we who never have turn’d a rhyme? Sing, riding’s a joy! For me, I ride.

And you, great sculptor--so, you gave A score of years to Art, her slave, And that’s your Venus, whence we turn To yonder girl that fords the burn! You acquiesce, and shall I repine? What, man of music, you grown gray With notes and nothing else to say, Is this your sole praise from a friend, ‘Greatly his opera’s strains intend, But in music we know how fashions end!’ I gave my youth: but we ride, in fine.

Who knows what’s fit for us? Had fate Proposed bliss here should sublimate My being--had I sign’d the bond-- Still one must lead some life beyond, Have a bliss to die with, dim-descried. This foot once planted on the goal, This glory-garland round my soul, Could I descry such? Try and test! I sink back shuddering from the quest. Earth being so good, would heaven seem best? Now, heaven and she are beyond this ride.

And yet--she has not spoke so long! What if heaven be that, fair and strong At life’s best, with our eyes upturn’d Whither life’s flower is first discern’d, We, fix’d so, ever should so abide? What if we still ride on, we two With life for ever old yet new, Changed not in kind but in degree, The instant made eternity,-- And heaven just prove that I and she Ride, ride together, for ever ride?

_728._ _Misconceptions_

This is a spray the Bird clung to, Making it blossom with pleasure, Ere the high tree-top she sprung to, Fit for her nest and her treasure. O, what a hope beyond measure Was the poor spray’s, which the flying feet hung to,-- So to be singled out, built in, and sung to!

This is a heart the Queen leant on, Thrill’d in a minute erratic, Ere the true bosom she bent on, Meet for love’s regal dalmatic. O, what a fancy ecstatic Was the poor heart’s, ere the wanderer went on-- Love to be saved for it, proffer’d to, spent on!

_729._ _Home-thoughts, from Abroad_

O to be in England Now that April’s there, And whoever wakes in England Sees, some morning, unaware, That the lowest boughs and the brushwood sheaf Round the elm-tree bole are in tiny leaf, While the chaffinch sings on the orchard bough In England--now!

And after April, when May follows, And the whitethroat builds, and all the swallows! Hark, where my blossom’d pear-tree in the hedge Leans to the field and scatters on the clover Blossoms and dewdrops--at the bent spray’s edge-- That’s the wise thrush; he sings each song twice over, Lest you should think he never could recapture The first fine careless rapture! And though the fields look rough with hoary dew, All will be gay when noontide wakes anew The buttercups, the little children’s dower --Far brighter than this gaudy melon-flower!

_730._ _Home-thoughts, from the Sea_

Nobly, nobly Cape Saint Vincent to the North-west died away; Sunset ran, one glorious blood-red, reeking into Cadiz Bay; Bluish ’mid the burning water, full in face Trafalgar lay; In the dimmest North-east distance dawn’d Gibraltar grand and gray; ‘Here and here did England help me: how can I help England?’--say, Whoso turns as I, this evening, turn to God to praise and pray, While Jove’s planet rises yonder, silent over Africa.

WILLIAM BELL SCOTT

1812-1890

_731._ _The Witch’s Ballad_

O I hae come from far away, From a warm land far away, A southern land across the sea, With sailor-lads about the mast, Merry and canny, and kind to me.

And I hae been to yon town To try my luck in yon town; Nort, and Mysie, Elspie too. Right braw we were to pass the gate, Wi’ gowden clasps on girdles blue.

Mysie smiled wi’ miminy mouth, Innocent mouth, miminy mouth;

_731._ miminy] prim, demure.

Elspie wore a scarlet gown, Nort’s grey eyes were unco’ gleg. My Castile comb was like a crown.

We walk’d abreast all up the street, Into the market up the street; Our hair with marigolds was wound, Our bodices with love-knots laced, Our merchandise with tansy bound.

Nort had chickens, I had cocks, Gamesome cocks, loud-crowing cocks; Mysie ducks, and Elspie drakes,-- For a wee groat or a pound; We lost nae time wi’ gives and takes.

--Lost nae time, for well we knew, In our sleeves full well we knew, When the gloaming came that night, Duck nor drake, nor hen nor cock Would be found by candle-light.

And when our chaffering all was done, All was paid for, sold and done, We drew a glove on ilka hand, We sweetly curtsied, each to each, And deftly danced a saraband.

The market-lassies look’d and laugh’d, Left their gear, and look’d and laugh’d; They made as they would join the game, But soon their mithers, wild and wud, With whack and screech they stopp’d the same.

gleg] bright, sharp. wud] mad.

Sae loud the tongues o’ randies grew, The flytin’ and the skirlin’ grew, At all the windows in the place, Wi’ spoons or knives, wi’ needle or awl, Was thrust out every hand and face.

And down each stair they throng’d anon, Gentle, semple, throng’d anon: Souter and tailor, frowsy Nan, The ancient widow young again, Simpering behind her fan.

Without a choice, against their will, Doited, dazed, against their will, The market lassie and her mither, The farmer and his husbandman, Hand in hand dance a’ thegither.

Slow at first, but faster soon, Still increasing, wild and fast, Hoods and mantles, hats and hose, Blindly doff’d and cast away, Left them naked, heads and toes.

They would have torn us limb from limb, Dainty limb from dainty limb; But never one of them could win Across the line that I had drawn With bleeding thumb a-widdershin.

But there was Jeff the provost’s son, Jeff the provost’s only son;

randies] viragoes. flytin’] scolding. skirlin’] shrieking. souter] cobbler. doited] mazed. a-widdershin] the wrong way of the sun: or E. to W. through N.

There was Father Auld himsel’, The Lombard frae the hostelry, And the lawyer Peter Fell.

All goodly men we singled out, Waled them well, and singled out, And drew them by the left hand in; Mysie the priest, and Elspie won The Lombard, Nort the lawyer carle, I mysel’ the provost’s son.

Then, with cantrip kisses seven, Three times round with kisses seven, Warp’d and woven there spun we Arms and legs and flaming hair, Like a whirlwind on the sea.

Like a wind that sucks the sea, Over and in and on the sea, Good sooth it was a mad delight; And every man of all the four Shut his eyes and laugh’d outright.

Laugh’d as long as they had breath, Laugh’d while they had sense or breath; And close about us coil’d a mist Of gnats and midges, wasps and flies, Like the whirlwind shaft it rist.

Drawn up I was right off my feet, Into the mist and off my feet; And, dancing on each chimney-top, I saw a thousand darling imps Keeping time with skip and hop.

waled] chose. cantrip] magic.

And on the provost’s brave ridge-tile, On the provost’s grand ridge-tile, The Blackamoor first to master me I saw, I saw that winsome smile, The mouth that did my heart beguile, And spoke the great Word over me, In the land beyond the sea.

I call’d his name, I call’d aloud, Alas! I call’d on him aloud; And then he fill’d his hand with stour, And threw it towards me in the air; My mouse flew out, I lost my pow’r!

My lusty strength, my power were gone; Power was gone, and all was gone. He will not let me love him more! Of bell and whip and horse’s tail He cares not if I find a store.

But I am proud if he is fierce! I am as proud as he is fierce; I’ll turn about and backward go, If I meet again that Blackamoor, And he’ll help us then, for he shall know I seek another paramour.

And we’ll gang once more to yon town, Wi’ better luck to yon town; We’ll walk in silk and cramoisie, And I shall wed the provost’s son My lady of the town I’ll be!

stour] dust. cramoisie] crimson.

For I was born a crown’d king’s child, Born and nursed a king’s child, King o’ a land ayont the sea, Where the Blackamoor kiss’d me first, And taught me art and glamourie.

Each one in her wame shall hide Her hairy mouse, her wary mouse. Fed on madwort and agramie,-- Wear amber beads between her breasts, And blind-worm’s skin about her knee.

The Lombard shall be Elspie’s man, Elspie’s gowden husband-man; Nort shall take the lawyer’s hand; The priest shall swear another vow: We’ll dance again the saraband!

ayont] beyond. glamourie] wizardry.

AUBREY DE VERE

1814-1902

_732._ _Serenade_

Softly, O midnight Hours! Move softly o’er the bowers Where lies in happy sleep a girl so fair! For ye have power, men say, Our hearts in sleep to sway, And cage cold fancies in a moonlight snare. Round ivory neck and arm Enclasp a separate charm; Hang o’er her poised, but breathe nor sigh nor prayer Silently ye may smile, But hold your breath the while, And let the wind sweep back your cloudy hair! Bend down your glittering urns, Ere yet the dawn returns, And star with dew the lawn her feet shall tread; Upon the air rain balm, Bid all the woods be calm, Ambrosial dreams with healthful slumbers wed; That so the Maiden may With smiles your care repay, When from her couch she lifts her golden head; Waking with earliest birds, Ere yet the misty herds Leave warm ’mid the gray grass their dusky bed.

_733._ _Sorrow_

Count each affliction, whether light or grave, God’s messenger sent down to thee; do thou With courtesy receive him; rise and bow; And, ere his shadow pass thy threshold, crave Permission first his heavenly feet to lave; Then lay before him all thou hast; allow No cloud of passion to usurp thy brow, Or mar thy hospitality; no wave Of mortal tumult to obliterate The soul’s marmoreal calmness: Grief should be, Like joy, majestic, equable, sedate; Confirming, cleansing, raising, making free; Strong to consume small troubles; to commend Great thoughts, grave thoughts, thoughts lasting to the end.

GEORGE FOX

1815-?

_734._ _The County of Mayo_

FROM THE IRISH OF THOMAS LAVELLE

On the deck of Patrick Lynch’s boat I sat in woful plight, Through my sighing all the weary day and weeping all the night; Were it not that full of sorrow from my people forth I go, By the blessèd sun! ’tis royally I’d sing thy praise, Mayo!

When I dwelt at home in plenty, and my gold did much abound, In the company of fair young maids the Spanish ale went round-- ’Tis a bitter change from those gay days that now I’m forced to go And must leave my bones in Santa Cruz, far from my

own Mayo.

They are alter’d girls in Irrul now; ’tis proud they’re grown and high, With their hair-bags and their top-knots, for I pass their buckles by-- But it’s little now I heed their airs, for God will have it so, That I must depart for foreign lands and leave my sweet Mayo.

’Tis my grief that Patrick Loughlin is not Earl of Irrul still, And that Brian Duff no longer rules as Lord upon the hill: And that Colonel Hugh McGrady should be lying dead and low, And I sailing, sailing swiftly from the county of Mayo.

EMILY BRONTË

1818-1848

_735._ _My Lady’s Grave_

The linnet in the rocky dells, The moor-lark in the air, The bee among the heather bells That hide my lady fair:

The wild deer browse above her breast; The wild birds raise their brood; And they, her smiles of love caress’d, Have left her solitude!

I ween that when the grave’s dark wall Did first her form retain, They thought their hearts could ne’er recall The light of joy again.

They thought the tide of grief would flow Uncheck’d through future years; But where is all their anguish now, And where are all their tears?

Well, let them fight for honour’s breath, Or pleasure’s shade pursue-- The dweller in the land of death Is changed and careless too.

And if their eyes should watch and weep Till sorrow’s source were dry, She would not, in her tranquil sleep, Return a single sigh!

Blow, west wind, by the lonely mound: And murmur, summer streams! There is no need of other sound To soothe my lady’s dreams.

_736._ _Remembrance_

Cold in the earth--and the deep snow piled above thee, Far, far removed, cold in the dreary grave! Have I forgot, my only Love, to love thee, Sever’d at last by Time’s all-severing wave?

Now, when alone, do my thoughts no longer hover Over the mountains, on that northern shore, Resting their wings where heath and fern-leaves cover Thy noble heart for ever, ever more?

Cold in the earth--and fifteen wild Decembers From those brown hills have melted into spring: Faithful, indeed, is the spirit that remembers After such years of change and suffering!

Sweet Love of youth, forgive, if I forget thee, While the world’s tide is bearing me along; Other desires and other hopes beset me, Hopes which obscure, but cannot do

thee wrong!

No later light has lighten’d up my heaven, No second morn has ever shone for me; All my life’s bliss from thy dear life was given, All my life’s bliss is in the grave with thee.

But when the days of golden dreams had perish’d, And even Despair was powerless to destroy; Then did I learn how existence could be cherish’d, Strengthen’d and fed without the aid of joy.

Then did I check the tears of useless passion-- Wean’d my young soul from yearning after thine; Sternly denied its burning wish to hasten Down to that tomb already more than mine.

And, even yet, I dare not let it languish, Dare not indulge in memory’s rapturous pain; Once drinking deep of that divinest anguish, How could I seek the empty world again?

_737._ _The Prisoner_

Still let my tyrants know, I am not doom’d to wear Year after year in gloom and desolate despair; A messenger of Hope comes every night to me, And offers for short life, eternal liberty.

He comes with Western winds, with evening’s wandering airs, With that clear dusk of heaven that brings the thickest stars: Winds take a pensive tone, and stars a tender fire, And visions rise, and change, that kill me with desire.

Desire for nothing known in my maturer years, When Joy grew mad with awe, at counting future tears: When, if my spirit’s sky was full of flashes warm, I knew not whence they came, from sun or thunder-storm.

But first, a hush of peace--a soundless calm descends; The struggle of distress and fierce impatience ends. Mute music soothes my breast--unutter’d harmony That I could never dream, till Earth was lost to me.

Then dawns the Invisible; the Unseen its truth reveals; My outward sense is gone, my inward essence feels; Its wings are almost free--its home, its harbour found, Measuring the gulf, it stoops, and dares the final bound.

O dreadful is the check--intense the agony-- When the ear begins to hear, and the eye begins to see; When the pulse begins to throb--the brain to think again-- The soul to feel the flesh, and the flesh to feel the chain.

Yet I would lose no sting, would wish no torture less; The more that anguish racks, the earlier it will bless; And robed in fires of hell, or bright with heavenly shine, If it but herald Death, the vision is divine.

_738._ _Last Lines_

No coward soul is mine, No trembler in the world’s storm-troubled sphere: I see Heaven’s glories shine, And faith shines equal, arming me from fear.

O God within my breast, Almighty, ever-present Deity! Life--that in me has rest, As I--undying Life--have power in Thee!

Vain are the thousand creeds That move men’s hearts: unutterably vain; Worthless as wither’d weeds, Or idlest froth amid the boundless main,

To waken doubt in one Holding so fast by Thine infinity; So surely anchor’d on The steadfast rock of immortality.

With wide-embracing love Thy Spirit animates eternal years, Pervades and broods above, Changes, sustains, dissolves, creates, and rears.

Though earth and man were gone, And suns and universes cease to be, And Thou were left alone, Every existence would exist in Thee.

There is not room for Death, Nor atom that his might could render void: Thou--Thou art Being and Breath, And what Thou art may never be destroyed.

CHARLES KINGSLEY

1819-1875

_739._ _Airly Beacon_

Airly Beacon, Airly Beacon; O the pleasant sight to see Shires and towns from Airly Beacon, While my love climb’d up to me!

Airly Beacon, Airly Beacon; O the happy hours we lay Deep in fern on Airly Beacon, Courting through the summer’s day!

Airly Beacon, Airly Beacon; O the weary haunt for me, All alone on Airly Beacon, With his baby on my knee!

_740._ _The Sands of Dee_

‘O Mary, go and call the cattle home, And call the cattle home, And call the cattle home, Across the sands of Dee.’ The western wind was wild and dark with foam, And all alone went she.

The western tide crept up along the sand, And o’er and o’er the sand, And round and round the sand, As far as eye could see. The rolling mist came down and hid the land: And never home came she.

‘O is it weed, or fish, or floating hair-- A tress of golden hair, A drownèd maiden’s hair, Above the nets at sea?’ Was never salmon yet that shone so fair Among the stakes of Dee.

They row’d her in across the rolling foam, The cruel crawling foam, The cruel hungry foam, To her grave beside the sea. But still the boatmen hear her call the cattle home, Across the sands of Dee.

ARTHUR HUGH CLOUGH

1819-1861

_741._ _Say not the Struggle Naught availeth_

Say not the struggle naught availeth, The labour and the wounds are vain, The enemy faints not, nor faileth, And as things have been they remain.

If hopes were dupes, fears may be liars; It may be, in yon smoke conceal’d, Your comrades chase e’en now the fliers, And, but for you, possess the field.

For while the tired waves, vainly breaking, Seem here no painful inch to gain, Far back, through creeks and inlets making, Comes silent, flooding in, the main.

And not by eastern windows only, When daylight comes, comes in the light; In front the sun climbs slow, how slowly! But westward, look, the land is bright!

WALT WHITMAN

1819-1892

_742._ _The Imprisoned Soul_

At the last, tenderly, From the walls of the powerful, fortress’d house, From the clasp of the knitted locks--from the keep of the well-closed doors, Let me be wafted.

Let me glide noiselessly forth; With the key of softness unlock the locks--with a whisper Set ope the doors, O soul!

Tenderly! be not impatient! (Strong is your hold, O mortal flesh! Strong is your hold, O love!)

_743._ _O Captain! My Captain!_

O Captain! my Captain! our fearful trip is done, The ship has weather’d every rack, the prize we sought is won, The port is near, the bells I hear, the people all exulting, While follow eyes the steady keel, the vessel grim and daring; But O heart! heart! heart! O the bleeding drops of red! Where on the deck my Captain lies, Fallen cold and dead.

O Captain! my Captain! rise up and hear the bells; Rise up--for you the flag is flung--for you the bugle trills, For you bouquets and ribbon’d wreaths--for you the shores crowding, For you they call, the swaying mass, their eager faces turning; Here, Captain! dear father! This arm beneath your head! It is some dream that on the deck You’ve fallen cold and dead.

My Captain does not answer, his lips are pale and still, My father does not feel my arm, he has no pulse nor will; The ship is anchor’d safe and sound, its voyage closed and done, From fearful trip the victor ship comes in with object won; Exult, O shores! and ring, O bells! But I, with mournful tread, Walk the deck my Captain lies, Fallen cold and dead.

JOHN RUSKIN

1819-1900

_744._ _Trust Thou Thy Love_

Trust thou thy Love: if she be proud, is she not sweet? Trust thou thy Love: if she be mute, is she not pure? Lay thou thy soul full in her hands, low at her feet; Fail, Sun and Breath!--yet, for thy peace, She shall endure.

EBENEZER JONES

1820-1860

_745._ _When the World is burning_

When the world is burning, Fired within, yet turning Round with face unscathed; Ere fierce flames, uprushing, O'er all lands leap, crushing, Till earth fall, fire-swathed; Up amidst the meadows, Gently through the shadows, Gentle flames will glide, Small, and blue, and golden. Though by bard beholden, When in calm dreams folden,-- Calm his dreams will bide.

Where the dance is sweeping, Through the greensward peeping, Shall the soft lights start; Laughing maids, unstaying, Deeming it trick-playing, High their robes upswaying, O'er the lights shall dart; And the woodland haunter Shall not cease to saunter When, far down some glade, Of the great world's burning, One soft flame upturning Seems, to his discerning, Crocus in the shade.

FREDERICK LOCKER-LAMPSON

1821-1895

_746._ _At Her Window_

Beating Heart! we come again Where my Love reposes: This is Mabel's window-pane; These are Mabel's roses.

Is she nested? Does she kneel In the twilight stilly, Lily clad from throat to heel, She, my virgin Lily?

Soon the wan, the wistful stars, Fading, will forsake her; Elves of light, on beamy bars, Whisper then, and wake her.

Let this friendly pebble plead At her flowery grating; If she hear me will she heed? _Mabel, I am waiting._

Mabel will be deck'd anon, Zoned in bride's apparel; Happy zone! O hark to yon Passion-shaken carol!

Sing thy song, thou trancèd thrush, Pipe thy best, thy clearest;-- Hush, her lattice moves, O hush-- _Dearest Mabel!--dearest ..._

MATTHEW ARNOLD

1822-1888

_747._ _The Forsaken Merman_

Come, dear children, let us away; Down and away below. Now my brothers call from the bay; Now the great winds shoreward blow; Now the salt tides seaward flow; Now the wild white horses play, Champ and chafe and toss in the spray. Children dear, let us away. This way, this way!

Call her once before you go. Call once yet. In a voice that she will know: ‘Margaret! Margaret!’ Children’s voices should be dear (Call once more) to a mother’s ear; Children’s voices, wild with pain. Surely she will come again. Call her once and come away. This way, this way! ‘Mother dear, we cannot stay.’ The wild white horses foam and fret. Margaret! Margaret!

Come, dear children, come away down. Call no more. One last look at the white-wall’d town, And the little grey church on the windy shore. Then come down. She will not come though you call all day. Come away, come away. Children dear, was it yesterday We heard the sweet bells over the bay? In the caverns where we lay, Through the surf and through the swell, The far-off sound of a silver bell? Sand-strewn caverns, cool and deep, Where the winds are all asleep; Where the spent lights quiver and gleam; Where the salt weed sways in the stream; Where the sea-beasts, ranged all round, Feed in the ooze of their pasture-ground; Where the sea-snakes coil and twine, Dry their mail, and bask in the brine; Where great whales come sailing by, Sail and sail, with unshut eye, Round the world for ever and aye? When did music come this way? Children dear, was it yesterday?

Children dear, was it yesterday (Call yet once) that she went away? Once she sate with you and me, On a red gold throne in the heart of the sea, And the youngest sate on her knee. She comb’d its bright hair, and she tended it well, When down swung the sound of the far-off bell. She sigh’d, she look’d up through the clear green sea. She said, ‘I must go, for my kinsfolk pray In the little grey church on the shore to-day. ’Twill be Easter-time in the world--ah me! And I lose my poor soul, Merman, here with thee.’ I said, ‘Go up, dear heart, through the waves. Say thy prayer, and come back to the kind sea-caves.’ She smiled, she went up through the surf in the bay. Children dear, was it yesterday?

Children dear, were we long alone? ‘The sea grows stormy, the little ones moan. Long prayers,’ I said, ‘in the world they say. Come,’ I said, and we rose through the surf in the bay. We went up the beach, by the sandy down Where the sea-stocks bloom, to the white-wall’d town. Through the narrow paved streets, where all was still, To the little grey church on the windy hill. From the church came a murmur of folk at their prayers, But we stood without in the cold-blowing airs. We climb’d on the graves, on the stones worn with rains, And we gazed up the aisle through the small leaded panes. She sate by the pillar; we saw her clear: ‘Margaret, hist! come quick, we are here. Dear heart,’ I said, ‘we are long alone. The sea grows stormy, the little ones moan.’ But, ah! she gave me never a look, For her eyes were seal’d to the holy book. Loud prays the priest; shut stands the door. Come away, children, call no more. Come away, come down, call no more.

Down, down, down; Down to the depths of the sea. She sits at her wheel in the humming town, Singing most joyfully. Hark what she sings: ‘O joy, O joy, For the humming street, and the child with its toy. For the priest, and the bell, and the holy well. For the wheel where I spun, And the blessed light of the sun.’ And so she sings her fill, Singing most joyfully, Till the shuttle falls from her hand, And the whizzing wheel stands still. She steals to the window, and looks at the sand; And over the sand at the sea; And her eyes are set in a stare; And anon there breaks a sigh, And anon there drops a tear, From a sorrow-clouded eye, And a heart sorrow-laden, A long, long sigh For the cold strange eyes of a little Mermaiden, And the gleam of her golden hair.

Come away, away, children. Come children, come down. The hoarse wind blows colder; Lights shine in the town. She will start from her slumber When gusts shake the door; She will hear the winds howling, Will hear the waves roar. We shall see, while above us The waves roar and whirl, A ceiling of amber, A pavement of pearl. Singing, ‘Here came a mortal, But faithless was she: And alone dwell for ever The kings of the sea.’

But, children, at midnight, When soft the winds blow; When clear falls the moonlight; When spring-tides are low: When sweet airs come seaward From heaths starr’d with broom; And high rocks throw mildly On the blanch’d sands a gloom: Up the still, glistening beaches, Up the creeks we will hie; Over banks of bright seaweed The ebb-tide leaves dry. We will gaze, from the sand-hills, At the white, sleeping town; At the church on the hill-side-- And then come back down. Singing, ‘There dwells a loved one, But cruel is she. She left lonely for ever The kings of the sea.’

_748._ _The Song of Callicles_

Through the black, rushing smoke-bursts, Thick breaks the red flame. All Etna heaves fiercely Her forest-clothed frame.

Not here, O Apollo! Are haunts meet for thee. But, where Helicon breaks down In cliff to the sea.

Where the moon-silver’d inlets Send far their light voice Up the still vale of Thisbe, O speed, and rejoice!

On the sward at the cliff-top, Lie strewn the white flocks; On the cliff-side, the pigeons Roost deep in the rocks.

In the moonlight the shepherds, Soft lull’d by the rills, Lie wrapt in their blankets, Asleep on the hills.

--What forms are these coming So white through the gloom? What garments out-glistening The gold-flower’d broom?

What sweet-breathing Presence Out-perfumes the thyme? What voices enrapture The night’s balmy prime?--

’Tis Apollo comes leading His choir, The Nine. --The Leader is fairest, But all are divine.

They are lost in the hollows. They stream up again. What seeks on this mountain The glorified train?--

They bathe on this mountain, In the spring by their road. Then on to Olympus, Their endless abode.

--Whose praise do they mention Of what is it told?-- What will be for ever. What was from of old.

First hymn they the Father Of all things: and then, The rest of Immortals, The action of men.

The Day in his hotness, The strife with the palm; The Night in her silence, The Stars in their calm.

_749._ _To Marguerite_

Yes: in the sea of life enisled, With echoing straits between us thrown. Dotting the shoreless watery wild, We mortal millions live _alone_. The islands feel the enclasping flow, And then their endless bounds they know.

But when the moon their hollows lights, And they are swept by balms of spring, And in their glens, on starry nights, The nightingales divinely sing; And lovely notes, from shore to shore, Across the sounds and channels pour;

O then a longing like despair Is to their farthest caverns sent! For surely once, they feel, we were Parts of a single continent. Now round us spreads the watery plain-- O might our marges meet again!

Who order'd that their longing's fire Should be, as soon as kindled, cool'd? Who renders vain their deep desire?-- A God, a God their severance ruled; And bade betwixt their shores to be The unplumb'd, salt, estranging sea.

_750._ _Requiescat_

Strew on her roses, roses, And never a spray of yew. In quiet she reposes: Ah! would that I did too.

Her mirth the world required: She bathed it in smiles of glee. But her heart was tired, tired, And now they let her be.

Her life was turning, turning, In mazes of heat and sound. But for peace her soul was yearning, And now peace laps her round.

Her cabin'd, ample Spirit, It flutter'd and fail'd for breath. To-night it doth inherit The vasty hall of Death.

_751._ _The Scholar-Gipsy_

Go, for they call you, Shepherd, from the hill; Go, Shepherd, and untie the wattled cotes: No longer leave thy wistful flock unfed, Nor let thy bawling fellows rack their throats, Nor the cropp'd grasses shoot another head. But when the fields are still, And the tired men and dogs all gone to rest, And only the white sheep are sometimes seen Cross and recross the strips of moon-blanch'd green; Come, Shepherd, and again begin the quest.

Here, where the reaper was at work of late, In this high field’s dark corner, where he leaves His coat, his basket, and his earthen cruise, And in the sun all morning binds the sheaves, Then here, at noon, comes back his stores to use; Here will I sit and wait, While to my ear from uplands far away The bleating of the folded flocks is borne, With distant cries of reapers in the corn-- All the live murmur of a summer’s day.

Screen’d is this nook o’er the high, half-reap’d field, And here till sundown, Shepherd, will I be. Through the thick corn the scarlet poppies peep, And round green roots and yellowing stalks I see Pale blue convolvulus in tendrils creep: And air-swept lindens yield Their scent, and rustle down their perfumed showers Of bloom on the bent grass where I am laid, And bower me from the August sun with shade; And the eye travels down to Oxford’s towers:

And near me on the grass lies Glanvil’s book-- Come, let me read the oft-read tale again: The story of that Oxford scholar poor, Of pregnant parts and quick inventive brain, Who, tired of knocking at Preferment’s door, One summer morn forsook His friends, and went to learn the Gipsy lore, And roam’d the world with that wild brotherhood, And came, as most men deem’d, to little good, But came to Oxford and his friends no more.

But once, years after, in the country lanes, Two scholars, whom at college erst he knew, Met him, and of his way of life inquired. Whereat he answer’d that the Gipsy crew, His mates, had arts to rule as they desired The workings of men’s brains; And they can bind them to what thoughts they will: ‘And I,’ he said, ‘the secret of their art, When fully learn’d, will to the world impart: But it needs Heaven-sent moments for this skill!’

This said, he left them, and return’d no more, But rumours hung about the country-side, That the lost Scholar long was seen to stray, Seen by rare glimpses, pensive and tongue-tied, In hat of antique shape, and cloak of grey, The same the Gipsies wore. Shepherds had met him on the Hurst in spring; At some lone alehouse in the Berkshire moors, On the warm ingle-bench, the smock-frock’d boors Had found him seated at their entering, But, ’mid their drink and clatter, he would fly: And I myself seem half to know thy looks, And put the shepherds, Wanderer, on thy trace; And boys who in lone wheatfields scare the rooks I ask if thou hast pass’d their quiet place; Or in my boat I lie Moor’d to the cool bank in the summer heats, ‘Mid wide grass meadows which the sunshine fills, And watch the warm green-muffled Cumnor hills, And wonder if thou haunt’st their shy retreats.

For most, I know, thou lov’st retirèd ground. Thee, at the ferry, Oxford riders blithe, Returning home on summer nights, have met Crossing the stripling Thames at Bablock-hithe, Trailing in the cool stream thy fingers wet, As the slow punt swings round: And leaning backwards in a pensive dream, And fostering in thy lap a heap of flowers Pluck’d in shy fields and distant Wychwood bowers, And thine eyes resting on the moonlit stream:

And then they land, and thou art seen no more. Maidens who from the distant hamlets come To dance around the Fyfield elm in May, Oft through the darkening

fields have seen thee roam, Or cross a stile into the public way. Oft thou hast given them store Of flowers--the frail-leaf’d, white anemone-- Dark bluebells drench’d with dews of summer eves, And purple orchises with spotted leaves-- But none has words she can report of thee.

And, above Godstow Bridge, when hay-time’s here In June, and many a scythe in sunshine flames, Men who through those wide fields of breezy grass Where black-wing’d swallows haunt the glittering Thames, To bathe in the abandon’d lasher pass, Have often pass’d thee near Sitting upon the river bank o’ergrown: Mark’d thine outlandish garb, thy figure spare, Thy dark vague eyes, and soft abstracted air; But, when they came from bathing, thou wert gone.

At some lone homestead in the Cumnor hills, Where at her open door the housewife darns, Thou hast been seen, or hanging on a gate To watch the threshers in the mossy barns. Children, who early range these slopes and late For cresses from the rills, Have known thee watching, all an April day, The springing pastures and the feeding kine; And mark’d thee, when the stars come out and shine, Through the long dewy grass move slow away.

In autumn, on the skirts of Bagley Wood, Where most the Gipsies by the turf-edged way Pitch their smoked tents, and every bush you see With scarlet patches tagg’d and shreds of gray, Above the forest-ground call’d Thessaly-- The blackbird picking food Sees thee, nor stops his meal, nor fears at all; So often has he known thee past him stray Rapt, twirling in thy hand a wither’d spray, And waiting for the spark from Heaven to fall.

And once, in winter, on the causeway chill Where home through flooded fields foot-travellers go, Have I not pass’d thee on the wooden bridge Wrapt in thy cloak and battling with the snow, Thy face towards Hinksey and its wintry ridge? And thou hast climb’d the hill And gain’d the white brow of the Cumnor range; Turn’d once to watch, while thick the snowflakes fall, The line of festal light in Christ Church hall-- Then sought thy straw in some sequester’d grange.

But what--I dream! Two hundred years are flown Since first thy story ran through Oxford halls, And the grave Glanvil did the tale inscribe That thou wert wander’d from the studious walls To learn strange arts, and join a Gipsy tribe: And thou from earth art gone Long since, and in some quiet churchyard laid; Some country nook, where o’er thy unknown grave Tall grasses and white flowering nettles wave-- Under a dark red-fruited yew-tree’s shade.

--No, no, thou hast not felt the lapse of hours. For what wears out the life of mortal men? ’Tis that from change to change their being rolls: ’Tis that repeated shocks, again, again, Exhaust the energy of strongest souls, And numb the elastic powers. Till having used our nerves with bliss and teen, And tired upon a thousand schemes our wit, To the just-pausing Genius we remit Our worn-out life, and are--what we have been.

Thou hast not lived, why shouldst thou perish, so? Thou hadst _one_ aim, _one_ business, _one_ desire: Else wert thou long since number’d with the dead-- Else hadst thou spent, like other men, thy fire. The generations of thy peers are fled, And we

ourselves shall go; But thou possessest an immortal lot, And we imagine thee exempt from age And living as thou liv’st on Glanvil’s page, Because thou hadst--what we, alas, have not!

For early didst thou leave the world, with powers Fresh, undiverted to the world without, Firm to their mark, not spent on other things; Free from the sick fatigue, the languid doubt, Which much to have tried, in much been baffled, brings. O Life unlike to ours! Who fluctuate idly without term or scope, Of whom each strives, nor knows for what he strives, And each half lives a hundred different lives; Who wait like thee, but not, like thee, in hope.

Thou waitest for the spark from Heaven: and we, Vague half-believers of our casual creeds, Who never deeply felt, nor clearly will’d, Whose insight never has borne fruit in deeds, Whose weak resolves never have been fulfill’d; For whom each year we see Breeds new beginnings, disappointments new; Who hesitate and falter life away, And lose to-morrow the ground won to-day-- Ah, do not we, Wanderer, await it too?

Yes, we await it, but it still delays, And then we suffer; and amongst us One, Who most has suffer’d, takes dejectedly His seat upon the intellectual throne; And all his store of sad experience he Lays bare of wretched days; Tells us his misery’s birth and growth and signs, And how the dying spark of hope was fed, And how the breast was soothed, and how the head, And all his hourly varied anodynes.

This for our wisest: and we others pine, And wish the long unhappy dream would end, And waive all claim to bliss, and try to bear, With close-lipp’d Patience for our only friend, Sad Patience, too near neighbour to Despair: But none has hope like thine. Thou through the fields and through the woods dost stray, Roaming the country-side, a truant boy, Nursing thy project in unclouded joy, And every doubt long blown by time away.

O born in days when wits were fresh and clear, And life ran gaily as the sparkling Thames; Before this strange disease of modern life, With its sick hurry, its divided aims, Its heads o’ertax’d, its palsied hearts, was rife-- Fly hence, our contact fear! Still fly, plunge deeper in the bowering wood! Averse, as Dido did with gesture stern From her false friend’s approach in Hades turn, Wave us away, and keep thy solitude.

Still nursing the unconquerable hope, Still clutching the inviolable shade, With a free onward impulse brushing through, By night, the silver’d branches of the glade-- Far on the forest-skirts, where none pursue. On some mild pastoral slope Emerge, and resting on the moonlit pales, Freshen thy flowers, as in former years, With dew, or listen with enchanted ears, From the dark dingles, to the nightingales.

But fly our paths, our feverish contact fly! For strong the infection of our mental strife, Which, though it gives no bliss, yet spoils for rest; And we should win thee from thy own fair life, Like us distracted, and like us unblest. Soon, soon thy cheer would die, Thy hopes grow timorous, and unfix’d thy powers, And thy clear aims be cross and shifting made: And then thy glad perennial youth would fade, Fade, and grow old at last, and die like ours.

Then fly our greetings, fly our speech and smiles! --As some grave Tyrian trader, from the sea, Descried at sunrise an emerging prow Lifting the cool-hair’d creepers stealthily, The fringes of a southward-facing brow Among the Ægean isles; And saw the merry Grecian coaster come, Freighted with amber grapes, and Chian wine, Green bursting figs, and tunnies steep’d in brine; And knew the intruders on his ancient home, The young light-hearted Masters of the waves; And snatch’d his rudder, and shook out more sail, And day and night held on indignantly O’er the blue Midland waters with the gale, Betwixt the Syrtes and soft Sicily, To where the Atlantic raves Outside the Western Straits, and unbent sails There, where down cloudy cliffs, through sheets of foam, Shy traffickers, the dark Iberians come; And on the beach undid his corded bales.

_752._ _Philomela_

Hark! ah, the Nightingale! The tawny-throated! Hark! from that moonlit cedar what a burst! What triumph! hark--what pain!

O Wanderer from a Grecian shore, Still, after many years, in distant lands, Still nourishing in thy bewilder’d brain That wild, unquench’d, deep-sunken, old-world pain-- Say, will it never heal? And can this fragrant lawn With its cool trees, and night, And the sweet, tranquil Thames, And moonshine, and the dew, To thy rack’d heart and brain Afford no balm?

Dost thou to-night behold Here, through the moonlight on this English grass, The unfriendly palace in the Thracian wild? Dost thou again peruse With hot cheeks and sear’d eyes The too clear web, and thy dumb Sister’s shame? Dost thou once more assay Thy flight, and feel come over thee, Poor Fugitive, the feathery change Once more, and once more seem to make resound With love and hate, triumph and agony, Lone Daulis, and the high Cephissian vale? Listen, Eugenia-- How thick the bursts come crowding through the leaves Again--thou hearest! Eternal Passion! Eternal Pain!

_753._ _Shakespeare_

Others abide our question. Thou art free. We ask and ask: Thou smilest and art still, Out-topping knowledge. For the loftiest hill That to the stars uncrowns his majesty, Planting his steadfast footsteps in the sea, Making the heaven of heavens his dwelling-place. Spares but the cloudy border of his base To the foil’d searching of mortality; And thou, who didst the stars and sunbeams know, Self-school’d, self-scann’d, self-honour’d, self-secure, Didst walk on earth unguess’d at. Better so! All pains the immortal spirit must endure, All weakness that impairs, all griefs that bow, Find their sole voice in that victorious brow.

_754._ _From the Hymn of Empedocles_

Is it so small a thing To have enjoy’d the sun, To have lived light in the spring, To have loved, to have thought, to have done; To have advanced true friends, and beat down baffling foes;

That we must feign a bliss Of doubtful future date, And while we dream on this Lose all our present state, And relegate to worlds yet distant our repose?

Not much, I know, you prize What pleasures may be had, Who look on life with eyes Estranged, like mine, and sad: And yet the village churl feels the truth more than you;

Who’s loth to leave this life Which to him little yields: His hard-task’d sunburnt wife, His often-labour’d fields; The boors with whom he talk’d, the country spots he knew.

But thou, because thou hear’st Men scoff at Heaven and Fate; Because the gods thou fear’st Fail to make blest thy state, Tremblest, and wilt not dare to trust the joys there are.

I say, Fear not! life still Leaves human effort scope. But, since life teems with ill, Nurse no extravagant hope. Because thou must not dream, thou need’st not then despair.

WILLIAM BRIGHTY RANDS

1823-1880

_755._ _The Flowers_

When Love arose in heart and deed To wake the world to greater joy, ‘What can she give me now?’ said Greed, Who thought to win some costly toy.

He rose, he ran, he stoop’d, he clutch’d; And soon the Flowers, that Love let fall, In Greed’s hot grasp were fray’d and smutch’d, And Greed said, ‘Flowers! Can this be all?’

He flung them down and went his way, He cared no jot for thyme or rose; But boys and girls came out to play, And some took these and some took those--

Red, blue, and white, and green and gold; And at their touch the dew return’d, And all the bloom a thousandfold-- So red, so ripe, the roses burn’d!

_756._ _The Thought_

Into the skies, one summer’s day, I sent a little Thought away; Up to where, in the blue round, The sun sat shining without sound.

Then my Thought came back to me.-- Little Thought, what did you see In the regions whence you come? And when I spoke, my Thought was dumb.

But she breathed of what was there, In the pure bright upper air; And, because my Thought so shone, I knew she had been shone upon.

Next, by night a Thought I sent Up into the firmament; When the eager stars were out, And the still moon shone about.

And my Thought went past the moon In between the stars, but soon Held her breath and durst not stir, For the fear that covered her; Then she thought, in this demur:

‘Dare I look beneath the shade, Into where the worlds are made; Where the suns and stars are wrought? Shall I meet another Thought?

‘Will that other Thought have wings? Shall I meet strange, heavenly things? Thought of Thoughts, and Light of Lights, Breath of Breaths, and Night of Nights?’

Then my Thought began to hark In the illuminated dark, Till the silence, over, under, Made her heart beat more than thunder.

And my Thought, came trembling back, But with something on her track, And with something at her side; Nor till she has lived and died, Lived and died, and lived again, Will that awful thing seem plain.

WILLIAM PHILPOT

1823-1889

_757._ _Maritæ Suæ_

I

Of all the flowers rising now, Thou only saw’st the head Of that unopen’d drop of snow I placed beside thy bed.

In all the blooms that blow so fast, Thou hast no further part, Save those the hour I saw thee last, I laid above thy heart.

Two snowdrops for our boy and girl, A primrose blown for me, Wreathed with one often-play’d-with curl From each bright head for thee.

And so I graced thee for thy grave, And made these tokens fast With that old silver heart I gave, My first gift--and my last.

II

I dream’d, her babe upon her breast, Here she might lie and calmly rest Her happy eyes on that far hill That backs the landscape fresh and still.

I hoped her thoughts would thrid the boughs Where careless birds on love carouse, And gaze those apple-blossoms through To revel in the boundless blue.

But now her faculty of sight Is elder sister to the light, And travels free and unconfined Through dense and rare, through form and mind.

Or else her life to be complete Hath found new channels full and meet-- Then, O, what eyes are leaning o’er, If fairer than they were before!

WILLIAM (JOHNSON) CORY

1823-1892

_758._ _Mimnermus in Church_

You promise heavens free from strife, Pure truth, and perfect change of will; But sweet, sweet is this human life, So sweet, I fain would breathe it still; Your chilly stars I can forgo, This warm kind world is all I know.

You say there is no substance here, One great reality above: Back from that void I shrink in fear, And child-like hide myself in love: Show me what angels feel. Till then I cling, a mere weak man, to men.

You bid me lift my mean desires From faltering lips and fitful veins To sexless souls, ideal quires, Unwearied voices, wordless strains: My mind with fonder welcome owns One dear dead friend's remember'd tones.

Forsooth the present we must give To that which cannot pass away; All beauteous things for which we live By laws of time and space decay. But O, the very reason why I clasp them, is because they die.

_759._ _Heraclitus_

They told me, Heraclitus, they told me you were dead, They brought me bitter news to hear and bitter tears to shed. I wept as I remember'd how often you and I Had tired the sun with talking and sent him down the sky.

And now that thou art lying, my dear old Carian guest, A handful of grey ashes, long, long ago at rest, Still are thy pleasant voices, thy nightingales, awake; For Death, he taketh all away, but them he cannot take.

COVENTRY PATMORE

1823-1896

_760._ _The Married Lover_

Why, having won her, do I woo? Because her spirit's vestal grace Provokes me always to pursue, But, spirit-like, eludes embrace; Because her womanhood is such That, as on court-days subjects kiss The Queen's hand, yet so near a touch Affirms no mean familiarness; Nay, rather marks more fair the height Which can with safety so neglect To dread, as lower ladies might, That grace could meet with disrespect; Thus she with happy favour feeds Allegiance from a love so high That thence no false conceit proceeds Of difference bridged, or state put by; Because although in act and word As lowly as a wife can be, Her manners, when they call me lord, Remind me 'tis by courtesy; Not with her least consent of will, Which would my proud affection hurt, But by the noble style that still Imputes an unattain'd desert; Because her gay and lofty brows, When all is won which hope can ask, Reflect a light of hopeless snows That bright in virgin ether bask; Because, though free of the outer court I am, this Temple keeps its shrine Sacred to Heaven; because, in short, She's not and never can be mine.

_761._ '_If I were dead_'

'If I were dead, you'd sometimes say, Poor Child!' The dear lips quiver'd as they spake, And the tears brake From eyes which, not to grieve me, brightly smiled. Poor

Child, poor Child! I seem to hear your laugh, your talk, your song. It is not true that Love will do no wrong. Poor Child! And did you think, when you so cried and smiled, How I, in lonely nights, should lie awake, And of those words your full avengers make? Poor Child, poor Child! And now, unless it be That sweet amends thrice told are come to thee, O God, have Thou _no_ mercy upon me! Poor Child!

_762._ _Departure_

It was not like your great and gracious ways! Do you, that have naught other to lament, Never, my Love, repent Of how, that July afternoon, You went, With sudden, unintelligible phrase, And frighten'd eye, Upon your journey of so many days Without a single kiss, or a good-bye? I knew, indeed, that you were parting soon; And so we sate, within the low sun's rays, You whispering to me, for your voice was weak, Your harrowing praise. Well, it was well To hear you such things speak, And I could tell What made your eyes a growing gloom of love, As a warm South-wind sombres a March grove. And it was like your great and gracious ways To turn your talk on daily things, my Dear, Lifting the luminous, pathetic lash To let the laughter flash, Whilst I drew near, Because you spoke so low that I could scarcely hear. But all at once to leave me at the last, More at the wonder than the loss aghast, With huddled, unintelligible phrase, And frighten'd eye, And go your journey of all days With not one kiss, or a good-bye, And the only loveless look the look with which you pass'd: 'Twas all unlike your great and gracious ways.

_763._ _The Toys_

My little Son, who look'd from thoughtful eyes And moved and spoke in quiet grown-up wise, Having my law the seventh time disobey'd, I struck him, and dismissed With hard words and unkiss'd, --His Mother, who was patient, being dead. Then, fearing lest his grief should hinder sleep, I visited his bed, But found him slumbering deep, With darkened eyelids, and their lashes yet From his late sobbing wet. And I, with moan, Kissing away his tears, left others of my own; For, on a table drawn beside his head, He had put, within his reach, A box of counters and a red-vein'd stone, A piece of glass abraded by the beach, And six or seven shells, A bottle with bluebells, And two French copper coins, ranged there with careful art, To comfort his sad heart. So when that night I pray'd To God, I wept, and said: Ah, when at last we lie with trancèd breath, Not vexing Thee in death, And Thou rememberest of what toys We made our joys, How weakly understood Thy great commanded good, Then, fatherly not less Than I whom Thou hast moulded from the clay, Thou'lt leave Thy wrath, and say, 'I will be sorry for their childishness.'

_764._ _A Farewell_

With all my will, but much against my heart, We two now part. My Very Dear, Our solace is, the sad road lies so clear. It needs no art, With faint, averted feet And many a tear, In our opposèd paths to persevere. Go thou to East, I West. We will not say There's any hope, it is so far away. But, O, my Best, When the one darling of our widowhead, The nursling Grief, Is dead, And no dews blur our eyes To see the peach-bloom come in evening skies, Perchance we may, Where now this night is day, And even through faith of still averted feet, Making full circle of our banishment,

Amazèd meet; The bitter journey to the bourne so sweet Seasoning the termless feast of our content With tears of recognition never dry.

SYDNEY DOBELL

1824-1874

_765._ _The Ballad of Keith of Ravelston_

The murmur of the mourning ghost That keeps the shadowy kine, ‘O Keith of Ravelston, The sorrows of thy line!’

Ravelston, Ravelston, The merry path that leads Down the golden morning hill, And thro’ the silver meads;

Ravelston, Ravelston, The stile beneath the tree, The maid that kept her mother’s kine, The song that sang she!

She sang her song, she kept her kine, She sat beneath the thorn, When Andrew Keith of Ravelston Rode thro’ the Monday morn.

His henchmen sing, his hawk-bells ring, His belted jewels shine; O Keith of Ravelston, The sorrows of thy line!

Year after year, where Andrew came, Comes evening down the glade, And still there sits a moonshine ghost Where sat the sunshine maid.

Her misty hair is faint and fair, She keeps the shadowy kine; O Keith of Ravelston, The sorrows of thy line!

I lay my hand upon the stile, The stile is lone and cold, The burnie that goes babbling by Says naught that can be told.

Yet, stranger! here, from year to year, She keeps her shadowy kine; O Keith of Ravelston, The sorrows of thy line!

Step out three steps, where Andrew stood-- Why blanch thy cheeks for fear? The ancient stile is not alone, ’Tis not the burn I hear!

She makes her immemorial moan, She keeps her shadowy kine; O Keith of Ravelston, The sorrows of thy line!

_766._ _Return!_

Return, return! all night my lamp is burning, All night, like it, my wide eyes watch and burn; Like it, I fade and pale, when day returning Bears witness that the absent can return, Return, return.

Like it, I lessen with a lengthening sadness, Like it, I burn to waste and waste to burn, Like it, I spend the golden oil of gladness To feed the sorrowy signal for return, Return, return.

Like it, like it, whene’er the east wind sings, I bend and shake; like it, I quake and yearn, When Hope’s late butterflies, with whispering wings, Fly in out of the dark, to

fall and burn-- Burn in the watchfire of return, Return, return.

Like it, the very flame whereby I pine Consumes me to its nature. While I mourn My soul becomes a better soul than mine, And from its brightening beacon I discern My starry love go forth from me, and shine Across the seas a path for thy return, Return, return.

Return, return! all night I see it burn, All night it prays like me, and lifts a twin Of palmèd praying hands that meet and yearn-- Yearn to the impleaded skies for thy return. Day, like a golden fetter, locks them in, And wans the light that withers, tho' it burn As warmly still for thy return; Still thro' the splendid load uplifts the thin Pale, paler, palest patience that can learn Naught but that votive sign for thy return-- That single suppliant sign for thy return, Return, return.

Return, return! lest haply, love, or e'er Thou touch the lamp the light have ceased to burn, And thou, who thro' the window didst discern The wonted flame, shalt reach the topmost stair To find no wide eyes watching there, No wither'd welcome waiting thy return! A passing ghost, a smoke-wreath in the air, The flameless ashes, and the soulless urn, Warm with the famish'd fire that lived to burn-- Burn out its lingering life for thy return, Its last of lingering life for thy return, Its last of lingering life to light thy late return, Return, return.

_767._ _A Chanted Calendar_

First came the primrose, On the bank high, Like a maiden looking forth From the window of a tower When the battle rolls below, So look'd she, And saw the storms go by. Then came the wind-flower In the valley left behind, As a wounded maiden, pale With purple streaks of woe, When the battle has roll'd by Wanders to and fro, So totter'd she, Dishevelled in the wind.

Then came the daisies, On the first of May, Like a banner'd show's advance While the crowd runs by the way, With ten thousand flowers about them they came trooping through the fields. As a happy people come, So came they, As a happy people come When the war has roll'd away, With dance and tabor, pipe and drum. And all make holiday.

Then came the cowslip, Like a dancer in the fair, She spread her little mat of green, And on it danced she. With a fillet bound about her brow, A fillet round her happy brow, A golden fillet round her brow, And rubies in her hair.

_768._ _Laus Deo_

In the hall the coffin waits, and the idle armourer stands. At his belt the coffin nails, and the hammer in his hands. The bed of state is hung with crape--the grand old bed where she was wed-- And like an upright corpse she sitteth gazing dumbly at the bed. Hour by hour her serving-men enter by the curtain'd door, And with steps of muffled woe pass breathless o'er the silent floor, And marshal mutely round, and look from each to each with eyelids red; 'Touch him not,' she shriek'd and cried, 'he is but newly dead!' 'O my own dear mistress,' the ancient Nurse did say, 'Seven long days and seven long nights you have watch'd him where he lay.' 'Seven long days and seven long nights,'the hoary Steward said; 'Seven long days and seven long nights,'

groan’d the Warrener gray; ‘Seven,’ said the old Henchman, and bow’d his aged head; ‘On your lives!’ she shriek’d and cried,‘he is but newly dead!’ Then a father Priest they sought, The Priest that taught her all she knew, And they told him of her loss. ‘For she is mild and sweet of will, She loved him, and his words are peace, And he shall heal her ill.’ But her watch she did not cease. He bless’d her where she sat distraught, And show’d her holy cross,-- The cross she kiss’d from year to year-- But she neither saw nor heard; And said he in her deaf ear All he had been wont to teach, All she had been fond to hear, Missall’d prayer, and solemn speech, But she answer’d not a word. Only when he turn’d to speak with those who wept about the bed, ‘On your lives!’ she shriek’d and cried, ‘he is but newly dead!’ Then how sadly he turn’d from her, it were wonderful to tell, And he stood beside the death-bed as by one who slumbers well, And he lean’d o’er him who lay there, and in cautious whisper low, ‘He is not dead, but sleepeth,’ said the Priest, and smooth’d his brow. ‘Sleepeth?’ said she, looking up, and the sun rose in her face! ‘He must be better than I thought, for the sleep is very sound.’ ‘He is better,’ said the Priest, and call’d her maidens round. With them came that ancient dame who nursed her when a child; O Nurse!’ she sigh’d, ‘O Nurse!’ she cried, ‘O Nurse!’ and then she smiled, And then she wept; with that they drew About her, as of old; Her dying eyes were sweet and blue, Her trembling touch was cold; But she said, ‘My maidens true, No more weeping and well-away; Let them kill the feast. I would be happy in my soul. “He is better,” saith the Priest; He did but sleep the weary day, And will waken whole. Carry me to his dear side, And let the halls be trim; Whistly, whistly,’ said she, ‘I am wan with watching and wail, He must not wake to see me pale, Let me sleep with him. See you keep the tryst for me, I would rest till he awake And rise up like a bride. But whistly, whistly!’ said she. ‘Yet rejoice your Lord doth live; And for His dear sake Say _Laus, Domine_.’ Silent they cast down their eyes, And every breast a sob did rive, She lifted her in wild surprise And they dared not disobey. ‘_Laus Deo_,’ said the Steward, hoary when her days were new; ‘_Laus Deo_,’ said the Warrener, whiter than the warren snows; ‘_Laus Deo_,’ the bald Henchman, who had nursed her on his knee. The old Nurse moved her lips in vain, And she stood among the train Like a dead tree shaking dew. Then the Priest he softly slept Midway in the little band, And he took the Lady’s hand. ‘_Laus Deo_,’ he said aloud, ‘_Laus Deo_,’ they said again, Yet again, and yet again, Humbly cross’d and lowly bow’d, Till in wont and fear it rose To the Sabbath strain.

But she neither turn’d her head Nor ‘Whistly, whistly,’ said she. Her hands were folded as in grace, We laid her with her ancient race And all the village wept.

WILLIAM ALLINGHAM

1824-1889

_769._ _The Fairies_

Up the airy mountain, Down the rushy glen, We daren’t go a-hunting For fear of little men; Wee folk, good folk, Trooping all together; Green jacket, red cap, And white owl’s feather!

Down along the rocky shore Some make their home, They live on crispy pancakes Of yellow tide-foam; Some in the reeds Of the black mountain lake, With frogs for their watch-dogs, All night awake.

High on the hill-top The old King sits; He is now so old and gray He’s nigh lost his wits.

With a bridge of white mist Columbkill he crosses, On his stately journeys From Slieveleague to Rosses; Or going up with music On cold starry nights To sup with the Queen Of the gay Northern Lights.

They stole little Bridget For seven years long; When she came down again Her friends were all gone. They took her lightly back, Between the night and morrow, They thought that she was fast asleep, But she was dead with sorrow. They have kept her ever since Deep within the lake, On a bed of flag-leaves, Watching till she wake.

By the craggy hill-side, Through the mosses bare, They have planted thorn-trees For pleasure here and there. If any man so daring As dig them up in spite, He shall find their sharpest thorns In his bed at night.

Up the airy mountain, Down the rushy glen, We daren’t go a-hunting For fear of little men; Wee folk, good folk, Trooping all together; Green jacket, red cap, And white owl’s feather!

GEORGE MAC DONALD

1824-1905

_770._ _That Holy Thing_

They all were looking for a king To slay their foes and lift them high: Thou cam’st, a little baby thing That made a woman cry.

O Son of Man, to right my lot Naught but Thy presence can avail; Yet on the road Thy wheels are not, Nor on the sea Thy sail!

My how or when Thou wilt not heed, But come down Thine own secret stair, That Thou mayst answer all my need-- Yea, every bygone prayer.

DANTE GABRIEL ROSSETTI

1828-1882

_771._ _The Blessèd Damozel_

The blessèd Damozel lean’d out From the gold bar of Heaven: Her blue grave eyes were deeper much Than a deep water, even. She had three lilies in her hand, And the stars in her hair were seven.

Her robe, ungirt from clasp to hem, No wrought flowers did adorn, But a white rose of Mary’s gift On the neck meetly worn; And her hair, lying down her back, Was yellow like ripe corn.

Herseem’d she scarce had been a day One of God’s choristers; The wonder was not yet quite gone From that still look of hers; Albeit, to them she left, her day Had counted as ten years.

(To _one_ it is ten years of years: ... Yet now, here in this place, Surely she lean’d o’er me,--her hair Fell all about my face.... Nothing: the Autumn-fall of leaves. The whole year sets apace.)

It was the terrace of God’s house That she was standing on,-- By God built over the sheer depth In which Space is begun; So high, that looking downward thence, She scarce could see the sun.

It lies from Heaven across the flood Of ether, as a bridge. Beneath, the tides of day and night With flame and darkness ridge The void, as low as where this earth Spins like a fretful midge.

But in those tracts, with her, it was The peace of utter light And silence. For no breeze may stir Along the steady flight Of seraphim; no echo there, Beyond all depth or height.

Heard hardly, some of her new friends, Playing at holy games, Spake, gentle-mouth’d, among themselves, Their virginal chaste names; And the souls, mounting up to God, Went by her like thin flames.

And still she bow’d herself, and stoop’d Into the vast waste calm; Till her bosom’s pressure must have made The bar she lean’d on warm, And the lilies lay as if asleep Along her bended arm.

From the fixt lull of Heaven, she saw Time, like a pulse, shake fierce Through all the worlds. Her gaze still strove, In that steep gulf, to pierce The swarm; and then she spoke, as when The stars sang in their spheres.

‘I wish that he were come to me, For he will come,’ she said. ‘Have I not pray’d in solemn Heaven? On earth, has he not pray’d? Are not two prayers a perfect strength? And shall I feel afraid?

‘When round his head the aureole clings, And he is clothed in white, I’ll take his hand, and go with him To the deep wells of light, And we will step down as to a stream And bathe there in God’s sight.

‘We two will stand beside that shrine, Occult, withheld, untrod, Whose lamps tremble continually With prayer sent up to God; And where each need, reveal’d, expects Its patient period.

‘We two will lie i’ the shadow of That living mystic tree Within whose secret growth the Dove Sometimes is felt to be, While every leaf that His plumes touch Saith His name audibly.

‘And I myself will teach to him,-- I myself, lying so,-- The songs I sing here; which his mouth Shall pause in, hush’d and slow, Finding some knowledge at each pause, And some new thing to know.’

(Alas! to _her_ wise simple mind These things were all but known Before: they trembled on her sense,-- Her voice had caught their tone. Alas for lonely Heaven! Alas For life wrung out alone!

Alas, and though the end were reach'd?... Was _thy_ part understood Or borne in trust? And for her sake Shall this too be found good?-- May the close lips that knew not prayer Praise ever, though they would?)

'We two,' she said, 'will seek the groves Where the lady Mary is, With her five handmaidens, whose names Are five sweet symphonies:-- Cecily, Gertrude, Magdalen, Margaret and Rosalys.

'Circle-wise sit they, with bound locks And bosoms coverèd; Into the fine cloth, white like flame, Weaving the golden thread, To fashion the birth-robes for them Who are just born, being dead.

'He shall fear, haply, and be dumb. Then I will lay my cheek To his, and tell about our love, Not once abash'd or weak: And the dear Mother will approve My pride, and let me speak.

'Herself shall bring us, hand in hand, To Him round whom all souls Kneel--the unnumber'd solemn heads Bow'd with their aureoles: And Angels, meeting us, shall sing To their citherns and citoles.

'There will I ask of Christ the Lord Thus much for him and me:-- To have more blessing than on earth In nowise; but to be As then we were,--being as then At peace. Yea, verily.

'Yea, verily; when he is come We will do thus and thus: Till this my vigil seem quite strange And almost fabulous; We two will live at once, one life; And peace shall be with us.'

She gazed, and listen'd, and then said, Less sad of speech than mild,-- 'All this is when he comes.' She ceased: The light thrill'd past her, fill'd With Angels, in strong level lapse. Her eyes pray'd, and she smiled.

(I saw her smile.) But soon their flight Was vague 'mid the poised spheres. And then she cast her arms along The golden barriers, And laid her face between her hands, And wept. (I heard her tears.)

GEORGE MEREDITH

1828-1909

_772._ _Love in the Valley_

Under yonder beech-tree single on the green-sward, Couch'd with her arms behind her golden head, Knees and tresses folded to slip and ripple idly, Lies my young love sleeping in the shade. Had I the heart to slide an arm beneath her, Press her parting lips as her waist I gather slow, Waking in amazement she could not but embrace me: Then would she hold me and never let me go?

* * * * *

Shy as the squirrel and wayward as the swallow, Swift as the swallow along the river’s light Circleting the surface to meet his mirror’d winglets, Fleeter she seems in her stay than in her flight. Shy as the squirrel that leaps among the pine-tops, Wayward as the swallow overhead at set of sun, She whom I love is hard to catch and conquer, Hard, but O the glory of the winning were she won!

* * * * *

When her mother tends her before the laughing mirror, Tying up her laces, looping up her hair, Often she thinks, were this wild thing wedded, More love should I have, and much less care. When her mother tends her before the lighted mirror, Loosening her laces, combing down her curls, Often she thinks, were this wild thing wedded, I should miss but one for many boys and girls.

* * * * *

Heartless she is as the shadow in the meadows Flying to the hills on a blue and breezy noon. No, she is athirst and drinking up her wonder: Earth to her is young as the slip of the new moon. Deals she an unkindness, ’tis but her rapid measure, Even as in a dance; and her smile can heal no less: Like the swinging May-cloud that pelts the flowers with hailstones Off a sunny border, she was made to bruise and bless.

* * * * *

Lovely are the curves of the white owl sweeping Wavy in the dusk lit by one large star. Lone on the fir-branch, his rattle-note unvaried, Brooding o’er the gloom, spins the brown evejar. Darker grows the valley, more and more forgetting: So were it with me if forgetting could be will’d. Tell the grassy hollow that holds the bubbling well-spring, Tell it to forget the source that keeps it fill’d.

* * * * *

Stepping down the hill with her fair companions, Arm in arm, all against the raying West, Boldly she sings, to the merry tune she marches, Brave is her shape, and sweeter unpossess’d. Sweeter, for she is what my heart first awaking Whisper’d the world was; morning light is she. Love that so desires would fain keep her changeless; Fain would fling the net, and fain have her free.

* * * * *

Happy happy time, when the white star hovers Low over dim fields fresh with bloomy dew, Near the face of dawn, that draws athwart the darkness, Threading it with colour, like yewberries the yew. Thicker crowd the shades as the grave East deepens Glowing, and with crimson a long cloud swells. Maiden still the morn is; and strange she is, and secret; Strange her eyes; her cheeks are cold as cold sea-shells.

* * * * *

Sunrays, leaning on our southern hills and lighting Wild cloud-mountains that drag the hills along, Oft ends the day of your shifting brilliant laughter Chill as a dull face frowning on a song. Ay, but shows the South-west a ripple-feather’d bosom Blown to

silver while the clouds are shaken and ascend Scaling the mid-heavens as they stream, there comes a sunset Rich, deep like love in beauty without end.

* * * * *

When at dawn she sighs, and like an infant to the window Turns grave eyes craving light, released from dreams, Beautiful she looks, like a white water-lily Bursting out of bud in havens of the streams. When from bed she rises clothed from neck to ankle In her long nightgown sweet as boughs of May, Beautiful she looks, like a tall garden-lily Pure from the night, and splendid for the day.

* * * * *

Mother of the dews, dark eye-lash'd twilight, Low-lidded twilight, o'er the valley's brim, Rounding on thy breast sings the dew-delighted skylark, Clear as though the dewdrops had their voice in him. Hidden where the rose-flush drinks the rayless planet, Fountain-full he pours the spraying fountain-showers. Let me hear her laughter, I would have her ever Cool as dew in twilight, the lark above the flowers.

* * * * *

All the girls are out with their baskets for the primrose; Up lanes, woods through, they troop in joyful bands. My sweet leads: she knows not why, but now she loiters, Eyes the bent anemones, and hangs her hands. Such a look will tell that the violets are peeping, Coming the rose: and unaware a cry Springs in her bosom for odours and for colour, Covert and the nightingale; she knows not why.

* * * * *

Kerchief'd head and chin she darts between her tulips, Streaming like a willow gray in arrowy rain: Some bend beaten cheek to gravel, and their angel She will be; she lifts them, and on she speeds again. Black the driving raincloud breasts the iron gateway: She is forth to cheer a neighbour lacking mirth. So when sky and grass met rolling dumb for thunder Saw I once a white dove, sole light of earth.

* * * * *

Prim little scholars are the flowers of her garden, Train'd to stand in rows, and asking if they please. I might love them well but for loving more the wild ones: O my wild ones! they tell me more than these. You, my wild one, you tell of honied field-rose, Violet, blushing eglantine in life; and even as they, They by the wayside are earnest of your goodness, You are of life's, on the banks that line the way.

* * * * *

Peering at her chamber the white crowns the red rose, Jasmine winds the porch with stars two and three. Parted is the window; she sleeps; the starry jasmine Breathes a falling breath that carries thoughts of me. Sweeter unpossessed, have I said of her my sweetest? Not while she sleeps: while she sleeps the jasmine breathes, Luring her to love; she sleeps; the starry jasmine Bears me to her pillow under white rose-wreaths.

* * * * *

Yellow with birdfoot-trefoil are the grass-glades; Yellow with cinquefoil of the dew-gray leaf; Yellow with stonecrop; the moss-mounds are yellow; Blue-neck'd the wheat sways, yellowing to the sheaf. Green-yellow, bursts from the copse the laughing yaffle; Sharp as a sickle is the edge of shade and shine: Earth in her heart laughs looking at the heavens, Thinking of the harvest: I look and think of mine.

* * * * *

This I may know: her dressing and undressing Such a change of light shows as when the skies in sport Shift from cloud to moonlight; or edging over thunder Slips a ray of sun; or sweeping into port White sails furl; or on the ocean borders White sails lean along the waves leaping green. Visions of her shower before me, but from eyesight Guarded she would be like the sun were she seen.

* * * * *

Front door and back of the moss'd old farmhouse Open with the morn, and in a breezy link Freshly sparkles garden to stripe-shadow'd orchard, Green across a rill where on sand the minnows wink. Busy in the grass the early sun of summer Swarms, and the blackbird's mellow fluting notes Call my darling up with round and roguish challenge: Quaintest, richest carol of all the singing throats!

* * * * *

Cool was the woodside; cool as her white dairy Keeping sweet the cream-pan; and there the boys from school, Cricketing below, rush'd brown and red with sunshine; O the dark translucence of the deep-eyed cool! Spying from the farm, herself she fetch'd a pitcher Full of milk, and tilted for each in turn the beak. Then a little fellow, mouth up and on tiptoe, Said, 'I will kiss you': she laugh'd and lean'd her cheek.

* * * * *

Doves of the fir-wood walling high our red roof Through the long noon coo, crooning through the coo. Loose droop the leaves, and down the sleepy roadway Sometimes pipes a chaffinch; loose droops the blue. Cows flap a slow tail knee-deep in the river, Breathless, given up to sun and gnat and fly. Nowhere is she seen; and if I see her nowhere, Lightning may come, straight rains and tiger sky.

* * * * *

O the golden sheaf, the rustling treasure-armful! O the nutbrown tresses nodding interlaced! O the treasure-tresses one another over Nodding! O the girdle slack about the waist! Slain are the poppies that shot their random scarlet Quick amid the wheat-ears: wound about the waist, Gathered, see these brides of Earth one blush of ripeness! O the nutbrown tresses nodding interlaced!

* * * * *

Large and smoky red the sun's cold disk drops, Clipped by naked hills, on violet shaded snow: Eastward large and still lights up a bower of moonrise, Whence at her leisure steps the moon aglow. Nightlong on black print-branches our beech-tree Gazes in this whiteness: nightlong could I. Here may life on death or death on life be

painted. Let me clasp her soul to know she cannot die!

* * * * *

Gossips count her faults; they scour a narrow chamber Where there is no window, read not heaven or her. ‘When she was a tiny,’ one agèd woman quavers, Plucks at my heart and leads me by the ear. Faults she had once as she learn’d to run and tumbled: Faults of feature some see, beauty not complete. Yet, good gossips, beauty that makes holy Earth and air, may have faults from head to feet.

Hither she comes; she comes to me; she lingers, Deepens her brown eyebrows, while in new surprise High rise the lashes in wonder of a stranger; Yet am I the light and living of her eyes. Something friends have told her fills her heart to brimming, Nets her in her blushes, and wounds her, and tames.-- Sure of her haven, O like a dove alighting, Arms up, she dropp’d: our souls were in our names.

* * * * *

Soon will she lie like a white frost sunrise. Yellow oats and brown wheat, barley pale as rye, Long since your sheaves have yielded to the thresher, Felt the girdle loosen’d, seen the tresses fly. Soon will she lie like a blood-red sunset. Swift with the to-morrow, green-wing’d Spring! Sing from the South-west, bring her back the truants, Nightingale and swallow, song and dipping wing.

* * * * *

Soft new beech-leaves, up to beamy April Spreading bough on bough a primrose mountain, you Lucid in the moon, raise lilies to the skyfields, Youngest green transfused in silver shining through: Fairer than the lily, than the wild white cherry: Fair as in image my seraph love appears Borne to me by dreams when dawn is at my eyelids: Fair as in the flesh she swims to me on tears.

* * * * *

Could I find a place to be alone with heaven, I would speak my heart out: heaven is my need. Every woodland tree is flushing like the dogwood, Flashing like the whitebeam, swaying like the reed. Flushing like the dogwood crimson in October; Streaming like the flag-reed South-west blown; Flashing as in gusts the sudden-lighted whitebeam: All seem to know what is for heaven alone.

_773._ _Phœbus with Admetus_

When by Zeus relenting the mandate was revoked, Sentencing to exile the bright Sun-God, Mindful were the ploughmen of who the steer had yoked, Who: and what a track show’d the upturn’d sod! Mindful were the shepherds, as now the noon severe Bent a burning eyebrow to brown evetide, How the rustic flute drew the silver to the sphere, Sister of his own, till her rays fell wide. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

Chirping none, the scarlet cicalas crouch’d in ranks: Slack the thistle-head piled its down-silk gray: Scarce the stony lizard suck’d hollows in his flanks: Thick on spots of umbrage our drowsed flocks lay. Sudden bow’d the chestnuts beneath a wind

unheard, Lengthen’d ran the grasses, the sky grew slate: Then amid a swift flight of wing’d seed white as curd, Clear of limb a Youth smote the master’s gate. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

Water, first of singers, o’er rocky mount and mead, First of earthly singers, the sun-loved rill, Sang of him, and flooded the ripples on the reed, Seeking whom to waken and what ear fill. Water, sweetest soother to kiss a wound and cool, Sweetest and divinest, the sky-born brook, Chuckled, with a whimper, and made a mirror-pool Round the guest we welcomed, the strange hand shook. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

Many swarms of wild bees descended on our fields: Stately stood the wheatstalk with head bent high: Big of heart we labour’d at storing mighty yields, Wool and corn, and clusters to make men cry! Hand-like rush’d the vintage; we strung the bellied skins Plump, and at the sealing the Youth’s voice rose: Maidens clung in circle, on little fists their chins; Gentle beasties through push’d a cold long nose. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

Foot to fire in snowtime we trimm’d the slender shaft: Often down the pit spied the lean wolf’s teeth Grin against his will, trapp’d by masterstrokes of craft; Helpless in his froth-wrath as green logs seethe! Safe the tender lambs tugg’d the teats, and winter sped Whirl’d before the crocus, the year’s new gold. Hung the hooky beak up aloft, the arrowhead Redden’d through his feathers for our dear fold. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darkened That had thee here obscure.

Tales we drank of giants at war with gods above: Rocks were they to look on, and earth climb’d air! Tales of search for simples, and those who sought of love Ease because the creature was all too fair. Pleasant ran our thinking that while our work was good, Sure as fruits for sweat would the praise come fast. He that wrestled stoutest and tamed the billow-brood Danced in rings with girls, like a sail-flapp’d mast. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

Lo, the herb of healing, when once the herb is known, Shines in shady woods bright as new-sprung flame. Ere the string was tighten’d we heard the mellow tone, After he had taught how the sweet sounds came. Stretch’d about his feet, labour done, ’twas as you see Red pomegranates tumble and burst hard rind. So began contention to give delight and be Excellent in things aim’d to make life kind. God! of whom music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

You with shelly horns, rams! and, promontory goats, You whose browsing beards dip in coldest dew! Bulls, that walk the pastures in kingly-flashing coats! Laurel, ivy, vine, wreathed for feasts not few! You that build the shade-roof, and you that court the rays, You that leap besprinkling the rock stream-rent: He has been our fellow, the morning of our days; Us he chose for housemates, and this way went. God! of whom

music And song and blood are pure, The day is never darken’d That had thee here obscure.

_774._ _Tardy Spring_

Now the North wind ceases, The warm South-west awakes; Swift fly the fleeces, Thick the blossom-flakes.

Now hill to hill has made the stride, And distance waves the without-end: Now in the breast a door flings wide; Our farthest smiles, our next is friend. And song of England’s rush of flowers Is this full breeze with mellow stops, That spins the lark for shine, for showers; He drinks his hurried flight, and drops. The stir in memory seem these things, Which out of moisten’d turf and clay, Astrain for light push patient rings, Or leap to find the waterway. ’Tis equal to a wonder done, Whatever simple lives renew Their tricks beneath the father sun, As though they caught a broken clue: So hard was earth an eyewink back; But now the common life has come, The blotting cloud a dappled pack, The grasses one vast underhum. A City clothed in snow and soot, With lamps for day in ghostly rows, Breaks to the scene of hosts afoot, The river that reflective flows: And there did fog down crypts of street Play spectre upon eye and mouth:-- Their faces are a glass to greet This magic of the whirl for South. A burly joy each creature swells With sound of its own hungry quest; Earth has to fill her empty wells, And speed the service of the nest; The phantom of the snow-wreath melt, That haunts the farmer’s look abroad, Who sees what tomb a white night built, Where flocks now bleat and sprouts the clod. For iron Winter held her firm; Across her sky he laid his hand; And bird he starved, he stiffen’d worm; A sightless heaven, a shaven land. Her shivering Spring feign’d fast asleep. The bitten buds dared not unfold: We raced on roads and ice to keep Thought of the girl we love from cold.

But now the North wind ceases, The warm South-west awakes, The heavens are out in fleeces, And earth’s green banner shakes.

_775._ _Love’s Grave_

Mark where the pressing wind shoots javelin-like, Its skeleton shadow on the broad-back’d wave! Here is a fitting spot to dig Love’s grave; Here where the ponderous breakers plunge and strike, And dart their hissing tongues high up the sand: In hearing of the ocean, and in sight Of those ribb’d wind-streaks running into white. If I the death of Love had deeply plann’d, I never could have made it half so sure, As by the unblest kisses which upbraid The full-waked sense; or failing that, degrade! ’Tis morning: but no morning can restore What we have forfeited. I see no sin: The wrong is mix’d. In tragic life, God wot, No villain need be! Passions spin the plot: We are betray’d by what is false within.

_776._ _Lucifer in Starlight_

On a starr’d night Prince Lucifer uprose. Tired of his dark dominion swung the fiend Above the rolling ball in cloud part screen’d, Where sinners hugg’d their spectre of repose. Poor prey to his hot fit of pride were those. And now upon his western wing he lean’d, Now his huge bulk o’er Afric’s sands careen’d, Now the black planet shadow’d Arctic snows. Soaring through wider zones that prick’d his scars

With memory of the old revolt from Awe, He reach’d a middle height, and at the stars, Which are the brain of heaven, he look’d, and sank. Around the ancient track march’d, rank on rank, The army of unalterable law.

ALEXANDER SMITH

1829-1867

_777._ _Love_

The fierce exulting worlds, the motes in rays, The churlish thistles, scented briers, The wind-swept bluebells on the sunny braes, Down to the central fires,

Exist alike in Love. Love is a sea Filling all the abysses dim Of lornest space, in whose deeps regally Suns and their bright broods swim.

This mighty sea of Love, with wondrous tides, Is sternly just to sun and grain; ’Tis laving at this moment Saturn’s sides, ’Tis in my blood and brain.

All things have something more than barren use; There is a scent upon the brier, A tremulous splendour in the autumn dews, Cold morns are fringed with fire.

The clodded earth goes up in sweet-breath’d flowers; In music dies poor human speech, And into beauty blow those hearts of ours When Love is born in each.

Daisies are white upon the churchyard sod, Sweet tears the clouds lean down and give. The world is very lovely. O my God, I thank Thee that I live!

_778._ _Barbara_

On the Sabbath-day, Through the churchyard old and gray, Over the crisp and yellow leaves I held my rustling way; And amid the words of mercy, falling on my soul like balms, ’Mid the gorgeous storms of music--in the mellow organ-calms, ’Mid the upward-streaming prayers, and the rich and solemn psalms, I stood careless, Barbara.

My heart was otherwhere, While the organ shook the air, And the priest, with outspread hands, bless’d the people with a prayer; But when rising to go homeward, with a mild and saint-like shine Gleam’d a face of airy beauty with its heavenly eyes on mine-- Gleam’d and vanish’d in a moment--O that face was surely thine Out of heaven, Barbara!

O pallid, pallid face! O earnest eyes of grace! When last I saw thee, dearest, it was in another place. You came running forth to meet me with my love-gift on your wrist: The flutter of a long white dress, then all was lost in mist-- A purple stain of agony was on the mouth I kiss’d, That wild morning, Barbara.

I searched, in my despair, Sunny noon and midnight air; I could not drive away the thought that you were lingering there. O many and many a winter night I sat when you were gone, My worn face buried in my hands, beside the fire alone-- Within the dripping churchyard, the rain plashing on your stone, You were sleeping, Barbara.

’Mong angels, do you think Of the precious golden link I clasp’d around your happy arm while sitting by yon brink? Or when that night of gliding dance, of laughter and guitars, Was emptied of its music, and we watch’d, through lattice-bars, The silent midnight heaven creeping o’er us with its stars, Till the day broke, Barbara?

In the years I’ve changed; Wild and far my heart has ranged, And many sins and errors now have been on me avenged; But to you I have been faithful whatsoever good I lack’d: I loved you, and above my life still hangs that love intact-- Your love the trembling rainbow, I the reckless cataract. Still I love you, Barbara.

Yet, Love, I am unblest; With many doubts opprest, I wander like the desert wind without a place of rest. Could I but win you for an hour from off that starry shore, The hunger of my soul were still’d; for Death hath told you more Than the melancholy world doth know--things deeper than all lore You could teach me, Barbara.

In vain, in vain, in vain! You will never come again. There droops upon the dreary hills a mournful fringe of rain; The gloaming closes slowly round, loud winds are in the tree, Round selfish shores for ever moans the hurt and wounded sea; There is no rest upon the earth, peace is with Death and thee-- Barbara!

CHRISTINA GEORGINA ROSSETTI

1830-1894

_779._ _Bride Song_

FROM ‘THE PRINCE’S PROGRESS’

Too late for love, too late for joy, Too late, too late! You loiter’d on the road too long, You trifled at the gate: The enchanted dove upon her branch Died without a mate; The enchanted princess in her tower Slept, died, behind the grate; Her heart was starving all this while You made it wait.

Ten years ago, five years ago, One year ago, Even then you had arrived in time, Though somewhat slow; Then you had known her living face Which now you cannot know: The frozen fountain would have leap’d. The buds gone on to blow, The warm south wind would have awaked To melt the snow.

Is she fair now as she lies? Once she was fair; Meet queen for any kingly king, With gold-dust on her hair. Now there are poppies in her locks, White poppies she must wear; Must wear a veil to shroud her face And the want graven there: Or is the hunger fed at length, Cast off the care?

We never saw her with a smile Or with a frown; Her bed seem’d never soft to her, Though toss’d of down; She little heeded what she wore, Kirtle, or wreath, or gown; We think her white brows often ached Beneath her crown, Till silvery hairs show’d in her locks That used to be so brown.

We never heard her speak in haste: Her tones were sweet, And modulated just so much As it was meet: Her heart sat silent through the noise And concourse of the

street. There was no hurry in her hands, No hurry in her feet; There was no bliss drew nigh to her, That she might run to greet.

You should have wept her yesterday, Wasting upon her bed: But wherefore should you weep to-day That she is dead? Lo, we who love weep not to-day, But crown her royal head. Let be these poppies that we strew, Your roses are too red: Let be these poppies, not for you Cut down and spread.

_780._ _A Birthday_

My heart is like a singing bird Whose nest is in a water'd shoot; My heart is like an apple-tree Whose boughs are bent with thick-set fruit; My heart is like a rainbow shell That paddles in a halcyon sea; My heart is gladder than all these, Because my love is come to me.

Raise me a daïs of silk and down; Hang it with vair and purple dyes; Carve it in doves and pomegranates, And peacocks with a hundred eyes; Work it in gold and silver grapes, In leaves and silver fleurs-de-lys; Because the birthday of my life Is come, my love is come to me.

_781._ _Song_

When I am dead, my dearest, Sing no sad songs for me; Plant thou no roses at my head, Nor shady cypress tree: Be the green grass above me With showers and dewdrops wet; And if thou wilt, remember. And if thou wilt, forget.

I shall not see the shadows, I shall not feel the rain; I shall not hear the nightingale Sing on, as if in pain; And dreaming through the twilight That doth not rise nor set, Haply I may remember, And haply may forget.

_782._ _Twice_

I took my heart in my hand (O my love, O my love), I said: Let me fall or stand, Let me live or die, But this once hear me speak (O my love, O my love)-- Yet a woman's words are weak; You should speak, not I.

You took my heart in your hand With a friendly smile, With a critical eye you scann'd, Then set it down, And said, 'It is still unripe, Better wait awhile; Wait while the skylarks pipe, Till the corn grows brown.'

As you set it down it broke-- Broke, but I did not wince; I smiled at the speech you spoke, At your judgement I heard: But I have not often smiled Since then, nor question'd since, Nor cared for cornflowers wild, Nor sung with the singing bird.

I take my heart in my hand, O my God, O my God, My broken heart in my hand: Thou hast seen, judge Thou. My hope was written on sand, O my God, O my God: Now let thy judgement stand-- Yea, judge me now.

This contemn'd of a man, This marr'd one heedless day, This heart take thou to scan Both within and without: Refine with fire its gold, Purge Thou its dross away-- Yea, hold it in Thy hold, Whence none can pluck it out.

I take my heart in my hand-- I shall not die, but live-- Before Thy face I stand; I, for Thou callest such: All that I have I bring, All that I am I give, Smile Thou and I shall sing, But shall not question much.

_783._ _Uphill_

Does the road wind uphill all the way? Yes, to the very end. Will the day’s journey take the whole long day? From morn to night, my friend.

But is there for the night a resting-place? A roof for when the slow, dark hours begin. May not the darkness hide it from my face? You cannot miss that inn.

Shall I meet other wayfarers at night? Those who have gone before. Then must I knock, or call when just in sight? They will not keep you waiting at that door.

Shall I find comfort, travel-sore and weak? Of labour you shall find the sum. Will there be beds for me and all who seek? Yea, beds for all who come.

_784._ _Passing Away_

Passing away, saith the World, passing away: Chances, beauty and youth sapp’d day by day: Thy life never continueth in one stay. Is the eye waxen dim, is the dark hair changing to gray That hath won neither laurel nor bay? I shall clothe myself in Spring and bud in May: Thou, root-stricken, shalt not rebuild thy decay On my bosom for aye. Then I answer’d: Yea.

Passing away, saith my Soul, passing away: With its burden of fear and hope, of labour and play, Hearken what the past doth witness and say: Rust in thy gold, a moth is in thine array, A canker is in thy bud, thy leaf must decay. At midnight, at cockcrow, at morning, one certain day, Lo, the Bridegroom shall come and shall not delay: Watch thou and pray. Then I answer’d: Yea.

Passing away, saith my God, passing away: Winter passeth after the long delay: New grapes on the vine, new figs on the tender spray, Turtle calleth turtle in Heaven’s May. Though I tarry, wait for me, trust me, watch and pray. Arise, come away; night is past, and lo, it is day; My love, my sister, my spouse, thou shalt hear me say-- Then I answer’d: Yea.

_785._ _Marvel of Marvels_

Marvel of marvels, if I myself shall behold With mine own eyes my King in His city of gold; Where the least of lambs is spotless white in the fold, Where the least and last of saints in spotless white is stoled, Where the dimmest head beyond a moon is aureoled. O saints, my belovèd, now mouldering to mould in the mould, Shall I see you lift your heads, see your cerements unroll’d, See with these very eyes? who now in darkness and cold Tremble for the midnight cry, the rapture, the tale untold,-- _The Bridegroom cometh, cometh, His Bride to enfold!_

Cold it is, my belovèd, since your funeral bell was toll’d: Cold it is, O my King, how cold alone on the wold!

_786._ _Is it Well with the Child?_

Safe where I cannot die yet, Safe where I hope to lie too, Safe from the fume and the fret; You, and you, Whom I never forget. Safe from the frost and the snow, Safe from the storm and the sun, Safe where the seeds wait to grow One by one, And to come back in blow.

_787._ _Remember_

Remember me when I am gone away, Gone far away into the silent land; When you can no more hold me by the hand, Nor I half turn to go, yet turning stay. Remember me when no more day by day You tell me of our future that you plann'd: Only remember me; you understand It will be late to counsel then or pray. Yet if you should forget me for a while And afterwards remember, do not grieve: For if the darkness and corruption leave A vestige of the thoughts that once I had, Better by far you should forget and smile Than that you should remember and be sad.

_788._ _Aloof_

The irresponsive silence of the land, The irresponsive sounding of the sea, Speak both one message of one sense to me:-- Aloof, aloof, we stand aloof, so stand Thou too aloof, bound with the flawless band Of inner solitude; we bind not thee; But who from thy self-chain shall set thee free? What heart shall touch thy heart? What hand thy hand? And I am sometimes proud and sometimes meek, And sometimes I remember days of old When fellowship seem'd not so far to seek, And all the world and I seem'd much less cold, And at the rainbow's foot lay surely gold, And hope felt strong, and life itself not weak.

_789._ _Rest_

O Earth, lie heavily upon her eyes; Seal her sweet eyes weary of watching, Earth; Lie close around her; leave no room for mirth With its harsh laughter, nor for sound of sighs. She hath no questions, she hath no replies, Hush'd in and curtain'd with a blessèd dearth Of all that irk'd her from the hour of birth; With stillness that is almost Paradise. Darkness more clear than noonday holdeth her, Silence more musical than any song; Even her very heart has ceased to stir: Until the morning of Eternity Her rest shall not begin nor end, but be; And when she wakes she will not think it long.

THOMAS EDWARD BROWN

1830-1897

_790._ _Dora_

She knelt upon her brother's grave, My little girl of six years old-- He used to be so good and brave, The sweetest lamb of all our fold; He used to shout, he used to sing, Of all our tribe the little king-- And so unto the turf her ear she laid, To hark if still in that dark place he play'd. No sound! no sound! Death's silence was profound; And horror crept Into her aching heart, and Dora wept. If this is as it ought to be, My God, I leave it unto Thee.

_791._ _Jessie_

When Jessie comes with her soft breast, And yields the golden keys, Then is it as if God caress’d Twin babes upon His knees-- Twin babes that, each to other press’d, Just feel the Father’s arms, wherewith they both are bless’d.

But when I think if we must part, And all this personal dream be fled-- O then my heart! O then my useless heart! Would God that thou wert dead-- A clod insensible to joys and ills-- A stone remote in some bleak gully of the hills!

_792._ _Salve!_

To live within a cave--it is most good; But, if God make a day, And some one come, and say, ‘Lo! I have gather’d faggots in the wood!’ E’en let him stay, And light a fire, and fan a temporal mood!

So sit till morning! when the light is grown That he the path can read, Then bid the man God-speed! His morning is not thine: yet must thou own They have a cheerful warmth--those ashes on the stone.

_793_. _My Garden_

A garden is a lovesome thing, God wot! Rose plot, Fringed pool, Fern’d grot-- The veriest school Of peace; and yet the fool Contends that God is not-- Not God! in gardens! when the eve is cool? Nay, but I have a sign; ’Tis very sure God walks in mine.

EDWARD ROBERT BULWER LYTTON, EARL OF LYTTON

1831-1892

_794._ _A Night in Italy_

Sweet are the rosy memories of the lips That first kiss’d ours, albeit they kiss no more: Sweet is the sight of sunset-sailing ships, Altho’ they leave us on a lonely shore: Sweet are familiar songs, tho’ Music dips Her hollow shell in Thought’s forlornest wells: And sweet, tho’ sad, the sound of midnight bells When the oped casement with the night-rain drips.

There is a pleasure which is born of pain: The grave of all things hath its violet. Else why, thro’ days which never come again, Roams Hope with that strange longing, like Regret? Why put the posy in the cold dead hand? Why plant the rose above the lonely grave? Why bring the corpse across the salt sea-wave? Why deem the dead more near in native land?

Thy name hath been a silence in my life So long, it falters upon language now, O more to me than sister or than wife, Once … and now--nothing! It is hard to know That such things have been, and are not; and yet Life loiters, keeps a pulse at even measure, And goes upon its business and its pleasure, And knows not all the depths of its regret….

Ah, could the memory cast her spots, as do The snake’s brood theirs in spring! and be once more Wholly renew’d, to dwell i’ the time that’s new, With no reiterance of those pangs of yore. Peace, peace! My wild song will go wandering Too wantonly,

down paths a private pain Hath trodden bare. What was it jarr'd the strain? Some crush'd illusion, left with crumpled wing

Tangled in Music's web of twinèd strings-- That started that false note, and crack'd the tune In its beginning. Ah, forgotten things Stumble back strangely! and the ghost of June Stands by December's fire, cold, cold! and puts The last spark out.--How could I sing aright With those old airs haunting me all the night And those old steps that sound when daylight shuts?

For back she comes, and moves reproachfully, The mistress of my moods, and looks bereft (Cruel to the last!) as tho' 'twere I, not she, That did the wrong, and broke the spell, and left Memory comfortless.--Away! away! Phantoms, about whose brows the bindweed clings, Hopeless regret! In thinking of these things Some men have lost their minds, and others may.

Yet, O for one deep draught in this dull hour! One deep, deep draught of the departed time! O for one brief strong pulse of ancient power, To beat and breathe thro' all the valves of rhyme! Thou, Memory, with thy downward eyes, that art The cup-bearer of gods, pour deep and long, Brim all the vacant chalices of song With health! Droop down thine urn. I hold my heart One draught of what I shall not taste again Save when my brain with thy dark wine is brimm'd,-- One draught! and then straight onward, spite of pain, And spite of all things changed, with gaze undimm'd, Love's footsteps thro' the waning Past to explore Undaunted; and to carve in the wan light Of Hope's last outposts, on Song's utmost height, The sad resemblance of an hour or more.

Midnight, and love, and youth, and Italy! Love in the land where love most lovely seems! Land of my love, tho' I be far from thee, Lend, for love's sake, the light of thy moonbeams, The spirit of thy cypress-groves and all Thy dark-eyed beauty for a little while To my desire. Yet once more let her smile Fall o'er me: o'er me let her long hair fall....

Under the blessèd darkness unreproved We were alone, in that best hour of time Which first reveal'd to us how much we loved, 'Neath the thick starlight. The young night sublime Hung trembling o'er us. At her feet I knelt, And gazed up from her feet into her eyes. Her face was bow'd: we breathed each other's sighs: We did not speak: not move: we look'd: we felt.

The night said not a word. The breeze was dead. The leaf lay without whispering on the tree, As I lay at her feet. Droop'd was her head: One hand in mine: and one still pensively Went wandering through my hair. We were together. How? Where? What matter? Somewhere in a dream, Drifting, slow drifting down a wizard stream: Whither? Together: then what matter whither?

It was enough for me to clasp her hand: To blend with her love-looks my own: no more. Enough (with thoughts like ships that cannot land, Blown by faint winds about a magic shore) To realize, in each mysterious feeling, The droop of the warm cheek so near my own: The cool white arm about my shoulder thrown: Those exquisite fair feet where I was kneeling.

How little know they life’s divinest bliss, That know not to possess and yet refrain! Let the young Psyche roam, a fleeting kiss: Grasp it--a few poor grains of dust remain. See how those floating flowers, the butterflies, Hover the garden thro’, and take no root! Desire for ever hath a flying foot: Free pleasure comes and goes beneath the skies.

Close not thy hand upon the innocent joy That trusts itself within thy reach. It may, Or may not, linger. Thou canst but destroy The wingèd wanderer. Let it go or stay. Love thou the rose, yet leave it on its stem. Think! Midas starved by turning all to gold. Blessèd are those that spare, and that withhold; Because the whole world shall be trusted them.

The foolish Faun pursues the unwilling Nymph That culls her flowers beside the precipice Or dips her shining ankles in the lymph: But, just when she must perish or be his, Heaven puts an arm out. She is safe. The shore Gains some new fountain; or the lilied lawn A rarer sort of rose: but ah, poor Faun! To thee she shall be changed for evermore.

Chase not too close the fading rapture. Leave To Love his long auroras, slowly seen. Be ready to release as to receive. Deem those the nearest, soul to soul, between Whose lips yet lingers reverence on a sigh. Judge what thy sense can reach not, most thine own, If once thy soul hath seized it. The unknown Is life to love, religion, poetry.

The moon had set. There was not any light, Save of the lonely legion’d watch-stars pale In outer air, and what by fits made bright Hot oleanders in a rosy vale Searched by the lamping fly, whose little spark Went in and out, like passion’s bashful hope. Meanwhile the sleepy globe began to slope A ponderous shoulder sunward thro’ the dark.

And the night pass’d in beauty like a dream. Aloof in those dark heavens paused Destiny, With her last star descending in the gleam Of the cold morrow, from the emptied sky. The hour, the distance from her old self, all The novelty and loneness of the place Had left a lovely awe on that fair face, And all the land grew strange and magical.

As droops some billowy cloud to the crouch’d hill, Heavy with all heaven’s tears, for all earth’s care, She droop’d unto me, without force or will, And sank upon my bosom, murmuring there A woman’s inarticulate passionate words. O moment of all moments upon earth! O life’s supreme! How worth, how wildly worth, Whole worlds of flame, to know this world affords.

What even Eternity can not restore! When all the ends of life take hands and meet Round centres of sweet fire. Ah, never more, Ah never, shall the bitter with the sweet Be mingled so in the pale after-years! One hour of life immortal spirits possess. This drains the world, and leaves but weariness, And parching passion, and perplexing tears.

Sad is it, that we cannot even keep That hour to sweeten life’s last toil: but Youth Grasps all, and leaves us: and when we would weep, We dare not let our tears fall, lest, in truth, They fall upon our work which must be done. And so we bind up our

torn hearts from breaking: Our eyes from weeping, and our brows from aching: And follow the long pathway all alone.

_795._ _The Last Wish_

Since all that I can ever do for thee Is to do nothing, this my prayer must be: That thou mayst never guess nor ever see The all-endured this nothing-done costs me.

JAMES THOMSON

1834-1882

_796._ _In the Train_

As we rush, as we rush in the Train, The trees and the houses go wheeling back, But the starry heavens above the plain Come flying on our track.

All the beautiful stars of the sky, The silver doves of the forest of Night, Over the dull earth swarm and fly, Companions of our flight.

We will rush ever on without fear; Let the goal be far, the flight be fleet! For we carry the Heavens with us, dear, While the Earth slips from our feet!

_797._ _Sunday up the River_

My love o’er the water bends dreaming; It glideth and glideth away: She sees there her own beauty, gleaming Through shadow and ripple and spray.

O tell her, thou murmuring river, As past her your light wavelets roll, How steadfast that image for ever Shines pure in pure depths of my soul.

_798._ _Gifts_

Give a man a horse he can ride, Give a man a boat he can sail; And his rank and wealth, his strength and health, On sea nor shore shall fail.

Give a man a pipe he can smoke, Give a man a book he can read: And his home is bright with a calm delight, Though the room be poor indeed.

Give a man a girl he can love, As I, O my love, love thee; And his heart is great with the pulse of Fate, At home, on land, on sea.

_799._ _The Vine_

The wine of Love is music, And the feast of Love is song: And when Love sits down to the banquet, Love sits long:

Sits long and arises drunken, But not with the feast and the wine; He reeleth with his own heart, That great, rich Vine.

WILLIAM MORRIS

1834-1896

_800._ _Summer Dawn_

Pray but one prayer for me ’twixt thy closed lips, Think but one thought of me up in the stars. The summer night waneth, the morning light slips Faint and gray ’twixt the leaves of the aspen, betwixt the cloud-bars, That are patiently waiting there for the dawn: Patient and colourless, though Heaven’s gold Waits to float through them along with the sun. Far out in the meadows, above the young corn, The heavy elms wait, and restless and cold The uneasy wind rises; the roses are dun; Through the long twilight they pray for the dawn Round the lone house in the midst of the corn. Speak but one word to me over the corn, Over the tender, bow’d locks of the corn.

_801._ _Love is enough_

Love is enough: though the World be a-waning, And the woods have no voice but the voice of complaining, Though the sky be too dark for dim eyes to discover The gold-cups and daisies fair blooming thereunder, Though the hills be held shadows, and the sea a dark wonder, And this day draw a veil over all deeds pass’d over, Yet their hands shall not tremble, their feet shall not falter; The void shall not weary, the fear shall not alter These lips and these eyes of the loved and the lover.

_802._ _The Nymph’s Song to Hylas_

I know a little garden-close Set thick with lily and red rose, Where I would wander if I might From dewy dawn to dewy night, And have one with me wandering.

And though within it no birds sing, And though no pillar’d house is there, And though the apple boughs are bare Of fruit and blossom, would to God, Her feet upon the green grass trod, And I beheld them as before!

There comes a murmur from the shore, And in the place two fair streams are, Drawn from the purple hills afar, Drawn down unto the restless sea; The hills whose flowers ne’er fed the bee, The shore no ship has ever seen, Still beaten by the billows green, Whose murmur comes unceasingly Unto the place for which I cry.

For which I cry both day and night, For which I let slip all delight, That maketh me both deaf and blind, Careless to win, unskill’d to find, And quick to lose what all men seek.

Yet tottering as I am, and weak, Still have I left a little breath To seek within the jaws of death An entrance to that happy place; To seek the unforgotten face Once seen, once kiss’d, once reft from me Anigh the murmuring of the sea.

RODEN BERKELEY WRIOTHESLEY NOEL

1834-1894

_803._ _The Water-Nymph and the Boy_

I flung me round him, I drew him under; I clung, I drown’d him, My own white wonder!...

Father and mother, Weeping and wild, Came to the forest, Calling the child, Came from the palace, Down to the pool, Calling my darling, My beautiful! Under the water, Cold and so pale! Could it be love made Beauty to fail?

Ah me for mortals! In a few moons, If I had left him, After some Junes He would have faded, Faded away, He, the young monarch, whom All would obey, Fairer than day; Alien to springtime, Joyless and gray, He would have faded, Faded away, Moving a mockery, Scorn’d of the day! Now I have taken him All in his prime, Saved from slow poisoning Pitiless Time, Fill’d with his happiness, One with the prime, Saved from the cruel Dishonour of Time. Laid him, my beautiful, Laid him to rest, Loving, adorable, Softly to rest, Here in my crystalline, Here in my breast!

_804._ _The Old_

They are waiting on the shore For the bark to take them home: They will toil and grieve no more; The hour for release hath come.

All their long life lies behind Like a dimly blending dream: There is nothing left to bind To the realms that only seem.

They are waiting for the boat; There is nothing left to do: What was near them grows remote, Happy silence falls like dew; Now the shadowy bark is come, And the weary may go home.

By still water they would rest In the shadow of the tree: After battle sleep is best, After noise, tranquillity.

THOMAS ASHE

1836-1889

_805._ _Meet We no Angels, Pansie?_

Came, on a Sabbath noon, my sweet, In white, to find her lover; The grass grew proud beneath her feet, The green elm-leaves above her:-- Meet we no angels, Pansie?

She said, ‘We meet no angels now’; And soft lights stream’d upon her; And with white hand she touch’d a bough; She did it that great honour:-- What! meet no angels, Pansie?

O sweet brown hat, brown hair, brown eyes, Down-dropp’d brown eyes, so tender! Then what said I? Gallant replies Seem flattery, and offend her:-- But--meet no angels, Pansie?

_806._ _To Two Bereaved_

You must be sad; for though it is to Heaven, ’Tis hard to yield a little girl of seven. Alas, for me ’tis hard my grief to rule, Who only met her as she went to school; Who never heard the little lips so sweet Say even ‘Good-morning,’ though our eyes would meet As whose would fain be friends! How must you sigh, Sick for your loss, when even so sad am I, Who never clasp’d the small hands any day! Fair flowers thrive round the little grave, I pray.

THEODORE WATTS-DUNTON

1836-1914

_807._ _Wassail Chorus at the Mermaid Tavern_

Christmas knows a merry, merry place, Where he goes with fondest face, Brightest eye, brightest hair: Tell the Mermaid where is that one place, Where?

Raleigh.

'Tis by Devon's glorious halls, Whence, dear Ben, I come again: Bright of golden roofs and walls-- El Dorado's rare domain-- Seem those halls when sunlight launches Shafts of gold thro' leafless branches, Where the winter's feathery mantle blanches Field and farm and lane.

CHORUS. Christmas knows a merry, merry place, &c.

Drayton.

'Tis where Avon's wood-sprites weave Through the boughs a lace of rime, While the bells of Christmas Eve Fling for Will the Stratford-chime O'er the river-flags emboss'd Rich with flowery runes of frost-- O'er the meads where snowy tufts are toss'd-- Strains of olden time.

CHORUS. Christmas knows a merry, merry place, &c.

Shakespeare's Friend.

'Tis, methinks, on any ground Where our Shakespeare's feet are set. There smiles Christmas, holly-crown'd With his blithest coronet: Friendship's face he loveth well: 'Tis a countenance whose spell Sheds a balm o'er every mead and dell Where we used to fret.

CHORUS. Christmas knows a merry, merry place, &c.

Heywood.

More than all the pictures, Ben, Winter weaves by wood or stream, Christmas loves our London, when Rise thy clouds of wassail-steam-- Clouds like these, that, curling, take Forms of faces gone, and wake Many a lay from lips we loved, and make London like a dream.

CHORUS. Christmas knows a merry, merry place, &c.

Ben Jonson.

Love's old songs shall never die, Yet the new shall suffer proof: Love's old drink of Yule brew I Wassail for new love's behoof. Drink the drink I brew, and sing Till the berried branches swing, Till our song make all the Mermaid ring-- Yea, from rush to roof.

FINALE.

Christmas loves this merry, merry place; Christmas saith with fondest face, Brightest eye, brightest hair: 'Ben, the drink tastes rare of sack and mace; Rare!'

ALGERNON CHARLES SWINBURNE

1837-1909

_808._ _Chorus from ‘Atalanta’_

When the hounds of spring are on winter’s traces, The mother of months in meadow or plain Fills the shadows and windy places With lisp of leaves and ripple of rain; And the brown bright nightingale amorous Is half assuaged for Itylus, For the Thracian ships and the foreign faces. The tongueless vigil, and all the pain.

Come with bows bent and with emptying of quivers, Maiden most perfect, lady of light, With a noise of winds and many rivers, With a clamour of waters, and with might; Bind on thy sandals, O thou most fleet, Over the splendour and speed of thy feet; For the faint east quickens, the wan west shivers, Round the feet of the day and the feet of the night.

Where shall we find her, how shall we sing to her, Fold our hands round her knees, and cling? O that man’s heart were as fire and could spring to her, Fire, or the strength of the streams that spring! For the stars and the winds are unto her As raiment, as songs of the harp-player; For the risen stars and the fallen cling to her, And the southwest-wind and the west-wind sing.

For winter’s rains and ruins are over, And all the season of snows and sins; The days dividing lover and lover, The light that loses, the night that wins; And time remember’d is grief forgotten, And frosts are slain and flowers begotten, And in green underwood and cover Blossom by blossom the spring begins.

The full streams feed on flower of rushes, Ripe grasses trammel a travelling foot, The faint fresh flame of the young year flushes From leaf to flower and flower to fruit; And fruit and leaf are as gold and fire, And the oat is heard above the lyre, And the hoofèd heel of a satyr crushes The chestnut-husk at the chestnut-root.

And Pan by noon and Bacchus by night, Fleeter of foot than the fleet-foot kid, Follows with dancing and fills with delight The Mænad and the Bassarid; And soft as lips that laugh and hide The laughing leaves of the trees divide, And screen from seeing and leave in sight The god pursuing, the maiden hid.

The ivy falls with the Bacchanal’s hair Over her eyebrows hiding her eyes; The wild vine slipping down leaves bare Her bright breast shortening into sighs; The wild vine slips with the weight of its leaves, But the berried ivy catches and cleaves To the limbs that glitter, the feet that scare The wolf that follows, the fawn that flies.

_809._ _Hertha_

I am that which began; Out of me the years roll; Out of me God and man; I am equal and whole; God changes, and man, and the form of them bodily; I am the soul.

Before ever land was, Before ever the sea, Or soft hair of the grass, Or fair limbs of the tree, Or the flesh-colour’d fruit of my branches, I was, and thy soul was in me.

First life on my sources First drifted and swam; Out of me are the forces That save it or damn; Out of me man and woman, and wild-beast and bird: before God was, I am.

Beside or above me Naught is there to go; Love or unlove me, Unknow me or know, I am that which unloves me and loves; I am stricken, and I am the blow.

I the mark that is miss'd And the arrows that miss, I the mouth that is kiss'd And the breath in the kiss, The search, and the sought, and the seeker, the soul and the body that is.

I am that thing which blesses My spirit elate; That which caresses With hands uncreate My limbs unbegotten that measure the length of the measure of fate.

But what thing dost thou now, Looking Godward, to cry, 'I am I, thou art thou, I am low, thou art high'? I am thou, whom thou seekest to find him; find thou but thyself, thou art I.

I the grain and the furrow, The plough-cloven clod And the ploughshare drawn thorough, The germ and the sod, The deed and the doer, the seed and the sower, the dust which is God.

Hast thou known how I fashion'd thee, Child, underground? Fire that impassion'd thee, Iron that bound, Dim changes of water, what thing of all these hast thou known of or found?

Canst thou say in thine heart Thou hast seen with thine eyes With what cunning of art Thou wast wrought in what wise, By what force of what stuff thou wast shapen, and shown on my breast to the skies?

Who hath given, who hath sold it thee, Knowledge of me? Has the wilderness told it thee? Hast thou learnt of the sea? Hast thou communed in spirit with night? have the winds taken counsel with thee?

Have I set such a star To show light on thy brow That thou sawest from afar What I show to thee now? Have ye spoken as brethren together, the sun and the mountains and thou?

What is here, dost thou know it? What was, hast thou known? Prophet nor poet Nor tripod nor throne Nor spirit nor flesh can make answer, but only thy mother alone.

Mother, not maker, Born, and not made; Though her children forsake her, Allured or afraid, Praying prayers to the God of their fashion, she stirs not for all that have pray'd.

A creed is a rod, And a crown is of night; But this thing is God, To be man with thy might, To grow straight in the strength of thy spirit, and live out thy life as the light.

I am in thee to save thee, As my soul in thee saith; Give thou as I gave thee, Thy life-blood and breath, Green leaves of thy labour, white flowers of thy thought, and red fruit of thy death.

Be the ways of thy giving As mine were to thee; The free life of thy living, Be the gift of it free; Not as servant to lord, nor as master to slave, shalt thou give thee to me.

O children of banishment, Souls overcast, Were the lights ye see vanish meant Alway to last, Ye would know not the sun overshining the shadows and stars overpast.

I that saw where ye trod The dim paths of the night Set the shadow call’d God In your skies to give light; But the morning of manhood is risen, and the shadowless soul is in sight.

The tree many-rooted That swells to the sky With frondage red-fruited, The life-tree am I; In the buds of your lives is the sap of my leaves: ye shall live and not die.

But the Gods of your fashion That take and that give, In their pity and passion That scourge and forgive, They are worms that are bred in the bark that falls off; they shall die and not live.

My own blood is what stanches The wounds in my bark; Stars caught in my branches Make day of the dark, And are worshipp’d as suns till the sunrise shall tread out their fires as a spark.

Where dead ages hide under The live roots of the tree, In my darkness the thunder Makes utterance of me; In the clash of my boughs with each other ye hear the waves sound of the sea.

That noise is of Time, As his feathers are spread And his feet set to climb Through the boughs overhead, And my foliage rings round him and rustles, and branches are bent with his tread.

The storm-winds of ages Blow through me and cease, The war-wind that rages, The spring-wind of peace, Ere the breath of them roughen my tresses, ere one of my blossoms increase.

All sounds of all changes, All shadows and lights On the world’s mountain-ranges And stream-riven heights, Whose tongue is the wind’s tongue and language of storm-clouds on earth-shaking nights;

All forms of all faces, All works of all hands In unsearchable places Of time-stricken lands, All death and all life, and all reigns and all ruins, drop through me as sands.

Though sore be my burden And more than ye know, And my growth have no guerdon But only to grow, Yet I fail not of growing for lightnings above me or deathworms below.

These too have their part in me, As I too in these; Such fire is at heart in me, Such sap is this tree’s, Which hath in it all sounds and all secrets of infinite lands and of seas.

In the spring-colour’d hours When my mind was as May’s There brake forth of me flowers By centuries of days, Strong blossoms with perfume of manhood, shot out from my spirit as rays.

And the sound of them springing And smell of their shoots Were as warmth and sweet singing And strength to my roots; And the lives of my children made perfect with freedom of soul were my fruits.

I bid you but be; I have need not of prayer; I have need of you free As your mouths of mine air; That my heart may be greater within me, beholding the fruits of me fair.

More fair than strange fruit is Of faiths ye espouse; In me only the root is That blooms in your boughs; Behold now your God that ye made you, to feed him with faith of your vows.

In the darkening and whitening Abysses adored, With dayspring and lightning For lamp and for sword, God thunders in heaven, and his angels are red with the wrath of the Lord.

O my sons, O too dutiful Toward Gods not of me, Was not I enough beautiful? Was it hard to be free? For behold, I am with you, am in you and of you; look forth now and see.

Lo, wing'd with world's wonders, With miracles shod, With the fires of his thunders For raiment and rod, God trembles in heaven, and his angels are white with the terror of God.

For his twilight is come on him, His anguish is here; And his spirits gaze dumb on him, Grown gray from his fear; And his hour taketh hold on him stricken, the last of his infinite year. Thought made him and breaks him, Truth slays and forgives; But to you, as time takes him, This new thing it gives, Even love, the belovèd Republic, that feeds upon freedom and lives.

For truth only is living, Truth only is whole, And the love of his giving Man's polestar and pole; Man, pulse of my centre, and fruit of my body, and seed of my soul.

One birth of my bosom; One beam of mine eye; One topmost blossom That scales the sky; Man, equal and one with me, man that is made of me, man that is I.

_810._ _Ave atque Vale_

(IN MEMORY OF CHARLES BAUDELAIRE)

Shall I strew on thee rose or rue or laurel, Brother, on this that was the veil of thee? Or quiet sea-flower moulded by the sea, Or simplest growth of meadow-sweet or sorrel, Such as the summer-sleepy Dryads weave, Waked up by snow-soft sudden rains at eve? Or wilt thou rather, as on earth before, Half-faded fiery blossoms, pale with heat And full of bitter summer, but more sweet To thee than gleanings of a northern shore Trod by no tropic feet?

For always thee the fervid languid glories Allured of heavier suns in mightier skies; Thine ears knew all the wandering watery sighs Where the sea sobs round Lesbian promontories, The barren kiss of piteous wave to wave That knows not where is that Leucadian grave Which hides too deep the supreme head of song. Ah, salt and sterile as her kisses were, The wild sea winds her and the green gulfs bear Hither and

thither, and vex and work her wrong, Blind gods that cannot spare.

Thou sawest, in thine old singing season, brother, Secrets and sorrows unbeheld of us: Fierce loves, and lovely leaf-buds poisonous, Bare to thy subtler eye, but for none other Blowing by night in some unbreathed-in clime; The hidden harvest of luxurious time, Sin without shape, and pleasure without speech; And where strange dreams in a tumultuous sleep Make the shut eyes of stricken spirits weep; And with each face thou sawest the shadow on each, Seeing as men sow men reap.

O sleepless heart and sombre soul unsleeping, That were athirst for sleep and no more life And no more love, for peace and no more strife! Now the dim gods of death have in their keeping Spirit and body and all the springs of song, Is it well now where love can do no wrong, Where stingless pleasure has no foam or fang Behind the unopening closure of her lips? Is it not well where soul from body slips And flesh from bone divides without a pang As dew from flower-bell drips?

It is enough; the end and the beginning Are one thing to thee, who art past the end. O hand unclasp'd of unbeholden friend, For thee no fruits to pluck, no palms for winning, No triumph and no labour and no lust, Only dead yew-leaves and a little dust. O quiet eyes wherein the light saith naught, Whereto the day is dumb, nor any night With obscure finger silences your sight, Nor in your speech the sudden soul speaks thought, Sleep, and have sleep for light.

Now all strange hours and all strange loves are over, Dreams and desires and sombre songs and sweet, Hast thou found place at the great knees and feet Of some pale Titan-woman like a lover, Such as thy vision here solicited, Under the shadow of her fair vast head, The deep division of prodigious breasts, The solemn slope of mighty limbs asleep, The weight of awful tresses that still keep The savour and shade of old-world pine-forests Where the wet hill-winds weep?

Hast thou found any likeness for thy vision? O gardener of strange flowers, what bud, what bloom, Hast thou found sown, what gather'd in the gloom? What of despair, of rapture, of derision, What of life is there, what of ill or good? Are the fruits gray like dust or bright like blood? Does the dim ground grow any seed of ours, The faint fields quicken any terrene root, In low lands where the sun and moon are mute And all the stars keep silence? Are there flowers At all, or any fruit?

Alas, but though my flying song flies after, O sweet strange elder singer, thy more fleet Singing, and footprints of thy fleeter feet, Some dim derision of mysterious laughter From the blind tongueless warders of the dead, Some gainless glimpse of Proserpine's veil'd head, Some little sound of unregarded tears Wept by effaced unprofitable eyes, And from pale mouths some cadence of dead sighs-- These only, these the hearkening spirit hears, Sees only such things rise.

Thou art far too far for wings of words to follow, Far too far off for thought or any prayer. What ails us with thee, who art wind and air? What ails us gazing where all seen is hollow? Yet with some fancy, yet with some desire, Dreams pursue death as winds a flying fire, Our dreams pursue our dead and do not find. Still, and more swift than they, the thin flame flies, The low light fails us in elusive skies, Still the foil'd earnest ear is deaf, and blind Are still the eluded eyes.

Not thee, O never thee, in all time’s changes, Not thee, but this the sound of thy sad soul, The shadow of thy swift spirit, this shut scroll I lay my hand on, and not death estranges My spirit from communion of thy song-- These memories and these melodies that throng Veil’d porches of a Muse funereal-- These I salute, these touch, these clasp and fold As though a hand were in my hand to hold, Or through mine ears a mourning musical Of many mourners roll’d.

I among these, I also, in such station As when the pyre was charr’d, and piled the sods. And offering to the dead made, and their gods, The old mourners had, standing to make libation, I stand, and to the Gods and to the dead Do reverence without prayer or praise, and shed Offering to these unknown, the gods of gloom, And what of honey and spice my seed-lands bear, And what I may of fruits in this chill’d air, And lay, Orestes-like, across the tomb A curl of sever’d hair.

But by no hand nor any treason stricken, Not like the low-lying head of Him, the King, The flame that made of Troy a ruinous thing, Thou liest and on this dust no tears could quicken. There fall no tears like theirs that all men hear Fall tear by sweet imperishable tear Down the opening leaves of holy poets’ pages. Thee not Orestes, not Electra mourns; But bending us-ward with memorial urns The most high Muses that fulfil all ages Weep, and our God’s heart yearns.

For, sparing of his sacred strength, not often Among us darkling here the lord of light Makes manifest his music and his might In hearts that open and in lips that soften With the soft flame and heat of songs that shine. Thy lips indeed he touch’d with bitter wine, And nourish’d them indeed with bitter bread; Yet surely from his hand thy soul’s food came, The fire that scarr’d thy spirit at his flame Was lighted, and thine hungering heart he fed Who feeds our hearts with fame.

Therefore he too now at thy soul’s sunsetting, God of all suns and songs, he too bends down To mix his laurel with thy cypress crown, And save thy dust from blame and from forgetting. Therefore he too, seeing all thou wert and art, Compassionate, with sad and sacred heart, Mourns thee of many his children the last dead, And hallows with strange tears and alien sighs Thine unmelodious mouth and sunless eyes, And over thine irrevocable head Sheds light from the under skies.

And one weeps with him in the ways Lethean, And stains with tears her changing bosom chill; That obscure Venus of the hollow hill, That thing transformed which was the Cytherean, With lips that lost their Grecian laugh divine Long since, and face no more call’d Erycine-- A ghost, a bitter and luxurious god. Thee also with fair flesh and singing spell Did she, a sad and second prey, compel Into the footless places once more trod, And shadows hot from hell.

And now no sacred staff shall break in blossom, No choral salutation lure to light A spirit sick with perfume and sweet night And love’s tired eyes and hands and barren bosom. There is no help for these things; none to mend, And none to mar; not all our songs, O friend, Will make death clear or make life durable. Howbeit with rose and ivy and wild vine And with wild notes about this dust of thine At least I fill the place where white dreams dwell And wreathe an unseen shrine.

Sleep; and if life was bitter to thee, pardon, If sweet, give thanks; thou hast no more to live; And to give thanks is good, and to forgive. Out of the mystic and the mournful garden Where all day through thine hands in barren braid Wove the sick flowers of secrecy and shade, Green buds of sorrow and sin, and remnants gray, Sweet-smelling, pale with poison, sanguine-hearted, Passions that sprang from sleep and thoughts that started, Shall death not bring us all as thee one day Among the days departed?

For thee, O now a silent soul, my brother, Take at my hands this garland, and farewell. Thin is the leaf, and chill the wintry smell, And chill the solemn earth, a fatal mother, With sadder than the Niobean womb, And in the hollow of her breasts a tomb. Content thee, howsoe'er, whose days are done; There lies not any troublous thing before, Nor sight nor sound to war against thee more, For whom all winds are quiet as the sun, All waters as the shore.

_811._ _Itylus_

Swallow, my sister, O sister swallow, How can thine heart be full of the spring? A thousand summers are over and dead. What hast thou found in the spring to follow? What hast thou found in thine heart to sing? What wilt thou do when the summer is shed?

O swallow, sister, O fair swift swallow, Why wilt thou fly after spring to the south, The soft south whither thine heart is set? Shall not the grief of the old time follow? Shall not the song thereof cleave to thy mouth? Hast thou forgotten ere I forget?

Sister, my sister, O fleet sweet swallow, Thy way is long to the sun and the south; But I, fulfill'd of my heart's desire, Shedding my song upon height, upon hollow, From tawny body and sweet small mouth Feed the heart of the night with fire.

I the nightingale all spring through, O swallow, sister, O changing swallow, All spring through till the spring be done, Clothed with the light of the night on the dew, Sing, while the hours and the wild birds follow, Take flight and follow and find the sun.

Sister, my sister, O soft light swallow, Though all things feast in the spring's guest-chamber, How hast thou heart to be glad thereof yet? For where thou fliest I shall not follow, Till life forget and death remember, Till thou remember and I forget.

Swallow, my sister, O singing swallow, I know not how thou hast heart to sing. Hast thou the heart? is it all past over? Thy lord the summer is good to follow, And fair the feet of thy lover the spring: But what wilt thou say to the spring thy lover?

O swallow, sister, O fleeting swallow, My heart in me is a molten ember And over my head the waves have met. But thou wouldst tarry or I would follow Could I forget or thou remember, Couldst thou remember and I forget.

O sweet stray sister, O shifting swallow, The heart's division divideth us. Thy heart is light as a leaf of a tree; But mine goes forth among sea-gulfs hollow To the place of the slaying of Itylus, The feast of Daulis, the Thracian sea.

O swallow, sister, O rapid swallow, I pray thee sing not a little space.

Are not the roofs and the lintels wet? The woven web that was plain to follow, The small slain body, the flower-like face, Can I remember if thou forget?

O sister, sister, thy first-begotten! The hands that cling and the feet that follow, The voice of the child’s blood crying yet, _Who hath remember’d me? who hath forgotten?_ Thou hast forgotten, O summer swallow, But the world shall end when I forget.

WILLIAM DEAN HOWELLS

b. 1837

_812._ _Earliest Spring_

Tossing his mane of snows in wildest eddies and tangles, Lion-like March cometh in, hoarse, with tempestuous breath, Through all the moaning chimneys, and ’thwart all the hollows and angles Round the shuddering house, threating of winter and death.

But in my heart I feel the life of the wood and the meadow Thrilling the pulses that own kindred with fibres that lift Bud and blade to the sunward, within the inscrutable shadow, Deep in the oak’s chill core, under the gathering drift.

Nay, to earth’s life in mine some prescience, or dream, or desire (How shall I name it aright?) comes for a moment and goes-- Rapture of life ineffable, perfect--as if in the brier, Leafless there by my door, trembled a sense of the rose.

BRET HARTE

1839-1902

_813._ _What the Bullet sang_

O joy of creation, To be! O rapture, to fly And be free! Be the battle lost or won, Though its smoke shall hide the sun, I shall find my love--the one Born for me!

I shall know him where he stands All alone, With the power in his hands Not o’erthrown; I shall know him by his face, By his godlike front and grace; I shall hold him for a space All my own!

It is he--O my love! So bold! It is I--all thy love Foretold! It is I--O love, what bliss! Dost thou answer to my kiss? O sweetheart! what is this Lieth there so cold?

JOHN TODHUNTER

1839-1916

_814._ _Maureen_

O you plant the pain in my heart with your wistful eyes, Girl of my choice, Maureen! Will you drive me mad for the kisses your shy, sweet mouth denies, Maureen?

Like a walking ghost I am, and no words to woo, White rose of the West, Maureen: For it’s pale you are, and the fear that’s on you is over me too, Maureen!

Sure it’s one complaint that’s on us, asthore, this day, Bride of my dreams, Maureen: The smart of the bee that stung us his honey must cure, they say, Maureen!

I’ll coax the light to your eyes, and the rose to your face, Mavourneen, my own Maureen! When I feel the warmth of your breast, and your nest is my arm’s embrace, Maureen!

O where was the King o’ the World that day--only me? My one true love, Maureen! And you the Queen with me there, and your throne in my heart, machree, Maureen!

_815._ _Aghadoe_

There’s a glade in Aghadoe, Aghadoe, Aghadoe, There’s a green and silent glade in Aghadoe, Where we met, my love and I, Love’s fair planet in the sky, O’er that sweet and silent glade in Aghadoe.

There’s a glen in Aghadoe, Aghadoe, Aghadoe, There’s a deep and secret glen in Aghadoe, Where I hid from the eyes of the red-coats and their spies, That year the trouble came to Aghadoe.

O, my curse on one black heart in Aghadoe, Aghadoe, On Shaun Dhu, my mother’s son in Aghadoe! When your throat fries in hell’s drouth, salt the flame be in your mouth, For the treachery you did in Aghadoe!

For they track’d me to that glen in Aghadoe, Aghadoe, When the price was on his head in Aghadoe: O’er the mountain, through the wood, as I stole to him with food, Where in hiding lone he lay in Aghadoe.

But they never took him living in Aghadoe, Aghadoe; With the bullets in his heart in Aghadoe, There he lay, the head, my breast keeps the warmth of where ’twould rest, Gone, to win the traitor’s gold, from Aghadoe!

I walk’d to Mallow town from Aghadoe, Aghadoe, Brought his head from the gaol’s gate to Aghadoe; Then I cover’d him with fern, and I piled on him the cairn, Like an Irish King he sleeps in Aghadoe.

O, to creep into that cairn in Aghadoe, Aghadoe! There to rest upon his breast in Aghadoe! Sure your dog for you could die with no truer heart than I, Your own love, cold on your cairn in Aghadoe.

WILFRID SCAWEN BLUNT

b. 1840

_816._ _Song_

O fly not, Pleasure, pleasant-hearted Pleasure; Fold me thy wings, I prithee, yet and stay: For my heart no measure Knows, nor other treasure To buy a garland for my love to-day.

And thou, too, Sorrow, tender-hearted Sorrow, Thou gray-eyed mourner, fly not yet away: For I fain would borrow Thy sad weeds to-morrow, To make a mourning for love’s yesterday.

The voice of Pity, Time’s divine dear Pity, Moved me to tears: I dared not say them nay, But passed forth from the city, Making thus my ditty Of fair love lost for ever and a day.

_817._ _The Desolate City_

Dark to me is the earth. Dark to me are the heavens. Where is she that I loved, the woman with eyes like stars? Desolate are the streets. Desolate is the city. A city taken by storm, where none are left but the slain.

Sadly I rose at dawn, undid the latch of my shutters, Thinking to let in light, but I only let in love. Birds in the boughs were awake; I listen’d to their chaunting; Each one sang to his love; only I was alone.

This, I said in my heart, is the hour of life and of pleasure. Now each creature on earth has his joy, and lives in the sun, Each in another’s eyes finds light, the light of compassion, This is the moment of pity, this is the moment of love.

Speak, O desolate city! Speak, O silence in sadness! Where is she that I loved in my strength, that spoke to my soul? Where are those passionate eyes that appeal’d to my eyes in passion? Where is the mouth that kiss’d me, the breast I laid to my own?

Speak, thou soul of my soul, for rage in my heart is kindled. Tell me, where didst thou flee in the day of destruction and fear? See, my arms still enfold thee, enfolding thus all heaven, See, my desire is fulfill’d in thee, for it fills the earth.

Thus in my grief I lamented. Then turn’d I from the window, Turn’d to the stair, and the open door, and the empty street, Crying aloud in my grief, for there was none to chide me, None to mock my weakness, none to behold my tears.

Groping I went, as blind. I sought her house, my belovèd’s. There I stopp’d at the silent door, and listen’d and tried the latch. Love, I cried, dost thou slumber? This is no hour for slumber, This is the hour of love, and love I bring in my hand.

I knew the house, with its windows barr’d, and its leafless fig-tree, Climbing round by the doorstep, the only one in the street; I knew where my hope had climb’d to its goal and there encircled All that those desolate walls once held, my belovèd’s heart.

There in my grief she consoled me. She loved me when I loved not. She put her hand in my hand, and set her lips to my lips. She told me all her pain and show’d me all her trouble. I, like a fool, scarce heard, hardly return’d her kiss.

Love, thy eyes were like torches. They changed as I beheld them. Love, thy lips were like gems, the seal thou settest on my life. Love, if I loved not then, behold this hour thy vengeance; This is the fruit of thy love and thee, the unwise grown wise.

Weeping strangled my voice. I call’d out, but none answer’d; Blindly the windows gazed back at me, dumbly the door; She whom I love, who loved me, look’d not on my yearning, Gave me no more her hands to kiss, show’d me no more her soul.

Therefore the earth is dark to me, the sunlight blackness, Therefore I go in tears and alone, by night and day; Therefore I find no love in heaven, no light, no beauty, A heaven taken by storm, where none are left but the slain!

_818._ _With Esther_

He who has once been happy is for aye Out of destruction’s reach. His fortune then Holds nothing secret; and Eternity, Which is a mystery to other men, Has like a woman given him its joy. Time is his conquest. Life, if it should fret, Has paid him tribute. He can bear to die, He who has once been happy! When I set The world before me and survey its range, Its mean ambitions, its scant fantasies, The shreds of pleasure which for lack of change Men wrap around them and call happiness, The poor delights which are the tale and sum Of the world’s courage in its martyrdom;

When I hear laughter from a tavern door, When I see crowds agape and in the rain Watching on tiptoe and with stifled roar To see a rocket fired or a bull slain, When misers handle gold, when orators Touch strong men’s hearts with glory till they weep, When cities deck their streets for barren wars Which have laid waste their youth, and when I keep Calmly the count of my own life and see On what poor stuff my manhood’s dreams were fed Till I too learn’d what dole of vanity Will serve a human soul for daily bread, --Then I remember that I once was young And lived with Esther the world’s gods among.

_819._ _To Manon, on his Fortune in loving Her_

I did not choose thee, dearest. It was Love That made the choice, not I. Mine eyes were blind As a rude shepherd’s who to some lone grove His offering brings and cares not at what shrine He bends his knee. The gifts alone were mine; The rest was Love’s. He took me by the hand, And fired the sacrifice, and poured the wine, And spoke the words I might not understand. I was unwise in all but the dear chance Which was my fortune, and the blind desire Which led my foolish steps to Love’s abode, And youth’s sublime unreason’d prescience Which raised an altar and inscribed in fire Its dedication _To the Unknown God_.

_820._ _St. Valentines Day_

To-day, all day, I rode upon the down, With hounds and horsemen, a brave company On this side in its glory lay the sea, On that the Sussex weald, a sea of brown. The wind was light, and brightly the sun shone, And still we gallop’d on from gorse to gorse: And once, when check’d, a thrush sang, and my horse Prick’d his quick ears as to a sound unknown. I knew the Spring was come. I knew it even Better than all by this, that through my chase In bush and stone and hill and sea and heaven I seem’d to see and follow still your face. Your face my quarry was. For it I rode, My horse a thing of wings, myself a god.

_821._ _Gibraltar_

Seven weeks of sea, and twice seven days of storm Upon the huge Atlantic, and once more We ride into still water and the calm Of a sweet evening, screen’d by either shore Of Spain and Barbary. Our toils are o’er, Our exile is accomplish’d. Once again We look on Europe, mistress as of yore Of the fair earth and of the hearts of

men. Ay, this is the famed rock which Hercules And Goth and Moor bequeath’d us. At this door England stands sentry. God! to hear the shrill Sweet treble of her fifes upon the breeze, And at the summons of the rock gun's roar To see her red coats marching from the hill!

_822._ _Written at Florence_

O world, in very truth thou art too young; When wilt thou learn to wear the garb of age? World, with thy covering of yellow flowers, Hast thou forgot what generations sprung Out of thy loins and loved thee and are gone? Hast thou no place in all their heritage Where thou dost only weep, that I may come Nor fear the mockery of thy yellow flowers? O world, in very truth thou art too young. The heroic wealth of passionate emprize Built thee fair cities for thy naked plains: How hast thou set thy summer growth among The broken stones which were their palaces! Hast thou forgot the darkness where _he_ lies Who made thee beautiful, or have thy bees Found out his grave to build their honeycombs?

O world, in very truth thou art too young: They gave thee love who measured out thy skies, And, when they found for thee another star, Who made a festival and straightway hung The jewel on thy neck. O merry world, Hast thou forgot the glory of those eyes Which first look'd love in thine? Thou hast not furl'd One banner of thy bridal car for them. O world, in very truth thou art too young. There was a voice which sang about thy spring, Till winter froze the sweetness of his lips, And lo, the worms had hardly left his tongue Before thy nightingales were come again. O world, what courage hast thou thus to sing? Say, has thy merriment no secret pain, No sudden weariness that thou art young?

_823._ _The Two Highwaymen_

I long have had a quarrel set with Time Because he robb’d me. Every day of life Was wrested from me after bitter strife: I never yet could see the sun go down But I was angry in my heart, nor hear The leaves fall in the wind without a tear Over the dying summer. I have known No truce with Time nor Time’s accomplice, Death. The fair world is the witness of a crime Repeated every hour. For life and breath Are sweet to all who live; and bitterly The voices of these robbers of the heath Sound in each ear and chill the passer-by. --What have we done to thee, thou monstrous Time? What have we done to Death that we must die?

HENRY AUSTIN DOBSON

b. 1840

_824._ _A Garden Song_

Here in this sequester’d close Bloom the hyacinth and rose, Here beside the modest stock Flaunts the flaring hollyhock; Here, without a pang, one sees Ranks, conditions, and degrees.

All the seasons run their race In this quiet resting-place; Peach and apricot and fig Here will ripen and grow big; Here is store and overplus,— More had not

Alcinoüs!

Here, in alleys cool and green, Far ahead the thrush is seen; Here along the southern wall Keeps the bee his festival; All is quiet else—afar Sounds of toil and turmoil are.

Here be shadows large and long; Here be spaces meet for song; Grant, O garden-god, that I, Now that none profane is nigh,— Now that mood and moment please,— Find the fair Pierides!

_825._ _Urceus Exit_

Triolet

I intended an Ode, And it turn’d to a Sonnet It began _à la mode_, I intended an Ode; But Rose crossed the road In her latest new bonnet; I intended an Ode; And it turn’d to a Sonnet.

_826._ _In After Days_

Rondeau

In after days when grasses high O’er-top the stone where I shall lie, Though ill or well the world adjust My slender claim to honour’d dust, I shall not question nor reply.

I shall not see the morning sky; I shall not hear the night-wind sigh; I shall be mute, as all men must In after days!

But yet, now living, fain would I That some one then should testify, Saying--‘He held his pen in trust To Art, not serving shame or lust.’ Will none?--Then let my memory die In after days!

HENRY CLARENCE KENDALL

1841-1882

_827._ _Mooni_

He that is by Mooni now Sees the water-sapphires gleaming Where the River Spirit, dreaming, Sleeps by fall and fountain streaming Under lute of leaf and bough!-- Hears what stamp of Storm with stress is, Psalms from unseen wildernesses Deep amongst far hill-recesses-- He that is by Mooni now.

Yea, for him by Mooni’s marge Sings the yellow-hair’d September, With the face the gods remember, When the ridge is burnt to ember, And the dumb sea chains the barge! Where the mount like molten brass is, Down beneath fern-feather’d passes Noonday dew in cool green grasses Gleams on him by Mooni’s marge.

Who that dwells by Mooni yet, Feels in flowerful forest arches Smiting wings and breath that parches Where strong Summer’s path of march is, And the suns in thunder set! Housed beneath the gracious kirtle Of the shadowy water-myrtle-- Winds may kiss with heat and hurtle, He is safe by Mooni yet!

Days there were when he who sings (Dumb so long through passion’s losses) Stood where Mooni’s water crosses Shining tracks of green-hair’d mosses, Like a soul with radiant wings: Then the psalm the wind rehearses-- Then the song the stream disperses-- Lent a beauty to his verses, Who to-night of Mooni sings.

Ah, the theme--the sad, gray theme! Certain days are not above me, Certain hearts have ceased to love me, Certain fancies fail to move me, Like the effluent morning dream. Head whereon the white is stealing, Heart whose hurts are past all healing, Where is now the first, pure feeling? Ah, the theme--the sad, gray theme!

* * * * *

Still to be by Mooni cool-- Where the water-blossoms glister, And by gleaming vale and vista Sits the English April’s sister, Soft and sweet and wonderful! Just to rest beneath the burning Outer world--its sneers and spurning-- Ah, my heart--my heart is yearning Still to be by Mooni cool!

ARTHUR WILLIAM EDGAR O’SHAUGHNESSY

1844-1881

_828._ _Ode_

We are the music-makers, And we are the dreamers of dreams, Wandering by lone sea-breakers, And sitting by desolate streams; World-losers and world-forsakers, On whom the pale moon gleams: Yet we are the movers and shakers Of the world for ever, it seems.

With wonderful deathless ditties We build up the world’s great cities, And out of a fabulous story We fashion an empire’s glory: One man with a dream, at pleasure, Shall go forth and conquer a crown; And three with a new song’s measure Can trample an empire down.

We, in the ages lying In the buried past of the earth, Built Nineveh with our sighing, And Babel itself with our mirth; And o’erthrew them with prophesying To the old of the new world’s worth; For each age is a dream that is dying, Or one that is coming to birth.

_829._ _Song_

I made another garden, yea, For my new Love: I left the dead rose where it lay And set the new above. Why did my Summer not begin? Why did my heart not haste? My old Love came and walk’d therein, And laid the garden waste.

She enter’d with her weary smile, Just as of old; She look’d around a little while And shiver’d with the cold: Her passing touch was death to all, Her passing look a blight; She made the white rose-petals fall, And turn’d the red rose white.

Her pale robe clinging to the grass Seem’d like a snake That bit the grass and ground, alas! And a sad trail did make. She went up slowly to the gate, And then, just as of yore, She turn’d back at the last to wait And say farewell once more.

_830._ _The Fountain of Tears_

If you go over desert and mountain, Far into the country of Sorrow, To-day and to-night and to-morrow, And maybe for months and for years; You shall come with a heart that is bursting For trouble and toiling and thirsting. You shall certainly come to the fountain At length,--to the Fountain of Tears.

Very peaceful the place is, and solely For piteous lamenting and sighing, And those who come living or dying Alike from their hopes and their fears; Full of cypress-like shadows the place is, And statues that cover their faces: But out of the gloom springs the holy And beautiful Fountain of Tears.

And it flows and it flows with a motion So gentle and lovely and listless, And murmurs a tune so resistless To him who hath suffer'd and hears-- You shall surely--without a word spoken, Kneel down there and know your heart broken, And yield to the long-curb'd emotion That day by the Fountain of Tears.

For it grows and it grows, as though leaping Up higher the more one is thinking; And ever its tunes go on sinking More poignantly into the ears: Yea, so blessèd and good seems that fountain, Reach'd after dry desert and mountain, You shall fall down at length in your weeping And bathe your sad face in the tears.

Then alas! while you lie there a season And sob between living and dying, And give up the land you were trying To find 'mid your hopes and your fears; --O the world shall come up and pass o'er you, Strong men shall not stay to care for you, Nor wonder indeed for what reason Your way should seem harder than theirs.

But perhaps, while you lie, never lifting Your cheek from the wet leaves it presses, Nor caring to raise your wet tresses And look how the cold world appears-- O perhaps the mere silences round you-- All things in that place Grief hath found you-- Yea, e'en to the clouds o'er you drifting, May soothe you somewhat through your tears.

You may feel, when a falling leaf brushes Your face, as though some one had kiss'd you; Or think at least some one who miss'd you Had sent you a thought,--if that cheers; Or a bird's little song, faint and broken, May pass for a tender word spoken: --Enough, while around you there rushes That life-drowning torrent of tears.

And the tears shall flow faster and faster, Brim over and baffle resistance, And roll down blear'd roads to each distance Of past desolation and years; Till they cover the place of each sorrow, And leave you no past and no morrow: For what man is able to master And stem the great Fountain of Tears?

But the floods and the tears meet and gather; The sound of them all grows like thunder: --O into what bosom, I wonder, Is pour'd the whole sorrow of years? For Eternity only seems keeping Account of the great human weeping: May God, then, the Maker and Father-- May He find a place for the tears!

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY

1844-1890

_831._ _A White Rose_

The red rose whispers of passion, And the white rose breathes of love; O, the red rose is a falcon, And the white rose is a dove.

But I send you a cream-white rosebud With a flush on its petal tips; For the love that is purest and sweetest Has a kiss of desire on the lips.

ROBERT BRIDGES

b. 1844

_832._ _My Delight and Thy Delight_

My delight and thy delight Walking, like two angels white, In the gardens of the night:

My desire and thy desire Twining to a tongue of fire, Leaping live, and laughing higher:

Thro’ the everlasting strife In the mystery of life.

Love, from whom the world begun, Hath the secret of the sun.

Love can tell, and love alone, Whence the million stars were strewn, Why each atom knows its own, How, in spite of woe and death, Gay is life, and sweet is breath:

This he taught us, this we knew, Happy in his science true, Hand in hand as we stood ’Neath the shadows of the wood, Heart to heart as we lay In the dawning of the day.

_833._ _Spirits_

Angel spirits of sleep, White-robed, with silver hair, In your meadows fair, Where the willows weep, And the sad moonbeam On the gliding stream Writes her scatter’d dream:

Angel spirits of sleep, Dancing to the weir In the hollow roar Of its waters deep; Know ye how men say That ye haunt no more Isle and grassy shore With your moonlit play; That ye dance not here, White-robed spirits of sleep, All the summer night Threading dances light?

_834._ _Nightingales_

Beautiful must be the mountains whence ye come, And bright in the fruitful valleys the streams, wherefrom Ye learn your song: Where are those starry woods? O might I wander there, Among the flowers, which in that heavenly air Bloom the year long!

Nay, barren are those mountains and spent the streams: Our song is the voice of desire, that haunts our dreams, A throe of the heart, Whose pining visions dim, forbidden hopes profound, No dying cadence nor long sigh can sound, For all our art.

Alone, aloud in the raptured ear of men We pour our dark nocturnal secret; and then, As night is withdrawn From these sweet-springing meads and bursting boughs

of May, Dream, while the innumerable choir of day Welcome the dawn.

_835._ _A Passer-by_

Whither, O splendid ship, thy white sails crowding, Leaning across the bosom of the urgent West, That fearest nor sea rising, nor sky clouding, Whither away, fair rover, and what thy quest? Ah! soon, when Winter has all our vales opprest, When skies are cold and misty, and hail is hurling, Wilt thoù glìde on the blue Pacific, or rest In a summer haven asleep, thy white sails furling.

I there before thee, in the country that well thou knowest, Already arrived am inhaling the odorous air: I watch thee enter unerringly where thou goest, And anchor queen of the strange shipping there, Thy sails for awnings spread, thy masts bare: Nor is aught from the foaming reef to the snow-capp'd grandest Peak, that is over the feathery palms, more fair Than thou, so upright, so stately and still thou standest.

And yet, O splendid ship, unhail'd and nameless, I know not if, aiming a fancy, I rightly divine That thou hast a purpose joyful, a courage blameless, Thy port assured in a happier land than mine. But for all I have given thee, beauty enough is thine, As thou, aslant with trim tackle and shrouding, From the proud nostril curve of a prow's line In the offing scatterest foam, thy white sails crowding.

_836._ _Absence_

When my love was away, Full three days were not sped, I caught my fancy astray Thinking if she were dead,

And I alone, alone: It seem'd in my misery In all the world was none Ever so lone as I.

I wept; but it did not shame Nor comfort my heart: away I rode as I might, and came To my love at close of day.

The sight of her still'd my fears, My fairest-hearted love: And yet in her eyes were tears: Which when I questioned of,

'O now thou art come,' she cried, ''Tis fled: but I thought to-day I never could here abide, If thou wert longer away.'

_837._ _On a Dead Child_

Perfect little body, without fault or stain on thee, With promise of strength and manhood full and fair! Though cold and stark and bare, The bloom and the charm of life doth awhile remain on thee.

Thy mother's treasure wert thou;--alas! no longer To visit her heart with wondrous joy; to be Thy father's pride:--ah, he Must gather his faith together, and his strength make stronger.

To me, as I move thee now in the last duty, Dost thou with a turn or gesture anon respond; Startling my fancy fond With a chance attitude of the head, a freak of beauty.

Thy hand clasps, as ’twas wont, my finger, and holds it: But the grasp is the clasp of Death, heartbreaking and stiff; Yet feels to my hand as if ’Twas still thy will, thy pleasure and trust that enfolds it.

So I lay thee there, thy sunken eyelids closing,-- Go lie thou there in thy coffin, thy last little bed!-- Propping thy wise, sad head, Thy firm, pale hands across thy chest disposing.

So quiet! doth the change content thee?--Death, whither hath he taken thee? To a world, do I think, that rights the disaster of this? The vision of which I miss, Who weep for the body, and wish but to warm thee and awaken thee?

Ah! little at best can all our hopes avail us To lift this sorrow, or cheer us, when in the dark, Unwilling, alone we embark, And the things we have seen and have known and have heard of, fail us.

_838._ _Pater Filio_

Sense with keenest edge unusèd, Yet unsteel’d by scathing fire; Lovely feet as yet unbruisèd On the ways of dark desire; Sweetest hope that lookest smiling O’er the wilderness defiling!

Why such beauty, to be blighted By the swarm of foul destruction? Why such innocence delighted, When sin stalks to thy seduction? All the litanies e’er chaunted Shall not keep thy faith undaunted.

I have pray’d the sainted Morning To unclasp her hands to hold thee; From resignful Eve’s adorning Stol’n a robe of peace to enfold thee; With all charms of man’s contriving Arm’d thee for thy lonely striving.

Me too once unthinking Nature, --Whence Love’s timeless mockery took me,-- Fashion’d so divine a creature, Yea, and like a beast forsook me. I forgave, but tell the measure Of her crime in thee, my treasure.

_839._ _Winter Nightfall_

The day begins to droop,-- Its course is done: But nothing tells the place Of the setting sun.

The hazy darkness deepens, And up the lane You may hear, but cannot see, The homing wain.

An engine pants and hums In the farm hard by: Its lowering smoke is lost In the lowering sky.

The soaking branches drip, And all night through The dropping will not cease In the avenue.

A tall man there in the house Must keep his chair: He knows he will never again Breathe the spring air:

His heart is worn with work; He is giddy and sick If he rise to go as far As the nearest rick:

He thinks of his morn of life, His hale, strong years; And braves as he may the night Of darkness and tears.

_840._ _When Death to Either shall come_

When Death to either shall come,-- I pray it be first to me,-- Be happy as ever at home, If so, as I wish, it be.

Possess thy heart, my own; And sing to the child on thy knee, Or read to thyself alone The songs that I made for thee.

ANDREW LANG

1844-1912

_841._ _The Odyssey_

As one that for a weary space has lain Lull’d by the song of Circe and her wine In gardens near the pale of Proserpine, Where that Ææan isle forgets the main, And only the low lutes of love complain, And only shadows of wan lovers pine-- As such an one were glad to know the brine Salt on his lips, and the large air again-- So gladly from the songs of modern speech Men turn, and see the stars, and feel the free Shrill wind beyond the close of heavy flowers, And through the music of the languid hours They hear like Ocean on a western beach The surge and thunder of the Odyssey.

WILLIAM ERNEST HENLEY

1849-1903

_842._ _Invictus_

Out of the night that covers me, Black as the pit from pole to pole, I thank whatever gods may be For my unconquerable soul.

In the fell clutch of circumstance I have not winced nor cried aloud. Under the bludgeonings of chance My head is bloody, but unbow’d.

Beyond this place of wrath and tears Looms but the Horror of the shade, And yet the menace of the years Finds and shall find me unafraid.

It matters not how strait the gate, How charged with punishments the scroll, I am the master of my fate: I am the captain of my soul.

_843._ _Margaritæ Sorori_

A late lark twitters from the quiet skies: And from the west, Where the sun, his day’s work ended, Lingers as in content, There falls on the old, gray city An influence luminous and serene, A shining peace.

The smoke ascends In a rosy-and-golden haze. The spires Shine and are changed. In the valley Shadows rise. The lark sings on. The sun, Closing his benediction, Sinks, and the darkening air Thrills with a sense of the triumphing night-- Night with her train of stars And her great gift of sleep.

So be my passing! My task accomplish’d and the long day done, My wages taken, and in my heart Some late lark singing, Let me be gather’d to the quiet west, The sundown splendid and serene, Death.

_844._ _England, My England_

What have I done for you, England, my England? What is there I would not do, England, my own? With your glorious eyes austere, As the Lord were walking near, Whispering terrible things and dear As the Song on your bugles blown, England-- Round the world on your bugles blown?

Where shall the watchful sun, England, my England, Match the master-work you’ve done, England, my own? When shall he rejoice agen Such a breed of mighty men As come forward, one to ten, To the Song on your bugles blown, England-- Down the years on your bugles blown?

Ever the faith endures, England, my England:-- ‘Take and break us: we are yours, England, my own! Life is good, and joy runs high Between English earth and sky: Death is death; but we shall die To the Song on your bugles blown, England-- To the stars on your bugles blown!’

They call you proud and hard, England, my England: You with worlds to watch and ward, England, my own! You whose mail’d hand keeps the keys Of such teeming destinies, You could know nor dread nor ease Were the Song on your bugles blown, England, Round the Pit on your bugles blown!

Mother of Ships whose might, England, my England, Is the fierce old Sea’s delight, England, my own, Chosen daughter of the Lord, Spouse-in-Chief of the ancient Sword, There’s the menace of the Word In the Song on your bugles blown, England-- Out of heaven on your bugles blown!

EDMUND GOSSE

b. 1849

_845._ _Revelation_

Into the silver night She brought with her pale hand The topaz lanthorn-light, And darted splendour o’er the land; Around her in a band, Ringstraked and pied, the great soft moths came flying, And flapping with their mad wings, fann’d The flickering flame, ascending, falling, dying.

Behind the thorny pink Close wall of blossom’d may, I gazed thro’ one green chink And saw no more than thousands may,-- Saw sweetness, tender and gay,-- Saw full rose lips as rounded as the cherry, Saw braided locks more dark than bay, And flashing eyes decorous, pure, and merry.

With food for furry friends She pass’d, her lamp and she, Till eaves and gable-ends Hid all that saffron sheen from me: Around my rosy tree Once more the silver-starry night was shining, With depths of heaven, dewy and free, And crystals of a carven moon declining.

Alas! for him who dwells In frigid air of thought, When warmer light dispels The frozen calm his spirit sought; By life too lately taught He sees the ecstatic Human from him stealing; Reels from the joy experience brought, And dares not clutch what Love was half revealing.

ROBERT LOUIS STEVENSON

1850-1894

_846._ _Romance_

I will make you brooches and toys for your delight Of bird-song at morning and star-shine at night. I will make a palace fit for you and me, Of green days in forests and blue days at sea.

I will make my kitchen, and you shall keep your room, Where white flows the river and bright blows the broom, And you shall wash your linen and keep your body white In rainfall at morning and dewfall at night.

And this shall be for music when no one else is near, The fine song for singing, the rare song to hear! That only I remember, that only you admire, Of the broad road that stretches and the roadside fire.

_847._ _In the Highlands_

In the highlands, in the country places, Where the old plain men have rosy faces, And the young fair maidens Quiet eyes; Where essential silence cheers and blesses, And for ever in the hill-recesses _Her_ more lovely music Broods and dies--

O to mount again where erst I haunted; Where the old red hills are bird-enchanted, And the low green meadows Bright with sward; And when even dies, the million-tinted, And the night has come, and planets glinted, Lo, the valley hollow Lamp-bestarr’d!

O to dream, O to awake and wander There, and with delight to take and render, Through the trance of silence, Quiet breath! Lo! for there, among the flowers and grasses, Only the mightier movement sounds and passes; Only winds and rivers, Life and death.

_848._ _Requiem_

Under the wide and starry sky Dig the grave and let me lie: Glad did I live and gladly die, And I laid me down with a will.

This be the verse you grave for me: _Here he lies where he long’d to be;_ _Home is the sailor, home from sea,_ _And the hunter home from the hill._

T. W. ROLLESTON

b. 1857

_849._ _The Dead at Clonmacnois_

FROM THE IRISH OF ANGUS O’GILLAN

In a quiet water’d land, a land of roses, Stands Saint Kieran’s city fair; And the warriors of Erin in their famous generations Slumber there.

There beneath the dewy hillside sleep the noblest Of the clan of Conn, Each below his stone with name in branching Ogham And the sacred knot thereon.

There they laid to rest the seven Kings of Tara, There the sons of Cairbrè sleep--Battle-banners of the Gael that in Kieran’s plain of crosses Now their final hosting keep.

And in Clonmacnois they laid the men of Teffia, And right many a lord of Breagh; Deep the sod above Clan Creidè and Clan Conaill, Kind in hall and fierce in fray.

Many and many a son of Conn the Hundred-Fighter In the red earth lies at rest; Many a blue eye of Clan Colman the turf covers, Many a swan-white breast.

JOHN DAVIDSON

1857-1909

_850._ _Song_

The boat is chafing at our long delay, And we must leave too soon The spicy sea-pinks and the inborne spray, The tawny sands, the moon.

Keep us, O Thetis, in our western flight! Watch from thy pearly throne Our vessel, plunging deeper into night To reach a land unknown.

_851._ _The Last Rose_

‘O which is the last rose?’ A blossom of no name. At midnight the snow came; At daybreak a vast rose, In darkness unfurl’d, O’er-petall’d the world.

Its odourless pallor Blossom’d forlorn, Till radiant valour Established the morn--Till the night Was undone In her fight With the sun.

The brave orb in state rose, And crimson he shone first; While from the high vine Of heaven the dawn burst, Staining the great rose From sky-line to sky-line.

The red rose of morn A white rose at noon turn’d; But at sunset reborn All red again soon burn’d. Then the pale rose of noonday Rebloom’d in the night, And spectrally white In the light Of the moon lay.

But the vast rose Was scentless, And this is the reason: When the blast rose Relentless, And brought in due season The snow rose, the last rose Congeal’d in its breath, Then came with it treason; The traitor was Death.

In lee-valleys crowded, The sheep and the birds Were frozen and shrouded In flights and in herds. In highways And byways The young and the old Were tortured and madden’d And kill’d by the cold. But many were gladden’d By the beautiful last rose, The blossom of no name That came when the snow came, In darkness unfurl’d--The wonderful vast rose That fill’d all the world.

WILLIAM WATSON

b. 1858

_852._ _Song_

April, April, Laugh thy girlish laughter; Then, the moment after, Weep thy girlish tears! April, that mine ears Like a lover greetest, If I tell thee, sweetest, All my hopes and fears, April, April, Laugh thy golden laughter, But, the moment after, Weep thy golden tears!

_853._ _Ode in May_

Let me go forth, and share The overflowing Sun With one wise friend, or one Better than wise, being fair, Where the pewit wheels and dips On heights of bracken and ling, And Earth, unto her leaflet tips, Tingles with the Spring.

What is so sweet and dear As a prosperous morn in May, The confident prime of the day, And the dauntless youth of the year, When nothing that asks for bliss, Asking aright, is denied, And half of the world a bridegroom is, And half of the world a bride?

The Song of Mingling flows, Grave, ceremonial, pure, As once, from lips that endure, The cosmic descant rose, When the temporal lord of life, Going his golden way, Had taken a wondrous maid to wife That long had said him nay.

For of old the Sun, our sire, Came wooing the mother of men, Earth, that was virginal then, Vestal fire to his fire. Silent her bosom and coy, But the strong god sued and press'd; And born of their starry nuptial joy Are all that drink of her breast.

And the triumph of him that begot, And the travail of her that bore, Behold they are evermore As warp and weft in our lot. We are children of splendour and flame, Of shuddering, also, and tears. Magnificent out of the dust we came, And abject from the Spheres.

O bright irresistible lord! We are fruit of Earth's womb, each one, And fruit of thy loins, O Sun, Whence first was the seed outpour'd. To thee as our Father we bow, Forbidden thy Father to see, Who is older and greater than thou, as thou Art greater and older than we.

Thou art but as a word of his speech; Thou art but as a wave of his hand; Thou art brief as a glitter of sand 'Twixt tide and tide on his beach; Thou art less than a spark of his fire, Or a moment's mood of his soul: Thou art lost in the notes on the lips of his choir That chant the chant of the Whole.

_854._ _The Great Misgiving_

'Not ours,' say some, 'the thought of death to dread; Asking no heaven, we fear no fabled hell: Life is a feast, and we have banqueted-- Shall not the worms as well?

'The after-silence, when the feast is o'er, And void the places where the minstrels stood, Differs in nought from what hath been before, And is nor ill nor good.'

Ah, but the Apparition--the dumb sign-- The beckoning finger bidding me forgo The fellowship, the converse, and the wine, The songs, the festal glow!

And ah, to know not, while with friends I sit, And while the purple joy is pass’d about, Whether ’tis ampler day divinelier lit Or homeless night without;

And whether, stepping forth, my soul shall see New prospects, or fall sheer--a blinded thing! _There_ is, O grave, thy hourly victory, And there, O death, thy sting.

HENRY CHARLES BEECHING

1859-1919

_855._ _Prayers_

God who created me Nimble and light of limb, In three elements free, To run, to ride, to swim: Not when the sense is dim, But now from the heart of joy, I would remember Him: Take the thanks of a boy.

Jesu, King and Lord, Whose are my foes to fight, Gird me with Thy sword Swift and sharp and bright. Thee would I serve if I might; And conquer if I can, From day-dawn till night, Take the strength of a man.

Spirit of Love and Truth, Breathing in grosser clay, The light and flame of youth, Delight of men in the fray, Wisdom in strength’s decay; From pain, strife, wrong to be free, This best gift I pray, Take my spirit to Thee.

_856._ _Going down Hill on a Bicycle_

A BOY’S SONG

With lifted feet, hands still, I am poised, and down the hill Dart, with heedful mind; The air goes by in a wind.

Swifter and yet more swift, Till the heart with a mighty lift Makes the lungs laugh, the throat cry:-- ‘O bird, see; see, bird, I fly.

‘Is this, is this your joy? O bird, then I, though a boy, For a golden moment share Your feathery life in air!’

Say, heart, is there aught like this In a world that is full of bliss? ’Tis more than skating, bound Steel-shod to the level ground.

Speed slackens now, I float Awhile in my airy boat; Till, when the wheels scarce crawl, My feet to the treadles fall.

Alas, that the longest hill Must end in a vale; but still, Who climbs with toil, wheresoe’er, Shall find wings waiting there.

BLISS CARMAN

b. 1861

_857._ _Why_

For a name unknown, Whose fame unblown Sleeps in the hills For ever and aye;

For her who hears The stir of the years Go by on the wind By night and day;

And heeds no thing Of the needs of spring, Of autumn’s wonder Or winter’s chill; For one who sees The great sun freeze, As he wanders a-cold From hill to hill;

And all her heart Is a woven part Of the flurry and drift Of whirling snow;

For the sake of two Sad eyes and true, And the old, old love So long ago.

DOUGLAS HYDE

b. 1861

_858._ _My Grief on the Sea_

FROM THE IRISH

My grief on the sea, How the waves of it roll! For they heave between me And the love of my soul!

Abandon’d, forsaken, To grief and to care, Will the sea ever waken Relief from despair?

My grief and my trouble! Would he and I were, In the province of Leinster, Or County of Clare!

Were I and my darling-- O heart-bitter wound!-- On board of the ship For America bound.

On a green bed of rushes All last night I lay, And I flung it abroad With the heat of the day.

And my Love came behind me, He came from the South; His breast to my bosom, His mouth to my mouth.

ARTHUR CHRISTOPHER BENSON

b. 1862

_859._ _The Phœnix_

BY feathers green, across Casbeen The pilgrims track the Phœnix flown, By gems he strew’d in waste and wood, And jewell’d plumes at random thrown.

Till wandering far, by moon and star, They stand beside the fruitful pyre, Where breaking bright with sanguine light The impulsive bird forgets his sire.

Those ashes shine like ruby wine, Like bag of Tyrian murex spilt, The claw, the jowl of the flying fowl Are with the glorious anguish gilt.

So rare the light, so rich the sight, Those pilgrim men, on profit bent, Drop hands and eyes and merchandise, And are with gazing most content.

HENRY NEWBOLT

b. 1862

_860._ _He fell among Thieves_

‘Ye have robb’d,’ said he, ‘ye have slaughtered and made an end, Take your ill-got plunder, and bury the dead: What will ye more of your guest and sometime friend?’ ‘Blood for our blood,’ they said.

He laugh’d: ‘If one may settle the score for five, I am ready; but let the reckoning stand till day: I have loved the sunlight as dearly as any alive.’ ‘You shall die at dawn,’ said they.

He flung his empty revolver down the slope, He climb’d alone to the Eastward edge of the trees: All night long in a dream untroubled of hope He brooded, clasping his knees.

He did not hear the monotonous roar that fills The ravine where the Yassîn river sullenly flows; He did not see the starlight on the Laspur hills, Or the far Afghan snows.

He saw the April noon on his books aglow, The wistaria trailing in at the window wide; He heard his father’s voice from the terrace below Calling him down to ride.

He saw the gray little church across the park, The mounds that hid the loved and honour’d dead; The Norman arch, the chancel softly dark, The brasses black and red.

He saw the School Close, sunny and green, The runner beside him, the stand by the parapet wall, The distant tape, and the crowd roaring between, His own name over all.

He saw the dark wainscot and timber’d roof, The long tables, and the faces merry and keen; The College Eight and their trainer dining aloof, The Dons on the daïs serene.

He watch’d the liner’s stem ploughing the foam, He felt her trembling speed and the thrash of her screw; He heard the passengers’ voices talking of home, He saw the flag she flew.

And now it was dawn. He rose strong on his feet, And strode to his ruin’d camp below the wood; He drank the breath of the morning cool and sweet: His murderers round him stood.

Light on the Laspur hills was broadening fast, The blood-red snow-peaks chill’d to a dazzling white; He turn’d, and saw the golden circle at last, Cut by the Eastern height.

‘O glorious Life, Who dwellest in earth and sun, I have lived, I praise and adore Thee.’ A sword swept. Over the pass the voices one by one Faded, and the hill slept.

GILBERT PARKER

b. 1862

_861._ _Reunited_

When you and I have play’d the little hour, Have seen the tall subaltern Life to Death Yield up his sword; and, smiling, draw the breath, The first long breath of freedom; when the flower Of Recompense hath flutter’d to our feet, As to an actor’s; and, the curtain down, We turn to face each other all alone-- Alone, we two, who never yet did meet, Alone, and absolute, and free: O then, O then, most dear, how shall be told the tale? Clasp’d hands, press’d lips, and so clasp’d hands again; No words. But as the proud wind fills the sail, My love to yours shall reach, then one deep moan Of joy, and then our infinite Alone.

WILLIAM BUTLER YEATS

b. 1865

_862._ _Where My Books go_

All the words that I utter, And all the words that I write, Must spread out their wings untiring, And never rest in their flight, Till they come where your sad, sad heart is, And sing to you in the night, Beyond where the waters are moving, Storm-darken’d or starry bright.

_863._ _When You are Old_

When you are old and gray and full of sleep And nodding by the fire, take down this book, And slowly read, and dream of the soft look Your eyes had once, and of their shadows deep;

How many loved your moments of glad grace, And loved your beauty with love false or true; But one man loved the pilgrim soul in you, And loved the sorrows of your changing face.

And bending down beside the glowing bars, Murmur, a little sadly, how love fled And paced upon the mountains overhead, And hid his face amid a crowd of stars.

_864._ _The Lake Isle of Innisfree_

I will arise and go now, and go to Innisfree, And a small cabin build there, of clay and wattles made; Nine bean rows will I have there, a hive for the honey bee, And live alone in the bee-loud glade.

And I shall have some peace there, for peace comes dropping slow, Dropping from the veils of the morning to where the cricket sings; There midnight’s all a-glimmer, and noon a purple glow, And evening full of the linnet’s wings.

I will arise and go now, for always night and day I hear lake water lapping with low sounds by the shore; While I stand on the roadway, or on the pavements gray, I hear it in the deep heart’s core.

RUDYARD KIPLING

b. 1865

_865._ _A Dedication_

My new-cut ashlar takes the light Where crimson-blank the windows flare; By my own work, before the night, Great Overseer, I make my prayer.

If there be good in that I wrought, Thy hand compell’d it, Master, Thine; Where I have fail’d to meet Thy thought I know, through Thee, the blame is mine.

One instant’s toil to Thee denied Stands all Eternity’s offence; Of that I did with Thee to guide To Thee, through Thee, be excellence.

Who, lest all thought of Eden fade, Bring’st Eden to the craftsman’s brain, Godlike to muse o’er his own trade And manlike stand with God again.

The depth and dream of my desire, The bitter paths wherein I stray, Thou knowest Who hast made the Fire, Thou knowest Who hast made the Clay.

One stone the more swings to her place In that dread Temple of Thy worth-- It is enough that through Thy grace I saw naught common on Thy earth.

Take not that vision from my ken; O, whatsoe’er may spoil or speed, Help me to need no aid from men, That I may help such men as need!

_866._ _L’Envoi_

There’s a whisper down the field where the year has shot her yield And the ricks stand gray to the sun, Singing:--‘Over then, come over, for the bee has quit the clover And your English summer’s done.’ You have heard the beat of the off-shore wind And the thresh of the deep-sea rain; You have heard the song--how long! how long! Pull out on the trail again!

Ha’ done with the Tents of Shem, dear lass, We’ve seen the seasons through, And it’s time to turn on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, Pull out, pull out, on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

It’s North you may run to the rime-ring’d sun, Or South to the blind Horn’s hate; Or East all the way into Mississippi Bay, Or West to the Golden Gate; Where the blindest bluffs hold good, dear lass, And the wildest tales are true, And the men bulk big on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, And life runs large on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

The days are sick and cold, and the skies are gray and old, And the twice-breathed airs blow damp; And I’d sell my tired soul for the bucking beam-sea roll Of a black Bilbao tramp; With her load-line over her hatch, dear lass, And a drunken Dago crew, And her nose held down on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, From Cadiz Bar on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

There be triple ways to take, of the eagle or the snake, Or the way of a man with a maid; But the sweetest way to me is a ship’s upon the sea In the heel of the North-East Trade. Can you hear the crash on her bows, dear lass, And the drum of the racing screw, As she ships it green on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, As

she lifts and ’scends on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new?

See the shaking funnels roar, with the Peter at the fore, And the fenders grind and heave, And the derricks clack and grate, as the tackle hooks the crate, And the fall-rope whines through the sheave; It’s ‘Gang-plank up and in,’ dear lass, It’s ‘Hawsers warp her through!’ And it’s ‘All clear aft’ on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, We’re backing down on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

O the mutter overside, when the port-fog holds us tied, And the sirens hoot their dread! When foot by foot we creep o’er the hueless viewless deep To the sob of the questing lead! It’s down by the Lower Hope, dear lass, With the Gunfleet Sands in view, Till the Mouse swings green on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, And the Gull Light lifts on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

O the blazing tropic night, when the wake’s a welt of light That holds the hot sky tame, And the steady fore-foot snores through the planet-powder’d floors Where the scared whale flukes in flame! Her plates are scarr’d by the sun, dear lass, And her ropes are taut with the dew, For we’re booming down on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, We’re sagging south on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

Then home, get her home, where the drunken rollers comb, And the shouting seas drive by, And the engines stamp and ring, and the wet bows reel and swing, And the Southern Cross rides high! Yes, the old lost stars wheel back, dear lass, That blaze in the velvet blue. They’re all old friends on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, They’re God’s own guides on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

Fly forward, O my heart, from the Foreland to the Start-- We’re steaming all too slow, And it’s twenty thousand mile to our little lazy isle Where the trumpet-orchids blow! You have heard the call of the off-shore wind And the voice of the deep-sea rain; You have heard the song--how long! how long! Pull out on the trail again!

The Lord knows what we may find, dear lass, And the deuce knows what we may do-- But we’re back once more on the old trail, our own trail, the out trail, We’re down, hull down on the Long Trail--the trail that is always new.

_867._ _Recessional_

June 22, 1897

God of our fathers, known of old-- Lord of our far-flung battle-line-- Beneath whose awful Hand we hold Dominion over palm and pine-- Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet, Lest we forget, lest we forget!

The tumult and the shouting dies-- The captains and the kings depart-- Still stands Thine ancient sacrifice, An humble and a contrite heart. Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet, Lest we forget, lest we forget!

Far-call’d our navies melt away-- On dune and headland sinks the fire-- Lo, all our pomp of yesterday Is one with Nineveh and Tyre! Judge of the Nations, spare us yet, Lest we forget, lest we forget!

If, drunk with sight of power, we loose Wild tongues that have not Thee in awe-- Such boasting as the Gentiles use Or lesser breeds without the Law-- Lord God of Hosts, be with us yet, Lest we forget, lest we forget!

For heathen heart that puts her trust In reeking tube and iron shard-- All valiant dust that builds on dust, And guarding calls not Thee to guard-- For frantic boast and foolish word, Thy Mercy on Thy People, Lord!

RICHARD LE GALLIENNE

b. 1866

_868._ _Song_

She’s somewhere in the sunlight strong, Her tears are in the falling rain, She calls me in the wind’s soft song, And with the flowers she comes again.

Yon bird is but her messenger, The moon is but her silver car; Yea! sun and moon are sent by her, And every wistful waiting star.

_869._ _The Second Crucifixion_

Loud mockers in the roaring street Say Christ is crucified again: Twice pierced His gospel-bearing feet, Twice broken His great heart in vain.

I hear, and to myself I smile, For Christ talks with me all the while.

No angel now to roll the stone From off His unawaking sleep, In vain shall Mary watch alone, In vain the soldiers vigil keep.

Yet while they deem my Lord is dead My eyes are on His shining head.

Ah! never more shall Mary hear That voice exceeding sweet and low Within the garden calling clear: Her Lord is gone, and she must go.

Yet all the while my Lord I meet In every London lane and street.

Poor Lazarus shall wait in vain, And Bartimæus still go blind; The healing hem shall ne’er again Be touch’d by suffering humankind.

Yet all the while I see them rest, The poor and outcast, on His breast.

No more unto the stubborn heart With gentle knocking shall He plead, No more the mystic pity start, For Christ twice dead is dead indeed.

So in the street I hear men say, Yet Christ is with me all the day.

LAURENCE BINYON

b. 1869

_870._ _Invocation to Youth_

Come then, as ever, like the wind at morning! Joyous, O Youth, in the agèd world renew Freshness to feel the eternities around it, Rain, stars and clouds, light and the

sacred dew. The strong sun shines above thee: That strength, that radiance bring! If Winter come to Winter, When shall men hope for Spring?

_871._ _O World, be Nobler_

O World, be nobler, for her sake! If she but knew thee what thou art, What wrongs are borne, what deeds are done In thee, beneath thy daily sun, Know’st thou not that her tender heart For pain and very shame would break? O World, be nobler, for her sake!

GEORGE WILLIAM RUSSELL (‘A. E.’)

b. 1853

_872._ _By the Margin of the Great Deep_

When the breath of twilight blows to flame the misty skies, All its vaporous sapphire, violet glow and silver gleam, With their magic flood me through the gateway of the eyes; I am one with the twilight’s dream.

When the trees and skies and fields are one in dusky mood, Every heart of man is rapt within the mother’s breast: Full of peace and sleep and dreams in the vasty quietude, I am one with their hearts at rest.

From our immemorial joys of hearth and home and love Stray’d away along the margin of the unknown tide, All its reach of soundless calm can thrill me far above Word or touch from the lips beside.

Aye, and deep and deep and deeper let me drink and draw From the olden fountain more than light or peace or dream, Such primæval being as o’erfills the heart with awe, Growing one with its silent stream.

_873._ _The Great Breath_

Its edges foam’d with amethyst and rose, Withers once more the old blue flower of day: There where the ether like a diamond glows, Its petals fade away.

A shadowy tumult stirs the dusky air; Sparkle the delicate dews, the distant snows; The great deep thrills--for through it everywhere The breath of Beauty blows.

I saw how all the trembling ages past, Moulded to her by deep and deeper breath, Near’d to the hour when Beauty breathes her last And knows herself in death.

T. STURGE MOORE

b. 1870

_874._ _A Duet_

‘Flowers nodding gaily, scent in air, Flowers posied, flowers for the hair, Sleepy flowers, flowers bold to stare----’ ‘O pick me some!’

‘Shells with lip, or tooth, or bleeding gum, Tell-tale shells, and shells that whisper _Come_, Shells that stammer, blush, and yet are dumb----’ ‘O let me hear.’

‘Eyes so black they draw one trembling near, Brown eyes, caverns flooded with a tear, Cloudless eyes, blue eyes so windy clear----’ ‘O look at me!’

‘Kisses sadly blown across the sea, Darkling kisses, kisses fair and free, Bob-a-cherry kisses ’neath a tree----’ ‘O give me one!’

Thus sang a king and queen in Babylon.

FRANCIS THOMPSON

1859-1907

_875._ _The Poppy_

Summer set lip to earth’s bosom bare, And left the flush’d print in a poppy there; Like a yawn of fire from the grass it came, And the fanning wind puff’d it to flapping flame.

With burnt mouth red like a lion’s it drank The blood of the sun as he slaughter’d sank, And dipp’d its cup in the purpurate shine When the eastern conduits ran with wine.

Till it grew lethargied with fierce bliss, And hot as a swinkèd gipsy is, And drowsed in sleepy savageries, With mouth wide a-pout for a sultry kiss.

A child and man paced side by side, Treading the skirts of eventide; But between the clasp of his hand and hers Lay, felt not, twenty wither’d years.

She turn’d, with the rout of her dusk South hair, And saw the sleeping gipsy there; And snatch’d and snapp’d it in swift child’s whim, With--‘Keep it, long as you live!’--to him.

And his smile, as nymphs from their laving meres, Trembled up from a bath of tears; And joy, like a mew sea-rock’d apart, Toss’d on the wave of his troubled heart.

For _he_ saw what she did not see, That--as kindled by its own fervency-- The verge shrivell’d inward smoulderingly:

And suddenly ’twixt his hand and hers He knew the twenty withered years-- No flower, but twenty shrivelled years.

‘Was never such thing until this hour,’ Low to his heart he said; ‘the flower Of sleep brings wakening to me, And of oblivion memory.’

‘Was never this thing to me,’ he said, ‘Though with bruisèd poppies my feet are red!’ And again to his own heart very low: ‘O child! I love, for I love and know;

‘But you, who love nor know at all The diverse chambers in Love’s guest-hall, Where some rise early, few sit long: In how differing accents hear the throng His great Pentecostal tongue;

‘Who know not love from amity, Nor my reported self from me; A fair fit gift is this, meseems, You give--this withering flower of dreams.

‘O frankly fickle, and fickly true, Do you know what the days will do to you? To your Love and you what the days will do, O frankly fickle, and fickly true?

‘You have loved me, Fair, three lives--or days: ’Twill pass with the passing of my face. But where _I_ go, your face goes too, To watch lest I play false to you.

‘I am but, my sweet, your foster-lover, Knowing well when certain years are over You vanish from me to another; Yet I know, and love, like the foster-mother.

‘So, frankly fickle, and fickly true! For my brief life-while I take from you This token, fair and fit, meseems, For me--this withering flower of dreams.’

* * * * *

The sleep-flower sways in the wheat its head, Heavy with dreams, as that with bread: The goodly grain and the sun-flush’d sleeper The reaper reaps, and Time the reaper.

I hang ’mid men my needless head, And my fruit is dreams, as theirs is bread: The goodly men and the sun-hazed sleeper Time shall reap, but after the reaper The world shall glean of me, me the sleeper!

Love! love! your flower of wither’d dream In leavèd rhyme lies safe, I deem, Shelter’d and shut in a nook of rhyme, From the reaper man, and his reaper Time.

Love! _I_ fall into the claws of Time: But lasts within a leavèd rhyme All that the world of me esteems-- My wither’d dreams, my wither’d dreams.

HENRY CUST

1861-1917

_876._ _Non Nobis_

Not unto us, O Lord, Not unto us the rapture of the day, The peace of night, or love’s divine surprise, High heart, high speech, high deeds ’mid honouring eyes; For at Thy word All these are taken away.

Not unto us, O Lord: To us thou givest the scorn, the scourge, the scar, The ache of life, the loneliness of death, The insufferable sufficiency of breath; And with Thy sword Thou piercest very far.

Not unto us, O Lord: Nay, Lord, but unto her be all things given-- My light and life and earth and sky be blasted-- But let not all that wealth of loss be wasted: Let Hell afford The pavement of her Heaven!

KATHARINE TYNAN HINKSON

b. 1861

_877._ _Sheep and Lambs_

All in the April morning, April airs were abroad; The sheep with their little lambs Pass’d me by on the road.

The sheep with their little lambs Pass’d me by on the road; All in an April evening I thought on the Lamb of God.

The lambs were weary, and crying With a weak human cry, I thought on the Lamb of God Going meekly to die.

Up in the blue, blue mountains Dewy pastures are sweet: Rest for the little bodies, Rest for the little feet.

Rest for the Lamb of God Up on the hill-top green, Only a cross of shame Two stark crosses between.

All in the April evening, April airs were abroad; I saw the sheep with their lambs, And thought on the Lamb of God.

FRANCES BANNERMAN

_878._ _An Upper Chamber_

I came into the City and none knew me; None came forth, none shouted ‘He is here! Not a hand with laurel would bestrew me, All the way by which I drew anear-- Night my banner, and my herald Fear.

But I knew where one so long had waited In the low room at the stairway’s height, Trembling lest my foot should be belated, Singing, sighing for the long hours’ flight Towards the moment of our dear delight.

I came into the City when you hail’d me Saviour, and again your chosen Lord:-- Not one guessing what it was that fail’d me, While along the way as they adored Thousands, thousands, shouted in accord.

But through all the joy I knew--I only-- How the hostel of my heart lay bare and cold, Silent of its music, and how lonely! Never, though you crown me with your gold, Shall I find that little chamber as of old!

ALICE MEYNELL

b. 1850

_879._ _Renouncement_

I must not think of thee; and, tired yet strong, I shun the love that lurks in all delight-- The love of thee--and in the blue heaven’s height, And in the dearest passage of a song. Oh, just beyond the sweetest thoughts that throng This breast, the thought of thee waits hidden yet bright; But it must never, never come in sight; I must stop short of thee the whole day long. But when sleep comes to close each difficult day, When night gives pause to the long watch I keep, And all my bonds I needs must loose

apart, Must doff my will as raiment laid away,-- With the first dream that comes with the first sleep I run, I run, I am gather’d to thy heart.

_880._ _The Lady of the Lambs_

She walks--the lady of my delight-- A shepherdess of sheep. Her flocks are thoughts. She keeps them white; She guards them from the steep. She feeds them on the fragrant height And folds them in for sleep.

She roams maternal hills and bright, Dark valleys safe and deep. Her dreams are innocent at night; The chastest stars may peep. She walks--the lady of my delight-- A shepherdess of sheep.

She holds her little thoughts in sight, Though gay they run and leap. She is so circumspect and right; She has her soul to keep. She walks--the lady of my delight-- A shepherdess of sheep.

DORA SIGERSON

d. 1918

_881._ _Ireland_

’Twas the dream of a God, And the mould of His hand, That you shook ’neath His stroke, That you trembled and broke To this beautiful land.

Here He loosed from His hold A brown tumult of wings, Till the wind on the sea Bore the strange melody Of an island that sings.

He made you all fair, You in purple and gold, You in silver and green, Till no eye that has seen Without love can behold.

I have left you behind In the path of the past, With the white breath of flowers, With the best of God’s hours, I have left you at last.

MARGARET L. WOODS

b. 1856

_882._ _Genius Loci_

Peace, Shepherd, peace! What boots it singing on? Since long ago grace-giving Phœbus died, And all the train that loved the stream-bright side Of the poetic mount with him are gone Beyond the shores of Styx and Acheron, In unexplorèd realms of night to hide. The clouds that strew their shadows far and wide Are all of Heaven that visits Helicon. Yet here, where never muse or god did haunt, Still may some nameless power of Nature stray, Pleased with the reedy stream’s continual chant And purple pomp of these broad fields in May. The shepherds meet him where he herds the kine, And careless pass him by whose is the gift divine.

R. D. BLACKMORE

1825-1900

_883._ _Dominus Illuminatio Mea_

In the hour of death, after this life’s whim, When the heart beats low, and the eyes grow dim, And pain has exhausted every limb-- The lover of the Lord shall trust in Him.

When the will has forgotten the lifelong aim, And the mind can only disgrace its fame, And a man is uncertain of his own name-- The power of the Lord shall fill this frame.

When the last sigh is heaved, and the last tear shed, And the coffin is waiting beside the bed, And the widow and child forsake the dead-- The angel of the Lord shall lift this head.

For even the purest delight may pall, And power must fail, and the pride must fall, And the love of the dearest friends grow small-- But the glory of the Lord is all in all.

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